



BRAHMANDA PURANA

Volume 2



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BRAHMANDA PURANA: VOLUME 2

Bibek Debroy is a renowned economist, scholar and translator. He has worked in universities, research institutes, industry and for the government. He has widely published books, papers and articles on economics. As a translator, he is best known for his magnificent rendition of the Mahabharata in ten volumes, the three-volume translation of the Valmiki Ramayana and the *Shiva Purana*, along with the *Harivamsha*, *Bhagavata Purana*, *Markandeya Purana*, *Brahma Purana* and *Vishnu Purana*, published to wide acclaim by Penguin Classics. He is also the author of *Sarama and Her Children*, which splices his interest in Hinduism with his love for dogs.

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PRAISE FOR *SHIVA PURANA*

‘Bibek Debroy’s translation of the *Shiva Purana* is written in an easy-to-understand language, with copious footnotes, and marked by scrupulous attention to consistency in the use of terms. The greater use of Sanskrit terms that do not have an exact or reasonably accurate translation in English is eased for the reader through the use of explanatory footnotes’—News18

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‘The Puranas are 18 volumes with more than four lakh *shlokas*, and all in Sanskrit—the language of our ancestors and the sages, which only a few can speak and read today and only a handful have the mastery to translate. Bibek Debroy is one such master translator, who wears the twin title of economist and Sanskrit scholar, doing equal justice to both’—*Outlook*

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Markandeya is asked to answer some deeper questions raised by the events in the Mahabharata’—*Indian Express*

‘Bibek Debroy’s translation of the *Markandeya Purana* presents the English reader with an opportunity to read the unabridged version in English. As he writes in the introduction, “*But all said and done, there is no substitute to reading these texts in the original Sanskrit.*” If you cannot read the original in Sanskrit, this is perhaps the next best thing’—Abhinav Agarwal

PRAISE FOR *VISHNU PURANA*

‘Bibek Debroy’s unabridged translation brings his trademark felicity of prose. Copious footnotes, numbering over a thousand, and scrupulous attention to keeping this a translation and not an interpretation, make this a much-needed and valuable text’—Firstpost

‘Like the others, this *Purana* captures ancient and medieval stories, and concepts of Hinduism in a range and complexity that no other Sanskrit texts offer . . . or the *Vishnu Purana* ends on a sombre note, but not without offering hope that those who chant Vishnu’s name can still reclaim dharma’—*Business Standard*

‘Immense credit to the translator for keeping the flow as light and engaging as the original may allow and for capturing and conveying intact the soul of the *Vishnu Purana* . . . In essence, this text functions as a concise encyclopaedia of perhaps the most evolved research and thought of the time and a 360-degree portrayal of Lord Vishnu in myriad forms aggregated from various oral or lost sources and tales . . . A treasure trove; a slow-paced perusal of the text is an eye-opener, an education in itself’—*New Indian Express*

PRAISE FOR *THE BRAHMA PURANA*

‘In two volumes and over 1000 pages, Mr Debroy’s translation of what is called the Adi Purana (or the original Purana) brings alive the many myths and legends surrounding Hindu gods, traditions, customs and ways of living’—*Business Standard*

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To Murli Manohar Joshi . . .

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Introduction

The word ‘Purana’ means old, ancient. The Puranas are old texts, usually referred to in conjunction with Itihasa (the Ramayana and the Mahabharata). ¹ Whether Itihasa originally meant only the Mahabharata, with the Ramayana being added to that expression later, is a proposition on which there has been some discussion. But that’s not relevant to our purposes. In the Chandogya Upanishad, there is an instance of the sage Narada approaching the sage Sanatkumara for instruction. Asked about what he already knows, Narada says he knows Itihasa and Purana, the Fifth Veda. ² In other words, Itihasa-Purana possessed an elevated status. This by no means implies that the word ‘Purana’, as used in these two Upanishads and other texts too, is to be understood in the sense of the word being applied to a set of texts known as the Puranas today. The Valmiki Ramayana is believed to have been composed by Valmiki and the Mahabharata by Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa. After composing the Mahabharata, Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa is believed to have composed the Puranas. The use of the word ‘composed’ immediately indicates that Itihasa-Purana are ‘smriti’ texts, with a human origin. They are not ‘shruti’ texts, with a divine origin. Composition does not mean these texts were rendered into writing. Instead, there was a process of oral transmission, with inevitable noise in the transmission and distribution process. Writing came much later.

F.E. Pargiter’s book on the Puranas is still one of the best introductions to this corpus. ³ To explain the composition and transmission process, one can do no better than to quote him. ‘The *Vayu* and *Padma Puranas* tell us how ancient genealogies, tales and ballads were preserved, namely, by the *sutas*, ⁴ and they describe the *suta*’s duty . . . The *Vayu*, *Brahmanda* and *Visnu* give an account, how the original Purana came into existence . . . Those three

Puranas say—Kṛṣṇa Dvaipayana divided the single Veda into four and arranged them, and so was called Vyasa. He entrusted them to his four disciples, one to each, namely Paila, Vaisampayana, Jaimini and Sumantu. Then with tales, anecdotes, songs and lore that had come down from the ages, he compiled a Purana and taught it and the Itihāsa to his fifth disciple, the *śuta* Romaharsana or Lomaharsana . . . After that he composed the Mahabharata. The epic itself implies that the Purana preceded it . . . As explained above, the *śutas* had from remote times preserved the genealogies of gods, rishis and kings, and traditions and ballads about celebrated men, that is, exactly the material—tales, songs and ancient lore—out of which the Purana was constructed. Whether or not Vyasa composed the original Purana or superintended its compilation, is immaterial for the present purpose . . . After the original Purana was composed, by Vyasa as is said, his disciple Romaharsana taught it to his son Ugrasravas, and Ugrasravas the *śauti* appears as the reciter in some of the present Puranas; and the *śutas* still retained the right to recite it for their livelihood. But, as stated above, Romaharsana taught it to his six disciples, at least five of whom were *brahmins*. It thus passed into the hands of *brahmins*, and their appropriation and development of it increased in the course of time, as the Purana grew into many Puranas, as Sanskrit learning became peculiarly the province of the *brahmins*, and as new and frankly sectarian Puranas were composed.’ Pargiter cited reasons for his belief that the Mahabharata was composed after the original Purana, though that runs contrary to the popular perception about the Mahabharata having been composed before the Puranas. That popular and linear perception is too simplistic since texts evolved in parallel, not necessarily sequentially.

In popular perception, Kṛṣṇa Dvaipayana Vedavyasa composed the Mahabharata. He then composed the Puranas. Alternatively, he composed an original core Purana text, which has been lost, and others embellished it through additions. The adjective ‘Purana’, meaning ‘old account’ or ‘old text’, became a proper noun, signifying a specific text. To be classified as a Purana, a text has to possess five attributes—*pancha lakshana*. That is, five topics must be discussed—*sarga*, *pratisarga*, *vamsha*, *manvantara* and

vamshanucharita. The clearest statement of this is in the *Matsya Purana*. Unlike the Ramayana and the Mahabharata, there is no Critical Edition of the Puranas.⁵ Therefore, citing chapter and verse from a Purana text is somewhat more difficult, since verse, if not chapter, may vary from text to text. With that caveat, the relevant *shloka* (verse) should be in the fifty-third chapter of the *Matysa Purana*. *Sarga* means the original or primary creation. The converse of *sarga* is universal destruction and dissolution, or *pralaya*. That period of *sarga* lasts for one of Brahma's days, known as *kalpa*. When Brahma sleeps, during his night, there is universal destruction.

In measuring time, there is the notion of a *yuga* (era) and there are four *yugas*—*satya yuga* (also known as *krita yuga*), *treta yuga*, *dvapara yuga* and *kali yuga*. *Satya yuga* lasts for 4000 years, *treta yuga* for 3000 years, *dvapara yuga* for 2000 years and *kali yuga* for 1000 years. However, all these are not human years. The Gods have a different time scale and these are the years of the gods. As one progressively moves from *satya yuga* to *kali yuga*, virtue (*dharma*) declines. But at the end of *kali yuga*, the cycle begins afresh, with *satya yuga*. An entire cycle, from *satya yuga* to *kali yuga*, is known as a *mahayuga* (great era). However, a *mahayuga* is not just 10,000 years. There is a further complication. At the beginning and the end of every *yuga*, there are some additional years. These additional years are 400 for *satya yuga*, 300 for *treta yuga*, 200 for *dvapara yuga* and 100 for *kali yuga*. A *mahayuga* thus has 12,000 years, adding years both at the beginning and at the end. 1000 *mahayugas* make up one *kalpa* (eon), a single day for Brahma. A *kalpa* is also divided into fourteen *manvantaras*, a *manvantara* being a period during which a Manu presides and rules over creation. Therefore, there are 71.4 *mahayugas* in a *manvantara*. Our present *kalpa* is known as the Shveta Varaha Kalpa. Within that, six Manus have come and gone. Their names are: (1) Svayambhuva Manu, (2) Svarochisha Manu, (3) Uttama Manu, (4) Tapasa Manu, (5) Raivata Manu and (6) Chakshusha Manu. The present Manu is known as Vaivasvata Manu. Vivasvat, also written as Vivasvan, is the name of Surya, the sun-God. Vaivasvata Manu has that name because he is Surya's son. Not only do Manus change from one *manvantara* to another, so do the Gods, the ruler of

the Gods and the seven great sages, known as the *saptarshis* (seven rishis). Indra is the title of the ruler of the Gods. It is not a proper name. The present Indra is Purandara. However, in a different *manvantara*, someone else will hold the title. In the present seventh *manvantara*, known as Vaivasvata *manvantara*, there will also be 71.4 *mahayugas*. We are in the twenty-eighth of these. Since a different Vedavyasa performs the task of classifying and collating the Vedas in every *mahayuga*, Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa is the twenty-eighth in that series. Just so that it is clear, Vedavyasa isn't a proper name. It is a title conferred on someone who collates and classifies the Vedas. There have been twenty-seven who have held the title of Vedavyasa before him and he is the twenty-eighth. His proper name is Krishna Dvaipayana; Krishna because he was dark and Dvaipayana because he was born on an island (*dvipa*). This gives us an idea of what the topic of *manvantara* is about. This still leaves *pratisarga*, *vamsha* and *vamshanucharita*. The two famous dynasties/lineages were the solar dynasty (*surya vamsha*) and the lunar dynasty (*chandra vamsha*), and all the famous kings belonged to one or the other of these two dynasties. *Vamshanucharita* is about these lineages and the conduct of these kings. There were the Gods and sages (*rishis*) too, not always born through a process of physical procreation. Their lineages are described under the heading of *vamsha*. Finally, within that cycle of primary creation and destruction, there are smaller and secondary cycles of creation and destruction. That's the domain of *pratisarga*. To a greater or lesser degree, all the Puranas cover these five topics, some more than the others. The Purana which strictly adheres to this five-topic classification is the *Vishnu Purana*.

There are many types of Puranas. Some are known as Sthala Puranas, describing the greatness and sanctity of a specific geographical place. Some are known as Upa-Puranas, minor Puranas. The listing of Upa-Puranas has regional variations and there is no countrywide consensus about the list of Upa-Puranas, though it is often accepted that there are eighteen. The Puranas we have in mind are known as Maha-Puranas, major Puranas. Henceforth, when we use the word Puranas, we mean Maha-Puranas. There

is consensus that there are eighteen Maha-Puranas, though it is not obvious that these eighteen existed right from the beginning. The names are mentioned in several of these texts, including a *shloka* that follows the *shloka* cited from the Matsya Purana. Thus, the eighteen Puranas are: (1) *Agni* (15,400); (2) *Bhagavata* (18,000); (3) *Brahma* (10,000); (4) *Brahmanda* (12,000); (5) *Brahmavaivarta* (18,000); (6) *Garuda* (19,000); (7) *Kurma* (17,000); (8) *Linga* (11,000); (9) *Markandeya* (9000); (10) *Matsya* (14,000); (11) *Narada* (25,000); (12) *Padma* (55,000); (13) *Shiva* (24,000); (14) *Skanda* (81,100); (15) *Vamana* (10,000); (16) *Varaha* (24,000); (17) *Vayu* (24,000); and (18) *Vishnu* (23,000).

A few additional points about this list: first, the Harivamsha is sometimes loosely described as a Purana, but strictly speaking, it is not a Purana. It is more like an addendum to the Mahabharata. Second, *Bhavishya* (14,500) is sometimes mentioned, with *Vayu* excised from the list. However, the *Vayu Purana* exhibits many more Purana characteristics than the *Bhavishya Purana* does. There are references to a *Bhavishya Purana* that existed, but that may not necessarily be the *Bhavishya Purana* as we know it today. That's true of some other Puranas too. Texts have been completely restructured hundreds of years later. Third, it is not just a question of the *Bhavishya Purana* and *Vayu Purana*. In the lists given in some Puranas, *Vayu* is part of the eighteen, but *Agni* is knocked out. In some others, *Narasimha* and *Vayu* are included, but *Brahmanda* and *Garuda* are knocked out. Fourth, when a list is given, the order also indicates some notion of priority or importance. Since that varies from text to text, our listing is simply alphabetical, according to the English alphabet. Fifth, when one uses the term *Bhagavata*, does one mean the *Bhagavata Purana* or *Devi Bhagavata Purana*? The numbers within brackets indicate the number of *shlokas* each of these Puranas has or is believed to have. The range is from 9000 in Markandeya to a mammoth 81,100 in Skanda. The aggregate is a colossal 4,09,500 *shlokas*. To convey a rough idea of the order of magnitude, the Mahabharata has or is believed to have 1,00,000 *shlokas*. It's a bit difficult to convert a *shloka* into word counts in English, especially because Sanskrit words have a slightly different structure. However, as a

very crude approximation, one *shloka* is roughly twenty words. Thus, 1,00,000 *shlokas* become two million words and 4,00,000 *shlokas*, four times the size of the Mahabharata, amounts to eight million words. There is a reason for using the expression ‘is believed to have’, as opposed to ‘has’. Rendering into writing is of a later vintage; the initial process was one of oral transmission. In the process, many texts have been lost, or are retained in imperfect condition. This is true of texts in general and is also specifically true of Itihasa and Puranas. The Critical Edition of the Mahabharata, mentioned earlier, no longer possesses 1,00,000 *shlokas*. Including the Harivamsha, there are around 80,000 *shlokas*. The Critical Edition of the Mahabharata has, of course, deliberately excised some *shlokas*. For the Puranas, there is no counterpart of Critical Editions, though work has started on a few. However, whichever edition of the Puranas one chooses, the number of *shlokas* in that specific Purana will generally be smaller than the numbers given above. Either that number of *shlokas* did not originally exist, or they have been lost. This is the right place to mention that a reading of the Puranas assumes a basic degree of familiarity with the Valmiki Ramayana and the Mahabharata, more the latter than the former. Without that familiarity, one will often fail to appreciate the context completely. More than a passing familiarity with the Bhagavat Gita, strictly speaking, a part of the Mahabharata, helps. ⁶

Other than the five attributes, the Puranas have a considerable amount of information on geography and even geological changes (changes in the courses of rivers) and astronomy. Therefore, those five attributes shouldn’t suggest the Puranas have nothing more. They do, and they have therefore been described as encyclopedias. Bharatavarsha is vast and heterogeneous and each Purana may very well have originated in one particular part of the country. Accordingly, within that broad compass of an overall geographical description, the extent of geographical information varies from Purana to Purana. Some are more familiar with one part of the country than with another. Though not explicitly mentioned in the five attributes, the Puranas are also about pursuing *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*, the four objectives of human existence, and about the four *varnas* and the four

ashramas. The general understanding and practice of *dharma* is based much more on the Puranas than on the *Vedas*. Culture, notions of law, rituals, architecture and iconography are based on the Puranas. There is beautiful poetry too.

Perhaps one should mention that there are two ways in which these eighteen Puranas are classified. The trinity has Brahma as the creator, Vishnu as the preserver and Shiva as the destroyer. Therefore, Puranas where creation themes feature prominently are identified with Brahma (*Brahma, Brahmanda, Brahmavaivarta, Markandeya*). Puranas where Vishnu features prominently are identified as Vaishnava Puranas (*Bhagavata, Garuda, Kurma, Matysa, Narada, Padma, Vamana, Varaha, Vishnu*). Puranas where Shiva features prominently are identified as Shaiva Puranas (*Agni, Linga, Shiva, Skanda, Vayu*). While there is a grain of truth in this, Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva are all important and all three feature in every Purana. Therefore, beyond the relative superiority of Vishnu vis-à-vis Shiva, the taxonomy probably doesn't serve much purpose. The second classification is even more tenuous and is based on the three *gunas* of *sattva* (purity), *rajas* (passion) and *tamas* (ignorance). For example, the Uttara Khanda of the *Padma Purana* has a few *shlokas* along these lines, recited by Shiva to Parvati. With a caveat similar to the one mentioned earlier, this should be in the 236th chapter of Uttara Khanda. According to this, the Puranas characterized by *sattva* are *Bhagavata, Garuda, Narada, Padma, Varaha* and *Vishnu*. Those characterized by *rajas* are *Bhavishya, Brahma, Brahmanda, Brahmavaivarta, Markandeya* and *Vamana*. Those characterized by *tamas* are *Agni, Kurma, Linga, Matysa, Skanda* and *Shiva*.

Within a specific Purana text, there are earlier sections, as well as later ones. That makes it difficult to date a Purana, except as a range. Across Purana texts, there are older Puranas, as well as later ones. Extremely speculatively, the dating will be something like the following. (1) *Agni* (800–1100 CE); (2) *Bhagavata* (500–1000 CE); (3) *Brahma* (700–1500 CE); (4) *Brahmanda* (400–600 CE); (5) *Brahmavaivarta* (700–1500 CE); (6) *Garuda* (800–1100 CE); (7) *Kurma* (600–900 CE); (8) *Linga* (500–1000 CE);

(9) *Markandeya* (250–700 CE); (10) *Matsya* (200–500 CE); (11) *Narada* (900–1600 CE); (12) *Padma* (400–1600 CE); (13) *Shiva* (1000–1400 CE); (14) *Skanda* (600–1200 CE); (15) *Vamana* (450–900 CE); (16) *Varaha* (1000–1200 CE); (17) *Vayu* (350–550 CE); (18) *Vishnu* (300 BCE to 450 CE); and (19) *Bhavishya* (500–1900 CE). Reiterating once again that there is no great precision in these ranges, by this reckoning, the *Vishnu Purana* is the oldest and some parts of the *Bhavishya Purana* are as recent as the 19th century. To state the obvious, within the same Purana, there may be older sections and newer ones.

As mentioned earlier, there is no Critical Edition of the Puranas. Therefore, one has to choose the Sanskrit text one is going to translate from. If one is going to translate all the Puranas, it is preferable, though not essential, that one opts for a common source for all the Purana texts. In all the Purana translations, as a common source, I have used and will use, the ones brought out by Nag Publishers, with funding from the Ministry of Human Resource Development. But Nag Publishers does not seem to have published *Brahmanda Purana*. Hence, in contravention of this principle, I have used a different source.⁷ To the best of my knowledge, other than this translation, there is only one other unabridged translation of the *Brahmanda Purana* in English. G.V. Tagare was the translator, published under the ‘Ancient Indian Tradition and Mythology Series’.⁸ In the course of this translation, extensive comparisons have been made with the Tagare translation. The Sanskrit texts used for the two translations are similar but not always identical. However, the differences are minor. More importantly, the discerning reader, who compares the two, will find that we have sometimes differed in interpreting words and sentences.

In the second half of the 19th century, the contribution of Calcutta and Bengal towards preserving the Itihasa-Purana legacy was remarkable. Consider the following: (1) Kaliprasanna Singha’s unabridged translation of the Mahabharata in Bengali; (2) the Sanskrit and unabridged Bengali translation of the Burdwan edition of the Mahabharata; (3) the unabridged Bengali translation of the Mahabharata, published by Pratap Chandra Roy;

(4) the unabridged English translation of the Valmiki Ramayana by William Carey and Joshua Marshman; (5) Hemachandra Bhattacharya's unabridged translation of the Valmiki Ramayana in Bengali; (6) Ganga Prasad Mukhopadhyaya's verse translation of the Valmiki Ramayana; (7) Panchanan Tarkaratna's Sanskrit editions and Bengali translations of Valmiki Ramayana, Adhyatma Ramayana and several Puranas; (8) unabridged translations of the Mahabharata in English by Kisari Mohan Ganguli and Manmatha Nath Dutt; (9) Asiatic Society's ⁹ Bibliotheka Indica Sanskrit editions of *Agni Purana*, *Brihad Dharma Purana*, *Brihad Naradiya Purana*, *Kurma Purana*, *Varaha Purana* and *Vayu Purana*; and (10) F.E. Pargiter's unabridged English translation of Markandeya Purana; and (11) And most important of all, Horace Hayman Wilson's translation of the *Vishnu Purana*, in five volumes, between 1864 and 1870. ¹⁰ Though Wilson's translation wasn't part of the Bibliotheka Indica corpus, it was part of the same broad tradition. Wilson's work was almost certainly the first unabridged translation of any Purana into English and the scholarship was remarkable. An act of research and scholarship still needs to be undertaken, cross-referencing names, genealogies and incidents across Itihasa and Purana texts. Often, when the same incident is narrated in different Purana texts, there are differences in nuances and details. Since ours is a translation, we have deliberately refrained from undertaking such an exercise. But the Horace Hayman Wilson translation did seek to do that. Before that work can be undertaken, the Purana corpus has to be translated, meaning translation into English. More often than not, practices of *dharma* are based on the Itihasa-Purana corpus. The Purana project, published by Penguin, is part of that translation endeavour. Translations of the *Bhagavata Purana*, *Markandeya Purana*, *Brahma Purana*, *Vishnu Purana* and *Shiva Purana* have already been published and *Brahmanda Purana* is the sixth.

As has been mentioned earlier, the composition of the Brahmanda Purana is dated to between 400 and 600 CE. It is a relatively early Purana. The Brahmanda Purana has a considerable degree of overlap with the Vayu Purana, dated to between 350 and 550 CE. R. C. Hazra's dissertation is still one of the best introductions to the Purana corpus, for all the Puranas. ¹¹

This is what he had to say about Brahmanda Purana. ‘From the facts that it has sometimes been called “Vayaviya Brahmanda”, that it also, like the Vayu Purana, is said to have been proclaimed by Vayu, and that its chapters often agree almost literally with those of the *Vayu*, F.E. Pargiter has rightly said that originally these two Puranas were not separate. This view of Pargiter seems to be supported by some of the verses quoted in the Nibandhas from the Vayu Purana or Vayaviya but found only in the present Brahmanda . . . It is not known definitely when and why the same original Purana, which was named most probably after Vayu, came to have a second version with a different title. A comparison between the dynastic accounts given in the Vayu and Brahmanda, shows that the separation took place after AD 325, and most probably, not earlier than AD 400.’

A quote from Wilson’s preface ¹² will add to what has already been said. Note that the version of the *Brahmanda Purana* Hazra used did not possess the Lalita Mahatmya section. To quote Wilson, ‘The first and largest portion, however, proved to be the same as the *Vayu Purana*, with a passage occasionally slightly varied . . . The second portion of this *Brahmanda* is not in any part of the *Vayu*; it is, probably current in the Dakhin as a Samita or Khanda . . . In illustration of the efficacy of this form of adoration, the main subject of the work is an account of the exploits of Lalita Devi, a form of Durga, and her destruction of the demon Bhandasura. Rules for her worship are also given, which are decidedly of a Sakta or Tantrika description; and this work cannot be admitted, therefore, to be part of a genuine Purana.’ As one reads this translation, one will realize the abruptness with which the Lalita Mahatmya section is introduced and the abruptness with which it ends. Effectively, *Brahmanda Purana* does seem to end in the first part, with the second part more like an add-on. With its overlay of *tantra*, the translation of the Lalita Mahatmya section also proved to be relatively more difficult.

In all Puranas, there are chapters that are almost verbatim reproductions of sections from the Mahabharata, Harivamsha and other Puranas. One should not deduce that a specific Purana text has been copied from another since these various texts might have had a common origin. That apart, even

when the *shlokas* seem to be virtually identical, there are interesting changes in words and nuances. This has a bearing on the Hazra and Wilson arguments. Today, given the texts we possess, it is impossible to unambiguously establish the original text. There may very well have been an original proto-*Vayu Purana* and an original proto-*Brahmanda Purana*. Who can determine which preceded which? After all, each Purana evolved and was added to.

In terms of its present structure and attributes, the *Brahmanda Purana* displays all the characteristics of a Maha-Purana. It covers the five topics and is divided into four *padas* or segments. The first section is known as *prakriya pada* and this section also summarizes the account. The other sections are *anushanga*, *upodghata* and *upasamhara*. *Prakriya pada* is the section on rites (*kriya*). *Anushanga* means something that is closely associated, a necessary consequence. *Upodghata* is commencement and *upasamhara* is conclusion. The first three, *prakriya pada*, *anushanga pada* and *upodghata parva* constitute the first part of *Brahmanda Purana*. *Upasamhara*, which includes Lalita Mahatmya, is the second part. The *Brahmanda Purana* is supposed to have 12,000 *shlokas*. As the table at the beginning of the translation indicates, this text possesses 13,674 *shlokas*, divided into 9498 *shlokas* for the first part and 4176 *shlokas* for the second part. There are 156 chapters, divided into 112 for the first part and 44 for the second part. A word about the numbering we have followed for the chapters, such as Chapter 145-2(32). The first number is a consecutive numbering of chapters of the entire *Brahmanda Purana*, while the second number indicates the part, the first or the second as the case might be. The number within brackets indicates a consecutive numbering of chapters within that part. As with many Purana texts, the chapters have no headings. If there is a colophon, the chapter heading is based on the colophon. If there is no colophon, the chapter heading is based on what the chapter is about.

As with every Purana, there are layers within layers, and the account is not recited by a single person. The basic template is, of course, the standard one of Suta reciting the Purana to sages who have assembled for a sacrifice in Naimisha forest. But there is a core template that is behind this, that of

Vayu reciting the Purana to Brahma. Through a line of transmission, this eventually reached Suta. In the second part, there is the narration by Hayagriva to Agastya.

When reading one Purana and comparing it to another, there is often the feeling that accounts are repetitive. This is partly true, but there is more to it than that. Even when the same incident is narrated, each Purana has its own twists and nuances. Other than the Lalita Mahatmya section, the Brahmanda Purana has, as its name implies, extensive sections on creation and dissolution, cosmology and geography, astronomy and measurements of time, funeral ceremonies and music. There is a detailed description of types of fires, types of ancestors and different kinds of beings. Plus there is an expansion of the Parashurama story, with rather unusually, Krishna and Radha brought into the story. This exemplifies the incremental value addition every Purana has.

In the translations of the Bhagavat Gita, the Mahabharata, the Harivamsha, the Valmiki Ramayana, the *Bhagavata Purana*, the *Markandeya Purana*, the *Brahma Purana*, the *Vishnu Purana* and the *Shiva Purana*,¹³ we followed the principle of not using diacritical marks. The use of diacritical marks (effectively the international alphabet of Sanskrit transliteration) makes the pronunciation and rendering more accurate, but also tends to put off readers who are less academically inclined. Since diacritical marks are not being used, there is a challenge of rendering Sanskrit names in English. Sanskrit is a phonetic language and we have used that principle as a basis. Applied consistently, this means that words are rendered in ways that may seem unfamiliar. Hence, Gautama will appear as Goutama here. This is true of proper names, and, in a few rare cases, of geographical names. The absence of diacritical marks causes some minor problems. How does one distinguish Mahadeva Shiva from Parvati Shivaa? Often, the context will make the difference clear. If not, we have written Mahadeva as Shiva and Parvati as Shivaa. This is especially the case when names of feminine divinities might give rise to confusion. In translating, the attempt has been to provide a word-for-word translation, so that if one were to hold up the Sanskrit text, there would be a perfect match.

In the process, the English is not as smooth as it might have been, deliberately so. We have strictly adhered to whatever the text says, word for word.

The intention is to offer a translation, not an interpretation. That sounds like a simple principle to adopt, and for the most part, is easy to follow. However, there is a thin dividing line between translation and interpretation. In some instances, it is impossible to translate without bringing in a little bit of interpretation. Inevitably, interpretation is subjective. We have tried to minimize the problem by (a) reducing interpretation; (b) relegating interpretation to footnotes; and (c) when there are alternative interpretations, pointing this out to the reader through those footnotes. But all said and done, there is no substitute for reading these texts in the original Sanskrit.

Finally, the *Brahmanda Purana* is not an easy Purana to translate, read and understand particularly the second part. That's often because the average reader is relatively unfamiliar with *mantra*, *mandala*, *tantra*, *yantra*, *chakra*, Shakti concepts (*iccha*, *jnana*, *kriya*), rituals and the theology (for want of a better word) of Devi's *dharma*. The thirty-six *tattvas* are different from the *tattvas* of *samkhya*, with many people being somewhat familiar with the latter. If this sounds esoteric, it is undoubtedly so. But a reading of *Brahmanda Purana* is also a convenient means of becoming exposed to these topics.



The Brahmanda Purana Continued

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Lalita Mahatmya (the second part)

Chapter 75-1(75) (Parashurama and Krishna)

Vasishtha said, ‘Parashurama witnessed that extremely wonderful marvel. He narrated everything about the two deer, exactly as he had heard it. Hearing this, the illustrious Agastya, who was born from a pot, was delighted. He spoke to Bhargava, ¹ who was standing in front of him. Agastya said, “O Rama! O one who is accomplished in distinguishing what should be done from what should not be done. Listen. I will now speak to you about your welfare. Be controlled and act accordingly. Not far from here, there is Vishnu’s extremely great spot and it is very rare. The marks made by the extremely great-souled one’s feet can be seen there. When he chastised Bali, Ganga arose from that spot, from the tips of the great-souled Vamana’s feet. ² He covered the worlds in his strides. Go there. Let your mind not deviate. Control yourself and restrain your diet. Follow *niyamas* and read this for a month. Desiring *siddhi*, ³ you have practised this *kavacha* earlier, ⁴ for the sake of chastising the enemies. In this way, you will obtain *siddhi*.” Agastya spoke in this way to Rama, the destroyer of enemies. He prostrated himself before the tranquil sage and went outside the hermitage.’

‘Using the same path, he swiftly reached the spot. O king! ⁵ That is the place where the divine river flowed from his last step. Along with

Akritavrana, he resolved to reside there. He started to chant the divine Krishna-*premamrita stotram*. Every day, he chanted this *stotram* to the lord of Vraja. ⁶ Hari ⁷ was pleased. O lord of the earth! He went there, to show himself to Jamadagni's son. This was the lotus-eyed Krishna himself, the lord of the four *vyuhas*. ⁸ His diadem had the complexion of the sun, and his two earrings were radiant. His chest was illuminated by the Koustubha jewel. He was attired in yellow garments and his complexion was like that of a cloud. He was playing on a flute and his form was extremely enchanting. On seeing him, Jamadagni's son hastily stood up, filled with delight. Like a rod, he prostrated himself on the ground and controlling himself, praised the lord. Parashurama said, "I prostrate myself. I bow. Your form is that of the cause. You are the one who protects those who seek refuge. You are the one who takes away the afflictions of the Gods. You are foremost among Brahma, Isha, ⁹ Vishnu and Indra. You are the one to be praised. I bow down before the eternal Parameshvara. You have been spoken about in different ways in the *Vedas*. Ishana and the best of others are incapable of determining you. You are without birth and cannot be ascertained. I praise that ancient and eternal lord. Please show me your compassion. You are the only lord who can bestow what one desires. In your pastimes, you assume many kinds of forms, such as *devas*, humans and inferior species, to remove the earth's burdens and protect it. You are affectionate towards people who are your devotees. You are yourself extremely indifferent towards Indira and evil-minded ones who have committed transgressions, their minds fixed in love for you. ¹⁰ I praise you. O lord! For your sake, the delighted *asuras*, Gods, men, *kinnaras* ¹¹ and inferior species have forgotten about their nature and have given up their bodies, women, sons and all sense of ownership. O lord of *devas*! You bestow what is desired on those who worship you. You have no wishes and are devoid of *gunas*. ¹² You are not manifest. You destroy floods of sins. I have obtained that refuge, a reservoir of love and affection. Some torment their bodies with many kinds of austerities. Others perform many kinds of sacrifices. O lord! Those who are tied to desires and material objects do not see your supernatural form, not even in their dreams. Those indifferent to

the exhaustions of the world remember your feet, properly. They prostrate themselves devoutly and worship your feet, describing this to each other in an assembly. With their minds fixed on your lotus feet, they wish to dispel the impurities that have accumulated across many births. O lord! Your name is nectar. It is the medication against worldly existence. Others use it to cross over and make others cross over. O noble one! O lord! My mind is fixed to desires, and I have made many kinds of efforts to worship you. O lord! You know. Is there anything in the world that needs to be told to you?” Thus, Jamadagni’s son prostrated himself in front and praised him in this way. As if confounded with his *maya*, he ¹³ spoke in a deep voice. Krishna said, “O Rama! Enough. O immensely fortunate one! Your excellent task has been accomplished. Understand that this is because of the power of the *kavacha* and your eulogy. You will kill King Kartavirya, who is firm in his mind. After doing this to your father’s enemy, you will rid the earth of *kshatriyas*. Kartavirya is an *avatara* ¹⁴ of my *chakra* on the surface of the earth. O best among *dvijas*! ¹⁵ O one who bestows honours! You will finish him and accomplish your task. From today, you will roam around the world, infused with my portion. At the right time, you will be like the Lord Destroyer himself. O child! In the twenty-fourth *mahayuga*, in *treta yuga*, I will be born in Raghu’s lineage. My name will be Rama. I am the eternal one, with four *vyuhas*. ¹⁶ I will be the delight of Kousalya and King Janaka. At the time, along with Lakshmana, I will ensure the success of Koushika’s ¹⁷ sacrifice. O immensely fortunate one! I will go to Janaka’s great city. There, I will break Isha’s bow and marry Videha’s daughter. ¹⁸ After this, while going to Ayodhya, I will take away your insolent energy from you.” In this way, Krishna instructed Jamadagni’s son, the store of austerities. While the extremely great-souled Rama watched, he vanished.’

Chapter 76-1(76) (Parashurama kills the king of Matsya)

Vasishtha said, ‘When Krishna had left, the immensely illustrious thought that he had been infused with Krishna’s powers. He blazed like a flaming

fire. Along with Akritavrana, he reached the city of Mahishmati.¹⁹ The supreme river, the sacred Narmada, is there and takes away sins. As soon as it is seen, it purifies, even creatures who are sinners. O lord of the earth! This was the place where the three cities used to be established earlier and the great-souled Hara made efforts to destroy Tripura.²⁰ How can one describe the holiness of men who have assumed the forms of *devas*? O king! The delight of the Bhargava lineage saw Narmada. Devoted to the issue of rebuffing the enemy, he was extremely happy and bowed down. “O Narmada! I prostrate myself before you. You are the one who bestows boons. O beautiful one! Quickly destroy my enemy. You have originated from Hara’s body.” In this way, he prostrated himself before Narmada, the destroyer of sins. He then sent a messenger to Kartavirya Arjuna. “O messenger! O unblemished one! Go and tell the king what I am telling you. Do not be suspicious. Under no circumstance is a messenger killed. ‘O king! O foolish one! Resorting to your army, you abused the sage Jamadagni. His son has come to fight. O evil-souled one! Emerge swiftly and offer Rama a fight. When you encounter Bhargava, you will quickly go to another world.’ After telling the king this, hear what he says in reply. O fortunate one! Return quickly. A delay is not praised in this world.” Thus addressed, the messenger went to the king of Haihaya. In an assembly, he made the king listen to everything. The king was extremely strong and valiant and was Atreya’s²¹ devotee. Hearing the words, he became enraged and told the messenger about his reply. Kartavirya answered, “Through the strength of my arms, granted by Datta, I have conquered the earth. Using force, I have bound the lords of the earth and have brought them to my city. That strength still exists. I will grant you a fight now.” Saying this, the king of Haihaya swiftly released the messenger. He summoned the commander of forces. The supreme among eloquent ones spoke to him. “O immensely valiant one! O one revered by heroes! Prepare my soldiers. I will fight against Rama of the Bhrigu lineage. There should not be any delay.” Thus addressed, the immensely valiant and powerful commander arranged the army, with its four components.²² Having done this, he reported it.’

‘Hearing that the soldiers had been prepared, King Kartavirya was delighted. The charioteer brought his own chariot and the lord of the earth climbed onto it. The vassals and the lords of the circles were all around the king. With many *akshouhinis*,²³ they surrounded him and remained stationed there. There were crores of elephants, horses, chariots and foot-soldiers. O great king! The soldiers were innumerable, and they resembled an ocean. Many kings, born in many lineages, could be seen there. They were immensely valiant and gigantic in size. They were accomplished in many kinds of fighting. The kings were accomplished in many kinds of *shastras* and *astras*.²⁴ They were astride many kinds of mounts. They were insolent, adorned with many kinds of ornaments. They had adorned themselves by donating. There were many shining elephants, controlled by elephant-riders. There were horses born in many lineages, as fleet as the wind or swans. O lord of the earth! Trained by their riders, they galloped around. There were extremely long chariots, with swift horses yoked to them. The wheels thundered, like clouds during the rainy season. O king! Wielding swords and shields, the foot-soldiers were radiant. They kept saying, “I will go first. I will advance first. Me first.” Kartavirya Arjuna’s army moved in this way. It covered the sky and the ten directions with dust. There were the sounds of many kinds of musical instruments and horses neighed. O king! The elephants trumpeted and the sound covered the sky. O lord of the earth! Along the way, the Indra among kings saw evil portents. These omens indicated that he would die in the battle. He saw a woman who was almost naked, with dishevelled hair.²⁵ She was attired in black garments and was crying because her nose had been severed. He saw a man who was miserable in his mind. His clothes were torn and in shreds. He was almost naked, attired in ochre garments. He was lacking in limbs. He saw a lizard, a hare, a porcupine, an empty pot, a reptile, cotton, a tortoise, oil, salt and a heap of bones. To his right, a jackal howled in a terrible voice. He saw a diseased person, a *pulkasa*,²⁶ a bull, a hawk and a bear. Despite seeing these, he advanced rashly, as if bound by the noose of time.’

‘Along with Akritavrana, Rama was seated under the shade of a banyan tree, on the northern bank of Narmada, and saw him arrive. One hundred

crore kings were with Kartavirya, supreme among kings. There were one thousand *akshouhinis*. He saw this and rejoiced. “I have cherished a task for a very long time and today, it will meet with success. Kartavirya, worst among kings, has come within the range of my vision.” Saying this, he stood up, holding his *parashu* ²⁷ weapon. To destroy the enemy, he yawned, like an enraged lion. They saw Rama, ready to kill the soldiers. All of them trembled a lot, like embodied beings at the prospect of death. With the speed of the wind or a swan, Bhargava hurled his battleaxe. Wherever he did this, elephants, horses, and brave men fell down, their arms, thighs and necks severed. This was like a gigantic elephant in *musth* running around and trampling down a clump of reeds. In that way, Rama, with the energy of the mind and the wind, crushed the king’s soldiers. Rama was supreme among wielders of weapons, and he was striking energetically in the battle. On seeing this, the king of Matsya, astride his great chariot, prepared to string his bow. He drew the bowstring back and approaching Bhargava, covered him with arrows that were as fierce and energetic as the fire. On seeing him advance, the great-souled Rama picked up his great and fierce bow. Overwhelmed by rage, he affixed the *vayavya astra* and countered Mangala’s shower of arrows. ²⁸ The king was extremely strong and spirited and released the *parvata astra* in Rama’s direction. He was extremely strong and accomplished and countered *vayavya astra* with his own weapon. Rama thus got to know that the king of Matsya was extremely strong and was accomplished in the use of many kinds of *astras*. Invoking it with the proper *mantra*, the powerful and energetic one released Narayana *astra*. O king! To kill the king, Bhargava Rama applied Narayana *astra*. Its extreme energy made all the directions blaze. The lord of Matsya trembled. Rama saw that he was trembling and killed his horses with four arrows. With one arrow, he severed his standard. With two arrows, the great-souled one severed his bow. With another arrow, he struck the charioteer and brought him down on the ground. With three arrows, he shattered the chariot. When Mangala left the chariot and sought refuge on the ground, he quickly struck him on the head with the *parashu*. His head shattered, he repeatedly vomited blood. He lost his senses and died within a short while.

His army was burnt down and destroyed by that *astra*, reduced to ashes in an instant. In this way, King Mangala, best among kings and born in *chandra vamsha*, was brought down. Rama was filled with joy.’

Chapter 77-1(77) (Parashurama kills other kings)

Vasishtha said, ‘When the king of Matsya was brought down, King Kartavirya, immensely strong and accomplished in fighting, sent other great kings. O lord of the earth! Brihadbala, Somadatta, Vidarbha, the lord of Mithila, the king of Nishadha and the king of Magadha arrived in the field of battle, to fight against the Indra among Bhargavas. Accomplished in many kinds of fighting, they showered down nets of arrows. All of them prided themselves on being brave and were following Haihaya’s instructions. With Pinaka in his hand, Bhrigu’s descendant was like the blazing flame of a fire. He invoked the *mantra* of a noose of *nagas* on an excellent arrow and released it. In the field of battle, the Indra among Bhargavas swiftly hurled that weapon, but the immensely strong Somadatta used the Garuda weapon to cut it down. At this, the immensely fortunate Rama, who shatters enemies, became angry. Using the trident given to him by Rudra, he killed Somadatta. He killed Brihadbala with his club and Vidharbha with his fists, the lord of Mithila with a bludgeon and the lord of Nishadha with a spear. He killed the lord of Magadha with a blow of his foot and the soldiers with his net of weapons. Like the fire of destruction, when it has been fanned by the wind, he slew all the soldiers. Jamadagni’s immensely strong son then rushed towards Kartavirya. The other kings, *maharathas*,²⁹ saw him advance in the battle. They knew what should be done and what should not be done. Therefore, they hid Haihaya behind their backs. Exhibiting their friendliness,³⁰ they fought against Rama. There were hundreds from Kanyakubja, Sourashtra and Avanti. From every direction, they created nets of arrows around Rama. In the field of battle, Rama was surrounded by their nets of arrows and could not be seen. O Indra among kings! At the time, Akritavrana remembered Rama’s conduct,

as stated by the deer. From Hari, the sage sought the welfare of the Indra among Bhargavas. At this time, Rama, accomplished in *astras* and *shastras* and knowledgeable about *mantras*, drove away those nets of arrows with the *vayavya* weapon. Desiring to fight, he arose, like the sun from within mist. In the field of battle, the powerful Rama fought against them for three nights. Dexterous in his valour, he destroyed twelve *akshounis* there. Using the excellent weapon of a battleaxe, he treated them like a clump of plantain trees. He stupefied all those arrays of kings and their large armies. On seeing that they had been killed by the great-souled Rama, the immensely valiant Suchandra, born in the solar dynasty, arrived. There were one hundred thousand kings and seven *akshouhinis* with him. There were many brave warriors there and they thundered like clouds. O king! As they fought against Bhargava, the earth trembled. O lord of the earth! They used *shastras* and great *astras*. However, the powerful Indra among Bhargavas destroyed those in an instant. Resembling the Destroyer, he then seized his divine battleaxe. The descendant of the Bhrigu lineage cut down and destroyed all the soldiers, like a farmer using a sickle to slash the ripe paddy and grass in a field. Thus, Rama eliminated all of them. The one hundred thousand kings and soldiers were destroyed by Rama in this way. O king! On seeing this, King Suchandra fought in that battle. Both of them were agitated and were accomplished in the use of many kinds of *shastras* and *astras*. Those two valiant ones, the lord among sages and the lord among kings, fought. Suchandra, learned in fighting, severed all the *shastras* and *astras* hurled by Rama. Angry in the field of battle, Rama gathered that King Suchandra was knowledgeable about countering weapons. To counter him, he touched water ³¹ and affixed the invincible Narayana weapon to an arrow. The intelligent Rama hurled that weapon, which was as resplendent as one hundred suns. On seeing this, Suchandra instantly got down from his chariot and prostrated himself. It was fashioned by Narayana himself and is worshipped by all weapons. When he prostrated himself in this way, the weapon left him and returned to Narayana's presence.'

'Seeing this, Rama, the destroyer of enemies, was astounded in the battle. He saw that the great weapon had failed and that his enemy's body was

unharmd. Rama angrily hurled a spear, a bludgeon, a javelin, a spike, a club and a battleaxe towards the king's head. However, as if toying, Suchandra seized all of them. Rama then hurled Shiva's trident towards the king. But the trident became a garland of flowers around the king's neck and he saw Bhadrakali, the mother of the universe, standing in front of him. She was hideous and terrible and wore a garland of skulls. She was astride a lion. She possessed three eyes and held an excellent trident. On seeing her, he cast aside his *shastras* and *astras*. He prostrated himself and praised her. Rama said, "I prostrate myself before Shankara's beloved, the mother of the universe, who is adorned in many kinds of ways. You are adorned in many kinds of ornaments and are borne by a lion. You are engaged in protecting those who seek refuge. You are Daksha's daughter and Himalaya's daughter. You are established as half of Maheshvara. You are Kali, who wears digits of the lord of *kalas*.³² You are loved by devotees. You are the sovereign of the worlds. You are known as Tara. You are attached to Shiva. Your footwear is worshipped by Ganeshvaras.³³ You are greater than the greatest. You grant boons to Parameshthi.³⁴ You think of destroying the roots of the three kinds of torment.³⁵ You are Jagaddhita, Puratraya, Balaa and Tripura and others.³⁶ You are the mother of every kind of learning and grace. There are many other beneficial aspects that are hidden. You possess the face of a stork.³⁷ You bestow many kinds of happiness. You destroy many kinds of *asuras* and *danavas*. Your hands are like creepers and are adorned in the *varada* and *abhaya mudras*.³⁸ All the Gods prostrate themselves before you. You are attired in yellow garments. You are as swift as the wind. You are the one who bestows auspiciousness. You are praised by Shiva. You ride the enemy of an elephant.³⁹ You drink the fresh juice of sugarcane. Your radiant complexion resembles that of a blue mountain. You are light in your stride. You are known as Lalitaa. You are the sovereign of the Gods. You are an ocean of compassion. Your eyes roll. You are devoid of dissolution. Your lotus feet are decorated with the juice of lac. You are known as Ramaa. You love sensual pleasures. You are the one who dispels disease. You have created everything. You bestow kingdoms. You are eager for intercourse. Your complexion is like that of a jewel. Your garments are

beautiful. I prostrate myself in front. I prostrate myself at the back. I prostrate myself along the two sides. I prostrate myself above. I prostrate myself below. I always prostrate myself everywhere. I bow down. I prostrate myself. I bow down before the one who is present in all forms. O Deveshi! Be pleased. O Bhadrakali! Fulfil the pledge I have taken earlier. You are the mother. You are the father, and you are the mother of the three worlds. I bow down. I prostrate myself.” The spirited Devi Bhadrakali was eulogized in this way. Delighted, the one who regarded the granting of boons as a festival, replied to Bhargava. Bhadrakali said, “O child! O Rama! O immensely fortunate one! I am pleased with you now. Ask for a boon from me, whatever is the wish in your heart.” Rama answered, “O mother! O one who is affectionate towards her devotees! If a boon is to be given to me, let me be victorious in the battle against Suchandra, who has obtained the benefit of your favours. O Devi! I have told you. With a delighted mind, please do this, using whatever means that are possible. O mother of the universe! I prostrate myself before you.” Bhadrakali said, “Use the *agneya* weapon to convey King Suchandra to my abode. He will become my most beloved attendant.” Hearing this, the Indra among Bhargavas got ready to do what would bring pleasure to Devi. He performed *pranayama* and *achamana* and affixed the weapon in Suchandra’s direction. ⁴⁰ O king! To kill the king, Rama invoked that powerful weapon. It burnt down his body and conveyed him to the supreme divinity’s world. After doing this, Rama prostrated himself before Bhadrakali, the original creator of the universe. She vanished. Jamadagni’s son remained there, desiring to kill the king in the battle.’

Chapter 78-1(78) (Death of Kartavirya)

Vasishtha said, ‘O king! Suchandra, the crest jewel among Indras among kings, was brought down. His son, Pushkaraksha, arrived, to fight against Rama. The immensely valiant one was accomplished in the use of all *shastras* and *astras* and was astride his chariot. He glanced towards Rama,

who resembled the Destroyer and was fierce in the field of battle. From every direction, he enveloped the Indra among Bhargavas with a net of arrows. In an instant, Jamadagni's son was covered with these arrows. However, the immensely strong Indra among Bhargavas emerged violently from within this bondage of arrows. O great king! He looked around in every direction and saw Pushkaraksha, Suchandra's son. Like a fire that burns down the directions, he was filled with rage. Full of anger, he released the *Varuna* weapon. Clouds arose from this and thundered with a terrible roar. O king! Torrents of water poured down and flooded the earth. The immensely valiant Pushkaraksha released *Vayavyastra* and immediately made the clouds disappear. At this, Rama became angry and unleashed *Brahmastra*. However, the immensely strong Pushkaraksha countered this with his *Brahmastra*. On seeing the *Brahmastra* countered, he became like a serpent struck with a rod. Sighing deeply, he seized his terrible battleaxe and rushed towards him. On seeing Rama advance, Pushkaraksha, the great archer, affixed five arrows that resembled serpents with blazing mouths. Using one arrow each, he progressively pierced Rama's heart, head, the two arms and his tuft of hair. As a result of this, in the battle against Pushkaraksha, Rama was made to suffer a great deal. Waiting for a while, he struck him severely on the head with the battleaxe. Pushkaraksha was sliced into two, from head to foot. While the men looked on at the time, these two parts fell on the ground. They were greatly amazed, as were the residents of heaven in the firmament. In his rage, Rama split the immensely strong Pushkaraksha. Like a fire in the forest, he angrily burnt down the soldiers. The Indra among Bhargavas rushed here and there, with the speed of thoughts and the wind, and struck with his battleaxe. In every such place, horses, chariots, elephants and men fell in hundreds, their limbs severed. In the battle, the extremely strong Rama killed all these with his battleaxe. As they were crushed and reduced to ashes, they screamed, "Alas, father! Alas, mother!" In an instant, Bhargava destroyed Pushkaraksha's entire army, consisting of many noble kings and nine *akshouhinis*. When the masters were killed, the others were severely afflicted.'

‘When Pushkaraksha fell, Kartavirya Arjuna himself arrived. The immensely valiant one was astride a golden chariot. It was full of many kinds of weapons and was full of bejewelled equipment. The king’s chariot was ten *nalvas* ⁴¹ in size and was yoked to one hundred horses. He possessed one thousand hands and held many kinds of weapons. He resembled a person with meritorious deeds, ready to ascend to heaven after giving up his body. He had one hundred valiant sons, and they were accomplished in fighting. Following their father’s command, they arranged the army in *vyuhas* ⁴² and prepared for battle. In the battlefield, Kartavirya saw the powerful Rama. He got ready against the one who resembled Yama, the Destroyer. To defeat the Indra among Bhargavas in the battle, he held five hundred arrows in his right hands and five hundred bows in his left hands. O lord of the earth! He showered down arrows on Rama. O valiant one! This was like clouds pouring down on top of a mountain. The descendant of the Bhrigu lineage was honoured in this way by a shower of arrows. He picked up his own divine bow and started to shower down arrows. Bhargava and Haihaya were proud in the field of battle. There was a tumultuous battle between them, and it made the body hair stand up. The powerful king was accomplished in the use of all *shastras* and *astras*. To kill the Indra among Bhargavas in the field of battle, he affixed *Brahmastra*. However, Rama touched the wind ⁴³ and countered *Brahmastra* with his own *Brahmastra*. O lord of the earth! The two weapons clashed against each other in the sky and increased their energy. They resembled blazing suns on the horizon. The three worlds and the nether regions witnessed this great wonder. They were scorched by these two blazing weapons and hoped that they might be restrained. Rama saw the universe would be destroyed and remembered what Jagannivasa ⁴⁴ had told him at the time. “I must restrain and control it now. Since I have been born from his supreme portion, it is my task to protect.” Thinking this, the lord, fierce in his energy, used his two eyes to drink up those two weapons. Seeing that the universe was suffering, the great-souled Rama meditated for a while. As a result of the power of his *dhyana*, those two Brahmastras lost their power. They violently fell on the ground and everything in the world was immediately

restored to its natural state. Jamadagni's son was greater than the greatest. He could create, preserve and destroy. Nevertheless, the lord followed the customary practices of the world and concealed his power. He was a great archer and the greatest among brave ones. In any assembly, he was foremost among those who spoke. He had made efforts to learn the various kinds of arts. He was learned in all kinds of learning and the sacred texts. He was knowledgeable about the norms. In this way, he was famous in the world of men. His nature was to always do what was beneficial for everyone. Thus, Rama, the enemy of royalty, vanquished the worlds.'

'In this way, Rama, famous for his prowess, pacified the two weapons. Thereafter, in the arena of battle, he again started to kill those from the Haihaya lineage. He picked up a pair of arrows from his quiver and fixed the feathered ends to the string of his bow. He desired to cut off the king's crest jewel. But instead, he took his aim at the two ears of the king. The two ears of the great-souled king were sliced off. Famous for his valour in the entire world, he thought that he had been vanquished. The lord of the earth thought that Rama had destroyed his valour and he censured himself. O king! In an instant, the lord of the earth turned pale and it was as if he had lost his senses. He was like a picture drawn by an artist. It could be seen that his mind was greatly dejected. His valour had exceeded that of everyone else in the worlds. The king thought that it had left him. He was the one who had obtained victory over Poulastya.⁴⁵ He grieved over this. However, desiring victory, the king opened his eyes again and thought of Datta, the light of Atri's lineage. It was because of his power and favours that he had obtained the energy he had used to chastise all the kings in the world. But the great and noble Datta had left and did not show himself to him. The lord of the earth was greatly dejected and performed *dhyana* again and again. O king! Though he kept on meditating, Datta did not arrive in his mind. This was because the lord had performed an extremely wicked and terrible deed, by harming an innocent and controlled ascetic. That is the reason Atri's great-souled descendant did not show himself in the path of the king's meditations. He was shattered by this great grief. As a result of his misery, he was overcome by delusion. The great-souled Rama, who

could see everything in the minds of the worlds, saw that the king was immersed in grief. He said, “O lord of men! Do not be overcome by sorrow. Resort to fortitude in your mind. At the time of a battle, one should grieve. Destiny brings about calamity. Every person enjoys the consequences of his own good and bad deeds. O lord of men! All calamities are brought about by one’s own auspicious and inauspicious deeds, not by those of anyone else. As a result of good deeds accumulated across many births, you were a worthy recipient of Datta’s favours. You will now have to enjoy the fruits of the wicked deed committed by you. You caused harm to my *guru*. That is the reason I have severed your ears. You will now see me take away your energy by robbing you of your crest jewel. You will lose your fame.”

Saying this, the great-souled Bhargava fixed an arrow and drew his bowstring back. Light in speed, the arrow severed the king’s crest jewel and brought it back to Rama. Arjuna, the lord of the Haihaya lineage, saw the deed performed by the sage’s son. Desiring to kill the *dvija* who was his enemy, he raised his weapons again. He used tridents, spears, clubs, *chakras*, swords, javelins, bludgeons and many other weapons to strike the *dvija*’s son. However, with dexterity, Rama used his arrows to quickly sever the tridents and everything else, while they were still in mid-air. At this, the king touched the wind and released the excellent *Agneyastra*. However, Rama swiftly pacified this with *Varunastra*. The king released *Gandharvastra*, but the lord countered this with *Vayavyastra*. O lord of the earth! Rama used *Garudastra* to slice down *Nagastra*. In the battle, the king seized the infallible trident that had been given to him by Datta. To kill Bhargava, he invoked *mantras* over it. That trident resembled one hundred suns and Gods and *asuras* were incapable of repulsing it. With great force, he hurled it in Rama’s direction. O lord of the earth! It descended on Bhargava’s head. Struck by the blow of the trident, Bhargava was distressed. O Indra among kings! He lost his senses. As he fell, he remembered Hari. When Bhargava fell, all the *devas* were filled with fear. With Brahma, Vishnu and Maheshvara at the forefront, they assembled there. The lord Shankara possesses great *jnana*. He has conquered Death himself. Using the knowledge of *mritasanjivani*,⁴⁶ he revived Bhargava.

Rama regained his senses and saw the Gods in front of him. O Indra among kings! He devotedly prostrated himself before Brahma and the others. Praised by the Indra among Bhargavas, they instantly vanished. Rama touched the wind and performed *japa* ⁴⁷ on the *kavacha*. He arose. Extremely enraged, it was as if he would burn down with his eyes. Bhargava remembered the Pashupata weapon, given to him by Shiva. He used this to immediately destroy the immensely strong Kartavirya. The king, Datta's devotee, entered Vishnu's Sudarshana *chakra*. O Bahu's son! ⁴⁸ His body was reduced to ashes.'

Chapter 79-1(79) (Parashurama and Vinayaka)

Vasishtha said, 'The one hundred sons witnessed the terrible death of their father. With their respective armies, they sought to restrain the fierce Bhargava. Each of them was indomitable in battle and possessed one *akshouhini*. Angry at their father's death, they engaged in a tumultuous battle. Rama saw that those brave sons were accomplished in fighting. In that clash, he seized his battleaxe and fought. In the space of a mere two *muhurtas*, ⁴⁹ the illustrious Rama swiftly destroyed that army, consisting of one hundred *akshouhinis*. All of them, revered for their valour, saw Rama playfully use his battleaxe to destroy their respective soldiers. All of those extremely energetic ones used many kinds of divine weapons to strike him. They surrounded the great-souled Bhargava in a circle. The powerful Rama was in the centre of that circle. The illustrious one was radiant, like the nave in the centre of a wheel. As those one hundred whirled around him, Rama was radiant and seemed to be dancing. He was as radiant as Krishna in the midst of *gopis*, as they surrounded and circled around him. With the foremost among them, all the Gods assembled there, astride their own respective *vimanas*. ⁵⁰ They surrounded Rama, whose valour did not diminish, from every direction and showered garlands from Nandana ⁵¹ on him. The sounds of weapons, trampling of feet and loud roars created a triple symphony, ⁵² touching the firmament. The wounds caused by arrows

resembled those made by nails and teeth. There were those whose limbs were mangled by weapons. They screamed, as if those accomplished in singing were singing. O king! As the battle continued within the circle, *devas* watched, amazement in their eyes. Using many kinds of weapons, Rama desired to kill the sons of the lord of the earth. Using his bow, the extremely strong lord broke that circle and created separated arrays. He killed those brave ones one by one. Out of the one hundred, five fled—Shura, Vrishasya, Vrisha, Shurasena and Jayadvaja. Their patience was exhausted, and their minds were filled with great fear. Separately, they entered the forests in the foothills of the Himalayas. They were severely afflicted and none of those kings were ever seen again. Rama destroyed all the other kings who had arrived to help the king.’ ⁵³

‘Along with Akritavrana, he happily went to Narmada to have a bath. Having bathed and performed the daily rites, he worshipped Vrishadhvaja. ⁵⁴ He then left, to see Isha Shiva, who resided in Kailasa. He also wished to see his *guru*’s wife, Uma, and the sons, Skanda and Vinayaka. Along with Akritavrana, the great-souled one used the powers of his mind. He was successful. Within an instant, he happily reached Kailasa. He saw the great city, known by the name of Alaka. It was adorned with many mansions, full of many kinds of jewels. There were *yakshas* ⁵⁵ in many different forms and they were handsome, with colourful garments. There were forests and groves, full of many kinds of trees. The place was adorned with extremely large ponds and lakes. All around, on the outside, there flowed the fair Alakananda. Celestial women came there to bathe and released reddish *kumkuma* into the water. Elephants happily drank this, even when they were not thirsty, and assumed this hue. Here and there, the sounds of singing could be heard. All around, the *gandharvas* sang, aided by *apsaras*. O king! On seeing this, Bhargava was filled with great joy. He ascended further up to the summit. Shiva’s supreme residence was there. O Indra among kings! He saw a large banyan tree there, with gentle shade. There was a supreme abode there, worthy of residing in. It was frequented by *siddhas*. He saw a circular rampart all around, extending for one hundred *yojanas*. ⁵⁶ It was beautiful and was decorated with many kinds of gems. There were four

gates and *ganas* all around—Nandishvara, Mahakala, Raktaksha, Vikatodara, Pingalaksha, Vishalaksha, Virupaksha, Ghatodara, Mandara, Bhairava, Bana, the terrible Ruru, Viraka, Virabhadra, Chanda, Bhringi, Riti, Mukha, Siddhendranatha, *vidyadharas*, giant *uragas*, *bhutas*, *pretas*, *pishachas*, *kushmandas*, *brahma-rakshasas*, *vetalas*, Indras among *danavas*, Indras among *yogis*, with matted hair, *yakshas*, *kimpurushas*, *dakinis* and *yoginis*.⁵⁷ He saw them. Delighted, he took Nandi's permission and entered. There, he saw Shiva's residence, surrounded by the entire world. It extended for four *yojanas*. At the eastern gate, he saw Kartikeya stationed on the left and Vinayaka on the right.'

'Bhargava prostrated himself before those two, who were Shiva's equal in valour. The best attendants were stationed there, along with those who protected the *kshetras*.⁵⁸ They were seated on bejewelled thrones, decorated with gems. O great king! Taking their permission, Bhargava was about to enter. But Vinayaka said, "Wait for a while. Along with Uma, Mahadeva is sleeping now. Let me get Ishvara's permission. I will return in a moment. O brother! I will then enter with you. Remain here now." The descendant of the Bhargava lineage heard Vinayaka's words. He quickly started to reply to Ganesha. Rama said, "O brother! I will enter the inner quarters and bow down before the Ishvara and Ishvari of the universe, Parvati and Shankara. I will then immediately return to my own home. Kartavirya, Suchandra, their sons, soldiers and relatives, many thousands of other kings, Kambojas, Pahlavas, Shakas, Kanyakubjas, lord of Koshala, those who were full of *maya* and immensely strong—thanks to Shambu's favours, I have killed all these in a battle. Therefore, prostrating myself, I will return to my own residence." In front of Ganapati, this is what Bhargava said there. Using sweet words, the lord of *ganas* replied to Bhargava. Vinayaka answered, "O immensely fortunate one! Remain here for a while. You will see him. O brother! Vishveshvara is spending time with Bhavani now. O child!⁵⁹ When a man and a woman are united on a single seat, anyone who breaks their pleasure certainly goes to hell. In particular, it is certainly the case that a *dvija* should never see a father, a *guru* or a king when that person is seated in privacy. Willingly or involuntarily, if a person sees someone eager for

intercourse, it is certain that he will be separated from his wife for seven births. If a person looks at the hips, breasts or face of another man's wife, or of his mother, sister or daughter, he is the worst among men." Bhargava responded, "These are amazing, unprecedented and unheard-of words that have emerged from your mouth. Have you uttered them because you were joking with a brother? Those instructions of the sacred texts are for those who deviate because of women. There never is a taint for an indifferent person, or for a child. O brother! I will proceed to the inner quarters. O child! What is it to you? You stay here. I will act following what I can see and what is appropriate for the occasion. You have said that your mother and father are there. Parvati and Parameshvara are the parents of the universe." O king! Having said this, Bhargava got ready to enter the inner quarters. However, Vinayaka stood up and quickly restrained him. There was a war of words between them first. After this, they tugged at each other with their hands. Witnessing this, Skanda was disturbed and tried to make them understand. Guha seized them with his two hands and separated them. Bhargava, the destroyer of enemy heroes, became angry at Ganesha. He seized his battleaxe and got ready to hurl it.'

'When the supreme one of the Bhrigu lineage was about to angrily hurl the battleaxe, Gajanana ⁶⁰ sought to protect himself. He seized him powerfully with his trunk and took him to Bhuloka, Bhuvārloka, Svarloka, Maharloka, Janaloka, Tapoloka and Satyaloka, before finally bringing him to Vaikuntha. Isha's son showed the excellent Bhargava Goloka, which was above all this. He hurled him down to the seven nether regions and showed him these too. He swiftly raised and flung him into the midst of the waters. At this, he was scared and wished to save his own life. He was then brought back to where he had been standing before.'

Chapter 80-1(80) (Parashurama and Vinayaka continued)

Vasishtha said, 'O lord of the earth! Rama was whirled around by Ganadhisha ⁶¹ in this way. He was filled with both joy and grief and thought

about his defeat. He looked towards Ganesha, who was standing there, indifferent. Filled with great rage, he hurled his battleaxe. Ganesha noticed that it was a battleaxe that had been given by his father. Therefore, desiring that it should not fail, he received it on his left tusk. That tusk was sliced off by the axe and fell on the ground. The ground was covered with blood. It was as if a mountain had been struck with the *vajra*. As a consequence of the tusk falling, all the mountains and *dvipas* ⁶² on the earth shook. O lord of the earth! The earth trembled and people were filled with fear. *Devas* witnessed this from heaven and there were great lamentations. Kartikeya and the others were severely afflicted and screamed. Parvati and Shankara heard this uproar and the sound of the tusk falling. Those two Ishvaras arrived there and saw Heramba, ⁶³ with his curved trunk and a single tusk. Parvati asked Skanda, “What is the reason for this?” Asked by his mother, the commander told her everything. While Rama heard, he told his mother everything that had happened. O king! The mother of the universe heard everything that had taken place. Enraged, Parvati spoke to Shankara, the beloved lord of her life. Parvati said, “O Shambhu! This Bhargava is your *shishya* and he is like a son. O lord! He has received the supreme energy and armour from you and has conquered the three worlds. In a battle, he has defeated the unvanquished king, Kartavirya. Having accomplished his task, he has given you the *dakshina*. ⁶⁴ With his axe, he has brought down your son’s tusk. As a result of this, there is no doubt that you have become successful. O Shambhu! Protect Bhargava, whom you love exceedingly. You are a virtuous *guru*, and he will accomplish all your tasks. O lord! Since you have acted against my wishes, I will not remain here. With the two sons, I will go to my own father’s residence. The virtuous treat the sons of their servants well as if they are their own sons. But you have not treated your own son well, not even in words. Therefore, miserable, I am leaving.” Bhagavan Bhava ⁶⁵ heard Parvati’s words. O lord of the earth! He did not say anything in reply, good or bad. In his mind, he remembered Krishna, who destroys the afflictions of those who prostrate themselves before him.’

‘The lord of *gopis* is the lord of Goloka. He is skilled in many kinds of entreaties. Bhagavan Keshava removes the afflictions of those who

prostrate themselves. As soon as he was remembered, the ocean of compassion arrived there. The lord of everything is subservient to his devotees. He was as dark as a cloud and his face was radiant. He wore bejewelled armlets and a necklace. His garments flashed like lightning. His earrings resembled *makaras*.⁶⁶ There was a peacock feather on his crest, adorned with many jewels. His radiant face smiled a bit. The dazzling Koustubha jewel was on his chest. The lord of *gopis* is extensively praised in words. The illustrious and unvanquished one was with Radha and Shridaman.⁶⁷ He was an ocean of *jnana* and he surpassed everyone's energy with his energy. On seeing him arrive, Shiva was delighted in his mind. He prostrated himself in the right way and worshipped the one who had come. Along with Radha, the lord entered the house. Along with his wife,⁶⁸ he sat down on a bejewelled throne. Along with her sons, Devi Parvati also went there. Along with her sons, she joyously prostrated herself before the lord's feet. Rama also went there. With an agitated mind, he lowered his shoulders and fell at Parvati's feet. She did not greet Bhargava, who had prostrated himself in front of her.'

'In words that were full of affection, Jagannatha spoke to Parvati. Shri Krishna said, "O daughter of a mountain! O one whose face surpasses the moon! O one infinite in qualities! Jamadagni's son has placed his head on your lap. Place your lotus hand on it. You are the one who dispels the fear of a worldly existence. You are the one who sports with Shambhu. You are the one who destroys sins. O one with the stride of an elephant! The sins of those who fall at your feet are always destroyed. Please grant him a boon. O Devi! O immensely fortunate one! Listen to my words, which are those uttered in the *Vedas*. When you hear them, there is no doubt that you will rejoice. Your great-souled son, Vinayaka, is greater than the greatest. Desire, anger, anxiety and fear never enter him. O beautiful one! In the collections of the *Vedas*, *smriti* texts and Puranas, great-souled ones have instructed us about his extremely sacred names. They destroy all accumulations of sins, and I will mention them. There are extremely strong groups of *pramathas*⁶⁹ and they have many forms. He is their leader and is therefore described as Ganesha. All the Brahmandas, past, present and

future, are inside him. Therefore, he is Lambodara.⁷⁰ O Devi! As a result of destiny's determination, his head was severed, and the head of an elephant was subsequently fixed. Hence, he is spoken of as Gajanana.⁷¹ When the moon arose on *chaturthi*, he was cursed by Darbhini and suffered. Since he wore that moon on his forehead, he is described as Bhalachandra.⁷² Earlier, Jataveda was cursed by the seven sages and was destroyed. Since he ignited him again, he is known as Shurpakarna.⁷³ Formerly, at the time of a battle between *devas* and *asuras*, he was worshipped by large numbers of residents of heaven, for countering impediments. Hence, he is described as Vighnashasta.⁷⁴ O fortunate one! As a result of destiny, today, Rama has brought down his tusk with an axe and he has now become Ekadanta.⁷⁵ O Hara's beloved! In the course of Brahma's future action, his trunk will become curved. Therefore, the learned will describe him as Vakratunda.⁷⁶ O Parvati! Thus, your son has many names. When they are remembered, the sins of the three periods of time⁷⁷ are dispelled. This is the thirteenth *kalpa*. Earlier, during the tenth *kalpa*, I granted him the boon that he would be worshipped before all the *devas*. O auspicious one! This is for *samskaras* like *jatakarma* and *garbhadana* and worshipping *devas* at the time of travels, trade, battles and hardships. If Gajanana is worshipped first, the desired success is obtained.⁷⁸ There is no doubt that success is obtained in all these tasks." Hearing the words spoken by the extremely great-souled Krishna, Parvati, the sovereign of the universe, was surprised and her face became auspicious. However, in Shiva's presence, she did not offer a reply. Radha, whose eternal form is the same as that of Shiva, spoke to Devi. Shri Radha said, "Prakriti and Purusha depend on each other's forms. Sometimes, in the visible world, they appear as if they are different. O Devi! Actually, there is no difference between you and me. You are Vishnu and I am Shiva. Thus, there are two forms. Vishnu has taken your form inside Shiva's heart. Shiva has taken my form inside Vishnu's heart. O immensely fortunate one! This Rama is Vishnu's devotee, who became Shiva's devotee. Ganesha is Shiva himself but has assumed the form as Vishnu. There is no difference between us and no difference can be seen between these two lords." Saying this, Radha took Gajanana up in her lap.

She inhaled the fragrance of his head and touched his cheek with her hand. As a result of this touch, the wound in the cheek became whole. Entreated by Radha in this way, Parvati was pleased. With her own hands, she raised Rama, who had fallen at her feet. Extremely happy, Parvati inhaled the fragrance of his head and placed him on her lap. On seeing that Rama and Ganesha were being honoured in this way, Krishna lovingly pulled Skanda towards him and placed him on his lap. At this, Shambhu rejoiced. Shridaman was present there. The bestower of honours honoured him and affectionately placed him on his lap.’

Chapter 81-1(81) (Parashurama is blessed)

Vasishtha said, ‘O lord of the earth! Thus, their minds became extremely gentle. Rama got up from Bhavani’s lap and joined his hands in salutation. He controlled himself and praised the divinity who has no distinguishing features, but assumes distinguishing features, the one who is devoid of duality, but assumes duality, the one who has no *gunas*, but assumes *gunas*. Rama said, “This universe is ordained and is created as a result of the transformations of Prakriti. What experience or power do I have to measure it? His form and name are not known. He alone is the reservoir of everything desired. Bhava’s beloved has fulfilled my desires. May she save me. You are described as Pradhana, when the qualities become manifest. You are the creator of the enumerations of time. You are the cause of everything in the world. Everything has originated and flowed from you. O mother! May your favourable glance fall on me now and save me. He eats with six mouths.⁷⁹ He destroys those born in Danu’s lineage. He destroys impediments faced by Gods. He is the first among those who express this lineage. He is the one who illuminates with every kind of learning. He is the one who forcefully appears in the mind. His mount is a peacock and he bestows everything on devotees. Let him always vanquish all my bonds. He resides near Hara.⁸⁰ He loves those who serve Krishna. He makes his devotees radiant. He makes *gopa* maidens smile. He shows a great deal of

respect to what Hara does since the mind of the lord of *gopis* is just like that of Hara's. He knows many kinds of means. Let him not take away any fame I have. Indeed, he has controlled his mind and has directed it towards his devotees, taking away their accumulation of difficulties. He is the supreme bestower of *jnana*. He is superior to everyone in his qualities. He lies down in Radha's lap. He should pardon all the fathomless sins I have committed. People worship Radha as the cause behind the creation, preservation and destruction of the universe.⁸¹ She understands words that emerge from the mouth of the lord of mendicants and tastes the eloquent *amrita* of these words of love. She is the sovereign of the *rasa* dance.⁸² For those who possess taste, she is Ishvari. She resides in the heart of her lover and delights those who are her own. Let that leader, who is described as Radha, save me. I bow down before her. The great Virat originated from her womb.⁸³ Virat originated as her portion. Vidhatri⁸⁴ originated from a lotus and was instructed in seclusion. He created the universe, with its mobile and immobile objects. All the resplendent Brahmandas originated from the pores in his body. Let his mother be eternally pleased with me. As the primordial water,⁸⁵ he pervades the universe and its mobile and immobile objects. The lord is an ocean of truth, consciousness and bliss. He delights and manifests himself, along with Radha, who is blind with love for him. Krishna is complete. Let him be moistened with compassion towards me. Through that, let me always perform meritorious deeds. Let me be submerged in this ocean of bliss." In this way, Jamadagni's son eulogized and stopped. Having got to know the truth about everything, his body hair stood up in delight and it was as if he had become successful in his objective.'

'The lotus-eyed Krishna was pleased in his mind. Bhargava, a devotee worthy of compassion, was prostrate in front of him and he replied. Krishna said, "O Indra among Bhargavas! You have accomplished *siddhi* now, because of my favours. O child! From now on, you will become the best person in the world. Earlier, I had granted you a boon in the hermitage of Vishnupada.⁸⁶ O lord! Across several years, all of that will duly happen now. If a person desires excellent welfare, it is recommended that

compassion must be shown towards the dejected. One must strive for *yoga* and also chastise enemies. In this world, no one is your equal in energy and strength. In *jnana* and fame too, you are the best. Therefore, return to your own house and serve your parents. Perform austerities. At the right time, *siddhi* will be in the palm of your hand.” Radhika’s lord raised Ganesha from Radha’s lap. He embraced him closely and established a friendship between him and Rama. At this, Rama and Ganeshvara were extremely happy. O scorcher of enemies! Those two immensely fortunate ones followed Krishna’s command. The virtuous Devi Radha is loved by Krishna. At this time, pleased and delighted, she bestowed boons on both of them. Radha said, “You will be worthy of being worshipped by all the worlds. You will be invincible and will bring joy. O sons! In particular, the two of you will be my devotees. As a result of my favours, if anyone starts a task after uttering your names, he will become successful in everything.” After this, Bhavani, the mother of the universe loved by Bhava, spoke. “O Rama! O child! I am pleased with you. What boon will I bestow on you? O immensely fortunate one! Cast fear a great distance away and tell me that.” Rama replied, “I will pass through thousands of future births in the future. In those, please grant me devotion towards the two Krishnas and the two Bhavas.”⁸⁷ I see no difference between the two Krishnas and the two Bhavas.” Parvati said, “Let it be that way. You will be devoted towards the two Bhavas and the two Krishnas. O one excellent in vows! Through my favours, you will live for a long time.” Uma’s lord, the lord of the earth, spoke. The Ishvara of the universe spoke to the Indra among Bhargavas, who had prostrated himself and was worthy of a boon. Shiva said, “O Rama! O child! You are my devotee and I have already granted you a boon. All of that will come to pass. I have spoken the truth. It will not be otherwise. From now on, there will be no one in the world who will be stronger than you. O child! There will be no one in the world who will be more energetic than you.” After this, Krishna took his leave from Shiva and the daughter of the mountain. Along with Shridaman and Radha, he went to Goloka. Rama, with *dharma* in his soul, worshipped Bhavani and Bhava. He performed *pradakshina*.⁸⁸ O lord of the earth! He bent down and took

his leave from Ganesha and Kartikeya. Along with Akritavrana, he emerged from inside the house. When Rama emerged, Nandishvara and the other foremost *ganas* bowed down before him. O king! Full of great joy, he left for his own house.’

Chapter 82-1(82) (Parashurama returns home)

Vasishtha said, ‘O king! The learned Bhargava, with *dharma* in his soul, left with Akritavrana and saw many countries. Along Bhargava’s route, wherever *kshatriyas* saw him, they hid themselves, intent on saving their own lives. O Indra among kings! Thus, Rama reached his own father’s hermitage. It was full of many tranquil beings and the sounds of the *Vedas* resounded. There were happy lions, deer, cows, elephants, cats and rats there, equal in their love, having cast fear a long distance away. O lord of the earth! There, fire arose from *agnihotra* rites. On seeing this, peacocks were delighted and danced. At the time of twilight, in the direction of the setting sun, *dvijas* offered oblations of water and as they flung this water away, the ground became slushy with water. Engaged in the vow of *brahmacharya*, the residents joyously practised the *Vedas*, sacred texts and *Samhitas*.⁸⁹ Pleased in his mind, Rama looked at the prosperity of the hermitage. O king! Along with Akritavrana, he slowly entered. Sons of *dvijas* uttered words of “Victory” and words of “*namah*”. *Dvijas* honoured Rama and he was filled with great delight.’

‘He entered the hermitage and entered his own house. Rama saw his father, Jamadagni, store of austerities. He was capable of chastising and forgiving and was seated, like another Bhrigu himself. He prostrated himself at his feet, touching the ground with eight parts of his body.⁹⁰ O lord of the earth. He said, “I am Rama, your servant.” The foremost among virtuous people clasped his feet, in the proper way. Joining his hands in salutation, he then showed obeisance at his mother’s feet. Prostrating himself, he spoke these words, which made them happy. Rama said, “O father! Kartavirya was extremely difficult to assail. As a result of your

power and austerities, he, along with his sons, forces and mounts, has been killed. Urged by his wicked minister, he committed a crime against you. O bull among sages! I have inflicted a punishment on that invincible one. Having prostrated myself before you, I went to Brahma's presence. Prostrating myself before Vidhatri, I told him about my task. Bhagavan heard my account, right from the beginning, and told me, 'To accomplish your own task, go to Shiva's eternal world.' O father! Hearing his words, I prostrated myself before the grandfather. Desiring to see Hara, I went to Shiva's world. I entered and prostrated myself before Bhagavan Shiva, who was with Uma. I prostrated myself before the divinity who bestows the desired objective. In front of him, I told him everything about my own conduct. With an attentive mind, he listened to everything I said. Having heard, he reflected. Out of compassion, he granted me everything, including Trailokya-vijaya *kavacha*, which grants every kind of success. Having obtained this, I prostrated myself and went to Pushkara. With a joyous mind, I performed *sadhana* ⁹¹ with the *kavacha* there. Having killed Kartavirya, I went to Shiva's world again. There, I saw Skanda and Vinayaka at the gate. O one who knows about *dharma*! Prostrating myself before them, I sought to enter. On seeing me quickly enter, the leader of *ganas* forcibly restrained me, saying, 'This is not an opportune moment.' O father! After engaging in a battle with words, we tugged at each other's hands. O delight of the Bhrigu lineage! Subsequently, the battleaxe was hurled. Realizing this, he seized me, whirling me down upwards and downwards, before placing me down at the same place again. Seeing this, I became extremely angry and hurled the axe. His tusk was brought down, and the divinity arrived there. Parvati also arrived there and was filled with rage. Krishna also arrived, along with Radha. He entreated her and she gave me a boon. After establishing friendship between him ⁹² and me, Krishna left. I prostrated myself before the two sovereigns of *devas*, Parvati and Parameshvara. Thereafter, along with Akritavrana, I have come to your presence." O lord of the earth! Saying this, Bhargava Rama stopped. Jamadagni spoke these words to Rama, the destroyer of enemies. Jamadagni said, "As a result of killing *kshatriyas*, sins have overwhelmed

you and they need to be pacified. Therefore, you should undertake the appropriate *prayashchitta*.”⁹³ Rama, supreme among intelligent ones, was addressed by his father in this way and replied, “You should instruct me about the appropriate *prayashchitta*.” Jamadagni responded, “You should make your body suffer through *vratas* and *niyamas*.”⁹⁴ Subsisting on vegetables, roots and fruits, you should torment yourself through austerities for twelve years.” Thus addressed, the extender of Bhrigu’s lineage prostrated himself before him and his mother. O king! Along with Akritavrana, he left, to undertake austerities. The afflicter of enemies went to Mahendra, the excellent mountain. He created a hermitage and tormented himself through extremely difficult austerities there. He performed austerities and observed *vratas* and *niyamas*. He worshipped *devas*. The great-minded Rama spent some years in this way.’

Chapter 83-1(83) (Shura’s revenge)

Vasishtha said, ‘On one occasion, Shura arrived in the forest on a hunt.⁹⁵ He was with Shurasena and the others and had the four kinds of forces with him. They entered that great forest and killed many kinds of animals. They suffered from thirst and at midday, went to River Narmada. They bathed and drank water from the river, thus getting rid of their exhaustion. As they were proceeding, they saw the path that led to Jamadagni’s hermitage. They saw that beautiful hermitage. Urged by perverse *karma*, they asked sages who were walking along the path, “Who does this belong to?” They replied, “This belongs to the great ascetic, Jamadagni, serene in his *atman*. He resides here. His son is Rama, supreme among those who wield weapons.” Hearing this and hearing the recital of Rama’s name, they were scared. However, remembering the earlier enmity, they were overwhelmed by rage and intolerable cruelty. They spoke to each other, “This is the father of the one who has killed our father. Why should we not punish our enemy? What should we do now? Please instruct us.” Saying this, with swords in their hands, they entered the hermitage. Since the brave sage had left, they killed

all those who were around. They killed him ⁹⁶ and like cruel *nishadas*, took his head away. With their own forces those evil-souled ones then left for their city. The sons of the great-souled one saw that their father had been killed. O great king! They surrounded him and wept, afflicted by grief. Renuka saw that her husband had been killed and had fallen on the ground. She lost her senses and immediately fell, like a creeper struck by lightning. The flames of the fire of grief burnt her mind and she lost her senses. With her senses destroyed, she immediately gave up her breath of life. Her sons regained their senses and saw that she was not saying anything. Immersed in an ocean of grief, they lost their senses and fell on the ground. There were other stores of austerities who resided in that grove. They assembled. Though they suffered equally from grief, they consoled the sage's sons. Comforted by a large number of sages, Jamadagni's sons followed the norms and consigned the bodies of their parents into the radiant flames. Thereafter, they performed all the necessary rites for those who had died. Day and night, they suffered, on account of the misery caused by the deaths of their parents. After some time had passed and the twelve years were over, with his friend, Rama returned to his father's hermitage, the austerities having been completed.'

Chapter 84-1(84) (Slaying of *kshatriyas*)

Vasishtha said, 'Along the path, he heard from sages about how the princes had acted towards his parents, the ascent to heaven of his parents, how his father had been robbed of his life and about how his head had been taken away. He also heard about his mother's death. The mighty-armed one was afflicted by sorrow and grief and lamented. Though he suffered from an equal measure of sorrow, Akritavrana comforted him. He cited the reasons instructed in the sacred texts, indicating that those who were capable should resort to bravery. He cited reasoning and instances from customary worldly practices to assuage the sorrow. Comforted in this way, the intelligent Bhargava resorted to his fortitude. Along with his friend, he left, wishing to

see his brothers. Suffering from grief, he saw them and greeted them. They were also extremely miserable. Amid this sorrow, he spent three days with them. He remembered his father's death and was filled with extremely great rage, so much so that he became capable of suddenly destroying all the worlds. True to his word, he had earlier taken a pledge for the sake of his mother. He firmed up his heart and got ready to kill all *kshatriyas*. "I will kill all those born in the lineage of *kshatriyas*. Using the blood from their bodies, I will perform *tarpana* ⁹⁷ for my parents." This was Bhargava's decision. He told all his brothers about this. Taking his leave from them, he performed all the rites for his parents and left.'

'Along with Akritavrana, he reached Mahishmati. He remained in a grove outside and remembered Mahodara. ⁹⁸ He quickly sent Rama a bow, a chariot yoked to horses and Sarvamsaha. ⁹⁹ Rama mounted the chariot, armoured himself and seized his bow and arrows. The vanquisher of enemies blew on the conch shell, given to him by Rudra. He twanged his bow-string and made the space between heaven and earth tremble. Sahasaha, supreme among charioteers, drove the chariot. At his parents being killed, he was filled with intolerance. The sound of the chariot, the twanging of the bow and the blare of the conch shell agitated all the men and elephants in the city. They got to know that Rama, the destroyer of all lineages of *kshatriyas*, had arrived. Agitated, the sons of the king made preparations for the battle. O king! On five chariots, Shura, Shurasena and the others got ready to fight with Rama, accompanied by the kings. The bulls among *kshatriyas* had four kinds of forces with them. Like insects approaching a fire, they approached Rama. As they descended, on that single chariot, Bhargava countered them. In the encounter, infinite in valour, he fought against all the kings. Yet again, there was a battle between Rama and the kings. Pervasive in intelligence, he slew one hundred kings there. He killed Shurasena and the others, along with their soldiers and mounts. In an instant, he made that circle of *kshatriyas* fall on the ground. With their forces and mounts killed, their hopes were shattered. The kings who had not been killed fled in all directions. In this way, he was victorious in the battle, having killed the soldiers and made them run away. With his

excellent and fiery arrows, he killed hundreds of kings. Overwhelmed by rage, he wished to burn down the entire city. Bhargava invoked a weapon that resembled the fire of destruction in its brilliance. The entire city, garlanded by ramparts, was garlanded by flames. The fire from the weapon burnt down the city, with its elephants, horses and men. The city was burnt down. Seeing this and intent on saving his own life, Vitihotra,¹⁰⁰ who was afflicted by fear, fled to save his life. The fire from the weapon burnt down everything in the city and killed the enemies. Like Kala, the Destroyer, it flattened all the worlds. As he advanced, with Akritavrana and Sahasaha, the clatter of his chariot made the earth tremble. After having killed all the *kshatriyas* on the surface of the earth, he was pacified. Making up his mind to perform austerities, Rama went to Mount Mahendra. But after twelve years, more *kshatriyas* arose. Therefore, he returned, firm in his vow and bound to his consecration of killing them. *Dvijas* gave birth to *kshatriyas* again, through the wives of the dead *kshatriyas*. Hence, he again killed hundreds and thousands of kings on earth. In two years, he again exterminated all the *kshatriyas* from earth. After this, he again performed austerities for thirty-two years.¹⁰¹ O king! However, *dvijas* again gave birth to *kshatriyas*, through the wives of *kshatriyas*. Like Kala, the Destroyer, he exterminated all of them from the earth again. In the course of time, kings were born again. He killed them and roamed around the earth for two years. O Indra among kings! Enough of this. Rama remembered the death of his father. He exterminated *kshatriyas* from earth twenty-one times. This was because his mother had beaten her stomach twenty-one times.¹⁰² Therefore, Rama exterminated *kshatriyas* from the earth that number of times.’

Chapter 85-1(85) (Samantapanchaka in Kurukshetra)

Vasishtha said, ‘After this, Rama captured twelve thousand kings alive. They were infinitely energetic, and he sprinkled their hair. ¹⁰³ He seized thousands of kings. Along with sages, the greatly-energetic one went to Kurukshetra, a place full of austerities. The extender of the Bhrigu lineage had five lakes dug there. In every direction, he constructed *tirthas* that one could use to comfortably descend. ¹⁰⁴ He killed those kings there. Using the blood that flowed from their bodies, Bhargava filled those five lakes. Jamadagni’s powerful son bathed there in the proper way. Following the sacred texts, he attentively performed *tarpana* for the ancestors. O Indra among kings! He performed all the *shraddha* ¹⁰⁵ and other rites for his dead father and mother. As had been instructed, he did this in the company of the *brahmanas*. He had overcome all adversities. He resided in Kurukshetra, a place full of austerities. Attentively and properly, he devoted himself to the worship of the ancestors. O king! Since then, that place became the best among all supreme *tirthas*. The hermitage of Jamadagni’s son, in Kurukshetra, came to be known as such a place. This place, famous in the three worlds, is known as Syamantapanchaka. ¹⁰⁶ That is the spot where the best of the Bhrigu lineage brought eternal contentment to his ancestors. In the world of the ancestors, all of his ancestors obtained eternal satisfaction and peace, as a result of bathing, donations, austerities, oblations, feeding of *dvijas* and *tarpana*. In the world, that *tirtha* became famous under the name of Syamantapanchaka. It is great and extensive in good merits and destroys all sins. Like a dry leaf in the wind, all the hardships of mortals are cast far away there. O great king! Wicked mortals in this world are unworthy and do not obtain an opportunity to go to this *kshetra*, not even in one hundred births. The *tirtha* of Syamantapanchaka in Kurukshetra is immensely purifying. If a human bathes there, it is like bathing in all the *tirthas*. Having accomplished his objective properly, Rama’s wishes were

completely attained. The immensely intelligent one controlled himself and resided there for some time.'

'After one year was over, in the company of *brahmanas*, Jamadagni's controlled son went to Gaya, to offer *pindas* ¹⁰⁷ to the ancestors. Having gone there, the scorcher of enemies followed the sacred texts and performed a *shraddha*. He honoured the ancestors and satisfied *brahmanas*. There is Shiva's supreme spot there, known as Chandrapada. In the world, there is no such other *kshetra* that yields satisfaction to the ancestors, when they are worshipped, according to capacity, by people who belong to their own families. When *pindas* and other things are offered, the ancestors obtain an imperishable destination. Directed towards the ancestors, he satisfied *dvijas* there. Full of devotion towards the ancestors, he offered *pindas* in the proper way. At this, all the ancestors arrived from the world of the ancestors. With Jamadagni at the forefront, they accepted the worship he offered. Greatly happy in their minds, they approached the extender of the Bhrigu lineage. Remaining invisible in the sky, all the ancestors spoke to him. The ancestors said, "O brave one! You have accomplished a great task, which would have been extremely difficult for anyone else to accomplish. In the proper way, you have also satisfied us completely. Nevertheless, you have not given us imperishable happiness. This is because you have committed the act of killing *kshatriyas*. As a result of your devotion and the influence of this *kshetra*, you have been able to see us. We arrived and have been worshipped. However, we have not obtained shares in eternal fruits. Hence, you should pacify the sin of killing brave ones. Perform the appropriate *prayashchitta*. This is eternal *dharma*. Hereafter, restrain yourself from killing *kshatriyas*. They have committed an offence against your father. The world is not independent. They were instruments and your father's death had already been ordained. Who is capable of killing whom in this world? Who can protect? Everyone is merely an instrument. This is true of all such instances. It is certain that everyone acts in accordance with his *karma*. There is no doubt that, following the progress of time, there are powerful ones in the world of men. Living beings are constrained. O child! Without destiny, no living being is capable of doing anything. His capacity

is determined by the *karma* he has committed. If you wish to do what will bring pleasure to us, free yourself of this rage towards *kshatriyas*. O fortunate one! Resort to tranquillity. That is our supreme strength.” Telling the descendant of the Bhrigu lineage this, all the ancestors vanished. He lovingly accepted all their words. Along with Akritvrana, he was filled with great joy. From there, Rama went to the hermitage of Siddhavana. O king! Along with the *brahmanas*, the best of the Bhrigu lineage remained there. The great-minded one made up his mind to perform austerities. He allowed Sahasaha to leave, along with the chariot, bow and armour, with the agreement that they would arrive whenever needed. He visited all the *tirthas* and attentively bathed there. He travelled everywhere on earth, worshipping *devas* and ancestors. In this way, in due order, the descendant of the Bhrigu lineage circled the earth thrice. O Indra among kings! Following the customary practice of the world, he undertook this act of circumambulating.’

‘After this, he again went to Mahendra, the supreme mountain. O king! Having gone there, he performed austerities, surrounded by *brahmanas*. He remained in that place, frequented by sages and *siddhas*, for many nights. O king! He knew about *dharma* and constructed a residence for himself, to perform austerities. There were controlled sages who lived in that *kshetra* and they spoke about the *brahman*. Desiring to see him, all of them arrived there. The large number of sages saw him, with his mind fixed on austerities. He was like a fire that had been pacified, after burning down the kindling, consisting of all the *kshatriyas*. He saw that the divine sages, full of austerities, had come. Bhargava honoured and worshipped them with *arghya* and other things. ¹⁰⁸ Those extremely great ones asked each other about their welfare. After this, sacred and agreeable conversation ensued between them. With the permission of the sages, who had cleansed their *atmans*, he started to make arrangements for a great horse sacrifice. ¹⁰⁹ O king! He started to gather all the necessary materials. Ourva, Vishvamitra, Bharadvaja, Markandeya and other sages were with him. Taking their permission, he made Kashyapa his *guru*. O king! He thus performed the great horse sacrifice. Kashyapa was the *adhvaryu*, the sage Goutama was

the *udgatri* and Vishvamitra was the *hotri* in the sacrifice of Rama, who knew about the *atman*.¹¹⁰ Markandeya, the great sage, performed the task of the *brahmana*. In the due order, Bharadvaja, Agniveshya and other sages, accomplished in *Vedas* and *Vedangas*, performed the other tasks. O king! Along with his sons, *shishyas* and *shishyas* of *shishyas* and with the other sages, the illustrious Bhrigu performed the task of *sadasya*.¹¹¹ With their help, the descendants of the Bhrigu lineage completed all the tasks. In the proper way, along with the *guru*, he worshipped the *brahmanas*. In the proper way, a beautiful maiden was ornamented, to represent the earth. The tiger of the Bhrigu lineage invoked the earth, with hundreds of cities and villages, with mountains, forests and groves, and with the garland of oceans as her garment. Except for the excellent mountain, he gave everything to Kashyapa.¹¹² Rama thought of that as a place he would reside in. O Indra among kings! Since then, following the sacred texts, he¹¹³ is worshipped with gold, jewels, garments, horses, cows, elephants, food and other things. When the entire sacrifice was completed, he performed *avabhritha*.¹¹⁴ With their permission, he gave up all objects. The descendant of the Bhrigu lineage bestowed freedom from fear on all beings. He started to perform austerities on that supreme mountain. All the sages, controlled in their vows, the *ritvijas* and *sadasyas*, took his leave and returned to wherever they had come from. When they had left, along with Akritavrana, the illustrious one resided there happily, resorting to great austerities. Thus, the earth belonged to Kashyapa. With the permission of Marichi's son,¹¹⁵ there are many people who have performed the *vrata* known as Dipa-pratishtha.¹¹⁶ This is for the pacification of all kinds of miseries. This was uttered from the mouth of Vishnu himself. Since then, the earth has been completely rid of all sorrows. Thus, the appearance of Jamadagni's son has been spoken about. If a man listens to this, he is freed from all major sins.'

'The powerful Kartavirya was famous in the world for his energy. In this connection, which has been properly described, not too briefly and not in great detail. Such was King Kartavirya's prowess on earth. There will never be another man like him in the future. Nor has anyone like this been heard of in the past. Earlier, he had sought a boon from Dattatreya to the effect

that he should meet his death at the hands of an excellent being. That is how he obtained emancipation by being killed by Rama in a battle. He had five sons and one was famous as Jayadhvaja. O king! His son was the mighty-armed Talajangha. He had one hundred sons who were excellent archers. They were known as Talajanghas and the eldest was Vitihotra. Along with Vitihotra and the other sons and Haihaya and other kings, he ¹¹⁷ resided for a long period of time in forests and caves in the Himalayas. Earlier, when he was running away, he was severely struck by Rama's arrow on the back. Talajangha fell to the ground. As a result of the great pain, he lost his senses. Vitihotra was also fleeing. Because of destiny, he saw him. He picked him up on his chariot and swiftly ran away. Suffering from fear, all of them resided in the Himalaya mountains. They faced great hardships, surviving on vegetables, roots and fruits. With his mind fixed on austerities, Rama turned to peace. He returned Talajangha and his sons to their kingdom. That excellent king inhabited that city, as was the case earlier. The scorcher of enemies resided in his kingdom and protected it. O great king! Talajangha remembered that earlier enmity. Along with his sons, followers and soldiers, he attacked your city. He had the four kinds of forces with him, and the earth seemed to tremble and weep. The lord of the earth approached the city of Ayodhya. Your father's forces were weak. ¹¹⁸ Though all of them were aged, they fought against those kings, as if they were young. The aged one slaughtered many elephants, horses, chariots and soldiers, but was defeated by the enemy. Therefore, he ran away. He abandoned his city, kingdom, treasury, forces and mounts. Along with your pregnant mother, he entered the forest. There, he resided near Ourva's hermitage for some time. He was full of rage and intolerance, and he was also old. His throat choking with tears, he glanced at your mother. O Indra among kings! Like a person without a protector, he left for the world of heaven. O king! At this, your mother was filled with sorrow and grief. Weeping, she placed her husband's body on the funeral pyre. She had not eaten, and she was extremely miserable. On account of her husband, she was afflicted by sorrow. She was firm in her resolution that she would enter the fire. Ourva, the great sage, heard everything. He emerged from his

hermitage and restrained your mother. He said, “O queen! You should not die now. The son who is in your womb will be supreme among all *chakravartis*.” ¹¹⁹ Hearing these words, your spirited mother refrained from dying and the sage brought her to his own hermitage. Desiring to see your lotus face, she checked all her grief. She resided comfortably, on the outskirts of the hermitage. When the time was right, in Ourva’s hermitage, she gave birth to you. The sage performed *jatakarma* and all the other rites. As a result of his compassion, you were reared in Ourva’s hermitage. O scorcher of enemies! You know everything that happened thereafter. Such was the power of King Kartavirya on earth. He was famous in all the worlds because of the power of his *vratas*. In a battle, your father was defeated by his descendants and entered the forest. I have told you everything about his account. I have also told you everything about the supreme *vrata*, along with the *mantras* and *tantra*. To everyone in the worlds, it bestows fruits. If a king observes this for the sake of the four *purusharthas*, ¹²⁰ nothing desired in the three worlds is difficult to obtain. I have briefly described the *vrata* followed by the king of Haihayas and that followed by the sage who was Jamadagni’s son. What else will I tell you about?’

Jaimini continued, ‘At this, King Sagara joined his hands in salutation before the sage. He replied, “O illustrious one! I wish to observe this *vrata*. Please instruct me and permit me. O *brahmana rishi*! Through this rite, there is no doubt that I will be successful in my objective.” When the king said this, the great sage assented. Following the path indicated in the sacred texts, he initiated the king. Sagara, the excellent king, was thus initiated by Vasishtha. In the proper way, he collected all the materials needed for this auspicious *vrata*. Following the norms, the king worshipped Jagannatha. Having obtained the *guru*’s permission in the appropriate way, he completed it. The extremely intelligent king took a pledge. “As long as I bear the breath of life, I will endeavour to practice this excellent *vrata*.” The illustrious *rishi*, Vasishtha, took his leave from the king. Restraining him from following him, he left for his hermitage.’

Chapter 86-1(86) (Sagara keeps his pledge)

Jaimini said, ‘When the excellent sage had left, Sagara, the excellent king, resided in Ayodhya and protected the earth. He possessed copious amounts of every kind of wealth. He knew the true meaning of every kind of *dharma* and *artha*. Though he was but a boy in age, his deeds were revered by the aged. However, he did not eat during the day. Nor did he sleep at night. Remembering something, he sighed extremely deeply, with warm sighs. His heart was constantly anxious. The king had heard that the enemy had won over his kingdom from his senior, that he had left for the extremely deep forest with his mother and that he had left for the world of heaven there. Hence, he was overwhelmed by grief and rage. He took a pledge that he would exterminate the entire lineage of the enemies. He immediately took that vow. Anyone born in the Ikshvaku lineage is unable to tolerate the fire of defeat.’

‘On one occasion, the lord of the earth performed a rite with the auspicious signs. He made up his mind to defeat the enemy and progressively conquer all the directions. In all directions, the king surrounded himself with many thousands of chariots, elephants, horses and soldiers. He emerged from the excellent city. He left to slay the enemy. His army consisted of spirited horses that seemed to fly. It resembled a net of waves that arose from the ocean and had six parts.¹²¹ There were herds of intoxicated elephants that resembled principal mountain ranges. The surface of the earth was covered with floods of white umbrellas and banners and resembled the sky, when it is illuminated by moonbeams. As the lord of the earth proceeded along low-lying areas, in front of him, companies of foot soldiers marched and as they pounded the ground with their feet, they pulverized mountains and raised dust. Each component of the army had those four parts and the dust they raised covered the ground. The earth was flattened. He immediately killed many insolent and brave warriors and destroyed *vyuhas*, consisting of elephants, horses and chariots. His resplendence was like that of the one with the moon on his crest,¹²² when

he slaughtered hordes of *asura* armies. When he laid siege to a city, he would proclaim from a distance the tasks the besieged could perform. Time was given to quickly withdraw so that there was no impatient loss of life. The king desired to conquer the directions. Whenever he approached a kingdom, the king of that dominion immediately prostrated himself before him. He defeated all the kings and made them follow in his footsteps. Indicating what needed to be done, he returned the kingdoms to some. In this way, the king travelled in different directions and headed southwards.'

'He remembered the enmity that had been created earlier and attacked the Haihayas. He fought against those kings, with all their chariots and elephants. There was a tumultuous battle with the Haihayas and it made the body hair stand up. The mighty-armed and enraged lord of Kosala ¹²³ slaughtered thousands of kings and their forces in that great battle. Having defeated the Haihaya kings, he shattered and burnt down their city. Wishing to put an end to the enmity, the king rendered it empty and desolate. The entire surface of the earth was crushed by his proud army. The entire kingdom of the Haihayas was reduced to dust. The kings who had not been killed fled in different directions. Their kingdom and city were taken away from them. They were deprived of their prosperity and dominion. As those kings fled, the lord of the earth advanced against them. Like the maddened and enraged Destroyer killing subjects, he slaughtered their followers. In the battle, the angry Sagara, the destroyer of enemies, behaved in this fashion. He released the extremely terrible Bhargava weapon, terrible for foes. When he released that extremely terrible Bhargava weapon, the three worlds were filled with fear. There were blazing flames that instantly burnt down those hapless kings. The *Vayavya* weapon enveloped and covered them with smoke. As a result of this darkness, they could not see. They fell and rolled around on the ground. As a consequence of the dust, for some time, they could not even be seen. The power of the *Agneya* weapon prevented them from moving around. In every direction, the kings could no longer see the paths. They lost their senses, and their bodies were no longer under their control. Their minds became anxious. They were scared and cast aside their garments, weapons, armour and ornaments. Their hair was

dishevelled. In front of the enemy, their action clearly suggested that they were mad. In this way, in that battle, the powerful Sagara conquered all the Haihayas. Resembling an agitated ocean, he then advanced against the Kambojas. The Kambojas, Talajanghas, Shakas, Kiratas and others were enemies who had committed offences against him in the past. Many kinds of musical instruments were sounded, and war drums were beaten. When their ears heard these sounds, they lost their fortitude. They were confounded and immediately abandoned all their kingdoms, forces, cities and women. Terrified of his weapons, they repeatedly fled from one direction to another direction. The enemies of that lord of men were terrified. The blaze and flames of his power robbed some of them of their sight. They abandoned their homes, kingdoms, sons and other things. Attacked by enemy soldiers, they fled to the forest. When they reached there, they were attacked by other enemies, who had been sleeping in the caves of the mountains and were woken up. ¹²⁴ The king killed the Talajanghas and destroyed their forces and mounts. Progressively, the afflicter of enemies destroyed their kingdom. Overwhelmed by rage, he slaughtered many Yavanas, Kambojas, Kiratas and others, as well as Pahlavas and Paradas. In the clash, all those kings were killed. Groups of those who survived fled in different directions. “I am the son of the one whose kingdom you seized. I have now taken a pledge to kill all of you. I desire to advance against the enemy with great force.” His valour was like that of elephants. His energy destroyed *kshatriyas*. In the battle, in this way, King Sagara made the enemy kings hear and remember his conduct.’

‘On witnessing that the noble king had taken the vow of exterminating the enemy lineages, they were scared. There were seven kings, born from noble and famous lineages. These enemies of the excellent king were Paradas, Pahlavas and others. To protect themselves and their own, with their women and children leading the way, they went and sought refuge with Vasishtha, the revered *guru* of the Ikshvaku lineage. All those kings approached him and joined their hands in salutation. “O *brahmana*! Please be our refuge. We are afflicted and desire freedom from fear. The flames from Sagara’s weapons are burning our bodies and we are about to die.

With enmity in his mind, he is eager to slay all of us. Therefore, we wish to save our lives and come out of this fear. Our kingdoms and objects of pleasure have been shattered. We have been separated from our wives, children and relatives. We have sought refuge with you only to save our lives. In friendliness and strength, there is no other man in this world who can make him retreat and save us from this great fear. Indeed, the kings whom he follows acted to make you the *guru* of the lineage. The kings who were his predecessors in this lineage did that. Such is your power. Thus, Sagara will respect you as a *guru* and be restrained now. He will not transgress your command, just as the great ocean does not cross the shoreline. O lord! You are the well-wisher, father, mother and *guru* of the worlds. O immensely fortunate one! Therefore, you should save us.” The illustrious *rishi*, Vasishtha, heard their words. He slowly glanced at the ones who had sought refuge with him. There were remnants of the noble kings, those who had not been killed. There were also the aged, the women and the children. The illustrious one, compassionate towards all beings, looked at them. He looked at them affectionately. In his mind, he thought about this for a long time. The immensely intelligent one revived them with these gentle words. “Do not be afraid.” Full of great compassion, the immensely fortunate one said this. So that they might remain alive, he made them agree to the king’s agreement. There are all kinds of rites of *dharma* indicated for those born in royal lineages. Vasishtha made the kings, who had been burnt down by the rage, take the pledge that they would not practice these rites. The lords of the earth pledged to this contract. He himself went to the noble king and gradually pacified him. He requested, “O child! Let the lives of the enemy be saved. Let them go. I seek your indulgence for this.” Though he was still angry, the lord of the earth respected his *guru*’s words. Those enemies took a truthful pledge not to follow the appropriate *dharma* of their lineages, or to wear the appropriate attire. They were deprived of all the rites associated with *shruti* and *smriti* texts. *Brahmanas* kept those deceitful ones far away. He let those many kings go. Though they did not lose their lives, they were as good as dead. The Shakas were made to shave off half their heads. The Palhavas were made to grow beards. The Yavanas were

made to shave off their beards, while the Kambojas were allowed to retain a slight beard at the chin. In this way, he disfigured all the other noble kings. They could not take part in the rites of the *Vedas* and *brahmanas* abandoned them. Having made them accept this agreement, he let them remain alive and released them. Since then, those enemies gave up their conduct and characteristics. They were cast off and were censured by all the *varnas*. All of them were shamed as those who were cruel and shameless. There were many groups of people who were born as *Mlecchas*.¹²⁵ Those Shakas, Yavanas, Kiratas and others were released by the king, and they immediately abandoned their conduct and garb. They sought refuge in mountains, forests and caves. Even today, virtuous people always show disrespect to those born thus. They are wicked in inclination and evil in their efforts. However, in this world, they adhered to the pledge made to the lord of men.’

Chapter 87-1(87) (Sagara’s conquest)

Jaimini said, ‘After this, Sagara took the permission of Vasishtha, the supreme *rishi*. With a large army, he advanced against Vidarbha. With great affection, the king of Vidarbha bestowed his daughter on him. She was known by the name of Keshini and was unmatched in her beauty. The tiger among kings followed the norms. At an auspicious *muhurta*, with the fire as a witness, the lord of the earth accepted Keshini’s hand. Honoured by the king of Vidarbha, he remained in his house for a few days. Taking his leave, he then prepared to depart. Having obtained the permission, he was next honoured by the Paribahas. Emerging from their city, the king approached Shurasena.¹²⁶ He was honoured by the Yadavas, his maternal uncles. After they gave him copious quantities of wealth, he left Madhura.¹²⁷ In this way, King Sagara conquered the entire earth. He made all the kings pay him taxes and follow his instructions. After this, the king permitted his followers to return to their own kingdoms. The lord of the earth granted all his followers the permission in this fashion. With that great army and his camp,

¹²⁸ without making any other country suffer, he gradually returned to his kingdom. As he proceeded, many from the outlying areas and many regions honoured him. He quickly reached Ayodhya. All the inhabitants of the city got to know about his arrival. Eager to engage in great festivities, they adorned the city, all around. The city was decorated with all the auspicious signs. The ground was cleaned and sprinkled with water. Hundreds of pots were filled with water. Hundreds of flags were raised, and the place was decorated with them too. There were excellent fragrances of aloe and incense everywhere. It was bright with many kinds of flowers. The lofty turrets, gates, terraces and mansions were ornamented with jewels. Flowers and parched rice were showered down, to decorate the large roads. Every house in the city was prepared for that great festival. The city was garlanded with abodes for *devas* and all of them were worshipped. The inhabitants of the city and countryside were happy and wished to seek the king who had conquered the directions. It was ornamented everywhere. All the ordinary people, the women from the inner quarters and beautiful courtesans were there. All around, the city was decorated with plantain trees. All the residents of the city arrived and assembled there. The repeated and deafening sounds of “Victory” resounded in all directions. The sweet notes of many kinds of musical instruments mixed with that sound. He was appropriately honoured by them. Delighting the joyous subjects, along with them, he entered the excellent city. The *brahmanas* welcomed him with the extremely sweet sounds of utterances from the *Vedas*. He was praised a lot by *sutas*, *magadhas* and *bandis*. ¹²⁹ All around him, the inhabitants of many habitations uttered sounds of “Victory”. Singers sang, mixed with the sounds of *veenas* and flutes and the clapping of hands. Large numbers of courtesans danced, following him. A radiant white umbrella was held above his head. Parched rice and flowers were scattered all around him. He entered the city of Ayodhya, like Vasava ¹³⁰ entering his city. *Brahmanas* led him along a route that was purified against evil glances through fragrances. He entered the handsome and ornamented house, in the centre of the city. Along with his two wives, he happily alighted from the vehicle. He entered the home and saw his mother and the happy and well-nourished people

there. He humbly approached his mother, who was seated on a couch. He prostrated himself before her and touched her feet with his head. She greeted him and pronounced her benedictions, her voice choking with joy. Showing respect, she arose and embraced her son. Full of joy, she pronounced many kinds of benedictions over her two daughters-in-law. He talked to her about many accounts and remained there for some time. Then, taking her permission, the king emerged from that residence. Fanned by white fans, along with his followers, the king gradually proceeded to the assembly hall, which was like the assembly hall of the king of the Gods. He entered that divine assembly hall, full of many kings. He bowed down before the seniors and all of them greeted him with blessings. The lord of men sat down on a divine and sparkling throne. He was served by kings and the rulers of many countries. There, the excellent king conversed about many kinds of subjects. He resided there, along with his relatives, and delighted them. The king had kept his pledge and had conquered all the directions. Pervasive in intelligence, he ensured the three objectives of human existence. ¹³¹ As a result of his power, he conquered all the enemies and became the lord of the entire globe. Like Vrisha, he brought the entire earth under the subjugation of a single umbrella. ¹³² Earlier, his father had been defeated. He had been afflicted and angry because of that. He fully completed the excellent pledge he had taken as a consequence. The earth is garlanded with seven *dvipas*, oceans, cities, villages and large expanses. He conquered all the enemies and ruled over it.'

'Time passed in this way. The illustrious *rishi*, Vasishtha, arrived, desiring to see the lord of men again. On seeing the noble sage advancing, the king went and welcomed him reverentially, with *arghya* in his hand and accompanied by all the other kings. The immensely intelligent one worshipped him the proper way, with *arghya*, *padya* and other things. Full of devotion towards his *guru*, he prostrated himself before him. Vasishtha pronounced his benedictions over Sagara and asked him to be seated, along with all the other lords of men. The king sat down on an excellent and golden seat. With the sage's permission, so did his wives and the other kings. Apava ¹³³ spoke to the excellent king, who was seated near him,

while all the other kings heard. His words were gentle and clear in articulation. Vasishtha said, “O king! Is everything well with you, externally and internally? Is everything well now with the kingdom and with all the ministers and advisers? It is good fortune that the full complement of forces and mounts has been vanquished by you. Your enemies were such that you did not have to make a great deal of effort in the battle. It is good fortune that you have kept your difficult pledge and that you paid heed to my words. Once they gave up *dharma*, you allowed the enemies to live and released them. After conquering their kingdoms, you again wished to set out on an expedition to conquer the directions. You left with your forces and mounts. I have heard words to that effect. I have heard that after conquering the directions again, you are now established in your city. O excellent king! Out of affection, I have now come here, to see you.’ Vasishtha spoke in this way to Sagara, who had defeated Talajangha. Joining his hands in salutation, he replied to the great sage. Sagara answered, “O *maharshi*! There is no doubt that all is well, everywhere. O sage! All the *devas* have always been kindly disposed towards us. In your mind, you have also constantly meditated about our welfare. O sage! That being the case, how can there be evil portents for me? Through your favours, I have now become successful in my objectives. O *guru*! You have yourself come here to see me now. O illustrious one! You have spoken to me about the victory over adversaries and other things. All of that has been carried out through your favours. I think that I have obtained the entire earth because of your favours. Otherwise, how could I have possessed the capacity to kill the enemies in that way? My little effort has yielded great fruits because of you. When a planted tree yields a little bit of fruit, a person is delighted.” Thus, the great sage was honoured properly by Sagara and taking his leave, he again left for his hermitage.’

‘When Vasishtha had left, King Sagara was delighted in his mind. He resided in Ayodhya and ruled over the entire earth. His two wives possessed beauty, good conduct and qualities. As he willed, he happily enjoyed objects of pleasure. The two wives were Sumati and Keshini, and their faces were like blossoming lotuses. They possessed beauty, generosity and

qualities. Their breasts were thick and round. Their hair was blue and curly. They were adorned in all the ornaments. They possessed all the good signs and were in the fresh bloom of youth. They were loved by him and were constantly engaged in bringing him pleasure. Through their good conduct, inclinations and efforts, they constantly captivated his mind. Delighted in his mind, the lord of the earth also sustained them in the best possible way. As he desired, he resided in that city and found his pleasure with them. There is no other king on earth for whom the word “*rajan*” should be used.¹³⁴ In his qualities, the great-souled Sagara was like that. In his mind, the king did not pay as much attention to a great deal of *artha* and *kama*, as he did to a little bit of *dharma*. He was not greedy in his mind and therefore, his enjoyment did not cause suffering to *dharma*. In the same way, the Indra among kings enjoyed *kama*, without making *artha* suffer.’

Chapter 88-1(88) (Sagara visits Ourva’s hermitage)

Jaimini said, ‘Thus, the king ruled over the earth, consisting of seven *dvipas*, in the proper way. He was like another Dharma himself. *Brahmanas* and the other *varnas* were established in their separate *dharma*s and duly protected. He was attentive to this. The subjects and all the *varnas* followed those who were the best. The *varnas* followed the due order in the pursuit of *artha*. As long as an aged person was still around, death never approached a child. This was true of all *varnas*, as long as that king ruled the earth. With impediments removed, the entire kingdom prospered. There were also innumerable habitations, inhabited by people from the four *varnas*. There were innumerable villages, consisting of hundreds of houses. As long as that king ruled, there were many divisions of houses in the country. There was no *dvija* on earth who did not follow his own *ashrama*. For subjects belonging to all the *varnas*, as soon as there was an attempt, fruits were obtained. Humans started tasks that were appropriate for them. The tasks of men were in accordance with the *purusharthas*. The residents of cities, villages and *vrajas* engaged in great festivities. They desired to do

good to each other and were full of devotion towards the king. No one was criticized or reviled. No one suffered from poverty or disease. No subject was greedy or miserly. The people were delighted with the qualities of others and desired to have associations with such individuals. They always prostrated themselves before their seniors and were devoted to virtuous learning, not indulgences. They were scared of slandering others and were constantly attached to their wives alone. They were naturally devoted to *dharma* and avoided associating with those who were deceitful. As long as he ruled, all the subjects were believers. In this way, Subahu's son conquered the earth through his own powers. O immensely fortunate one! Then, the seasons always arrived at the right time. All the time, the earth always yielded copious quantities of excellent *shali*.¹³⁵ This happened as long as that tiger among men ruled over the earth. The lords of eighteen different dominions arrived there to serve him. There were hundreds of kings, famous for their beauty and valour, and these were kings who had been crowned. They were always seated on separate bejewelled seats and worshipped him. They resembled the immortals, worshipping the radiant Shakra in heaven. His assembly hall was illuminated with the radiance of jewels. As soon as they were summoned, all the vassal kings from the extremities of the kingdom arrived, with gifts. These kings set up separate camps for their soldiers, all around the city. Along with their sons, these kings wished to see him. They sent the information through the gatekeepers repeatedly, especially if the lord of men happened to reside in the inner quarters for a long period of time. The crowns of arrays of Indras among men rubbed excessively against his feet and scarred the king's feet, making them even more radiant. All around, large numbers of Indras among men served him. Resplendent with jewels, his assembly hall resembled those of Guha, Soma and Ravi. Such was the *dharma* of the king, a crest-jewel of *surya vamsha*. The scorcher of enemies ruled over the earth. There was no one else who ruled it. Sagara, lord of the earth, ruled over the earth in this way.'

'But he was not as pleased. People are pleased when they glance at the blossoming faces of their sons. Without that, he was extremely unhappy and

thought about it in many kinds of ways. “Alas! This is a great misery since there is no certainty about this lineage. It is certainly the case that our ancestors will face tumult in the matter of receiving *pindas*. When a virtuous son is born, it is indeed the case that the ancestors joyously go to that house, even from hell, eager for the *jatakarma* and other rites. As a result of great good merits, a person can certainly reach heaven. However, if he doesn’t have a son, the immortals do not open the gate to heaven. When a virtuous son is born, it is certainly the case that in both the lineages, ¹³⁶ the father obtains both the worlds and the grandfathers obtain the world of heaven. Without offspring, I will not obtain the destination obtained by those with sons. Without a son, it is indeed the case that it will be extremely difficult for me to obtain that destination. My prosperous and ornamented kingdom is not that different from Indra’s dominion. However, because of this demerit, it will be futile. My ancestors occupied this throne earlier. Without a son, this kingdom will come under the subjugation of others. Therefore, I shall now go to the hermitage of Ourva, bull among sages. For the sake of a son, along with my wives, I will now please him. I will go there and tell the great-souled one about my not having a son. There is no doubt that I will do everything that he tells me to do.” Sagara, supreme among kings, decided this in his mind.’

‘The king thus decided to leave for Ourva’s hermitage. Having entrusted the kingdom to the best of ministers, astride a chariot and along with his two wives, he happily left for the forest. He proceeded on a chariot that roared like the clouds. Along the sides of his path, peacocks were motionless and looked at him with unblinking eyes. ¹³⁷ O king! He showed his beloved wives the deer that gazed at him with unblinking eyes. They raised their eyes up for a moment. But instantly, got ready to run away again. He saw the trees, laden with flowers and fruit, and was delighted. The flowers did not fade. The fruits were succulent. The ground was covered with grass. The trees were covered with tender sprouts and yielded pleasant shade. The sound made by the cuckoos was pleasant since they had tasted the tender sprouts from mango trees. Their ears could hear these sweet calls in every direction. There were flowers from every season,

ornamented with buzzing bees. There were bunches of flowers on creepers and these made the trees bend down. There were hundreds of trees and troops of monkeys sat on them. ¹³⁸ There were the calls of flocks of birds, intoxicated peacocks and cooing *sarangas*. ¹³⁹ The wives of *vidyadharas* sang extremely agreeable songs. There were radiant caves in the forest and *kinnara* couples wandered around there. There were lakes and the banks of these were surrounded by the melodious calls of many kinds of birds—*hamsas*, *sarasas*, *chakravakas*, *karandavas* and *shukas*. ¹⁴⁰ The lakes were full of clumps of *ambujas*, *kahlaras*, *kumudas* and *utpalas*. ¹⁴¹ The gentle breeze wafted slowly and bore this fragrance, filling all the directions. The hermitage possesses such qualities. The lord of men imbibed all this as he proceeded and was filled with great joy. When he reached the circle of the hermitage, his mind was filled with serenity. Along with his two wives, the prosperous one descended from his vehicle. The lord of the earth instructed the driver, “Let the horses rest.” In this way, he reached the outskirts of the hermitage of the *maharshi* who had cleansed his *atman*.’

‘From the *shishyas*, he learned that the sage had completed the daily rites. To see the sage, he humbly entered the hermitage. The sage was seated in the centre, surrounded by a large number of *rishis*. Along with his two wives, the king happily lowered his head and bowed down. The lord of men prostrated himself before Ourva, the powerful *rishi*. He lovingly asked him to sit, along with them. ¹⁴² The great sage properly honoured him with *arghya*, *padya* and other things. With hospitality that befits the forest, he satisfied him and his wives. After the hospitality, the king rested for a while. He prostrated himself before Ourva, who was seated in front of him. The sage addressed him in soft and gentle words. “Is everything well in your kingdom, externally and internally? In accordance with *dharma*, are you protecting all the subjects? Using proper means, have you conquered the three objectives of human existence? I hope all your initiatives have been urged by the proper qualities and yield fruits. O excellent king! It is good fortune that you have conquered all your enemies. It is good fortune that you are protecting the entire kingdom in accordance with *dharma*. For those who base themselves on *dharma*, there is never any reason for distress.

Dharma itself protects those who protect it. I have heard that you have conquered the entire earth earlier. You returned to the city with your forces and married. The excellent *dharma* for kings is to protect the subjects. That way, they obtain happiness, in this world and the next one. Nevertheless, you have given up the task of nurturing the kingdom and have come to my presence with your two wives. O king! Why have you come here? Tell me.” Thus addressed by the sage, Sagara, the excellent king, joined his hands in salutation. He spoke in sweet words.’

Chapter 89-1(89) (Asamanja’s exile)

Sagara said, ‘O *maharshi*! There is no doubt that everything is well with me, in every possible way. O excellent one from the Bhrigu lineage! Thinking about peace, I have thought of you. Earlier, you instructed me about *astras* and *shastras*. Without that, I would have been incapable of chastising all the enemies now. You alone are my *guru*, well-wisher, *deva*, relative and friend. Other than you, I do not know any other father. Instructed by you in the matter of weapons, I have defeated all the kings. This is because of your austerities, and I remembered that strength. Through your austerities, you purify and protect the entire world. There is no doubt that you are capable of creating and destroying too. The power of your austerities is great and unmatched. When even one part of it is seen in this world, it gives rise to wonder. O *brahmana*! Behold. In your hermitage, a fawn, as soon as it is born, approaches the seat of a lion and gradually drinks water, without any fear. Without any fear, even an emaciated doe offers her udders to her young. A deer scratches its itching cheek by rubbing itself against the tip of the horn of a *ruru* antelope. Outside the circle of this forest, a tigress killed a doe that had just given birth. But residing inside this hermitage, that tigress now rears that fawn. In the forest, a lion was swiftly chasing an elephant. But as soon as they entered the hermitage, the chase stopped and they are standing here, together. Mongooses, rats, cats, peacocks, hares, serpents, wolves, boar, tigers, *sharabhas*, ¹⁴³ bears,

monkeys, jackals, *gavayas*, ¹⁴⁴ cows, deer and buffaloes have natural enmity in the forest. But once they come here, there is friendship. Such is the strength of your austerities, and it causes wonder in this world. O *brahmana*! Barring you, this cannot be seen anywhere else in this world. Through your favours, I have conquered this earth. O *brahmana rishi*! Along with the enemies, I returned to my kingdom. The advisers are under my control. In the appropriate way, I am attentive to the three objectives of human existence. Following the path instructed by you, I protect the entire kingdom. I am engaged in this way and am established in the kingdom. O bull of the Bhrigu lineage! However, I wished to see you because an expectation arose in my mind. Is it enough for me now that I should protect the earth, without offspring who will offer *pindas* to the ancestors? That is the reason there is excessive misery in my mind and it is impossible to counter it. There is no one other than you in this world who can dispel this. That is the reason I have come to you.” When Sagara said this and stood there, the illustrious Ourva thought about this in his mind for an instant. He then directed him in these words. “Control yourself. Along with your wives, reside here for some time. You will obtain your desired objective. There is no need to reflect on this.” He was delighted and lived there, devoted to performing service. With *dharma* in his soul, along with his wives, he resided there for a long time, full of devotion. The king and his two wives were attentive all the time. They followed the sage and brought him pleasure through their humility, good conduct and devotion.’

‘The great sage was satisfied with the devotion and service of the king’s two wives. He summoned them and addressed them in these words. “The two of you should tell me about the boon you wish for. There is no doubt that I will bestow it, even if it is extremely difficult to obtain.” Both of them lowered their heads and prostrated themselves before the great sage. They lovingly said, “O illustrious one! We desire sons.” The illustrious one replied, “To bring the desired pleasure to the king and also to the two of you, I grant you the desired boon. O immensely fortunate ones! Through my favours, you will have sons. This is certain. However, listen to some other words that I will speak. One of you will have a son who will not be

greatly devoted to *dharma*. However, he will remain until the end of the *kalpa* arrives. The other one will give birth to sixty thousand sons. They will not be successful and within a short time, all of them will be destroyed. I have granted the two of you boons with such qualities. According to your wishes, please state what you desire.” Thus, addressed by the sage, the princess of Vidarbha asked for a son who would live and extend the lineage. The other one asked for many sons. In this way, the great sage bestowed a boon on King Sagara and his two wives. He granted them leave to return to the city. The lord of the earth was successful in his objective. Having obtained the sage’s permission, along with his beloved wives, he ascended the chariot and left for the city. He entered the beautiful city, full of happy and well-nourished residents. The citizens were happy and sported, filled with supreme joy.’

‘O king! At this time, the king’s two wives were filled with great happiness and told the king that they had conceived. Their two foetuses grew, like the king of stars ¹⁴⁵ during *shukla paksha*. Their husband, their fathers and the citizens were content. When the designated time was completed, in an auspicious *muhurta*, Keshini gave birth to an extremely radiant boy, with the lustre of *agnigarbha*. ¹⁴⁶ His *jatakarma* and other rites were completed in the proper way. The king gave him the name of Asamanjasa. ¹⁴⁷ At that time, Sumati gave birth to a foetus that was in the form of a gourd. On seeing what she had given birth to, the king thought of throwing it away. However, getting to know about this, following his own will, the illustrious Ourva arrived there. When he was properly honoured by the king, he spoke quickly. “O king! You should not throw away this foetus, which is in the form of a gourd. This is the seed of sixty thousand sons who will be born to you. Therefore, cut it into pieces and carefully place those in pots full of *ghee*. Once they have been placed there, cover them with lids and protect them separately. O king! If this is done properly, through my favours, there is no doubt that you will have the stipulated number of sons. When the time is complete, they will shatter the pots and emerge separately. O king! In this way, sixty thousand sons will be born to you.” Having said this, the illustrious lord vanished from the spot. The king acted in

accordance with what Ourva had said. When one year was complete, one by one, from one day to another day, the pots full of *ghee* were suddenly shattered and sons were born. In this way, in the due order, sons were born to the lord of the earth. O king! Sixty thousand sons were born in this way and grew up. These sons were extremely strong and valiant and followed identical *dharma*. They were impossible to assail. In particular, they were cruel. The king, supreme among intelligent ones, did not love them too much.'

'However, Keshini's single son was loved and honoured by him greatly. Following the norms, the lord of the earth got him married. As a result of his qualities, he delighted all his well-wishers. Keshini's son conducted himself in this way. He had a famous son, famous under the name of Amshuman. From his childhood, this intelligent one was generous and full of extensive qualities. He delighted his well-wishers and his paternal grandfather. At this time, the king's son, Asamanja, was possessed in some way by a *pishacha* and this destroyed his senses. In an earlier birth, he had been a *vaishya* who had known about *dharma*. He had resided in a king's dominion and had possessed large amounts of wealth and grain. On one occasion, roaming around in the forest, he had seen an excellent store of riches. Overcome by avarice, the trader had started to seize this. The *pishacha*, the guard of that trove, had told him then, "I am hungry. I have resided here for a long time, guarding this treasure. Therefore, give me the flesh of a cow and then take it away. With my command, you can then seize this treasure, as you will." He had promised him, "I will give you the meat of a cow." With the *pishacha*'s permission, he had taken away the treasure. But in his folly, he had not given him what had been promised. O king! The *pishacha* had been filled with rage at the violation of a pledge that had been made. He had waited for a long time, desiring the expected food. While the wealth had been taken away, as a result of the distress and hunger, he had died. The *vaishya* had also died and after some time, had been born as Sagara's child and that of Keshini, as the extender of the lineage. The *pishacha*, who didn't possess a body, remembered this earlier enmity. O lord of the earth! In the form of the wind, he entered the prince's body.

Possessed by him at the time, he became cruel in his mind. Forcibly possessed in this way, his inclinations were confused. In that city, Asamanja behaved like a cruel person. He was always especially deceitful towards the young, the aged and women. He killed them. Having killed them, he flung the dead bodies into the Sarayu. ¹⁴⁸ All the citizens witnessed his vile deeds. Oppressed by him in many kinds of ways, they went and informed the king. Hearing this, the king was filled with great sorrow. He summoned him and made efforts to restrain him. His great-souled father restrained him in many kinds of ways. But all this was futile, like burnt barley that is placed in hot water. The king was incapable of restraining him from these wicked deeds. Scared of the censure of people, he banished him from his dominion.'

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Chapter 90-1(90) (Release of the horse)

Jaimini said, ‘With *dharma* in his soul, Sagara abandoned his son. The love the lord had felt for him was now transferred to the child Amshuman, who followed *dharma* in his conduct. O king! During this time, Sumati’s sons grew up. They were many and were devoted to each other. They were capable of withstanding the *vajra*. They were cruel, heartless and devoid of shame. All of them followed the same *dharma* of not being devoted to *dharma*. They were devoted to the same task and their minds were full of folly and rage. All beings found them unassailable, and they caused oppression to people. In every kind of way, they were indifferent to the virtuous path of humility and good conduct. They were like *asuras* in their desire and caused impediments to the entire world. They destroyed the path of sacrifices and oppressed the world, making it suffer. In particular, there was no studying and no *vashatkara*.¹⁴⁹ As a result of the boon that had been obtained, Sagara’s sons were insolent and caused great destruction. They caused great agitation among *devas*, *asuras* and giant *uragas*. The earth does not move. However, oppressed by the sons of Sagara, it started to move. The *samadhi* of ascetics was disturbed.¹⁵⁰ Gods and ancestors were deprived of their *havya* and *kavya*.¹⁵¹ Overwhelmed by great misery, they went to Virinchi’s abode.¹⁵² With Sharva at the forefront, having gone there, in the proper way, they told him everything that Sagara’s sons had done. Hearing their words, Brahma, the grandfather of the worlds, thought them over in his mind for a while. The excellent divinity spoke. “O *devas*! O fortunate ones! Listen attentively to my words. There is no doubt that Sagara’s sons will be destroyed within a short period of time. Therefore, all of you should control yourselves and wait for some more time. Everything else is an instrument. Time alone is the lord. O excellent Gods! I will tell you what is beneficial for you. All of you should now act in accordance with what I say. The illustrious Kapila, supreme among victorious ones, has been born as part of Vishnu’s portion. The supreme Indra among *yogis* has

been born on earth to ensure the welfare of the world. For one hundred divine years, Agastya drank up the waters of the ocean. The invincible one is performing *dhyana* somewhere there, alone. Following my command, all of you should go to Kapila, bull among sages. Go and wait there, until his *dhyana* is over. When the lord withdraws from his *samadhi*, tell him everything. Prostrate yourselves and tell him. He will ensure what is best for you. Act so that the sage's *samadhi* is broken by Sagara's sons. O excellent Gods! Act to ensure that kind of conduct in them." Addressed in this way, the Gods prostrated themselves before the grandfather.'

'They went to the best of Gods. ¹⁵³ They joined their hands in salutation and spoke. *Devas* said, "O sage! Be pleased with us. We have sought refuge with you, the best among us. Sagara's sons are making the entire world suffer and are destroying it. Indeed, you are the cause behind the preservation and destruction of all the worlds. You are part of Vishnu's portion. In your own form of an Indra among *yogis*, you have established yourself on earth. Your objective is only to ensure the removal of affliction and the three types of torment faced by men. ¹⁵⁴ O supreme among ascetics! You have assumed this physical body as a result of your own will. Through your mental powers, you can create and destroy the entire universe. O *brahmana*! You are capable of preserving it too. There is no doubt about this. You are our Dhatri and Vidhatri. ¹⁵⁵ You are the *guru*. You are the refuge. You are our saviour. Please take away this calamity. O Indra among *brahmanas*! In particular, become the refuge of Indras among *brahmanas*. Sagara's sons are scorching the residents of the three worlds. O one excellent in vows! Therefore, those who are full of *sattva*, like you, should act to save us and the worlds. O illustrious one! Otherwise, the entire universe will be destroyed when it is not yet time." When all the *devas* said this, he opened his eyes slowly. Kapila looked at them and spoke these excellent words. "When the time arrives, as a result of their deeds, Sagara's sons will be burnt down and destroyed. You should wait for that. I will be the cause behind the destruction of those evil-souled ones. O best among Gods! I will do that to accomplish your objective. Sagara's sons, wicked in their minds, will be burnt down by the fire of my wrath. This will happen

within a short period. Time has robbed them of their intelligence. O *devas*! Hence, get rid of your fever. The worlds will be freed from fear. Evil in conduct, they will swiftly head towards destruction. Thus, without any fear, return to your respective cities. Wait for some more time and you will obtain what you wish for.” When Kapila said this, along with Vasava, all the *devas* prostrated themselves before him. Believing in the impending fire, they went to heaven.’

‘Meanwhile, Sagara, lord of the earth, made up his mind to perform the great sacrifice, that is, a horse sacrifice. Taking Vasishtha’s permission, he gathered all the necessary materials. With Ourva and other *brahmanas*, he properly consecrated himself. Having taken the *diksha*, ¹⁵⁶ the immensely illustrious king summoned all his sons and instructed them that the horse should be allowed to wander around. “Let the horse roam around everywhere on the surface of the earth. O sons! Then, you should quickly bring it back to my presence.” Instructed by their father in this way, all of them took the horse and made it circumambulate the entire surface of the earth. It was urged to wander around for the sake of accomplishing the required rite. This was not done for the sake of conquering the directions, or for the sake of exacting tribute. This was because the king had already conquered the entire earth. Goaded by his valour and because of what he had accomplished in the field of battle, kings had already offered him tribute. In this way, the king’s sons reached the salty ocean, where there was no water. Delighted, they surrounded the horse and made it enter inside the earth.’

Chapter 91-1(91) (Destruction of Sagara’s sons)

Jaimini said, ‘When they entered there, urged by Vasava, instantly, Vayu seized the horse and took it away to Rasatala. ¹⁵⁷ Invisible to all of them, the one who goes everywhere abducted the horse. O king! He conveyed it along this path and took it to the presence of the sage, Kapila. At the horse having vanished, all those princes were agitated. All of them circled the earth,

searching for the horse's trail. They searched the earth, with its cities, mountains and forests. Unable to see the sacrificial animal, they were overwhelmed by great grief. Surrounded by the *rishis*, they went back to Ayodhya. They saw their father, prostrated themselves, and told him everything that had happened. "We circled the earth and entered Varuna's abode. Though we were watching the horse and protecting it, someone abducted it." Thus addressed, the excellent king, full of rage, spoke to them. "O worst among those who follow *adharma*! ¹⁵⁸ All of you go and do not return here again. O evil-souled ones! While all of you were alive, how could it have been destroyed? You should not return here without the horse. This is the truth." At this, all of them assembled and as they left, spoke to each other. "The horse cannot be seen even now. What will we do? We have searched the earth, with its mountains, forests and groves. However, we could not see the horse and nothing has been heard about it anywhere. Therefore, let us go to the ocean and start to dig the ground, right up to Patala. In search of the horse, we will split the ground and dig down to Patala." All of Sagara's sons, cruel in resolution, made up their minds in this way. Starting with the shore of the ocean, in every direction, they started to dig up the ground. As they dug the earth up, she was greatly agitated and shrieked. On witnessing their activities, creatures also screamed. They dug up the part that was Bharata and flung it on the surface of the ground. For a distance of one thousand *yojanas*, the ground was connected all the way, up to the ocean.'

'They dug the earth down to the nether regions, all the way up to Patala. The sons of the king saw the horse, wandering around in Patala. All of them were delighted. They assembled and surrounded it from all sides. Content, some of them laughed. Others danced in their joy. They happened to see the great-souled Kapila, blazing in his energy. He was aged and seated in *padmasana*. ¹⁵⁹ His eyes were fixed on the tip of his nose. His head and neck were upright. His broad chest was projected forward. His energy filled all directions and illuminated everything all around him, like a lamp in a place without wind. He was full of every kind of *vijnana* and that inner radiance illuminated his body. His senses were immersed in *samadhi*. He

resembled an ocean where the waves had retreated. He was fixed in *yoga* in the appropriate way, and his mind was merged in the object of meditation. The supreme Indra among *yogis* resembled a serene fire, where the garland of flames had died down. On seeing him, they remained there, consulting each other. O king! But since they were full of great wickedness, this was only for a *muhurta*. Urged by destiny, they took him to the thief who had stolen the horse. Those evil-souled ones surrounded Kapila, the excellent sage. They surrounded him and said, “There is no doubt that this is the thief. This is the one who has stolen the horse. He is a reservoir of wickedness and deserves to be killed by us.” All of them lost their intelligence and behaved like ordinary people. Since their death was imminent, they easily assaulted the sage. The sage wasn’t distressed in his mind. However, he suffered because his *dhyana* had been broken. Kapila was overcome by great rage, and this agitated him. Oppressed by those evil-souled ones, the unassailable one moved. He was like the fire at the end of a *kalpa*, fanned by the wind and extending in size. The fire of rage emerged from his body, and it was like a fathomless ocean. It was like the *samkarshana* fire, ¹⁶⁰ which emerges from the nether regions, desiring to burn down the worlds. It dazzled and was ignited by the great intolerance and rage. When he opened his eyes, their radiance was like that of the solar disc. O king! In an instant, his eyes turned resplendent and extremely red. It was as if the sun and the moon had simultaneously risen in the morning sky. He glanced at the sons of the king with his rolling eyes. His glance was deep, like that of the Destroyer when the end of time is near. Flames of fire suddenly emerged from his angry eyes. Like the fire of destruction, this issued from his eyes and spread in every direction. There were dense columns of smoke, combined with repeated sparks of fire. The blazing fire that arose from the sage’s rage spread continuously in every direction. The flames that issued from his eyes resemble the fierce fire that emerges from the cavity inside a serpent’s stomach. The flames resembled the *vadava* fire, ¹⁶¹ blazing inside the turbulent ocean. O extremely great king! The blazing fire of rage spread and enveloped the directions. It touched the firmament and burnt all of them down. The whirling winds made a loud sound. The

rage made nets of fire and smoke circle around. Great clouds of dust arose and covered everything so that the world was greatly afflicted. The fire was struck by the force of the wind and seemed to etch the firmament with its touch. The flames from the fire of rage instantly burnt down all those sons, the enemies of Gods, on the ground, while all the worlds looked on. Only the horse was spared.’

‘All of Sagara’s sons, evil doers, were burnt down. This is what the fire of rage did to Sagara’s evil-minded sons. This was like dry trees being violently burnt by a blazing forest conflagration. Seeing the destruction of Sagara’s evil-souled sons, *devas* and *rishis* were amazed and spoke to each other. “How wonderful! Impure and fierce sinners do not last for a long time. Indeed, in this world, evil-souled men always come to a wicked end. They were like mountains in size, cruel and vile in intelligence. But like grass in fire, all of them came about a violent destruction, simultaneously. They agitated creatures and were greatly reprimanded by the virtuous, throughout their lives. It is good fortune that they have been killed and destroyed. Those who constantly harass others are abhorred by all the worlds. If a man commits inauspicious deeds in this world, how can he obtain happiness? They made all the creatures scream. Because of their deeds, they have now departed. The sinners have been killed by a *brahmana*’s staff. ¹⁶² They will now remain in hell for an eternal number of years. Therefore, learned men should always undertake auspicious deeds. Anything censured by the worlds must be cast far away. As long as a person is alive, if he knows, he must always strive to do what is beneficial. Since life is transient, one should never cause injury to anyone. The body is always temporary, and prosperity is fickle. There is no substance in *samsara*. ¹⁶³ How can a learned person place any trust in it?” The Gods and Indras among sages spoke to each other in this way. As a result of the sage’s anger, Sagara’s sons were like kindling and were destroyed. Their bodies were violently burnt down, and the ashes stupefied the earth. As a result of their own deeds, Sagara’s sons immediately descended into hell. The fire that arose from the rage burnt down all of Sagara’s sons. When it arose, it could have easily burnt down the worlds in an instant. Stationed in the

firmament, the *devas* were scared and terrified. Desiring that the fire of rage should be pacified, they praised the great-souled one.'

Chapter 92-1(92) (The horse is brought back)

Jaimini said, "O Indra among *brahmanas*! You should immediately restrain this fire of rage. Otherwise, though it is not yet time, all the worlds will be burnt down. Your greatness can be seen and it has pervaded everything, mobile and immobile. Please pardon us. Withdraw your rage. O bull among *brahmanas*! I prostrate myself before you." The illustrious sage, Kapila, was praised in this way. He swiftly withdrew the extremely terrible fire of rage. At this, everything in the universe, mobile and immobile, became tranquil. *Devas* and ascetics were rid of their fever.'

'O king! At this time, the illustrious sage, Narada, travelling as he willed, went from the world of the *devas* to Ayodhya. Sagara saw that Narada had arrived. Following the sacred texts, he worshipped him properly, with *arghya*, *padya* and other things. Accepting this worship, he seated himself on an excellent seat. Narada addressed the tiger among kings in these words. Narada said, "O excellent king! You sent your sons so that the horse could move around. They have been slain by a *brahmadanda* and all of them have been destroyed. O king! All of them were protecting the sacrificial horse. Without it being noticed by anyone, under the control of destiny, it was conveyed by someone to heaven. When the horse vanished, they searched for it on the surface of the earth. O king! For a long time, they did not get it. Nor did they get to know about it from anyone. Thereupon, they made up their minds to search under the earth. Starting with the ocean, they dug up the ground on earth. O king! They dug up the earth and saw the horse in Patala and the great sage, Kapila, Indra among *yogis*, near it. Seeing him, all those evil-doers were goaded by destiny. They said, "This is evidently the one who has stolen the horse," thereby enraging Kapila. The fire that arose from the rage in his eyes burnt down the directions. The bodies of your sons were like kindling and they headed

towards destruction. They were cruel and evil in conduct. They committed offences against all the worlds. O Indra among kings! Therefore, you should not grieve on their account. Resort to the wealth of your fortitude. This was destined to happen to you. Those who are dead and destroyed belong to the past. The learned do not grieve over them. This grandson of yours is a child. But Amshuman is extremely intelligent. O excellent king! Engage him to bring the horse back.” He spoke to the tiger among kings in this way, who was accompanied by the *sadasyas* and the *ritvijas*. Thereafter, while all of them looked on, the sage Narada vanished in an instant.’

‘Hearing Narada’s words, the excellent king was overcome by sorrow and grief. ¹⁶⁴ Pervasive in intelligence, he remained seated in that assembly hall for a long time, thinking, with his face cast downwards. Vasishtha, who knew about the time and the place, comforted the king and spoke to him. “For someone like you, full of the substance of fortitude, this is not the time to immerse yourself in the sorrow of your heart. Is this the fruit one obtains from fortitude? Give up this lassitude in your mind. For humans, everything is subjugated by destiny. Therefore, without any hesitation, you should do what needs to be done thereafter.” Vasishtha spoke in this way to the king, who knew about the true meaning of tasks. He resorted to his fortitude and spirit and replied in words of assent. He summoned his grandson, Amshuman, who was full of humility. In that assembly of *brahmanas* and *kshatriyas*, he slowly addressed him in these words. “O son! All your fathers ¹⁶⁵ have been slain by a *brahmadanda*. Because of their evil deeds, they have descended into hell and will remain there for an eternal number of years. You are my descendant now, and this kingdom will be protected by you. All my welfare, in this world and in the next one, will be obtained through you. Follow my instructions. Go to Patala, to Kapila’s presence. Make great efforts to bring back the horse. Beseech him in the proper way. Make special efforts to placate him. O child! You should obtain the horse and return quickly.” Addressed in this way, Amshuman prostrated himself before his father’s father. The immensely intelligent one agreed to this.’

‘He left and went to Kapila’s presence. Having reached, he followed the norms and other ways that occurred to his mind and prostrated himself before him. Bent in humility, he slowly spoke to him in these words. “O tiger among *brahmanas*! Be pleased. I seek refuge with you. Please restrain your rage quickly. It destroys the worlds. When you are angry, the entire universe faces destruction. Please become serene quickly, so that the worlds are well and lose their pain. O immensely fortunate one! Be pleased and glance at me with amiable eyes. Know that I am the descendant of the ones who were burnt down by the fire of your rage. My name is Sagara ¹⁶⁶ and I am the grandson of Sagara, the lord of the earth. With a desire to obtain your favours, I have been engaged by him. O *brahmana*! If you give me the horse, I will take it back.” Hearing these words, the sage, supreme among Indras among *yogis*, looked at Amshuman. Pleased, he spoke these words. “O child! Welcome. It is good fortune that you have come here. Take the horse, leave swiftly, and go to Sagara’s presence. His sacrifice has been disturbed and it must first be completed. Please ask for a boon from me, anything that is there in your mind. I am satisfied with your devotion, and I will grant it, even if it is extremely difficult to obtain. Go and tell your grandfather that he should not grieve over the death and destruction of those sinners.” Amshuman prostrated himself before the Indra among *yogis* and replied in these words. “O great sage! Please grant me the boon I seek from you. If I truly deserve a boon, you should be pleased and grant me this boon. As a result of your rage, all my fathers have been scorched. O *brahmana*! They have gone to hell and will remain there for an eternal number of years. Since they have been slain by a *brahmadanda*, water rites have not been performed and they have not been offered *pindas*. O great sage! In this world, if a person is deprived of water-rites and *pindas*, he does not obtain the world of the ancestors. Indeed, that is what the *shruti* texts say. They can obtain an imperishable residence in heaven only through your favours. O illustrious one! If I am granted this boon, I will have accomplished my objective. Therefore, be pleased and tell me about the means through which they can go to heaven. How can they be saved from the fire of your rage?” At this, with an extremely pleased mind, the Indra

among *yogis* spoke to him. “O child! You are incapable of saving them from hell. As a consequence of their evil deeds, they must reside in hell. They must wait for the time until a grandson is born to them. O child! After the progress of time, you will have an immensely intelligent grandson. His name will be King Bhagiratha and he will know the true meaning of every kind of *dharma* and *artha*. To regain the honour of his ancestors, he will make great efforts. Having tormented himself through great austerities, he brought down Ganga from heaven. Those waters will purify the ashes and bones from their bodies. All your ancestors will then obtain a destination in heaven. O son of a king! Such is the greatness of Ganga, which will thereafter be famous in the world as Bhagirathi. If the ashes, bones, body hair and nails of any embodied being are flooded by her waters, he obtains an imperishable state in heaven. O fortunate one! Therefore, leave. You should not grieve. Take this horse and return it to your grandfather.” The immensely intelligent one agreed to this and prostrated himself devoutly. Taking his permission, he left for the city of Saketa. He reached Sagara and prostrated himself in the proper way. He narrated everything, about himself and the sage. He gave him the horse, which had been brought back carefully. He asked, “What will I do for you after this?”

Chapter 93-1(93) (Amshuman obtains the kingdom)

Jaimini said, ‘At this, Sagara was overwhelmed by love and embraced his grandson. He congratulated him and uttered his blessings. He showed his love and praised him. After this, with *ritvijas*, *sadasyas* and those accomplished in the *Vedas*, the excellent king observed the indicated norms and started the sacrifice. Possessing the prosperity of all the qualities, the sacrifice commenced. Ourva, Vasishtha and the other sages ensured that it was conducted properly. The sacrificial altar was made out of gold and there were superior and inferior vessels. Everything about that sacrifice was full of prosperity, conducted in accordance with the sacred texts. In this way, all the *ritvijas* performed the sacrifice in the due order, placing the

yajamana ¹⁶⁷ in the front. When the sacrifice was duly completed, the king, supreme among learned-ones, gave the *ritvijas* the appropriate *dakshina*. The *ritvijas*, *sadasyas*, *brahmanas* and those who desired wealth were all given an excessive quantity of wealth. In this way, *brahmanas* and others were satisfied in the proper order with *dakshina*. He prostrated himself before *gurus* and *sadasyas* and sought forgiveness. ¹⁶⁸ With *brahmanas* and other *varnas*, *ritvijas*, courtesans, multitudes, *sutas*, *magadhas* and *bandis*, he followed the sacred texts and in the proper way, went to the banks of Sarayu. He was followed by the women. A white umbrella was held aloft on his head. He was fanned with whisks made out of yak hair. There were the sounds of many kinds of musical instruments, and this deafened the directions. He was delighted and along with his relatives, completed the *avabhritha* bath. Having bathed, along with his wife, well-wishers and *brahmanas*, he entered the beautiful city, full of happy and well-nourished residents. There were the sounds of *veenas*, flutes, drums and many kinds of musical instruments. The *brahmanas* who were with him chanted from the *Vedas* and uttered auspicious benedictions. In every direction, he was praised by *sutas*, *magadhas* and *bandis*. The city was garlanded with white fans, sparking umbrellas, flags and banners. The ground was cleaned and sprinkled with water. The shops were decorated. With its rows of mansions, it sparkled and was as radiant as Mount Kailasa. The delightful fragrance of aloe and incense arose in every direction. The women residents joyously and repeatedly showered parched grain in front of him, from every direction. The happy residents looked on. Large numbers of traders came there, bearing many kinds of gifts. Honoured by them, he slowly proceeded towards his city. He entered his beautiful residence, decorated with every kind of ornament. Well-wishers and *brahmanas* honoured him in the proper way. He was served by kings, the lords of many lands. Like another Shakra, the tiger among kings sported, along with his wife. In this way, along with his well-wishers, his desires were fulfilled. Sagara, the supreme and excellent king, sported with his two wives. ¹⁶⁹ His grandson, Amshuman, was full of humility. Taking Vasishtha's permission, the king instated him as the heir apparent. Because of his great generosity and extensive qualities,

this king ¹⁷⁰ was loved by citizens of the city and countryside, relatives and well-wishers. Though he was still a child, the subjects were delighted with the immensely energetic one. Amshuman resembled the one with the cool beams, ¹⁷¹ newly arisen at the beginning of *shukla paksha*. Along with this prosperous one and his well-wishers, the excellent king ¹⁷² lived for a long time. He sported with his two wives, who were his equals in every respect. As if he was still young, the tiger among kings protected the earth, with its mountains, forests and groves. He was like another Dharma. Such was the greatness of the lord of North Kosala. He was like a crest jewel in the *surya vamsha* lineage. Like the full moon, he caused delight to all the worlds. He filled everyone, along with the subjects, with joy.’

Chapter 94-1(94) (Descent of Ganga)

Jaimini said, ‘Everything about the conduct of the great-souled Sagara has been described, briefly and in detail. It destroys sins. This land, named Bharata, extends from the south to the north. Its circumference measures nine thousand *yojanas*. When the sons of the Indra among men searched for the horse, they dug up one thousand *yojanas*. Eight thousand *yojanas* were thrown down. ¹⁷³ Sagara’s sons dug up and expanded the abode of *makaras*. Since then, it has obtained the name of Saagara in the worlds. ¹⁷⁴ The ocean flung its waters and covered the earth, with its *tirthas*, *kshetras* and forests, extending up to Brahmapada. ¹⁷⁵ The abodes of all *devas*, *asuras* and humans were scattered here and there and they were filled with great sorrow. There is a *kshetra* famous under the name of Gokarna. It is worshipped by all the Gods. It is on the shores of the western ocean and extends for one and a half *yojanas*. There are innumerable *tirthas* there, abodes of sages and *devas*. O king! Earlier, large numbers of *siddhas* resided in that *kshetra*. It is an auspicious *kshetra*, famous in the worlds. It destroys every kind of sin. The area of this *tirtha* is on the south-western part of the ocean. All the sages, firm in their vows, tormented themselves through austerities there. They obtained supreme *nirvana*, ¹⁷⁶ a state from

which there is no return. As a result of the power of that *kshetra*, Shankara is pleased. ¹⁷⁷ Along with Devi, he always resides there, accompanied by all the *devas* and large numbers of *bhutas*. As instructed, if men go on a journey to that *tirtha*, like a dry leaf in a strong wind, their sins are swiftly destroyed. Evil-souled men never obtain a desire to serve that *kshetra* or reside near it. O king! It is only through great good merits that a desire to go that *kshetra* is generated in men, never otherwise. O king! Living beings, mobile and immobile, are bound. If they die there, they instantly obtain an eternal abode in heaven. Even if a man remembers it, he is freed from all sins. This is a supreme *kshetra* among all the *kshetras* and all the *tirthas* reside there. Some sages reside there, desiring *siddhi*. They bathe in the *tirthas* and worship Sadashiva. They are free of desire and anger and are devoid of jealousy. Residing there, within a short period, they attain *siddhi*. There are those who reside there, engaged in *japa* and oblations. They are serene and controlled, following *brahmacharya*. They also obtain the desired *siddhi*. O king! The fruits obtained from donations, oblations, *japa*, worshipping ancestors, *devas* and *dvijas* and other rites performed here, have one crore times the fruits obtained if these are performed anywhere else. It is an extremely purifying *kshetra* and it got submerged in the waters of the ocean. Sages, engaged in great austerities, resided there. Searching for a residence, they ascended Sahya, the best among mountains. All of them lived there and consulted each other. They got ready to go to Rama, who was performing austerities on Mount Mahendra.'

The king said, 'Agastya drank up the waters of the ocean. The king's sons dug all around and that *kshetra*, along with other parts of the earth, with *tirthas*, hermitages, forests, cities, villages, mines and other things, fell. All the regions along the shores of the ocean were destroyed. O best among sages! What did the people who resided there do? Amidst hardships, did they continue to reside there? Or did they go elsewhere? After what period was the ocean filled with water again? Through what means did this happen? O *brahmana*! Please tell me that'

Jaimini answered, 'Those evil-souled ones destroyed the regions near the water. ¹⁷⁸ All the people with residences there left and went here and there.

Amidst those hardships, some continued to reside in that *kshetra*. O king! Meanwhile, Amshuman had a son. He had *dharma* in his soul and was famous on earth under the name of Dilipa. King Amshuman had enjoyed objects of pleasure completely and instated him in the kingdom. The intelligent one left for the forest, having made up his mind to perform austerities. The prosperous Dilipa followed *dharma* and ruled over the entire earth. He defeated all the enemies. His son, named Bhagiratha, became famous in the worlds. He was accomplished in every kind of *dharma* and *artha*. He was handsome and infinite in valour. King Dilipa instated him in the kingdom and left for the forest. He ruled over the earth, bereft of thorns, properly. He delighted himself with many kinds of objects of pleasure, like the lord of *devas* in heaven. The lord of the earth heard what had happened to his forefathers earlier. As a consequence of the rage engendered in a *brahmana*, they had descended into a terrible hell. All his ancestors had been slain by a *brahmadanda*. Hearing this, he was extremely miserable. He became supremely indifferent towards the kingdom, relatives and objects of pleasure. He entrusted the kingdom to an excellent minister and left for the forest, to perform austerities. The excellent king wished to convey his ancestors to the vault of heaven. To obtain a long lifespan, he first worshipped the one who originated from a lotus ¹⁷⁹ through great austerities. Thus, he obtained a lifespan for as long as he wished. O great king! After this, he worshipped Ganga and pleased her. He asked for the boon that she would leave heaven and come to earth. So that he might hold her in his hand, he performed austerities and worshipped Shiva.

Affectionate towards his devotees, he too granted him that boon. As Ganga descended from the summit of Meru, along with crocodiles, alligators and *makaras*, ¹⁸⁰ the lord of the world received her on his head. The one who flows with great force reached his head and was dissolved in the extremely deep and auspicious cavity of his mass of matted hair. The water vanished in the braids of hair on Lord Shambhu's head. Seeing this, wishing to free her, he worshipped Hara again. Through Sharva's favours, he got her back, and she arrived on earth. He led her towards the direction where Sagara's sons had been burnt down. Following the king, along the path, she flooded,

all around, the sacrificial arena of a *rajarshi* who was performing a sacrifice. When the entire sacrificial arena was submerged, the *rajarshi* became angry. O child! As if it was but a handful, he drank up all the water. The great-souled one served him attentively for one hundred years. When he was pleased, the king got Ganga back. After having remained in his stomach for a long period, she emerged. Therefore, she became famous on earth under the name of Jahnavi. ¹⁸¹ The celestial river followed Bhagiratha and sprinkled the bones and ashes of all his ancestors with her water. As soon as the bones and ashes were sprinkled with this water, the sins of all of Sagara's sons were destroyed. They left hell and went to heaven. In this way, the great river conveyed the sons of Sagara to heaven. Following that same path, she swiftly reached the eastern ocean. She divided herself into four from Meru's summit and flowed in four different directions. As a result of these four divisions, she assumed four names—Sita, Alakananda, Suchakshu and Bhadravati. ¹⁸² When Agastya drank up the waters, these became dry, lacking in water, for a long period of time. Ganga's waters filled these four up with water again. When Sagara's sons extended the ocean, the ocean filled everything up. In every direction, many countries and *kshetras* that were along the shores of the ocean disappeared. O king! The people who had abodes there left, here and there. Earlier, I have spoken to you about the *kshetra* of Gokarna. Since it was near the ocean, it was also submerged. All those who resided there desired that it should be raised again. O king! Desiring to see the tiger of the Bhrigu lineage, they left Mount Sahya.'

Chapter 95-1(95) (Varuna visits Bhargava)

Jaimini said, ‘Shushka, Sumitra and other sages, rigid in their vows, went towards Mount Mahendra, desiring to see Rama. They passed over many countries, forests and rivers. In due order, those bulls among sages reached that excellent mountain. They ascended slowly and reached the circle of the famous hermitage. All the cruel beings were tranquil there. There was an auspicious hermitage in the centre. It was beautiful, with flowers and fruits from all the seasons and excellent groves of trees. The gentle shade was without parallel. The breeze that blew was delightful and pleasant. They reached the hermitage, which echoed with sounds of the *brahman*. Delighted in their minds, they entered. As is proper, the aged were in front. The stores of austerities saw him, seated in *brahmasana* ¹⁸³ on a soft skin, made out of the hide of a black antelope. He was serene and surrounded by *shishyas*. He resembled the fire of destruction. Having burnt down the three worlds earlier, of his own will, like an embodied being, he was engaged in austerities, to pacify the taint. With their conduct reflecting their humble behaviour, they approached the best one of the Bhrigu lineage. Lowering their shoulders in devotion, they worshipped the one who was observing a great vow of silence. The extender of the Bhrigu lineage saw that the sages had arrived. Affectionately, he honoured them properly, with *arghya*, *padya* and other things. The *rishis* who had come from other countries were offered hospitality. When they were seated, the tiger of the Bhrigu lineage smiled and spoke to them. “O immensely fortunate ones who have come here! All of you are welcome. Without any hesitation, please state what I can do for you.” At this, the sages prostrated themselves before Rama and spoke. “O best among sages! We are sages who had residences in Gokarna. For some reason, the sons of Sagara dug up the ground. Consequently, that *tirtha* and great *kshetra* got submerged in the waters of the ocean. That *kshetra* purifies everything. There is no doubt about our wish for you. You should withdraw the waters of the ocean and give it back to us. Indeed, you

have been born in Bhrigu's lineage as Vishnu's portion. There is nothing in the three worlds that you are incapable of doing. We have heard that, in this world, you alone are the one who can grant us the desired objective. O Rama! That is the reason all of us have come here. O Indra among *brahmanas*! Use your powers to make the waters of the ocean recede and give that excellent *kshetra* back." Rama replied, "O stores of austerities! I know everything about all this. I should certainly carry out this task for you. There is no need to think about it. But in this world, your desired task will be extremely terrible. I can only perform it if I take up weapons, not otherwise. However, I have granted everyone freedom from fear and have cast aside my weapons. I am full of peace. As a result of my father's earlier command, I have resorted to performing austerities. O unblemished ones! Amid an assembly of the virtuous, I took a pledge earlier, 'I will not take up weapons. I will practice austerities.' What you desire can only be accomplished by taking up weapons. What should be done? My mind is vacillating because of this." Shushka said, "If weapons are taken up for the sake of protecting the virtuous, there is no deviation from the truth. In earlier times, Brahma said this. Hence, for the sake of our welfare, you should take up weapons. If you do this, you will perform a great act of *dharma*." The sages entreated the bull of the Bhrigu lineage in this way. The intelligent one agreed, only because this was in conformity with *dharma*.'

'With all of them, the best among sages headed in a south-western direction. O king! He went there because he wanted to see the lord of rivers. ¹⁸⁴ The extender of the Bhrigu lineage descended from Sahya, the excellent mountain. ¹⁸⁵ Thereafter, the great-minded one reached the shores of the lord of rivers. The immensely fortunate one saw that it was all around him, agitated by the wind. It was a reservoir of jewels and was constantly filled with water. It was impossible to fathom its depth, like the minds of those who are great. No one was capable of crossing it and it was full of many kinds of *grahas*. In this world, it was like Dhatri and it was impossible to assail it. It was immersed in itself alone and had arisen, casting everything else aside. It was the refuge of all kinds of creatures and the king of all those who lived in the water. There were garlands of hundreds of lofty and

turbulent waves. As these struck against the rocks on the shore, they raised a mist. The waves broke into hundreds of fragments, raising torrents of foam. Along with the large number of sages, he saw the ocean, roaring deeply. It was as if he was being served by the cool spray from the waves. O Indra among kings! For some time, the mighty-armed one rested on the shores of the lord of major and minor rivers. He desired to see Prachetas.'

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'After this, Rama stood up and faced the southern direction. In a voice that was as deep as the rumble of the clouds, he addressed Varuna in these words. "Along with the large number of sages, I have come here to see you. O Prachetas! Therefore, assume your own form and show yourself to me." O king! Hearing these words, Varuna, lord of aquatic creatures, did not move from his position but became even more strong-minded. Rama repeatedly summoned the lord of waters. However, he did not reply or approach, or show himself. Though these words should not have been transgressed, Varuna paid no attention to them. Knowing that the person was in urgent need of some task, he ignored this. Rama, supreme among the wielders of weapons, thought that his words had been ignored by Prachetas. Full of rage, he glanced at him. Using his strength, he assumed the form of a turbulent ocean and extremely angry, wished to rob the ocean of waters. He touched water. In his mind, he prostrated himself before Sharva, whose great bow, Vijaya, was near him. His eyes red with rage, he picked up that excellent bow. The excellent Bhargava strung it. While all the beings looked on, he twanged on the bowstring. The extremely harsh sound of the bowstring twanging touched heaven and could be heard there. The earth, with all its seven *dvipas* and oceans, moved. With great force, Rama affixed an excellent arrow, feathered and gold-tufted and resembling the fire of destruction, to the bow. That weapon was extremely terrible, and Bhargava united with the divinity of fire. Using *mantras*, the tiger of the Bhrigu lineage got ready to release it. At this, the earth, with its mountains, forests and groves, moved. Devas, *asuras* and giant *uragas* were filled with great agitation. His eyes red with rage, the excellent Bhargava affixed the weapon. On seeing this, all mobile and immobile entities were terrified in

their minds. The directions blazed and were covered with layers of brown clouds. Making loud sounds, harsh winds blew, pervading everything with dust. The moon's cool beams were dimmed, and the solar disc became red. Meteors descended and there was lightning. There were showers of water mixed with blood. There were terrible emissions of smoke. Scared, people asked, "What is this?" Having affixed the divine weapon, he drew the great arrow back. As the bowstring was drawn back, the tip of the arrow blazed and threw off sparks. The sages saw Rama, resembling the fire that comes at the end of a *kalpa*. He stood there, with the bowstring drawn back up to his ears, in the form of a circle. It was impossible to look at his extremely fearful body. As he drew the bowstring back, his form was like that of the fierce sun that has arisen at the end of a *kalpa*, with a disc all around it. His body quivered, like the terrible blaze of the fire that comes at the end of a *kalpa*. In the midst of that circle, he seemed to be like Hari with his *chakra*. He quivered in the blazing fire of his rage and everything around him was extremely terrible. He seemed to assume the form of Vishnu as Narasimha.

¹⁸⁷ As he drew the bowstring back, his forehead was furrowed and Rama's body was like that of Bhava, when he wished to burn down Tripura in earlier times. They saw that blazing human form and were suddenly filled with fear. All the sages praised him, "O Rama! Be pleased. Victory to you." There were gusts of brown smoke and sparks from the fire in the weapon. Everything in the inner quarters of the lord of the waters was covered and fragmented. The flaming fire of the weapon blazed in every direction and struck. The mass of torrents of water was agitated and over-flowed. All creatures which resided in the ocean, *timingilas*, ¹⁸⁸ *timis*, *grahas*, *nakras*, serpents and tortoises were filled with great affliction. As the waves were raised, many creatures leapt up, fell and were tossed around. The waters were suddenly agitated, with great violence. As the extensive waters flooded everything, creatures were terrified. Those who roamed around in the water were agitated and severely scorched. The blaze from the arrow smothered and dissipated everything. It was clearly evident that this spread in all directions. Terrible winds circulated in every direction. Since there was the blaze of the fire, it seemed as if everything was covered by a red

canopy. The waters were greatly agitated by the fire of the weapon and the ocean resembled the one at the time of dissolution. Extending beyond the ocean, the waves approached the shores. As a result of the fire of the weapon, the water was struck and agitated, roaring loudly. The ocean, full of water, deafened the directions. The agitated water was surrounded from every direction by the blazing fire of the weapon. Full of great affliction, it seemed to seek refuge in Sahya.'

'The store of water saw Rama, with the bowstring drawn all the way back up to his ear. Like a sinner who sees Yama, he was filled with great dejection. All the limbs of the lord of major and minor rivers trembled in fear. He abandoned his natural fortitude and was filled with cowardice. Hence, he assumed his own form, adorned with all the ornaments. Varuna was seen, climbing up from his own store of water. With his hands generally joined in salutation, Prachetas approached Bhargava. He approached swiftly and quickly as if he was terrified of the arrow. As he stood there, with the bow drawn back, he prostrated himself at his lotus feet. The *aksharas* faltered because of his fear; he spoke in an extremely scared voice. "O tiger of the Bhrigu lineage! Please show pity and save me. I have sought refuge with you. O Rama! In my ignorance, I committed a crime. I am standing here, awaiting your command. What will I do?"'

Chapter 96-1(96) (Land reclaimed from the ocean)

Jaimini said, 'Saying this, Varuna fell on the ground at his feet. The intelligent extender of the Bhrigu lineage looked at him and withdrew his weapon. Varuna was standing in front of him. Having withdrawn the weapon, Rama looked at him. His anger was gone and as he spoke, he seemed to smile. "These bulls among sages had their residences in Gokarna. O lord of rivers! Earlier, when I dwelt on Mount Mahendra, they came to me. Formerly, when the sons of Sagara dug, the earth fell into the water. The *kshetra* of Gokarna, frequented by *rishis*, also fell, below. They wanted to regain the *kshetra*, loved by Bhava. That is the reason the sages, residents

of the *tirtha*, came to me. It is for that reason that I left the excellent Mount Mahendra and came here to see you, along with the bulls among sages. It is for that reason that you should yourself withdraw the waters. Let the waters be as they were earlier. You should give them back that *kshetra*.” Hearing his words, Varuna, lord of aquatic creatures, thought about it in his mind. He addressed Rama in these words. Varuna replied, “No one is capable of withdrawing my waters. That is the boon Virinchi had given to me earlier. Also, because of your energy, I have given up my natural fortitude. O Bhargava! I am suffering and have come under your control. O destroyer of the lineage of *kshatriyas*! How can I possibly not undertake the task? Therefore, I will withdraw the waters from that much of land, which you think of in your mind.” Hearing his words, Bhargava agreed. He cast aside the arrow and broke his bow. O lord of the earth! He wished to determine and show the extent of the ground. The intelligent one picked up a sacrificial ladle, intending to fling it into the store of water. Rama was pleased in his mind and there was no longer any rage in his heart. When the lord of rivers vanished, Rama stood there, facing the north. With great force, he whirled the sacrificial ladle and hurled it into the salty ocean. It was flung into the ocean in a north-western direction. O king! The sacrificial ladle travelled a distance of two hundred *yojanas* and fell. This is the *tirtha* named Shurparaka. It frees from every kind of sin. ¹⁸⁹ It is on the shores of the lord of major and minor rivers and is famous in the three worlds. When the sacrificial ladle fell from Rama’s hand, it created the *tirtha* within that place. O great king! It is indicative of his valour. O lord of the earth! The land that was created and established through this process is the *tirtha* of Shurparaka. It is glorious and famous in the worlds. The ocean withdrew its waters up to that place. O king! When the waters withdrew, he gave that land to Rama. The extender of the Bhrigu lineage never violated an agreement. At the time, he also made the ocean abide by the agreement, of permitting that expanse of land. He knew that the waters had withdrawn from the eastern part of the land. ¹⁹⁰ Witnessing Rama’s valour, all the Gods were amazed. When the waters of the ocean receded from Sahya, here and there, there were some traces of the boundaries of cities and villages, ones

that had existed earlier. He saw that these had remained in those lower levels, by chance. Full of affection, the best of the Bhrigu lineage gave these desired spots to the sages who had cleansed their *atmans*. At this, all the sages were filled with great delight. Extremely successful in their objective, they worshipped Rama and uttered their benedictions. Since they had attained their wishes, he took their leave and departed.'

'Rama, the excellent sage, left that region and returned to his hermitage. All the sages went to the shore of the ocean again. With great care, they circumambulated the ground. O king! They saw that the land was located there, with the ocean all around it. This was a place where all the *devas* were always established. When the digging took place, it fell into the ocean and remained there for a long time. Nevertheless, when the water had gone, it was generally left unharmed. This happened because of Rudra's powers. When the water withdrew, the *kshetra* became as it used to be earlier. O excellent king! Such are the divinity's unthinkable powers. In this way, Rama got it back from the ocean and recreated the land. O king! From the south to the north, the expanse was four hundred *yojanas*. Even today, the store of waters does not cross that boundary. Rama did this and did not string his giant bow again. Such were the powers of Rama and King Sagara, whose sons caused this region of Bharata to fall into the ocean. Thereby, the great ocean extended by one thousand *yojanas*. Rama again created this, by a measure of six hundred *yojanas*.¹⁹¹ Sagara's sons extended the expanse of the abode of *makaras*. Since then, it obtained the name of Saagara in the worlds. I have thus properly recounted the conduct of great ones, Rama, Kartavirya and King Sagara, to you.'

Chapter 97-1(97) (Origin of Vaivasvata)

Brihaspati said, 'The *rishis* who were told this were filled with great delight. Thereafter, desiring to hear more, they asked.'

The *rishis* said, 'In the due order, please tell us about the lineages of the infinitely energetic kings, their duration and their powers. We are asking

you.’

‘Lomaharshana was asked by them in this way. Accomplished in the accounts and skilled in the use of words, he made the *rishis* hear the subsequent accounts. He addressed them again in these words.’

Lomaharshana said, ‘I will tell you what the *rishi* ¹⁹² told me earlier. Listen. In the due order, hear from me about the lineages of the infinitely energetic kings, their duration and their powers. Hear the due order from me. Varuna’s wife is said to have been the *devi* Stutaa. ¹⁹³ Stutaa was a beautiful celestial lady, and her two sons were Kali and Vaidya. Kali’s two sons were the immensely valiant Jaya and Vijaya. Vaidya’s two sons were the extremely strong Ghrini and Muni. They devoured those who were given to them in marriage and devoured anyone who desired them. They devoured each other and came about their destruction in this way. Kali is known as the son of Suraa. ¹⁹⁴ His son is said to have been Mada. Himsa, described as wicked, is said to have been Kali’s senior wife. Kali had four other sons who fed on humans. They were Naka, the famous Vighna, Bhadrana and Vidhama. Vighna possessed one head and Naka had no body. Bhadrana possessed only one hand. Vidhama is said to have had one foot. Bhadrana’s wives were Tamasi and Putanaa. Through Revati, Vidhama had one thousand sons. Naka’s wife was Shakuni and Vighna’s wife was Ayomukhi. Those immensely valiant *rakshasas* roamed around at the time of the two *sandhyas*. ¹⁹⁵ The sons of Revati and Putana are said to have had the name Nairritas. All these *rakshasas* seize, especially children. With the permission of Lord Brahma, Skanda is their lord. Brihaspati’s sister was Varastri and she was a *brahmacharini*. ¹⁹⁶ She obtained *siddhi* in *yoga* and wandered around the entire universe, always remaining unattached. Later, she became the wife of Prabhasa, the eighth Vasu. Prajapati Vishvakarma, the lord of artisans, was her son. Tvashta, pervasive in intelligence and radiant in form, was Dharma’s grandson. ¹⁹⁷ Using his powers of *yoga*, he created thousands of works of craftsmanship for the Gods. He also constructed all the *vimanas* for *devas*. Humans subsist on that great-souled one’s artisanship. Prahlada’s daughter, famous as Virochanaa, was Tvashta’s wife. She was Virochana’s sister and the mother of Trishira. The great and

intelligent Vishvarupa ¹⁹⁸ was the *acharya* for *devas*. Vishvakarma's son was Maya, also described as Vishvakarma. ¹⁹⁹ His younger sister was the famous Surenu. Tvashta's daughter, known as Samjna, was the wife of Savitar. ²⁰⁰ She gave birth to the immensely fortunate Manu, Vivasvat's eldest son. She later gave birth to twins, Yama and Yami. Assuming the form of a mare, the *devi* went to the region of Kuru. Savitar also assumed the form of a horse. O immensely fortunate one! Through the nose, in the air, she gave birth to the two Ashvins, Nasatya and Dasra. These two were the sons of Martanda.'

The *rishis* asked, 'Why do learned-ones speak of Vivasvat as Martanda? Why did the beautiful lady give birth through her nostrils? We wish to know this. Please tell us everything that we have asked.'

Suta answered, 'For a long time after it was produced, the egg did not break. ²⁰¹ Tvashta broke it. Bewildered at the foetus having been killed, Kashyapa fled. Tvashta looked at the two pieces of the broken egg and spoke. "O unblemished one! There is nothing lacking in this egg. Become Martanda." The father affectionately remarked, "Indeed, he is not dead inside the egg." Hearing his words, that name was given to him. When the egg was divided into two, inside the egg, he was asked to become Martanda. ²⁰² Hence, those who know about the Puranas think of Vivasvat as Martanda. After this, I will speak about the offspring of Vivasvat Martanda. It should be known that Samjna, Savitar's wife, had three children—Manu, Yama and Yami. Chhaya's children were Tapati and Shanaishchara. These are described as Martanda's offspring. The immensely illustrious Vivasvat was born as the son of Kashyapa and Daksha's daughter. ²⁰³ *Devi* Samjna, Tvashta's daughter, became Vivasvat's wife. She was known as Surenu and later became famous as Samjna. She became the wife of the illustrious Martanda, who was infinite in his energy. In his affection, Kashyapa ignorantly said, "Indeed, the egg is not yet dead." ²⁰⁴ That is the reason he is known as Martanda. Vivasvat's energy was always excessive. Using that, Kashyapa's son scorched the three worlds. Through Samjna, Ravi ²⁰⁵ had three children. It is known that two were immensely valiant sons and the other was a daughter. The eldest was

Vaivasvata Manu. The twins, Yama and Yami, were born and Yama became Prajapati Shraddhadeva. Samjna saw Vivasvat's form, consisting of intolerable energy. Unable to bear this, from her own shadow, she created Savarnaa.²⁰⁶ The immensely fortunate lady, Chhaya, originated. She joined her hands in salutation and addressed Samjna. "Please tell me. What is my task?" Samjna replied, "O fortunate one! I am leaving for my own father's residence. Without any fear, you reside here, in my house. These two sons are mine. There is also the daughter, beautiful in complexion. O illustrious one! You should rear them as if they are your own." She said, "These two sons are like mine own." As if ashamed, the spirited one went to Tvashta's presence. On seeing Samjna arrive, her angry father told her, "Go to your husband's presence." He urged her repeatedly. Therefore, the unblemished one assumed the form of a mare and concealed her form. She went to the Uttara Kuru region and roamed around in the grassland there.'

'Thinking that the second Samjna was the real Samjna, Aditya²⁰⁷ had two immensely energetic sons through her. These two lords were equal to their elder brother Manu. Of these two, Shrutashrava will become Savarni Manu. Shrutakarma is known as the planet Shanaishchara.²⁰⁸ The one who will become Manu is also spoken of as Savarni. Samjna behaved like an ordinary person from earth and loved her sons more than the elder offspring. Manu forgave all this, but Yama did not. Extremely miserable, he muttered about this co-wife. In his childhood rage and because of the force of destiny, Vaivasvata Yama censured Chhaya back.²⁰⁹ Angry, Savarn's mother cursed Yama. "You suddenly censured your father's illustrious wife. Therefore, there is no doubt that your foot will fall down." As a result of this curse, Yama suffered a lot mentally. Along with Manu, he went and told his father, who had *dharma* in his soul, everything. "I have been vanquished by Samjna's words and am anxious because of the terrible curse. I did raise my foot towards her, but did not actually bring it down on her body. Whether it was because of childishness or delusion, you should pardon this. O lord of the worlds! O supreme among those who scorch! I have been cursed by my mother. Through your favours, I should be saved from this great fear." The lord Vivasvat replied to Yama. "O son! There must be some

great reason behind this. You know about *dharma* and are truthful in your speech. Nevertheless, you succumbed to rage. I am incapable of rendering your mother's words false. Worms will seize your flesh and enter the ground. O immensely wise one! But you will get your foot back and be happy. In this way, your mother's words will come true, but you will also be saved from the effects of the curse." Aditya asked Samjna, "All the sons are equal. Why do you exhibit more love for one over the other?" She avoided the query and did not reply to Vivasvat. He immersed himself in *yoga* and perceived the truth. The illustrious lord became angry and got ready to curse and destroy her. At this, she told Vivasvat the truth about everything.'

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'Hearing this, Vivasvat was enraged and went to Tvashta. Following the norms, Tvashta worshipped Vibhvasu, ²¹¹ who was about to burn him down in his rage. He pacified him gently. "Your form possesses excessive energy, and your beauty is impaired. Unable to tolerate it, Samjna is wandering around in a forest with grassy plains. You will see your wife, auspicious in conduct, there today. Her youth is praiseworthy. O lord of the rays! I think it will be favourable if you adhere to an agreement. O scorcher of enemies! I will transform your appearance, which you have had since the beginning, and make it better. O Vivasvat! Your form is such that your energy spreads upwards, downwards and sideways. O lord of the firmament! The *devi* has suffered because of this form. I will place you on my wheel and give you an excellent form." Having obtained his permission, Tvashta altered his form. This is what Tvashta did to Martanda Vivasvat. He placed him on his whirling wheel and pared off his energy. Some of the excess energy was taken away. The energy was removed. Prabhakara ²¹² became handsome, auspicious to behold.'

'Resorting to *yoga*, he saw his own wife, in the form of a mare. As a result of her energy and vows, she was invisible to all beings. In the form of a horse, Martanda approached her towards her mouth, intent on physical intercourse. ²¹³ Taking him to be someone else's husband, she expelled Vivasvat's semen through her nostrils. The two *devas*, the two Ashvins who were excellent physicians, were born from this. They are described as

Nasatya and Dasra, sons of the one with twelve forms.²¹⁴ These are Prajapati Manu's eight children.²¹⁵ In that beautiful form, Bhaskara²¹⁶ showed himself to her. On seeing his wife, he was content and said, "Because of that curse, Yama is greatly afflicted in his mind. With *dharma*, he causes delight. Therefore, he is Dharmaraja. Because of his auspicious deeds, he has obtained supreme radiance. He has become the lord of the ancestors and is a guardian of the worlds. Manu is a Prajapati. The immensely illustrious Savarni will be the Manu in the future Savarni *manvantara*."²¹⁷ Even today, the lord is performing terrible austerities on the slopes of Meru. His brother, Shanaishchara, obtained the status of becoming a planet. With that form, Tvashta fashioned Vishnu's *chakra*.²¹⁸ It is great in power and cannot be repulsed. It counters *danavas*. The illustrious Yamuna was youngest among them and became Yamuna, best among rivers, which purifies the worlds. The eldest among them was Vaivasvata Manu. The greatly energetic one's creation is current now and I will speak in detail about him. If a person hears, or reads, about this birth of *devas* and about Vaivasvat's seven energetic sons, he obtains great fame and is freed from calamities.'

Chapter 98-1(98) (Vaivasvata Manu's creation)

Suta said, 'Along with its *devas*, Chakshusha *manvantara* was over.²¹⁹ Vaivasvata was instructed to rule over the large kingdom of earth. Vaivasvata had ten sons who were his equals—Ikshvaku, Nriga, Dhrishta, Sharyati, Narishyanta, Pramshu, Nabhaga, Dishta, Karusha and Prishadhra. These ten are described as Manavas.²²⁰ To kindle his understanding, Brahma had earlier urged Manu. Therefore, the king wished to perform a horse sacrifice. Prajapati performed this sacrifice with the supreme objective of obtaining a son. He offered oblations into the fire in a spot meant for Mitra and Varuna. It is heard that Ilaa was born from this. She wore divine garments and was adorned with divine ornaments. Her form was divine. Seeing her, Manu, the wielder of the rod, spoke, "O fortunate

one! Follow me.” Prajapati desired a son, and Ilāa replied in words that were in conformity with *dharma*. “O supreme among eloquent ones! I have been born from Mitra-Varuna’s portion. I will go to their presence. Otherwise, having been destroyed, *dharma* will destroy.” Saying this, the *devi* went to their presence. Having gone to their presence, the one with the excellent hips joined her hands in salutation and said, “O *devas*! I have been born from your portion. What will I do for you? Manu has asked me to follow him.” The virtuous Ilāa spoke these words and sought refuge with them. The two *devas*, Mitra and Varuna, replied in these words. “O one who knows about *dharma*! O one with beautiful hips! O one with the beautiful complexion! We are pleased with your humility, self-control and truth. O immensely fortunate one! O maiden! You will obtain fame through us. You will become Sudyumna, revered and worshipped in the three worlds. You will be loved by the universe and be devoted to *dharma*. You will extend Manu’s lineage.” She became a man, the lord Sudyumna. ²²¹ However, in her form as a woman, with the boon, the *devi* returned to her father. Subsequently, Budha approached her and requested that she should have intercourse with him. Through Budha, Soma’s son, Ilāa gave birth to Pururava. ²²² When she had given birth through Budha, she became Sudyumna again. Sudyumna had three heirs who were devoted to *dharma*. They were Utkala, Gaya and Vinata. Utkala obtained the kingdom of Utkala and Vinata obtained the region to the west. *Rajarshi* Gaya obtained the city of Gaya, towards the east. After creating these subjects, Manu entered the sun. He divided the earth into ten parts, each ruled over by a *kshatriya*. The heir, Ikshvaku, obtained the tenth part. Since he had been a woman, Sudyumna did not obtain a share. However, following Vasishtha’s words, he was established in Pratishtana. ²²³ The great-souled king Sudyumna devoted to *dharma*, was established there.’

Hearing this, the *rishis* asked Suta, ‘Sudyumna was a man. How did he become a woman?’

Suta answered, ‘Earlier, Sanatkumara and the others ²²⁴ came to see Maheshvara. They came to Ilavrita, wishing to see Vrishadhvasa. All of them saw that he was sporting with Uma in a concealed spot and returned.

But Shiva²²⁵ was ashamed. For her own pleasure, the beloved Devi spoke these words to her beloved. “O divinity! If a man enters this hermitage, he will certainly become a woman, the equal of an auspicious *apsara*.” All the *bhutas*, *pishachas* and animals who were there became female. Like *apsaras*, they sported with Rudra. Out on a hunt, the king entered Uma’s grove. Thus, with Rudra in the form of a woman and along with *pishachas* and *bhutas*, King Sudyumna assumed the form of a woman. As a result of Mahadeva’s favours, he became a man again.’

Chapter 99-1(99) (*Murchhanas of gandharvas*)

Suta said, ‘Understand about the creation of Manu’s sons in detail. In the night, Prishadhra caused violence to his *guru*’s cow and was destroyed. The great-souled Chyavana cursed him that he would become a *shudra*. Karusha’s descendants were the Kaarusha *kshatriyas*, indomitable in battle. Thousands of *kshatriyas* were born and they were valiant. Dishta’s son was Nabhaga²²⁶ and his son was the learned Bhalandana. Bhalandana had an immensely strong son named Pramshu. Pramshu had a single son and that king was like a Prajapati. Along with his well-wishers and relatives, Samvarta took him to heaven.²²⁷ In this connection, there was a great dispute between Samvarta and Brihaspati. Witnessing the prosperity of his sacrifice, Brihaspati was enraged. Extremely angry at Samvarta’s sacrifice, he was about to destroy the worlds. However, he was placated by *devas*. *Chakravarti* Marutta had a son named Nariyshanta, who was like Vasava. Narishyanta’s son was King Dama, who wielded the rod. His son was known as King Rashtravardhana. His son was Sudhriti and Sudhriti’s son was Nara. Nara’s son was Kevala and Kevala’s son was Bandhuman. Bandhuman’s son was King Vegavan, with *dharma* in his soul. Vegavan’s son was Budha and Budha’s son was Trinabindu. He became king at the onset of the third *treta yuga*. He had a daughter named Idavidaa, who was the mother of Vishrava. Trinabindu’s son was King Vishala, who was extremely devoted to *dharma*. He was famous for his generosity and valour

and constructed the city of Vishalaa.²²⁸ Vishala's son was the immensely strong king, Hemachandra. Hemachandra's son was the famous Suchandra. Suchandra's son was the king famous under the name of Dhumrashva. Dhumrashva had the learned Srinjaya as a son. Srinjaya's son was the prosperous and powerful Sahadeva. Sahadeva's son was Krishashva, who was extremely devoted to *dharma*. Krishashva's son was the powerful and immensely energetic Somadatta. *Rajarshi* Somadatta had Janamejaya as a son. Janamejaya's son was famous under the name of Pramati. As a result of Trinabindu's powers, all the kings of Vishalaa had long lifespans. They were great-souled and valiant and extremely devoted to *dharma*. Sharyati²²⁹ had twins. The son was famous under the name of Anarta. The daughter was Sukanya, Chyavana's wife. Anarta's heir was extremely valiant and was named Reva. His kingdom was Anarta and his city was Kushasthali.²³⁰ Reva's son was Raivata, also known under the name of Kakudmi. He was devoted to *dharma*. He was the eldest of one hundred brothers and obtained the kingdom of Kushasthali. To listen to the *gandharvas*, along with his daughter, he went to Brahma's presence. It was only a *muhurta* for the lord of *devas*, but it was many *yugas* for mortals. When he returned to his own city, surrounded by Yadavas, he was still a young man. The city was then named Dvaravati. It was beautiful, with many gates. With Vasudeva²³¹ at the forefront, it was protected by Bhojas, Vrishnis and Andhakas. Raivata, the scorcher of enemies, heard everything that had happened. His daughter was named Revati and she was excellent in her vows. He bestowed her on Baladeva and having done this, he went to the summit of Meru, to perform austerities. With *dharma* in his soul, Rama²³² sported himself with Revati.'

Hearing these words, the *rishis* asked. The *rishis* said, 'A time period of many *yugas* passed. How is it that Revati and Raivata Kakudmi did not suffer from old age? We wish to hear about this and about the art of *gandharvas*. Please tell us.'

Suta replied, 'For a person who has gone to Brahma's world, there is no old age, hunger, thirst or fear of death. Disease has no power. O supreme sages! O ones excellent in vows! You have asked me about the art of *gandharvas*. I will tell you accurately. The aggregate of *svaras* consists of

seven svaras, three *gramas*, twenty-one *murcchanas* and forty-nine *tanas*.

²³³ The svaras are known as *shadaja*, *rishabha*, *gandhara*, *madhyama*, *panchama*, *dhaivata* and *nishada*. ²³⁴ The *madhyama gramas* are known to be *souvira*, *madhyama-grama*, *harina*, *kaloyanopeta* as the fourth, *suddha-madhyama*, *nagni*, *poupa* and *deva-drishta-kamcha*, in that order. Now hear about *shadaja gramas*. They are *uttara*, *mandra*, *rajani*, *unnarayata*, *madhya-shadaja* and *abhimudgana*. Understand the *gandhara gramas*, or *shyamas*, as I describe them. They are *agnishtoma* as the first, *vajapeyika* as the second, *yavaratasuya*, *suvarnaka* as the sixth, *gousavana* is the name of the seventh, the eighth is *mahavrishtika*, *brahmadana* is the ninth, *prajapatya* comes after that, *nagayakshashraya*, the learned *gottara*, *padakranta*, *mrigakranta*, the charming *vishnukranta*, *suryakantadharenya* and the famous *santakokila*. They must always be learnt and *pishachas* find it impossible to tolerate them. Other *tanas* are *savitra*, *arddhasavitra*, *sarvatobhadra*, the charming *adhatrya*, *gandharvanupata*, *alambusheshta*, *vishnu*, *sagaravijaya*, charming to all creatures, and *hatotsrishta*. Know about the beloved *skandha* too. There are the charming *adhatrya*, *gandharvanupata*, ²³⁵ *alambusheshta* and *naradapriya*.

Bhimasena has spoken about *tanas* loved by citizens. *Vikalopanita* and *vinatashri* are said to be loved by Bhargava. Narada has spoken about fourteen or fifteen he liked. Brahma has sung *souvira* and *susouvira*. Brahma is the presiding divinity for *uttaradi svara*. *Harinasya* originated in Hari's region. Chandra is the presiding divinity for the *murcchana harinasya*. *Karopanita* is extensively sung in the solar disc. Manu is the presiding divinity for *sakalopanatata*. This *murcchana*, pure in its *atman*, originated in Manu's region. In that way, Mrigendra is the presiding divinity for *mrigamargi*. There are many men who sing this in many hermitages. The *murcchana rajani* is heard for many *yojanas* and has *rajas* as its essence. Similarly, there is a presiding divinity for *uttaramandra*. It is known as that because it starts before being extended further. It originates from *tamas* and Dhruva is the presiding divinity. The ancestors and divinities of *shraddhas* are presiding divinities for *uttarayata murcchana*. Having started, it ends with *dhaivata*. *Maharshis* worship Agni with the

pure *svara* of *shadaja*. Hence, it should be known as pure, pure in its extension. These are the *murchhanas* that were devised, with such sentiments. The *murcchana pakshoka* is known as that since birds heard this *murcchana*.²³⁶ When *murcchanas* are sung, *nagas*, with their venomous glances, do not approach. There are many such ordinary ones and those who are knowledgeable about the three *Vedas* sing to the fire.’

Chapter 100-1(100) (Art of *gandharvas*)

Suta said, ‘After understanding the views of earlier *acharyas*, in the due order, I will describe the *alamkaras*.²³⁷ Listen attentively. *Alamkaras* are spoken of with respect to their specific *varnas*²³⁸ and their configuration. One must always consider the dramatic performance. Words, meanings and *padas*²³⁹ are combined and completed with the use of *alamkaras*. It is said that the *padas* sung come either before, or after.²⁴⁰ There are three places from which utterances take place—the resting place of the mind,²⁴¹ the throat and the head. Seeking to pronounce from these three places is said to be the excellent norm. In the natural form, there are four *varnas* and the movements follow this. Alternatively, there are said to be eight movements and *devas* know about sixteen. The first *varna* is *srishtha*, while the second is *prasanchari*. The third is *avarohana*. Those who know about *varnas* say that the fourth *varna* is *arohana*.²⁴² Among these movements, *sthayin* is the one that moves, but is steady. The others move, with movement. When the *varnas* descend, that has been determined to be *avarohana*. When they ascend, those who know about *varnas* speak of this as *arohana*. Such are the *varnas*. Now understand about *alamkaras*. There are four kinds of *alamkara*—*sthapani*, *kramarejana*, *pramada* and *apramada*. I will describe their characteristics. There are *visvara* and *ashtakala*, with the latter uniting the positions of the two.²⁴³ *Avarta* and *kramotvakshi* are used, depending on the measurement. Know that *kumara*, *dvistara* and *vamana* come next. In this way, there are *kutareka* and *kuladhika*. *Svena* is based on *kalaas*²⁴⁴ and is used when one desires to worship Agni. A discriminating person knows

that there is an enhancement of *svaras* in *nishtapta*. Other than *syena*, *hasta*, *uttara* and *kamala* are also based on *kalaas*. Those who do not know commit transgressions, but not those who know. It must be ensured that the *varnas* are based on the *kalaas*. If the measurement is in the wrong way, there will be a transgression. The supreme pitch of *shadaja svara* is *ekottara svara*. To effect *akshepaskandana*, one must imitate the complete cawing of a crow. Depending on the cause and the effect, one should descend quickly. *Akshipta* belongs to the descending or *avarohana* category. The *alamkara* of *prekhollikhita* has *svaras* that combine after every twelfth *kalaa*. Many *svaras* and *kalaas* are combined to form a *grama*. If the *kalaas* are flung around, that is like making a present to the enemy. When the emphasis is doubled, that is spoken of as *bhashitam*. It is *vishvarudha* when eight *svaras* ascend. It is certainly *vapa* when there is a slow descent. It is excellent when the *svaras* are placed one after another. *Makshi-praccheda* ²⁴⁵ is described as that with groups of four *kalaas*. Thirty kinds of *alamkaras* have thus been described. The *varnas* are used in a certain place and *kalaa* and *matra* ²⁴⁶ are used to measure the duration of time. Depending on the need, it is known that *alamkaras* depend on four things—the place, the duration, the modification and the attribute. The willful use of *alamkaras*, as one pleases, is censured. That is also the case, if depending on one's will, one uses *alamkara* for any *varna*. A woman is adorned when she uses many kinds of ornaments appropriately. As with *varnas*, the ornaments are not used to adorn as one pleases. An earring is not seen on the feet, nor is a girdle around the neck. In that way, a transgression in use of *alamkaras* is censured. *Alamkaras* should be used as they are seen on the limbs. One should stick to the path that has been instructed. Like a painting done with a brush, the attributes follow. I will accurately state the way tones emerge from the mouth. It is known that there are one hundred and forty divinities for these. Starting with the peak, one comes down to the middle portions. According to the divisions, these charming divinities are established along the path. A *svara* is seen to follow another *svara*, along with the accompaniments. Sometimes, there is a reversal in the due order of the seven *svaras*. Using *gandhara* as a base, excellent and illustrious

compositions are sung. This is also true of *panchama*, *madhyama*, *dhaivata*, *nishada*, *shadaja* and *rishabha*. We know that this is prevalent in the groves on the extremities of the Madraka region. Others are sung beyond these boundaries, in the warm regions. *Gandhara* is used in its natural form, as well as in its modified form. Seven *padas* are appropriately used in the *natya* form known as *koushiki*. The entire norm, for use of *gandhara*, has been described. In this way, there are instructions for using *madhyama* in the middle portions. In particular, the songs that follow this pattern have been described. Using the seven *svaras*, *koushiki* has seven different forms. This is said to be indicative of the different divisions and unity in various limbs. There is a single *matra* and two *matras* are used everywhere.²⁴⁷ The subsequent *matra* is rare and has vanished, except for utterances about the *brahman*. Otherwise, that *matra* has suffered and has been withdrawn. In a *pada* with a single *matra*, there may be another *varna*. When there is a deficiency in numbering, that is said to be *pana*.²⁴⁸ When the second *pada* is broken, that is known as *graha*. In *aparantika*, the breaks are in the first, eighth, third and second. There is a natural division of *padas*. In the Uttara and Madraka regions, one quarter more is added.²⁴⁹ In the Madraka and Dakshina regions, *kalaas* are as described. Everyone follows this and no one desires to have a different kind of inclination. It is recommended that one should use one or the other methods for *avarohana* and not mix them up. O excellent *dvija*! One mode should be used and not two. If there is a combination of many modes, Hari has said it is a sin. There are three kinds of modes—Chitra, Vritti and Dakshina. O brave ones! There are also eight combinations of different kinds of *murcchanas*. In the due order, the different divisions of *svaras* have been described.’

Chapter 101-1(101) (Ikshvaku's lineage)

Suta said, ‘Kakudmi Raivata went to that world. ²⁵⁰ All the *rakshasas* and *punyajanas* ²⁵¹ seized Kushasthali. His one hundred brothers were great-souled and devoted to *dharma*. However, they were pierced by iron arrows and scared, fled in different directions. O excellent *dvijas*! Overcome by fear, the number of *kshatriyas* who fled was extremely large. All of them were devoted to *dharma* and are famous in the directions as Sharyatas. The sons of Dhrishta ²⁵² were Dharshtikas and all of them were unassailable in battle. There were groups of three thousand such great-souled *kshatriyas*. Nabhaga had a valiant heir, also named Nabhaga. Nabhaga's son was Ambarisha and Ambarisha's son was Virupa. Virupa's son was Prishadashva and Prishadashva's son was Rathitara. Though born as *kshatriyas*, they are described as Angirasas. Born as *kshatriyas*, the best among Rathitaras were *dvijas*. Earlier, when Manu sneezed, Ikshvaku emerged. ²⁵³ He had one hundred sons, who were generous in distributing *dakshina*. Three among them were the best—Vikukshi, Nimi and Danda. He ²⁵⁴ had fifty sons, Shakuni being the foremost. They were kings who protected the region of Uttarapatha. ²⁵⁵ There were another forty-eight in the southern direction. Virata was foremost among those who protected Dakshinapatha.’

‘On the day of *ashtaka*, ²⁵⁶ Ikshvaku instructed Vikukshi. The king said, “O immensely strong one. Kill *mriga* ²⁵⁷ and bring flesh for the *shraddha*. There is no doubt that I have to perform an *ashtaka shraddha*.” Following these words, the intelligent one went on a hunt. The valiant one killed thousands of animals and was exhausted. Having gone on that hunt, Vikukshi ate a hare. Vikukshi returned with the soldiers and the flesh. The king followed the norms, presented himself before Vasishtha and requested him to sprinkle it. ²⁵⁸ Thus urged, Vasishtha agreed. But he saw that the meat had been defiled and spoke angrily to the king. “O lord of the earth! Your son has polluted this meat. O immensely radiant one! The wicked one

has eaten a hare from this flesh. O unblemished one! The evil-souled one has already eaten a hare. O excellent king! Hence, the meat meant for the ancestors has been polluted.” Enraged, Ikshvaku addressed Vikukshi in these words. “In connection with a rite meant for the ancestors, I instructed you to go on a hunt. But you have been cruel and have already eaten a hare in the forest. As a result of your own deeds, I am banishing you. Leave.” In this way, following Vasishtha’s words, Ikshvaku abandoned his son. When Ikshvaku departed, Shashada ²⁵⁹ obtained this earth. He became the lord of Ayodhya and was extremely devoted to *dharma*. Guided by Vasishtha, he ruled over the kingdom. But when the lord of the earth ruled over the kingdom, he was completely overwhelmed by his sin. After his time was over, he lived amidst urine and excrement. ²⁶⁰ If a learned person knows this account, he will not eat, except in a permitted way. The learned-ones say this about eating *mamsa*. “What I eat in this world has the quality of being *mamsa* because it will eat me in the next birth.” ²⁶¹ Shashada’s heir was the valiant Kakutstha. Earlier, in the Adibaka battle, Indra assumed the form of a bull. ²⁶² He rode on the hump of that bull and was victorious. He is therefore known as Kakutstha. Kakutstha’s son was Anenas and the son of Anenas is said to have been Prithu. Prithu’s son was Drishdashva and Drishdashva’s son was the valiant Andhra. Andhra’s son was Yuvanashva and Yuvanashva’s son was born as Shravasta. Shravasta was the king who constructed Shravasti. ²⁶³ Shravasta’s heir was the immensely illustrious Brihadashva. Brihadashva’s son was famous as Kuvalashva. Since he killed Dhundhu, the king obtained the name of Dhundhumara.’

The *rishis* said, ‘O immensely wise one! We wish to hear in detail about the slaying of Dhundhu, as a result of which, Kuvalasha came to be known as Dhundhumara.’

Suta replied, ‘Kuvalashva had twenty-one thousand sons. All of them were perfect in learning. They were strong and impossible to assail. All of them were devoted to *dharma*. They performed sacrifices, with copious amounts of *dakshina*. Brihadashva, lord of men, instated the immensely valiant and brave Kuvalasha, devoted to *dharma*, in the kingdom. Having passed on that prosperity to his son, the king entered the forest. *Brahmarshi*

Utanka tried to restrain the great and valiant king, Brihadashva, who was extremely devoted to *dharma*, from leaving. Utanka said, “Your task is to protect, and you should act accordingly. O lord of the earth! Without being agitated, I am incapable of performing austerities. There is a desert everywhere around my hermitage. O lord of the earth! The ocean is full of sand there. There is a *rakhasa* that is gigantic and immensely strong. He cannot be slain by *devas*. That great one is inside the ground there, hiding himself inside the sand. This giant *asura* is Madhu’s son and his name is Dhundhu. He lies down there, performing terrible austerities for the destruction of the world. He exhales at the end of the year. At that time, the earth quakes, along with its forests. From the wind created by his breathing, a giant storm of dust arises. This covers the path of the sun and the ground trembles for seven days. There are blazing sparks and extremely terrible smoke. O king! As a result of this, I am incapable of remaining in my own hermitage. O mighty-armed one! With the welfare of the worlds in mind, restrain him. Your energy is great and Vishnu will extend your energy even more. When that *asura* is killed now, the worlds will regain their natural state. O lord of the earth! You are the one who is capable of killing him. O unblemished one! Earlier, Vishnu granted me a boon. ²⁶⁴ Dhundhu is exceedingly valiant and a person with limited energy cannot accomplish this, even if he tries for one hundred years. He will burn down all the lords of the earth. His prowess is extremely great and even *devas* find it impossible to assail him.” The great-souled Utanka spoke to the *rajarshi* in this way. To counter Dhundhu, he gave Kuvalashva to him. “O illustrious one! I have cast aside my weapons. O best among *dvijas*! This is my son. There is no doubt that he will be Dhundhumara.” He instructed his undecaying son to kill Dhundhu. Firm in his vows, the ascetic left for the forest. Kuvalashva, with *dharma* in his soul, followed the words of his father. The king was with his twenty-one thousand sons. To counter Dhundhu, he left, along with Utanka. Bhagavan Vishnu’s own energy entered him. With the welfare of the worlds in mind, Utanka invoked this. As the invincible one advanced, there was a tumultuous sound in heaven. “From today, this king will become Dhundhumara.” Divine flowers were

showered. *Devas* assembled and surrounded him in all directions. At that time, the drums of *devas* were sounded loudly. Along with his sons, the valiant tiger among men departed. He dug up the ocean, which was filled up with an inexhaustible mass of sand. As his sons dug, they found Dhundhu hidden inside the sand, in a western direction. He was angry and fire emerged from his mouth, as if he was going to destroy the worlds. Using his *yoga*, he unleashed a torrent of water that resembled the giant ocean when the moon waxes. The best among *asuras* created this large flow of water. In the battle, all of his sons were burnt down. Only three survived. The king was extremely strong, and the *rakshasa* was extremely strong too. The immensely energetic one approached Dhundhu, who had destroyed his relatives. O child! The lord of men was a *yogi* and he used *yoga* against that flood of water. To pacify the water, he created fire. The *rakshasa* was gigantic in size and his strength was the water. While Utanka looked on, he killed him. Thus, the lord of men was successful in his objective. Utanka bestowed a boon on the great-souled king. He granted him imperishable wealth, invincibility before enemies, constant devotion towards *dharma* and an imperishable residence in heaven. The sons who had been killed by the *rakshasa* would obtain eternal residence in heaven. Three of his sons remained. Of these, the eldest is said to have been Dridhashva. The two younger ones are described as Bhadrashva and Kapilashva.’

‘Dhundhumara’s son was Dridhashva and his son was Haryashva. Haryashva’s son was Nikumbha, always devoted to the *dharma* of *kshatriyas*. Nikumbha’s son was Samhatashva, who was accomplished in fighting. Samhatashva had two sons, Krishashva and Akritashva. His ²⁶⁵ wife was the virtuous Haimavati and his mother was Drishadvati. His son, Prasenajit, was famous in the three worlds. Prasenajit’s son, Yuvanashva, was famous in the three worlds. His wife, Gouri, was devoted to her husband and was extremely devoted to *dharma*. She was cursed by her husband and became the river Bahuda. ²⁶⁶ Her son, Gourika, was a *chakravarti*. Mandhata, Yuvanshva’s son, was a king who conquered the three worlds. In this connection, *dvijas* who know the Puranas cite this *shloka*. “The entire region, where the sun rises and is established, is said to

be the *kshetra* of Mandhata, Yuvanashva's son." His wife, Chaitrarathi, was the daughter of Shashabindu. The virtuous one was also named Bindumati and her beauty was unmatched on earth. She was devoted to her husband. She was the eldest, with ten thousand brothers. Through her, Lord Mandhata had three sons—Purukutsa, Ambarisha and the famous Muchukunda. Another Yuvanashva is said to have been Ambarisha's heir. Through Narmadaa, he had Sambhuta as a son. Sambhuta's son was the powerful Anaranya. Earlier, when Ravana conquered the three worlds, he killed him. Anaranya's son was seen to be Haryashva. Through Drishadvati, Haryashva had King Sumati as a son. His son was the king named Tridhanva, devoted to *dharma*. Tridhanva's son was the learned lord, Trayyaruni.'

'He had a son named Satyavrata, who was extremely strong. He killed Divoukasa of Vidarbha and abducted his wife.²⁶⁷ This was done when the *mantras* for accepting a hand in marriage had not been completed. He was driven by desire and strength and using his strength, did it joyously. Driven by destiny, the intelligent one did this by force. Since he had been touched by *adharma*, his father, Trayyaruna,²⁶⁸ exiled him. Full of rage, he repeatedly said, "This is a sin." He repeatedly asked his father, "I am alone. Where will I go?" His father replied, "Reside with *shvapakas*."²⁶⁹ O worst of the lineage! Though I desire a son, I don't want a son like you." Thus addressed, he followed the words of the lord and left the city. The illustrious *rishi*, Vasishtha, did not restrain him. The intelligent Satyavrata resided near *shvapakas*. Abandoned by his father, the valiant one dwelt there. Meanwhile, his father left for the forest. Because of that *adharma*,²⁷⁰ for a full twelve years, the chastiser of Paka did not rain down in that kingdom. At that time, the great ascetic, Vishvamitra, had left his wife in that kingdom and had gone to the marshy shores of the ocean to perform extensive austerities. To sustain the lives of the remaining sons, his wife tied a noose around the neck of the son in the middle, offering to sell him in exchange for one hundred cows. The excellent man saw that he was being offered for sale, with a noose around his neck. With *dharma* in his soul and excellent in his vows, he freed the *maharshi*'s son. The immensely

intelligent Satyavrata nurtured him. He did this out of compassion and because he wanted to satisfy Vishvamitra. Because he had been bound at the neck, *maharshi* Koushika's son became the intelligent and great ascetic named Galava and he was freed by that brave one.²⁷¹ Because of his vow, devotion, compassion and pledge, he humbly nurtured Vishvamitra's wife. He slew deer, boar and aquatic buffaloes and brought their flesh to near Vishvamitra's hermitage. For twelve years, he initiated himself into observing the *upamshu vrata*.²⁷² Commanded by his father, the king resorted to the forest. Following the norms, the sage Vasishtha performed sacrifices and protected the kingdom of Ayodhya and the inner quarters. As a consequence of his great childishness and the force of inevitable destiny, Satyavrata was angry and full of great rage towards Vasishtha. When his father exiled his own son from the kingdom, the sage Vasishtha had not restrained him. This was the reason. The *mantras* of accepting a hand in marriage are completed when seven steps have been taken together. That being the case, Satyavrata had abducted her at the seventh step.²⁷³ "Though he knows *dharma*, Vasishtha desires that the *mantras* should be uttered again." That is the reason Satyavrata's mind was full of rage towards Vasishtha. Knowing about the qualities, the illustrious Vasishtha performed austerities. But engaged in his *upamshu vrata*, Satyavrata did not know this. Thus, he was filled with great rage towards his great-souled father. The chastiser of Paka did not shower down for twelve years. "He has initiated himself into a vow that will be extremely difficult to observe on earth now. If he is able to follow this, he will himself save his lineage. I will thereafter instate this son in the kingdom." This was the reason why the illustrious Vasishtha did not restrain his father from abandoning him. "When his father is dead, I will perform a consecration for the lord." The powerful one observed that *diksha* for twelve years. There was a time when flesh could not be obtained and the prince saw the great-souled Vasishtha's cow, which was capable of yielding milk to satisfy every object of desire. Overcome by anger, delusion, exhaustion and hunger, the supreme among strong ones followed the *dharma* of bandits and killed it. He ate the flesh himself and gave it to Vishvamitra's sons. Hearing that he had fed them this, Vasishtha

abandoned him. He said, “O cruel one! O worst among men! Even if you had not committed this sin, I would have brought you down. Failing to satisfy your father, slaying a cow that belongs to your *guru* and having intercourse with someone you should not have intercourse with—these are the three sins you have committed.” Because of the three sins he had witnessed, the great ascetic addressed him as Trishanku and he came to be known as Trishanku. ²⁷⁴ Vishvamitra returned and saw that his wife had been sustained. Delighted with Trishanku, the sage granted him a boon. The prince told his *guru* about the boon he desired. He asked for the boon, “Let me go to heaven in my physical body.” The fear resulting from twelve years of drought was over. While *devas* and Vasishtha looked on, the sage Koushika instated him in his father’s kingdom. The lord was made to ascend to heaven in his physical body. While Vasishtha looked on, this extraordinary act was performed. In this connection, people who know about the Puranas chant a *shloka*. “As a result of the intelligent and immensely energetic Vishvamitra’s favours and boon, Trishanku is radiant in heaven, along with *devas*.” His wife was named Satyarataa, born in the Kekaya lineage. As a son, she gave birth to the unblemished Harishchandra. It is heard that King Harishchandra was known as Traishankava. ²⁷⁵ He performed a royal sacrifice and was renowned as an emperor. Harishchandra’s valiant son was named Rohita. It is said that Rohita’s son was Harita and Harita’s son was Chanchu. Chanchu had two sons—Vijaya and Sudeva. Since he conquered all the regions, he was known as Vijaya. ²⁷⁶ His son was Ruruka, a king accomplished in *dharma* and *artha*. Ruruka’s son was Vrika and Vrika gave birth to Bahu. Since he was addicted to vices, Haihayas, Talajanghas, Shakas, Yavanas, Kambojas, Paradas and Pahlavas dislodged him. Though that *yuga* was full of the virtuous and had *dharma*, he was not excessively devoted to *dharma*. Bahu’s son was Sagara and he was born with poison. He reached the hermitage of Bhrigu’s descendant and was protected by Ourva. King Sagara obtained the *agneya* weapon from Bhargava. He travelled the earth and killed Haihayas and Talajanghas. He made Shakas and Pahlavas deviate from their *dharma*. The one who knew about *dharma* did this for the *kshatriyas* who the Paradas were too.’

The *rishis* asked, ‘How was King Sagara born with poison? Why was the king so incensed? Why did he make the immensely energetic *kshatriyas*, Shakas and others, deviate from the *dharma* of their lineages?’

Suta said, ‘In earlier times, Bahu indulged in vices. Haihayas, Talajanghas and Shakas arrived together and deprived him of his kingdom. There were also Yavanas, Paradas, Kambojas and Pahlavas. These five categories contributed their valour for the sake of the Haihayas. ²⁷⁷ With his kingdom seized, Bahu gave up his home. With *dharma* in his soul, he entered the forest. Along with his wife, he performed austerities. On one occasion, though he was incapacitated, the king left, to collect water. Since Bahu was weak and aged, he died. His wife, who belonged to the Yadava lineage, followed him from the rear. Wishing to kill the foetus, her co-wife had given her some poison. Having prepared her husband’s funeral pyre, she got ready to ascend it. On seeing this, full of compassion, Bhargava Ourva restrained her. The embryo and the poison were delivered in his hermitage. Since he was born in this way, the mighty-armed one, who was devoted to *dharma*, was given the name of Sagara. ²⁷⁸ The great-souled Ourva performed his *jatakarma* and other rites. He taught him the *Vedas* and sacred texts and gave him weapons. The king decided that he would annihilate the Shakas, Yavanas, Kambojas, Paradas and Pahlavas. Slaughtered by the great-souled and brave Sagara, all of them went to Vasishtha, wishing to seek refuge with him. Seeing that they were full of humility, Vasishtha, the great sage, spoke to them. He granted them freedom from fear and restrained Sagara. Sagara listened to his *guru*’s words and controlled the pledge he had made. He destroyed their *dharma* and altered their attire. He shaved half of the heads of the Shakas and released them. He shaved the entire heads of the Yavanas and the Kambojas. He made the Paradas wear their hair loose and made the Pahlavas sport beards. The great-souled one robbed them of studies and *vashatkara*. The great-souled Sagara placed primary importance on the words of Vasishtha. He took away the *dharma* of all these groups of *kshatriyas*—Shakas, Yavanas, Kambojas, Pahlavas, Paradas, Kalisparshas, Mahishikas, Darvas, Cholas and Khashas. The king used *dharma* to conquer and conquered the earth. Consecrating

himself for a horse sacrifice, he made the horse wander around. While the horse was wandering around along the south-eastern shores of the ocean, it was stolen and taken inside the earth. All the king's sons began to dig in that region. As they dug in that spot, along the great ocean, they came upon the original Purusha, the divinity Hari Krishna Prajapati Vishnu, the Lord Hamsa Narayana, sleeping in the form of Kapila. They came within his range of vision and the energy from his eyes burnt down all the sons, barring four. These were Barhiketu, Suketu, Dharmaratha and the brave Panchajana. They extended the lord's lineage. Bhagavan Hari Narayana granted him boons—his lineage would last forever, he would perform one hundred horse sacrifices, the ocean would be known as the lord's son and he would dwell in heaven for eternity.²⁷⁹ The ocean, the lord of rivers, brought the horse and honoured him. It obtained the name of Saagara because of his deeds.²⁸⁰ From the ocean, the lord of the earth obtained the horse meant for the horse sacrifice. One after another, he performed one hundred horse sacrifices. His sixty thousand sons were burnt down by the lord's rage. Those sixty thousand great-souled ones entered Narayana's energy. This is what we have heard.'

The *rishis* asked, 'Through what means were those immensely strong and valiant sons born to Sagara? What was the method? Please tell us.'

Suta answered, 'Sagara had two wives and they destroyed their sins through austerities. The elder was named Keshini, and she was the daughter of Vidarbha. The younger wife Mahati was Arishtanemi's daughter, and she was extremely devoted to *dharma*. She was unmatched in beauty on earth. When they worshipped him through austerities, Ourva granted both a boon. One would give birth to a desired son who would extend the lineage. The second would give birth to sixty thousand sons. Hearing the sage's words, Keshini accepted the single son, who would extend the lineage and be the oldest of the lot. O king! Delighted, the immensely fortunate Sumati, Suparna's sister, accepted sixty thousand sons. After time passed, the elder wife gave birth to the eldest son. Sagara's son belonged to the Kakutshtha lineage and was known under the name of Asamanja. The illustrious Sumati gave birth to a foetus that was in the form of a bottle gourd. Sixty thousand

sons emerged from within that bottle gourd. Each of these foetuses was immersed in a pot that was full of *ghee* and the king appointed a nursemaid to take care of each of these. Through nine months, these were developed comfortably. These were immensely fortunate sons who enhanced Sagara's pleasure. After a long period of time, they attained the prime of youth. Through Keshini, Sagara had another son. He was the immensely strong Barhiketu, known under the name of Asamanja. Since he harmed the citizens, his father expelled him from the city. Asamanja had a valiant son, named Amshuman. His son, with *dharma* in his soul, was famous as Dilipa. Dilipa gave birth to the valiant and immensely energetic Bhagiratha. Ganga, the best among rivers, beautiful and ornamented with *vimanas*, was brought down by him to this world and the lord of Gods thought of her as his daughter. In this connection, those who know the Puranas recite a *shloka*. "Through his deeds, Bhagiratha brought down Ganga. Therefore, those who know about lineages speak of Ganga as Bhagirathi." Bhagiratha had a son named Shruta. Nabagha was his heir, always devoted to *dharma*. His son was Ambarisha and Sindhudvipa came after that. Those who know the Puranas and about the earlier lineages are heard to sing this. "The earth was protected by the arms of Nabhaga and Ambarisha and was freed from the three kinds of distress.'

'Sindhudvipa's son was the valiant Ayutayu. Ayutayu's heir was the extremely illustrious Rituparna. He was powerful and knew the divine art of playing with dice. ²⁸¹ He was also King Nala's friend. Two Nalas are famous in the Puranas, and both were firm in their vows. The first was the son of Virasena and the second was the one who extended the Ikshvaku lineage. Rituparna's son was Sarvakarma, the lord of men. His son, Sudasa, was Indra's friend. Sudasa's son is said to have been the king named Soudasa. This king was also known by the names of Kalmashapada and Mitrasaha. For extending the Ikshvaku lineage, through Kalmashapada's *kshetra*, ²⁸² the immensely energetic Vasishtha gave birth to Ashmaka. Ashmaka's son was Mulaka. In connection with King Mulaka, the following is cited. "Since he was scared of Rama, ²⁸³ the king lived such that he was surrounded by women. Naked and bereft of weapons, the lord used women

as *kavacha*.” Mulaka’s son is said to have been King Shataratha, with *dharma* in his soul. Shataratha’s son was the powerful king, Idavida. Idavida’s son was the prosperous and powerful Krishasharma. Through Putrikasi, he had Vishvasahasra as a son. His son was Dilipa, famous as Khatvanga.²⁸⁴ He went to heaven for a *muhurta* but got back his life again. O unblemished ones! Through his intelligence and truth, he comprehended the nature of the three worlds. His son was Dirghabahu and Dirghabahu’s son was Raghu. Raghu’s son was Aja. Aja’s son was the valiant king named Dasharatha, the extender of the Ikshvaku lineage. Dasharatha’s sons were Rama, who was famous in the worlds and knew about *dharma*, Bharata, Lakshmana and the immensely strong Shatrughna. Shatrughna went to Madhuvana and killed Lavana, the son of Madhu. He then populated the city of Mathura there. Shatrughna’s two sons were Subahu and Shurasena. Sons of the princess of Videha,²⁸⁵ these two protected the city of Mathura. Lakshmana’s two sons were Angada and Chandraketu. Their prosperous domain extended up to Mount Himalaya. In the region known as Angada, Angada created a beautiful city. Chandraketu built the auspicious and famous city of Chandrachakra. Bharata had two valiant sons, Taksha and Pushkara. Those two great-souled ones successfully built cities in the region of Gandhara. Taksha’s city, named Takshashila, is famous in all directions. The brave Pushkara’s city is the famous Pushkaravati. In this connection, those who know about the Puranas sing a chant. This is about the greatness of the intelligent Rama, who was bound to the truth. “He was dark and young. His eyes were red, and his face was radiant. He was restrained in speech. His arms extended up to his knees. His face was pleasant and his shoulders were like those of a lion. He was mighty-armed. Rama ruled over the kingdom for ten thousand years. The loud sounds of the *Rig, Sama* and *Yajur Vedas* being chanted could be heard. In that kingdom, one could constantly hear, ‘Let it be given. Let it be enjoyed.’ While residing in Janasthana, he accomplished the tasks of the Gods.²⁸⁶ Searching out Sita’s footsteps, the immensely illustrious one, bull among men, killed Poulastya,²⁸⁷ who had caused him harm earlier. He was full of the *guna* of *sattva* and blazed in his own energy, which surpassed that of the sun and the fire. Such

was Rama, Dasharatha's son." ²⁸⁸ This mighty-armed one had two sons. They were known as Lava and Kusha. Hear about their territories. Kusha's kingdom was Koshala, and his city was Kushasthali. He constructed this beautiful city on the summit of Mount Vindhya. The great-souled Lava's kingdom was Uttara Koshala. His city of Shravasti is famous in the worlds. Hear about Kusha's lineage. Kusha's son was Atiithi. He had *dharma* in his soul and was extremely fond of guests. Atithi's son was the famous king, Nishadha. Nishadha's son was Nala and Nala's son was Nabha. Nabha's son was Pundarika. Kshemadhanva is said to have come after him. Kshemadhanva's son was the powerful king, Devanika. Lord Devanika had a son named Ahinagu. Ahinagu's heir was the immensely illustrious Pariyatra. His son was Dala and Dala's son was King Bala. Bala had a son named Ahuka, who possessed *dharma* in his soul. His son was Vajranabha and Vajranabha's son was Shankhana. Shankhana's son was Vyushitashva, who is said to have been learned. Vyushitashva's son was King Vishvasaha. His excellent son was Hiranyanabha, the lord of Koshala. He is said to have been the *shishya* of Poushyenji, who taught the eastern variant of the *Sama Veda*. He studied five hundred *Samhitas*. ²⁸⁹ The intelligent one studied *yoga* from Yajnavalkya. His son, Pushpa, was learned. Pushpa's son was Dhruvasandhi and Dhruvasandhi's son was Sudarshana. Sudarshana's son was Agnivarna. Agnivarna's son was Shighra and Shighra's son is said to have been Maru. Maru resorted to *yoga* and resided in Kalapagrama. The lord established *kshatriyas* in the twenty-first sub-*yuga*. Maru's son was Prabhusuta and his son was Susandhi. Susandhi's son was Marsha, also known by the name of Sahasva. Sahasva's son was King Vishrutavan. Vishrutavan's son was King Brihadbala. Hundreds of kings are described as the descendants of Ikshvaku. Those who are foremost have been described, because of their importance. If a person reads about the creation of Aditya Vivasvat properly, he has offspring and obtains *sayujya* ²⁹⁰ with Vaivasvata Manu. The divinity Shraddhadeva bestows nourishment on subjects. Such a person will destroy his sins and *rajas*. He will be born with a long lifespan and will never deviate.'

Chapter 102-1(102) (Nimi's lineage)

Suta said, 'Hear about the lineage of Nimi, Vikukshi's younger brother. He constructed a city that was like a city of the *devas*. It was known as Jayanta and was near Goutama's hermitage. Janaka, the excellent king, was born in his lineage. The one named Nimi was exceedingly full of *dharma* in his soul and was worshipped by all beings. O great king! Ikshvaku, full of great energy, had this son. He was cursed by Vasishtha and lost his body. ²⁹¹ Videha's son was Mithi, and he was born during three *parvas*. The immensely illustrious one appeared when the *arani* was churned. Born in this way, Mithi came to be known as Janaka. Mithila was named after the name of the immensely valiant Mithi. This king was Janaka and his son was Udavasu. Undavasu's son was Nandivardhana, who had *dharma* in his soul. Nandivardhana's son was named Suketu. He was brave and devoted to *dharma*. Suketu's son was the immensely strong Devarata, who had *dharma* in his soul. Devarata's son is said to have been Brihaduktha, who also had *dharma* in his soul. Brihaduktha's son was the powerful Mahavirya. Mahavirya's son was Dhritiman and Dhritiman's son was Sudhriti. Sudhriti's son was Dhrishtaketu. He was a scorcher of enemies and had *dharma* in his soul. Dhrishtakeu's son was famous under the name of Haryashva. Haryashva's son was Maru and Maru's son was Pratimbaka. Pratimbaka's son is said to have been King Kirtiratha, who had *dharma* in his soul. Kirtiratha's son is said to have been Devamidha. Devamidha's son was Vibudha and Vibudha's son was Mahadhriti. Mahadhriti's son was the powerful king, Kirtirata. Kirtirata's learned son was known as Maharoma. Maharoma's son was the famous Svarnaroma. Svarnaroma's son, Hrasvaroma, became the king. Hrasvaroma's son is said to have been the learned Siradhvaja. When the king tilled the ground, the illustrious Sita originated. She was Rama's queen, virtuous, excellent and firm in her vows.'

Vaishampayana asked, 'When the ground was ploughed, how did the illustrious Sita originate? Why did the king till and what was the field?'

Suta answered, ‘In the course of horse sacrifice, the great-souled one followed the rules and extremely attentively, ploughed the ground where the fire was placed. She arose from this. The one from Mithila, named Bhanuman, was Siradhvaja’s younger brother. His brother was Kushadhvaja, the lord and master of Kashi. The powerful Pradyumna was Bhanuman’s son. His son is said to have been Muni and Muni’s son was known as Urjavaha. Urjavaha’s son was Sanadhvaja and Sanadhvaja’s son was Shakuni. Shakuni’s son was Svagata and it is said that his son was Suvarcha. Suvarcha’s heir was Sutoya and Sutoya’s son was Sushruta. Sushruta’s son was Jaya and Jaya’s son was Vijaya. Vijaya’s son was Kratu and Kratu’s son is said to have been Sunaya. Sunaya’s son was Vitahavya and Vitahavya’s son was Dhriti. Dhriti’s son was Bahulashva and Bahulashva’s son was Kriti. The lineage of the great-souled Janakas extended up to him. I have spoken about the ones from Mithila. Now hear about the Somas.’

Chapter 103-1(103) (Soma and Soumyas)

Suta said, ‘O *brahmanas*! The illustrious *rishi*, Atri, gave birth to Soma. Atri was established there, surrounding the worlds with his energy. ²⁹² Everything he did, in deeds, thoughts and words, was auspicious. The immensely radiant one raised his arms. He resembled a block of wood, a wall, or a boulder. These austerities were great and extremely difficult to perform. In those ancient times, they scorched everything. We have heard that he performed them for three thousand divine years. The immensely intelligent *dvija* did not blink and held up his seed. The semen rose upwards and obtained the status of *soma*. As he cleansed his *atman*, he obtained the status of *soma*. *Soma* emanated from his eyes and illuminated the ten directions. As a destiny, the *devis* of the ten directions held this in their wombs. They gathered around and sought to bear it together but were incapable of doing so. Suddenly, the foetus fell from the directions. As it fell, its cool beams purified everything and illuminated the worlds. Those

women were incapable of bearing that foetus. Along with them, the cool beams fell on earth. Brahma, the grandfather of the worlds, saw that Soma was falling. To ensure the welfare of the worlds, he placed him on a chariot. O *brahmanas*! He was full of the *Vedas*. He possessed *dharma* in his soul and was devoted to the truth. We have heard that he was seated on a chariot yoked to one thousand horses. The son of Atri, the *paramatman*, fell in this way. Devas, Brahma's seven sons born through mental powers,²⁹³ the Angirasas and the sons of Bhrigu praised him with many hymns from *Rig*, *Yajur* and *Atharva Veda* and Angirasa texts. Praised in this way, Soma was radiant in his energy. He pervaded the three worlds and nourished everything. On that foremost chariot, he did *pradakshina* of the earth twenty-one times. This enhanced his energy, which flowed to the earth. The energy blazed in the firmament and herbs originated from it. This purified the worlds and the four kinds of *prajas*.²⁹⁴ O excellent *dvijas*! Bhagavan Soma is the one who nourishes the world. He obtained energy through the austerities, the praise and his own deeds. The immensely fortunate one tormented himself through austerities for nine hundred years. There are *devis*, golden in complexion, who hold up the world. They were delighted with the lord and Soma became famous because of his own deeds. O excellent *dvijas*! Brahma, supreme among those who know about the *brahman*, bestowed on him the kingdom of seeds, herbs, *brahmanas* and water. The immensely energetic one was instated in this great kingdom and became a king of kings. Supreme among those who scorch, the energetic one nourished the worlds. Daksha, the son of Prachetas, bestowed twenty-seven of Daksha's daughters on him. These are known as *nakshatras*.²⁹⁵ The lord Soma, who was full of *soma*, obtained that great kingdom. He performed a *rajasuya* sacrifice with *dakshina* amounting to one hundred thousand.²⁹⁶ Hiranyagarbha was the *udgatri* and Brahma was the *brahmana*. The lord Bhagavan Hari Narayana was the *sadasya*, surrounded by *brahmarshis*, Sanatkumara being the foremost. O *dvijas*! We have heard that Soma gave the foremost *brahmarshis* and the *sadasyas* the three worlds as *dakshina*. He was served by nine *devis*—Sini, Kuhu, Vapu, Pushti, Prabha, Vasu, Kirti, Dhriti and Lakshmi.²⁹⁷ When the *avabhritha* was over,

as the foremost person present, he was worshipped by all the *devas* and the *rishis*. The Indra among kings was radiant and illuminated the ten directions. He was praised by the *rishis* and obtained a prosperity impossible to obtain.’

‘O *brahmanas*! He lost his humility, and his mind was in a whirl, thus engaging in improper conduct. He showed disregard for all the sons of Angiras and violently abducted Brihaspati’s illustrious wife, named Tara. *Devas* and *devarshis* beseeched him. However, he did not return Tara to the son of Angiras. ²⁹⁸ Ushanas took his side and Bhava took the side of Angiras. This is because the immensely energetic one had earlier been the *shishya* of Brihaspati’s father. Out of that affection, Bhagavan Rudra took Brihaspati’s side. ²⁹⁹ Having taken his side, the divinity Bhava picked up the Ajagava bow. The great-souled one used the supreme weapon known as *brahmashira* and when he directed this towards *devas*, all their fame was destroyed. The famous encounter known as the Tarakamaya ³⁰⁰ battle took place between *devas* and *danavas* and it led to great destruction in the worlds. *Devas* who survived are known as Tushitas. They went and sought refuge with Brahma, the grandfather and original divinity. He restrained Ushanas and his senior, Rudra Shankara. The grandfather himself gave Tara back to the son of Angiras. Brihaspati saw that Tara, with a face like that of the moon, was pregnant. The *brahmana* said, “Discharge this foetus immediately. This vagina belongs to me and you should never nurture any other foetus.” At this, Tara discharged the foetus, which blazed like the fire. As soon as he was flung away and born, the illustrious one assumed a form like that of the *devas*. Therefore, the Gods were suspicious and spoke to Tara. “Tell us the truth. Whose son is this, Soma’s or Brihaspati’s?” Because of her shame, she did not tell the *devas* anything, good or bad. At this, the boy, the destroyer of bandits, got ready to curse her. But Brahma restrained him and asked Tara about the doubt. “O Tara! Tell us the truth. Whose son have you delivered?” She joined her hands in salutation and addressed Lord Brahma, the one who bestows boons, in these words. “This great-souled boy, the destroyer of bandits, is Soma’s son.” King Soma, the Prajapati, inhaled the fragrance of his son’s head. ³⁰¹ The intelligent one gave his son

the name of Budha. In the sky, Budha rises in the opposite direction. ³⁰² The daughter of the king ³⁰³ gave birth to his son. His son was immensely energetic Pururava, born as Ila's son. Through Urvashi, he ³⁰⁴ had six immensely energetic sons. At that time, consumption entered him. ³⁰⁵ He suffered, found it impossible to tolerate and was incapacitated. When Soma was overwhelmed by consumption, the lunar disc faded. He went and sought refuge with his father, Atri. The immensely illustrious Atri pacified his sin. Freed from consumption, in every direction, he blazed in prosperity. O excellent *dvijas*! I have thus described Soma's birth to you. O best among *dvijas*! I will now describe his lineage. Listen. If a person hears about Soma's birth, he is freed from all sins. This account is sacred and cleanses sins. It is blessed and confers freedom from disease and a long lifespan.'

Chapter 104-1(104) (Amavasū's lineage)

Suta said, 'Soma's son was Budha and Budha's son was Pururava. He was energetic and generous in donating. He performed sacrifices with copious quantities of *dakshina*. He was valorous and spoke about the *brahman*. In a battle, the enemies found it impossible to defeat him. The lord of the earth performed *agnihotra* and other sacrifices. He was truthful in speech and his intelligence focused on *dharma*. He was handsome and restrained in indulging in sexual intercourse. His beauty was so excessive that he was unmatched in the three worlds. He spoke about the *brahman* and was controlled. He knew about *dharma* and was truthful in his speech. Abandoning her pride, the illustrious Urvashi accepted him. ³⁰⁶ For ten years, eight years, seven years, six years, seven years, eight years, ten years and eight years, the valiant king resided with her in the beautiful Chaitraratha forest, along the banks of the Mandakini, in Alaka ³⁰⁷, in Vishala ³⁰⁸, in Nandana, supreme among groves, in the foothills of Gandhamadana, on the summit of Meru, the excellent mountain, in Uttarakuru and in Kalapagrama. ³⁰⁹ These foremost groves were frequented

by the Gods. Along with Urvashi, the king enjoyed himself, full of great joy.'

The *rishis* asked, 'The king was human. What extremely wicked deed did the *gandharvas* do, as a result of which, the *devi* abandoned him?'

Suta answered, 'As a result of Brahma's curse, she arrived in the world of humans.³¹⁰ To free herself from the curse, she set some conditions. She said, "I will remain with you as long as I do not see you naked. There will be no intercourse without desire. There will be two rams³¹¹ near my bed. O lord of the earth! I will eat only *ghee*, that too, only once a day. O king! This must be the firm contract for the duration. I will reside with you as long as this agreement is adhered to." The king observed everything, according to her contract. She resided with Ilaa's son and had intercourse with him. Since she was confounded by the curse and out of devotion towards him, she did this for sixty-four years." When Urvashi arrived in the world of humans, the *gandharvas* were filled with thoughts. The *gandharvas* said, "O fortunate ones! Think of a means whereby the beautiful lady, Urvashi, the ornament of heaven, can return here again, to the *devas*." The *gandharva* named Vishvavasus was great and extensive in intelligence. He stole the two rams that belonged to her. So, she returned to heaven.³¹² Separated from Urvashi, he wandered around. He finally saw her in Kurukshetra and there was a conversation between them. She told him, "Follow the *gandharvas*." They gave him a vessel with fire in it. After this, the *maharatha* king went to heaven. Earlier, there used to be a single fire. Ilaa's son thought of them as three.³¹³ O excellent *dvijas*! Such were the powers of the king who was Ilaa's son. The lord of the earth established his kingdom in Prayaga, in the most sacred of places, ornamented by *maharshis*. The immensely illustrious one established Pratishtana,³¹⁴ on the northern banks of Yamuna. He had six sons. They were infinitely energetic, like Indra. In the world of the *gandharvas*, they are known as Ayu, Dhiman, Amavasus, Vishvavasus, Shrutayu and Ghritayu. These were Urvashi's sons.'

'Amavasus's son was King Bhima, who conquered the universe. The prosperous King Kanchanaprabha was Bhima's heir. The learned and

immensely strong Suhotra was Kanchana's son.³¹⁵ Through Keshini's womb, Jahnu was born as Suhotra's son. Since what is destined to happen is certain to occur, when he was engaged in sacrificial rites, Ganga arrived there and flooded the place. He saw that Ganga had flooded the sacrificial arena, in every direction. O excellent *dvijas*! The king who was Suhotra's son became angry at Ganga. While all the divine *rishis* looked on, he drank up Ganga. They brought the immensely fortunate one and made her his daughter, Jahnavi. Jahnu married Kaveri, Yuvanashva's granddaughter. As a result of Yuvanashva's curse, half of Ganga's body gave birth to Kaveri, the best among rivers.³¹⁶ This unblemished one was Jahnu's wife. Jahnu's beloved son, born through Kaveri, was named Sunanda and he was devoted to *dharma*. His son was Ajaka. Ajaka's heir was the immensely illustrious Balakashva. Kusha, who was extremely attached to hunting, is said to have been his son. Kusha had four sons who were as radiant as *devas*—Kushika, Kushanabha, Amurtarayasa and Vasu. For the sake of a son, the excellent king, Kushika, tormented himself through austerities. This went on for a full one thousand years and Shatakratu³¹⁷ noticed this. Purandara, who possessed one thousand eyes, witnessed these fierce austerities. The eternal one was himself capable of generating such a son. Therefore, Purandara thought of himself as the son. The chastiser of Paka became Kushika's son, under the name of Gadhi.'

'Purukutsa's daughter became Gadhi's wife and at first, through her, he had an immensely fortunate and auspicious daughter, named Satyavati. Desiring a son, the lord Gadhi bestowed her on Richika. Her husband, Bhargava, the delight of the Bhrigu lineage, was pleased with her.³¹⁸ For the sake of a son, he prepared some *charu*³¹⁹ for himself and Gadhi. Richika Bhargava spoke to his beloved. "O auspicious one! You should eat this *charu*. Your mother should eat that. She will have a blazing son, a bull among *kshatriyas*. *Kshatriyas* will find him to be invincible in battle and he will slay bulls among *kshatriyas*. O fortunate one! Your son will be intelligent, a store of austerities. He will be best among *dvijas*, with serenity in his *atman*. The *charu* will ensure this."³²⁰ This is what Richika, the descendant of the Bhrigu lineage, told his wife. To constantly perform

austerities, he then entered the forest. Along with his wife, Gadhi happened to come to Richika's hermitage. Having embarked on a visit to the *tirthas*, the lord of men wished to see his daughter. Satyavati accepted the two portions of *charu* given by the *rishi*. On seeing her mother, she calmly told her about her husband's words. As a result of destiny, her mother gave her *charu* to her daughter. In her ignorance, she ate her *charu*. Satyavati conceived an auspicious foetus that would destroy all *kshatriyas*. As she bore it, her body blazed and she became terrible to behold. Richika saw her and using his *yoga*, realized what had happened. The best among *dvijas* spoke to his wife, who possessed a beautiful complexion. "O fortunate one! You have been deceived by your mother. There has been an exchange of *charus*. You will give birth to a son who will be extremely cruel and terrible in his deeds. Your mother will give birth to a son who is a store of austerities. Using my austerities, I had given you the entire *brahman* from the universe." The immensely fortunate Satyavati was addressed by her husband in this way. She sought her husband's favours. "My son should not be like this. He should not be such a worst among *brahmanas*." Thus addressed, the sage replied, "O fortunate one! I did not desire this, nor you. Because of what a father or a mother does, a son becomes fierce in deeds." When she was told this, Satyavati again spoke the following words. "O sage! If you wish, you can create the worlds. What need be said about a son? O husband! You should grant me a son with serenity in his *atman*. O one excellent in vows! If it cannot be according to this wish, let our grandson be like that. O excellent *dvija*! If you are incapable of altering it, let it be that way." Using the strength of his austerities, he pleased her and said, "O one with a beautiful complexion! I do not see any special difference between a son and a grandson. O fortunate one! It shall be in accordance with the words you have uttered." Thus, Satyavati gave birth to Bhargava Jamadagni as a son. He was self-controlled and devoted to austerities, with serenity in his *atman*. Earlier, the Vaishnava and Roudra *charus* ³²¹ given by Bhargava had been mixed up. Since he had eaten the Vaishnava fire, he was born as Jamadagni. ³²² Vishvamitra was the heir of

Gadhi, Kushika's son. He obtained the status of a *brahmarshi* and went to Brahma, surrounded and revered by *brahmanas*.'

'Satyavati was auspicious and devoted to the vow of the truth. She began to flow as the great river, known by the name of Koushiki. The immensely fortunate Koushiki is best among rivers and is famous. In the Ikshvaku lineage, there was a powerful lord of the earth, by the name of Renuka. His immensely fortunate daughter was named Kamali and was also known as Renukaa. Through Kamali Renukaa and using his austerities, fortitude and mediation, Jamadagni had an extremely terrible son, born to the Richika lineage. He was best and supreme in all kinds of learning. He was accomplished in *dhanurveda*.³²³ This was Rama, the slayer of *kshatriyas*. He blazed like the fire. Jamadagni was great-minded, supreme among those who knew about the *brahman*. Because of the austerities and energy of Richika, Ourva's son, he³²⁴ was born through Satyavati. Shunahshepha was the son in the middle and Shunahpuccha was the youngest.³²⁵ Vishvamitra, with *dharma* in his soul, is said to have had the name of Vishvaratha. He was born through Bhargava's favours and extended the Koushika lineage. The sage Shunahshepha was Vishvamitra's son. For Harishchandra's sacrifice, he had been earmarked as the *pashu*.³²⁶ *Devas* gave Shunahshepha back to Vishvamitra again. Since he was given by *devas*, he came to have the name of Devarata.³²⁷ Among Vishvamitra's sons, Shunahshepha is described as the eldest. There were others too, Madhucchanda and others, Kritadeva, Dhruva, Ashataka, Kacchapa and Purana. These were Vishvamitra's sons. The great-souled Koushikas had many *gotras*³²⁸—Parthivas, Devaratas, Yajnavalkyas, Samarpanas, Udumbaras, Vatadyas, Talakayanas, Chandravas, Lohiniss, Renus, Karishus, Babhrus, Paninas, Dhyanajapyas, Shyamayanas, Hiranyakshas, Samkritas, Galavas, Devalas, Yamadutas, Shalankayanas, Bashkalas, Lalatyas, Badaras and others. These are said to be the ones descended from the intelligent Vishvamitra. Among the Koushikas, there are many who entered into marriages with other rishi lineages—Koushikas, Soushrutas, Saindhavayanas and others. These are descendants of the sacred *brahmarshi* Koushika, the lord of *yoga*. Among Vishvamitra's sons, Shunahshepha is

said to have been the eldest.³²⁹ Through Dhrishadvati, Vishvamitra had Ashtaka as a son. Ashtaka is said to have had Louhi as a son. I have thus spoken about the ones descended from Jahnu.’

The *rishis* asked, ‘Vishvamitra and other kings obtained the status of becoming *brahmanas*. What was the nature of *dharma*, austerities and learning, through which, they achieved this? What are the rules for *kshatriyas* to become *brahmanas*? In particular, we wish to know about austerities and donations.’

Thus addressed, Suta uttered these sentences, which were full of meaning. “A person desiring *dharma* may invite excellent *dvijas* and perform a sacrifice with objects acquired through unjust means. He does not reap the fruits of *dharma*. A person greedy for wealth may perform unrestrained and fierce *japa*. Full of attachment and delusion, to purify himself, he may donate. However, he does not reap any fruits through such donations. In that way, an evil-souled and violent person may engage in acts of *dharma*. Having obtained wealth through delusion, he may donate and perform sacrifices. For an evil-souled person, such tainted deeds and donations have no effect. Having obtained objects through legitimate means, a person must go to *tirthas* and without any desire, perform sacrifices and donate. Such donations bear fruits, and such donations give rise to happiness. Through donations, one obtains objects of pleasure. Through truth, one obtains heaven. If a person torments himself through austerities, he obtains a permanent status in the worlds. Truth is superior to austerities and *jnana* is said to be the most important of all. Hear about *kshatriyas* who obtained the status of *dvijas* by attaining success through austerities—Vishvamitra, King Mandhata, Sankriti, Kapi, Kashya, Purukutsa, Shala, the lord Gritsamada, Arshtishena, Ajamidha, Bhargavyoma, Kakshivan, Oushija, King Shishira, Rathantara, Shounaka, Vishnuvridha and other kings. These are said to have been *kshatriyas*. However, through their austerities, they became *rishis*. All of these *rajarshis* obtained great success in *siddhi*. After this, I will describe the lineage of the great-souled Ayu.’

Chapter 105-1(105) (Dhanvantari's origin)

Suta said, ‘The great-souled Ayu had five extremely strong sons. These kings were born through Prabha, Svarbhanu’s daughter. Nahusha was the first among them and Kshatravridha is said to have been the next. Rambha, Raji and Anena were famous in the three worlds. Kshatravridha’s son was the immensely illustrious Sunahotra. Sunahotra had three heirs who were extremely devoted to *dharma*. Two of them were Kasha and Shala. The other one was the lord Gritsamada. Gritsamada’s son was Shunaka and his son was Shounaka. O *dvijas*! Because of their *karma*, different lineages of *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras* were born through him. Shala’s son was Arshtishena and his son was Shishira. Shounaka and Arshtishena were *kshatriyas* but became *dvijas*. Kashya’s son was King Dirghatapa, the lord of Kashi. Dirghatapa’s son was Dhanva and the learned Dhanvantari was his son. The intelligent and greatly energetic one was born to his aged father after the austerities had been completed.’

At this, the *rishis* again questioned Suta in the following words. The *rishis* asked, ‘Who was Dhanvantari, the *deva* born among humans? We wish to know this. O scorcher of enemies! Therefore, tell us that.’

Suta replied, ‘O *dvijas*! Hear about Dhanvantari’s origin. Earlier, he had been born after the churning of the ocean for *amrita* had been completed. Earlier, he had been born with a pot in his hand, surrounded on every side by prosperity. Vishnu was stationed in the firmament. On seeing him accomplish his task instantly, he said, “You have been born from water. Therefore, you will be known as Abja.”³³⁰ Abja told Vishnu, “O lord! I am your son. O excellent God! In this world, please arrange a location and share for me.” Thus addressed, the lord reflected on the truth and replied. “The *daityas* and Gods have already divided up the shares of sacrifices. In the *Vedas*, *maharshis* have already laid down the rules and the norms for offering oblations. It is impossible for oblations to be ever offered to you. You are the son of a downward flow.³³¹ O *deva*! O lord! Therefore, there cannot be any *mantra* for you. However, your second origin will obtain

fame in this world. You will then obtain *siddhi*, *anima* and the others. O lord! You will obtain the status of becoming a *deva* in this body. *Dvij*as will worship you with *mantras*, *ghee* and other objects from a cow's milk. You will once again formulate the principles of *Ayurveda*.³³² All this is certain and has already been visualized by the one born from the lotus. When the second *dvapara yuga* arrives, there is no doubt that you will be born." Having granted him this boon, Vishnu vanished from the spot.'

'When the second *dvapara yuga* arrived, King Dirghatapa, descended from Sunahotra, was the king of Kashi. To obtain a son, the king tormented himself through austerities. For the sake of a son, the king wished to worship *deva* Abja. Dhanvanatri told the king to ask for a boon. The king said, "O illustrious one! If you are pleased with me, you should become my son." The lord agreed to this and disappeared. Thus, *deva* Dhanvantari manifested himself in his house. He was the king of Kashi. He was a great king and pacified all ailments. He learnt *Ayurveda* and the art of being a physician from Bharadvaja. He again divided this knowledge into eight parts³³³ and taught it to his disciples. Dhanvantari's son was famous as Ketuman and Ketuman's son was King Bhimaratha. Bhimaratha had an intelligent son who was the lord of subjects. He was famous as Divodasa and he became the lord of Varanasi. In those ancient times, a *rakshasa* named Kshemaka resided in Varanasi and rendered it bereft of all inhabitants. Earlier, the great-souled Nikumbha had repeatedly cursed the city that it would remain empty for one thousand years.³³⁴ When it was cursed for this duration, Divodasa, lord of subjects, established the beautiful city of Gomati beyond these boundaries and populated it.'

The *rishis* asked, 'In earlier times, why did Nikumbha curse Varanasi? Why did Nikumbha, with *dharma* in his soul, curse a *kshetra* frequented by *siddhas*?'

Suta answered, 'King Divodasa, the *rajarshi*, obtained the city. The immensely energetic lord of men resided in that prosperous place. At this time, Maheshvara married. Wishing to bring pleasure to Devi, he lived close to his father-in-law. Following the divinity's command, his attendants assumed universal forms and those as stores of austerities. As has been

mentioned earlier,³³⁵ they assumed forms and attires and satisfied Maheshvari. Mahadeva was delighted at this, but Mena³³⁶ was not satisfied. She constantly reprimanded Deva and Devi. “Even when he is next to me, your husband, Maheshvara, does not exhibit good conduct. He is poor in every possible way. Alas! He is not even ashamed at this hardship.” When her mother spoke in this way, as a result of her feminine nature, she was incapable of tolerating it. Though she smiled a bit, the bestower of boons went to Hara’s presence. With a distressed face, Devi spoke to Mahadeva. “O divinity! I will not live here. Take me to your own residence.” Glancing at all the worlds, Mahadeva agreed. O excellent *dvijas*! The idea of residing on earth appealed to him. Maheshvara Bhava got to know that Divodasa had populated the city of Varanasi and that it was an extremely energetic *kshetra*, populated by *siddhas*. He summoned a leader of *ganas* who was by his side and happily addressed him. “O leader of *ganas*! O Ganeshvara! Go to the city of Varanasi and empty it. The king there is not mild but possesses an excess of strength.” In those ancient times, Nikumbha thus went to the city of Varanasi. He showed himself to a *dvija* named Mankana, in his dreams. “O unblemished. I will do something beneficial for you. This place appeals to me. Make an image of my form and place it on the extremities of the city.” The *dvija* did as he had been told in his sleep. He placed it at the city’s gate and informed the king. Following the norms, great worship was organized every day, using fragrances, incense, offerings and objects worthy of beholding. There were donations of food and other wonderful things. In this way, every day, Ganeshvara was worshipped there. He bestowed thousands of boons on the citizens of the city—sons, gold, long lifespans and all that was desired. The king’s queen was excellent and was known under the name of Suyasha. For the sake of a son, the king urged this virtuous queen. The queen undertook a great worship and asked for a son. For the sake of a son, she repeatedly came there, many times. But for a specific reason, Nikumbha did not grant her a son. If the king became angry, he would then do something. After a long period of time, the king was overwhelmed with rage. “This *bhuta*, at my gate, is delighted and grants hundreds of boons to citizens. But he does not give us anything. My

people constantly worship him in my city. For the sake of a son, my queen has entreated him many times. But he has not granted me a son. He eats a lot and is ungrateful. From me, he never deserves any kind of worship. Therefore, I will destroy this evil-souled one's spot." Having decided this, the evil-souled king committed the sin. Evil-minded, he destroyed Ganeshvara's spot. On seeing that his abode had been destroyed, the lord cursed the king. "Though I have not committed a crime, you have destroyed my spot. O lord of men! Therefore, your city will suddenly become empty." At the time, as a result of his curse, Varanasi became empty. After cursing the city, Nikumbha brought Mahadeva there. In that empty city, the great-minded Mahadeva constructed a residence for himself and Devi, rivalling the prosperity of the *devas*. Devi was amazed at this prosperity and sported there with him. In his pastimes, the divinity Ishana addressed Devi in these words. "I will not leave my abode. Avimukta is my home."³³⁷ He smiled and said, "Avimukta is my home. O Devi! I will not leave this place and go elsewhere. O beautiful one! O unmatched one! With me, sport in this *kshetra*." The divinity himself referred to the place as Avimukta. In this way, Varanasi was cursed and was described as Avimukta." Bhava, the divinity revered by *devas*, always resides there. Maheshvara, with *dharma* in his soul, resides there with Devi, in the three *yugas*. The great-souled one's city vanished in *kali yuga*. When the city vanished, the city was populated again. In this way, Varanasi is repeatedly cursed and re-populated.'

'Bhadrasena had one hundred sons who were excellent archers.³³⁸ Divodasa, lord of men, got the city populated after killing them. Using his strength, he killed Bhadrasena and seized his kingdom. Bhadrasena had a son who was known by the name of Durmada. Since he was a child, in his contempt, Divodasa released him. The brave Pratardana was born through Divodasa and Drishadvati. The son who had been a child seized it back from him again.³³⁹ This happened because of enmity and because of what destiny had ordained. Pratardana had two famous sons—Vatsa and Bharga. Vatsa's son was Alarka and Alarka's son was Sannati. There is an ancient *shloka* that was sung about *rajarshi* Alarka. "Alarka, the excellent one from

Kashi, possessed youth and beauty that lasted for sixty thousand and six hundred years. Through Lopamudra's ³⁴⁰ favours, he obtained a long lifespan." When the period of the curse was over, the mighty-armed one ³⁴¹ slew the *rakshasa* Kshemaka. The king again populated the beautiful city of Varanasi. Sannati's heir was named Sunitha, and he was devoted to *dharma*. Sunitha's heir was known as Kshema, and he was devoted to *dharma*. Kshema's son was Ketuman and Ketuman's son was Suketu. It has been heard that Suketu's son was Dharmaketu. Dharmaketu's heir was *maharatha* Satyaketu. Satyaketu's son was the lord of subjects named Vibhu. Vibhu's son was Suvibhu and Suvibhu's son is said to have been Sukumara. Sukumara's son was Dhrishtaketu, and he was extremely devoted to *dharma*. Dhrishtaketu's heir was Venuhotra, lord of subjects. Venuhotra's son was famous under the name of Gargya. Gargya's son was Gargabhumi. This is the lineage of the intelligent Vatsa. Their sons were *brahmanas* and *kshatriyas*, extremely devoted to *dharma*. They were brave and strong, like lions in their valour. I have thus spoken about the Kashyapas. Now hear about Raji's descendants.'

'Raji had five hundred sons. They were famous on earth for their valour and were known as Rajeyas. These *kshatriyas* caused fear in Indra himself. At the time, there was an extremely terrible battle between *devas* and *asuras*. *Devas* and *asuras* went and asked the grandfather, "O illustrious one! Who amongst us will be victorious in the battle? O lord of all the worlds! Please tell us. We wish to hear." Brahma replied, "On whichever side the lord Raji fights, wielding his weapons, there is no doubt about that side being victorious in the three worlds. Prosperity exists wherever Raji is. Perseverance exists wherever there is prosperity. Wherever there is perseverance, *dharma* exists there. Wherever there is *dharma*, there is victory." All the *devas* and *danavas* heard about Raji's victory. Desiring victory, they approached the excellent king and praised him. Delighted in their minds, all the *devas* and *danavas* went to Raji and told him, "Please pick up your excellent bow for our victory." Raji replied, "O *daityas* and *devas*, with Shakra at the forefront! I will be victorious. With *dharma* in my soul, I will become Indra. I will fight in the field of battle." *Danavas*

responded, “Our Indra is Prahlada, and it is for his sake that we will be victorious. Urged by our *deva*, please abide by this agreement.” Just as he was about to agree, *devas* urged him. “When you are victorious, you will be the Indra.” *Devas* invited him in this way. He slew all the *danavas*, who could not be killed by the one with the *vajra* in his hand. The lord Raji killed all the *danavas* and wrested their supreme prosperity. He controlled this prosperity and gave it back to *devas*, who had lost it. Along with *devas*, Shatakratu told Raji, “I am Raji’s son.” He again added the words, “O king! There is no doubt that you are the Indra of all the Gods. O slayer of enemies! As your son, I will obtain the fame of being Indra.” He heard Shakra’s words and was deceived by his *maya*. Pleased with Shatakratu, the king signified his assent. Later, the lord of the earth went to heaven and became like a God. Raji’s sons, and the sons of their *acharya*, took the kingdom back from Indra. Hundreds of his sons attacked the abode of Shachi’s consort. ³⁴² There were many occasions when they attacked the world of heaven, the abode of the Gods. Many days passed. With his kingdom lost and his fortune lost, the immensely strong Shakra spoke to Brihaspati. “O *brahmarshi*! Please arrange it so that the sacrificial offering to me should only be *badari* fruit. ³⁴³ Let that be sufficient for my energy to remain. O *brahmana*! I am emaciated. My mind is depressed. I have lost my kingdom. I have lost my seat. I have lost my energy and am weak. Raji’s sons have defeated me in the battle. Please show me your favours.” Brihaspati replied, “O Shakra! You should have urged me about this earlier. O unblemished one! Had you done that, it would have been my task to ensure that nothing unpleasant occurred to you. O Indra of *devas*! O immensely radiant one! For the sake of your welfare, I will strive. Within a short period of time, you will get back your kingdom and your share in sacrifices. O Shakra! I will go. Let your mind not be dejected.” He performed rites so that there was a great increase in his ³⁴⁴ energy. Excellent in his intelligence, he also caused their ³⁴⁵ intelligence to be deluded. They were extremely deluded. They became angry and intoxicated, acting against *dharma*. They surrounded themselves with those who hated *brahmanas*. They lost their energy and valour. All of Raji’s sons were filled with desire

and anger and he ³⁴⁶ killed them. If a person hears about Shatakratu being dislodged and getting his position back or makes it heard, he never suffers from any depredation.'

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Chapter 106-1(106) (Yayati's story)

The *rishis* asked, 'Why did the great-souled Marutta ³⁴⁷ bestow his daughter on the king? What was the valour of the great-souled sons of Marutta's daughter?'

Suta answered, 'The lord of subjects desired food and performed a Marutsoma. ³⁴⁸ The immensely energetic king did this every month, for sixty years. The Maruts were satisfied with this Martusoma sacrifice. Pleased, they gave him an inexhaustible supply of food and every other object that he wished for. Once the food had been cooked, it did not diminish for a day and a night. From the time when the sun rose, he gave this to crores of people. Through Mitrajyoti's daughter, the intelligent Marutta had immensely spirited sons. They knew about *dharma*, with insight about *moksha*. ³⁴⁹ They cast aside the *dharma* of householders and resorted to non-attachment. Having adopted the *dharma* of mendicants, they merged into the *brahman*.'

'The son of Anenas was the powerful Kshatradharma. Kshatradharma's son was Pratipaksha, the great ascetic. Pratipaksha's son was famous under the name of Srinjaya. Srinjaya's son was Jaya and Jaya's son was Vijaya. Vijaya's son was Jaya ³⁵⁰ and Jaya's son is said to have been Haryashvaka. Haryashvaka's son was the powerful king, Sahadeva. Sahadeva's son was famous as Ahina, and he possessed *dharma* in his soul. Ahina's son was Jayatsena and Jayatsena's son was Sankriti. The immensely illustrious Kritadharma, with *dharma* in his soul, was Sankriti's son. These are the descendants of Kshatradharma.'

'Now hear about Nahusha's descendants. Nahusha had six heirs who were like Indra in their energy. They were Yati, Yayati, Samyati, Ayati, Viyati and Kriti. Yati was the eldest among them and Yayati was younger to him. Yati obtained Kakutstha's daughter, named Gam, as his wife. Yati resorted to *moksha*. He became a sage and merged into the *brahman*. Among these five, Yayati became the lord of the earth. He obtained

Devayani, the daughter of Ushanas, as a wife. Sharmishtha, daughter of the *asura* Vrishaparva, was also his wife. ³⁵¹ Devayani gave birth to Yadu and Turvasu. Sharmishtha, Vrishaparva's daughter, gave birth to Druhyu, Anu and Puru. These sons were immensely valiant and were like sons of *devas*. Pleased, Shukra gave him ³⁵² an extremely radiant chariot. Its parts were divine and were made out of gold. There were two large quivers, with inexhaustible arrows. This chariot was yoked to horses that could travel at the speed of thought. He brought these two maidens on that chariot. On that foremost chariot, he constantly conquered the earth. *Devas*, *danavas* and humans found Yayati to be invincible in battle. Until the powerful Kourava, Janamejaya, ruled over the kingdom, all the kings of the Puru lineage possessed this chariot. Among Kuru's descendants who were kings, there was King Parikshit. As a result of the curse of the intelligent Gargya, the chariot was destroyed. Gargya had a son, a child. King Janamejaya was evil in intelligence. The lord of men, Lohagandhi, ³⁵³ caused violence to this son. *Rajarshi* Lohagandhi rushed around, here and there. But the inhabitants of the city and the countryside abandoned him and he could not find peace anywhere. He was tormented by grief and did not obtain consolation from anyone. Generally dejected, he sought refuge with *rishi* Shounaka. Extensive in intelligence, the sage was known by the name of Indrota. O excellent *dvijas*! To purify King Janamejaya, Indrota Shounaka made him perform a horse sacrifice. Lohagandhi died at the time of *avabhritha*. Hence, the divine chariot was given to Vasu, the lord of Chedi. It was given to him by Shakra, who was pleased with him. ³⁵⁴ Brihadratha got it. Bhima, a descendant of the Kourava lineage, killed Jarasandha ³⁵⁵ and gladly gave Vaasudeva that excellent chariot.'

'*Rajarshi* Yayati, Nahusha's son, became old. He summoned his excellent and eldest son, Yadu, and addressed him in these words. "O son! I have been overcome by old age, wrinkles and grey hair. This is because of the curse imposed by Kavya Ushanas. ³⁵⁶ Youth has not satisfied me. O Yadu! Along with my sin, accept my old age. Take my old age." Yadu replied to him, "I have pledged a *brahmana* alms, but have not yet fulfilled it. Since it can only be accomplished through exertion, I will not accept your old age.

Caused by food and drink, there are many taints associated with old age. O king! Therefore, I am not interested in accepting your old age. Old age makes the body lax and dejected, with a white beard. The body is covered with wrinkles. One loses hope and becomes weak in form. One is incapable of undertaking any task. My youth will suffer. Since there are such hardships, I do not desire that old age. O king! You have many sons, loved more than me. O one who knows about *dharma*! Please choose some other son and ask him to accept it.” When Yadu addressed him in this way, he was filled with fierce rage. Censuring his eldest son, the best among eloquent ones replied. “What other *ashrama* do you have, what other norm of *dharma*? O evil-minded one! Though I am your instructor, you disregard me.” Saying this, the angry king cursed Yadu. “Although you have been born from my heart, you have not given me your young age. O foolish one! Therefore, the offspring who will be born to you will not enjoy this kingdom. O Turvasu! Along with my sin, accept my old age.” Turvasu answered, “O father! I do not desire old age. It destroys desire and objects of pleasure. Caused by food and drink, there are many taints associated with old age. O king! Therefore, I am not interested in accepting your old age.” Yayati answered, “Although you have been born from my heart, you have not given me your young age. O Turvasu! Therefore, your offspring will be sliced away. O foolish one! You will be the king of those who eat flesh and others who are narrow in their *dharma*, men who engage in *pratiloma* marriages. ³⁵⁷ They will be addicted to the wives of their *gurus* and will be born as inferior species. O wicked one! There is no doubt that you will reside among Mlecchas.” In this way, Yayati cursed Turvasu, his own son. He then addressed Druhyu, Sharmishtha’s son, in these words. “O Druhyu! For one thousand years, accept this old age, which destroys form and complexion. Give me your youth. After one thousand years are over, I will give your youth back to you. I will again take back my sin and old age.” Druhyu answered, “A person who is decayed cannot ride a chariot or a horse or enjoy a woman. He has no happiness. Therefore, I do not wish for such an old age.” Yayati said, “Although you have been born from my heart, you have not given me your young age. O Druhyu! Hence, your

beloved desires will never be accomplished. You will have to constantly roam around in boats and rafts. Though you have been born in a lineage of kings, you will always live as someone who is not a king. O Anu! You accept the sin and the old age. For one thousand years, I will roam around with your youth.” Anu replied, “An old man is as incapacitated as a child. As a result of old age, he is always unclean. At the right time, he cannot offer oblations into the fire. I do not desire old age.” Yayati said, “Although you have been born from my heart, you have not given me your young age. You have spoken about taints associated with old age. You will have to face those. As soon as they attain youth, your offspring will be destroyed. They will be scattered and will not be able to perform the fire-rites. O Puru! You accept the sin and the old age. O son! I am overcome by old age, wrinkles and grey hair. This is because of the curse imposed by Kavya Ushanas. Youth has not satisfied me. For some time, with your youth, let me roam around amidst material objects. When one thousand years are complete, I will return your youth to you. I will take back my sin and old age.” Thus addressed, the son unhesitatingly replied to the father. “O father! I will act in accordance with whatever you have thought. O king! I will accept your sin, along with the old age. O lord! Accept the youth from me and pursue the desires you wish for. I will be enveloped in your old age. I will assume your old age and form. I will truly wander around, after giving you the youth.” Yayati replied, “O Puru! O fortunate one! I am pleased with you. Pleased, I am granting you this. Your offspring will obtain the kingdom, prosperous with every object of desire.” With Puru’s permission, King Yayati transferred his old age. With Bhargava’s favours, Yayati, Nahusha’s son, roamed around, proud of his young age.’

‘Full of joy, the best among men wandered around in his own kingdom, as he wished, as he exerted himself and as he pleased, depending on the time. According to his capacity, he never acted contrary to *dharma*. He satisfied *devas* with sacrifices and ancestors with *shraddhas*. He favoured his wives with whatever they wished for and gave excellent *dvijas* whatever they desired. He gave food and drink to guests and protected *vaishyas*. He was not violent towards *shudras* and punished bandits. Following *dharma*,

he delighted all the subjects in the proper way. Yayati ruled like another Indra himself. The king was like a lion in valour. With his youth, he enjoyed material objects. Without violating *dharma*, he acted to enjoy excellent happiness. Since he did not detect the taints, he followed the path of *kama*. With Vishvachi,³⁵⁸ he sported in the groves of Nandana and Vaibhrajā. But the king saw that his desires only increased. Therefore, he went to Puru and took his old age back. Despite obtaining objects of desire, the king was not satiated, but was dejected. The lord of men remembered the time period of one thousand years. He counted the time, the *kalaas* and *kaṣṭhas*.³⁵⁹ Thinking that the time period was over, he told his son, Puru, “O scorcher of enemies! According to my efforts, I have enjoyed happiness for the stipulated period of time. O son! With your youth, I have enjoyed objects of pleasure. O Puru! O fortunate one! I am pleased with you. Please take your youth back. Accept this kingdom. O son! You have done what brought me pleasure.” King Yayati, Nahusha’s son, took back the old age. Puru took back his youth.’

‘The king desired to instate his youngest son, Puru. The *varnas*, with *brahmanas* as the foremost, spoke to him in these words. “O lord! What about the son of Devayani, Shukra’s grandson? After passing over Yadu, the eldest, you are giving the kingdom to Puru. Yadu is your eldest son and Turvasu was born after him. Sharmishtha had Druhyu as a son. Thereafter, there was Anu. Puru came after that. Passing over the eldest, how is the youngest worthy of a kingdom? We are reminding you about your sons. Please follow *dharma*.” Yayati answered, “O *varnas*, with *brahmanas* as the foremost! All of you listen to my words. I should never give the kingdom to those who are older. A brave son who follows the words of the mother and the father is praised. Though I asked him, my eldest, Yadu, did not follow my words. The view of the virtuous is that a son who acts against the father is not a son. A son is truly a son when he follows the father and the mother. Yadu disregarded me and so did Turvasu. Druhyu and Anu also showed great disregard towards my command. Puru acted in accordance with my words and specially honoured me. Since he accepted the old age, the youngest will be my heir. As a result of what Puru, auspicious in his deeds,

did, I have accomplished all my desires. Kavya Ushanas Shukra himself bestowed a boon on me. ‘O immensely wise one! The son who obeys you will be the king.’” The subjects responded, “As permitted by you, let Puru be instated in the kingdom. A son who is always engaged in the welfare of his mother and father is a true son. The lord, the auspicious youngest one, deserves everything. Puru deserves the kingdom. He is loved by you and has done what brought you pleasure. As a result of the boon bestowed by Shukra, no one is capable of contradicting this.” The inhabitants of the city and the countryside were content to speak in this way and Nahusha’s son instated his son, Puru, in the kingdom. He instated Turvasu in the south-eastern direction. Yadu, the eldest, was instated as the king in the south-western direction. Druhyu was instated in the west and Anu in the north.’

‘Yayati conquered the earth, with its seven *dvipas*, extending up to the ocean. The king, Nahusha’s son, divided the five parts among his sons. They knew about *dharma* and following *dharma*, protected the entire earth, with all its seven *dvipas*, habitations and regions. In this way, Nahusha’s son divided the earth amongst his sons. Having transferred the prosperity to his sons, the king was pleased. He cast aside his bow and arrows and gave the kingdom to his sons. The king was pleased at having handed over the burden to his relatives. In this connection, there is an ancient song, sung by Yayati, the great king, implying that like a tortoise draws in its limbs, one should practice *pratyahara*. “Desire is not pacified through enjoying objects of pleasure. It increases again, like the one with the black trail ³⁶⁰ fed through oblations. All the *vrihi*, ³⁶¹ barley, gold, animals and women are not sufficient. If one sees this, one is not deluded. In thoughts, words and deeds, if one does not possess inauspicious sentiments towards any being, one obtains the *brahman* then. If a person does not terrify others, if he is not terrified of others, if he does not desire or hate, he obtains the *brahman* then. Evil-minded people find it difficult to give up thirst. Even when one gets old, it is not digested. It is like an ailment that leads to loss of life. Therefore, for the sake of happiness, it must be given up. When one becomes old, the hair decays. When one becomes old, the teeth decay. But even when one becomes old, the desire for life and the desire for wealth do

not decay. The desire for happiness in this world and the great happiness in heaven do not amount to one-sixteenth of the happiness obtained from the destruction of thirst.” Saying this, along with his wife, the *rajarshi* left for the forest. The immensely illustrious one tormented himself with austerities on Bhrgutunga. He followed the vow of *rishis* there and obtained heaven. His auspicious lineage, divided into five, was revered by *devas* and *rishis*. Like the sun with its rays, they pervaded the entire earth. O excellent *dvijas*! A man who reads everything about Yayati’s conduct, or hears it, is blessed. He obtains offspring, a long lifespan and fame.’

Chapter 107-1(107) (Kartavirya’s birth)

Suta said, ‘I will tell you about the lineage of Yadu, Yayati’s eldest and infinitely energetic son, in detail and the due order. Listen to my words. Yadu had five sons who were like the sons of *devas*. They were Sahasrajit, the best, Kroshtu, Nila, Anjika and Laghu. Sahasrajit’s son was a prosperous king, named Shatajit. Shatajit had three famous sons, who were extremely devoted to *dharma*. They were Haihaya, Haya and King Venuhaya. Haihaya’s son was known as Dharmanetra. Dharmanetra’s son was Kunti and Kunti’s son was Samjneya. Samjneya’s heir was the king named Mahishmat. Mahishmat had the powerful Bhadrasena as a son. It has already been stated that he was the king of Varanasi. Bhadrasena’s heir was the king named Durmada. Durmada’s intelligent son was famous under the name of Kanaka. Kanaka had four heirs and they were famous in the worlds. They were Kritavirya, Kritagni, Kritavarma and Kritoujas as the fourth. Kritavirya’s son was Arjuna. He was born with one thousand arms, and he was the king and lord of the seven *dvipas*. For ten thousand years, he tormented himself through extremely difficult austerities. Kartavirya worshipped Datta, born in Atri’s lineage. The infinitely energetic one granted him four boons. Initially, as his first boon, he asked for one thousand arms. ³⁶² The second was that he would immediately be restrained if he thought about *adharma*. His third was that he would rule over the earth

in accordance with *dharma*, after having conquered it through *dharma*. Finally, ‘I will conquer many in battles and slay thousands of enemies. I should die while fighting in battle against a foremost warrior.’ Following the rules of *kshatriyas*, he conquered the entire earth, with its seven *dvipas* and habitations, surrounded by the seven oceans. Through the *yoga* and *maya* of the lord of *yoga*, his one thousand arms appeared while he was fighting. ³⁶³ O excellent sages! It has been heard that, following the norms, the king performed seven hundred sacrifices in those seven *dvipas*. In all the sacrifices performed by the mighty-armed and infinitely energetic one, all the sacrificial altars were made out of gold. All the sacrificial posts were made out of gold. All the immensely fortunate *devas* attended, astride ornamented *vimanas*. They were always adorned by *gandharvas* and *apsaras*. Witnessing the conduct and greatness of the *rajarshi*, the *gandharva* Narada ³⁶⁴ sang a chant about the king. “Indeed, humans will not be able to proceed to the destination achieved by Kartavirya, in sacrifices, donations, austerities, valour and learning.” As a result of his *yoga*, the king was seen in all the seven *dvipas*, astride his chariot, and with his followers. He held a bow, arrows and a sword. As a result of the great king’s powers, following *dharma*, the subjects were protected. Possessions were not lost. There was no hardship or agitation. The lord of men enjoyed all the jewels for eighty-five thousand years. He was a *chakravarti*, the emperor. He was the protector of animals. He was the protector of fields. Through his *yoga*, Arjuna became Parjanya and showered down. His one thousand arms became tough because of friction against the bowstring. The king was as radiant as the autumn sun with its one thousand rays.’

‘With one thousand elephants, the king conquered the assembly-hall of Karkotaka in Mahishmati and established his city there. At the time of the monsoon, the lotus-eyed one stemmed the force of the ocean. Without any effort, he sported happily with the waters and created an artificial monsoon. Narmada, garlanded with golden ropes, ³⁶⁵ shrieked loudly when he tossed and agitated her and robbed her of her waves. In earlier times, he strode into the large ocean and using his one thousand arms, stirred up an untimely tidal wave that swept the shoreline, as if stirred up by a storm. When he

agitated the large ocean with his one thousand arms, the great *asuras* hid in Patala, immobile. Hiding under the large waves, large fish were crushed. Torrents of foam were flung up and hurled down, creating whirlpools that were impossible to tolerate. As the king agitated the ocean with his one thousand arms, it was as if the milky ocean was being churned by *devas* and *asuras*, agitated and whirled around by Mandara for the sake of obtaining *amrita*. On suddenly seeing the terrible and excellent king, giant *uragas* lost their senses. They lowered their hoods and fled. They resembled stumps of plantain trees in the evening, motionless in the absence of wind. He firmly strung the bowstring of his bow and affixed five hundred arrows. Using his strength, he confounded the lord of Lanka ³⁶⁶ and his soldiers. He defeated and subjugated him, bound him and brought him to Mahishmati. Having gone there, Pulastya's son pacified Arjuna. Entreated by Pulastya, the king released Poulastya. When his bowstring slapped against his one thousand hands, the sound was like the thunder of masses of clouds at the end of a *yuga*. It was as if they sparkled with lightning. It was wonderful that in a battle, the immensely valorous Bhargava severed these one thousand arms as if they were a grove of golden palm. On one occasion, Chitrabhanu ³⁶⁷ was thirsty and requested him. As alms, the lord of the universe gave him the seven *dvipas*, with all their cities, settlements of cattle, villages and habitations. In all the directions, Chitrabhanu blazed through his arrows. Such were the powers of the immensely illustrious Indra among men. Kartavirya burnt down mountains and forests. He burnt down everything, including the hermitage of Varuna's son. ³⁶⁸ Chitrabhanu and Haihaya burnt down the canopy in the forest. This belonged to the blazing and excellent son Varuna had obtained in earlier times. This was the sage named Vasishtha, also known as Apava. The lord Apava was enraged and cursed Arjuna. "O Haihaya! You did not spare my forest. Another one will surpass the extremely difficult task performed by you. His name will be Kounteya Arjuna and he will be a king. ³⁶⁹ The immensely valiant Rama is supreme among those who strike. The spirited and powerful one will strike and slice off the one thousand arms of Arjuna. The immensely strong *brahmana* ascetic will kill you." As a result of the intelligent one's curse, he came by

his death at the hands of Rama. This is the boon that the king had himself asked for earlier.’

‘He had one hundred sons and five of them were *maharathas*. They were accomplished in the use of weapons and strength. They were brave and illustrious and possessed *dharma* in their souls. They were Shura, Shurasena, Vrishasya, Vrisha and Jayadhvaja. Jayadhvaja extended the lineage and was the king in Avanti. Jayadhvaja’s son was the powerful Talajangha. It is heard that his one hundred sons were the Talajanghas. Five groups of the great-souled Haihayas are famous. They were Vitihotras, Bhojas, Avantis, Tundirakas and the valiant Talajanghas. Vitihotra’s son was the king named Ananta. He had a son named Durjaya, who was the slayer of enemies. When he was the king, no objects were lost. Through his powers, the great king protected subjects. His wealth was never destroyed. Anything lost was regained. If an intelligent person describes the account of Kartavirya’s birth, his prosperity and wealth will increase. His *dharma* will be enhanced. According to his sacrifices and according to his donations, the lord of the earth obtained heaven.’

Chapter 108-1(108) (Jyamagha’s lineage)

The *rishis* asked, ‘Why did Kartavirya use his valour to burn down the great-souled Apava’s forest? We are asking you. Please tell us. We have heard that the *rajarshi* protected the subjects. Having protected in this way, why did he burn down a hermitage?’

Suta answered, ‘Aditya assumed the form of a *brahmana* and presented himself before Kartavirya. He said, “I am Aditya. There is no doubt that you will give me food so that my wishes are met.” The king replied, “O illustrious one! O Divakara! ³⁷⁰ Please tell me how you can be satisfied. What kind of food will I give you? After hearing, I will make the arrangements.” Surya said, “O supreme among those who donated! As food, give me everything that is immobile. I will be satisfied with that. O lord of the earth! There is nothing else that will satisfy me.” The king replied, “The

energy of a human is incapable of burning down everything that is immobile. O best among those who scorch! Therefore, I prostrate myself before you.” Aditya said, “Pleased with you, I will give you inexhaustible arrows that face every direction. When they are shot, they will blaze, full of my energy. Pierced by my energy, they will now dry up everything immobile. O lord of men! In an instant, I will dry up and reduce it to ashes.” The lord Aditya gave Arjuna arrows. Having obtained these, the king shot torrents of arrows from his bow and burnt down everything immobile—hermitages, villages, settlements of cattle, cities, beautiful forests, groves and gardens. The earth was scorched by Surya’s energy and became bereft of trees and grass.” During this period, Apava, the great *rishi*, was performing a sacrifice to the fire and had lived inside water for ten thousand years. With the vow completed, the immensely energetic store of austerities arose. The great *rishi* saw that Arjuna had burnt down his hermitage. As I have already described, in his rage, he cursed the *rajarshi*.’

‘Hear about the lineage of *rajarshi* Kroshtu. There were excellent men in it. Vrishni, the extender of the Vrishni lineage, was born in his lineage. Kroshtu had a single son, the greatly illustrious Vrijivan. Vrijivan’s son was Svahi, supreme among Svahavats. ³⁷¹ Svahi’s son, Rusheku, became the king and he was supreme among those who donate. Desiring a son, Rusheku controlled himself and performed a great sacrifice, at which, many kinds of *dakshina* were given. His son, Chitraratha, was born from this and he performed many kinds of deeds. Chitraratha had a brave son named Shashabindu, who performed sacrifices with large quantities of *dakshina*. His conduct was supreme among all those performed by *rajarshis*. He was a *chakravarti* with great spirits. He was immensely brave and had many offspring. An ancient *shloka* is sung about his lineage. “Shashabindu had ten thousand sons. They were prosperous and like him in form. They were extensive in wealth and energy.” Among these, six were important. They were immensely strong and performed many sacrifices. Shashabindu’s sons, who were kings, were Prithushrava, Prithuyasha, Prithukarma, Prithunjaya, Prithukirti and Prithudanta. Those who know about the Puranas praise Antara as Prithushrava’s son. Akshara’s ³⁷² son was Suyajna and Suyajna’s

son was Ushanas. Ushanas had *dharma* in his soul and obtained the earth. He performed one hundred horse sacrifices, with excellent *dakshina*. His son, Marutta, followed other *rajarshis*. Marutta's son is said to have been Virakambalabarhi. The learned Rukmakavacha was Kambalabarhi's son. Earlier, using his sharp arrows, Rukmakavacha killed many armoured archers in battle and obtained excellent prosperity. At a horse sacrifice, the immensely illustrious one donated wealth to *brahmanas*. King Rukmakavacha, the supreme slayer of enemy heroes, had five great-spirited and immensely strong sons. They were Rukmeshu, Prithurukma, Jyamagha and Hari. Their father established Parigha and Hari in Videha. Rukmeshu became the king and Prithurukma sought refuge with him.'

'Thus, defeated by them, King Jyamagha lived in a hermitage.³⁷³ He was serene. However, in that terrible forest, a *brahmana* opposed him. He picked up his bow, and on a chariot with a standard, went to a different country. Alone, the king went to Mekala, the forest of Mirika and Mount Rikshavan. Eventually, he went to Muktiman. Jyamagha had a wife named Shaibya. She was extremely powerful. Though he did not have a son, the king did not take another wife. He was victorious in a battle and obtained a maiden. Scared of his wife, the lord of men said, "This is your daughter-in-law." Thus addressed, she asked, "Where is the son that she should be a daughter-in-law?" He replied, "She will be the wife of the son who will be born." At this, Shaibya performed fierce austerities. Though she was aged, the virtuous and extremely fortunate one had a son named Vidarbha. Through that daughter-in-law, the prince had two learned sons — Kratha and Kaishika. Vidarbha had these two sons, who were brave and accomplished in fighting. Later, a third son, Lomapada, was born and he was extremely devoted to *dharma*. Lomapada's son was Babhru and Babhru's son was Akriti. Kaishika's son was Chedi³⁷⁴ and his descendants are the kings known as the Chedis. Kratha, Vidarbha's son, had a son named Kunti. Kunti's son was Dhrishta and Dhrishta was powerful in battle. Dhrishta's son was Nirvriti. He possessed *dharma* in his soul and was the slayer of enemy heroes. His son was Dasharha, immensely strong and brave. Dasharha's son was Vyoma. Vyoma's son is said to have been

Jimuta. Jimuta's son was Vikriti and Vikriti's son was Bhimaratha. Bhimaratha's son was Rathavara. He was always devoted to the *dharma* of making donations. He was good in conduct and devoted to learning. His son was Navaratha and Navaratha's son is said to have been Dasharatha. His son was Ekadasharatha and Ekadasharatha's son was Shakuni. His son was the archer Karambhaka and Karambhaka's son was Devarata. Devarata's son was the immensely illustrious king, Devakshatra. Devakshatra's son was Devana, who delighted *kshatriyas*. Devana's son was Madhu, and his son was Meghartha. His son was the immensely energetic Madhu,³⁷⁵ whose son was Puruvasu. Puruvasu's son was Purudvan, the excellent man. Purudvan and Bhadravati's son was Purudvaha. His wife was Aikshvaki and Sattva was her son. Sattva's son was Satvata, who possessed the qualities and extended the fame of the lineage. These are the descendants of the great-souled Jyamagha. If an intelligent person knows this, he has offspring and obtains *sayujya* with King Soma.'

Chapter 109-1(109) (The Vrishni lineage)

Suta said, ‘Through Koushalya, Satvata had extremely strong sons. They were Bhajamana, Bhaji, Divya, Vrishni, Devavridha, Andhaka and the famous Mahabhoja, who was devoted to the truth and to *brahmanas*. Hear in detail about the lineages of four.’ ³⁷⁶

‘Bhajamana’s son was Srinjaya. Srinjaya had two daughters, Bahyakaa and Upabahyakaa. In marriage, Srinjaya bestowed these two daughters on Bahyaka. These two sisters, his wives, gave birth to many sons. Bahyakaa, the daughter of Srinjaya, Bhajamana’s son, had Nimlochi, Kinkana, Dhrishti and Parapuranjaya as sons. Through Bahyakaa’s sister, ³⁷⁷ Ayutajit, Sahasrajit, Shatajit and others were born as sons.’

‘Among all of these, King Devavridha performed supreme austerities. “Let me have a son who possesses all the qualities.” Performing *yoga* in this way, he touched the waters of the river Parnasha. ³⁷⁸ Touched by the lord of men in this way, the fortunate and beloved river started to think. Immersed in thought, the excellent river arrived at a decision. “King Devavridha has not yet approached a woman who can bear him such a son, possessing all the qualities. Therefore, I should myself approach him now and observe that vow with him.” Such kinds of sentiments arose in her heart. Thinking in this way, she assumed the form of a maiden. She chose the king, and the lord of the earth also desired her. He was extensive in intelligence and energetic and she conceived through him. In the ninth month, the supreme among rivers delivered King Devavridha’s son, Babhru, the possessor of all the qualities. O *dvijas*! Those who know about the Puranas chant about the qualities of the great-souled Devavridha. “We have heard about it and seen it from a distance. Babhru is best among men and Devavridha is the equal of *devas*.” Babhru and Devavridha bestowed immortality on seventy thousand and sixty-five men.’ ³⁷⁹

‘Mahabhoja, the *maharatha* from the Satvata lineage, performed sacrifices and was the lord among donors. He was patient, famous and

learned, devoted to truth and *brahmanas*. His descendants were the extremely famous Bhojas, famous on earth.’

‘Vrishni ³⁸⁰ had two wives, Gandhari and Madri. Gandhari gave birth to Sumitra, who was a delight to his friends. Madri’s sons were Yudhajit, Midhva and the two excellent men, Anamitra and Shina. Anamitra’s son was Nighna. Nighna had two sons, Prasena and the immensely fortunate Satrajit. Surya was Satrajit’s friend, and he loved him like his own life. On one occasion, at the end of the night, the supreme among charioteers mounted his chariot and went to the banks of a water body to touch water and worship Ravi. Surya Vivasvat arose and stood in front of him. The illustrious lord manifested himself in a clear form with a disc that was full of energy. The king ³⁸¹ spoke to Vivasvat, who was standing in front of him. “O lord of shining bodies! O God! I see you in front of me, in your disc of energy, just as I always see you in the sky. What is special about this? O Vivasvat! What have I gained from you approaching me as a friend?” Hearing this, in privacy, the illustrious one took Syamantaka, the best of jewels, off from his neck and bound it around the king’s neck. The king was then able to see his form alone. ³⁸² On seeing this, he was pleased, and they conversed for a *muhurta*. As Vivasvat got ready to leave, Satrajit spoke to him again. “As a result of this excellent jewel, the world sees you in a form that possesses the complexion of the fire. O illustrious one! You should give it to me.” ³⁸³ At this, Bhaskara gave him the Syamantaka jewel. Wearing it, the lord of the earth entered the city. He astounded the city and his inner quarters. Out of affection, Satrajit, lord of men, gave that divine and excellent gem, named Syamantaka. As long as the jewel named Syamantaka was present in the kingdom, as desired, Parjanya showered down. There was no fear from disease. From Prasena, Govinda desired this gem, Syamantaka. ³⁸⁴ However, though he was capable of doing so, he did not seize it. On one occasion, adorned with it, Prasena went out on a hunt. For the sake of Syamantaka, he faced a terrible death from a lion. Jambavan, the king of bears, killed the lion. He seized the divine jewel and entered his own cave. The great ones among Vrishnis and Andhakas thought Krishna had done the deed, desiring the jewel. They suspected the lord of the

universe. The powerful one, the slayer of enemies, faced this false accusation. Unable to tolerate this, the illustrious one thought about it. He decided to search out Prasena. Along with a few citizens from the city who loved him, he followed Prasena's footsteps. He searched the supreme Mount Rikshavan and the excellent Mount Vindhya. After he was tired out from searching, the great-minded one saw the dead bodies of Prasena and his horse. However, he did not find the gem there. Then, not very far from Prasena's body, he saw the lion's dead body. Because of the footprints of the bear, he deduced that a bear had killed it. Following those footprints, Yadava ³⁸⁵ entered the bear's cave. Inside the extremely large cave, he heard a female voice. O *dvijas*! This was the nurse speaking to Jambavat's young son, using the Syamantaka gem to play with him and asking him not to cry. The nurse said, "Do not cry. The lion killed Prasena and Jambavat killed the lion. O delicate child! Do not weep. Here is Syamantaka." These words clearly emerged, and he quickly entered the cave. Near the cave, he saw fragments of Prasena. The illustrious one easily entered the bear's cave. He saw Jambavat, the king of bears, extensive in his intelligence. Inside the cave, Vasudeva fought with Jambavat. Govinda used his hands and fought for twenty-one days. When Krishna entered the cave, the others, with Vasudeva at the forefront, returned to Dvaravati and reported that Krishna had been killed. Meanwhile, Vasudeva defeated the immensely strong Jambavat and obtained Jambavati, the respected daughter of the king of the bears, from him. Jambavat was overwhelmed by the illustrious one's energy and quickly gave him the jewel. He also bestowed his daughter, Jambavati, on Vishvaksena. ³⁸⁶ Entreated by the king of bears and to clear himself of the taint, he accepted the Syamantaka jewel and emerged from the cave. In this way, he obtained the jewel and cleared his name. In an assembly of all the Satvatas, he gave the jewel to Satrajit. Madhusudana married the daughter, Jambavati. In this way, Madhusudana cleared himself of the false accusation. Krishna got rid of the false calumny he had been subjected to. A person who knows this, will never be touched by false accusations.'

'Satrajit had ten wives and ten thousand sons through them. Three of them are famous and Bhangakara was the eldest. Vatapati was brave and

Tapasvi was loved a lot. Through Viramati, Bhangakara had three daughters who possessed beauty and qualities. Satyabhama was excellent among women and Vratini was firm in her vows.³⁸⁷ Her father bestowed the ascetic lady on Krishna. Satrajit obtained the Syamantaka jewel from Krishna. Hearing this, Shatadhanva, descended from the Bhoja lineage desired it, as he had desired the unblemished Satyabhama. Akrura, desiring wealth, also desired Syamantaka. In the night, the immensely strong Shatadhanva killed Satrajit. Seizing the gem, he gave it to Akrura. Akrura, bull among men, accepted the gem and entered into an agreement. “This should not be known to anyone else. Even if Krishna assails both of us, there is no doubt that everyone in Dvaraka will be under my subjugation.” When her father was slain, the illustrious Satyabhama was afflicted with grief.³⁸⁸ She ascended a chariot and left for the city of Varanavata.³⁸⁹ She reached her husband’s side and shedding tears, miserably told him about what Bhoja Shatadhanva had done. With the Pandavas having been burnt, Hari offered oblations of water to them. He entrusted tasks connected with the welfare of the brothers to Satyaki.³⁹⁰ Madhusudana returned to Dvaraka swiftly. The prosperous one spoke these words to his elder brother, the wielder of the plough.³⁹¹ “The lion killed Prasena and Satrajit has been slain by Shatadhanva. O lord! Let us search out Syamantaka. I will own it. Let us quickly ascend a chariot and go and kill the immensely strong Bhoja. O mighty-armed one! Syamantaka will generally belong to all of you.” There was a tumultuous encounter between Bhoja and Krishna. Shatadhanva looked for Akrura in all directions. He did not seek to make peace between Bhoja and Janardana.³⁹² Because he was full of deceit, Akrura did not help Hridika’s son³⁹³, though he was capable. Afraid, his³⁹⁴ mind turned towards thoughts of running away. Bhoja possessed a famous horse named Hridaya and it could dash for one hundred *yojanas*. He fled on this divine mare, but Krishna fought with him. After one hundred *yojanas*, Hridaya tired and slowed down. Seeing that the chariot was gaining on him, Shatadhanva fled. O *dvijas*! Afflicted by exhaustion, the horse gave up its life, which headed upwards. Krishna spoke to Rama. “O mighty-armed one! You remain here. I discern a weakness in my horse too. I will pursue him on foot

and seize the gem Syamantaka.” Achyuta pursued Shatadhanva on foot. The one who knew about supreme weapons slew him in the groves of Mithila. But though he killed the immensely strong Bhoja, he did not find Syamantaka. When Krishna returned, the wielder of the plough told him, “Give me the gem.” Krishna replied, “I don’t have it.” Rama became full of anger and spoke to Janardana, shaming him repeatedly. “You have dishonoured me earlier too. I have tolerated it because you are my brother. May you be fortunate. I am leaving. I have nothing more to do with you, or with Dvaraka, or with the Vrishnis.” Rama, the destroyer of enemies, entered Mithila. The lord of Mithila honoured him and gave him all the objects of desire. During this time, the supremely intelligent one of the Babhru lineage collected all the diverse kinds of materials required and incessantly performed sacrifices.³⁹⁵ The gem was like a talisman, and he consecrated himself for the sacrifices to protect it. Gandi’s wise and great-minded descendant did this for the sake of Syamantaka.³⁹⁶ The great-souled one’s sacrifice is known as *Akrura yajna*. All the many kinds of *dakshina* and all the diverse objects of pleasure were offered to *brahmanas*. King Duryodhana went to the lord who was in Mithila.³⁹⁷ From Balabhadra, he learnt the divine art of fighting with the mace. With the Vrishni and Andhaka *maharathas*, the great-souled Krishna placated Rama and brought him back to Dvaraka.’

‘Akrura, the powerful bull among men, arrived there with the Andhakas and, in a battle, killed Shatrughna, along with Bandhumata. These two extremely strong ones were the sons of Bhangakara and Naraa, Suyajna’s daughter. Since Shatrughna and Bandhumata were born as foremost members of the Andhaka lineage, Krishna wasn’t happy when Bhangakara’s sons were killed. However, fearing a clash among the kin, he ignored this. When Akrura left, the chastiser of Paka ceased to shower down.³⁹⁸ When it did not rain down, the kingdom faced many kinds of difficulties. The Kukuras and Andhakas pacified Akrura. When Danapati³⁹⁹ returned to Dvaravati again, the one with the thousand eyes⁴⁰⁰ showered down and there were waterbodies in Kuksha.⁴⁰¹ O bulls among sages! To please the prosperous Vaasudeva, Akrura bestowed his sister, revered for her good

conduct, on him. Through his *yoga*, Krishna discerned that the jewel was with the descendant of the Babhru lineage. During an assembly, Janardana spoke to Akrura. Krishna said, “O lord! You have the gem, supreme among jewels, in your possession. O one who deserves honours! Give it to me. Otherwise, do not show me false signs of honour. For sixty years, my rage against you has been increasing. After this great period of time has elapsed, you must show me proper respect.” Thus, addressed by Krishna in the assembly of all the Satvatas, with difficulty, the immensely intelligent one from the Babhru lineage gave him the gem. The scorcher of enemies received it from Babhru’s hands in this straightforward way. However, cheerful and content in his mind, Krishna again returned the gem to Babhru. Having obtained the supreme gem Syamantaka from Krishna’s hands, Gandini’s son tied it around his neck. ⁴⁰² He was as radiant as the one with the rays. ⁴⁰³ If a person knows this account about the false accusation and about how the excellent name was cleared, he never suffers from false accusations.’

‘Anamitra’s son was Shini, the youngest among those of the Vrishni lineage. ⁴⁰⁴ His son was Satyaka, who was devoted to the truth and truthful in speech. Satyaka’s son was Yuyudhana Satyaki. His son was Bhuti. Bhuti’s son was Yugandhara, known as Bhoutya. Madri’s son was Yudhajit and Yudhajit’s son was Vrishni. Vrishni had two sons, Shvaphalka and Chitraka. Shvaphalka had *dharma* in his soul. Therefore, wherever the great king happened to be, there was no fear of disease. Nor was there fear of drought. O excellent *dvijas*! On one occasion, the chastiser of Paka did not rain down in the kingdom of the lord and king of Kashi for three years. He honoured Shvaphalka greatly and made him reside there. When Shvaphalka lived there, the chastiser of Paka showered down. Shvaphalka obtained the daughter of the king of Kashi as a wife. Every day, she used to give a cow to a *brahmana*. So, her name was Gandini. ⁴⁰⁵ She had lived for many hundreds of years in her mother’s womb. When she resided in the womb and wasn’t born, her father spoke to her. “O fortunate one! Be born quickly. Why are you remaining there?” From within the womb, the daughter replied, “Donate a cow every day. If you do this for three years, I will

emerge from the womb.” Thus addressed, her father agreed and fulfilled her wishes. Shvaphalka’s son is said to have been Akrura. He donated and sacrificed. He was brave and learned and loved guests. He was generous in giving *dakshina*. There were also Upamangu, Mangu, Mridura, Arimejaya, Giriraksha, Yaksha, Shatrughna, Arimardana, Dharmavridha, Sukarmana, Gandhamada, Avaha and Prativaha. ⁴⁰⁶ There was a beautiful daughter too, Vasudevaa. Through Ugrasena, Akrura had two sons who were the delight of the lineage. They were Devavan and Upadeva and they resembled *devas*. Chitraka’s sons were Prithu, Viprithu, Ashvagriva, Ashvavaha, Suparshvaka, Gaveshana, Arishtanemi, Ashvasya, Suvarma, Varmabhrit, Abhumi and Bahubhumi. There were two daughters, Shravishtha and Shravana. Through the daughter of the king of Kashi, ⁴⁰⁷ Satvata had four sons—Kukura, Bhajamana, Shuchi and Kambalabarhi. Kukura’s son was Vrishni and Vrishni’s son was Kapotaroma. Kapotarama had Viloma as a son. He had a learned son named Andhaka, who was Tumburu’s ⁴⁰⁸ friend. He was famous under the name of Chandanodakadundubhi. His son was Abhijit and Abhijit’s son was Punarvasu. For the sake of a son, the excellent man ⁴⁰⁹ performed a horse sacrifice. At the time of an *atiratra* rite, Punarvasu arose in the middle of the assembly. Therefore, he was learned and knew about *dharma*. He donated and performed sacrifices. A set of twins was born to Abhijit too. They were extremely intelligent and were famous as Ahuka and Ahuki. In this connection, a *shloka* is chanted about Ahuka. “He possessed ten thousand chariots that thundered like the clouds. They possessed quivers, axle-trees, standards and bumpers. There was no one who did not speak the truth. ⁴¹⁰ There was no one who did not perform a sacrifice or donate thousands. There was no one who was impure or did not have *dharma* in his soul.” We have heard that Ahuka’s son was Dhriti. ⁴¹¹ The unmatched Ahuka marched in the eastern direction, surrounded by eight million young and unmatched horses. Bhoja had a greater number of elephants and there were twenty-one thousand gold and silver harnesses to be tied on them. There were as many thousands as possible in the northern direction also. As Bhoja, the lord of the earth, advanced, there was the

sound of bells tinkling. Ahuka bestowed his sister, Ahuki, on the lord of Avanti.’

‘Through the daughter of the king of Kashi, Ahuka had two sons. Through the daughter of the king of Kashi, Ahuka had two sons—Devaka and Ugrasena. They were like those born as sons of the Gods. Devaka had four sons who were like the residents of heaven—Devavan, Upadeva, Sudeva and Devarakshita. They had seven sisters who were bestowed on Vasudeva—Dhritadevaa, Upadevaa, Devarakshitaa, Shridevaa, Shantidevaa, Sahadevaa and the youngest and seventh, Devaki, who was beautiful to behold. Ugrasena had nine sons and Kamsa was the eldest. The others were Nyagrodha, Sunama, Kankashanku, Subhumi, Sutanu, Rashtrapala, Yuddhatusta and Tushtiman. They had five sisters—Kamsaa, Kamsavati, Sutanu, Rashtrapali and the beautiful Kankaa. Ugrasena and his large number of offspring, born in the Kukura lineage, have been described. A man who sustains the account of this infinitely energetic Kukura lineage in his heart, obtains an extensive lineage with a large number of sons.’

‘Bhajamana’s son was Viduratha, foremost among charioteers.⁴¹² Viduratha’s son was Shura, and he became the king of kings. Shura had sons who were extremely strong. They were Vata, Nivata, Shonita, Shvetavahana, Shami, Gadavarma and Nidanta, who conquered enemies. Shami’s son was Pratikshatra and Pratikshatra’s son was Svayambhoja. Svayambhoja’s son was Hridika. Hridika had ten sons who were terrible in valour. Kritavarma was the eldest and Shatadhanva was in the middle. There were also Devabahu, Subahu, Bhishak, Shvetaratha, Sudanta, Adhidanta, Kanaka and Kanakodbhava. Devabahu had a learned son, Kambalabarhisha. His sons were Asamouja and the famous Susamouja. Since Asamouja possessed no sons, Krishna gave him Suchandra and Vasurupa. These are said to have been the Andhakas. If a person constantly recites this lineage of Andhakas, there is no doubt that he obtains an extensive lineage for himself.’

‘Through Ashmaki, Shura had Devamidhusa as a son. Through Marishi, Shura had ten sons, the Bhojas. The mighty-armed Vasudeva was born first. As soon as he was born, the sound of a *dundubhi* was heard in the

firmament. The great sound of *anakas* was also heard in the firmament. ⁴¹³ There was a great shower of flowers over Shura's house. In the entire world of humans and all of earth, there was no one who was his equal in beauty. The foremost among men was as handsome as the moon. After him were born Devabhaga, Devashrava, Anadhrishti, Vrika, Nandana, Srinjaya, Shyama, Shamika and Gandusha. There were five beautiful sisters—Prithaa, Shrutadevaa, Shrutakirti, Shrutashravaa and Rajadhidevi. These five were the mothers of brave warriors. Shura gave his daughter, Prithaa, to Kuntibhoja. ⁴¹⁴ That is how Prithaa became Kuntibhoja's daughter and is known as Kunti. Pandu, the foremost among Kuru heroes, got her as a wife. Prithaa gave birth to three sons who were like the fire in their energy. They were brave, like Shakra in their valour. In this world, they were unmatched *atirathas*. ⁴¹⁵ Through Dharma, she had Yudhishtira as a son. She had Vrikodara through Maruta and Dhananjaya through Indra. These are the sons Prithaa gave birth to. It is known that Madravati gave birth to the two Ashvins. These were Nakula and Sahadeva, who possessed beauty, spirit and qualities. Shrutadevaa married Vriddhadharma, the lord of Karusha, Shrutadevaa gave birth to the brave and immensely strong Dantavakra. Through the king of Kekaya, Shrutakirti gave birth to the powerful Santardana. There were two other immensely strong sons, Chekitana and Brihatkshatra. The sons of the lord of Avanti ⁴¹⁶ were the two immensely strong brothers, Vinda and Anuvinda. Through *rajarshi* Damaghosha of Chedi, Shrutashravaa had Shishupala as a son. He was famous for his manliness. In an earlier life, he had been Dashagriva, ⁴¹⁷ the afflicter of enemies. He had been Vaishravana's younger brother and Kumbhakarna had been his younger brother.'

'Thirteen beautiful women were Vasudeva's wives. They were Pouravi, Rohini, Madiraa, Bhadravaishakhi and Sunamni as the fifth. There were also Sahadevaa, Shantidevaa, Shridevaa, Devarakshitaa, Dhritadevaa, Upadevaa and Devaki as the seventh. There were also two attendants, Sugandhaa and Vanaraji. ⁴¹⁸ Rohini and Pouravi were Bahlika's younger sisters. Anakadundubhi loved his immensely fortunate eldest wife. ⁴¹⁹ Rohini gave birth to eight sons. The eldest was Rama. ⁴²⁰ The others were

Sarana, Shatha, Durdama, Damana, Shubhra, Pindaraka and Kushitaka. There was also a daughter, named Chitraa. Rama had two famous sons, Nishatha and Ulmuka. Rama had other sons too—Parshvi, Parshvamardi, Shishu, Satyadhriti, Mandabahya, Girika, Giri, Shulkagulma, Atigulma and Daridranta. ⁴²¹ There were five daughters too. Listen to their names. They were Archishmati, Sunandaa, Surasaa, Suvachaa and Shatabalaa. These were Sarana's daughters. Bhadrashva, Bhadrugupti, Bhadravishta, Bhadrabahu, Bhadraratha, Bhadrakalpa, Suparshvaka, Kirtiman and Rohitashva were Shatha's sons. Abhibhuta was Durdama's son. ⁴²² These are described as the ones from Rohini's lineage. Through Madiraa, Vasudeva had the sons Nanda, Upananda, Mitra, Kukshimitra, Bala, Chitra, Upachitra, Kritaka, Tushti and Pushti. Bhadraa had four famous and immensely strong sons—Upabimba, Bimba, Sattvadanta and Mahoujas. ⁴²³ Through Vaishali, Shouri had an excellent son, Koushika. Through Devaki, Shouri had six sons—Sushena, Kirtiman, Udarshi, Bhadrasena, Rijudaya as the fifth and Bhadradeva as the sixth. Kamsa killed all of them. When this was the state of affairs, Vishnu Prajapati, the protector of the worlds, manifested himself in the form of the long-lived Krishna. Subhadraa, pleasant in speech, was born after Krishna. Subhadraa caused delight to the Vrishni lineage and was also known as Krishnaa. Through the charioteer Partha, Subhadraa gave birth to Abhimanyu. Through his immensely fortunate seven wives, Vasudeva had brave sons. Listen to their names. Initially, through Sahadevaa, he had two brave sons. Through Shantidevaa, Shouri's son was Janastamba, the extender of the lineage. The great-souled Agavaha was born through Vrikadevi. Shridevi gave birth to a son named Mandaka. Devarakshitaa's two sons were Upasanga and Vasu. Kamsa killed ten such sons. The great-souled sons, Vijaya, Rochana, Varddhamana and Devala were born through Shishiravati. Through the seventh wife, Devaki, had Sunama as a son. There was also the immensely fortunate Gaveshana, who was colourful when he fought in a battle. O *dvijas*! Earlier, when he was wandering around in gardens and groves, through the *vaishya* lady Shraddhadevi, Shouri had the undecaying Koushika as a son. Shouri also married Sugandhi and Vanaraji. Sugandhi had two sons, Pundra and Kapila.

Pundra became a king, while Kapila left for the forest. Vasudeva had other strong and brave sons too. The first was a Nishadha named Jara and he was an archer. Devabhaga had the famous Mahabhaga as a son. The one born through Devashrava is said to have been revered by the learned. Through Ashmaki, Anadhrishti had the illustrious Shraddhadeva as a son. He was immensely strong. He killed enemies and all the enemies withdrew. Shraddhadeva had a son who was famous as a Nishadha. This was the immensely fortunate Ekalavya, who was reared by Nishadhas. Gandusha has no sons. To satisfy him, Krishna gave him his sons, Charudeshna and Samba. They were accomplished in the use of weapons and were praised for their qualities. Nandana's two sons were Ranti and Rantipala. Vrika had no sons. The powerful Vasudeva Shouri gave him the brave Soumi and Koushika as sons. Srinjaya's two sons were Dhanu and Viraja. Shyama had no sons. Shamika abhorred the idea of being a Bhoja and left for the forest. He became a *rajarshi*. If a person controls himself through vows and reads this account about Krishna's birth, or makes *brahmanas* hear it, he obtains great happiness.'

'The lord of *devas*, the immensely energetic Krishna, was initially Lord Narayana Prajapati. In his pastimes, he was born as a human. Because of their austerities, the lotus-eyed one was born to Devaki and Vasudeva. The four-armed one was born, full of divine prosperity and beauty. Bhagavan *yogi* manifested himself as Krishna, in human form. The Lord, Narayana, is not manifested. But he assumed a manifest form and signs. Narayana is imperishable, but he assumed a perishable form. The eternal divinity, Narayana, assumed the form of Hari.⁴²⁴ He is the original Purusha, who created Prajapati from a lotus. The one who was Aditi's son became a descendant of the Yadava lineage. The divinity known as Vishnu assumed the form of Shakra's younger brother.⁴²⁵ Aditi sought the favours of the Lord, for the sake of a son. To slay the enemies of the Gods, the *daityas*, *danavas* and *rakshasas*, he was born in Yayati's lineage, as the son of the intelligent Vasudeva. Since the Lord, Narayana, was born there, that lineage became sacred. The oceans trembled and the mountains shook. When Janardana was born, the fires of *agnihotra* sacrifices blazed. Auspicious

winds blew and the dust was quietened. When Janardana was born, the luminous bodies became even more radiant. The *nakshatra* was named Abhijit and the night was named Jayanti. When Janardana was born, the *muhurta* was named Vijaya. The unmanifest and eternal Lord, Hari Narayana, became Krishna. Bhagavan was born and deluded subjects through his *maya*. The lord of the Gods showered down flowers from the sky. Along with the *gandharvas*, *maharshis* presented themselves in their thousands. They praised Madhusudana with auspicious words of benediction. Adhokshaja⁴²⁶ was born as Vasudeva's son in the night. His own divine sign, the *srivatsa* mark, was on his chest.⁴²⁷ Seeing this, Vasudeva said, "O Lord! Please withdraw this form. O son! I am scared of Kamsa. That is the reason I am saying this. My sons, your elders, were extraordinary to behold and were killed by him." Hearing Vasudeva's words, the Lord withdrew his form. He permitted his father to convey him to Nandagopa's home, who was staying at the time in Ugrasena's residence.⁴²⁸ He handed him over to Yashoda. Yashoda had conceived at the same time as Devaki. Yashoda was Nandagopa's wife and Nanda was the lord of *gopas*. On the night when the Lord Krishna was born in the Vrishni lineage, on the same night, Yashoda gave birth to a daughter. The immensely illustrious Vasudeva protected her. He handed over the son to Yashoda and accepted the daughter himself. He handed him over and told Nandagopa, "Please protect him. He is your son and will bring everything auspicious to the Yadavas. He is my son and Devaki's and will take away all hardships." Accordingly, Anakadundubhi informed Ugrasena's son about the daughter. "O Kamsa! A daughter, bearing the auspicious signs, has been born to your sister." Kamsa did not know that a son had been born. The evil-souled one was delighted and released her.⁴²⁹ "There is no doubt that she is my daughter, just as she is yours. O mighty-armed one! I will not kill her. Go wherever you want, with her." The daughter grew up in the home of the Vrishnis and was worshipped. Rejoicing, Devaki reared the Goddess, like a son. It is said that because of destiny, for the sake of Prajapati Krishna, she was born in this way. Ekadashaa was born for Keshava's protection.⁴³⁰ The

Yadavas worshipped her with single-minded attention. She was the one who protected Krishna, the lord of *devas*, possessor of a divine form.'

The *rishis* asked, 'Why did the Bhoja, King Kamsa, kill Vasudeva's infant sons? You should explain this to us.'

Suta replied, 'Hear about the reason why Kamsa killed Anakadundubhi's new-born sons as soon as they were born. However, his intelligence failed. It was because of this fear that the mighty-armed Krishna was exiled as soon as he was born. Purushottama Govinda grew up with the cattle. At the time of the marriage of Devaki and the intelligent Vasudeva, Kamsa acted as a charioteer. He was the heir apparent then. At the time, a divine voice, uttered by someone, was heard from the sky. It mentioned Kamsa by name and all the people witnessed it. "O Kamsa! Because of your affection towards her, you are bearing her in your chariot. However, her eighth child will be the cause of your death." Hearing these words, Kamsa was distressed, though all his intelligence would be in vain. He drew out his sword, desiring to kill the maiden. But the mighty-armed and powerful Vasudeva spoke to him. Since he was a well-wisher and out of his affection, he addressed Kamsa, Ugrasena's son. "A person born as a *kshatriya* never kills a woman. O descendant of the Yadava lineage! I have thought of a means. O lord of the earth! As soon as the eighth child is born to her, I will hand him over to you. You can do with him whatever you want. O one extensive in donations! But you should not do what you wish now. Or, if you so desire, I will bring all the children to you. O best among men! That voice cannot be false." Addressed and entreated in this way, he accepted the words at the time. On getting his wife back, Vasudeva rejoiced. Kamsa, evil in his deeds, killed her sons. But his intelligence failed him.'

The *rishis* asked, 'Who is this Vasudeva? Who is the illustrious Devaki? Who is Nandagopa? Who is the immensely illustrious Yashoda? Vishnu was born and they addressed him as a son. In whose womb was he born? Who reared him?'

Suta replied, 'Purusha became Kashyapa and his beloved ⁴³¹ became Aditi. Kashyapa was born as Brahma's portion and Aditi as that of Prithivi's. ⁴³² Nanda was known as Drona and Yashoda was Dharaa. ⁴³³ The

mighty-armed one ensured that Devaki's wishes would flourish. Therefore, the divinity entered a human body and roamed around on earth. With *yoga* in his *atman*, he confounded all beings with his *yoga* and his *maya*. When *dharma* was destroyed, Vishnu was himself born in the lineage of the Vrishnis. He acted so as to establish *dharma* and destroy *asuras*. Rukmini was the daughter of the king of Vidharbha, Satyaa was Nagnajit's daughter. Satyabhamaa was Satrajit's daughter. There were Jambavati and Rohini.⁴³⁴ There was Shaibyaa. There were sixteen thousand other blessed queens. There are said to be fourteen categories of *apsaras* in heaven.⁴³⁵ Shakra consulted the *devas* and sent the foremost ones to earth. So that they might become Vaasudeva's wives, they were born in the residences of kings. These were the immensely fortunate and famous wives of Vishvaksena. Rukmini gave birth to Pradyumna, Charudeshna, Sudeva, Sharabha, Charu, Charubhadra, Bhadracharu and Charuvidya. She also had a daughter named Charumati. Satyabhamaa's sons were Sanu, Bhanu, Aksha, Rohita, Mantravid, Jara, Andhaka, Tamrachakra, Soubhari and Jarandhara. Through the one with Garuda on his banner,⁴³⁶ four sisters were also born to them. They were Bhanu, Soubharikaa, Tamraparni and Jarandhara. Now hear about Jambavati's children. The sons were famous as Bhadra, Bhadragupta, Bhadrachitra and Bhadrabahu. The daughters were famous as Bhadravati and Sambodhini. These are known as Jambavati's children. It is said that Sangramjit, Shatajit and Sahasrajit are the sons of Sudevi and Vishvaksena. The children of Nagnajit's daughter were Vrika, Vrikashva, Vrikajit, Mitrabahu and Sunitha. There was also the beautiful lady, Vrijini. Understand that there were thousands of such sons. The number of Vaasudeva's sons is enumerated as one million. Among them, eighty thousand were brave and accomplished in fighting. Janardana's lineage has been accurately described to you.'

'Brihati was Puru's wife and so were Sumadhyaa and Sugati. Brihati was the daughter of the great-souled Brihaduktha, descended from Shini. She had three famous sons, who were the ornaments of assemblies. They were Ananda, Kanaka and Shveta. There was also a daughter, Shvetaa. The sons of Agavaha were Chitra, Shura, Chitraratha and Chitrasena. There is also

said to have been a daughter, Chitravati. Tumba⁴³⁷ had two sons, Tumba and Tumbavarcha. Upasanga's two sons were Vajrara and Kshipra. Gaveshana's two sons were Bhurindrasena and Bhuri. Sudhanu was the son of Yudhishtira's daughter.⁴³⁸ Through the princess of Kashi, Samba had five spirited sons. These five are described as brave and like the Gods, they were naturally devoted to the truth. The great-souled Yadavas had three crores of grandsons. All those in the lineage, and the entire lineage, followed the lordship and commands of Vishnu. Gods and humans are also bound by his commands. The immensely strong *asuras* were killed in battles between *devas* and *asuras*. They were then born as humans and harassed humans. He was born in the Yadava lineage to destroy them. Hundreds of great-souled Yadavas were also born in that lineage. This was the Vrishni lineage, described briefly and in detail. If a person desires fame and success, he should recite it.'

Chapter 110-1(110) (In conclusion, the praise)

Suta said, 'I will describe the human nature of *devas*. Listen. The five brave ones in the lineage are described as Samkarshana, Vaasudeva, Pradyumna, Samba and Aniruddha. The *saptarshis*, Kubera, Yajna, Manivara, Shaluki, Narada, the learned Dhanvantari, Nandi, Mahadeva, Salankayana and the original divinity, Vishnu, are *devas*.'⁴³⁹

The *rishis* asked, 'What was the reason for Vishnu being born? How many manifestations did he have? How many will be there in the future? How many other manifestations of the great-souled one are there? Why is he repeatedly born as a human, in lineages of *brahmanas* and *kshatriyas*? We are asking you this. Please tell us. We wish to hear in detail about all of the intelligent Krishna's deeds. He is the slayer of enemies. Please tell us properly. In the due order, tell us about the lord's manifestations and deeds. O father!⁴⁴⁰ What was his nature? You should tell us that. Bhagavan Vishnu is the slayer of the enemies of the Gods. Born in Vasudeva's lineage, why did the intelligent one become Vaasudeva? Why did he give up the sacred

world of the *devas*, where he was surrounded by the immortals and ornamented by the performers of auspicious deeds? Why did he appear in the world of mortals? Hari gave birth to Dhatri, ⁴⁴¹ who is the origin of *devas* and humans. With his divine *atman*, why did he enter a human form? He is the one who makes the minds of humans revolve and function. He is supreme among those who wield the *chakra*. Why did he resolve to be born as a human? At all times, he is the one who protects and preserves the universe. Why did Lord Vishnu go to earth and become a *gopa*? The elements are in his *atman*, and he is the one who creates and preserves the great elements. He is the womb of prosperity. How did he appear in the womb of a woman who walked around on earth? One by one, he conquered the worlds and bestowed that prosperity on the residents of heaven. He assumed the form with the three strides and following that path, established the universe. ⁴⁴² Having conquered the earth, the supreme among Gods handed it over to the Gods. In earlier times, there was the immensely valiant *daitya*, Hiranyakashipu. Assuming the form of a lion, he tore his body into two parts. ⁴⁴³ In earlier times, the lord assumed the form of the Ourva Samvartaka fire. ⁴⁴⁴ Stationed in Patala, inside the ocean, he drank up the oblations of water. The divinity has one thousand feet. He has a thousand rays and a thousand forms. From one *yuga* to another *yuga*, the divinity is said to possess one thousand heads. His navel was like *arani* and the grandfather's residence originated from that. At that time, the world had become a single ocean. He emerged from a lotus, but not from any mud. ⁴⁴⁵ In the Tarakamaya battle, he is the one who killed *daityas*. He assumed a form that had all the *devas* in it. He held every kind of weapon. Kalanemi was intoxicated because of his great strength but was brought down by him. ⁴⁴⁶ In the northern part of the ocean of milk, there is an ocean of *amrita*. Enveloping everything in great darkness, in his eternal *yoga*, that is where he lies down. Earlier, Aditi became an *arani* for Gods. Through divine austerities, she attracted him to her womb, along with Shakra. ⁴⁴⁷ This caused severe hardships and restrictions to the wombs of *daitya* women. He created positions for the worlds. Having created these worlds, he made the *daityas* seek refuge in the water. He created heaven for *devas* and made the

radiant Puruhuta ⁴⁴⁸ the lord of Gods. He established the norms for *garhapatya*, the rites for *anvaharya* and *ahavaniya* fires. ⁴⁴⁹ He established the altar, *kusha*, *shruva*, *prokshaniya*, ⁴⁵⁰ *shruti* texts and *avabhrita*. To offer shares of *havya* in sacrifices, he created *rishis*. He arranged *havya* for Gods and *kavya* for ancestors. For enjoyment, he created rules for sacrifices. In the rites of sacrifices, he is Yajna personified. He created ancillaries for the sacrifice—sacrificial post, kindling, *shruva*, *soma*, *pavitra*, *paridhi*, materials offered at a sacrifice, sacrificial fires, *sadasyas*, *yajamanas*, *ashvamedhas*, excellent *kratus*, wonderful *rajasuyas*, rites for Parameshthi, *udgattris* and other things. Through these, he nurtured sacrifices and the worlds. ⁴⁵¹ He laid down *kshana*, *nimesha*, *kashtha*, *kalaa*, the three periods of time, *muhruta*, *tithi*, *masa*, *dina*, *samvatsara*, *ritu* and the right conjunctions. ⁴⁵² He determined the three and the three kinds of proof. ⁴⁵³ He decided on lifespan, the field, strength, duration, beauty and handsomeness, intelligence, wealth, bravery and skill in the sacred texts. ⁴⁵⁴ He fixed the three, the three *varnas*, the three worlds, the three kinds of learning, the three fires, the three periods of time, the three kinds of tasks, the three *matras* and the three *gunas*. He created the lords of the worlds, along with their tasks. He created all the categories of beings. His *atman* exists in all the categories of beings. Using his *yoga*, in advance, he fixes the moments for his engaging in pastimes. He is the leader for comings and goings. Ishvara is present everywhere, in many kinds of ways. For those who are full of *dharma*, he is the destination. Those who are evil doers cannot reach him. He is the origin of the four *varnas*. He is the one who protects the four *varnas*. He is the one who knows the four kinds of knowledge. ⁴⁵⁵ He is the refuge of the four *ashramas*. He is the space between the directions, space, earth, water, wind, fire, both the sun and the moon, the lord of luminous bodies, *yugas* and those who roam around in the night. The *shruti* texts speak of him as the supreme divinity. The *shruti* texts speak of him as the supreme austerity. He is spoken of as the one who is beyond darkness. He is the *paramatman*. He is the divinity who existed before the Adityas. He is the lord who destroys *daityas*. When it is the end of a *yuga*, he is the one who destroys. He is the one who destroys the worlds. He is the bridge. He

establishes ordinances for the worlds. For those who are middling in their rites, he is the sacrifice. Those who know the *Vedas* know that he is the one who should be known. He is the lord of all those who possess power in their *atmans*. He assumes the form of the moon. He assumes the form of fire in beings. Among those who are radiant, he is the fire. Among human beings, he assumes the form of Manu. Among those who are ascetics, he assumes the form of austerities. Among those who possess good conduct, he is humility. Among those who are energetic, he is the energy. Among those who have forms, he is the form. Among those who possess movement, he is the movement. He is the origin of space and wind. In the wind, he is *prana*. He is fire. *Devas* owe their breath of life to fire. Madhusudana is the *prana* in fire. He assumes the form of the essence in blood. It is said that flesh originates from blood. It is said that fat originates from flesh and bone results from fat. Marrow originates from bone and semen results from marrow. The root cause behind conception is the act of semen being mixed with bodily fluids. Water originates first and this is spoken of as Soumya *rashi*.⁴⁵⁶ It is known that the foetus results from stone and this is known to be the second *rashi*.⁴⁵⁷ It is known that semen possesses the essence of *soma*, and the menstrual flow possesses the essence of fire. What results follow these two essences and the moon, and the fire are present in semen. Semen belongs to the category of *kapha* and the menstrual blood belongs to the category of *pitta*.⁴⁵⁸ *Kapha* is established in the heart and *pitta* is established in the navel. The heart is located in the middle of the body and is described as the location of the mind. The navel is located in the stomach and the divinity of the fire⁴⁵⁹ is established there. The mind is known as Prajapati and *kapha* is thought of as Soma. *Pitta* is thought of as Agni. The essence of the universe is based on Agni and Soma. In this way, like a jujube fruit, the foetus develops.⁴⁶⁰ When wind enters, there is union with the *paramatman*. The wind exists in five forms in the body and the foetus grows. These are *prana*, *apana*, *samana*, *udana* and *vyana*.⁴⁶¹ As the foetus develops, *prana* circles around, as the *paramatman*. *Apana* develops the lower half of the body, *udana* develops the other half of the body. *Vyana* spreads and *samana* is in every joint. As a result of the elements, the senses

of perception originate. Earth, wind, space, water and fire as the fifth—these are established in all the senses and perform their respective functions. The physical body is said to have the nature of the earth, *prana* the nature of the wind. The pores have the nature of space, and the liquid flows have the nature of water. Fire is present in the eyes. Thus, the abodes are said to be named after these. In this way, all the material objects are gathered through the functioning of semen. The eternal Purusha is alone the one who created everything. He is imperishable. How did Vishnu come to be a man in this world? O intelligent one! This is our doubt. This is a great wonder. He is the movement behind everything that moves. How did he assume a human body? In the due order, we wish to hear about Vishnu's deeds. Vishnu is a great wonder. Even the lords of *devas* speak of him in that way. O immensely intelligent one! Please tell us about Vishnu's origin. Please describe what is said to be wonderful. The account brings happiness. He is famous for his strength and energy. How did the great-souled one manifest himself? Once manifested, his deeds were wonderful. In this world, he is spoken of as *sattva*.'

Suta replied, 'I will describe to you the great-souled one's manifestation, about how Bhagavan, great in austerities, was born among humans. As a result of the sin of killing Bhrigu's wife, Bhrigu cursed him that he would become human. To accomplish the tasks of *devas*, he is born at the end of *yugas*. Vishnu's body is divine. Listen to my words. In the course of time, the *dharma* of *yugas* becomes lax and contrary. To establish *dharma*, the lord is born among humans. This was because of Bhrigu's curse and because of what *devas* and *asuras* had done.'

The *rishis* asked, 'How did this conduct come about, as a result of what the *devas* and *asuras* had done? We wish to know about what the *devas* and *asuras* did, and how.'

Suta answered, 'I will describe the conduct of *devas* and *asuras* accurately to you. Listen. At first, the *daitya* Hiranyakashipu used to rule over the three worlds. In due course, Bali was again instated in the kingdom of the three worlds. There was great friendship between *devas* and *asuras*. For a complete period of ten *yugas*, there were no disturbances in the

universe. Both *devas* and *asuras* followed the commands of those two. However, when Bali was bound, ⁴⁶² an extremely terrible conflict started. This caused great and terrible destruction among *devas* and *asuras*. There were many battles over the *dvipas*. In Varaha *kalpa*, there are said to have been twelve battles, ending with Shandamarka. ⁴⁶³ I will state their names briefly. Listen attentively. The first involved Narasimha and the second involved Vamana. The third involved Varaha ⁴⁶⁴ and the fourth was when the ocean was churned for *amrita*. The fifth was the extremely terrible Tarakamaya battle. The sixth was Adibaka and the seventh is described as the one over Tripura. The eighth was Andhakara and the ninth is described as Dhvaja. The tenth was over Vritra and the next is described as the terrible Halahala. After this, it is said that there was the terrible Kolahala. Narasimha killed *daitya* Hiranyakashipu. Vamana bound Bali and covered the worlds in three strides. Hiranyaksha was immensely strong, with great spirits. He was unvanquished in battle and repulsed the *devas*. Varaha killed him in a duel and used his tusks to slice the *daitya* into two. In the course of churning the ocean for *amrita*, Indra defeated Prahlada in a battle. Virochana was Prahlada's son and constantly sought to kill Indra. In the Tarakamaya battle, Indra used his valour to slay him. From Bhava, Jambha obtained the boon of special *astras* and the boon that he could not be killed. He was killed in the sixth battle, when Vishnu permeated Shakra. After this, *devas* became incapable of tolerating those who were against the *devas*. In the battle of Tripura, Tryambaka ⁴⁶⁵ killed all the *danavas*. In the Andhakara battle, *daityas* and *asuras* were defeated by *devas* and humans and merged with the ancestors. ⁴⁶⁶ All the *danavas* gathered together and joined Vritra. With Vishnu aiding him and enhancing his strength, the great Indra killed him. Viprachitti knew about *yoga* and had a standard made out of *maya*. In the battle of Dhvaja ⁴⁶⁷ the great Indra entered and targeted these standards, killing him and his younger brother. All the *daityas* and *danavas* gathered together again. Surrounded by all the *devas*, Vrisha ⁴⁶⁸ defeated them in the Halahala battle. In the battle of Kolahala, Raji was surrounded by the Gods and defeated all the *daityas*. In the *avabhritha* of the sacrifice, Shanda and Marka were defeated by *devas*. These are the twelve battles that occurred

between *devas* and *asuras*. They caused destruction among Gods and *asuras* and were inauspicious to subjects. Hiranyakashipu was king and lord of the three worlds for one hundred million, one hundred and eighty thousand and one hundred and forty-four years. In the course of time, Bali was king for one hundred and three million and sixty-thousand years. Until he was defeated, along with the *asuras*, Prahlada reigned over the kingdom for exactly the same duration as Bali. These immensely energetic ones were the three famous Indras of *asuras*. The *daityas* were instated for a complete period of ten *yugas*.'

'For a period of ten *yugas*, the kingdom was then cursed by Shukra. ⁴⁶⁹ Bali's three worlds were eagerly grabbed by the great Indra. In the course of time, Prahlada's three worlds were taken away. In due course, the three worlds were obtained by the chastiser of Paka. The sacrifice abandoned the *asuras* and went to the *devas*. When the sacrifice went to the *devas*, the *asuras* spoke to Kavya. "Why has this occurred? While our eyes were open, the sacrifice has forsaken our kingdom and gone to the Gods. We cannot remain here now and will enter Rasatala." Thus addressed, he was dejected and addressed them in these words. "O *asuras*! Do not be scared. I will nourish you with my energy. Rain, herbs, juices and all other material objects will remain with you. The sins will be with the Gods. For your sake, I will sustain all these and give them to you." The *devas* saw that the intelligent Kavya nurtured the *asuras*. Anxious to be victorious, they consulted among themselves. "Using his strength, Kavya is taking everything away from us. It is best that we quickly attack before he revives them. We will strike and kill them. The remaining ones will hide in Patala." The enraged *devas* attacked the *danavas*, killing them. As they were slaughtered, they fled to Kavya. Kavya saw the *devas*, quickly chasing after them. He protected the terrified sons of Diti from the *devas*. Kavya saw the *devas* standing there and thought about the *devas*. He remembered what had happened earlier, thought about it, and spoke to them. "Vamana conquered all the three worlds in his three strides. Bali was bound. Jambha was killed. Virochana was killed. In twelve battles, the large *asuras* were slain by Gods. The ones who were the most important were killed by various means.

There are only a few of you left. This is not sufficient for a battle on your own. Let us wait for some time and I will devise a policy. I will go to Mahadeva and obtain *mantras* for victory. The *hotri* will use *mantras* to kindle a fire. Meanwhile, for the sake of *mantras*, I will go to the divinity, Nilalohita.⁴⁷⁰ When I return, I will show you my favours again. Cover yourselves in bark. Stay in the forest and perform austerities. Until I return, *devas* will not kill you. When I obtain the unmatched *mantras* from the divinity Maheshvara, we will fight with the *devas* again and we will obtain victory.” Consulting among themselves, the *asuras* spoke to the *devas*. “All of us have cast aside our weapons. You can stride over the worlds. Covering ourselves in bark, we will perform austerities in the forest.” The *devas* heard Prahlada’s words, uttered truthfully. They were delighted and lost their anxiety. Casting aside their weapons, the *daityas* returned to wherever they had come from. Kavya told them, “Wait for some time. Do not be eager to do anything. Perform austerities. Time will ensure that the objective is accomplished. O *danavas*! Remain in my father’s⁴⁷¹ hermitage and wait.” Instructing the *asuras* in this way, Kavya went to Mahadeva.’

‘He prostrated himself and addressed Ishvara, the origin of the universe, in these words. “O divinity! I wish for *mantras* that Brihaspati does not possess. They will defeat *devas* and grant *asuras* freedom from fear.” Thus addressed, the divinity replied, “O *dvija*! If you desire the *mantras*, follow the *vrata* instructed by me. Control yourself and be a *brahmachari* for a full one thousand years. With your head hanging downwards, drink in the smoke from a pit. O fortunate one! If you do this, you will obtain the *mantras* from me.” Addressed by the lord of *devas* in this way, Shukra, the great ascetic, agreed. He touched the divinity’s feet and spoke words of assent. “O lord! O divinity! As instructed by you, I will observe the *vrata*.” The divinity employed Kundadhara⁴⁷² to arrange for the smoke. To ensure the welfare of the *asuras*, Shukra left. For the sake of *mantras*, he remained with Maheshvara, practising *brahmacharya*. Abiding by the policy decided earlier, the *asuras* gave up their kingdom. Detecting the weakness, the intolerant *devas* attacked them. With Brihaspati at the forefront, all of them seized their weapons. A large number of *asuras* saw that the *devas* had

taken up their weapons again. Terrified, all of them quickly leapt up. “We have cast aside our weapons. Our *acharya* has granted us freedom from fear and is observing a *vrata*. *Devas* have abandoned the agreement and wish to slay their rivals. O fortunate one! We do not have an *acharya* now. We trusted and are performing austerities. We are wearing rags, bark and hides. We lack action and are devoid of possessions. We are incapable of doing anything and *devas* will vanquish us in battle. Without fighting, we will go and seek refuge with Kavya’s mother.” ⁴⁷³ Scared and seeking freedom from fear, they went and sought refuge with her. She granted the terrified *daityas* freedom from fear. *Devas* saw that the *asuras* had sought refuge with her. Without thinking about strengths and weaknesses, they struck and started to kill them. She saw that the *asuras* were being slaughtered by the *devas*. Angry, the *devi* said, “I will take away Indra from you.” Enraged, she quickly acted so as to paralyze Indra. Seeing that Shakra had been paralyzed, the *devas* were struck dumb. Scared that Shakra had been subjugated, they fled.’

‘When the large number of Gods had gone away, Vishnu spoke to Indra. “O fortunate one! O lord of Gods! Enter me. I will convey you.” Saying this, Vishnu entered Purandara. *Devi* saw that Vishnu had protected him and spoke angrily. “O Maghavan! ⁴⁷⁴ Using my strength, I will burn you down, along with Vishnu. While all the beings look on, behold the strength of my austerities.” Paralyzed by her, those two *devas*, Indra and Vishnu, consulted each other. Vishnu told Indra, “How will both of us be freed?” Indra replied, “O lord! Before she burns us down, kill her. In particular, I have been paralyzed by her. Therefore, without any delay, slay her.” Vishnu looked at her and got ready to kill a woman. The lord thought about Shakra being made to suffer. He wanted to act quickly since the enemy of the Gods would also have acted fast. Despite knowing, the divinity, Vishnu, desired to act in a cruel way. Enraged, Madhava used his weapon to cut her head into three parts. Lord Bhrigu witnessed this terrible act of a woman being killed. Since his wife had been killed, Bhrigu cursed Vishnu at the time. “Despite knowing the *dharma* that a woman should not be killed; you have slain her. Hence, you will be born among humans seven times.” As a result

of this curse, whenever *dharma* is destroyed, for the welfare of all the worlds, he is repeatedly born among humans. After having spoken to Vishnu in this way, he himself gathered the head. Bringing it, he joined it to the body and spoke these words. “You have been killed by Vishnu. But by my truth, I will revive you. If I have knowingly acted in accordance with *dharma*, by the truth of all that, revive. I am speaking the truth.” As a result of his truth, the *devi* came back to life. He sprinkled her with cool water and said, “Come back to life.” While all the beings looked on, she arose, as if she had been asleep. On seeing that *devi* had been revived by Bhrigu, in all the directions, there were words of praise, spoken by invisible entities. All the beings witnessed that marvel. Revived by Bhrigu, his wife was not scared at all. However, seeing this, Shakra was filled with fear of Kavya and could not find any peace.’

‘Indra remained awake at night and spoke to his daughter, Jayanti. The intelligent chastiser of Paka spoke to his own daughter. “To remove Indra, Kavya is performing terrible austerities. O daughter! I am anxious on that account, though I have sought to steady my mind. O auspicious one! Go and serve him to remove his exhaustion. Act attentively to make him favourably disposed towards you.” *Devi* Jayanti, Indra’s daughter, was auspicious in her deeds. She assumed an excellent form and went to the one who was performing that impossible *vrata*. She acted towards Kavya in accordance with the words her father had spoken. Sweet in speech, she used favourable words to praise him. She served him. At the right time, she massaged his body and brought pleasure to his skin. In this way, with agreeable service, she resided with him for many years. The terrible vow, of inhaling smoke for one thousand years, was complete. Pleased, Shiva told Kavya to ask for a boon. “This kind of *vrata* has been performed by you and not by anyone else. Therefore, you will surpass all the Gods in austerities, intelligence, learning, strength and energy. O *brahmana*! O descendant of the Bhrigu lineage! Everything that I possess will be revealed to you—the *Vedangas*, mysteries, sacrifices and Upanishads. These must not be spoken about to anyone. O best among *dvijas*! You will become such that you will surpass everyone.” In this way, Bhava repeatedly bestowed

boons on Bhargava. He would be a lord of subjects. He would be the lord of wealth. It would be impossible to kill him.’

‘Having obtained these boons, Kavya was delighted, and his body-hair stood up. Because of his delight, a divine *stotram* to Mahesha manifested itself. Still upside down, he praised Nilalohita. “O Shitikantha! ⁴⁷⁵ I prostrate myself before you. O first among Gods! O extremely radiant one! O Lelihana! ⁴⁷⁶ O Lehya! ⁴⁷⁷ O Vatsara! ⁴⁷⁸ O lord of the universe! O Kapardin! ⁴⁷⁹ O one whose hair stands up! O one who bestowed boons on Haryaksha! ⁴⁸⁰ O one who is praised! O excellent *tirtha*! O lord of *devas*! O Ramhas! ⁴⁸¹ O one with a headdress! O one with an excellent face! O one with one thousand eyes! O Midhusha! ⁴⁸² O Vasureta! ⁴⁸³ O Rudra! O ascetic! O one clad in rags! O one devoid of possessions! O one with loose hair! O commander in chief! O one with a red complexion! O wise one! O one whose radiance spreads! O one who plays with Takshaka! O Girisha! ⁴⁸⁴ O one with the sun as an eye! O mendicant! O one who accepts oblations of *ghee*! O one with excellent conduct! O one with excellent hands! O one with a bow! O Bhargava! ⁴⁸⁵ O one with one thousand arms! O one with one thousand unblemished eyes! O one with one thousand stomachs! O one with one thousand feet! O one with one thousand heads! O one with many forms! O creator! O Bhava! ⁴⁸⁶ O Vishvarupa! ⁴⁸⁷ O Shveta! ⁴⁸⁸ O Purusha! O one with a quiver! O one with armour! O subtle one! O Destroyer! O one with a coppery complexion! O terrible one! O fierce one! O Shiva! ⁴⁸⁹ O Mahadeva! O Sarva! ⁴⁹⁰ O one who is everything auspicious in the universe! O golden one! O Vasishtha! ⁴⁹¹ O one who showers down! O one in the middle! O refuge! O one with a tawny complexion! O one with a tawny and red complexion! O one with Pinaka! ⁴⁹² O one who possesses arrows! O colourful one! O one with a red complexion! O one who is lauded with the sound of drums! O Ekapada! ⁴⁹³ O worthy one! O intelligent one! O Mrigavyadha! ⁴⁹⁴ O Sthanu! ⁴⁹⁵ O terrible one! O one with three eyes! O Ishvara! O Kapila! ⁴⁹⁶ O Ekavira! ⁴⁹⁷ O Death! O Tryambaka! ⁴⁹⁸ O Vastospati! ⁴⁹⁹ O Pinaki! ⁵⁰⁰ O Shankara! ⁵⁰¹ O one who resides in the forest! O one who resides in a household! O ascetic! O *brahmachari*! O one who can be reached through *samkhyā*! O one who can be reached through *yoga*!

O one who can be reached through *dhyana*! O one who can be reached through *diksha*! O one who is hidden inside! O one who can be reached through austerities! O one who pervades! O enlightened one! O pure one! O emancipated one! O absolute one! O one who suppresses! O wise one! O one who is established in the *brahman*! O *maharshi*! O one with four feet! O sacred one! O one with armour! O one who moves swiftly! O one with a tuft of hair! O one with a skull! O one with a staff! O universal intelligence! O one who is not manifest! O illuminated one! O one who illuminates! O one with excellent intelligence! O cruel one! O malformed one! O hideous one! O one who purifies! O one who envelopes! O Sadyojata! ⁵⁰² O one who devours flesh! O Sharva! ⁵⁰³ O cloud! O lightning! O accomplished one! O abhorred one! O lord of the worlds! O one who is free of ailments! O kindling! O one with the single golden eye! O supreme one! O Vamadeva! ⁵⁰⁴ O Ishana! O intelligent one! O Mahakalpa! ⁵⁰⁵ O one who weeps! O one who laughs! O one with a firm bow! O one with a chariot! O one with an army! O Bhrigu's lord! O Shukra! ⁵⁰⁶ O one who resides in a cavity! O one who never fails! O serene one! O one who is always loved by *brahmanas*! O one with the directions as a garment! O Krittivasa! ⁵⁰⁷ O slayer of Bhaga! ⁵⁰⁸ I prostrate myself before you. O lord of *pashus*! O lord of *bhutas*! O source of *Rig Veda*, *Yajur Veda* and *Sama Veda*! O Svaha! O nectar! O Vashatkara! O one with *mantras* in your *atman*! I prostrate myself before you. O creator! O one who ordains! O one who acts! O one who destroys! O one who preserves! O lord of the past, the present and the future! O one with *karma* in your *atman*! I prostrate myself before you. O Vasus! O Sadhyas! O Rudras! O Adityas! O Ashvins! O Vishvadevas! O Maruts! All these deities are in your *atman*. I prostrate myself before you. You are the one who knows the rites of *agnishtoma*. You are the one who knows the medication of the Pashupata *mantra*. You are *dakshina* and you are *avabhritha*. You have the sacrifice in your *atman*. I prostrate myself before you. You are austerities. You are truth. You are renunciation. You are self-control. You are non-violence. You are avarice. You constantly wear excellent garments. You are the origin of all beings. You possess *yoga* in your *atman*. I prostrate myself before you. You are the earth. You are the

firmament. You are Maharloka. You are heaven. You are Janaloka. You are Tapoloka. You are Satyaloka. You have the worlds in your *atman*. I prostrate myself before you. You are the one who is not manifest. You are the one who is great. You are the elements and the senses. You are the *tanmatras*.⁵⁰⁹ You are the gross elements. The principles are in your *atman*. I prostrate myself before you. You are the eternal one. You are the one who possesses no signs. You are the subtle one. You are beyond that. You are pure. You are power. The eternal is in your *atman*. I prostrate myself before you. I prostrate myself before the one who is in the three worlds, starting with earth and ending with heaven. I prostrate myself before the one who is in the four worlds, starting with Maharloka and ending with Satyaloka. In this *stotram*, I have uttered the names of the one who is existence and non-existence. I am your devotee, and you are attached to *brahmanas*. Therefore, you should pardon everything.”

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Chapter 111-1(111) (Vishnu's greatness)

Suta said, 'In this way, he worshipped the divinity, Ishana Nilalohita. He humbly prostrated himself at his feet. He joined his hands in salutation and spoke these words. Pleased, Bhava touched Kavya's body with his hand. Hara showed himself, as had been wished for, and vanished from the place. When the divinity vanished, along with his companions, he ⁵¹⁰ spoke to Jayanti, who was standing there, with her hands joined in salutation. "O fortunate one! Who do you belong to? When I was miserable, why were you also miserable? In great austerities, why did you try to surpass me? O one with the excellent hips! O one with the beautiful complexion! I am pleased with your constant devotion, humility, self-control and affection. O one with the excellent loins! What do you wish for? What desire will gratify you? I will fulfil it today, even if it is extremely difficult to obtain." Thus addressed, she replied, "O one with the *brahman*! Through your austerities, you should know exactly what I desire." When she said this, through his divine vision, he saw and spoke. "O one with the beautiful hips! You are the great Indra's daughter. You have come here for my welfare. O one with the excellent loins! O beautiful one! Invisible to all beings, you wish to be united with me for ten years. O *devi*! O one with the complexion of blue sapphire! O one with the excellent hips! O one with the excellent eyes! O one sweet in speech! This is what you wish from me. O one with the gait of an intoxicated elephant! It shall be that way. Let us leave for home." Along with Jayanti, the lord went to his own residence. Covering himself with *maya* and invisible to all beings, Bhargava resided with the *devi* for ten years. All of Diti's sons got to know that Kavya had been successful in his objective. Delighted, they went to his house, wishing to see him. Having gone there, they could not see him, since Jayanti had ensured that their *guru* was hidden. Understanding the sign, ⁵¹¹ they returned to wherever they had come from. Brihaspati knew that Kavya had been restrained by the boon for ten years, granted to Jayanti with a desire to please her and ensure her

welfare. Understanding this, he held a consultation with the *devas* and urged them. Assuming Kavya's form, he went and spoke to the *asuras*. On seeing that all of them had come, Brihaspati spoke to them. "O *yajnyas*! ⁵¹² Welcome. For your welfare, I have returned. I will instruct you about the learning I have obtained." Delighted in their minds, they accepted that learning.'

'The entire contracted period of ten years was over. When the period was over, his mind immediately turned to his *yajnyas*. His mind turned to the task of looking after the *yajnyas*. Shukra said, "O *devi*! O one with the beautiful smiles! I will now go and see the *yajnyas*. O virtuous one! O one with the maddening eyes! O one with eyes of three hues!" Thus addressed, the *devi* replied, "O one great in vows! Attend to your devotees. O *brahmana*! This is the *dharma* of the virtuous and I will not destroy your *dharma*." Having gone there, he saw that the *asuras* had been deceived by the intelligent preceptor of the Gods, who had deceived them in Kavya's form. He addressed them in these words. "Know me to be Kavya. This one is descended from Angiras. ⁵¹³ O *danavas*! Though I am attached to you, you have been deceived." Hearing what he said, Diti's sons were scared. In front of them, they saw both seated on seats, with smiles on their faces. All of them were confounded and remained there, not knowing what to do. Since they were bewildered, Kavya spoke to them again. "I am Kavya, your *acharya*. This is the one descended from Angiras. He is the *acharya* of the *devas*. All of you leave Brihaspati and follow me." Thus addressed, all of them looked at both of them. The *asuras* could not discern any special difference between the two. Brihaspati spoke to those bewildered ones. "This one is the son of Angiras. O *daityas*! I am Kavya, your *guru*. O *asuras*! He has assumed my form to confuse you." Hearing what he said, they consulted each other and spoke these words. "This lord has been constantly teaching us for ten years. He is our *guru*! This *dvija* is searching for an opportunity." All the *danavas* prostrated themselves and greeted him. ⁵¹⁴ They were deluded by what he had taught and accepted his words. All the *asuras* became angry. They spoke, eyes red with rage. "This is our *guru*, engaged in our welfare. Leave. You are not our *guru*. Whether he is

Bhargava, or whether he is descended from Angiras, he will be our *guru*. We will remain here, following his commands. O virtuous one! Without any delay, leave.” Saying this, all the *asuras* sought refuge with Brihaspati. They did not accept the great and beneficial words he had spoken. Bhargava was enraged at their arrogance and said, “O *danavas*! Though I made you understand, you did not serve me. Therefore, your senses will be destroyed, and you will face defeat.” Saying this, Kavya returned to wherever he had come from. Brihaspati got to know that the *asuras* had been cursed by Kavya. He was delighted that he had accomplished his objective and returned to his form. He understood that he had been successful since the *asuras* had deviated. He vanished and went away.’

‘When he went away, the *danavas* were confused. They spoke to each other. “Shame on us. Our affection has led to this deception. The creator has acted so as to make us turn away from *dharma*. We have been scorched and the *maya* has made us deviate from our respective tasks.” The *asuras* were terrified of the *devas*. With Prahlada at the forefront, they quickly followed Kavya again. Having reached Kavya, they stood around him, their faces lowered downwards. Kavya saw that his *yajnyas* had returned and spoke to them. “At the time, when I tried to make you understand, you paid no heed. As a result of that arrogance, you will face defeat.” Prahlada replied, “O Bhargava! Please do not abandon us. We are your *yajnyas*. In particular, we are devotees who serve you. When you could not be seen, the *acharya* of the *devas* deluded us. You are far-sighted and can see this. You should save your devotees. O descendant of the Bhrigu lineage! If you forsake us and do not show us your favours, we will enter Rasatala today.” Discerning the truth, Kavya was filled with great compassion. Entreated in this way, Shukra restrained his rage. He said, “Do not be frightened. Do not go to Rasatala. This was certain to happen. Therefore, it occurred even while I was awake. Destiny is immensely powerful, and I am incapable of countering it. Your senses have been destroyed. If you so wish, that can be got back. Brahma said, ‘The time period is over. You conquered the three worlds through my favours. For ten complete *yugas*, you placed your feet on the heads of *devas*.’ As stated by Brahma, that was the duration for you

to reign. At the time of Savarni *manvantara*, you will regain your kingdom again. Your grandson, Bali, will again become the lord of the worlds. This duration, about your grandson, has been spoken by Brahma himself. Therefore, we should not grieve because your worlds have been taken away. Bali's activities were not driven by desire. As a result of this, Ishvara was pleased, and at the time of Savarni *manvantara*, bestowed the kingdom of the *devas* on him. Therefore, invisible to beings, he is waiting for the right time. Pleased, Svayambhu has bestowed immortality on you. Hence, do not lose your eagerness. Why should you suddenly get agitated? I am incapable of countering what has already been decided for you. The lord, Brahma, who knows about the future, has prevented me. These two *shishyas* of mine⁵¹⁵ are Brihaspati's equal. When the angry *devas* attack you, they will support you." Kavya, indefatigable in his deeds, spoke to the *daityas* in this way. With Prahlada leading the way, they went away with those two.'

'The *daityas* and *danavas* heard what was certain to happen. They were instantly assuaged by the victory Kavya had spoken about. All of them armoured themselves and picking up their weapons, challenged the *devas*. The *devas* saw that they had presented themselves for the battle. At this, the *devas* armoured themselves and fought against them. The battle that commenced between *devas* and *asuras* lasted for one hundred years. *Devas* were defeated by *asuras*. Suffering in this way, *devas* consulted among themselves. *Devas* said, "The *asuras* have defeated us because of the powers of Shanda and Marka. Hence, to ensure our benefit, we should be instructed by them about a sacrifice. We will invite them for the sacrifice and thereby, defeat the *asuras*." Consulting in this way, the *devas* approached Shanda and Marka. They invited them for the sacrifice and said, "O *dvijas*! Abandon the *asuras*. When we have defeated the *danavas*, you can accept whatever is there to take." In this way, Shanda and Marka abandoned the *asuras*. Thus, the *devas* were victorious and the *danavas* were defeated. When the *asuras* were defeated, the *devas* approached Shanda and Marka. They⁵¹⁶ were overwhelmed by Kavya's curse and no longer had support. Restricted by the *devas*, they entered Rasatala again. In

this way, Shakra made the *danavas* lose their enterprise. Since then, they have suffered from the curse Bhargava pronounced.’

‘When sacrifices became lax, Lord Vishnu was born again. He did this to establish *dharma* and destroying *adharma*. Lord Brahma had said that all the *asuras* who did not abide by Prahlada’s commands would be killed by humans. That is the reason, at the time of Chakshusha *manvantara*, Narayana was born as Dharma’s son.⁵¹⁷ In Vaivasvata *manvantara*, as Vena’s son,⁵¹⁸ he started sacrifices. When Vena’s son manifested himself, the Lord Brahma was the priest. When the Gods suffered in the *yuga* known as the fourth, he originated from within the ocean.⁵¹⁹ Assuming the terrible form of Narasimha, he killed the second, Hiranyakashipu, placing his son in front.⁵²⁰ Bali, Virochana’s son, was the Indra among *daityas* and performed a sacrifice. At that auspicious time, the delight of Aditi’s lineage assumed the form of a *dvija* and spoke to him. “You are the king of the three worlds, and everything is established in you. O king! You should grant me what can be covered in three strides.” This is what the lord said. King Bali, Virochana’s son, replied in words of assent. Despite knowing that this was Vamana *avatara*, he gave everything away happily. O excellent *dvijas*! The lord Vamana covered the entire universe, earth, firmament and heaven, in his three strides. He is in the *atman* of all beings. In his own energy, he surpasses the sun. The immensely illustrious one illuminates all the directions and sub-directions. The mighty-armed one is resplendent, illuminating all the worlds. Janardana took away the prosperity of the three worlds from the *asuras*. With their sons and grandsons, the *asuras* entered Patala. They were Namuchi, Shambara and Prahlada. Vishnu killed the cruel ones. Routed, the others fled in different directions. In particular, Madhava’s *atman* is present in the great elements. O *brahmanas*! With his forces, Bali witnessed that wonder. He saw the essence of the entire universe in his body. There is nothing in the worlds that is not pervaded by the great-souled one. On witnessing Upendra’s⁵²¹ form, *devas*, *danavas* and humans rejoiced. All of them were confounded by Vishnu’s energy. Bali, and his large number of well-wishers, were bound in large nooses. All those from Virochana’s lineage were restricted to Patala. He bestowed all the

prosperity of the immortals on the great-souled Indra. These three are described as his divine manifestations. ⁵²² Thereafter, the mighty-armed Janardana manifested himself among humans. There were seven manifestations among humans. Hear about the most important ones. In the tenth *treta yuga*, when *dharma* was destroyed, his fourth manifestation was Dattatreya, who placed Markandeya at the forefront. ⁵²³ The fifth manifestation was in the fifteenth *treta yuga*. This was as *chakravarti* Mandhata, who placed Utathya at the forefront. ⁵²⁴ In the nineteenth *treta yuga*, the lord destroyed all *kshatriyas*. This was the sixth manifestation as Jamadagni's son, the one who placed Vishvamitra at the forefront. In the twenty-fourth *treta yuga*, for the sake of Ravana, the seventh manifestation occurred as Rama, Dasharatha's son, with Vasishtha as the priest. In the twenty-eight *dvapara yuga*, he had the eighth manifestation as Vedavyasa, Parashara's son, with Jatukarnya at the forefront. ⁵²⁵ Vishnu's ninth manifestation was as the son of Aditi and Kashyapa. He was born as the son of Devaki and Vasudeva, with Gargya at the forefront. ⁵²⁶ He is immeasurable and cannot be controlled. He is self-controlled and supreme among those who possess no desire. Like a child playing with a toy, Bhagavan sports with the worlds. No one is capable of measuring the mighty-armed Madhusudana. There is nothing superior to the one who has the universe as his form. Towards the end of the twenty-eighth *dvapara yuga*, when *dharma* was destroyed, Lord Vishnu was born in the Vrishni lineage. He destroyed *asuras* and established *dharma*. With *yoga* in his *atman*, he confounded all beings with his *yoga* and his *maya*. He entered a human womb and undetected, wandered around the earth. To sport among humans, he placed Sandipani ⁵²⁷ at the forefront. Resorting to a human body, the valiant one destroyed *daityas*—Kamsa; Shalva; the great *asura*, Dvidida; ⁵²⁸ Arishta; Vrishabha; the horse, Keshi; the elephant, Kuvalayapida; the wrestler ⁵²⁹ and the lord of Rajagriha. ⁵³⁰ Extraordinary in deeds, he severed the one thousand arms of Bana. In a battle, he killed Naraka and the immensely strong Yavana. ⁵³¹ He robbed the lords of the earth of all their jewels and energy. The heroes of the Kuru lineage and the

kings were killed and conveyed to Rasatala. The great-souled one manifested himself for the welfare of the worlds.'

'Whenever this *yuga* decays and only the *sandhya* part is left, the powerful one will manifest himself as Kalki Vishnuyasha, in Parashara's lineage. This will be the tenth manifestation, with Yajnavalkya at the forefront.⁵³² Soldiers, elephants, horses and chariots will follow him. He will be surrounded by hundreds and thousands of *brahmanas*, who will pick up their weapons. The powerful lord will destroy those who are not excessively devoted to *dharma* and those who hate *dharma*—those from the north and the central regions; those who live beyond the Vindhyas; those from the southern regions, Dravidas and Simhalas; Gandharas, Paradas, Pahlavas, Pavanas and Shakas; Tubaras, Shabaras, Pulindas, Baradas and Vasas; Lampakas, Andhrakas, Pundrakas and Kiratas; and the extremely strong Mlecchas. Invisible to all beings, he will roam around on earth. The intelligent one will be born as a human, as the son of Devasena. In an earlier birth, the valiant Vishnu was born under the name of Pramiti, in the *gotra* of Chandramasa.⁵³³ He will be born when *kali yuga* is complete. Thus, the divinity is said to manifest himself among Daksha's descendants, at different time periods, in different forms, with different purposes and different reasons. His portions manifest themselves as different species in the three worlds. In the twenty-fifth year of the twenty-fifth *kalpa*,⁵³⁴ he killed all beings and all humans. Cruel in deeds, he only left seeds on earth. He pacifies *vrishalas*⁵³⁵ and those who are against *dharma*. Along with his soldiers, Kalki will accomplish his objectives in that way. He will kill some through his deeds. He will also accomplish his objective by confounding others and making them kill each other. Urged by destiny, all this destruction will occur. Thereafter, along with his followers, he will establish himself in the region between Ganga and Yamuna. When that *kalpa* is over, the kings, along with their soldiers, will be destroyed and the subjects will be freed from repressions. With protection removed, some will kill each other in battles. Killing each other, they will be extremely miserable, without any joy. They will abandon cities, villages and any similar habitation. They will be without possessions. The *dharma* of the *shruti* texts

will be destroyed. The *dharma* of *ashramas* will be destroyed. People will be short, with limited lifespans. They will reside in the forest. They will frequent rivers and mountains, surviving on leaves, roots and fruits. They will be clad in bark, leaves and hides. They will resort to what is terrible, mixing up *varnas*. Lifespans will be short, and the means of subsistence will be destroyed. There will be many obstructions and they will be extremely miserable. When the final *kashthas* in the *sandhyamsa* of *kali yuga* are reached, the subjects will head towards destruction, along with *kali yuga*. When *kali yuga* is over, *krita yuga* will commence again. The natural order will be restored. It won't be otherwise. I have thus described everything that the *devas* and *asuras* did. In connection with Yadu's lineage, Vishnu's greatness and fame have also been described. I will now speak about the descendants of Turvasu, Puru, Druhyu and Anu.'

Chapter 112-1(112) (Description of lineages)

Suta said, 'Turvasu's son was Vahni and Vahni's son was Gobhanu. Gobhanu's son was the brave and undefeated Trishanu. Trishanu's son was Karandhama and his son was Marutta. I have earlier spoken about another King Marutta, who was Avikshit's son. It has been heard that this king was without a son. He accepted Dushkanta Pourava as a son. In this way, the curse that Yayati imposed on the lineage of Turvasu after the onset of old age, passed into the Pourava lineage. Dushkanta's heir was the king named Sarupya. Andira was Sarupya's son, and he had four sons. They were Pandya, Kerala, Chola and Kulya. Their countries were Kulya, Pandya, Chola and Kerala. Druhyu had two brave and famous sons—Babhru and Setu. Aruddha was Setu's son and Babhru's son is said to have been Ripu. The powerful one fought a great battle with Youvanashva for fourteen years, following which, he was killed after facing hardships. Aruddha's heir was the king named Gandhara. The great country of Gandhara is famous under that name. The horses from the land of Gandhara are supreme among horses. Gandhara's son was Dharma and Dharma's son was Dhrita. Dhrita's

son was Durdama and his son was Pracheta. Pracheta had one hundred sons and all of them were kings. In the northern direction, all of them were kings of Mlechha kingdoms. Anu had had three brave sons who were extremely devoted to *dharma*. They were known as Sabhanara, Kalachakshu and Paraksha. Sabhanara's son was Kalanala, the learned king. Kalanala had a son named Srinjaya, who had *dharma* in his soul. Srinjaya had a brave son named Puranjaya. This king was Indra's equal, and his fame was established in heaven. This great householder was devoted to *dharma* and his son was Mahamana. He was an immensely illustrious *chakravarti*, a king who was the master of the seven *dvipas*. Mahamana gave birth to two famous sons. They were Ushinara, who knew about *dharma*, and Titikshu, who was devoted to *dharma*. Ushinara had five wives, who were born in the lineages of *rajarshis*. They were Nrigaa, Krimi, Navaa, Darvaa and Drishadvati as the fifth. Through them, Ushinara had five daughters who extended the lineage. After he performed austerities when he became old, sons devoted to *dharma* were born to him. Nrigaa's son was Nriga. Navaa's son was Nava. Krimi's son was Krimi. Darvaa had a son named Suvrata, who was devoted to *dharma*. O *dvijas*! Shibi Oushinara was Drishadvati's son. Shibi's city became famous as Shivapura, Nriga's city was Youdheya. Nava's city was Navarashtra and Krimi's city was Krimila. Suvrata's city was Ambashta. Now hear about Shibi's sons. Shibi had four sons who were revered in the worlds as the Shibis. They were Vrishadarbha, Suvira, Kekaya and Madrakas. Their prosperous countries were Kekaya, Madraka, Vrishadarbha and Suvira. Now hear about Titikshu's offspring. Titikshu became a famous king in the eastern direction. His son was the mighty-armed Ushadratha and Ushadratha's son was Hema. Hema's son was Sutapa and Sutapa's son was Bali. The great-minded Bali, who was bound, was a great *yogi*. The lineage was declining, and he was born as a human, with a desire for sons. He had sons who established the four *varnas* on earth. He gave birth to Anga, Vanga, Suhma, Yuddha and Kalinga. These were known as Baleya *kshatriyas*. Baleya *brahmanas* also extended the lord's lineage. Delighted, Brahma bestowed many boons on the intelligent Bali. He would be a great *yogi*. The duration of his lifespan would last for one *kalpa*. He

would be invincible in battles. He would possess the power of *dharma*. He would be able to see the three worlds. In having offspring, he would be prominent. In understanding the true meaning of *dharma* and *artha*, he would be unmatched. “You will establish the four *varnas* and control them.” Being addressed by the lord in this way, King Bali obtained supreme peace. After a long period of time, the learned-one attained his own position. The countries of Anga, Vanga, Suhma, Pundra and Kalinga were prosperous. Hear about their lineages. All his sons were born in his *kshetra*, from a sage.⁵³⁶ They were born to Sudeshna through the extremely energetic Dirghatamas.’

The *rishis* asked, ‘O lord! How were five sons born to Bali through his *kshetra*, through the *rishi* Dirghatamas? We are asking you that. Please tell us.’

Suta answered, ‘In earlier times, there was a famous and intelligent *rishi* named Ushija. The great-souled one had a wife named Mamata. Ushija’s younger brother was the priest for the residents of heaven. This was Brihaspati, great in his energy. He approached Mamata. Mamata did not desire Brihaspati and replied, “I am your elder brother’s wife and I am pregnant. O Brihaspati! The great foetus in my womb loudly chants the *brahman* constantly, reciting the *Vedas* and the *Vedangas*. Since your semen will not be futile, you should not approach me. O lord! At this time, you should not think of doing this.” Brihaspati, great in his energy, was spoken to in this way. Though he was great-souled, he was overcome by desire and could not control himself. With *dharma* in his soul, Brihaspati had intercourse with her. When he released the semen, the foetus in the womb spoke. “O Jiva! ⁵³⁷ Do not release the semen. There is no space for two here. Your semen is never futile, but I came here before.” Thus addressed, Brihaspati became angry. The illustrious *rishi* cursed his brother Ushija’s son, who was inside the womb. “You spoke to me at a time that is desired by all beings. Because of this delusion, you will enter a long period of darkness.” As a result of this curse, the *rishi* was born and obtained the name of Dirghatamas. ⁵³⁸ Because of his great deeds and energy, Ushija’s son was like Brihaspati. He lived in the brother’s ⁵³⁹ hermitage and held up

his seed. The lord learnt about the *dharma* of cows from a bull who was Surabhi's son. ⁵⁴⁰ The brother, his uncle, ⁵⁴¹ built a residence for him. While he lived there, wandering around as it wished, a bull came there. Surabhi's son wandered around on the *darbha* grass that had been spread out for a *darsha* rite. ⁵⁴² Dirghatamas caught it by the horns, and it struggled. Though it was held by him in this way, the bull did not move even one step. It said, "O supreme among strong ones! Release me. O son! I have not come across a person as strong as you anywhere. I am the mount of the divinity Tryambaka but have been born on earth now. O best among strong ones! Release me. Because of my affection, ask for a boon." Thus addressed, he replied, "How can you escape with your life? Though you are a quadruped, since you have eaten someone else's possessions, I will not release you." At this, the bull replied to Dirghatamas. "O son! For us, there is no sin from theft. We never distinguish between what should be eaten and what should not be eaten, what should be drunk and what should not be drunk. O *brahmana*! We do not distinguish between what should be done and what should not be done, where one should go and where one should not go. O *brahmana*! We are not sinners. This is known to be the *dharma* of cattle." On hearing the name of cattle, he was alarmed and released the bull. To hear what the son of a cow had to say, he devoutly placated him. Through the favours of the Indra among bulls, he learned about the *dharma* of cows. He retained it in his mind and acted accordingly.'

'Because of destiny, his senses were confounded. He approached the wife of his younger son, Outathya. ⁵⁴³ She struggled and wept. Taking this to be a transgression, Sharadvan did not tolerate it. Following the *dharma* of cows, he approached his daughter-in-law by force. Witnessing the perversity, Sharadvan thought about this. The great-souled one determined what would happen as a consequence of this. His eyes red with rage, he spoke to Dirghatamas. "You do not know the difference between those one should have intercourse with and those one should not. Following the *dharma* of cows, you desired your daughter-in-law. You are evil in conduct. Therefore, I am abandoning you. Because of your own deeds, leave. Since you are blind and aged, you should be looked after. But your conduct has been

wicked. Hence, I will forsake you. I think that you are evil in conduct.” His intelligence turned towards performing a cruel act. He reprimanded him in many kinds of ways. He seized him by his arms and placed him inside a box, which he released in the waters of Ganga so that it might head towards the ocean. For seven days, the box was borne along in the current, headed towards the ocean. The king named Bali knew the truth about *dharma* and *artha*. Along with his wife, he saw the box, rising and falling in the current. Bali, Virochana’s son, with *dharma* in his soul, picked it up. He took him to the inner quarters and satisfied him with different kinds of food. Pleased, he requested Bali to ask for a boon. The bull among *danavas* desired sons and asked for that boon. Bali said, “O immensely fortunate one! O one who bestows honours! Through my wife, you should give me sons. I desire sons who know about *dharma* and *artha*. You should generate them for me.” Thus addressed, since this was beneficial, the *rishi* agreed. The king sent his wife, who was named Sudeshna. On seeing that he was blind and aged, the queen did not go there. She decorated her servant-maid with ornaments and sent her there instead. Through this *shudra* lady, the self-controlled *rishi*, with *dharma* in his soul, gave birth to two extremely energetic sons, Kakshivan and Chakshusha. King Bali saw these two sons, Kashivan and Chakshusha. These two lords studied the *Vedas* in the proper way and spoke about the *brahman*. They directly obtained *siddhi* in the pursuit of *dharma*. They were the best among those who possessed understanding.’

‘Bali, Virochana’s son, told the *rishi*, “These are my sons.” He answered, “Though they are my sons, they are not yours. They are excellent *asuras*, but they have been born from a *shudra* womb. Sudeshna, your queen, thought that I was blind and old. She sent her *shudra* servant-maid to me, showing me disrespect.” He sought to placate the excellent *rishi* again. The lord Bali reprimanded his wife, Sudeshna. He decorated her in ornaments and sent her to the *rishi*. Dirghatamas spoke to the queen. “O auspicious one! I will be naked and smear myself with curds mixed with salt. Without finding this revolting, you must lick me from head to foot. O queen! If you do this, you will obtain the sons you wish for.” The queen did everything, in accordance with his words. But when it came to the anus, she was filled

with revulsion and avoided it. The *rishi* told her, “O auspicious one! Since you avoided the anus, your eldest son will be born without an anus.” The queen replied to Dirghatamas, “O immensely fortunate one! You should not give me such a son.” The *rishi* said, “O queen! This is because of your crime. It cannot but be otherwise. O queen! But I will grant you a grandson like that. Despite possessing no anus, he will be worthy.” Touching her stomach, Dirghatamas said, “O one with the sweet smiles! Since you have licked the curd from my body, your conception is complete and your womb is full, like the ocean on the day of the full moon. There will be five sons who will be like the sons of the Gods. They will be energetic and brave. They will perform sacrifices and be devoted to *dharma*.” Thus, Anga was born as Sudeshna’s eldest son. After that, there were Vanga, Kalinga, Pundra and Sumha. These five were born through Bali’s *kshetra* ⁵⁴⁴ and extended the lineage. In this way, in earlier times, Dirghatamas gave Bali sons. Because of some reason, Brahma had prevented him from having offspring earlier. “This great-souled one will not be able to obtain offspring through his wife.” That is why the children were born through another man. Pleased, Surabhi addressed Dirghatamas in these words. “You did this after having reflected on the *dharma* of cows. O sage! I am pleased with your single-minded devotion. Hence, I will take away your long period of darkness. Behold. Brihaspati placed that sin on your body. Inhaling your body, I will take away the fear of old age and death.” As soon as she inhaled, the darkness went away and he could see. He became a young man, possessing a long lifespan and eyesight. Since a cow took away the darkness, he became Goutama.’ ⁵⁴⁵

‘Along with his father, Kakshivan went to Girivraja. As instructed by his father, he undertook extensive austerities. After a long period of austerities, he cleansed himself. Having cleansed all his taints, the lord became a *brahmana*. His father said, “O lord! Now I indeed have a son. O son! With an excellent and illustrious son like you, I have accomplished my objective.” After that, he performed *yoga* with his *atman* and attained Brahma’s imperishable abode. Having become a *brahmana*, Kakshivan had one thousand sons. These sons of Kakshivan are known as Kushmandas and

Goutamas. Thus, the interaction between Dirghatamas and Bali and their obtaining sons has been described. Bali instated his five unblemished sons. Having accomplished his objective, the lord resorted to *yoga* and immersed his *atman* in *yoga*. Invisible to all beings, it is said that he is waiting for the time. ⁵⁴⁶ King Dadhivahana was *rajarshi* Anga's son. Because of Sudeshna's crime, the king was Anapana. ⁵⁴⁷ Anapana's son is said to have been King Diviratha. Diviratha's son was the learned king, Dharmaratha. These are said to be those from the Ikshvaku lineage. They will be born in *kali yuga*. They will be born in Brihadbala's lineage. They will be immensely brave and valiant. They will be heroes who are accomplished in learning. They will be devoted to the truth and conquer their senses. In connection with this lineage, those who know the future cite a *shloka*. "The Ikshvaku dynasty will end with Sumitra. When Sumitra becomes the king, it will be *kali yuga* and the lineage will end." The *kshatriyas* who were descended from Manu and Aila have been described.'

'After this, I will describe that of Brihadratha from Magadha. These kings were born in Jarasandha's lineage and that of Sahadeva, who followed. ⁵⁴⁸ There are past, present and future ones. I will mention the most important. Listen as I speak. Sahadeva was brought down in the Bharata battle. His son was *rajarshi* Somapi. He ruled over the kingdom of Girivraja for fifty-eight years. His son, Shrutashrava, ruled for sixty-seven years. His son, Ayutayu, ruled over the kingdom for twenty-six years. After enjoying the earth for one hundred years, Niramitra went to heaven. Sukshatra obtained the earth for fifty-six years. Brihatkarma ruled over the kingdom for twenty-three years. Senajit is king at the moment. In the future, Shrutanjaya will be the king for forty years. The mighty-armed Ripunjaya will possess immense intelligence and valour. This kin will rule over the earth for thirty-five years. Shuchi will be established in the kingdom for fifty-eight years. Kshema will be the king for a full twenty-eight years. The valiant Suvrata will rule over the kingdom for sixty-four years. Dharmanetra will become the king when he completes five years of age. This king will enjoy the kingdom for fifty-eight years. Sushrama will rule over the kingdom for thirty-eight years. Dridhasena will be the king for

fifty-eight years. Sumati will obtain the kingdom for thirty-three years. King Sunetra will enjoy the kingdom for forty years. Satyajit will enjoy the earth and the kingdom for eighty-three years. Vishvajit will obtain the kingdom for twenty-five years. Arinjaya will obtain the earth for fifty years. There will be twenty-two kings known as Brihadrathas. They will rule over the kingdom for a full one thousand years.'

'When the Brihadrathas have passed, it will be the time of a slayer of heroes. Shunaka will kill his master and instate his son. While all the *kshatriyas* look on, he will use force to make Pradyoti the king. Because of destiny, all the others will prostrate themselves before him. This excellent man will be a king for twenty-three years. Palaka will be the king for twenty-four years. Vishakhayupa will be the king for fifty years. Ajaka will rule over the kingdom for twenty-one years. His son, Nandivardhana, will rule for twenty years. The five Pradyota kings will rule for one hundred and thirty-eight years.'

'Robbing them of all their fame, Shishunaga will become the king in Varanasi and will send his son to Girivraja. Shishunaga will be the king for forty years. His son, Kakavarna, will be the king for thirty-six years. After this, Kshemadharma will be the king for twenty years. Kshatrouja will obtain the kingdom for forty years. Vidhisara will be the king for thirty-eight years. Ajatashatru will be the king for twenty-five years. Darbhaka will be the king for thirty-five years. Udayi will be the king for thirty-three years. The king will construct an excellent city on earth, known as Kusuma.

⁵⁴⁹ He will do this on the fourth day, on the southern banks of the Ganga. Nandivardhana will be the king for forty years. Sahanandi will be the king for forty-three years. The ten Shishunaga kings will be *kshatra-bandhus* ⁵⁵⁰ and will rule for three hundred and sixty years. Along with them, there will be other kings who will rule for an equal duration of time. There will be twenty-four Ishvakus, twenty-five Panchalas, twenty-four Kalakas, twenty-four Haihayas, thirty-two Ekalingas, twenty-five Shakas, thirty-six Kurus, twenty-eight from Mithila, twenty-three Shurasenas and twenty Vitihotras. All these will rule over the earth for an equal duration of time.'

‘Because of destiny, Mahanandi will have a son through a *shudra* woman. This will be Mahapadma, a king who will destroy all *kshatriyas*. Since then, all kings will be born through *shudra* wombs. Mahapadma alone will be the emperor, with a single umbrella.⁵⁵¹ He will rule the earth for eighty-eight years. He will uproot all *kshatriyas* and seize their wealth by force. After that, in the due order, Mahapadma’s eight sons will be kings for a period of twelve years. Koutilya, a bull among *dvijas*, will uproot all of them. That Indra among men will enjoy the earth for one hundred years. After that, Koutilya will establish Chandragupa as the king of the kingdom. Chandragupta will be king for twenty-four years. Bhadrasara will be the king for twenty-five years. For thirty-six years, the king will provide satisfaction to Ashoka and others.⁵⁵² His son, Kulala, will be the king for eight years. Kushala’s son, Bandhupalita, will enjoy the earth for eight years.⁵⁵³ Indrapalita will be Bandhupalita’s heir. Devavarma will be a lord of men for seven years. His son will be King Shatadhanu. Brihadratha will be the king for seven years. These nine Mouryas will enjoy the earth for a full one hundred and thirty-seven years, after which, from them, it will go to the Shungas. The commander, Pushpamitra,⁵⁵⁴ will uproot Brihadratha and rule over the kingdom for sixty years. Agnimitra will become the king and this king will rule for eight years. After this, Sujyeshtha will be the king for seven years. Vasumitra will then be the king for ten years. Bhadra will then be the king for two years. After this, Pulindaka will be the king for three years and Ghosha will also be the king for three years. Thereafter, Vajramitra will be the king for seven years and Bhagavata will be the king for thirty-two years. His son, Devabhumi, will be the king for ten years. The ten Shunga kings will enjoy the earth for a full one hundred and twelve years.’

‘From them, the earth will go the Kanvas. Devabhumi will indulge in vices from childhood. His adviser, Vasudeva, will kill him and become king in place of the Shungas. In this Kanva dynasty, he will be the king for five years. His son, Bhumimitra, will rule for twenty-four years. Narayana will be the king for twelve years. His son, Susharma, will be the king for four years. The four Kanvas will rule for forty-five years. After they have

enjoyed the earth, it will pass to the Andhras. Sindhuka, from the Andhra lineage, will uproot Susharma Kanva by force and obtain the earth. Sindhuka will be the king for twenty-three years. After this, his brother, Krishna, will be the king for ten years. His son will be the great Shri-Shantakarni. Shantakarni will be the king for fifty-six years. His son, Apolava, will be the king for twelve years. Patuman will be the king for twenty-four years. Anishtakarma will be the king for twenty-five years. Hala will be the king for an entire year. The immensely strong Pattallaka will rule for five years. Purishabhiru will be the king for twenty-one years. Shatakarni will be the lord of men for one year. Shivasvati will be the king for twenty-eight years. Goutamiputra will be the king for twenty-one years. Yajna Shri-Shatakarni will be the king for nineteen years. After this, Vijaya will be the king for six years. His son, Danda Shri-Shatakarni, will be the king for three years. Pulomari will be the king for seven years. In this way, thirty Andhra kings will enjoy the earth for four hundred and fifty-six years. Five Andhra kings belong to the past and there will be seven in the future.

⁵⁵⁵ After this, there will be ten Abhira kings. There will be seven Gardabhins and ten Shakas. There will be eight Yavanas and fourteen Tusharas. There will be thirteen Gurundas and eleven Mounas. The Andhras will enjoy the earth for three hundred years. The ten Abhiras will be kings for sixty-seven years. The seven Gardabhins will enjoy the earth for seventy-two years. The Shakas will enjoy the earth for three hundred and eighty years. The Yavanas will enjoy the earth for one hundred and sixty years. It is said that the Tusharas will rule over earth for five hundred years. The thirteen Gurundas will enjoy the earth, along with *vrishalas* and Mlecchas, for one hundred and fifty-four years. The eleven Mounas will enjoy the earth for three hundred years. When time destroys them, Kilakila will be the king. From Kilakila, it will pass on to Vindhyashakti. He will rule over the earth for ninety-six years.'

‘Hear about the future kings of Vidisha. Shesha is the king of *nagas* and his son will destroy the city of the Gods. This serpent will become the king and this king, Sadachandra, will extend the lineage of Nagas. Chandramshu will be the second king, followed by Nakhavan. Dhanadharma is described

as the fourth king in this lineage. After this, Bhutinanda will rule over Vidisha. His younger brother will have the name of Nandiyasha. There will be only three kings in his lineage. ⁵⁵⁶ His daughter's son, by the name of Shishika, will be the king in Purika. Vindhyashakti will have a valiant son named Pravira. He will enjoy the city of Kanchanaka for sixty years. He will perform and complete horse sacrifices, with excellent *dakshina*. His four sons will be lords of men. Three of these kings will have matrimonial alliances with the Vindhyaka dynasty. Supratika and Gabhira will enjoy the kingdom for twenty years. Shankamana will become king and he will be the lord of the earth in Mahishi. There will be six Pushpamitras and thirteen Strimitras. Seven kings will rule over Mekala for seventy years. There will be extremely strong kings in Komala. There will be nine such intelligent ones and they will be known as Meghas. There will be all the Nishadha kings and they will remain until destruction. They will be born in Nala's lineage. They will be valiant and immensely strong. The immensely brave Vishvasphani will rule in Magadha. He will uproot all the lords of the earth and create other *varnas*—Kaivartas, Madrakas, Pulindas and Brahmanas. These kings will establish people in many countries. Vishvasphani will be great in spirits. In a battle, the lord will be as radiant as Vishnu. It is said that King Vishvasphani will have the form of a eunuch. He will uproot *kshatriyas* and establish other *kshatriyas*. Nine Nagas will be kings and enjoy the city of Champavati. Seven Nagas will enjoy the beautiful city of Mathura. These seven, born in that lineage, will enjoy all the territories around the Ganga—Prayaga, Saketa and Magadha. They will enjoy all the countries that are full of jewels and grain—Naishadha, Yaduka, Shaishita and Kalatoyaka. Devarakshitas will enjoy Koshala, Andhra, Pundra, Tamralipta, Sagara and the beautiful city of Champa. Kalinga, Mahisha and Mahendranilaya-Guha will protect all these countries. The ones known as Kanakas will enjoy Strirashtra and Bhojaka. All of these will be lords of the earth at the same time. There will be Yavanas, who will not be pleased easily. They will not follow *dharma* and will be prone to rage. They will not be truthful in matters connected with *dharma*, *kama* and *artha*. These kings

will not sprinkle their heads. Because of the taint of the *yuga*, these kings will be evil in conduct.'

“In the course of time, there will be lords of the earth who will be devoid of pursuits of *dharma*, *artha* and *kama*. There will be countries with mixed *varnas* and the conduct of Mlecchas will be prevalent everywhere. There will be calamities and subjects will be destroyed. The kings will be avaricious and untruthful in speech. As a result of the progress, there will be many women in that *yuga*.⁵⁵⁷ Little by little, they will be destroyed—in lifespan, beauty, strength and learning. In this way, as time passes, subjects and lords of the earth will become like blocks of wood. Struck by destiny, kings will be destroyed. Destroyed by Kalki, all the Mlecchas will face destruction. All those who follow *adharma* and are excessively heretical will be destroyed. When only the *sandhya* of *kali yuga* is left, the word “king” itself will be destroyed. There will be a few subjects left. *Dharma* will be destroyed. They will be without possessions, lacking a means of subsistence. Whatever they possess, will be destroyed. They will suffer from disease and grief. They will suffer from lack of rain and be engaged in killing each other. They will be without support and terrified. They will abandon their livelihoods and be reduced to a miserable state. They will abandon cities and villages and become residents of forests. In this way, abandoning their homes, subjects will be destroyed. They will be dejected, without anyone to love them. Well-wishes will lose any sense of affection. They will deviate from *varnas* and *ashramas* and follow the terrible mixture of *varnas*. Subjects will then inhabit rivers and mountains. They will live in rivers, marshy lands near oceans and mountains. Humans will seek refuge in Anga, Kalinga, Vanga, Kashmira, Kashi, Koshala and the valleys around Mount Rishikanta. Along with Mlecchas, all the noble ones will go to the slopes of the Himalayas, the shores of the salty ocean and the intervening forests. Humans will survive on the flesh of deer, fish, boar and predatory beasts and sugarcane, honey, vegetables, fruits and roots. They will wear rags, leaves and many kinds of bark and hides. Like sages, they will have to make their garments themselves. Using wooden sticks, they will dig up seeds from under the ground as food. They will make efforts to rear goats,

sheep, donkeys and camels. For the sake of water, humans will have to reside near rivers. In their conduct, kings will create obstructions for each other. They will have high opinions of themselves but have no subjects. They will be devoid of purity and good conduct. Men will be like this, establishing themselves in *adharma*. Subjects will follow those who are inferior and debased, devoid of *dharma*. At the time, lifespans will not exceed twenty-three years. People will be weak and suffer from old age, addicted to material objects. Leaves, roots and fruits will provide food. Garments will be made out of bark and black antelope skin. Desiring a means of subsistence, they will roam around the earth. When subjects reach this state, it will be the end of *kali yuga*. After one thousand divine years, *kali yuga* will be over.’

‘When *sandhyamsha* is also over, along with *kali yuga*, *krita yuga* will commence. *Krita yuga* will start when Chandra, Surya, Brihaspati and Tishya *nakshatra* are in the same *rashi*.⁵⁵⁸ In the due order, I have thus described to you all the lineages, the past, the present and the future. It should be known that the period from the birth of Parikshit to the consecration of Mahananda is one thousand and fifty years. It is possible to state that the duration of the period from after Mahapadma to the end of the Andhras is eight hundred and thirty-six years. This future duration has been enumerated by learned *rishis* conversant with the Puranas. At the time of Parikshit, the *saptarshis* will reach Pitrya *nakshatra*,⁵⁵⁹ remaining there for one hundred years. They will remain for one hundred years in each of the twenty-seven *nakshatras* and that will be the duration of the Andhra dynasty. There are twenty-seven *nakshatras* in the entire circle of *nakshatras*. In the due order, the *saptarshis* remain in each of these for one hundred years. In divine years, this is said to be the duration of a *yuga* for *saptarshis*.⁵⁶⁰ There are said to be six divine months and seven divine years. The divine duration of *saptarshis* is derived on the basis of that. In the northern direction, there are two among the *saptarshis* that are seen first. In the firmament, when a *nakshatra* is seen between these two, the *saptarshis* are known to be in conjunction with that *nakshatra* in the firmament and remain there for one hundred years.⁵⁶¹ This is said to be the

indication for the conjunction between the *rishis* and the *nakshatras*. As has been said, at the time of Parikshit, the *saptarshis* will be in that *nakshatra* for one hundred years. These one hundred years will be completed with the twenty-fourth king of the Andhra dynasty. As a consequence of natural hardships, the subjects will suffer immensely. Falsehood will overcome *dharma*, *artha* and *kama*. *Dharma* of *shruti* and *smriti* texts and that of *varnas* and *ashramas* will become lax. Weak and suffering from mixed *varnas*, they will proceed towards delusion. *Shudras* will have associations with *dvijas*. *Brahmanas* will perform sacrifices for *shudras*. *Shudras* will be the origin of *mantras*. *Brahmanas* will wish to be wicked in conduct and will seek subsistence through them. Little by little, in the due order, all the subjects will be destroyed. When the end of the *yuga* arrives, the ones who remain will also be destroyed. *Kali yuga* arrived on the very day that Krishna left for heaven. Hear about its duration. In human years, the duration of *kali yuga* is said to be three hundred and sixty thousand years. It amounts to one thousand divine years. A *sandhyamsha* is also described. When all of this is over, *krita yuga* will commence.’

‘The different divisions of Aila and Ikshvaku lineages have been described. It is said that the *kshatriya* lineage of Ikshvaku, *surya vamsha*, ended with Sumitra. The learned know that the *kshatriya* lineage of Aila, *chandra vamsha*, ended with Kshemaka. Vivasvat’s sons have been described and they extended the lineage. They are from the past, the present and the future. They are said to have been *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras*. From one *yuga* to another *yuga*, thousands of great-souled ones have passed on. From one lineage to another lineage, there are many names that are enumerated. To avoid repetition and since there are so many, I have not described all of them. Nimi’s lineage will end in this *Vaivasvata manvantara*. I will describe those from whom *kshatriyas* will again start in this *yuga*. Listen to my words. King Devapi from the Puru lineage and Maru from the Ikshvaku lineage possess great strength of *yoga* and are established in Kalapagrama. In the twenty-fourth *mahayuga*, they will start *kshatriyas* again. In the twenty-ninth *mahayuga*, Ikshvaku ⁵⁶² will have a son named Suvarcha. He will start the lineage. In Aila’s lineage through

Devapi, Poula will be the first king. In the cycle of *mahayugas*, these two will start *kshatriyas*. In every case, this should be understood as the signs of offspring. They are destroyed in *kali yuga* and start afresh in *krita yuga*. In the first *treta yuga*, along with the *saptarshis*, these two will also initiate the system of *gotras* for *kshatriyas*. In a part of *dvapara*, *kshatriyas* remain, along with *rishis*. This is for the future period of creation when *krita yuga* starts afresh. These are seeds for future *brahmanas* and *kshatriyas*. In this way, for the sake of offspring from one *yuga* to another *yuga*, *saptarshis* remain, along with all the *asuras* and the kings. When *kshatriyas* are destroyed, they are reborn through association with *brahmanas*. You have heard about the progeny in the seven *manvantaras*. The origins and functions of *brahmanas* and *kshatriyas* depend on each other. Their destruction follows the pattern of their origin.⁵⁶³ Because they live for a long time, the *saptarshis* know about this origin and destruction. O *dvijas*! This is the due order of the Aila and Ikshvaku lineages. They originate in *treta yuga* and are again destroyed in *kali yuga*. They follow the nature of the *yuga*, until the *manvantara* ends. Rama, Jamadagni's son, exterminated *kshatriyas*. This was because all the *kshatriya* kings had caused confusion. I will describe the origins of the two lineages. Listen. The nature of the progress of the Aila and Ikshvaku lineages is different. Kings and *kshatriyas* follow a certain progression. This is true of kings who are said to belong to the Aila lineage and is also true of kings from the Ikshvaku lineage. In each of these, one hundred and one have been consecrated as kings. The duration of Bhoja kings is said to be twice as long. Three-fourths of *kshatriyas* are established. The remaining one-fourth is dispersed in different directions. There were others in the past who were their contemporaries. I will tell you. Listen. There were one hundred Prativindhya and one hundred Nagas, along with Haihayas. There were one hundred Dhritarashtras and eighty Janamejays. There were one hundred Brahmadattas and one hundred Sharins and Virins. There were one hundred Poulas, Shvetakas, Kashyas, Kushas and others. That apart, in the past, there were one thousand Shashabindus. All of them performed horse sacrifices, with one million⁵⁶⁴ *dakshina*. In this way, there were hundreds and thousands of *rajarshis* in the

past and in the current Vaivasvata *manvantara*. Understand that they are said to have had offspring in this world. But in the due order, it is impossible to describe their offspring in detail, even if one speaks for one hundred years. Twenty-eight *mahayugas* have passed in Vaivasvata *manvantara*,⁵⁶⁵ along with their *rajarashis*. Hear about the ones that remain. There will be forty-three in the future, along with their kings. These are the remaining *mahayugas*, before Vaivasvata *manvantara* comes to an end. I have told you everything, briefly and in detail. Because of repetition and because there are too many, it is impossible to describe everything in detail. These five lineages of Yayati's sons were beneficial to the world. The past ones have been described. They sustained the world. If an intelligent person hears about these five lineages and nurtures it, he obtains five boons that are extremely difficult to obtain in this world—a long lifespan, deeds, wealth, sons and eternal heaven. O *dvijas*! I have thus recited the third *pada*, in detail and the due order.⁵⁶⁶ What will I describe next?'

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Chapter 113-2(1) (Description of the deluge)

Hearing the third *pada*, as narrated by the intelligent Suta, the excellent *rishis* asked him about the fourth *pada*.

The *rishis* said, ‘Out of your affection towards us, you have narrated the third *pada*. Please describe in detail the fourth *pada* of *samhara*.⁵⁶⁷ In detail and in the due order, please tell us everything about all the *manvantaras*, the past and the future, the *saptarshis* for those, the current *manvantara* and the extent and form of the great-souled one’s creation.’

Suta replied, ‘I will describe all this accurately. O excellent sages! This is the fourth *pada*, *samhara*. It is currently the period of Vaivasvata Manu. O *dvijas*! In the due order and detail, hear about the great-souled one’s creation. I will briefly tell you about the future seven *manvantaras* and the dissolution of the worlds. Listen to me. The subjects for each of these seven will be described.⁵⁶⁸ Hear briefly from me about the future *manvantaras*.’

‘I will speak about Savarni Manu, the son of Vivasvat. I will briefly speak about what will occur in the future. Listen.⁵⁶⁹ The seven future *maharshis* are said to be Galava from the Koushika lineage; Jamadagni’s son, from the Bhargava lineage; Dvaipayana from Vasishtha’s lineage; Kripa from Sharadvata’s lineage; Diptiman from Atri’s lineage; Rishyashringa from Kashyapa’s lineage and the immensely illustrious Ashvatthama, Drona’s son from the Bharadvaja lineage. These seven great-souled ones will be the future supreme *rishis*. There will be three categories of *devas*—Sutapas, Amitabhas and Sukhas. There are said to be twenty *devas* in each of these categories. I will describe the names to you. Listen attentively. The names of the twenty Sutapas are described as Ritu, Tapa, Shukra, Kriti, Nemi, Prabhakara, Prabhasa, Masakrit, Dharma, Tejas, Rashmi, Kratu, Virat, Archishman, Dyotana, Bhanu, Yasha, Kirti, Budha and Dhriti. The twenty Amitabhas are described as Prabhu, Vibhu, Vibhasa, Jetri, Hantri, Ariha, Kratu, Sumati, Pramati, Dipti, Samakhyata, Maha, Mahan, Dehi, Muni, Ina, Poshta, Sama, Satya and Vishruta. The twenty

Sukhas in the first Savarni *manvantara* are described as Dama, Dani, Rita, Soma, Vitta, Vaidya, Yama, Nidhi, Homa, Havya, Huta, Dana, Deya, Datri, Tapas, Shama, Dhruva, Sthana, Vidhana and Niyama. They are sons of the great-souled Kashyapa, Marichi's son. There are sixty *devas* in the current *manvantara* and there will be the same number in the future one too.

Savarni Manu will have nine sons. They will be Virajas, Arvarivan, Nirmoka and others. I will speak about the nine, in each of the *manvantaras* after Savarni *manvantara*. There will be other Savarni Manus who will be Brahma's sons.⁵⁷⁰ Four, Meru-Savarni and others, will possess divine vision. They will be Daksha's grandsons, sons through his daughter, Kriyaa. Those immensely energetic ones are engaged in great austerities on the slopes of Meru. They were born through Brahma and others and through the intelligent Daksha. They had gone to Maharloka and are now engaged in Meru. They will be future Manus. Earlier, these great ones were born during Chakshusha *manvantara*. Having been born, they will be Manus in future *manvantaras*. Among these Manus, grandsons of Prachetas Daksha, five have the name Savarni, while four have been born from supreme *rishis*.'

'There is one Savarni who was the son of Samjna and Vivasvat.⁵⁷¹ Samjna's eldest son is the lord who is named Vaisvasvata Manu. The auspicious births of these two occurred when Vaivasvata *manvantara* started. The fourteen Manus extended their deeds. They have been described in the *Vedas*, the *smriti* texts and the Puranas. They are the lords of *prajas*. They are established as the lords of all beings. This earth, with its seven *dvipas* and all its habitations, will be protected by these lords among men for a complete one thousand *mahayugas*. I will speak in detail about their offspring and austerities. It is known that there are creations of these fourteen, Svayambhuva and the others. Once, each has rights, for his respective *manvantara*. When the period for the exercise of rights is over, he goes to Maharloka. Out of these, six are over. Eight remain. The lord exists in the earlier one, but rules over the current one. O *dvijas*! I will speak about all the future ones that remain, along with *devas*, *rishis*, *danavas* and the creation of *prajas*. Details about these can be gleaned from that of Vaivasvata's creation. Indeed, none of them exceed, or fall short, of

that in *Vaivasvata manvantara*. There is no need to repeat this multiple times. Therefore, I will not describe each in detail. This is true of the past *manvantaras*, as well as the future ones. It should be known that there are divisions in creation, from one lineage to another. To understand this completely, one has to look at the details, in the due order. Daksha had a daughter who was devoted to *dharma*. She was famous under the name of Suvrataa. Among all the daughters of Virini,⁵⁷² she was the oldest and the best. Her father took this daughter and went to the presence of the unsullied Brahma, who was seated, attended by Dharma and Bhava. In the presence of Bhava and Dharma, Brahma spoke to Daksha. “Your daughter, Suvrataa, will give birth to four sons who will be Manus. They will be auspicious and will establish the four *varnas*.” Hearing Brahma’s words, those three, Daksha, Dharma and Bhava, approached the maiden, using their mental powers. They were accompanied by Brahma. Since their meditation was truthful, the daughter instantly gave birth to four sons who were exactly like them. They would be successful in accomplishing their tasks. When they were born, they were infused with prosperity. From the moment they were born, their bodies were capable of enjoying. Seeing them manifest themselves, Brahma and the others exclaimed, “This is my son. My son.” They were proud and attracted the respective sons towards themselves. They told each other, “He has resulted from my meditation. Let each one always accept the son who is exactly like him in bodily form. Let each one accept the son who is exactly like him in beauty, energy and dimensions. O fortunate ones! Let each one accept the one who is similar in complexion. It is certainly the case that the son is just like the father in form and appearance. Since a father’s seed is placed inside a mother, the son is just like the father.” Having made this agreement, each of them accepted his own son. When *Chakshusha manvantara* was over and *Vaivasvata manvantara* arrived, a son named Rouchya was born to Prajapati Ruchi. Since the wise one had this son through Bhuti, his name became Bhoutya. In *Vaivasvata manvantara*, Vivasvat had two Manus as sons. *Vaivasvata* Manu was one and the other was known as Savarni. The lord *Vaivasvata* Manu is known as the son of Samjna. The other son, born to Vivasvat and

Savarnaa, is known as Savarni Manu. The four Savarni Manus, born through the *maharshis*, are engaged in austerities, waiting for their own respective future *manvantaras*. They will accomplish all the tasks in the future.’

‘The first of these Manus is Meru-Savarni, Daksha’s son. There will be three categories of *devas*—Paras, the ones born through Marichi and Sudharmans. All these great-souled ones were born during Vaivasvata *manvantara*, as the sons of Rohita Prajapati, Daksha’s son. They will be *devas* in the future and each of these categories will have twelve *devas*. The twelve Paras are known as Aishvara, Graha, Rahu, Vaku, Vasha and others. Hear about the others. The twelve Marichis are Vajipa, Vajijit, Prabhuti, Kakudma, Dadhikrava, Vipakva, Pranita, Vijaya, Madhu, Utathya and two by the name of Uttamaka. I will mention the names of the Sudharmans. Listen. They are Varna, Athagarvi, Bhuranya, Vrajana, Amita, a second Amita, Dravaketu, Jambha, Aja, Shakraka, Sunemi and Dyutaya. These are described as the Sundharmans. Their Indra, the future one, will have the name of Adbhuta. He is Skanda, Parvati’s son, also known as Kartikeya and Pavaki. The seven *saptarshis* during Rohita *manvantara* ⁵⁷³ will be Medhatithi from Pulastya’s lineage, Vasu from Kashyapa’s lineage, Jyotishman from Bhrigu’s lineage, Dyutiman from the lineage of Angiras, Vasina from Vasishtha’s lineage, Havyavahana from Atri’s lineage and Sutapa from Pulaha’s lineage. The nine sons of Savarni Manu are described as Dhritiketu, Diptiketu, Shapa, Hasta, Niramaya, Prithushrava, Anika, Bhuridyumna and Brihadyasha.’

‘In the tenth *manvantara*, Dharma’s son will be Manu. ⁵⁷⁴ He will be the Manu during the second of the Savarni *manvantaras*. There are said to be two categories of *devas*—Sudhamans and Viruddhas. All of them will be radiant and the total number will be one hundred. The *rishis* say that there are one hundred types of *prana* in Purusha. At the time of the Manu who is Dharma’s son, they will be the *devas*. Their future Indra is said to be the learned Shanti. The seven supreme *rishis* are said to be Havishman from Pulaha’s lineage, the prosperous Sukirti from Bhrigu’s lineage, Apomurti from Atri’s lineage, Apava from Vasishtha’s lineage, Apratima from

Pulastya's lineage, Nabhaga from Kashyapa's lineage and Abhimanyu from the lineage of Angiras. The ten sons of Manu are described as Sukshetra, Uttamouja, Bhurisenā, Viryavan, Shatanika, Niramitra, Vrishasena, Jayadratha, Bhuridyumna and Suvarcha.'

'In the eleventh *manvantara*, the Manu will be the third Savarni. There are said to be three categories of great-souled *devas*, Nirvanaratis, Kamagas and Manojavas. Each of these categories of the residents of heaven will have thirty *devas*. Wise ones know that there are thirty days in a month. They will be the Nirvanarati *devas*. The thirty nights will be Vihangamas.

⁵⁷⁵ The thirty *muhurtas* are said to be the *devas* belonging to the third category of Manojava *devas*. These are Brahma's sons, born through his mental powers, and they will feature in the future. Their Indra, the future king of the Gods, will have the name of Vrisha. I will describe the seven *rishis*. Listen. They will be Havishman from Kashyapa's lineage, Vapushman from Bhrigu's lineage, Aruni from Atri's lineage, Naga from Vasishtha's lineage, Pushti from the lineage of Angiras, Nishchara from Pulastya's lineage and Atiteja from Pulaha's lineage. Such are the *devas* during the eleventh *manvantara*. The nine sons of Savarni Prajapati will be Sarvavega, Sudharma, Devanika, Purovaha, Kshemadharma, Graheshu, Adarsha, Poundraka and Maru.'

'In the twelfth *manvantara*, Rudra's son will be the Manu. This is the fourth Savarni *manvantara*, that of Rudra-Savarni. In the future, there are said to be five categories of *devas*, Haritas, Rohitas, Sumanas, Sukarmans and Sutaras. The ten Haritas are described as Vidvan, Sahasrada, Parvata, Anuchara, Apashu, Manjova, Urja, Svaha, Svadha and Tara. The ten Rohitas are described as Tapo, Jnani, Mriti, Varcha, Bandhu, Raja, Raaja, Svarnapada, Pushti and Vidhi. Thirty-three *devas* have already been mentioned, starting with the Tushitas. They should be known as the Sumanas. Now hear about the Sukarmans. They are Supvara, Vrishabha, Prishtha, Kapi, Dyumna, Vipashchit, Vikrama, Krama, Vibhrita and Kanta. These are *devas* known as Sukarmans. Now hear about Sutaras. They are Varsha, Divya, Anjishtha, Varchasvi, Dyutiman, Kavi, Shubha, Havi, Kritaprapti and Vyaprita as the tenth. The names of the *devas*, Sutaras, has

been described. It should be known that their Indra will be the immensely illustrious Ritadhama. The seven *rishis* should be known as Vasishtha's son, Dyuti, Sutapas from Atri's lineage, Tapomurti from the lineage of Angiras, Tapasvi from Kashyapa's lineage, Tapodhana from Pulastya's lineage, Taporati from Pulaha's lineage and Tapodhriti from Bhrigu's lineage. These are the *siddhas*, the *saptarshis*, in the last of the Savarni *manvantaras*. The sons of the twelfth Manu will be Devavan, Upadeva, Devashreshtha, Viduratha, Mitraavan, Mitrasena, Chitrasena, Amitraha, Mitrabahu and Suvarchas.'

'The thirteenth future *manvantara* is said to be that of Rouchya. Svayambhu has said that there will be three categories of *devas*. All these great-souled ones are sons born through Brahma's mental powers. The three categories are Sutramans, Sudharmans and Sukarmans. These are said to be the three future categories of Gods, the ones who will drink *soma*. There are thirty-three *devas* who are separately offered *ghee* by those who perform sacrifices. The *ajyas* are those who are offered *ghee*. The *prishadaajyas* are those who are offered *ghee* mixed with milk. There are also those who are the best among *grahas*. Hear about the thirty-three separate *devas*. The Sutramans are the *ajyas*. They are the ones who are offered *ghee* now and accept them. The Sukarmans are *prisdhajyas*, those who are offered *ghee* mixed with milk and accept them. The Sudharmans are also worshipped through sacrifices.⁵⁷⁶ Thus, *devas* have been described. Their Indra will be Divaspati, great in spirits. Ruchi's sons are known to have been the sons of Pulaha's son.⁵⁷⁷ The seven *rishis* of the thirteenth *manvantara* will be Dhritiman from the lineage of Angiras, Avyaya from Pulastya's lineage, Tattvadarshi from Pulaha's lineage, Nirutsuka from Bhrigu's lineage, Nishprakampya from Atri's lineage, Nirmoha from Kashyapa's lineage and Sutapas from Vasishtha's lineage. The ten sons of Rouchya Manu, in the thirteenth *manvantara*, will be Chitrasena, Vichitra, Naya, Dharma, Dhrita, Bhava, Aneka, Kshatravridhha, Surasa and Nirbhaya.'

'In the fourteenth *manvantara* of Bhoutya Manu, it is said that there will be five categories of *devas*. They are Chakshushas, Pavitras, Kanishthas, Bhrajitas and Vachavridhhas. These are described as the five categories of

devas. There are seven *svaras*, *nishada* and the others.⁵⁷⁸ Know that these are the seven Chakshushas. There are seven metres from *Sama* hymns, *brihati* and others.⁵⁷⁹ These are known as the seven Kanishthas. The seven worlds are the Pavitras and the seven oceans are the Bhrajitas. The Vachavridhdhas are known as the *rishis* who existed at the time of Svayambhuva Manu. It should be known that all the Indras of the *manvantaras* are similar in characteristics, energy, austerities, intelligence, strength, learning and valour. There are beings in the three worlds, mobile and immobile. Using their own respective qualities, the Indras overcome all of them. There are those who existed before the creation of beings. There are happy ones who exist in the middle, when beings are created. There are also those who are capable of existing when beings have been destroyed. The *Vedas* speak of these three types. The seven sages are said to be Agnidhra from Kashyapa's lineage, Magadha from Pulastya's lineage, Agnibahu from Bhrigu's lineage, Shuchi from the lineage of Angiras, Shukra from Vasishtha's lineage, Mukta from Pulaha's lineage and Shvajita from Atri's lineage. Now hear about Manu's sons. They are Uru, Guru, Gambhirta, Buddha, Shuddha, Shuchi, Kriti, Urjasvi and Subala. These will be the sons of Bhoutya Manu. There are four Savarni Manus who are Brahma's sons. One of them is the son of Vivasvat and is known as Savarni Manu. Rouchya and Bhoutya are held to be the descendants of Pulaha and Bhrigu. During the reign of Bhoutya Manu, the *kalpa* will be completed.'

'At the end of many *yugas*, when all the *manvantaras* are over, everything is destroyed. This is spoken of as *samhara*. There are seven *devas*, descended from Bhrigu, who exist when all the *manvantaras* are over. They have enjoyed the three worlds for the duration of the seventy-one *mahayugas*. When the *manvantaras* are over, along with the ancestors and the Manus, they are also destroyed. All the three worlds will be deprived of support. The *Sthanins*⁵⁸⁰ are dislodged from their auspicious positions and are separated from stars, *nakshatras* and planets. The lords of the three worlds reach Maharloka, where those who survive beyond the *kalpa* reside. These are Ajitas and other fourteen categories that possess long lifespans. In all the *manvantaras*, there are fourteen *devas*. It is heard

that they go to Janaloka in their bodies, along with their followers. Thus, *devas* pass over Maharloka and to Janaloka. *Bhutadi* ⁵⁸¹ alone is left. Starting with Bhuloka and ending with Maharloka, all the positions in the worlds become empty, including immobile objects. *Devas* proceed upwards and are united with those who survive beyond the *kalpa*. Brahma withdraws *devas*, *rishis*, ancestors and *danavas*. At the end of his day, he sees that his creation and the *mahayugas* have come to an end. The learned know that Brahma's day ends after one thousand *mahayugas*. Those who know about night and day know that his night also ends after one thousand *mahayugas*. The withdrawal of all beings is said to be of three types—*naimittika*, *prakritika* and *atyantika*. ⁵⁸² *Naimittika* withdrawal is said to be that which is done by Brahma at the end of a *kalpa*. When the causes are destroyed, the destruction of beings is *prakritika*. Development of *jnana* is said to be *atyantika* since the cause behind birth is eliminated. Thus, Brahma withdraws *devas* and the residents of the three worlds. At the end of a *prahara*, ⁵⁸³ he again brings about the dissolution of his creation. Desiring to sleep, Bhagavan Brahma withdraws *prajas*. At the end of one thousand *mahayugas*, the destruction of *yugas* arrives. Prajapati makes all the *prajas* reside within him.'

'After this, there is a lack of rain, lasting for one hundred years. As a result of this, all beings on the surface of the earth have little substance left. Everything is dissolved and reduced to a state of earth. The sun rises, on a chariot with seven rays. The rays are intolerable and the illustrious one drinks up all the water with his rays. The seventy tawny rays blaze. They whirl around and gradually pervade the firmament. The energy blazes severely and burns the thick wood on earth. Thus, Surya is said to suck up the water and scorch. When there is a lack of rain, Surya scorches. When there is a lack of rain, it sprinkles down. ⁵⁸⁴ When there is a lack of rain, water enters Ravi, and he blazes. Thus, drinking up water, Ravi blazes in the firmament. With the seven rays, he drinks up water from the great ocean. Feeding on this, seven blazing suns result. Seven suns result from the rays and blaze in the four directions. Those crested suns burn everything in the four worlds. The rays spread above, below and sideways. The seven

suns blaze, like the fire that scorches at the end of a *yuga*. The water ignites the many thousands of rays. Remaining in the firmament, they scorch the earth. The earth is heated and scorched by them. The earth, with its mountains, rivers and oceans, is robbed of all moisture. There is a blaze all around, colourful in all directions. Surya's rays constrain everything, above, below and sideways. As they touch each other, the fires in the suns are enhanced. They become one and there is a single fire that blazes. Having assumed the form of a fire, it circles around and destroys all the worlds. The energy swiftly burns down everything in the four worlds. Everything, mobile and immobile, is dissolved. Devoid of trees and devoid of grass, the earth resembles the back of a tortoise. Everything in the entire universe comes to resemble a frying pan. Everything is filled by the rays and there is a dense blaze. There are beings on the surface of the earth and inside the great ocean. All these are dissolved and are reduced to the state of the earth. The fire, which is in all *atmans*, burns down everything—*dvipas*, mountains, *varshas* ⁵⁸⁵ and the large ocean. The blazing fire is kindled and reaches earth, drinking up the water from oceans, rivers, Patala and everywhere else. This terrible Samvartaka fire expands and transcends mountains and planets. It blazes and destroys the worlds. It shatters earth and dries up Rasatala. It scorches Patala and burns Vayu's world. It burns the earth from below and the firmament from above. The flames of the Samvartaka fire rise, extending for thousands, millions and trillions of *yojanas*. It burns *gandharvas*, *pishachas*, large *uragas* and *rakshasas*. It blazes and burns all the worlds of Bhuloka, Bhavarloka, Svarloka and Maharloka. This terrible fire of destruction burns the four worlds. The fire pervades the worlds, above and sideways. The energy gradually reaches the entire universe. Everything seems to appear like a huge mass of iron. Terrible Samvartaka clouds rise and cover the firmament. They are ornamented with flashes of lightning and resemble herds of gigantic elephants. Some are as dark as blue lotuses; some possess the complexion of water-lilies. Some are like lapis lazuli; others possess the complexion of blue sapphire. Some are like conch shells and jasmine; others possess the complexion of black collyrium. Some clouds are smoky in hue, other clouds

are yellow. Some have the hue of donkeys; others possess the colour of lac juice. Some resemble red arsenic; other clouds possess the complexion of doves. Some are like *indragopa* insects,⁵⁸⁶ others possess the complexion of green parrots. Some possess the hue of a crow's wings. Some clouds rise in the firmament. Some resemble excellent cities; others are like herds of elephants. Some resemble mountains, others are like dense bits of ground. Some resemble playing halls, others are like schools of fish. There are many forms. There are terrible forms. They thunder in terrible tones. In this way, the clouds fill up the entire firmament. The clouds, thundering in terrible tones, appropriate the suns. They expand, appropriate the seven fires and pacify them. After this, the clouds rain down, releasing torrents of water. These destroy all the inauspicious and extremely terrible fires. As a result of this excessive rain, the universe is filled with water. With the fire overcome by water, fire enters the water. The fires are destroyed. The fire that originated enters the shower created by the clouds. The entire universe is flooded by this great flow of water. Urged by Svayambhu, the water fills up everything. Other floods of water cross the shoreline. The mountains and *dvipas* are drunk up and immersed in water. The water from the clouds in the firmament pours down on the ground again. In every direction, a wind, terrible in form, envelopes the firmament. Everything mobile and immobile is destroyed in that single terrible mass of water. When one thousand *mahayugas* are over, it is said that the *kalpa* is over.'

'The learned say that the world is covered by a single mass of water. Earth, water, space and wind are all in that single mass of water. The fire is destroyed and in that blinding darkness, nothing can be discerned. Everything on earth, everything in the waters of the ocean and everything divine is rendered immobile. They proceed to a union that is known as water. That water is described to be one where nothing comes or goes. The earth is shrouded in water and is known as an ocean. Water is known as *ambhas*, because it shines, and its beauty is radiant.⁵⁸⁷ That radiance pervades. Since everything is reduced to ashes, it is spoken of as *ambhas*. The root "ar" is said to convey a sense of multiplicity and swiftness. Since everything is reduced to a single mass of stationary water, water is known

as *naara*. This is what happens at the end of one thousand *mahayugas*, when Brahma's day is over. The universe becomes a single ocean of water for the same length of time. At that time, Prajapati withdraws from every kind of action. Everything mobile and immobile is then destroyed in that single ocean. Brahma then comes to possess one thousand eyes and one thousand feet. With an excellent mind, he comes to have one thousand heads, one thousand feet, one thousand eyes and faces and one thousand tongues. This is the first Prajapati, with one thousand arms. The three *Vedas* are in him, and he is spoken of as Purusha. He possesses the complexion of the sun. He is the protector of the universe. He is unmatched and alone. He is the first mighty lord. He is Hiranyagarbha Purusha. One reads about him as the great one, the one beyond *rajas*. At the end of one thousand *mahayugas*, everything is flooded with water. The divinity desires to sleep. Since the lord doesn't want illumination, he creates night. As he sleeps, the four kinds of beings ⁵⁸⁸ are dissolved into him. The seven *maharshis* perceive the great-souled Kala. ⁵⁸⁹ Having obtained insight through their austerities, they enter Janaloka. These are Bhrigu and other great-souled ones and their characteristics have been described earlier. With their insight, they can perceive Satyaloka and the other seven worlds. During Brahma's night, they can constantly see Brahma. The *saptarshis* perceive Kala sleeping during his night. Since he is a Parameshthi who is beyond *kalpas*, one reads about him as Adya. ⁵⁹⁰ At the beginning of *kalpas*, he is the one who repeatedly creates. Like this, Prajapati absorbs everything within himself. The immensely energetic one is the one who creates everything. He gathers everything into his *atman*. During the night, he resides in the ocean, which is a single mass of water. When the night is over, Prajapati wakes up. His mind turns to the idea of creating afresh. When Prajapati is calm after withdrawing the worlds, that period of dissolution is thought of as Brahma's *naimittika* destruction. It is said that all beings are separated from their bodies then. All the beings are scorched by the sun's rays. *Devas*, *rishis* and noble Manus are submerged in that flood, as are *gandharvas* and other beings and all the *pishachas*. Those who are not scorched by the *kalpa* seek refuge in Janaloka. Those born as inferior species have gone to hell.

They are scorched there and cleansed of all their sins. As long as the universe is flooded in water, they are also submerged in water. When the night is over, all the beings are again born from Brahma, whose birth is not manifest. This includes *rishis*, Manus, *devas* and the four kinds of *prajas*. It is said that even *siddhas* face origin and destruction. Just as the sun rises and sets in this world, it is said that the birth and destruction of beings are witnessed in that way. When creation occurs after the flood, this is spoken of as *samsara*. All beings are born after the rains. From one *kalpa* to another *kalpa*, all *prajas* and immobile objects originate in this way. With the progress of time, the seasons display different characteristics and forms. What is seen at the time of Brahma's day and night is just like that. At the time of withdrawal, there is destruction of everything mobile and immobile and they enter Prajapati. At the time of creation, *prajas* emerge from him again. Brahma is a great *yogi*. He is the great lord of all beings. At the beginning of a *kalpa*, he is repeatedly the creator of all beings. The great divinity is both manifest and unmanifest and this entire universe is his. Here and there, everything auspicious and inauspicious flows from him. Depending on these, mortals are thought to move from one body to another, moving upwards and downwards. There are *devas*, Manus, *siddhas* and other lords of subjects who go to heaven. Just as heat sucks up water and showers it down, these entities are also born again.'

'After this, I will speak about the measurement of time for the deluge. O *dvijas*! I have already explained the fourteen *manvantaras*, along with the creation of *prajas* and *devas*. There are fourteen *manvantaras* in a period of one thousand *mahayugas*. Two thousand *mahayugas* are said to be a specific *kalpa*. This is known as Brahma's day and night. Hear about the enumeration of time. When one rests, a *nimesha* is said to be the same as a *matra* or *kshana*. Fifteen *nimeshas* of a human eye are described as one *kashtha*. Five *kshanas* are one *lava*.⁵⁹¹ Eighteen *nimeshas* are one *kashtha*. Three *kashthas* are one *prastha* and seven *prasthas* are one *udaka*. This is how *lava* is successfully measured. Thirty *lavas* make up one *kala* and it should be known that there are thirty *kalas* in one *muhurta*. The duration of day and night is said to consist of thirty *muhurtas*. Hence, there are more

than six hundred *kalas* in a day and night.⁵⁹² It should be known that this enumeration is in accordance with the movements of the sun and the moon. Fifteen *nimeshas* make up one *kashtha*. Thirty *kashthas* make up one *kala*. There are thirty *kalas* in one *muhurta*. *Kala* is said to amount to one-tenth of a *muhurta*. It is also said that forty-five *kalas* make up one *muhurta*. Those who know about *lavas* and *muhurtas* speak about measurements in this way. In accordance with the measurements used in Magadha, thirteen *palas* are said to amount to one *prastha* of water. A vessel is taken, measuring four *angulas* on every side. A golden wire four *angulas* long and one *masha* in weight is inserted into it. The time taken for this to be submerged in water is one *nadika*.⁵⁹³ The water that passes through this is said to be one *prastha*. When day and night are equal, there are two *nadikas* in one *muhurta*. These measurements are always made with specific reference to the movements of the sun. What is spoken of as more than six hundred *kalas* should be known to be a human day. The duration of a *nakshatra* day is ten times more. In *savana* reckoning,⁵⁹⁴ this is described as the duration of a human year. However, for divine measurements, the sacred texts have determined that this amounts to a day and night. Months, *ayanas* and years should be calculated based on such days. Learning has determined that this is the description and characteristic. This is also said to be the knowledge for measuring *kalas*. One of Brahma's days is said to amount to 1,20,90,000 years for *devas*.⁵⁹⁵

‘Hearing this, the *rishis* were extremely surprised. They wished to know more about the enumeration of time and asked. The *rishis* asked, “What is the accepted reckoning according to human years? We wish to hear the measurement briefly, in appropriate *padas* and *aksharas*.” The divinity, Vayu, possessed divine insight. On hearing their words, engaged in the welfare of the worlds, the lord replied succinctly. “His night and day have already been described, in worldly terms. I will enumerate the end of Brahma's day in those years. O *dvijas*! This enumeration of the duration of the deluge is described as 4,32,89,80,000 years, according to human years.⁵⁹⁶ This is the period of deluge and the worlds are burnt down by the seven suns. The four kinds of *prajas* are dissolved into the gross elements. The

world is flooded with water and everything mobile and immobile is destroyed. The withdrawal is over and Prajapati is pacified. There is no illumination. Scorched, everything is enveloped by the darkness of night. Ishvara alone is established then, in that single mass of water. The duration of that single mass of water is known to be the same as the extent of a day of the lord. During the night, there is water. When this recedes, it is said to be day. In the due order, day and night follow each other. When the deluge occurs, this is described as a night and day for the lord. All entities in the three worlds, mobile and immobile, face dissolution. Hence, this is described as the submergence of beings and that of *prajas*, past, present and future. Measurements for *devas* are several multiples of that of a *parardha*.⁵⁹⁷ Two *parardhas* are described as his lifespan. This is the period during which Aja⁵⁹⁸ Prajapati is established. Parameshthi Brahma remains until his existence also comes to an end. The force of the wind quietens the flame of a lamp. Like that, when his existence comes to an end, Brahma is also quietened. He is himself absorbed into the original Mahat Maheshvara. In turn, Mahat is dissolved into the unmanifest and there is equilibrium in the *gunas*. I have thus described the dissolution of beings to you. Brahma's *naimittika* destruction is like controlling oneself and washing oneself with water. I have narrated it briefly. What will I describe next for you? If a person constantly hears this and nurtures it, if he recites it and describes it, he obtains great *siddhi*.”

Chapter 114-2(2) (Description of Shiva's city)

Vayu said, 'For people who are extraordinary in conduct, subtle in their vision, there are special kinds of *dharma* and the offering of oblations that are prescribed. Along with *devas*, they reside in Maharloka and are established there. Fourteen Manus, who extended their deeds, have been described, as have past, present and future *devas*, *rishis*, Manus and ancestors. I have already described all those who seek refuge in Maharloka. They are with Gods and are *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas* and *vaishyas* who are devoted to *dharma*. Along with them, there are those who have performed rites faithfully, without being full of insolence, and those who have established themselves in the *dharma* of *varnas* and *ashramas*, as described in the *shruti* and *smriti* texts. When the *manvantaras* are over, they withdraw from their rights.'

The *rishis* asked, 'O lord! O Matarishvan! ⁵⁹⁹ You have spoken about Maharloka. For those who are based in that world, what are the tasks?'

He knew about the truth and replied in sweet words that were in conformity with the truth.

Vayu answered, '*Maharshis* have created fourteen abodes. These are described as worlds and humans reside there. Seven of these are described as *Kritas* and seven are *Akritas*. ⁶⁰⁰ The seven worlds starting with Bhuloka and ending with Satyaloka are *Kritas*. The seven worlds that evolved from Prakriti are *Akritas*. The locations are bound to *Sthanins*, created along with them. The earth, the firmament, heaven and Maharloka, these four worlds are described as sheaths. They are subject to perishing, though there are some there who do not perish. ⁶⁰¹ They remain until the *naimittika* deluge of beings comes about. There are three worlds, Janaloka, Tapoloka and Satyaloka. They remain steady until the final destruction comes about. I will clearly describe these seven abodes. Bhuloka is the first and the second is said to be Bhuvarka. Svarloka is known as the third and the fourth is described as Maharloka. Janaloka is the fifth and Tapoloka is thought of as

the sixth. Satyaloka is the seventh and the world without illumination is beyond this. In a *vyahriti*,⁶⁰² “*bhuh*” is stated first and Bhuloka emerged from this. When the second part of “*bhuvah*” was uttered, the firmament appeared. When the third bit of “*svah*” was uttered, heaven manifested itself. With the three parts of *vyahriti*, Brahma thought of the worlds. That is the reason Bhuloka is the earth and Bhuvanloka is said to be the firmament. Svarloka is heaven. This is the determination arrived at in the Puranas. The lord of everything that has come into existence is Agni and he is described as Bhutapati.⁶⁰³ Vayu is the lord of Bhuvanloka and Vayu is described as Bhuvapati. Surya is the lord of heaven and Surya is Divapati. When “*mahah*” was uttered, Maharloka came into being. When their rights are withdrawn, *devas* who are there are destroyed. Janaloka is the fifth world and there are those who are born from there. Since Svayambhuva and other subjects are born from there, it is known as Janaloka.⁶⁰⁴ Svayambhuva and the others have been described earlier. In this *kalpa*, they were established in Tapoloka, performing austerities. Ribhu, Sanatkumara and others held up their seed, cleansing themselves through austerities. That is the reason it is known as Tapoloka.⁶⁰⁵ The word Satya indicates Brahma, standing for pure existence. Thus, the radiant seventh world of Satyaloka is Brahma’s world. *Gandharvas*, *apsaras*, *yakshas*, *guhyakas*, *rakshasas*, all *bhutas* and *pishachas*, *nagas*, humans and all *devas* reside in Svarloka. Maruts, wind-Gods, Rudras, the two *devas* who are Ashvins and those without habitation reside in Bhuvanloka, the firmament. Adityas, Ribhus, Vishvadevas, Sadhyas and ancestors reside in heaven. The Angiras *rishis* dwell in Bhuvanloka. There are *devas* who are in *vimanas*, living in stars and planets. Starting with Shukra and ending with Chakshusha, there are those who have passed away, seeking refuge in Bhuloka. Using the *tanmatras*, they purify each other. Maharloka is the fourth and those who reside during the *kalpa* are there. It is said that they emerged in this way, from Brahma’s *vyahriti*. It is said that starting with Bhuloka and ending with Maharloka, all these worlds are scorched by the rays of the seven suns. Marichi, Kashyapa, Daksha, Svayambhuva, Angiras, Bhrigu, Pulastya, Pulaha, Kratu and others—all these are Prajapatis. They have no possessions and are devoid of a

sense of ownership. They hold up their seed. Ribhu, Sanatkumara and others—these are stores of austerities that are devoid of *rajas*. In all the *manvantaras*, they are described as possessing similar *varnas*. All those in the fourteen worlds are subject to causes of rebirth. However, there are those who fix their *atmans* in *yoga*, austerities and *sattva*. It is said that when the calamity arrives, they withdraw themselves to the sixth world. The seventh world of Satyaloka is for those who do not return. It is known as Brahma's world and it possesses the trait of not suffering from any impediments.'

'The expanse of Bhuloka is said to be determined by the extent of revolution. The expanse between the earth and the sun is the firmament and is said to be Bhuvarloka. The expanse between Surya and Dhruva ⁶⁰⁶ is heaven and is said to be Svarloka. The expanse between Dhruva and Janaloka is spoken of as Maharloka. I will speak about the *siddhis* for the seven worlds. All those who reside in Bhuloka eat food that is full of juices. All those in Bhuvarloka and Svarloka drink *soma* and drink *ghee*. It should be known that all those who reside in the fourth world of Maharloka possess mental *siddhi* with five different characteristics. Everything they wish for, in their minds, is instantly produced. These *devas* use sacrifices to mutually worship each other. They belong to the past, the present and the future. The nature of the past and the future ones are indicated from the present ones. When these large number of *devas* withdraw from relationships, they go to Tapoloka. When they withdraw from their rights, their *siddhi* becomes completely mental. It should be known that this mental *siddhi* is derived from each other and is pure. O *brahmanas*! I have briefly stated the norms for the four worlds and Janaloka too. I will describe it to you again. Marichi, Kashyapa, Daksha, Vasishtha, Angiras, Bhrigu, Pulastya, Pulaha, Kratu and others—they were earlier born in this world through Brahma's mental powers. After establishing *prajas*, they seek refuge in Janaloka. When there is burning at the end of a *kalpa*, starting with Bhuloka and ending with Maharloka, all these are pervaded by a terrible fire. The flames of the Samvartaka fire burn everything, along with all desire. When Maharloka blazes, all those who reside in Maharloka,

Yama and others, seek refuge in Janaloka. They exist there in their subtle bodies. Their capacities are equal and their forms are similar. When the entire universe is flooded, they remain in Janaloka. Brahma's origin is not manifest. When his night is over and it is the start of the day, in the due order, they are born first. These are the *sadhakas*, starting with Svayambhuva and ending with Marichi. *Devas* who died are born again. In the due order, Yama and the others are born, as the younger brothers of the Prajapatis. Those who were initially born earlier, are born earlier. Those who were initially born later, are born later. *Devas* follow *devas* and it is said that they have been born seven times in this way, along with the *kalpas*. Three more remain. ⁶⁰⁷ In the due order, all the *devas* are born in this way. The past and future such movements amount to ten. After this, all these categories behold the transitory nature of sentiments. Because of destiny and because of the great strength of their good deeds, all of them come to possess excellent minds and refrain from activities. They abandon the worlds and go to a place where there is no *rajas*. There are those who have always engaged in austerities during this period of time. Requested by Dharma, they are born as successors. They originate in this world and fill up those vacant positions, assuming all the positions of *devas*, *rishis* and humans. In this way, all the different categories of *devas* are born ten times. They reach a world without *rajas* and remain there for ten cycles of deluge. As each *kalpa* is completed, they remain in that world, devoid of *rajas*. Following the earlier order, they then return to Brahma's world. Thus, in one *kalpa*, they leave Brahma's world and go to a world without *rajas*. They remain unmanifest in the world without *rajas*. However, in the due order, they go to Brahma's world again. In this way, they circle ten times and reach the world without *rajas*. Thus, thousands of *yugas* have passed for *devas*. When they are destroyed, along with the *rishis*, they go to Brahma's world. It is impossible to speak about this in detail, in the due order. This is because time is without a beginning and everything cannot be enumerated. There should be no doubt about this. I have narrated it accurately.'

Hearing these words, the *rishis* were filled with doubts. They spoke to the immensely intelligent Suta, who was Vyasa's disciple and knew about the Puranas.

The *rishis* asked, 'When they reach the world without *rajas*, what is the food for the entities who seek refuge there? What is the duration for which they remain there? Please tell us accurately.'

Suta knew about the true nature of the worlds and the Puranas. Hearing their words, he submitted the following in reply. 'Reaching the place of the one who is the lord of everything, they seek refuge in pure intelligence. Until the onset of ten deluges, they remain there, without any anxiety. All of them possess subtle bodies. All of them are learned, with dense forms. They remain established in that world, where there is no existence. I have spoken about Sanatkumara and others. They are *siddhas* who follow the *dharma* of *yoga*. In this way, those immensely fortunate ones enter Pranava.⁶⁰⁸ They remain in Brahma's world, the best place for all of us. It is said that after reaching Brahma's world, all of them engage in sacrifices, following the *dharma* of *yoga*. They dissolve there, like the serene flame of a lamp. They merge into Brahma's body, from which, it is rare to return. All of them reach a world that is free of ailments. They obtain the bliss that is the *brahman* and achieve immortality. Brahma's world is said to be six times above the world without *rajas*. Brahma is the priest there. All of them have Pranava in their *atmans* and are established in pure intelligence. They obtain the bliss that is the *brahman* and enjoy immortality. They do not possess the opposite pair of sentiments and are devoid of the three kinds of states.⁶⁰⁹ They are immensely energetic and possess powers that are Brahma's equal, without that of being an overlord. They possess power, victory, prosperity, establishment, non-attachment and insight. All those who go to Brahma's world attain the state of not returning. When the time for withdrawal arrives, along with Brahma and the *devas*, they reach a state where all austerities cease. They are learned, with perfect understanding. All of them possess insight into transience and dissolve into the unmanifest. This is the immortal seed, eternal, imperishable and without manifestation. This is what *devarshis* always worship in Brahma's sacrifice. They are pure

and hold up their seed, not suffering from any kind of death. They have devoutly practised their *karma*, as indicated in *Vedanta*. Engaged in these practices, they worship the supreme objective. They cast aside physical bodies, full of sin, and achieve immortality. They are devoid of attachment and devoid of anger. They are without delusion and truthful in speech. They are serene, with concentrated minds. They conquer their senses and are full of compassion. They are devoid of association and are pure. They are described as those who have obtained *sayujya* with Brahma. They possess no desires. Those brave ones have burnt down their sins through austerities. They are not dislodged from these worlds. Their happiness is described as immeasurable. This is Brahma's divine world. It is a supreme and radiant place in the firmament. Having gone there, along with Brahma and the immortals, one does not grieve.'

The *rishis* asked, 'What is a *parardha*? What is described as *para*? O excellent one! We wish to know this. Please tell us.'

Suta answered, 'Hear about the enumeration of *parardha* and *para*. The numbers are one, ten, one hundred and one thousand. ⁶¹⁰ These are the numbers till one thousand. It should be known that ten thousands make up one *ayuta*. The learned speak of one hundred thousand as *niyuta*. Ten times one hundred thousand is spoken of as *prayuta*. Ten thousand times ten thousand is spoken of as a *koti*. Ten *kotis* are said to constitute one *arbuda*. The learned know that one hundred *kotis* amount to *abja*. The learned speak of one thousand *kotis* as *kharva*. Ten thousand *kotis* is known to be *nikharva*. One hundred thousand *kotis* is spoken of as *shanku*. One thousand multiplied by one thousand *kotis* is known as *padma*. People who know about numbers say that a *padma* multiplied by ten is *samudra*. One thousand *kotis* multiplied by *niyuta* is known as *antya*. *Prayuta* multiplied by one thousand *kotis* is known as *madhya*. *Koti* multiplied by one thousand *kotis* is said to be *parardha*. The learned say that two times *parardha* is *para*. *Shata* is also known as *parivridha* and *sahasra* is known as *paripadmaka*. It should be known that the next numbers are *ayuta*, *niyuta*, *prayuta*, *arbuda*, *nyarbuda*, *kharbuda*, *kharva*, *nikharva*, *shanku*, *padma*, *samudra*, *antya*, *madhya*, *parardha* and *para*. Those who know about

calculations have listed eighteen such positions.⁶¹¹ *Shata* and the other numbers indicated by *maharshis* should be known. In the enumeration of a *kalpa*, *parardha* is said to be the duration of time when Brahma is active. An equal period of time remains, during which he exists. I have spoken about the enumeration of *parardha* and the enumeration of *para*. Brahma is supreme. He is supreme *jnana*. He is supreme prosperity. Nothing to Brahma exists. He is established as the supreme. He is supreme among all objectives. *Para* is the greatest enumeration and Brahma's duration is *para*. Half of that is *parardha*. Numbers and what cannot be enumerated are always spoken about in *tantra* texts. What can be counted is enumeration and one speaks about *parardha*. When there is a heap, no particular number can be discerned. That is the attribute of something that cannot be counted. The characteristic of a pile of sand is that it is seen to be infinite. Lords possess a divine and pure insight to enumerate. This kind of *jnana* is established in Brahma, and he can see everything.'

Hearing this, all the ascetics who resided in Naimisha were delighted and their eyes filled with tears of joy. Their voices choked in delight. All those who knew about the *brahman* questioned Matarishvan. 'O lord! How far is the world of Bhagavan Brahma? Can this be enumerated in *yojanas*? How is it measured in *yojanas*! We wish to hear about the exact distance, as measured in *kroshas*.'⁶¹²

Hearing their words, which were full of humility, Matarishvan replied in sweet words in the right order, as he had seen it.

Vayu said, "I will tell you about it. Listen to what I say. The manifest emerged from the unmanifest. It is gross and is spoken of as Mahat. Mahat has ten parts and the gross bit is known as *bhutadi*. The dimension of *bhutadi* is a little more than a tenth part. *Paramanu* is extremely subtle. It can be thought of, but cannot be seen with the eyes. Everything that exists in the world, but cannot be broken down further, is known to consist of *paramanus*. When the rays of the sun pass through a lattice, subtle particles of dust are seen. This is the first that is measured and is spoken of as *paramanu*. When there is a collection of eight *paramanus*, it assumes the size of dust from the pollen of a lotus and is known as *trasarenu*. A

collection of eight *trasarenu* is said to be *ratharenu*. The learned say that a collection of eight *ratharenu* is known as *balagra*.⁶¹³ Eight *balagras* amount to a *liksha* and eight *likshas* make up one *yuka*.⁶¹⁴ Eight *yukas* are said to make up a *yava*⁶¹⁵ and eight *yavas* amount to one *angula*. The joints of twelve *angulas* are said to amount to one *vitasti*. The joints of twenty-one *angulas* are known as one *ratni*. Twenty-four *angulas* amount to one *hasta*. Two *ratnis*, or forty-two *angulas*, make up one *kishku*. The learned say that ninety-six *angulas* are a *dhanush*. It is said that *dhanush* is used to measure the distance of a *gavyuti*. Measured in *angulas*, there are two *dhanurdandas* in a *dhanush* and *dhanurdanda* is also called a *nali*. People who know about enumeration say that three hundred units of *dhanush* amount to a *nalva*. It is said that a *gavyuti* consists of two thousand *dhanush* measures. Eight thousand units of *dhanush* are said to be one *yojana*. This concludes the measurement of *dhanush* and *yojana*. One thousand measures of *dhanush* are known as *Shakra-krosha*. Those skilled in countering have enumerated *yojana* in this way. Using *yojanas*, hearing about the distance to Brahma's world. The sun is located one hundred thousand *yojanas* above the surface of the earth. The moon is located two hundred thousand *yojanas* above the sun. The entire circle of *nakshatras*, sparkling in illumination, is located a full one hundred thousand *yojanas* above the moon. There is a distance of two hundred thousand *yojanas* between the circle of *nakshatras* and the planets. The space between the planets is also that much. Budha moves below all the stars and planets. Shukra moves above this and Lohita is above this too.⁶¹⁶ Brihaspati is above this and Shanaishchara is above that. One hundred thousand *yojanas* above Shanaishchara is the entire circle of *saptarshis*, sparkling in illumination. It is said that one hundred thousand *yojanas* above the *saptarshis* is Uttanapada's son, Dhruva, in a divine and small *vimana* that is made up of stars. He is like a pivot in the firmament. Using *yojanas*, I have described the three worlds.⁶¹⁷ During the *manvantaras*, people in the three worlds worship *devas* through sacrifices. It is seen that *varnas* and *ashramas* are observed in this world. It is said that all those who are in the nature of *devas* are established for this precise reason. I have described the three worlds. Now hear about what is above

this. Maharloka is above Dhruva. Those who survive the *kalpa* reside there. It has been determined that it is one crore *yojanas* far away. Janaloka is established two crore *yojanas* above Maharloka. It is said that the *sadhakas* who are Brahma's sons, Daksha and others, are there. Tapoloka is above this. *Devas* who do not suffer from *rajas* are there. They do not suffer when living entities are scorched. Satyaloka is said to be six hundred thousand *yojanas* above Tapoloka. This is said to be Brahma's pure world, where one does not suffer from any kind of death. Those who are there to worship Brahma and are never dislodged. The upper part of the cosmic egg, above Brahma's world, extends for one crore and fifty *niyuta yojanas*. The orbit of revolution, above and otherwise, is said to be fourteen crores eleven *niyuta yojanas*. As I have heard, I have described the regions above Dhruva, in *yojanas*.'

'I will now describe the abodes that have been thought of for beings that proceed downwards. As a result of their *karma*, living beings who are terrible in their deeds go there. These are the hells Rourava, Ghora, Shukara, Tala, Taptakumbha, Mahajvala, Shabala, Vimohana, Krimi, Krimibhaksha, Lalabhaksha, Vishamsana, Adhohshira, Puyavaha, Rudhirandhu, Vishtakirna, the hell Mutrakirna, Vaitarani, Krishna, Asipatravana, Agnijvala, Mahaghora, Sandamsha, Ashvabhojana, Tamas, Krishnasutra, Loha, Abhija, Apratishtha and Vichi. ⁶¹⁸ These and others are the hells. All these dark hells are located in Yama's dominion. Evil doers descend into them, separately. All these, Rourava and the others, are described as being under the earth. A person who bears false witness, or indulges in false calumny, goes to Rourava. ⁶¹⁹ A man who is partial as a witness, falls into Krurgraha. ⁶²⁰ A person who obstructs cattle, kills a foetus or sets fire to a city, also goes there. A person who kills a *brahmana*, is a drunkard or steals gold, is submerged in Shukara. ⁶²¹ A person who kills a *kshatriya* or a *vaishya*, falls into Tala. ⁶²² Taptakumbha ⁶²³ is for a person who kills a *brahmana*, violates his *guru*'s bed; for a royal servant who harasses travellers, merchants and those who protect wealth; for a person who sells a virtuous lady and for a person who abandons a devotee. Mahajvala ⁶²⁴ is for a person who has intercourse with his daughter or

daughter-in-law. A person who sells the *Vedas*, reviles the *Vedas*, shows disrespect to a *guru* and abuses him with words that are like arrows and a man who has intercourse with a person one shouldn't have intercourse with, goes to Shabala. ⁶²⁵ A person who breaks a contract descends into the terrible Vimoha. ⁶²⁶ A person who performs wicked sacrifices reaches Kitaloha. ⁶²⁷ A person who hates *devas* and *brahmanas*, does not worship *gurus* or pollutes a jewel, goes to Krimibhaksha. ⁶²⁸ A person who eats alone, without offering food to *brahmanas* and well-wishers, goes to Lalabhaksha, ⁶²⁹ a hell with a foul stench, and remains there. A person who makes arrows, a potter, a person who steals gold coins, a physician and a person who sets fire to a pleasure-garden, descend into Vishamsana. ⁶³⁰ If a person receives gifts from the wicked, performs a sacrifice for a person who is not worthy of sacrificing or if a man earns a living through *nakshatras*, he goes to Adhomukha. ⁶³¹ A person who sells milk, liquor, salt, lac, fragrances, juices, sesamum and similar articles, descends into the terrible Puyavaha. ⁶³² A person who ties up a cock, cat, pig, bird, deer or goat, also goes to this hell. The learned say that the following descend into Rudhirandha ⁶³³—a person who earns a living through goats, sheep or buffaloes; a person who earns a living by making wheels or standards; a *brahmana* who earns a living as an actor; a person who is an officiating priest in a village, accepting vegetables as payment; a person who sets fire to a house; a poisoner; a pimp; a person who sells *soma*; a drunkard; a person who eats flesh; a person who kills animals; a reviled person who kills buffaloes and deer; a person who makes a living out of *parva* days; a spy and a person who kills a friend. There is no doubt that a person who deceives someone who has sat down to eat in a *pankti*, descends into the terrible hell of Vidbhuja. ⁶³⁴ A man who utters falsehoods, or uses inauspicious words to abuse—such a sinner descends into the terrible hell of Mutrakirna. ⁶³⁵ Men who destroy honey and crocodiles go to Vaitarani. ⁶³⁶ A mad person, a senseless person, a person devoid of pure conduct, a person prone to rage, a person who causes misery and a cheat—such people go to Krishna. ⁶³⁷ A person who uses spades and saws to destroy, cut down or disfigure a forest and a hunter of deer to the extremely terrible Asipatra.

⁶³⁸ A person who gives up the *ashrama* of *sannyasa* descends into Agnijvala, ⁶³⁹ where he is devoured by Shyama and Shabala and birds with iron beaks. A person who deviates from *ishta*, *purti* or *vratas*, descends into the hell of Samdamsha. ⁶⁴⁰ A *brahmachari* who has an emission while sleeping during the day, despite observing a *vrata*, a father who is taught by a son or a son who commands a father—all these always go to the hell of Shvabhojana. ⁶⁴¹ A person who acts against *varnas* and *ashramas* and a person who undertakes rites, while excessively angry or delighted, all such reside in hell. The terrible, great and hot hell of Rourava is located above. It is said that hells that are exceedingly cold and chilly are located below it. This is the order, as described. Listen. It is said that there are seven hells under the earth. They are Andhatamisra ⁶⁴² and others and acts of *adharma* lead to these. Rourava is the first among these, known as the great Rourava. Below that is said to be the hell of Shitastapa. ⁶⁴³ The third is Kalasutra ⁶⁴⁴ and it is said that there are many kinds of gigantic serpents there. Apratishtha ⁶⁴⁵ is the fourth, while Avichi ⁶⁴⁶ is described as the fifth. Loha ⁶⁴⁷ is described as the sixth, while Avidheya ⁶⁴⁸ is the seventh. Rourava is said to be terrible. It is described as one that is hot and scorches. Shitastapa is below that. It is extremely terrible and exceedingly cold. The extremely terrible Kalasutra is described as one where one is bitten by snakes. There is no stability in Apratishtha. It is said that one is constantly whirled around. Avichi is said to be terrible because one is crushed by machines there. Loha is said to be more terrible because a sinner has to undertake acts of great exhaustion there. Avidheya is described as a place where there is no physical body. One is bound and the limbs are subjected to torture, but there are no means of countering this. The hells are connected with each other, above and below. They are devoid of illumination. All of these are full of miseries and afflictions and *adharma* is the cause. The first two hells are like the worlds above, but they are devoid of illumination. The bodies of the sinners are placed in hidden apartments. As a result of their own *karma*, they are instantly sent there and are incapable of any enjoyment. All of them are said to suffer from miseries, afflictions and grief. It is said that there are innumerable hardships in hell. They experience hardships there

until the *karma* is exhausted. When the *karma* has almost been exhausted, they are born as an inferior species. *Devas* and stars look down, from above, at the sinners who are below. Their forms are instantly sent there, because of acts of *dharma* and *adharma* they have committed. Though they are capable of enjoyment, they suffer hardships because of their *karma*. *Devas* look down on those who are in hell, those who have fallen there and hang, heads facing downwards. With their heads facing downwards, those in hell behold *devas*. They are located there because of their natures and compare themselves with each other. In Lokaloka,⁶⁴⁹ there is no sense of above or below. This is the natural description of what happens in Lokaloka.'

The *brahmanas* performing the sacrifice spoke to Vayu again. The *rishis* asked, 'What is the total number of beings who reside in Lokaloka and living entities who are roaming around in *samsara*? Please tell us the complete enumeration and numbers.' Hearing the words of the *rishis*, the wind-God replied in the following words.

Vayu answered, 'Even those with divine vision are incapable of possessing this *jnana*. O *dvijas*! If one uses the eyes, there is no end to this enumeration. It cannot be studied or measured. The question is not appropriate. Hear about the numbers indicated by Brahma. Earthy worms that are generated from moisture amount to one-thousandth part of immobile entities. All the aquatic creatures amount to one-thousandth part of those that are born from moisture. This should be understood as a certain determination. All the birds in the world are known to be one-thousandth part of beings that reside in the water. Quadruped *pashus* in this world are known to be one-thousandth part of all the birds. Bipeds are said to constitute one thousandth part of all quadrupeds and those who follow *dharma* are one thousandth part of all bipeds. One-thousandth part of those who follow *dharma* go to heaven. Those who obtain *moksha* are one-thousandth part of those who go to heaven. Those who reside in hell and face hardships are the same in number as those in heaven. Those who hate *dharma* are evil-souled. When they die, they descend into the darkness of Rourava and face heat and cold there. In those places of hardship, they are

stupefied by bitter pain. Those who are terrible in energy face the heat of Rourava. The one named Andhatamisra is terrible. There is always a great chill in Shitastapa. Hence, it is extremely rare to find men who are devoted to *dharma* and go to heaven. Thus, the numbers have been indicated by Ishvara Svayambhu. Such enumerations and numbering have been done by Brahma and are beyond humans.'

The *rishis* said, 'You have spoken about the worlds of Maharloka, Janaloka, Tapoloka, Satyaloka and Bhuta, Bhavya and Bhava. ⁶⁵⁰ What is the space between the worlds? Please tell us the exact nature of the distance between the worlds.' Vayu heard the words of the *rishis*, who had held up their seed. Thinking about the nature of the truth, he stated the facts.

Vayu replied, 'Those who possess the direct insight of *yoga* can behold this clearly through their reasoning. They cleanse their *atmans* through *pratyahara*, *dhyana* and austerities. Ribhu, Sanatkumara and others possess understanding and purity of intelligence. Those virtuous ones have cast aside their sheaths and are devoid of *rajas*. Those excellent ones are like Brahma. They are full of joy and do not perish. Those *yogis* are established in the *brahman*. Those lords can see what the *valakhilya rishis* ⁶⁵¹ do. When I was in their presence, I also saw it. A person who has not cleansed his *atman* cannot behold Ishvara's abode. Ishvara is like a *paramanu* and can only be grasped by those who are learned. There are ten imperishable qualities that are present in Shankara—*jnana*, non-attachment, power, austerities, truth, forgiveness, fortitude, insight, connection with the *atman* and state of presiding. He is indeed the lord and an excellent *yogi*, engaged in showing favours to Brahma. So as to help him, he presents himself in a worldly form. Ishvara's region is imperishable. It is permanent and serene, devoid of adversities. It is the eighth world. It consists of consciousness alone. It is supreme and is full of *maya*. It has been created out of *maya*. The divinity Maheshvara acts in his *maya*. The destruction of *devas* is cited as a proof of that. I will describe this in detail, in the due order. Listen. It is said that Brahma's world is at a distance of thirteen crore and ten *niyuta yojanas* from Bhuloka. The cosmic egg is said to be one crore and fifty *niyuta yojanas* above the world of Bhagavan Brahma. This is the extent of

movements. Beyond this, it is said that there is no motion. They are described as eternal, depending on each other's *gunas*. They are subtle and their *dharma* is to give birth. These are said to be the Prakritis. Their lord is *kshetrajna*,⁶⁵² also known as the *brahman*. Established in this subtle and imperishable form, he presides over the Prakritis. This supreme destination has no origin. It is *paramanu*. It is Paresha.⁶⁵³ It is imperishable and cannot be conceived. It has no form, though mentally, one can think of a form. He manifests himself and vanishes. He establishes and shows favours. He is the creator, who has no other parallel. He is *paramanu* Maheshvara. He is the energy of *tamas*. He is also the one who illuminated first. There was an egg that was golden in form. This was the first indication. This was large and circular in every direction. It originated from Ishvara. Ishvara is the seed who pierced it. He is spoken of as *kshetrajna*, the seed. Prakriti is spoken of as the womb, with Narayana in its *atman*. The lord exists for the creation of the worlds and for the preservation of the worlds. The great-souled one always sustains the creation of the worlds. There is a divine city that is in front of Brahma's world and below the cosmic egg. In between the two, it is free of ailments and is full of the powers of the mind. When he assumes a form, it is the abode of the infinitely energetic Ishvara. This city is named Shivam. It is the refuge for those who are scared of rebirth. O excellent *dvijas*! Its internal dimension is one hundred thousand *yojanas* and it is established in the earth's circle. Its radiance is like that of the mid-day sun and its supreme energy crushes all those who approach it. There are giant ramparts made out of gold, as resplendent as the sun. There are four gates, decorated with gold and garlands of pearls. It is surrounded by sparkling, deep and well-designed walls that are made out of gold. That divine and beautiful city is in the sky and resounds with the sound of bells. This supreme, excellent and beautiful city is in the air, above the ground. There are many colourful jewels and many flags. It is full of objects that satisfy every kind of desire. It is ornamented by rows of shining forests and groves. Those who are excellent in their vows rejoice on the tops of supreme mansions. They are devoted to the sounds of the *brahman* being recited and to the narration of diverse auspicious accounts. The sweet sounds of singing

and the playing of musical instruments flow in every direction. The assemblies of people who are there are unmatched. This is what exists on the tops of the mansions. There is an auspicious palace made out of gold. It stands on one thousand stilts. It is unrivalled and is ornamented in every direction with supreme jewels. There is a crystal that resembles the moon and brilliant lapis lazuli. These resemble the rising sun, and the gold is like fire.'

Hearing this, the ascetic sages who resided in Naimisha exclaimed. Since they had doubts, they addressed the wind-God in these words. The *rishis* asked, 'Who are the great-souled ones who follow Bhava there? Who are the ones who are shown favours, so that they enjoy themselves properly in that excellent city?' Hearing the words of the *rishis*, Vayu replied in the following words.

Vayu answered, 'Hear about those who have thought of devotion to the lord of *devas*. They are modest and full of enthusiasm. They are controlled and full of valour, devoid of avarice. In their thoughts, words and deeds, they have purified their inner *atmans*. With single-minded attention, they have sought refuge with Maheshvara. They have obtained *salokya* with Rudra. This is the eternal and undecaying destination. They have attained excellent forms that are like those of Bhava. All of them have fire in their mouths. They wear matted hair, and the universe is their form. They are blue in the throat and white in the neck. They possess sharp teeth and three eyes. The half-moon is in the head-dress and their matted hair resembles diadems. All those brave ones possess ten arms and are as fragrant as the inside of a lotus. All of them wear yellow garments and resemble the rising sun. All of them have Pinakas in their hands and their mounts are white bulls. They wear earrings and are full of prosperity. They are decorated with necklaces made out of pearls. Their bodies are full of excessive energy. They are omniscient and possess every kind of insight. They are devoid of old age and death and can divide themselves in many kinds of ways. They sport with many kinds of sentiments. They enjoy objects of pleasure that are extremely difficult to obtain. They are *siddhas* and can travel wherever they wish. Their understanding is kindled by other *siddhas*. The great-souled

ones do not number only one. There are crores of groups of eleven Rudras. Such are the ones with the great-souled Maheshvara, the lord of *devas*. Bhagavan is compassionate towards his devotees. He loves Parvati and rejoices. I do not see any difference between those Rudras and the great-souled Bhava, though they are there in many kinds of forms. I am telling you the truth.'

The wind-God completed the extremely sacred account, exactly as he had heard it from Ishvara. All those *rishis* were like the sun in their radiance. They heard this supreme and auspicious account about Tryambaka. Having obtained this great favour, they were filled with supreme joy. They honoured the immensely strong Vayu and spoke to him again. The *rishis* said, 'O wind-God! O immensely fortunate one! O lord! You have spoken to us about the excellent and sacred manifestation, Ishvara's eighth world. You have accurately described the dimensions of that place. It is the *paramatman*'s supreme abode, prosperous with the *dharma* of *yoga*. Even the Gods find it impossible to comprehend Mahadeva's greatness. He is infinitely energetic, and the greatness of his own *yoga* has one thousand dimensions. He confounds his devotees and also shows them his favours. He has himself infused Brahma with a prosperity that is unmatched. Like the moonlight of the moon, he pervades. He spreads himself, with the universe as his form. Because of his powers, the abode of the lord of *devas* is exceedingly radiant. The great-souled Rudras are Mahadeva's equals. Like a flow of *amrita*, you have spoken about all this. O one excellent in vows! We are devotees and we have drunk in all this about Sharva. Is there anything else about the followers that we do not know? We are asking you. You are a supreme *deva*. You are the breath of life. You should tell us.'

Suta continued, 'The illustrious one answered, "What else will I tell you about? O ones excellent in vows! I will narrate whatever deserves to be spoken about."'

The *rishis* asked, 'There will be a terrible deluge for beings when all those with life will be destroyed. There are the Adityas and lions, valiant and angry, by their sides. There are the fires, the large number of *bhutas* and the tigers that follow them. At the time, what state are they reduced to?

Please tell us accurately. We have got to know about the powers and sentiments of Ishvara, who is not manifest.'

Vayu replied, 'There is the place that Brahma's sons, Sanatkumara, Sanandana, Sanaka and Sanatana as the third, formerly went to. *Brahmarshi* Kapila went there and the immensely illustrious Asuri. There was the sage Panchashikha and there were others. After time passes and the cycle of *kalpas* is over, the great elements are destroyed, and dissolution presents itself. Many crores of Rudras approach the pleasant Maheshvari. They cast aside sound and other objects of the senses, material objects and articles of enjoyment. They seek refuge in the eight. ⁶⁵⁴ Full of energy and united with *jnana*, they enter all beings. Full of compassion for beings, they easily abandon their positions. They go to the place where the great-souled *paramanu* Maheshvara exists. They cross over the extremely large whirlpools and the river that is full of the water of birth and death. They behold the supreme *brahman*, bereft of divisions. They are with seven Devis and those Devis have been described. The thousands of lions, Adityas, fires, large number of *bhutas* and the tigers who follow them, are also there. Using *samkhya* and *yoga*, all of them enter Bhava. Along with Vishnu, he creates the seven worlds and the five great elements and destroys them again. O *dvijas*! He is Rudra, full of the *Yajur Veda* and full of the *Sama Veda*. It is certain that he is inside and outside, like the warp and the weft. He alone is Bhagavana, the protector. He is the creator and the destroyer. All the *rishis* are like the sun in their radiance. They are truthful in their learning and properly invoke the fire in their *atmans*. In thoughts, words and deeds, the insides of their *atmans* have been purified. With single-minded attention, they approach Maheshvara. They are devoted to vows and fasting. They are compassionate towards all beings. They follow divine *yoga* and *yama* and with their doubts dispelled, reach him. With their supreme devotion, they reach him. Their energy is full of *jnana*. They obtain *salokya* with Rudra, the eternal and imperishable destination. Full of austerities, if a person reads this *shruti* text recited by Vayu, if he is a *brahmana*, *kshatriya* or *vaishya* engaged in his tasks, he obtains the world of Rudra, the cause behind the creation of the worlds. Creation is then

withdrawn and resides in Prakriti. Nothing can be directly perceived. Nothing can be seen. It cannot be described. It cannot be understood. Even those with *jnana* seem to lack *jnana* about this. There is nothing that is received, nothing that comes and goes. It cannot be perceived through conception. It can be inferred. Thinking about it, one can speak about it. The eternal cause, with existence and non-existence in its *atman*, is established there. Its activity cannot be discerned. He alone is the lord and the cause. When creation is withdrawn, in the due order, the seven Prakritis⁶⁵⁵ enter into each other and into him. The cosmic egg, which envelopes everything, dissolves in the water. The seven *dvipas* ending in the ocean and the seven worlds, with their mountains, have water as a sheath and dissolve into fire. The sheath of fire is devoured by the wind. The sheath of wind is devoured by space. The sheath of space is devoured by *bhutadi*. *Bhutadi* is absorbed by Mahat, which possesses intelligence as its attribute. Mahat is devoured by the unmanifest and there is a supreme equilibrium between the *gunas* then. Thus, Brahma and the manifest are responsible for annihilation and the new expansion. Creation and destruction are due to transformations, resulting in association and separation. Those who obtain *siddhi* as tasks and instruments are those who have obtained *siddhi* through *jnana*. They proceed swiftly and are speedily absorbed in their respective places. In the course of withdrawal, *kshetrajna* is again united with the instruments. The unmanifest is known as *kshetra* and Brahma is said to be *kshetrajna*. They follow the same *dharma* and also follow separate *dharma*. The union between them is without a beginning. O *brahmanas*! This should be known to be the role of *kshetrajna* in creation. If one possesses *jnana* about *kshetra*, Brahma can be known separately. *Kshetra* is described as an object and *kshetrajna* lacks the trait of being an object. Brahma should be known as one who lacks the trait of being an object, while *kshetra* is spoken of as the object. Since *kshetrajna* is established in *kshetra*, that is said to be *kshetrajna*'s purpose. Since there are many kinds of bodies, those with bodies are said to be many. The Shankaras have no form. They are established in the form of a radiance. Every body experiences happiness and unhappiness. Therefore, it should be known that there are many kinds

of beings. What brings about their differences also brings about their identity. After the progress of a long period of time, all this is naturally brought about. They return there, along with those who are attached to Svayambhu. They obtain *sayujya* with all the residents of Brahma's world. They withdraw from their states and reside with those who are *atmans*. While they reside there, they can behold the taints. This leads to non-attachment and destroys all sense of "I". Their sentiments are such that they can see many kinds of objects of pleasure and those who enjoy them. *Kshetrajnas* who are in Brahma's world possess *jnana* about this separateness. All of them are beyond the many kinds of causes Prakriti displays. They reside within their *atmans*. Within their *atmans*, they possess serenity of vision. All of them are pure and unblemished. They are both sentient and not sentient. They are described as those who attain *nirvana* and do not return. They are *nirguna*. With the fire in their *atmans*, they do not suffer from Prakriti's transformations. This is described as Svayambhu's *prakritika* destruction. If a person follows the conduct of *varnas* and *ashramas* and hears about this annihilation, he proceeds to *salokya* with Shiva. Such a devout person is freed from anxiety. If a *shudra* does not drink liquor, conquers his senses and is devoted to Bhava, until the onset of the deluge, he possesses the attribute that he does not suffer from impediments. He obtains the status of a Ganapati and this lasts for all time to come. If he drinks liquor, he rejoices, along with large numbers of *bhutas* who drink liquor. When he frequents the surface of the earth, Bhava is the one who bestows boons on mortals.'

These are the excellent words spoken by the illustrious Vayu.

Chapter 115-2(3) (Dissolution)

Suta said, 'I will describe Syambhu's withdrawal after a *para* is over. The lord Brahma's period of existence comes to an end then. Ishvara created the manifest universe, which is extremely subtle. In that way, at the time of withdrawal, everything manifest is swallowed by the unmanifest. When the

cycle of the *kalpa* is complete, there is a destruction of everything, from the smallest to the largest. It is extremely terrible and nothing direct can be seen. All the trees are destroyed and the time of the last of the Manus is over. When *kali yuga* is over and everything decays, it is described as destruction. This is like an act of washing and withdrawal presents itself. When there is withdrawal, the elements and *tanmatras* are destroyed. The transformations, starting with Mahat and ending with Vishesha, ⁶⁵⁶ are destroyed. Natural attributes lead to this act of re-absorption. Initially, water devours the earth and its attribute of smell. When the attribute of smell has gone away, it is conceived that the earth is ready for dissolution. When the *tanmatra* of smell has been destroyed, the earth is reduced to the state of water. Water enters everywhere and moves around, with a great force and a loud roar. It fills up everything and moves around. Then, water and its quality of taste dissolve into fire. Water and its *tanmatra* of taste are destroyed. The fierce fire takes away taste and water is reduced to the state of fire. Having devoured the water, fire faces every direction. The fire pervades everything and devours the water. The flames gradually fill up everything in the universe. The flames are everywhere, above, below and sideways. Fire and its attribute of form and great illumination dissolved into the wind, like the flame of a lamp being extinguished by the wind. When the *tanmatra* of form is destroyed, fire is robbed of its form. The great element of wind grasps and pacifies the fire. The world is without illumination then and fire is reduced to the state of wind. The wind returns to its foundational connections. It blows in the ten directions, above, below and sideways. Then, wind and its attribute of touch are devoured by space. Wind is pacified and uncovered space alone remains. This has no form, taste, touch or smell and there is nothing embodied. Everything is filled with that great radiance of sound. At this time of destruction, space and its attribute of sound are the only things that are left. Space and the *tanmatra* of sound remain, enveloping everything. Next, *bhutadi* devours the attribute of sound. The elements and the objects of the senses are simultaneously absorbed into *bhutadi*. *Bhutadi* is described as *ahamkara*, *tamas* in nature. Mahat, with the attribute of intelligence, devours *bhutadi*. Mahat is known

as the *atman*, representing resolution and determination. Mahat is imperishable and its signs are intelligence and the mind. Those who have thought about it, progressively use these words to describe it. When the elements are dissolved, Mahat also dissolves into the equilibrium of *gunas*. This equilibrium of *gunas* exists within the *atman*. In this connection, all the causes behind the elements are dissolved. This is a restraint of the *tattvas*,⁶⁵⁷ along with their causes. O *dvijas*! This restraint of the *tattvas* is said to periodically recur. *Dharma*, *adharma*, austerities, *jnana*, the auspicious, truth, falsehood, superior sentiments, inferior sentiments, happiness, unhappiness, the agreeable and the disagreeable—all these are *prapancha*,⁶⁵⁸ described as nothing but an expression of the *gunas*. Those who possess *jnana* no longer possess senses. Therefore, the auspicious and the inauspicious, good deeds and bad deeds, are all established in Prakriti. These states are said to exist in those with bodies. For creatures, all good deeds and bad deeds become established in Prakriti. However, in that state, good deeds and bad deeds are still united with creatures and start to function when they assume bodies again. For creatures, *dharma* and *adharma* are both aspects of the *gunas*. These causes exist in creatures, existing in the form of effects. Consciousness is dissolved and the *gunas* are established in *kshetrajna*. At the time of primary creation and secondary creation,⁶⁵⁹ creatures come into *samsara*. They wander around, connected and separated from the causes. Conduct is said to be of the *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas* types. These three types of *gunas* act and are established in beings. *Sattva* takes one upwards, *tamas* takes one downwards. Between the two, *rajas* moves around and acts in the middle. In this way, the three *gunas* move around. Among all beings in the world, their functioning is known through their deeds.'

‘All activities undertaken by humans start with ignorance. There are said to be three kinds of destinations, depending on whether the deeds are auspicious or wicked. When a being is overwhelmed by *tamas*, he does not get to know the truth. Not possessing insight about the truth, he is bound in many kinds of ways. There is bondage because of Prakriti and because of transformations. The third kind of bondage is based on lack of skills.⁶⁶⁰ He

circles around in these bonds. These are said to be the three kinds of bonds, resulting from lack of *jnana*. The transient is described as permanent. In unhappiness, one perceives happiness. There is a sense of ownership in what is not one's own. There is certainty that impure *jnana* is actually pure. Those who have taints in their minds suffer from such adversities, through taints in *jnana*. *Jnana* is described as withdrawal from attachment and hatred. *Tamas* is the foundation for *ajnana* and *rajas* leads to the fruits of the two kinds of *karma*. As a consequence of *karma*, one has to assume a body again and there are great miseries. Thirst results from the ears, eyes, skin, tongue and nose. *Karma* leads to rebirth and miseries. A person with thirst is said to be foolish. His own *karma* leads to fruits. The living being is whirled around, as if he is on an oil-press. It is therefore instructed that *ajnana* is the root cause of adversity. Understanding that this is the enemy, one must make efforts to pursue *jnana*. With that *jnana*, one renounces everything. Radiant intelligence results from renunciation. Non-attachment leads to purification and one is freed through pure *sattva*. After this, I will speak about attachment, which destroys living beings. If a person has not practiced *yoga*, he comes under the subjugation of material objects. The beneficial and the harmful, pleasure and displeasure, torment and misery, torment and misery on account of not getting something, remembrance of happiness—attachment is said to be the cause behind all such addiction to material objects. Starting with Brahma and ending with immobile objects, everything in *samsara* is *adhibhoutika*. They originate in *ajnana*. Therefore, *ajnana* must be given up. If a person does not accept the proof of the *rishis* and the good conduct of the virtuous, if he is against *varnas* and *ashramas*, if he opposes the instructions of the sacred texts, that is a path to hell and the cause behind being born as inferior species. There are said to be three kinds of causes behind being born as inferior species and three kinds of hardship that are faced there. There are said to be six kinds of inferior species.⁶⁶¹ In material objects, there are causes for impediments everywhere. Among all these impediments, the lack of power is mentioned. The four kinds of beings are thus *tamas* in conduct. The consciousness is established in *sattva* only when one beholds the nature of *sattva*. One

beholds the *tattvas* only when one realizes the true nature of the *tattvas*. There are many kinds of living beings and many kinds of *kshetrajnas*. Accordingly, they behold many kinds of meanings. This insight about many kinds of truth leads to *jnana* and it is said that *yoga* results from *jnana*. A person who is bound by this, is bound. A person who is freed from this, is free. Withdrawing from *samsara* is said to be the sign of emancipation. When the consciousness does not suffer from associations, it is established in one's own *atman*. However, even when he is established in his own *atman*, he is touched by what are described as modifications. The signs of *jnana* and *moksha* have been spoken about briefly. Those who possess insight about the truth speak about three kinds of *moksha*. The first is separation from *ajnana*, the second is the destruction of attachment. The third is the destruction of thirst. It is explained that these are the three causes behind *moksha*. When the *linga sharira* ⁶⁶² no longer exists, that is *kaivalya*. *Kaivalya* is a state that is devoid of blemish. When there is no blemish, this leads to purification. There is no other available method.'

‘After this, I will speak about non-attachment and the taints associated with attachment. For both *devas* and humans, material objects are associated with the signs of the five senses. Having seen the taints, one should not hate. One should act so as not to be attached. One should avoid torment, pleasure and misery. After resorting to non-attachment in this way, an embodied being no longer has a sense of ownership. Using the intelligence, one thinks, “This inauspicious misery is transient.” Therefore, by resorting to *sattva*, he should purify the task and the instrument. When this whip has matured, all the taints can be seen. At the time of departure from the body, the taints are seen to be the causes. The body is agitated by heat, fanned by a fierce wind. All the taints in the body are thereby obstructed. This severs the inner organs and pierces the place where *prana* is based. Agitated by the chill, the wind gradually proceeds upwards. For all beings, it enters the place where *prana* is based. As stated briefly, all *jnana* is shrouded. All *karma* is also shrouded. The *jivatman*, based in the navel, is urged by the *karma* he has himself committed earlier. *Prana* is again separated from the eight limbs. ⁶⁶³ In the end, he gives up the body and all

breathing ceases. When *prana* goes away, the person is said to be dead. In this world, in the course of sleeping, a person is seen to be conveyed, here and there. Attachment is seen to be like this. There is no other way. The destruction of thirst is described as the third sign of *moksha*. It is seen that there are taints associated with the five objects of the senses, sound and others. Absence of hate, absence of attachment, avoidance of pleasure and torment are described as the causes of non-attachment and the dissolution of nature. It should be known that the eight Prakritis are the ones that have been mentioned before, in the due order. It should be known that these start with the unmanifest and end with the elements, which evolve from Prakriti.’

‘A virtuous person is one who follows the *varnas* and the *ashramas* and does not oppose the sacred texts. Following the *dharma* of *varnas* and *ashramas* is the cause behind obtaining the status of a *deva*. Starting with Brahma and ending with *pishachas*, there are eight types of *devas*.⁶⁶⁴ The causes are seen to be eight kinds of powers, *anima* and the others. As a result of the causes, the impediments, sound and other objects of the senses, are seen to be countered. In the due order, the eight forms of Prakriti are attached to the *kshetrajnas*, with their *gunas* and *tanmatras*. Those who have eyes can first see a cloud at the time of the monsoon. In this way, with their divine sight, *siddhas* see the *jivatman*. They enter wombs and accept the food and drinks. In the due order, they roam around, above, below and in the middle.⁶⁶⁵ One wishes to express the same meaning through the progressive use of four different words—*jiva*, *prana*, *linga* and *karana*.⁶⁶⁶ These are the aspects of the manifest and the unmanifest. He enjoys everything through the favours of the unmanifest and is established as *kshetrajna*. Knowing this, one is purified, and *jnana* liberates him. When one possesses insight about the truth, the truth that was lost is seen again as the truth. However, in bodies that have been completely destroyed, a person with *jnana* can see a difference between the unmanifest and *karana*. A person is then freed, in every possible way, from *gunas*, the body, *prana* and other things. Like a burnt seed does not sprout, he does not accept another body again. A person with *jnana*, may possess a body and a mind, but he knows everything about *samsara*. Using *jnana* to comprehend the

four kinds of states, ⁶⁶⁷ he withdraws into Prakriti. Prakriti is said to be the truth. Transformations are known as falsehood. Non-existence should be known as falsehood. Existence is said to be the truth and it is without a name and a form. However, *kshetrajna* is given a name and a form. The one who knows the *kshetra* is said to be *kshetrajna*. Since *kshetrajna* experiences the *kshetra*, it is spoken of as auspicious. Thus, *kshetrajna* is remembered and the *jiva* is known as the *kshetra*. It is seen that *kshetra* has no certainty, but *kshetrajna* always possesses certainty. Those who know about *kshetra* know it as *kshetra* because it is temporary and an instrument, because it has no protection against destruction and because it enjoys material objects. Starting with Mahat and ending with Vishesha, all these forms have attributes. Those attributes are subject to transformations. Hence, the imperishable assumes the form of the perishable. Since it follows the transformations, it is subject to repeated destruction. Because of this reason, because it is *kshara*, it is known as *kshetra*. ⁶⁶⁸ It is known as *kshetra* because it saves a being from *samsara* and from hell and because it also saves from misery. Because of *ahamkara*, happiness and unhappiness are spoken of as things that are enjoyed. But a material object is insentient. The lord ⁶⁶⁹ is spoken of as possessing the opposite kind of *dharma*. He does not decay or perish. He does not suffer from transformations or expansion. He is imperishable and is not diminished in any kind of way. Since he lies down in the city, he is spoken of as Purusha. ⁶⁷⁰ Since he experiences the city, he is spoken of as Purusha. An ignorant person says, “Describe Purusha.” A person who knows, knows that he is pure, unblemished and radiant. He is devoid of *ajnana*. He is neither existent nor non-existent. He is neither bound, nor free. He is neither mobile nor stationary. He has no cause. He cannot be indicated. There is no kind of taint in him. He is pure. He is not an object that can be seen. He is the one who sees, impartial in vision. He experiences the *atman* and needs no other cause. He is not subject to sentiments. He cannot be grasped. He cannot be inferred. He cannot be thought of. He is not deluded. When a person with *jnana* visualizes this, with that kind of insight, he achieves serenity. Thus, this is superior to, and better than, notions of who sees and what is seen. In

no possible way, can the person who sees and the object that is seen, be thought of as separate entities. He sees his *atman* within himself. Within his *atman*, he restrains the causes. Causes and Prakriti are established within his *atman*. Does it exist or does it not exist? Is it in this world or is it in another world? Is it one or many? Is it *kshetrajna* or Purusha? Is it the *atman* or is it not the *atman*? Does it possess consciousness, or does it not possess consciousness? Is it the doer or is it not the doer? Is it the one who enjoys or is it the one who enjoys? *Kshetrajna* is without any such blemish and on reaching it, one does not return. It cannot be expressed in words. It cannot be described. It cannot be grasped through reasoning and debating. It is not directly manifest. It cannot be thought of. It can never be expressed through words. It cannot be reached through words. It cannot be reached through the mind. *Kshetrajna* is devoid of *gunas*. It is pure and serene. It is without blemish and does not decay. It is beyond notions of happiness and unhappiness. When these are restrained, one obtains tranquillity. There is nothing other than the *atman*. Using words, or not using words, has no meaning. In this way, withdrawal and expansion, the manifest and the unmanifest occur repeatedly. The manifest is established and there is creation and devouring. The *kshetrajna* is established in everything and creation occurs again. In the end, its establishment is only based on intelligence. The association between the two ⁶⁷¹ is based on the similarity of *dharma* and also the dissimilarity of *dharma*. The association of what originates with the great Purusha is said to be without a beginning. During the period of primary creation and secondary creation, it is established. Initially, it restrains. It then functions on the basis of intelligence. All this is for the sake of Purusha. Creation and destruction are brought about by Ishvara through Pradhana. ⁶⁷² This is without a beginning and an end. As a consequence of *ahamkara*, it approaches the universe and causes terror. These are the signs and causes of the third *prakritika* creation. If a person knows about the final destination of time, he is liberated. I have thus spoken about the three types of destruction, in due order and detail. What will I do next?’

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Chapter 116-2(4) (The cycle of the cosmic egg)

The *rishis* said, ‘We have heard the great account that has been narrated by you, about *prajas* and Manus, along with *devas* and *rishis*, ancestors, *gandharvas*, *bhutas*, *pishachas*, *uragas*, *rakshasas*, *daityas*, *danavas*, *yakshas*, birds, extremely wonderful deeds and the aggregation of diverse kinds of *dharma*. Using colourful words, you have spoken about the foremost and excellent births. You have narrated this to us in gentle words. O Souti! ⁶⁷³ This has brought joy to the mind and the ears. It is like *amrita* and has brought us delight.’

In this way, the *maharshis* honoured and worshipped Suta. ⁶⁷⁴ All those engaged in the sacrifice again asked about the onset of creation. ‘O Suta! O immensely wise one! How does creation start afresh? All the bonds have been dissolved. There is equilibrium between the *gunas* and everything is full of *tamas*. The transformations of creation do not exist and the *atman* is established in the unmanifest. Brahma is not engaged in doing anything. How is he suddenly urged? How does creation start? We are asking you. Please tell us.’ Thus asked, Suta Lomaharshana again started to explain how the process of creation starts afresh.

Suta answered, ‘I will tell you how creation starts again. It should be known that it becomes just as it used to be earlier. Listen briefly. Inference should be based on what is seen. I will speak about logic and the arguments. The unmanifest is indirect and mysterious. It is impossible to reach. Words return from it and it cannot be reached with the mind. The transformations are withdrawn and there is equilibrium between the *gunas*. Pradhana and Purusha exhibit a similar kind of *dharma*. *Dharma* and *adharma* of living beings dissolve into the unmanifest. There is *sattva* alone and *dharma* and *gunas* are established in *sattva*. There is *tamas* alone and *dharma* and *gunas* are established in *tamas*. There is no difference between the two and both *gunas* exist in equilibrium. Every task that Pradhana is engaged in, occurs on the basis of intelligence. *Kshetrajna* presides over the *gunas*, but without

exercising any intelligence. In this situation, *ahamkara* functions again. ⁶⁷⁵ When it starts to function, *kshetra* and *kshetrajna* attain the association between the enjoyed and the one who is doing the enjoying. The imperishable unmanifest is still based on equilibrium between the *gunas*. Established there, *kshetrajna* brings about disequilibrium. The manifest starts to characterize both *kshetra* and *kshetrajna*. With *kshetrajna* presiding over it, *sattva* brings about transformations. Starting with Mahat and ending with Vishesha, there are twenty-four such transformations. ⁶⁷⁶ *Kshetrajna*, Pradhana and Purusha function. The original divinity is spoken of as the one who shows favours to Pradhana. Both these excellent ones are without a beginning, and both are described as subtle. The association is without a beginning and everything is based on *kshetrajna*. When there is no intelligence, both these excellent ones are incapable. They are not futile, but they are not direct. They are established, like fish and water. When they initially start to function, everything else follows. Originating in that ignorance, *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas gunas* start to function. At the time, the *tattvas* of Mahat, *bhutadi* and Vishesha start to function. Like a man seeks out medication, Vishesha and the senses seek out the *gunas*. If a person is engaged in meditation, through that *dhyana*, he can see the causes and the different kinds of *dharma* of the unmanifest *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. Those who know, see this as water extending everywhere in a field, from the beginning to the end. To accomplish the tasks and the instruments, *ahamkara* is generated. Earlier, everything was based on the unmanifest *sattva*. There were those who endured earlier, *sadhakas*, as well as those who were not *sadhakas*. All of them were serene. But now, all of them take up their positions and their modes. To take up their tasks, they are repeatedly born. The connection between *dharma* and *adharma* is only on the basis of the *gunas*. They foster each other, through showing favours and granting boons. At the beginning of creation, everything thus functions for the sake of creation. Refuge is sought in the *gunas* because that is appealing. *Gunas* resort to the tasks they had followed during the earlier cycle of creation. Seeking refuge with these, they are repeatedly created. Violence and non-violence, mild and cruel, *dharma* and *adharma*, truth and

falsehood—all these sentiments evolve from him, because they appeal to him. The many kinds of great elements, the objects of the senses, the forms and the separation of living beings—all these flow from the *gunas*. I have thus briefly told you about how creation occurs afresh. I will now briefly tell you how Brahma originates. The unmanifest is the cause. It is eternal, comprising the existent and the non-existent. Maheshvara is born through Pradhana and Purusha. When he is thought of, he is again born, under the name of Brahma. Based on *ahamkara* and the *gunas*, he again creates the worlds. *Ahamkara* originates from Mahat and the elements are born from that. The elements and the senses originate simultaneously from the *atman*. Different kinds of beings originate from the elements. It is thus that creation occurs. In accordance with my wisdom and in accordance with what I have heard, I have already stated the nature, in detail. It has been described earlier. Retain that in your memory.’

The residents of Naimisha heard about the origin of the worlds, their preservation and their destruction. Hearing about this, they performed the *avabhritha* of the sacrifice. The *rishis* were purified and obtained the sacred world. ‘You should also follow the norms and worship the *devas*.⁶⁷⁷ After the *avabhritha*, you will be purified. At the end of your lifespans, you will give up your body. You will be successful in your objectives. You will obtain the sacred world and rejoice there. All the residents of Naimisha had the *avabhritha* bath after performing the sacrifice. They saw and were touched. They went to heaven. O *brahmanas*! You should also perform many kinds of sacrifices. O excellent *dvijas*! At the end of your lifespans, you will also go to heaven. *Prakriya* is the first *pada*, where the account begins. The others are *anushanga*, *upodghata* and *upasamhara*. These are the four *padas* of this Purana, which is revered by the worlds. Engaged in the welfare of the worlds, the illustrious Vayu himself narrated this. O supreme among sages! The sages were performing a sacrifice in Naimisha then. Through his favours, they successfully learnt about the origin and dissolution of beings, the creation by Pradhana and what Ishvara did. An intelligent person who knows about this properly, will not be overwhelmed by delusion. If a learned *brahmana* hears or studies this ancient Itihasa, or

makes it heard, for an eternal number of years, he rejoices in the great Indra's world. He obtains *sayujya* with Brahma and rejoices with Brahma. A person who recites the deeds of the great-souled lords of *prajas* and the first lords of the earth proceeds towards union with the *brahman*. This is blessed and sacred, in conformity with the *Vedas*. It bestows fame and a long lifespan. Krishna Dvaipayana, who spoke about the *brahman*, narrated this Purana. It recounts the famous deeds of the lords of the *manvantaras*. It speaks about the great wealth of the infinitely energetic *devas* and *rishis*. It narrates everything about good deeds and wicked deeds. A learned person, who always makes this heard from one *parva* to another *parva*, obtains greatness. He cleanses his sins and conquers heaven. He is worthy of obtaining union with the *brahman*. If a person makes *brahmanas* hear one *pada* of this at a *shraddha* ceremony, the ancestors present themselves and grant him everything that he desires, for an eternity. This is known as a Purana because it is about an ancient account. If a person knows about this etymological meaning, he is freed from all sins. Men from the three *varnas* study this Itihasa, they obtain the same results. If a person turns his mind towards *dharma* and listens to this, after he dies, he rejoices in heaven for as many thousands of crores of years as there are body-hairs all over his body. He obtains *sayujya* with Brahma and rejoices with *devas*. It is sacred and destroys all sins. It is holy and bestows fame. Brahma gave this sacred text of the Purana to Matarishvan. Ushanas received it from him, and Brihaspati got it from Ushanas. After this, Brihaspati spoke about it to Savitar. Savitar narrated it to Mrityu and Mrityu narrated it to Indra. Indra narrated it to Vasishtha and Vasishtha narrated it to Sarasvata. Sarasvata narrated it to Tridhama and Tridhama narrated it to Sharadvan. Sharadvan gave it to Trivishta and Trivishta gave it to Antariksha. Charshin obtained it from Antariksha and gave it to Trayyaruna. Trayyaruna gave it to Dhananjaya, who passed it on to Kritanjaya. Kritanjaya gave it to Trinanjaya, who passed it on to Bharadvaja. Bharadvaja gave it to Goutama, who gave it to Niryantara. Niryantara narrated it to Vajashrava, who gave it to Somashushma. Trinabindu obtained it from him. Trinabindu narrated it to Daksha and Daksha spoke about it to Shakti. While he was in the womb,

Parashara heard it from Shakti. ⁶⁷⁸ Parashara narrated it to Jatukarnya, who passed it on to Lord Dvaipayana. O excellent *dvijas*! I obtained it from Dvaipayana. I narrated it to my son, who is infinite in intelligence. These are words narrated by Brahma and other *gurus*. Learned people must make efforts to prostrate themselves before *gurus*. This is blessed and sacred. It accomplishes every objective. It bestows fame and a long lifespan. It destroys sins. Controlling oneself, one must always hear it, along with *brahmanas*. This is excellent and sacred and must never be given to an impure person, a sinner, one who has not served for a *shishya* for at least a year, a person who lacks faith, a person who lacks learning or to a person who is not a son. The unmanifest is his origin. It is said that time and movement represent his manifest body. The fire is his mouth. The sun and the moon are his eyes. The directions are his ears. His smell is spoken of as Vayu. The *Vedas* are his speech. The firmament is his body. His feet constitute the earth. The stars are his pores. The entire sky is his head. All kinds of learning and the Upanishads constitute his tail. He is the lord of *devas*. He is the father of all fathers. The sacrifice is his *atman*. He is established in Satyaloka. He is supreme among the most excellent. He is the one who bestows boons. He is Maheshvara, the primordial Brahma. I control myself and bow down before him.'

Chapter 117-2(5) (Agastya's journey and Janardana's manifestation) ⁶⁷⁹

'I prostrate myself before Shri Ganesha. Shri Lalitaa Upakhyana ⁶⁸⁰ commences. O mother of the universe! You possess four arms. The digits of the moon are on your forehead. Your breasts are peaked. You are red because you have been smeared with *kumkuma*. You hold a lotus, a stalk of sugarcane, a noose, a goad, a flower and arrows in your hands. Let the one with the beautiful limbs always bestow what is beneficial to us. The learned learn the third from her. ⁶⁸¹ She is greater and superior to the third.'

‘There was a *rishi* named Agastya. He was accomplished in the *Vedas* and the *Vedangas*. He knew the essence of every kind of determination. He possessed bliss about the *brahman* in his *atman*. For some reason, he wandered around wonderful *tirthas*, temples, mountains, forests, the best and foremost among rivers and all the countries. In all these places, he saw beings who were overwhelmed by the darkness of *ajnana*. He saw that they were addicted to the stomach and the penis and thought about them. Thinking about them, he wandered around the earth. He reached the extremely sacred and excellent city of Kanchi. Shiva makes his abode in Ekamra there and the place is protected by elephants that resemble gigantic mountains. ⁶⁸² Kamakshi, who destroys the taints of *kali yuga*, is also worshipped there. The intelligent one thought repeatedly about the welfare of the world and his heart was wet with compassion. Because of the austerities he had performed over a long period of time, Janardana was pleased. Though his form is that of consciousness alone, he assumed the form of Hayagriva and showed himself. ⁶⁸³ His arms blazed with a conch shell, a *chakra*, a bangle of *aksha* beads and a book. The entire universe was purified by the radiance that emanated from his body. Infinite in energy, he manifested himself before the sage. On seeing him, he was filled with joy and prostrated himself repeatedly. He bent down in humility and satisfied the lord of the universe. Jagannatha said, “I am pleased with your austerities. O fortunate one! You are an excellent *brahmana*. Ask for a boon.” Thus addressed by Bhagavan, the excellent sage replied. “O Bhagavan! If you are pleased with me, you should tell me how vile creatures can obtain liberation.” The lord of *dvijas* and the lord of *devas*, Jagannatha, was asked this.’

‘He said, “Earlier, Shiva had asked me this question. Later, Brahma asked the same question. Durvasa asked this question thereafter and you asked it after him. Those like you are great-souled *gurus* of all beings. You should make my instructions famous in the world. This is my boon. I am the origin of all beings. I am myself the lord who is the original creator. I am the cause behind everything, creation, preservation and dissolution. I am Trimurti, ⁶⁸⁴ but I am beyond the three *gunas*. I am devoid of *gunas*, but I

am the refuge of *gunas*. Sporting as I will, I am in the *atmans* of all beings. I am Pradhana and Purusha. O *brahmana*! Being that I assume the three forms in the universe. I divide myself into two forms, Pradhana and Purusha. My form of Pradhana has all the *gunas* and is in all the worlds. There is another form that is beyond the *gunas*. It is great and is greater than the greatest. If a person knows about these two forms, he is liberated. After austerities undertaken over a long period of time, *yamas*, *niyamas* and renunciation, wicked deeds are pacified, and liberation is immediately obtained. Through the form that possesses *gunas*, one obtains identity with the *gunas*. The other form is universal, and it is obtained through *karma*, valour and enjoyment of these. What is obtained through *karma* is also obtained through renunciation. O ascetic! However, out of these two, for everyone, renunciation is very difficult. The easier path is the one obtained through good and evil *karma*. The *gunas* within one's self makes a person virtuous. It is the same for a person who is wicked. The *jnana* obtained through unity with the *atman* bestows every kind of *siddhi*. Even for sinners who are outside the pale of the three *varnas*, if *dhyana* is performed in that form, bad deeds instantly become good ones. If a person worships supreme Shakti, whether it is in accordance with the rules or not in accordance with the rules, he does not have to suffer *samsara*. Indeed, there is no doubt about this. Using the strength of his *dhyana* and *yoga*, Shiva worshipped her and became Ishvara over all *siddhas*. He obtained the form of Arddhanarishvara. ⁶⁸⁵ Through *dhyana* on her, other *devas*, the one born from the lotus being the foremost, became *siddhas*. For all the worlds, without worshipping Tripuraa, one cannot simultaneously obtain objects of pleasure and emancipation. Therefore, fix your mind on her and worship her. Make her the destination. Offering all your *karma* to her, you will obtain emancipation. For the sake of everyone's benefit, I have revealed this secret. O excellent sage! Your austerities have satisfied me. Through the words spoken through your lotus mouth, *devas*, sages, *siddhas*, humans and others will obtain *siddhi* and go to the destination that is greater than the greatest." Hearing the words of Hayagriva, who wields the Sharnga bow, ⁶⁸⁶ he prostrated himself and again addressed Madhusudana in these words. "O

Bhagavan! What is the form that you spoke about earlier? What are its pastimes and what are its powers? You should speak to me about this.” Hayagriva answered, “O *devarshi*! This Hayagriva form is one of my portions. He should tell you everything that you wish to hear.” Saying this, Jagannatha instructed Hayagriva, the store of austerities, while the sage who was born from the pot⁶⁸⁷ was standing in front. Thereafter, Hari vanished. The store of austerities was filled with wonder and his body hair stood up. With the sage, Hayagriva returned to his own hermitage.’

Chapter 118-2(6) (Nature of violence)

Agastya made Hayagriva sit on an excellent and wonderful seat. He then approached him and addressed him in these words. ‘O illustrious one! You know about every kind of *dharma*. O excellent one! You know about every kind of determination. The sight of a person like you is the cause of upliftment of the worlds. Please speak in detail about Mahadevi’s manifestation, her different kinds of forms and the most important of her pastimes.’

Hayagriva replied, ‘She is without a beginning. She is the one who supports everything. Her form incorporates existence and non-existence. She can be seen through *dhyana*. Her limbs are formed out of *dhyana*. Her limbs are learning. She is based in the heart. Full of devotion, if one reverentially worships the unity between her and the *atman*, she manifests herself. In the beginning, because of Brahma’s *dhyana* and *yoga*, Shakti manifested herself. She is known by the name of Prakriti, and she bestows the *siddhi* desired by *devas*. The second form manifested itself when the ocean was churned for *amrita*. That form cannot be grasped through words or thoughts and it deluded Sharva. Though he is omniscient, as soon as he saw her, Isha was deluded. He suddenly left Parvati and though he was restrained, quickly had intercourse with her.⁶⁸⁸ Shasta, the one who crushed *asuras* was born through this.’

Agastya said, ‘He is the lord of all beings. He is controlled. He is the one who chastised Manmatha. ⁶⁸⁹ This is amazing. How was he deluded by Devi and how did he come to have a son?’

Hayagriva replied, ‘Earlier, the lord of the city of the immortals possessed victory, glory and prosperity. He ruled over the three worlds, along with all the *devas*, *asuras* and humans. He was mounted astride a gigantic elephant that resembled the summit of Kailasa. He roamed around the worlds worshipped by everyone. Knowing that he was intoxicated, Bhavani’s imperishable husband summoned Durvasa and sent him to his presence. He was clad in a small piece of antelope skin, and he held a staff. His body was covered with dust. In this garb of a mad person, he followed the path traversed by the *vidyadharas*. There was a *vidyadhara* lady, beautiful in form. At this time, travelling as she willed, she arrived in front of him. After a long period of austerities, she had satisfied the supreme Ambikaa. She had received a garland from her and was pleased in her mind. On seeing her, with eyes resembling those of a fawn, the bull among sages spoke. “O timid one! Where are you going? Where did you get this?” She prostrated herself before the great-souled one and replied humbly. “O *brahmana*! I performed austerities for a long period of time and satisfied, Devi gave me this.” Hearing her words, he asked for that excellent garland. As soon as she was asked, satisfied, she gave it to the great-souled one. “I have become successful in my objective.” Saying this, he instantly accepted it in his hands. He devoutly placed it on his head and spoke these joyous words. “This cannot be obtained by Brahma and others. Through my good fortune, I have received it. May you always be devoted to Devi’s extremely radiant lotus feet. O amiable one! You will possess a wonderful form. Cheerfully, go wherever you wish to.” She lowered her head in prostration and went to wherever she had come from, content. Having sent her away, he again followed the path traversed by the *vidyadharas*. He accepted a lute from the hands of a *vidyadhara*’s wife. He received divine garlands and unguents and other divine ornaments. He wore some and held some. Sometimes, he sang. And sometimes, he laughed. Wandering around as he willed, the sage went to the spot where Purandara was. The sage gave

Shakra the garland that was in his hand. Taking it, the king of *devas* placed it on the elephant's shoulder. The elephant picked it up and hurled it down on the ground. Seeing that the garland had been flung down, the ascetic became angry. He said, "You did not wear the garland I gave you on your head. Intoxicated as a result of the prosperity of the three worlds, you have dishonoured it. What is held by Mahadevi is worshipped by Brahma and the others. You rule over the worlds, with the *devas*, *asuras* and humans. As a consequence of my curse, your rule will become hideous, devoid of energy." Cursed in this way, he humbly worshipped him. O *brahmana*! However, he left silently, remembering the future course of action. At this, the Shri of victory went to Bali, the *daitya*. Eternal Shri went to Vasudeva, the eternal Purusha.'

'Indra returned to his city, full of all the *devas*. His mind was dejected. With Shri gone, the king of *devas* was full of thoughts. He saw many evil portents in the city of the immortals. He called Brihaspati and addressed him in these words. "O illustrious one! You know about every kind of *dharma*. You possess knowledge about the three periods of time. Many kinds of inauspicious portents, never seen before, can be seen. What will be the effects of these? How can they be countered?" Brihaspati heard the words of Indra of the *devas*. He replied in these auspicious and beneficial words, full of *dharma* and *artha*. "O king! The consequences of enacted *karma* cannot be destroyed in hundreds of crores of *kalpas*, until the fruits have been enjoyed and there has been *prayashchitta*." Indra asked, "O *brahmana*! What is the nature of *karma* and what *prayashchitta* is there? I wish to hear all this. Please tell me in detail." Brihaspati replied, "It is said that a lord of the earth can commit five kinds of wicked *karma*—killing, theft, violence, drinking and intercourse with another woman. ⁶⁹⁰

Brahmana, *kshatriya*, *vaishya*, *shudra*, quadrupeds like a cow, a horse, an ass and a camel, born from an egg, born from the water, inferior species and those without bones—the progressive order of *adharma* is said to be *niyuta*, *sahasra*, *shata*, ten, ten, five, three, one and half. ⁶⁹¹ For *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and women, there are instructions about sins and also about how ancestors, mothers, fathers, *gurus*, husbands and sons can be

saved.⁶⁹² The sin committed by violating a *guru*'s order is half of the demerits obtained when a sin is committed by following a *guru*'s command. For the sake of sustaining ten *brahmanas*, a king can kill a single *dvija*. For the sake of sustaining one hundred *brahmanas*, a *brahmana* can kill another *brahmana*. For the sake of five who are learned about the *brahman*, one can punish a single *vaishya*. For the sake of ten *vaishyas*, one can punish a single *vaishya*. Like that, for the sake of one hundred *vaishyas*, one can punish a single *dvija*. For the sake of one thousand *shudras*, one can punish a single *brahmana*. For the sake of one hundred and fifty *vaishyas*, one can punish a single *shudra*. For the welfare of relatives and friends, one should give up three-fourths of one's wealth and half for the sake of wives and sons, but nothing for one's own self. If a person kills a *brahmana*, *kshatriya*, *vaishya*, cow or horse, or any other living being who seeks to angrily kill him, there is no sin attached to this. O excellent *dvija*! The sin in killing, or the good merit in protecting, is respectively ten times more for the succeeding one, as compared to the preceding one, for one's wife, son, brother and relative. The virtuous say that the *prayashchitta* for killing a king, a learned *dvija* who knows the *Vedas*, a person who follows *vratas*, a person who knows *Vedanta* and a person who is ignorant, is respectively one, two, fifty and one *ayuta* times more. If arrangements are made to protect them and if donations are given to them, the good merits are said to increase by multiples, as stated before. The norms for seeing them, bowing down and acts of service towards them are said to be similar. For the sake of *devas* and for the sake of *brahmanas*, a king should always kill lions, tigers and other animals that cause people harm. In times of calamity and to protect oneself, one should kill and eat animals that are fit to be sacrificed. One should not cook for one's own self alone. One should not cook animals for one's own self alone. If one cooks for *devas* and *brahmanas*, one is not tainted.”

“Earlier, Bhagavati Mayaa was eager to impart life to the universe. She created all the *devas*, *asuras* and humans. For their sake, she created fourteen types of animals.⁶⁹³ She decided norms for sacrifices and told them, ‘O men! Follow the norms and use these *pashus* to perform sacrifices

to *devas*. Nourished through these sacrifices, they will give you what you wish for. If a person does not follow the cycle that has been established in this way, in birth after birth, they are poor and go to hell.’ For the sake of *devas*, ancestors, visitors, *gurus* and great ones who have come, a *dvija* can kill a *pashu* that is worthy of being sacrificed. At the time of a calamity, a *brahmana* can eat flesh from an animal that is fit to be sacrificed. There is no taint in this. One should undertake recommended tasks and avoid those that are prohibited. Earlier, Yuvanashva performed a great sacrifice to the *devas*. There was a quarrel among *devas* and each said, ‘This is mine.’ Thereupon, Brahma, the grandfather of the worlds, divided *devas*, humans and *pashus* and gave each a separate category. At this, the supreme Shakti, aided by large numbers of *bhutas*, became angry. She manifested herself. On seeing her, he was miserable and scared. He joined his hands in salutation. He spoke humbly, repeatedly asking her to be pacified. ‘Since you have manifested yourself in front of me, I am successful in my objective. I am an instrument. All deeds, auspicious and inauspicious, are yours. You are the one who propounded the *shruti* and *smriti* texts. You are the one who thought of *yajnas* and great *kratus*, enunciated through my mouth. O Parameshvari! All *pashus*, separately divided among *devas*, are yours. May you and the *bhutas* be content.’ When the grandfather said this, she vanished from his presence and he undertook that great sacrifice, following the norms laid down by her. Killing *pashus* that were fit to be sacrificed, he performed a sacrifice to supreme Shakti. These divisions are not enumerated here, since they have been spoken about in the *Vedas*. Even if there is no *brahmana*, a woman and a *shudra* can accept meat. In the case of a calamity, taking the *guru*’s permission, a *brahmana* can also eat it. ‘This lump of meat has originated from Shiva. It has obtained union with Shiva. O sacrificial animal! You are not auspicious. You are auspicious. Isha is the creator and the source of the entire universe. He is responsible for dissolution. Rudra is superior to the universe. O *pashu*! You are Rudra.’ If one uses this *mantra* and kills a horse, a cow, an elephant, a camel, a buffalo or any other animal, for one’s own sake or the sake of someone else, one is not touched by sin. There is no sin if one kills a creature that harms

the house—a serpent, a mouse, a sacrificial animal or a scorpion. This is what a person who follows the *ashrama* of *garhasthya* must do. Such an act yields the desired fruits. One’s mental resolutions become successful, and one becomes great, as radiant as Shiva. A *yajna* where a *pashu* is sacrificed is like *ishta* and *purti*. Like *japa*, oblations and worship, it brings success in obtaining the desired objective.”

Chapter 119-2(7) (Theft and drinking)

Indra said, ‘O illustrious one! You have described all the characteristics of violence. What are the characteristics of theft? Please tell me in detail.’

Brihaspati replied, ‘The killing of something with life is a greater sin than ordinary sins. An even greater sin is to kill a person who has trustingly sought refuge. A person who kills a person who trusts, even if that person happens to be a *shudra* or an *antyaaja*,⁶⁹⁴ is a sinner. This is a greater sin than the killing of a *brahmana* and there is no salvation. If one steals objects, with a desire to remain alive, from a person who knows about the *brahman*, a poor person, a person who has earned wealth with a great deal of difficulty or a person who has a wife and many sons—there is no *prayashchitta* for this sin. It is said that sin is greater when one steals from a trusting person. Whether the person is trusting or is not trusting, one should never steal the wealth of a poor man. Without thinking about it, if a person kills a thief who has stolen gold and jewels from a *deva* or a *dvija*, the fruits obtained are those of a horse sacrifice. If a person steals wealth from an *antyaaja*, a *shudra*, a *vaishya*, a *kshatriya* or a *brahmana*, the sins accumulated are progressively ten times more.’

‘In this connection, an ancient account is cited. This is a greater secret than all other secrets and it destroys all sins. In earlier times, there was a thief known by the name of Vajra. He was born in the city of Kanchi. All those in that beautiful and excellent city possessed every kind of prosperity. All of them were bereft of ailments. They were controlled, happy and full of compassion towards those who sought something. That city was prosperous

with every kind of wealth. The thief started by stealing small objects. Gradually, he stole larger objects and accumulated many kinds of articles. In his greed, he dug a hole in the forest and buried all this there. In the second half of the night, he hid it there and went a long distance away. A Kirata ⁶⁹⁵ arrived there and saw him do this. Without being noticed, he stole one-tenth and bore it away, along with his burden of wood. Vajra was thirsty for wealth. He had covered up the hole with a rock and filled it up with earth. He had then returned to the city. In this way, he stole a great deal of wealth and hid it under the ground. Meanwhile, the Kirata returned home and happily spoke to his beloved. “I followed a desolate path and went to collect wood. O timid one! I obtained this wealth. You desire wealth. Keep it safely.” Hearing this, she gathered it up and kept it inside. Thinking about it, she addressed her husband in these words. “There is a *brahmana* who passes by my house every day. He looked at me and said, ‘You will soon be very fortunate. Had you been a woman who belonged to the four *varnas*, you would have been a king’s beloved. However, because of Valmiki’s curse, Lakshmi does not reside for a long time with Bhillas, ⁶⁹⁶ Kiratas, actors and *antyajas*. Even in the case of those who are extremely fortunate and those who are virtuous and worthy recipients, it has been seen before that his words are never in vain. Wealth acquired by one’s own efforts, with a great deal of difficulty, remains. Over a period of time, everything else goes away. The wealth that has come on its own must be used for *dharma* and *artha*. Therefore, perform auspicious deeds, like constructing tanks and wells.’” He heard her words and was also urged by destiny. He searched for level ground, where there was a lot of water. In the great Indra’s direction, ⁶⁹⁷ he constructed a tank that was filled with an eternal supply of sparkling water. This could only be accomplished after expending a great deal of wealth. He had to give away all his wealth to artisans. Seeing that the task was still incomplete, he was filled with thoughts. “Unknown to him, I will follow the thief named Vajra. He has secreted a large amount of wealth under the ground. Little by little, I will take away a great deal of wealth from there.” Having made up his mind in this way, he followed him, without being noticed. Taking away those objects, he completed the

construction of the bunds. In the centre, surrounded by water, there was a mansion for the wielder of Sharnga bow. That divine and large tank was filled with a supply of water that never dried up. In the centre of the bund, he constructed a large temple for Shankara.'

'The forest, which had been populated by many kinds of creatures, was destroyed. He constructed many excellent and expensive fields there. He divided these and gave them to *devas* and *dvijas*. He summoned *brahmanas*, Devavrata being the foremost. He satisfied them with gold, garments and other things and addressed them in these words. "Who am I? I am a Kirata named Viradatta, who sells wood. There are the barriers of this great bund and the conception of a temple to *devas*. There is also the matter of fields and residences for *brahmanas*. O excellent *brahmanas*! All this has happened because of your favours." The *dvijas*, led by Devavrata, accepted these. Content in their minds, they named the great-souled and immensely energetic person Dvijavarma and his wife was named Shilavati. To protect them, the controlled one happily resided there, along with his wife and his relatives. After the name of the priest, he named the city Devaratapura. ⁶⁹⁸ This naming of the city satisfied all the *dvijas*. Having come under the subjugation of time, Dvijavarma died. The messengers of Yama, Brahma, Vishnu and Rudra arrived. They started to fight among themselves, like the clash between *devas* and *asuras*. At this time, the sage Narada arrived there and spoke to them. "Why are you fighting in vain? Listen to my words. Earlier, this Kirata constructed the bund through theft. He will roam around, in the form of the wind, until the original owner of the objects dies. He has stolen objects from many. Until they die, he will also be reduced to that state." Hearing what Narada had said, all the messengers left. He roamed around in the firmament for twelve years, assuming the form of the wind. The sage told his wife, "You have committed no sin. As a result of the good deeds you have performed, go to Brahma's world." Seeing that her husband was in the form of the wind, she did not wish to go to Brahma's abode. She was filled with supreme indifference and addressed the sage in these words. "Without my husband, I do not wish to go to the grandfather. I will remain here, until my husband gets back his body. I will follow him and his

destination. To remove this hardship, is there anything that he or I can do?” Hearing her words, the store of austerities was pleased and replied to her, “Your body is not only capable of enjoying, but also of performing *karma*. Through my powers, I will tell you about a means of removing this hardship. You must fast and bathe in a great *tirtha* every day. You must devoutly worship Shiva, along with Ambikaa. After this, you must only eat tubers, roots and fruits. You must perform *dhyana* on Mahesha and perform *japa* with the Shatarudriya ⁶⁹⁹ *mantra*. If this is done for one thousand and eight times, a person is freed from sins, even that of killing a *brahmana*. There is no doubt that one is freed from every other kind of sin.” Instructing her in this way, the store of austerities gave her Rudradhyaya. ⁷⁰⁰ Having shown his favours to the woman, he vanished from the spot.’

‘She made up her mind to do what would bring pleasure to her husband. Therefore, she performed supreme *japa* with that *mantra*. He was freed from the sin of theft and got his own body back. Vajra, the thief, followed the *dharma* of time. All the others, the owners of those objects, also followed the *dharma* of time. Yama summoned them and addressed them in these words. “You have committed sins. However, by chance, you have also committed good deeds. What fruit do you wish to enjoy first, that of evil deeds or that of auspicious ones?” Hearing his words, Vajra and the others replied, “Let the fruits of good deeds materialize first. Let the sin be enjoyed thereafter.” Yama again said, “Through the powers of that, all of you quickly go to heaven, along with your sons, friends and wives.” They ascended a foremost *vimana*, the one Dvijavarma was in. According to the appropriate fruits, they easily went to heaven. Along with his wife, who was a friend, Dvijavarma passed over all the worlds and obtained the status of being a Ganapati. He enjoyed himself in Kailasa.’

Indra said, ‘O immensely intelligent one! Please tell me about the divisions between good deeds, constructing bunds and other good deeds. All these enhance good merits.’

Brihaspati answered, ‘The immensely illustrious Dvijavarma obtained half the fruits of the accumulated good deeds. Vajra obtained half of what was left. The others obtained half of what was left. Good deeds are

committed in four ways—in thoughts, words, deeds and efforts. Bad deeds are destroyed when there is atonement with these respective limbs.’

Indra asked, ‘What is the nature of *asava*?⁷⁰¹ What are its taints and what are its qualities? What kind of food is tainted? Please tell me in detail.’

Brihaspati answered, ‘Different types of liquor are *paishtika*, *talaja*, *kaira*, *madhuka* and *gudasambhava*.⁷⁰² Progressively, the associated sin diminishes by half. It is said that the three *varnas*, *kshatriyas* and others, can drink *asava*. Women, with the exception of a *brahmana* lady, can drink the third and others.⁷⁰³ A widow, a virgin, and a woman going through her monthly period, should not drink. If a woman is greedy and drinks when her husband is not present, she is described as a mad woman and must be shunned, like an *antyaja*. *Dvij*as must drink in the ratio of ten, eight, six and four.⁷⁰⁴ Women should drink half this quantity of liquor. However, at the time of intercourse with their husbands, they should only drink one quarter. Out of delusion, if a *dvija* drinks liquor, he should undertake the hardship of *chandrayana*.⁷⁰⁵ He should perform *japa* with the *gayatri mantra*, or with a *mantra* to Agni, ten thousand times. Alternatively, a man can purify himself by performing *japa* with the Ambika-hridaya *mantra*. A *kshatriya* will perform *japa* for one-half the number of times as for a *dvija* and so on for the three *varnas*. Women will do half of this, or they can get this done through *dvijas*. If one performs this *japa* one thousand times, while inside water, one is purified. Liquor is praised at the time of worshipping Lakshmi, Sarasvati, Gouri, Chandikaa, Tripurambikaa, Bhairava, Kali, Mahashastri, *matrikas*⁷⁰⁶ and other Shaktis. A *brahmana* accomplished in *Vedas* and *Vedangas* can worship them without liquor. One should only eat what has been offered to them first. One should single-mindedly meditate on them. Through their powers, those who are indifferent will reach the supreme destination. Remembering the feet of the supreme Shakti is described as the *prayashchitta* for all sins, committed deliberately or inadvertently. If an inferior person drinks liquor without offering it to the supreme Shakti, he resides in the hell of Rourava for as many years as the number of drops he has consumed. A person who drinks liquor to enjoy himself is the worst among men. Without falling from a rock, or falling into

a fire, there is no *prayashchitta* for him. A *dvija* should not drink liquor out of delusion, affection, desire or to show favours. If he does so, he must go through great repentance. He must follow the *niyamas* and worship supreme Shakti. He must go through the hardship of *chandrayana* for that number of days. ⁷⁰⁷ If a *brahmana* has committed the sin consciously, the number of days required for purification is double.’

Chapter 120-2(8) (Forbidden intercourse)

Indra asked, ‘What does it mean to have intercourse with someone one shouldn’t have intercourse with? What is sin and how is one saved from it? O tiger among sages! You should tell me about this in detail.’

Brihaspati replied, ‘Having intercourse with someone one should not have intercourse with includes the mother, the sister, the *guru*’s wife and the maternal uncle’s wife. If one does this, there is no expiation. The sin of having intercourse with a mother is the same as that of having intercourse with a sister. It is the same for having intercourse with a *guru*’s wife. However, there are many types of *gurus*. If a single person’s instruction starts with teaching about the *brahman* and ending with insight about *Vedanta*, that person is described as a *mahaguru*. If a single person imparts instruction about the *brahman*, he is known as *acharya*. Each of the others, who teaches about the sacred texts of the *Vedas*, is known as a *deshika*. If a person has intercourse with a *guru*’s wife, he is destroyed. If a person has intercourse with an *acharya*’s wife, he should undertake a rite of hardship for twelve years, divided into two segments of six years each. If a person has intercourse with a maternal uncle’s wife, the act of hardship should be performed for six years. If a *brahmana* has intercourse with a woman who belongs to his own *varna*, ⁷⁰⁸ he must fast for three nights and perform one hundred *pranayamas*. If he has intercourse with a *kulata* ⁷⁰⁹ from his own *varna*, he is purified in three nights. If he has intercourse with a *kshatriya* woman, he is purified in five days. If he has intercourse with a *vaishya* woman, he is purified in seven days. If he has intercourse with a woman who

is a *chakri*, a *kirata*, a *kaivarta* or a *karmakara*,⁷¹⁰ after worshipping the Shakti that is there in the earth, he is purified in ten days. In his delusion, if a *brahmana* has intercourse with an *antyaja* woman, he is purified in a year. There are said to be four types of *dasis*—*devadasis*, *brahmadasis*, *svatantras* and *shudradasis*.⁷¹¹ Of these, the first two are equal to a *kshatriya* woman. *Svatantra* is equal to a woman who is a courtesan, while *shudradasi* is born into an inferior family. In his delusion, if a *dvija* enjoys his own *dasi*, he commits a sin. If a person has intercourse with his own wife while she is going through her period, he must observe a *prajapatya vrata*.⁷¹² If it is someone else's wife, the penance is doubled. If it happens to be a *kshatriya* woman, the penance is four times. If it is a *vaishya* woman, the penance is eight times. If it is a *shudra* woman, the penance is sixteen times. If the woman happens to be from a mixed *varna*, the penance is thirty-two times. If she is a courtesan, the penance is the same as that for a *shudra* woman. In his delusion, if a person wishes to have intercourse with his wife while she is going through her period, he will be purified by bathing, wearing a fresh garment and undergoing the penance mentioned earlier. After fasting for the rest of the day, he should bathe and undertake the rites. This must also be done if one has intercourse with some other woman. If a person has intercourse with a maiden, even if this is with the permission of her parents, he must purify himself by fasting for three nights and then marry her. If a person has intercourse with a maiden who has been bestowed on someone else, as long as this is with the permission of her parents, he will be purified in one and a quarter days. If a person has intercourse with a maiden for one month, even if this is with the knowledge of her parents, he is known as a *vrishala* and is expelled from all rites. With the knowledge of her parents, if a man has intercourse with someone else's wife, when he dies, she does not become a widow. Instead, she goes to the first man. But this must have the favour of *dvijas* and the man must marry her in the proper way. Following the *shruti* and *smriti* texts, rites of renunciation⁷¹³ must be performed. If a woman has been married to someone, and on his death her father bestows her on someone else, she

becomes an instrument to pander to wishes of enjoyment. She is not worthy of any of the rites.'

'Starting with Brahma and ending with an ant, all mobile and immobile objects are said to be formed out of the five elements, always succumbing to four kinds of desire from birth—food, intercourse, sleeping and fear. A living being cannot exist without food. But food is said to lead to desire. Therefore, among all kinds of living beings, it is impossible to overcome desire. The creator of the universe used Madana ⁷¹⁴ and masculine and feminine forms. At the beginning, he created activities for creation, preservation and dissolution. *Pravritti* continues in this way. With *nivritti*, an imperishable destination is obtained. ⁷¹⁵ Those with intelligence can obtain liberation even through *pravritti*. I will now describe the secret and the means. Listen. "Vaasudeva is the ancient Purusha. He is in all *atmans*. This Lakshmi is the original Prakriti, who gives birth to the entire universe. The churn of intercourse is undertaken for the sake of satisfying the five elements." If the churn of intercourse is performed after uttering this *mantra*, since the two undertake the act with the use of this *mantra*, no sin attaches to either of them. This is only for those who possess the strength of austerities. Others descend downwards. Moreover, this is only for one's own wife. Otherwise, the strength of destiny will be greater than both of them. If both their minds function as one, if both their hearts are wet with devotion towards Devi and if the act is not performed on prohibited days, there is no sin. "This is Ambaa, the mother of the universe. This man is Sadashiva. For pleasing the twenty-five *tattvas*, ⁷¹⁶ this churn of intercourse is being undertaken now." If the churn of intercourse is undertaken after reciting this *mantra*, both of them become the performers of auspicious deeds and neither suffers from a sin. O Indra of the *devas*! Listen to this supreme and great secret. This *yoga* instantly destroys all sin. One must be full of faith and devotion. Having bathed, one must stand inside the water. One must perform *japa* one thousand and eight times, using the *mantra* with fifteen *aksharas*. ⁷¹⁷ If one worships Para Shakti, one is freed from all sins. All his sins are destroyed, even if they have been committed in one

crore of *kalpas*. He is freed from all calamities and obtains everything that he wishes for.’

Indra said, ‘O illustrious one! You know about every kind of *dharma*. You are engaged in the welfare of all beings. You should specifically tell me about the sins that result from association.’

Brihaspati replied, ‘There are said to be four kinds of sins that result from association. The doer is the most important. In the due order, there are the one who helps, the one who instigates and the one who sanctions.

Progressively, the sin of the succeeding one is one-tenth that of the preceding one. Purification is along the lines mentioned earlier. There are sins from selling the following and progressively, the sin from selling a succeeding item is one-tenth of that from selling a preceding item—liquor, an animal killed with a poisoned weapon, gum or resin, mushrooms, onion, garlic, *kalinga*,⁷¹⁸ *mahakoshataki*,⁷¹⁹ *bimbi*,⁷²⁰ *kavaka*,⁷²¹ *hastini*,⁷²² *shishulambika*,⁷²³ the Indian fig, brinjal, wood-apple and jasmine. If one accepts cooked food from the following, there is a sin—a person who sells part of a city or a village or the implements of a *vaishya*; or sells objects given to a courtesan, a servant, an inhabitant of a city, an inhabitant of a distant village, a condemned person, a physician, a hermit or Shiva’s devotee; a person who earns his subsistence through women; a person who sells cooked food; a person who earns his livelihood by selling weapons; a person who wanders around or a person who criticizes the conduct recommended in the *Vedas*. Progressively, the sin is one-tenth of the succeeding one, compared to the preceding one. If one eats food fried in oil for one’s own sake, it is instructed that there is the same kind of sin. A sin is instructed not only for the person who eats but also for the person who sees this act. Unseen by others, if one eats food fried in oil for one’s own sake, progressively for *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras*, the extent of the sin is reduced by one-fourth. If a *dvija* eats food prepared by a *dasi*, or seen by her, the sin is half. If the food is prepared by a courtesan, or seen by her, the sin is three-fourths. If the food is prepared by a *gopa*, unless it happens to be one of the four *gavyas*,⁷²⁴ the sin is the same as that prepared by a *shudra*. If food mixed with oil, *ghee* and molasses is prepared by a

vaishya, there is no sin. A *brahmani* ⁷²⁵ who has deviated is the same as a *vaishya* and there is no sin if the food is seen by her. If a *dvija* eats food prepared by a *bruva*, ⁷²⁶ he must perform one hundred *pranayamas*. Alternatively, immersed in water, he can perform *japa* with the *drupadad mantra* ⁷²⁷ thrice. Or, immersed in water, he can perform *japa* with the “*idam Vishnu*” or “*Tryambaka mantra*”. ⁷²⁸ If he fasts for one night, he will be cleansed of his sins. Or, chanting the *pavamana mantra*, ⁷²⁹ he can sprinkle water over the food. Or he should perform *japa* with “*anna suktam*” or “*Bhrigurvai Varuni*”. ⁷³⁰ He must follow *niyamas* and perform *japa* with the “*Brahmarpanam shloka*”. ⁷³¹ If he fasts for one night, he will be purified. If a woman eats a *bruva*’s food, she will feed *dvijas* for a day. If a *brahmana* takes such food at the time of a calamity, there is no sin. If a person eats food after devoutly chanting the “*idam Vishnu*” *mantra* seven times and performs *dhyana* on the *mantra* with the thought “I am he”, he is not touched by sin. Or a person can perform *dhyana* on Shankara and perform *japa* with the “*Tryambaka mantra*” and with the *jnana* that “I am he”. He will not be touched by sin. O Indra of *devas*! Listen to my secret words. A person must perform *dhyana* on Para Shakti and perform *japa* with the *panchadasi akshara mantra*. Every day, a *dvija* must consciously offer the food to her and then eat. If he does this, there will be no sin on account of the food and there will be no fear on account of poverty. There will be no fear on account of ailments, nor any fear on account of enemies. If he performs *japa* in this way, he will obtain liberation and everything will be auspicious everywhere. O Shakra! I have thus described sins in detail to you and also about the consequent *prayashchitta*. What else do you wish to hear?’

Chapter 121-2(9) (Churning for *amrita*)

Indra said, ‘O illustrious one! You know everything about *dharma*. O excellent one! You know about the three periods of time. You have accurately described the atonement for wicked deeds. What is the *karma*, as

the result of which I am facing this adversity? What is the *prayashchitta*? O supreme among eloquent ones! Please tell me about that.'

Brihaspati replied, 'It is said that through Diti, Kashyapa had a son named Danu. ⁷³² He also had a daughter named Rupavati and her father bestowed her on Dhatri. The resultant son was the extremely radiant Vishvarupa. He was accomplished in the *Vedas* and *Vedangas* and was supremely devoted to Narayana. That lord of *daityas* sought out Bhrigu's son ⁷³³ as his priest. O Vasava! You obtained control over the kingdom of *devas*. On an earlier occasion, you were present in Sudharma. ⁷³⁴ In the presence of *rishis*, you asked a question. "Among the two, *samsara* and visiting *tirthas*, which has superior qualities? Show me your favours. Determine this and give me an answer." All of them got ready to reply to your question. However, such is the strength of destiny that I spoke before them. "Visiting *tirthas* is swifter and faster than *samsara*." Hearing this, all the *rishis* became angry and cursed me. "Along with your sons, go to *karma-bhumi* ⁷³⁵ and be constrained by poverty." They were enraged and cursed me. Dejected, I went to Kanchi. On seeing that your city lacked a priest, along with *devas*, you were filled with thoughts. For the sake of a priest, you lovingly requested Vishvarupa, supreme among those who scorch. His sister gave birth to *danavas* and he became the priest of *devas*. Hence, the great ascetic did not possess excessive enmity towards *daityas*. At the time, the Indra among *daityas* and Vasava were equal in strength. O king! You became enraged at this and wished to kill the *danavas*, his sister's sons. You swiftly went to the place where the ascetic was performing austerities in the forest. Resembling a mountain with three peaks, the sage was seated on his seat. ⁷³⁶ He was single-mindedly focused on the *brahman* and the three *Vedas* emerging from his mouth resounded in the directions. With Isha's favours, you formed a view about what would be best for all beings. You simultaneously severed his three heads. Touched by that sin, you repeatedly suffered. You went to a cave in Meru and remained there for many years. Through the words of the sages, Brahma got to know what had happened. Tormented by sorrow on account of his son, he was filled with wrath and cursed. "As a result of my curse, Vasava will quickly lose his

prosperity.” *Devas* no longer had a protector. Oppressed by the *daityas*, they were miserable. Without me and without you, all the *devas* ran away. They went to Brahma’s abode. Prostrating themselves, they quickly told him what had happened. He thought about what could be done to counter the sin. However, he was unable to decide on a means of countering it. Therefore, surrounded by *devas*, he went to Narayana.’

‘The one with the four faces bent praised him and told him everything. Full of compassion, the lord of the worlds thought about this in many kinds of ways. He divided the sin into three parts and placed these in three different places—women, the earth and trees. He granted them boons. Thus, women would be united with their husbands and have sons at the time of their monthly period. Even when cut down, all the trees would be able to grow again. Madhusudana granted the earth the boon of being able to fill up spots that had been dug up. The sin started to flow quickly—as menstrual flow in women, as sap in trees and as barren spots on earth. After this, Indra, leader of *devas*, emerged from the cave. Through Parameshthi’s favours, you regained prosperity and the kingdom. Comforted in this way, Dhatri spoke to Janardana. “O sage! ⁷³⁷ Let my curse not be in vain. Let it materialize after some time.” Bhagavan heard the words spoken by the infinitely energetic sage. He was delighted. However, since he knew about what would occur in the future, he was silent and left. At this time, you ruled over the three worlds. But, intoxicated because of your prosperity, you made Mount Kailasa suffer. ⁷³⁸ Shiva, who knows everything, sent the illustrious sage, Durvasa. Wishing to destroy your insolence, he cursed you. Both the curses have led to the same consequence. You can see that the three worlds have been deprived of their prosperity now. O Vasava! No sacrifices are undertaken and there are no donations. There are no *yamas* and *niyamas*. There are no austerities anywhere. All the *brahmanas* are deprived of prosperity and their minds have succumbed to avarice. They are without spirit and lack in patience. In general, they are non-believers. The earth lacks in herbs and juices and has lost its vigour. The sun is grey in complexion and the moon is devoid of beauty. The one who accepts oblations ⁷³⁹ has lost energy. The winds have forms that are full of dust. The

directions are no longer pleasant, and the sky is no longer sparkling. All the *devas* are feeble and seem to have lost their radiance. All the mobile and immobile objects in the three worlds have almost been destroyed.’

Hayagriva continued, ‘In this way, a conversation was taking place between Brihaspati and the great Indra. Meanwhile, Malaka and other great *daityas* laid siege to the world of heaven. Haughty because of their strength, they severed Nandana and the other gardens. Using weapons, they struck all those who guarded those gardens. Shattering the ramparts, they entered inside the city. They severely punished all the Gods in their homes. In particular, they abducted all the *apsaras* and other jewels. Suffering in this way, all the *devas* screamed. Hearing their shrieks, Vasava got up from his seat. Along with all the other *devas*, who followed him, he fled. With a dejected face, Vrisha ⁷⁴⁰ reached Brahma’s residence. He told him everything that the *daityas* had done. The one with the tawny horses was with all the *devas* and had lost his prosperity. Vidhatri heard what he had said and told him, “O Indra! Along with all the *devas*, go and seek refuge with Mukunda. ⁷⁴¹ He is the one who creates afflictions for *daityas*. He will do what is best for you.” Saying this, with him and all the *devas*, the grandfather Brahma himself went to the milky ocean. Using excellent words, Brahma and the other *devas* praised Bhagavan Janardana, the great lord of all the worlds. At this, the eternal Bhagavan Vaasudeva was pleased. Eager to protect the universe, he spoke to all the *devas*. Shri Bhagavan said, “I will arrange it so that your energy is enhanced. You should now do what I am telling you. Hurl all the excellent herbs into the milky ocean. Contract an alliance with the *asuras* and act together. Make Mandara the churning rod and make Vasuki the rope used for churning. O Gods! With me established as your aide, churn the ocean for *amrita*. First using words of conciliation, you must speak to all the *danavas*. Tell them the resultant fruits will accrue to them and to you. When the ocean of milk is churned, nectar will be generated. When you drink this, all of you will become strong and immortal. I will arrange it so that the *daityas* do not get any of the nectar. They will merely exert themselves.”’ This is what Shri Vaasudeva told all the Gods.

‘The Gods contracted an alliance with the unmatched *daityas*. The Gods and *asuras* gathered together heaps of many kinds of herbs. They hurled them into the waters of the ocean of milk, which was clearer than the moon. Mandara was made the churning rod and Vasuki was made the churning rope. With a great deal of effort, they started to churn the lord of aquatic creatures. All the *devas* were stationed near Vasuki’s tail. Shouri⁷⁴² appointed the *daityas* towards the head. The *daityas* were strong. But as he⁷⁴³ breathed, the flames that emerged from his mouth scorched all their bodies and they were robbed of their energy. The Gods, who tugged at the tail, were repeatedly strengthened by a favourable breeze sent by Vishnu. In the centre of the ocean of milk, the illustrious one assumed the form of the original tortoise. As Mount Mandara was whirled around, he provided the support.⁷⁴⁴ In another form, he was amidst all the *devas*. In another form, he was amidst the *daityas* and tugged at Vasuki. His form of the *brahman* was present in the mountain, as it was used to churn the ocean. In a different form as a *devarshi*,⁷⁴⁵ he repeatedly infused energy into the *devas* and enhanced their strength. In another form, he helped the *naga* and increased his strength. Janardana’s power was present everywhere. As *devas* and *danavas* churned the ocean of milk, Surabhi, worshipped by the Gods, appeared first. O store of austerities! *Devas* and *daityas* were filled with joy. *Devas* and *danavas* again churned the ocean of milk. The *siddhas* in the firmament wondered, “What will emerge next?” *Devi Varuni*⁷⁴⁶ arose, her eyes rolling with intoxication. She smiled and stood in front of the *asuras*. The *daityas* did not accept her and came to be known as *asuras*.⁷⁴⁷ The word *asura* indicates that they did not accept *sura*. At this, she stationed herself before all the *devas*. Urged by Parameshthi, the *devas* happily accepted her. Since they accepted *sura*, they are described through the expression *suras*. As the churning continued, the giant tree of Parijata arose and filled all the directions in the world with its excellent fragrance. O *devarshi*! After this, a large number of patient *apsaras*⁷⁴⁸ arose, exceedingly beautiful in form. They charmed the minds of all the worlds. The one with the cool beams⁷⁴⁹ arose and Maheshvara accepted him. Poison arose and those born as *nagas* accepted this. The jewel known as

Koustubha arose and was accepted by Janardana. After this, there was a giant herb, known by the name of Vijaya. The smell from its leaves was maddening and Bhairava accepted this. After this, *deva* Dhanvantari himself arose, clad in divine garments. He presented himself, holding a radiant and excellent *kamandalu* ⁷⁵⁰ filled with *amrita* in his hand. The minds of all the *devas* and *daityas* rejoiced. O store of austerities! All the sages were also content.'

'After this, from that great ocean of milk, Shri ⁷⁵¹ arose. She was seated on a blossoming lotus, and she held a lotus in her hand. All the sages praised Shri with the supreme Shri *suktam*. ⁷⁵² Content in their hearts, the *gandharvas* sang beautifully. Vishvachi and large numbers of foremost *apsaras* danced. Ganga and other sacred rivers presented themselves, so that they might bathe her. Eight *diggajas* ⁷⁵³ gathered water from golden vessels and bathed Shri, who was seated on a lotus. Tulasi emerged from one of her halves and united with Hari. Assuming an embodied form, the ocean of milk gave her ⁷⁵⁴ a garland of lotuses. Vishvakarma gave her divine ornaments. She was adorned in excellent divine garlands. She was ornamented with celestial ornaments. While everyone looked on, Ramaa went to her place on Vishnu's chest. The immensely powerful Vishnu held Tulasi. Devi glanced at everything from her place on Vishnu's chest. As Maheshvari of all the worlds looked towards the *devas*, her eyes were wet with compassion.'

Chapter 122-2(10) (Mohini's manifestation)

Hayagriva said, 'Thus, as a result of the promise made by the immensely powerful Vishnu, the extremely patient *devas*, the great Indra and others, were filled with great delight. Malaka and all the other *daityas* turned away from Vishnu. Abandoned by Devi Shri, they were filled with great anxiety. The *daityas* seized the golden pot that had arisen, held in Dhanvantari's hand and full of the supreme and excellent essence of *amrita*. As a result, a quarrel ensued between *asuras* and *devas*. Meanwhile, Vishnu, the protector of all the worlds, properly worshipped Lalitaa, who was part of his own form. Witnessing the extremely terrible battle between Gods and *asuras*, Brahma returned to his own abode, while Shambhu remained in Kailasa. Vrisha fought with Malaka, the lord of the *daityas*. All the Gods fought with the *asuras*. Bhagavan, Indra among *yogis*, worshipped Maheshvari. She is one with him. But as a result of his *dhyana* and yoga, she manifested herself in her form. She confounded everyone. She is herself the *nayikaa* of *shringara*.⁷⁵⁵ She was dressed in every kind of excellent *shringara* attire. She was adorned in every kind of ornament. She restrained the Gods and *asuras* from their fighting. She confounded the *daityas* with her sweet smiles and said, "Enough of this fighting. Why use weapons that strike at the inner organs? Cruel conversations are only responsible for throats getting parched. Why indulge in them in vain? I will be the mediator between you and the residents of heaven. They and you have had a constant share in hardships. I will distribute this wonderful *amrita* equally among all of you. The excellent vessel of nectar should be placed in my hand." Hearing these words, the *daityas* were deluded by her words. With their minds charmed, they gave her the pot of nectar. In a form that deluded the universe, she accepted the vessel. She made the Gods and *asuras* sit down in separate rows. Standing between the two rows, she spoke to the Gods and *asuras*. "All of you should be silent. In the due order, I will give everyone." All of them honoured the words she had spoken. She is the one who

confounds all the worlds and she started to distribute. The golden ladle tinkled. Her auspicious bangles tinkled. All her parts were excellent, and her ornaments were beautiful and excellent. The dazzling pot of nectar was in her left hand, which resembled a lotus. Using the ladle, she first served the nectar to the row where *devas* were seated. As she was gradually doing this, the sun and the moon pointed out to her that Simhika's son ⁷⁵⁶ was seated amidst them. Using the ladle in her hand, she severed his head. Only the head had drunk the *amrita* and it left for the firmament. Seeing this, the *asuras* who were present were confounded and remained silent. In this way, she distributed it among all the Gods. Next, she placed the vessel in front of the *asuras* and vanished. All the *daityas* and *danavas* saw that the vessel was empty. As a result of their rising rage, they wished to fight. Having drunk the nectar, Indra and all the other Gods had become stronger. Using their weapons, they fought against the feeble *asuras*. The excellent Gods pierced hundreds of Indras among *danavas*, who fled in different directions. Some went to Patala. The lord of Gods defeated the *daitya* named Malaka. Since Shri had glanced at him, he regained his own prosperity. The great Indra got his throne back again and was served by the Gods. Having conquered, as had been the case earlier, he ruled over the three worlds, as had been the case earlier. All the *devas* no longer faced any fear in the three worlds. As they wished, they roamed around among all mobile and immobile entities, always happy in their minds.'

'The sage Narada was amazed at witnessing everything that Mohini had done. Wandering around as he willed, he went to Kailasa. When Nandi granted him permission, he prostrated himself before Parameshvara. Honoured by him, he was content and seated himself on a seat. The sage, who wandered around as he willed, was seated. Mahadeva, Parvati's beloved, resembled sparkling crystal. He said, "O illustrious one! You know everything that has happened. You have sanctified this seat. O *devarshi*! O one who loves dissensions! What have the residents of heaven been up to? Who has been victorious, the Gods or the *asuras*? What is the news about *amrita*? What has Vishnu done?" Mahesha asked Narada, the excellent sage, in this way. For a short while, he was surprised. However, he replied

with a pleased countenance. “O Bhagavan! You are omniscient. Therefore, you know everything. Nevertheless, since you have asked me, I will now tell you what transpired. There was a terrible battle between *daityas* and the residents of heaven. The illustrious and primordial Narayana assumed the form of Mohini. She was ornamented and pervasive in her beauty. Her embodied form was the divinity of *shringara*. Seeing her, the Gods and *asuras* stopped fighting. When the *daityas* were confounded by her *maya*, she asked them for the vessel of nectar. The *asuras* easily gave it to her and made her the mediator. Devi captivated the mind with a sweet smile. Accepting it, she distributed all the nectar among the *devas*. Next, the *daityas* saw that she had vanished and that the vessel was empty. With blazing faces, they stood up again, so as to fight. Since they had tasted the *amrita*, the immortals were filled with unmatched valour. They defeated the great *daityas*, who were destroyed and fled to Patala.” Bhavani’s imperishable husband heard this account and quickly sent Narada away.’

‘He constantly remembered what he had said and was filled with wonder. Unknown to all the *pramathas*, Skanda, Nandi and Vinayaka, but accompanied by Parvati, he went to Vishnu. Along with his wife, the one with the bull as a mount went to the shores of the ocean of milk. Vishnu was lying down on his couch, which was a serpent. On seeing him, he stood up, advancing and welcoming him. Isha got down from his mount and stood there, along with Parvati. Seeing him, Achyuta swiftly advanced and happily welcomed him with *arghya* and other things. Full of affection, he clasped Bhavani’s husband in a deep embrace. When he was seated, he asked him about the reason for his arrival. Mahadeva said, “O Bhagavan! O Purushottama! O great lord of *yoga*! Show me the form that you manifested yourself in, beautiful and full of every kind of prosperity and good fortune. It engendered delusion in everyone and is incapable of being grasped through words and thoughts. I desire to see that form, the presiding divinity of *shringara*. I should certainly see that form. You bestow everything desired on those who ask.” Mahadeva continuously entreated him in this way. Hari meditated on that wonderful form, which could only be obtained

through *dhyana*. He smiled a little as he meditated on it in his mind. The great lord of *yoga* signified his assent and disappeared.'

'Sharva repeatedly glanced around in every direction. In a certain place, he then saw a pleasure garden, the likes of which had never been seen before. There were rows of blooming flowers. Bees were drinking honey and buzzing around. In every direction, there was a sweet fragrance, spreading from clumps of *champaka* flowers.⁷⁵⁷ Cuckoos fluttered, as they drank in the honey from bunches of mango blossoms. Peacocks danced within circles created by the trunks of *ashoka* trees.⁷⁵⁸ The buzzing of bees vanquished the sounds from the playing of lutes. There was a pervading fragrance from *patala* flowers⁷⁵⁹ and *patala* flowers blazed. The place was charming with *tamala*, *tala* and *hintala* trees,⁷⁶⁰ which seemed to form garlands. There were long ponds along the boundaries, full of the sparkling radiance of lotus flowers. The flowering blossoms and beautiful sprouts moved, stirred by the gentle breeze. The fragrance from *santana* trees brought greater pleasure than one obtains from the birth of an offspring.⁷⁶¹ There were excellent flowers everywhere there. It was enchanting to everyone. A beautiful maiden could be seen, seated at the foot of a Parijata tree. She was reddish in complexion, resembling the rising sun. Because of the bloom of youth, she was proud. The nails on her feet, which were like lotuses, were attractive and red, with the hue of rubies. As a result of the beautiful red lac that had been applied to her feet, her feet were coloured red. Her charming lotus feet wore anklets that tinkled. Her shanks were such that they quelled the pride in the brave Ananga Madana's quiver. The beautiful lady's thighs possessed a charm like the trunks of elephants or the trunks of plantain trees. She was radiant and her loins were meant for enjoyment. Her excellent buttocks were covered with an extremely soft, silken and red garment. Her body's beauty was made even more radiant by a girdle, decorated with freshly cut jewels. Her deep navel was like a whirlpool and the shining waves of the *trivali*⁷⁶² rose above this. Her breasts had nipples that were like buds. Hundreds of pearl necklaces covered them and swung as she moved. The burden of her extremely heavy breasts pressed down on her slender waist. Her arms were as delicate as

shirisha flowers. ⁷⁶³ She wore bangles and bracelets. There were rings on her fingers and her beautiful neck resembled a polished conch shell. There was a curved chin around her face, which shone like a mirror. Her lips were red. The rows of her white teeth were as radiant as pure knowledge. They resembled a jasmine flower or the white moon. The dazzling ornament on her nose was made out of large pearls. Her long braid of hair was glossy, like the inside of a *ketaki* flower. ⁷⁶⁴ Her eyes were large and long. Her forehead was like the half-moon and the shining forelocks were arranged properly. Earrings ornamented her ears and they were studded with jewels, rendering the ears more charming. The mark on her forehead, made out of fresh camphor and musk, caused joy. The sweet circle of her face resembled the autumn moon. There was a shining *tilaka* mark, made out of *kasturi*, on her forehead. ⁷⁶⁵ Her masses of glossy hair were dark blue. The mark of *sindura* ⁷⁶⁶ on the parting of her hair made her even more beautiful. The ornament on the crown of her head sparkled like a digit of the moon. Her eyes darted around. Her excellent attire reflected every kind of *shringara* and she was adorned with every kind of ornament. Adorned and garlanded, she was playing with a ball. On seeing her, Ishvara abandoned Umaa and quickly rushed after her. On seeing that her own beloved was rushing after her, Umaa was greatly surprised and criticized her own beauty. Full of shame and jealousy, she stood there silently, her face cast downwards. Somehow or other, he grasped her and repeatedly embraced her. She shook him off and ran far away. But full of desire, Isha seized her again. He was completely under the subjugation of Kama.’

‘As he embraced her with great force, his semen oozed out. The immensely strong divinity, Mahashasta, arose from this. He was capable of countering the insolence of many crores of Indras among *daityas*. O crusher of Vindhya! ⁷⁶⁷ Since drops of the semen came into contact with the earth, here and there, the earth assumed golden and silver marks. Immediately, *Devi*, who confounded the universe, vanished from the spot. Girisha withdrew and returned to the mountain ⁷⁶⁸ with his friend, Gouri. O Lopamudra’s husband! I will describe an extraordinary event to you. Listen. This has been in my heart and I have not spoken about it to anyone. Earlier,

there was a crest-jewel among all the *daityas*. His name was Bhandasura. He was accomplished and as he wished, had formerly chastised *devas* in many kinds of ways. From his right shoulder, he created a *daitya* named Vishukra, who was Shakra's equal and was capable of protecting the lineage. From his left shoulder, he created Vishanga, who was a crest-jewel among the wicked. *Danava* Bhandasura also created a sister named Dhumini. With his two brothers, who were fierce in their valour, he killed all the enemies. Full of extensive valour and prowess, he shattered the universe. Brahma, Vishnu and Mahesha witnessed his blazing energy. They immediately fled and began to continuously reside in their abodes alone. At the time, crushed by his arms, large numbers of those who lived in the vault of heaven lost their senses and were not even able to breathe. Some of them entered the depths of Patala. Some of them hid in the waters of the ocean. Some of them hid in different corners. Some of them resorted to groves in mountains. Extremely scared, they disappeared, abandoning their wives, sons and women. The Ribhus ⁷⁶⁹ were dislodged from their entitlements and roamed around in disguise. Bhandasura chastised everyone in the three worlds —*yakshas*, giant *uragas*, *siddhas*, *sadhyas* who were indomitable in battle, Brahma, the one with the lotus in his navel, ⁷⁷⁰ Rudra and the wielder of the *vajra*. He took them to be as insignificant as a blade of grass. O sage! To kill Bhandasura and protect the three worlds, from the fire of a great sacrifice, she arose in her third form. ⁷⁷¹ The form of this supreme divinity is known as Lalitaa. In her four arms, she holds a noose, a goad, a bow and polished arrows. This Devi is supreme Shakti. Her form is that of the supreme *brahman*. Accomplished in fighting, in a battle, she killed Bhandasura, Indra among the *daityas*.'

Chapter 123-2(11) (Bhandasura's appearance)

Agastya asked, 'How was Bhandasura born? How did Tripurambikaa appear? How did she destroy him in battle? Please tell me everything in detail.'

Hayagriva replied, ‘Earlier, when Dakshayani ⁷⁷² gave up her body, and he had destroyed her father’s sacrifice, Shankara beheld the *atman* within himself, the essence of *jnana* and bliss. The one who possessed the quality of being beyond the opposite pair of sentiments was worshipped by the sages. He dwelt in the region that extended up to the Himalayas, along the banks of Ganga. For a long time, the spirited lady worshipped him. Using *yoga*, she gave up her own body and became Mount Himalaya’s daughter. The mountain heard from Narada that his own daughter was actually Rudrani. Therefore, so that she could serve him, ⁷⁷³ he placed her near him. At this time, *devas* were oppressed by Taraka. Following what Brahma said, they summoned Madana and addressed him in these words. “At the beginning of creation, Bhagavan Brahma created all *prajas*. After some time, he refrained from creating through his mental powers. For a long time, he performed austerities of thoughts, words, body and deeds. At this, Bhagavan Janardana, who is one with Lakshmi, was pleased. He is the one who grants boons to all those with bodies and he requested him to ask for a boon. Brahma said, ‘O Bhagavan! If you are pleased, through your favours, let me be able to easily create the world, with its mobile and immobile objects.’ When Vidhatri said this, the one whose form charms the universe looked towards Mahalakshmi. You manifested yourself. ⁷⁷⁴ As weapons, you were given a bow made out of sugarcane and arrows that are flowers. Delighted, Hari granted you the boon that you would be victorious and invincible. This one ⁷⁷⁵ creates beings, with their own *karma* being the cause. With your own companions, you will be a witness and he will practice *nivritti*. Brahma was granted a boon, and he has extended that boon to you. O Manmatha! Now that you will act, he can practice *nivritti* in his mind. Your strength and valour will be invincible. Your bravery will never be futile. Your weapons are delicate flowers, but they will never be in vain. Brahma has granted a boon to a *danava* named Taraka. He has caused impediments to all the worlds. In particular, he has done that to us too. Barring Shiva’s son, he will not face fear from anybody. Other than you, there is no one who can accomplish this great task. You must use your own hands to undertake the task. No one else is capable. Though Shiva is with

Gouri, he is constantly engaged in performing *dhyana* on his own *atman*. He is in a beautiful spot on the slopes of the Himalayas, surrounded by sages. Urge him towards Gouri, so that a son is born. O immensely strong one! Use your arrows to accomplish this task and save us.” He was thus entreated by *devas*, who praised him repeatedly.’

‘For his own destruction, he proceeded towards the slope of the Himalayas. The one whose weapons were large arrows made out of flowers saw Ishana seated there. His eyes were closed, and he was performing *dhyana*, worshipping someone. At the time, Himalaya’s daughter arrived there, in a radiant and wonderful form. She wished to worship Shiva. Girijaa ⁷⁷⁶ bore fragrances, flowers and offerings and approached Shambhu. The extremely strong Smara saw her, intent on serving him. Invisible to all beings, he stood there, not very far away. He pierced Maheshvara with arrows made out of flowers. Pierced by the arrows, he forgot his tasks. His senses destroyed by Manmatha, he glanced at Gouri, who was standing there. Regaining his composure, he thought, “What is this?” He saw the armoured Manmatha standing in front of him, with flowers as his weapon. The wielder of the trident, who was capable of burning down the three worlds, looked angrily at him. He opened his third eye and burnt down Makaradhvaja. ⁷⁷⁷ Thus ignored by Shiva, the mountain’s daughter was miserable. Taking the permission of her parents, she left for the forest, to undertake austerities. Chitrakarma, lord of *ganas*, saw those ashes. Using those ashes, he fashioned a wonderful man. Rudra saw that man, wonderful in form, in front of him, and he instantly came to life, as if Manmatha had assumed an embodied form. He was extremely strong and greatly energetic. His radiance was like that of the mid-day sun. Rejoicing, Chitrakarma embraced him in his arms and said, “O child! Worship Mahadeva. He is the one who bestows *siddhi* in everything.” Saying this, immeasurable in intelligence, he taught him the Shatarudriya hymn. He bowed down before Rudra one hundred times and performed *japa* with Shatarudriya. At this, Bhagavan Mahadeva, with the bull on his banner, was pleased. He asked him to choose a boon and the child asked for a boon. “Let it be such that half of my adversary’s strength is united with my strength. Let me be able

to render the best of *astras* and *shastras* futile.” The lord thought about something and agreed to this. He granted him a kingdom for sixty thousand years. Witnessing this conduct, Dhatri said, “May you be Bhanda. You will be Bhanda.” ⁷⁷⁸ Since he said this, the worlds describe him with the name of Bhanda. Having granted him this boon and having bestowed all the *astras* and *shastras* on him, surrounded by large numbers of sages, he ⁷⁷⁹ vanished from the spot.’

Chapter 124-2(12) (Lalita’s manifestation)

Hayagriva said, ‘The immensely strong Bhanda was born from the fire of Rudra’s rage. Therefore, he became a terrible *danava*. Shukra, the priest of the *daityas*, went there. Hundreds of extremely strong *daityas* also assembled. Urged by Bhrigu’s son, ⁷⁸⁰ Bhanda summoned Maya, the architect born in the *daitya* lineage and addressed him in these words.” Earlier, Indras among *daityas* were established in Shonitapura ⁷⁸¹ and ruled over the three worlds from there. Go there and build a city, like the former one.” Hearing these words, the architect went to that great city. Using the powers of his mind, he instantly created a city that was like the city of the immortals. After this, Shukra and the immensely strong *daityas* instated him. Filled with supreme prosperity and energy, he was radiant. Earlier, Brahma had given a crown to Hiranya. ⁷⁸² As long as one was alive, it would not be destroyed. It dazzled like the rising sun and Indras among *daityas* had been ornamented with this earlier. Bhrigu’s son gave Bhanda this. There were two whisks that resembled the moon, constructed by Brahma. As long as one was alive and was fanned with these, there would be no ailment and no misery. These were given to him and he was also given an umbrella, fashioned by Brahma in earlier times. Those seated under its shade were not harmed by crores of weapons. There was a bow named Vijaya and a conch shell that killed enemies. He was given many other extremely expensive ornaments too. He gave him an imperishable throne that was like the sun in hue. Adorned with every kind of ornament,

he seated himself on that throne. Like a jewel that had been polished, the energetic one was resplendent. Eight immensely strong *daityas* served him—Indrashatru, Amitraghna, Vidyunmali, Vibhishana, Ugrakarma, Ugradhanva, Vijaya and Shrutiparaga. He had four wives who were extremely beautiful to behold—Sumohini, Kumudini, Chitrangi and Sundari. All the *devas*, along with Vasava, who knew about time, ⁷⁸³ served him. There were thousands of chariots, elephants, horses and foot soldiers. All the *danavas* followed the instructions of Bhrigu's son. They were great and gigantic in form, desiring victory. Abiding by Shiva's command, they worshipped Mahadeva. All the *danavas* there possessed sons, grandsons and wealth. Sacrifices were performed in every direction, in every house. In every *daitya* house, there were chants of *Rig Veda*, *Yajur Veda*, *Sama Veda*, *mimamsa* ⁷⁸⁴ and other subjects. In the sacrifices of the *daityas*, Gods ate the *havya*, just as they did so in the best of hermitages of sages and *dvijas*. All this was done with the hope of Bhanda's victory. Sixteen thousand years passed as if it was an instant.'

'The *daitya*'s strength and austerities increased. Indra's strength diminished. Seeing this, Kamalaa's husband, ⁷⁸⁵ suddenly created a beautiful Mayaa that would confound the worlds. Janardana, lord of *devas*, spoke to this Mayaa. "With your energy, you are the one who deludes all beings. Roam around as you will. No one will ever detect you. Quickly go to Bhanda, the leader of *daityas*. Without any delay, confuse him and enjoy his material objects." Having obtained this boon, Mayaa prostrated herself before Janardana. She asked for some foremost *apsaras* as aides. As asked by her, he sent some. The foremost among them was Vishvachi. Along with them, the one with eyes like a doe went to the excellent shores of Manasa, where shining trees grew. Along with his own women, the Indra among *daityas* was sporting there. The one with eyes like a fawn seated herself, at the foot of a *champaka* tree. Residing there, she sang in sweet tones. The Indra among *daityas* arrived there, surrounded by his forces and ministers. He heard the sounds of the *veena* and saw the beautiful lady. He saw her, beautiful in all her limbs, resembling a flash of lightning. He descended into the huge pit full of *maya*, known as Madana. The hearts of the ministers

were also affected by Smara. The lord of *daityas* entreated the virtuous lady for a long time. As requested by them, they promised them great delight. This kind of enchantment cannot be obtained through great sacrifices and horse sacrifices. Having obtained this, they were greatly content. They forgot the *Vedas* and the divinity who is Umaa's consort. They abandoned sacrifices and all the other auspicious rites. Their priest was shown utter contempt by them. Ten thousand years passed as if it was but one *muhurta*. All the *daityas* were deluded in this way and *devas*, along with Vasava, were freed from the calamity. O *brahmana*! They were filled with great joy.'

'On one occasion, the sage Narada arrived there and saw Indra of the *devas* seated on his throne, surrounded by all the *devas*. He prostrated himself before the tiger among sages, who resembled a blazing fire. Joining his hands in salutation, the lord of *devas* addressed him in these words. "O illustrious one! You know about every kind of *dharma*. You are supreme among those who possess superior and inferior knowledge. You only go to places you want to bless. The cause of your arrival must be something that will be auspicious for us. When one hears your words, which are like *amrita*, the ears are filled with bliss. O lord among sages! I will cross over all the difficulties and be successful in my objective." Narada replied, "Bhanda, Indra among *daityas*, has been confounded by Vishnu's *maya*. If he is freed from her, like another fire, he will burn down the three worlds. He is superior to you in energy, weapons and strength of *maya*. You should act so as to remove his energy and great strength. O Vasava! Even if you practice austerities for hundreds of crores of *kalpas*, you will be incapable of doing this, unless you worship Devi Para-Shakti. O foolish ones! Before the enemy wakes up, worship her. When Bhagavati is worshipped, she will ensure what is beneficial for you." Shakra, lord of large numbers of *devas*, was addressed in this way. Along with all the *devas*, he worshipped the sage. Instructed to perform austerities, he went to the slopes of the Himalayas. There, the banks of the Bhagirathi are dazzling, because of flowers from all seasons. All the Gods performed a great worship of Para-Shakti. The place came to be known as Indraprastha⁷⁸⁶ and it bestows every

kind of *siddhi*. They followed the supreme rites indicated by Brahma's son.
⁷⁸⁷ With their minds fixed on *japa* and *dhyana*, they performed Devi's great worship. They immersed their minds in performing these fierce austerities. Ten thousand years and ten days passed.'

'Seeing that Bhandasura was deluded in this way, Bhrigu's immensely intelligent son approached him. The priest said, "O Indra among kings! The excellent *danavas* always seek refuge with you. That is how, as they will, they roam around in the three worlds, without any fear. Hari always kills all those who are born in your species. The *maya* that has deluded you has been fashioned by him. Indra is intent on seeking out a weakness. Seeing that you have been deluded, for the sake of triumphing over you, he is performing great austerities. If Jagaddhatri is pleased, he will be victorious. Along with the ministers, you should cast aside this *maya*. Go to Mount Himalaya and act so as to create impediments for the enemy." Addressed by the *guru* in this way, he abandoned his excellent couch. He summoned his aged ministers and told them what had happened. Hearing what the king said, Shrutavarma thought about it and said, "For sixty thousand years, Shiva has bestowed a kingdom on you. O brave one! The period that has passed is much more than that. The period indicated by Shiva is impossible to counter. Without worshipping him, we are incapable of countering it. Whether it is happiness or unhappiness, it must be enjoyed at the right time." The one known as Bhimakarma said, "The enemy's strength must not be ignored. As long as we can create hindrances in their rites, we will be victorious. O great king! Shiva has granted you the learning that you will take away half of the enemy's strength in a battle. Therefore, you will always triumph." Bhanda, the leader of *danavas*, agreed with these words. He emerged with his soldiers and went to the slopes of the Himalayas.'

'The mother of the universe saw that the *danavas* were intent on creating hindrances in the path of austerities. She created a large and dazzling wall in front that was impossible to cross. On seeing this, the Indra among *danavas* was surprised and asked, "What is this?" Enraged, he shattered it with the extremely powerful *danava* weapon. However, it materialized in front again, and it was impossible for any of the *danavas* to cross it. The

persevering one shattered it with a *vayavya* weapon and roared. As many times as it was reduced to ashes, it repeatedly rose again. On seeing this, the Indra among *daityas* was dejected and left for his city. Seeing Jagaddhattri and seeing the blazing wall, *devas* trembled because of their excessive fear and were freed from their rites. ⁷⁸⁸ Shakra told them, “The Indra among *daityas* came here. All of us together are incapable of defeating him in battle. Even if we flee, there is no other place we can go to. Let us construct a proper and beautiful pit that is one *yojana* in expanse. We will kindle a fire, according to the norms laid down for a great sacrifice. Using *mahamamsa*, ⁷⁸⁹ we Gods will perform a sacrifice to supreme Shakti. We will either become one with the *brahman*, or we will enjoy heaven.” Thus addressed, all the *devas*, with Indra leading the way, sliced off pieces of flesh and offered them as oblations in the proper way. This was done with the use of *mantras*. All the flesh from the hands and the feet was offered as oblations. *Devas* then wished to offer the rest of the body as oblations. At that time, an excellent and supreme mass of energy appeared in front of them. An excellent *chakra* arose in its centre. Mahadevi was in the middle, with a radiance resembling that of the rising sun. She is the one who imparts life to the universe and Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva are in her *atman*. She possessed the ultimate essence of every kind of beauty. She was an ocean of bliss. Her complexion resembled that of a *japa* flower. ⁷⁹⁰ Her garments possessed the hue of a pomegranate flower. She wore every kind of ornament. She was a reservoir of *shringara rasa*. Her sidelong glances were like moonlight, the tips of her eyes tinged with compassion. Her hands held a noose, a goad, a bow made out of sugarcane and five arrows. All the *devas*, along with Vasava, saw Mahadevi. Their minds were delighted, and they repeatedly prostrated themselves before the one who has everything in her *atman*. As soon as she looked at them, they lost all their anxiety. Their limbs became whole again and firmer. They became immensely strong, with bodies as firm as the *vajra*. They praised Mahadevi Ambikaa, who bestows everything desired.’

Chapter 125-2(13) (Lalitaa's praise) ⁷⁹¹

*D*evas said, 'O Devi! Victory to you. O mother of the universe! O greater than the greatest! Victory to you. O reservoir of everything auspicious! Victory to you. O one with the arts of *kama* in your *atman*! Victory to you. O one who brings about victory! O one with the beautiful eyes! O Kamakshi! O beautiful one! Victory to you. O one who triumphs over everything! O one who deserves to be worshipped by the Gods! O Kameshi! O one who bestows honours! Victory to you. O one who is full of the *brahman*! Victory to you. O Devi! O one who absorbs the *brahman* into your *atman*! O Narayani! Victory to you. O supreme one! O abode of every kind of delight! O one loved by Shrikantha! ⁷⁹² Victory to you. O Shri Lalitaa! O Ambikaa! Victory to you. O one who wins over prosperity! Victory to you. O Devi! O one who bestows victory, riches and prosperity! You are the cause behind those who have been born, those who will be born and *ishta* and *purti*. You are the one who preserves the three worlds. I prostrate myself before you. You are greater than the greatest. *Kalaas*, *muhurtas*, *kashthas*, days, months, seasons and years are in your *atman*. I prostrate myself before the one with one thousand heads, one thousand faces and one thousand eyes. I prostrate myself before the one with one thousand hands like lotuses and adorned with one thousand feet that are like lotuses. O Devi! You are smaller than the smallest and larger than the largest. O mother! You are supreme, you are beyond the supreme. You are the most energetic, you are beyond the most energetic. Your feet are Atala, and your knees are Vitala. Rasatala is the region around your waist, the earth is your stomach. Bhuvvarloka is your heart and Svarloka is said to be your face. The sun, the moon and the fire are your eyes. O Ambikaa! The directions are your arms. The wind is your breath. All the *shruti* texts are your speech. In your pastimes, you create the worlds. Your friend is Shiva, who is full of consciousness. Constant bliss is your food. You reside in the hearts of the virtuous. Your forms are in everything visible and invisible. The worlds are your forms. The clouds are the hair on your head, the stars

are your flowers. ⁷⁹³ *Dharma* and the others are your arms, *adharma* constitutes your weapons. *Yamas* and *niyamas* are the nails on your hands and feet. Your breasts are the sounds of *svaha* and *svadha*, which impart life to the worlds. *Pranayama* is your nose and Sarasvati ⁷⁹⁴ is your tongue. Your senses are *pratyahara*. *Dhyana* constitutes your excellent intelligence. The power of *dharana* is your mind and *samadhi* is your heart. The large trees are the hair on your body, dawn is your garment. The past, the present and the future represent your eternal form. Your form is the sacrifice. O Jagaddhatri! Your sanctifying form is the universe. In the beginning, you were full of compassion and created all the *prajas*. You reside in the heart but are invisible to all the worlds. Delusion is in your *atman*. In your own pastimes, you create divisions of names and forms. You preside over everything, but you are not attached to anything. You are the one who bestows *artha* and *kama*. I prostrate myself before Mahadevi. I prostrate myself before the one who is every kind of Shakti. I bow down. The fire, the sun, the moon, and the winds function because of your command. So do earth, and all the other elements. I prostrate myself before that Devi. I bow down. In the beginning, you are the one who created Dhatri. You are the one who bestows creation, prosperity, and everything else. You alone are the one who supports everything. I prostrate myself before that Devi. I bow down. You are the immeasurable one who holds up earth and space. The sun rises in you. I prostrate myself before that Devi. I bow down. Everything in the universe arises because of you, is established in you and obtains support from you, merging into you at the end. I prostrate myself before that Devi. I bow down. I prostrate myself. I bow down before the *rajas* of origin. I prostrate myself. I bow down before the *sattva* of preservation. I prostrate myself. I bow down before the *tamas* of destruction. I prostrate myself. I bow down before Shivaa, who is *nirguna*. I prostrate myself. I bow down before the only mother of the universe. I prostrate myself. I bow down before the only father of the universe. I prostrate myself. I bow down before the one whose form is in every kind of *tantra*. I prostrate myself. I bow down before the one whose form is in every kind of *yantra*. ⁷⁹⁵ I prostrate myself. I bow down before the one who is the supreme *guru* in the worlds. I

prostrate myself. I bow down before the one who is every kind of splendour in speech. I prostrate myself before Lakshmi, the only one who brings satisfaction to the universe. I prostrate myself. I bow down before Shambhavi, ⁷⁹⁶ who possesses every kind of Shakti. You do not have a beginning, a middle, or an end. You are not made out of the five elements. You cannot be reached through words or thoughts. You are beyond debate. You are without form and devoid of the opposite pair of sentiments. You cannot be perceived through sight. Your power is great. O Ambaa! How can you be described? O Vishveshvari! Be pleased. O one worshipped by the universe! Be pleased. O Ishvari of learning! O one whose form is the *Vedas*! O one who is full of *maya*! Be pleased. O one whose form are the *mantras*! O Sarveshvari! O one whose form is everywhere! Be pleased.'

Hayagriva continued, 'In this way, Mahadevi was praised by all the *devas*, along with Vasava. They repeatedly prostrated themselves before her and quickly sought refuge with her. Seeing that Vasava had prostrated himself; Devi was pleased. The one who bestows boons on all living beings asked him to choose a boon. Indra said, "O fortunate one! We are suffering on account of the Indra among *daityas*. It is impossible to remain alive. If you are pleased, grant us the boon that we may come and seek refuge with you." Shri Devi replied, "I will myself defeat Bhanda, who has been born in the lineage of *daityas*. In a short while, I will give back the three worlds, with their mobile and immobile objects, to you. Let all the large number of *devas* be happy and free from fear. Men who devoutly praise me, using this hymn, will always be the recipients of *dharma*, prosperity and fame. They will be full of learning and humility and be free of ailments. They will live for a long time. Through my favours, they will obtain excellent sons, friends and wives." Thus, *devas* and the immensely strong Indra of the *devas* obtained a boon. They glanced at her repeatedly and were filled with great joy.'

Chapter 126-2(14) (Manifestation of Kameshvara)

Hayagriva said, ‘At this time, along with *maharshis*, Brahma, the grandfather of the worlds, arrived there, wishing to see Deveshi. Vishnu arrived, astride Vinataa’s son.⁷⁹⁷ To see the Ishvari of everything, Shiva arrived, astride the bull. Narada and the other *devarshis* arrived to see Maheshvari. All the large numbers of *apsaras* arrived before Mahadevi. There were Vishvavasu and other *gandharvas*, as well as *yakshas*. Commanded by Brahma, the lord of the worlds, Vishvakarma created a divine city there, just like the city of the immortals. Bhagavati Durgaa, the presiding divinity of all *mantras*, and Shyamaa, the presiding divinity of learning, approached Ambikaa. Brahmi and the other *matrikas* arrived, surrounded by their own respective *ganas*. There were *anima* and the other *siddhis* and crores of *yoginis*. There were Bhairavas, Kshetrapalas,⁷⁹⁸ Mahashasta, foremost among *ganas*, Skanda, the great leader of *ganas*, Batuka and Virabhadra. They arrived there, praised Mahadevi and prostrated themselves.”

‘With mansions, ramparts and gates, the city was beautiful. There were excellent stations for elephants, horses and chariots. There were glittering royal roads. There were vassals, advisers, soldiers, *dvijas*, *vetalas*⁷⁹⁹ and male and female servants. There were beautiful houses. There was a divine and royal residence in the centre, decorated with gates and turrets. There were many chambers. The place was decorated with assembly-halls. There was an auspicious throne in the assembly-hall, studded with *navaratnas*.⁸⁰⁰ It was constructed out of *chintamani*.⁸⁰¹ It dazzled and was without parallel, resembling the rising sun. Looking at this, Brahma, the grandfather of the worlds, thought. “Even if a person happens to be foolish, as a result of the city’s powers, if he presides over it, he will become lord of all the worlds. However, a woman alone, without a man, does not deserve to rule over a kingdom. The *shruti* texts say that a great man must be consecrated with auspicious benedictions, provided that he has the auspicious signs. This beautiful lady is radiant. Her form is like that of a divinity of *shringara*.

Other than Shankara, no one in the three worlds deserves to be her groom. He has matted hair and wears a garland of skulls. His eyes are malformed, and he holds a skull. He is speckled, with ashes smearing his limbs. Bones from cremation grounds are his ornaments. His signs are inauspicious. Will this auspicious lady choose him?” While Brahma was thinking this, Maheshvara appeared in front of him. His body was divine, and his beauty was like that of one crore Kandarpas.⁸⁰² He wore garlands, and his garments were divine. He was smeared in divine unguents and pastes. He was ornamented with a diadem, necklace, bracelets and earrings. In a form that charmed the universe, he manifested himself in front. Brahma, the grandfather of the worlds, embraced that youth, who possessed a delightful body and gave him the name of Kameshvara. “This is an appropriate groom for supreme Shakti.” Having decided this, along with him, he went to her. Brahma, Vishnu and Maheshvara praised Para-Shakti. On seeing her, with eyes like that of a fawn, the youth, Nilalohita, was overcome by desire and forgot all his rites. She too looked at his beautiful body. It seemed as if Smara had got back his body.⁸⁰³ All her limbs were filled with desire too and she thought he was worthy of her. They looked at each other, full of love and desire. Those two knew about every kind of sentiment and were spirited and patient. But others cannot fathom their conduct and for an instant, they seemed to lose their senses.’

‘After this, Brahma spoke to Mahadevi, the leader of the worlds. “Along with Isha, your beloved, these *devas*, *rishis*, *gandharvas* and large numbers of *apsaras* wish to see you in the great field of battle. O Devi! Who is worthy of you? Who is your beloved? Who is that blessed man? To protect the worlds, serve the supreme Purusha. Become the queen of the city and be seated on the excellent throne. You will be consecrated by the unblemished and immensely fortunate *devarshis*. Be marked with all the signs of the kingdom, adorned in every kind of ornament. We wish to see you seated on the seat, along with your beloved.”’

Chapter 127-2(15) (Wedding festivities)

Hayagriva continued, ‘On hearing these words, there was a gentle smile on Devi’s lotus face. She addressed Brahma, Vishnu and the other foremost Gods in these words. “O *devas*! I am always independent. I always roam around according to my own wishes. A person whose conduct is similar to mine will be my beloved.” The grandfather and all the *devas* agreed to this. Brahma addressed Mahadevi in words that were in conformity with *dharma* and *artha*. Between a man and a woman, there are four kinds of marriage—*kalakrita*, *krayakrita*, *pitridatta* and *svayamyuta*.⁸⁰⁴ A *kalakrita* bride is a courtesan. A *krayakrita* bride is a *dasi*. A *yukta* bride is one who has been married according to *gandharva* rites. *Bharya* is a bride who has been bestowed by her father. *Yukta* is one who follows the same *dharma* as the groom. *Bharya* follows her father’s commands. The supreme *brahman* has no duality and is devoid of notions of existence and non-existence. It is in the nature of consciousness and bliss and Prakriti originated from it. You are that *brahman* and you are also that Prakriti. You are the one who is without a beginning. You assume the form of cause and effect in everything. Yogis, Sanaka and others seek you out. You are praised as the five forms of the *brahman*—that which is existent, that which is non-existent, that which is in the form of *karma*, that which is manifest and that which is not manifest. Compassion is in your *atman*. In the beginning, you are the one who creates. You are the one who instantly protects. With a desire to show favours to the worlds, serve some Purusha.” Brahma and all the other Gods requested Devi in this way. She picked up a garland in her hand and hurled it up into the sky. The garland she threw up was radiant in the firmament. It fell and hung around Kameshvara’s neck. With Brahma and Vishnu at the forefront, all the *devas* were delighted. Fanned by a gentle wind, the clouds showered down flowers.’

‘Vidhatri spoke to Bhagavan Janardana. “O Hari! The marriage between Shiva and Shivaa must be carried out in the proper way. This *muhurta*,

when the *devas* have arrived, will be auspicious for the entire universe. You and Mahadevi originated together, and her form is similar to your own. Therefore, you should bestow the fortunate one on Kameshvara Shiva.” Trivikrama, the lord of *devas*, heard his words. Following the norms, he happily bestowed her on Shankara. *Devarshis*, foremost ancestors, all the *devas*, *yogis* and the primordial Keshava performed the auspicious rites for the marriage between Shiva and Shivaa. Brahma and all the other Gods gave them gifts. Brahma gave her a bow made from sugarcane. It was imperishable, with an essence that was as firm as the *vajra*. Hari gave her weapons made from flowers. They would not fade and decay. Varuna, lord of aquatic creatures, gave her a noose made from serpents. Vishvakarma, lord of the worlds, gave both goads. Agni gave a crown and the sun, and the moon gave earrings. Ratnakara⁸⁰⁵ himself gave her ornaments studded with *navaratnas*. The lord of liquor gave her a vessel stocked with an inexhaustible supply of liquor. Kubera gave her a garland made from *chintamani* jewels. Lakshmi’s husband gave an umbrella, indicative of the empire. Ganga and Yamuna gave the two of them two whisks that were as brilliant as the moon. Content, the eight Vasus, the Rudras, the Adityas, the two Ashvins, the guardians of the directions, the Maruts, the *sadhyas*, *gandharvas* and the lords of *pramathas* gave them their own respective weapons, chariots, horses, elephants that were immensely strong and immensely swift, camels free of ailments and horses that did not suffer from hunger and thirst. They gave them weapons as firm as the *vajra* and other equipment. In this way, Shiva and Shivaa were instated in that kingdom. Vidhatri constructed a *vimana* named Kusumakara. It was always full of garlands that did not decay, and weapons could not penetrate it. Full of great prosperity, as it wished, it could travel on earth, in the firmament and in heaven. As soon as one inhaled its fragrances, confusion, disease, hunger and afflictions were instantly destroyed. It was auspicious and brought delight to the mind. The divine couple was seated in that *vimana*, which was full of charming whisks, fans, umbrellas and staffs. There were the sounds of many kinds of musical instruments—*veenas*, flutes, drums and trumpets. Served by large numbers of Gods, she emerged from the king’s

palace. Wishing to sport, she advanced along the road, illuminating everything with her own energy. Thousands of *apsaras* stationed themselves on the terraces of all the mansions. Women residents of the city showered down parched grain and *akshata* ⁸⁰⁶ from their hands. Auspicious songs were sung. There were the sounds of *veenas*, flutes and musical instruments. As she gradually travelled along the roads, these satisfied her. She got down from the *vimana* and accepting the *nirajana* ⁸⁰⁷ worship performed by *apsaras*, entered the large assembly hall.'

'Along with the divinity Shambhu, she was seated on the throne. Since she was omniscient, she knew whatever the great people assembled there wished for. Through a glance of her eyes, she satisfied those desires. On witnessing Devi's conduct, Brahma, the grandfather of the worlds, gave her the names of Kamakshi and Kameshvari. ⁸⁰⁸ Following her command, a wonderful cloud showered down extremely expensive objects and other divine ornaments. To ensure Devi's victory, every house in the city had a *chintamani*, a *kalpavriksha*, Kamalaa and a *kamadhenu*. ⁸⁰⁹ Those who served her in that form were freed from rites and *gunas*. They obtained every kind of *kama* and *artha* and rejoiced for all time to come. The grandfather, Hari, Mahadeva, Vasava, other lords of the directions, all the large number of *devas*, Narada and other *devarshis*, Sanaka and other *yogis*, *maharshis*, Manu and others, Vasishtha and other stores of austerities, *gandharvas*, *apsaras*, *yakshas*, others belonging to divine species, heaven, earth and the firmament resided there, without any obstacles. Without any impediments, all of them resided in that city. Devi was affectionate towards them and leaving these people, did not go anywhere else. With a great deal of affection, she satisfied them greatly. She was a great queen on earth. She was learned and bestowed everything wished for. For all those who lived on earth, the queen milked for them everything wished for. Along with Ambikaa, Kameshvara ruled as the king of the three worlds for ten thousand years and the period passed like an instant.'

'On one occasion, the illustrious *rishi*, Narada, arrived there. He prostrated himself before supreme Shakti and spoke humbly. "You are the supreme *brahman*. You are the supreme refuge. You are the sacred

Parameshvari. Existence, non-existence, resolution, alternatives, cause and effect are in your *atman*. You have arrived in this manifest form for the upliftment of the universe. You wish to destroy the wicked and ensure the rise of the virtuous. O auspicious one! Your inclinations are to protect the virtuous. O Devi! This Bhandasura is causing impediments for the three worlds. You alone can defeat him. No other God is capable. These *devas* have resided here for a long time, intent on serving you. Following your instructions, they will leave for their own cities. There were parts that were inauspicious and empty. May those truly become prosperous and wealthy.” Narada said this to Devi, who is the Ishvari of everything. She sent the immortal away to their own respective abodes. Honouring them, as they deserved, Ambikaa sent away Brahma, Hari, Shambhu, Vasava and the other lords of the directions. Though they were sent away, the Gods thought that abandoning her would be a crime. In their respective portions, they continued to serve Shiva and Shivaa, the primordial parents. This account bestows a long lifespan and is the cause of everything auspicious. It is about Mahadevi’s appearance and her being instated in the kingdom. If a person gets up in the morning and full of devotion and faith, performs *japa* with it, he becomes prosperous and wealthy. His speech becomes like a flow of nectar. That intelligent person does not suffer from anything inauspicious, in this world or in the next one. Among those who are equals, and even among those who are superiors, he obtains extensive fame. Shri does not move from him and at every step, he obtains what is beneficial. He never suffers from fear and becomes energetic and brave. He is devoid of the three kinds of torment and is filled with the *purusharthas*. At the time of the three *sandhyas*, every day, if a person performs *japa* with this and meditates on Ishvari on her throne, he obtains Lakshmi within a period of six months and becomes supreme among those who perform *japa*.’

Chapter 128-2(16) (Victory march with the soldiers)

Hayagriva continued, ‘The mother of the universe, Lalitaa Parameshvari, emerged, to defeat the *daitya* Bhandas, the thorn of the three worlds. Heaps of water from the seven oceans were gathered together in the form of a *mardala*.⁸¹⁰ The sky filled with the repeated sound from the *mardala*. There were different kinds of drums—*mridanga*, *muraja*, *pataha*, *atukus*, *selukas* and *linganas*.⁸¹¹ There were other drums—*jhallaris*, *randhas*, *hudukas*, *hundukas* and *ghatas*. There were different types of other musical instruments—*anakas*, *panavas*, *gomukhas*, *arddhachandrikas*, *yavamadhyas*, *mushtimadhyas*, *mardalas*, *dindimas*, *jharjharas*, *baritas*, different types of *ingyas* and *lingyas*, *uddhakas*, *etuhundas*, *nihsanas*, *barbaras*, *humkaras* and *kakatundas*.⁸¹² As arrangements were made for battle, Shakti’s soldiers sounded these. From Lalitaa Parameshi’s goad, a *devi* named Sampatkari arose, and she marched with the Shaktis. Sampadishvari⁸¹³ was as red as the rising sun and she was served by many crores of elephants, horses, chariots, arranged in arrays. She was astride an intoxicated elephant named Ranakolahala. It was fierce and crazy and loved to fight, resembling a mountain. A large army followed her, roaring in terrible voices. The fluttering garlands of flags seemed to etch out marks in the clouds. There was also the divinity named Sampannatha, her movements seemingly impeded by her heavy breasts. There was a radiant and thick breastplate over her breasts. She held a shining and flickering sword in her hand. It was crooked and terrible, resembling the furrowed eyebrows of the God of death. Excellent elephants, numbering crores, followed her at the rear. They resembled mountains rendered mobile by gusty winds. The divinity Atitvaritavikranti originated from Shri Lalitaa Devi’s beautiful weapon, the noose. She moved astride a horse. An army followed her in waves, mostly consisting of neighing horses. As they moved, their hooves dug up the surface of the ground. The horses were of many types—from Vanayu, from Kamboja, from Parada, from the region of Sindhu, from Tankana, from mountainous regions, Parasikas, from

Ghattadhara, from Darada, from Kalavandi, from Valmika, from the Yavana region and from the land of the *gandharvas*. There were some from the eastern regions, from the country of Kiratas and from the frontiers. They were obedient and trained, bearing the riders properly. They were swift and steady of heart. They specifically knew what their masters wanted and could tolerate large battles. They possessed many auspicious signs and had conquered anger and exhaustion. They were properly trained in the five kinds of movements. ⁸¹⁴ They were obedient and could jump. They possessed auspicious marks—lines indicating success, white lines, a divine lotus, a divine jewel, divine *svastika*, the mark of any *svastika*, humps and smooth necks. ⁸¹⁵ These auspicious signs indicated victory and obtaining a kingdom. These horses advanced, bearing the rider with the speed of the wind.’

‘Mahadevi advanced astride a horse named Aparajita, which was extremely energetic. With a dazzling bridle in its mouth, it moved along an extremely lofty path. Clusters of shining manes descended along both the sides. It shook its thick and bushy tail and scattered the clouds. There was bejewelled armour along the flanks and bells tinkled on the legs. As it fiercely struck on the ground with its hooves, it was as if musical instruments were sounded. The earth was like a large musical instrument, being sounded for the sake of victory. It neighed and repeatedly exhibited many kinds of gait. When the whisks on either side were tossed around, it seemed to possess wings. The harnesses were beautiful, ornamented with nets of bells. The sounds made by these seemed to emit a *humkara* ⁸¹⁶ sound against the *asuras*. She advanced on this horse. In her four hands, she held a noose, a goad, a cane and the reins of the horse, radiant in her many acts of valour. She resembled the rising sun, with rays being spread by her shining girdle. As she moved astride the horse, the horse seemed to dance. As they emerged, Shridandanathaa ⁸¹⁷ caused drums to be sounded. The sound was like that of the turbulent ocean and deafened the universe. Some Shaktis arose, their arms as firm as rocks. With firm arrows as hard as the *vajra*, they pierced the ten directions. Some marshalled Shridandanathaa’s troops who were at the rear. Using swords and shields, these fierce Shaktis leapt

around. So that the soldiers did not obstruct each other, they struck them hundreds of times with canes. Restraining them with canes, those Shaktis moved around. The Shaktis who were in front brandished shining standards and flags marked with horses, buffaloes, deer and lions. Thousands held aloft Shridandanathaa's white umbrella. As the Shaktis moved, these flashed.'

Chapter 129-2(17) (Advance of Dandanathaa and Shyamalaa)

Hayagriva continued, 'As Dandanathaa emerged, there were innumerable white umbrellas in the sky, resembling innumerable moons. As these white umbrellas rubbed against each other, there was darkness between them. But this was dispelled because of the many jewels fixed to the handles of the umbrellas. As Krodamukhi's forces advanced, there were hundreds of fans made from palm leaves and the sheen of diamonds embedded on the handles dispelled the shade in all the directions. Chanda, Danda and other fierce Bhairavas held tridents in their hands. Their mass of tawny hair blazed, illuminating the directions like flashes of lightning. The flames from their sharp arrows seemed to burn down the hordes of *daityas*. As Dandanathaa marched, her soldiers advanced. Devi was Potrimukhi and their forms and ornaments were similar to hers. Their weapons were similar to hers. Their respective mounts were similar to hers. From between their sharp fangs, flames and smoke emerged, covering the sky. Their forms were as dark as *tamala* trees. Their eyes were tawny and cruel. They advanced astride thousands of buffaloes, with faces like boars. Shri Dandanathaa descended from the excellent chariot drawn by elephants. She got onto her own mount, the large lion. It was known as Vajraghosha ⁸¹⁸ and it shook its circular mane. It was hideous in form and its mouth gaped. It looked at everything with its tawny eyes. It gnashed its fangs and deafened the directions. Its nails were as hard as the shell of the primordial tortoise ⁸¹⁹ and it seemed to drink up the earth's circle, all the way up to the sky, and drive it down to Patala. It was three *yojanas* tall and it swiftly moved its tail

from one side to another. Dandanayikaa⁸²⁰ advanced astride her mount, the lion. She blazed in rage, as she engaged in the task of destroying *asuras*. The three worlds, with their mobile and immobile entities, were filled with great anxiety. Large numbers of those who resided in heaven came and assembled in the sky. They arrived to see her, but because of their fright, remained in their *vimanas*, some distance away. They exclaimed, “In her rage, will Potrini destroy the universe now? With a blow from her club, will she split the earth into two? With blows from her plough, will she agitate the oceans?” Joining their hands in salutation, *devas* worshipped her. Stationed in the firmament, they repeatedly chanted her twelve names.’

Agastya asked, ‘O lord! What are Devi’s twelve names? Please tell me. O one with a face like a horse! O immensely wise one! I have great curiosity about this.’

Hayagriva answered, ‘O one born from a pot! Listen to Devi’s twelve names. As soon as she hears these names, she is pleased. They are Panchami, Dandanathaa, Samketaa, Samayeshvari, Samayasamketa, Varahi, Potrini, Vartali, Mahasenaa, Ajnaa, Chakreshvari and Arighni. O sage! I have thus described the twelve names. If a human remains inside the cage, as firm as the *vajra*, determined by these twelve names, he never suffers from grief because of a calamity. Stationed in the firmament, they used these names to praise Samketaa several times. To show them favours, she continued to advance. After this, Samketaa *yogini* touched the feet of Mantranathaa.⁸²¹ This signified the advance and trumpets were sounded in the firmament. The forces of all the Shaktis emerged. Generally, their ornaments expressed *shringara*. Their complexions were as dark as tigers. There were *veenas* in their hands. Some danced. Others sang, with tones like those of maddened cuckoos. They played on *veenas*, flutes, drums and other musical instruments. Their strides were enchanting. Delighting all the people in the universe, these dark Shaktis advanced. Some were mounted on peacocks. Others had swans as mounts. Some were astride mongooses; others were seated on cuckoos. All of them were dark in form and some were seated in palanquins. Some were astride horses from the Sindhu region and were intoxicated because of the honey from *kadamba* flowers.⁸²²

They advanced, placing Mantranathaa in front. Mantranayikaa was dark in complexion, like a dark cloud. She advanced on a gigantic chariot, with a lofty chariot and wheels. Her armour had the hue of the rising sun. Her eyes rolled in intoxication. There were slight beads of sweat on her face, which was like a lotus. As she cast sidelong glances, her eyebrows seemed to dance. Among that entire army of Shaktis, a triangular umbrella made out of peacock feathers was held aloft her head, proclaiming her greatness. Among all the other Shaktis, there was no one who was as resplendent as her. Those who resided in the vault of heaven used sixteen names to praise her. O one born from a pot! Listen to these sixteen names. They are Sangitayogini, Shyamaa, Shyamalaa, Mantranayikaa, Mantrini, Sachiveshi, Pradhaneshi, Shukapriyaa, Vinavati, Vainiki, Mudrini, Priyakapriyaa, Nipapriyaa, Kadambeshi, Kadamba-vana-vasini and Sadamadaa. O one born from the pot! These are the sixteen names. If any embodied creature uses these names to praise Sachiveshi even once, there is no doubt that everything in the three worlds will be in the grasp of his hands. Wherever Mantranathaa casts her glances, there is no doubt that enemy soldiers fall there. As long as there is a discussion about Lalitaa Parameshi and her kingdom and as long as there is a discussion about the Shaktis, there will be victory everywhere. There was a young parrot in Sangitayogini's hand. *Dhanurveda* emerged from this, along with a bow that had already been strung. The brave one ⁸²³ possessed four arms. He possessed three heads and three eyes. He prostrated himself before Pradhaneshi and devoutly addressed her in these words. "O Devi! You have prepared yourself for the battle against Bhandasura. O Mantranayikaa! Therefore, it is my duty to assist you. This excellent and large bow is named Chitrajiva. O mother of the universe! For destroying the *danavas*, please accept it. These two inexhaustible quivers are embellished with gold. To show me a favour and to destroy the *daityas*, please accept it." Thus, *Dhanurveda* devoutly lowered his head and prostrated himself. He offered the bow and quivers, which were duly accepted by Priyakapriyaa. Shukapriyaa accepted the giant bow, Chitrajiva. She repeatedly twanged the bow and the sound filled up the earth. The sound of Sangitayogini twanging the bow filled up the entire

universe. The minds of those who resided in heaven were filled with a wealth of bliss. She had two attendants, known as Yantrini and Tantrini. Holding the parrot and the *veena*, they immediately attended to her. Ghanashyamaa ⁸²⁴ held that beautiful bow and as she twanged it, the sound enhanced the sound from the tinkling of her bangles. Gitayogini ⁸²⁵ embellished the bow, Chitrajiva. The umbrella was made out of *kadamba* flowers, and the beautiful bow was like a *kadamba* tree. An arrow, with a head made out of stone, blazed in her right hand. It was as fierce as Kali's glance, and it was as dreadful as a dancing serpent. She was astride a chariot, with wheels that deserve to be sung about. She was served from the rear by excellent Devis who were as dark as her, holding bows and arrows. There were one thousand *akshouhinis*, intoxicated and extremely forceful. They filled the directions with their chattering, roars and tumultuous sounds.'

Chapter 130-2(18) (Lalitaa Parameshvari's victory march)

Hayagriva continued, 'To do battle, Lalitaa advanced. Rajanayikaa aided her, with a blazing goad in her hand. She also held a noose, which resembled a serpent. She held a bow made from sugarcane and five arrows made out of flowers. The bangles tinkled on her hands. A shower of extremely red radiance spread from her body, as if one thousand suns had suddenly arisen. The radiance from her face spread in all the directions and it seemed as if she had filled up the sky with moons. The white umbrella held aloft her was more than ten *yojans* in expanse. It was studded with pure pearls and its radiance penetrated the three worlds. It seemed as if it was a friend of the lunar disc. She was served by attendants, Vijaya being the foremost, who fanned her with four whisks rendered beautiful with jewels and gems. It was as if fresh moonbeams were spreading over four green plantain trees. The javelin in her hand indicated her status as empress of the empire. Her soldiers were marked with hundreds of other marks of royal insignia. The immortals praised her prosperity and pervasive radiance

with compositions sung and played through musical instruments. The prosperity and pride of her kingdom, along with the circle of Shaktis, filled up the inner recesses of the three worlds. It could not be grasped through words. Nor could it be grasped through intelligence. Using any comparisons, it was impossible to describe it. She showered down sidelong favourable glances towards the faces of the excellent Gods, Brahma, Isha, Vishnu and Vrisha ⁸²⁶ being the chief. They devoutly joined their hands in salutation and raised them above their heads, each proclaiming, “I will serve her first.” Radiance arose from the five flowers, her arrows, and suddenly filled up the three worlds with illumination. Large numbers of *apsaras*, with a resplendence like that of flashes of lightning, showered down parched grain, pronouncing benedictions for her victory. Kameshvari and other beautiful ladies served her. They were attired in extremely charming garments, ready to do battle. Their blazing weapons seemed to challenge the sun. They constantly served at her feet. To perform acts in battle, she was mounted on a supreme chariot named Shrichakra. As it moved, the force of one fierce roar merged into another. Tawny in complexion, she was attired in a charming and sparkling garment, which enhanced her beauty. As she advanced in the direction of the battle, Lalitaa was praised by the accomplished Maruts, who used twenty-five names that were like jewels in pacifying the miseries of *prapancha*.’

Agastya said, ‘O one with a face like a horse! O immensely intelligent one! Please tell me about Lalitaa Parameshi’s twenty-five names, which are like medication to the ears.’

Hayagriva answered, ‘They are (1) Simhasanaa, (2) Shri Lalitaa, (3) Maharajni, (4) Parankushaa, (5) Chapini, (6) Tripuraa, (7) Maha-Tripurasundari, (8) Sundari, (9) Chakranathaa, (10) Samrajni, (11) Chakrini, (12) Chakreshvari, (13) Mahadevi, (14) Kameshi, (15) Parameshvari, (16) Kamarajapriyaa, (17) Kamakotigaa, (18) Chakravartini, (19) Mahavidyaa, (20) Shivananga-vallabhaa, (21) Sarvapatalaa, (22) Kulanathaa, (23) Amnayanathaa, (24) Sarvamnaya-nivasini and (25) Shringara-nayikaa. ⁸²⁷ These are the twenty-five names. If a person uses these to praise the immensely fortunate Lalitaa Parameshvari, he obtains the eight types of

siddhi and great fame. In this way, full of intolerable force, she made the large army advance. Lalitaa Ambikaa marched, angry at Bhandasura.'

Chapter 131-2(19) (Chakraraja and divinities on chariots)

Agastya asked, 'There were divinities who manifested themselves and stationed themselves on the joints of Chakraraja, ⁸²⁸ Indra among chariots. What were they known as? Please tell me their names. What were their numbers? What were all the divisions between them and their complexions? What were the beautiful and divine weapons? O one with the face of a horse! Please tell me.'

Hayagriva answered, 'There were said to be ten Siddhidevis stationed on the ninth layer of the blazing chariot. Hear their names. They were Animaa, Mahimaa, Laghimaa, Garimaa, Ishitaa, Vashitaa, Prapti-Siddhi as the seventh, Prakamya-Siddhi, Mukti-Siddhi and the one known as Sarvakamaa as the last. These Devis possessed four arms and their complexion was like that of the *japa* flower. They held *chintamani*, a skull, a trident and the collyrium of *siddhi*. They were full of compassion and *yogis* served them. In the front half, there were eight Shaktis, Brahmi and others. They were Brahmi, Maheshvari, Koumari, Vaishnavi, Varahi, Mahendri, Chamundaa as the seventh and Mahalakshmi as the eighth. They were red in complexion and possessed two arms. They held a lotus and a skull and were radiant in their red garments. Alternatively, others speak of other methods of *dhyana*. ⁸²⁹ Their forms are like Brahma and the others. Their weapons are like Brahma and the others. Their supreme signs are like Brahma and the others. It is said that *dharana* must be performed according to this. Mudradevis were greater and were stationed above their heads. With hands as beautiful as lotuses, they were engaged in displaying *mudras*. Their complexion was like a pomegranate flower. Their yellow garments were charming. They possessed four arms. Two of these held a sword and a shield. Their rolling eyes were red with intoxication. Hear their names. They were Sarva-samkshobhini, Sarva-vidravini, Sarvakarshana-

krinmudraa, Sarva-vashankari, Sarvonmadana-mudra, the staff of Sarva-mahankusha, Sarva-khecharikaa *mudra*, Sarva-bijaa as the next, Sarva-yoni as the ninth and Sarva-trikhandikaa. Siddhis, Brahmis and Mudras—these were Shaktis who were manifest. To destroy Bhandasura, they were stationed on the red chariot. There were some who have been mentioned earlier as Gupta Shaktis.⁸³⁰ Hear their names. They were Kama-karshanikaa, Buddhya-karshanikaa Kalaa, Ahamkara-karshini, Shabda-karshini Kalaa, Sparsha-Karshanikaa Nityaa, Rupa-Karshanikaa Kalaa, Rasa-Karshanika Nityaa, Gandha-Karshanikaa Kalaa, Chitta-Karshanikaa Nityaa, Dhairya-Karshanikaa Kalaa, Smritya-Karshanikaa Nityaa, Nama-Karshanikaa Kalaa, Bija-Karshanikaa Nityaa, Atma-Karshanikaa Kalaa, Amrita-Karshini Nityaa and Sharira-Karshini Kalaa. These were the sixteen Shaktis, in the form of the digits of the one with the cool beams. This completes the eighth layer, and they are described under the appellation of Gupta. They were charming and smiled gently, resembling coral trees. They possessed four arms and three eyes. They possessed shining crowns, resembling the sun and the moon. They held bows and arrows, swords and shields. Their beauty was divine. O one born from a pot! They embarked on the destruction of Bhandasura. Those known as Guptataraas were stationed on the seventh layer of the chariot known as Chakraratha,⁸³¹ which resembled a radiant lamp in the evening. They were Ananga-Madanaa, Ananga-Madanaturaa, Ananga-Lekhaa, Ananga-Vegaa, Ananga-Ankusha and Ananga-Alingyaa as the next one. These Devis resembled a *japa* flower. Their bows were made out of sugarcane and their arrows out of flowers. They held clusters of flowers and lotuses. They were radiant and extremely brave, following Lalitaa's commands. They were established there, blazing against Bhandasura. Those known as the Sampradayaas, with Sarva-Samkshobhini as the foremost, were stationed on the sixth layer of the excellent chariot, Chakraratha. Their shining hair was in braids and there was a dazzling *tilaka* mark of *sindura* on the forehead. They were exceedingly fierce in nature, possessing a virulence like that of the fire of destruction. The arrows were made from fire. The bows were made from fire. The swords were made out of fire. Blazing in form, they held shields

known as Vahnichakras. Arising from the ashes of Kama, they were enraged at the Indra among *asuras*. These immensely energetic Shaktis followed Lalitaa's commands. They were Sarva-Samkshobhini, Sarva-Vidravini, Sarva-Karshanikaa Shakti, Sarva-Hladinikaa, Sarva-Sammohini Shakti, Sarva-Stambhanaa Shakti, Sarva-Jrimbhanaa Shakti, Sarva-Unmadanaa Shakti, Sarvartha-Sadhikaa Shakti, Sarva-Sampattipurani, Sarva-Mantramayi Shakti and Sarva-Dvanda-Kshayankari. I have told you the names of the Sampradayaas. Those stationed on the fifth layer are described as Kulottirnaas. They resembled crystals. Blazing in form, they held a battleaxe, a noose, a mace, a bell and a jewel. As a result of the rage against the enemy of *devas*, their foreheads were furrowed. O one born from a pot! Hear their names. They were Sarva-Siddhipradaa Devi, Sarva-Sampatpradaa, Sarva-Priyankari Devi, Sarva-Mangalakarini, Sarva-Kamapradaa Devi, Sarva-Duhkhavimochini, Sarva-Mrityuprashamini, Sarva-Vighnanivarini, Sarvanga-Sundari Devi and Sarva-Soubhagyadayini. These ten Devis are described as those whose hearts were full of compassion. Ten famous ones, described under the names of Nirbhaya-Yoginis, were stationed on the fourth layer and they resembled necklaces made of pearls. They were Sarvajnaa, Sarvashakti, Sarvaisharya-Pradaa, Sarva-Jnanamayi Devi, Sarva-Vyadhivinashini, Sarvadhara-Svarupaa, Sarva-Papaharaa, Sarvanandamayi Devi and Sarva-Rakshasvarupini. The tenth Devi was known as Sarveysita-Phalapradaa. It should be known that all of them possessed four arms. They held a *vajra*, a javelin, a club and a *chakra*. They dazzled and got ready to kill Bhandasura. Those stationed on the third layer of the excellent chariot, Chakraratha, were named Rahasya-Yoginis. They were famous as those who presided over speech and intelligence. Their complexion was like that of red *ashoka* flowers, and they held bows and arrows in their hands. All their limbs were covered in armour, and they were also adorned with *veenas* and books. They were Vashini, Kameshi, Bhogini, Vimalaa, Arunaa, Javini, Sarveshi and Koulini. These eight are described as Devis responsible for the destruction of *daityas*. There were three, established on three seats on the second layer of the excellent chariot, Chakraratha. They possessed eight arms and held

bows, arrows, a drinking vessel, a *matulunga*,⁸³² a sword, a shield, a noose made of serpents and a bell that made a loud noise. They were radiant and intoxicated and guarded mysteries and secrets. They were Kameshi, Vajreshi and Bhagamalini. These three Devis are said to have been full of rage towards Bhandasura. Their greatness was like that of Lalitaa. Their energy was like that of Lalitaa. These are always described as great confidants of Shri Devi. In the central layer of the chariot, there was a great seat of bliss. There are said to be fifteen imperishable ones who set up abodes all around this. They were Tithinityaas⁸³³ and their forms were that of time. They were established there, pervading the universe. Their foreheads were furrowed, and they were agitated against Bhandasura and other *daityas*. Their forms were like that of Devi. Their weapons were like that of Devi. For the welfare of the worlds, they exist from one *yuga* to another *yuga*. O one born from the pot! Understand their names from me. They were Kameshi, Bhagamalaa, Nityaklinnaa, Bherundaa, Vahnivasini, Mahavrajeshvari, Duti, Tvaritaa Devi, Kulasundari as the ninth, Nityaa, Nilapatakaa, Vijayaa, Sarvamangalaa, Jvalamalinikaa and Chitraa. Thus, the fifteen names have been described. Along with these, who were always intent on rendering service, Devi Parameshvari emerged to defeat the wicked Bhandasura.'

'Mantrinathaa's⁸³⁴ excellent chariot had large wheels and was known as Gitichakra. It is said to have possessed seven layers. Hear about the Devis who were there. In the centre of the chariot known as Geyachakra,⁸³⁵ Sangitayogini is said to have set up her seat and residence. She was extremely loved by Shri Devi. Mantrini resided on the first layer. Rati, Priti and Manojaa were on the second layer of the excellent chariot, Geyachakra. They held *veenas* and bows in their hands. Their forms were as dark as the *tamala* tree, and they were capable of uprooting *danavas*. The divinities associated with the arrows of the God of love were astride the third layer. They were Dravini, Shoshini, Bandhini, Mohini and Unmadini. They held blazing bows in their hands. Also on that layer, there were five immensely energetic Gods. They were Kamaraja, Kandarpa, Manmatha, Makaradhvaja and Manobhava as the fifth. They were capable of charming the three worlds. Marked with *tilakas* of musk on their foreheads, they dazzled. Their

limbs were covered with armour and their complexion was like that of a *palasha* flower. ⁸³⁶ These are known as the five Kamas, and they sought to slay Bhandasura. In the fourth layer of the excellent chariot, Geyachakra, Brahmi was the first and foremost, while Chandikaa was the eighth. The others on that layer were the Shaktis—Lakshmi, Sarasvati, Rati, Priti, Kirti, Shanti, Pushti and Tushti. To kill the extremely strong *daitya*, their eyes were red with rage. O one born from the pot! They held lances and *chakras*, and they are described as Kumaris. On the fifth layer of that excellent chariot, Gitichakra, there were sixteen, Vamaa and others. Hear about their names from me. They were Vamaa, Jyeshthaa, Roudri, Shanti, Shraddhaa, Sarasvati, Shribhu Shakti, Lakshmi, Srishti, Mohini, Pramathini, Ashvasini, Vichi, Vidyunmalini, Suranandaa and Nagabuddhikaa. Their complexion resembled red amaranth and they were eager to agitate the universe. At every stage, they prepared for the great battle. They were armoured and held *vajras*, shining swords, staffs that were like *vajras*, *shataghnis* and shining *bhushundis*. ⁸³⁷ With terrible weapons, Asitanga and other Bhairavas were on the sixth layer of that excellent chariot, Gitichakra. They held tridents and drinking vessels. They were resplendent, blue in complexion. They were Asitanga, Ruru, Chanda, Krodha, Unmatta Bhairava, Kapali, Bhishana and Samhara. These were the eight Bhairavas. On the seventh layer of that excellent chariot, Gitichakra, there were Matangi, Siddhalakshmi, Mahamatangikaa and Mahati. They were red in complexion and held bows and arrows. On that same layer, there were the leaders of *ganas*—Kshetrapa, Durgamba and Batuka. They held weapons in their hands. Lakshmi, Sarasvati and the *nidhis* Shankha and Padma were also on that layer. ⁸³⁸ All of them held weapons in their hands. Terrible in valour, they were angry at Bhandasura, who hated the world. Also on that layer, but slightly below, were the leaders of the ten directions, Shakra and the others, ending with Vishnu. They were in the form of Shaktis. Each held a *vajra*, a spear, Kala's staff, a noose, a standard, a mace, a trident, a blade of *darbha* grass as a weapon and a *chakra*. ⁸³⁹ Full of devotion, all of them constantly served Mantrinathaa. They wished to slay Bhandasura's followers, who were thorns to the universe. They sought refuge with Mantrinathaa and

were eager to follow Lalitaa's commands. The leaders of the directions sought refuge with the chariot Gitichakra. All these found a means in Mantrini, to submit to Mahadevi the requests of *devas* about accomplishing the task. To convey a message to the queen, one seeks the help of the foremost gatekeeper. Indeed, that is the way those who serve obtain the subsequent fruits. Otherwise, who was capable of approaching the one who was blazing in energy? Shridevi's power was such that no one could directly approach her. But Shridevi loved her a lot, because of her learning about singing and music. In accomplishing a task, she would never ignore a request submitted to her. In Shridevi's empire, Mantrini possesses the strength to accomplish all tasks. She could speak to her about doing something, and also speak about not doing something. All the guardians of the worlds desired Shridevi's victory. Therefore, they served her foremost attendant. Shri Lalitaa Devi's chariot, Chakraratha, was excellent. All the Devis established in different layers have been mentioned. Her divine weapons, to be used for Bhandasura's destruction, have also been mentioned. The Devis on different layers of Geyachakra have also been described. If men hear the names of all these Devis, they are freed from all sins and are victorious.'

Chapter 132-2(20) (Divinities on Kirichakraratha)

Hayagriva said, ‘Kirichakraratha ⁸⁴⁰ was a king among chariots and it possessed five layers. O wise one! Listen to the names of the divinities. If one hears them, there is victory. Dandanayikaa was stationed on the first layer, known as Bindu. She is the one who destroys the insolent thorns in the universe. Blazing amidst many kinds of fires, she made the glory of victory dance. With blows from her raised snout, she mangles and kills *danavas*. She resembled the night, with her curved tusks like the crescent moon. Her body was delicate, as blue as a mass of dark clouds during the monsoon. She was a constant adornment of Kirichakra, king of chariots. She was Potrini, a mother to all the revolving worlds, having adopted everyone as her children.’

‘There were three in the second layer of the chariot’s centre—Jrimbhini, Mohini and Stambhini. All of them resembled blossoming pomegranate flowers and they were ones who crushed *danavas*. In their hands, which blazed with bangles that dazzled with rubies, they held a pestle, a plough and a vessel for liquor, studded with several precious jewels. Their eyes were extremely piercing and cruel, as if to burn down *daitya* soldiers with their blaze. Without any hesitation, they served the one with a face like a boar.’

‘Five Devis, Andhini and others, were established in the third layer of Kirichakra, Indra among chariots. They formed the base for Devi’s *yantra*. Their loud laughter was harsh and shattered the three worlds. Though their garb was that of women, they blazed like the fire that comes at the end of a *kalpa*. With their flickering and shining tongues, they wished to lick the blood that flowed from all Bhandasura’s soldiers. They constantly served Dandanathaa, terrible in valour.’

‘They were six Devis in the fourth layer of Kirichakra, king of chariots. These were Brahmi and others, excluding the fifth and the eighth. ⁸⁴¹ Fiery in form, these six formed a blazing circle. ⁸⁴² Their force of valour was

great, and they seemed to drink up *danavas*. Following the instructions of Dandanathaa, they based themselves in that region. In that layer, but below, there were seven divinities known as Dhatunathaas. They were terrible and fierce in valour. They were Yakshini, Shankhini, Lakini, Hakini, Shakini, Dakini and Hakini, though they were all united in one single form. They seemed to drink up beings. They seemed to drink up the earth. Hideous in form, they drank up the *dhatus* in the body—skin, blood, flesh, fat, bones, marrow and semen.⁸⁴³ They were cruel. They filled the ten directions with their roars, which were like those of lions. They were the ones who bestowed *siddhis*, *anima* and others. They were accomplished in deluding, killing, stupefying, striking, devouring, uprooting wicked *daityas* and destroying them. They destroyed all calamities faced by the faithful. They are described as Dhatunathaas and they are present in all the *dhatus*. In half an instant, they were capable of drinking up garlands of waves from the seven oceans, which seemed to kiss the sky. They were full of great bravery. Their teeth were like carts and their eyes were horrible. All of them were equally capable of devouring those who harmed their mistress, those who violated ordinances, those who opposed the *Vedas*, those who were enemies of the brave and wicked *daityas* who acted against sacrifices. They constantly served Potrini Dandanayikaa. There was a second divine temple to the side of that same layer. The two Devis known as Krodhini and Stambhini were there. The bangles on their creeper-like hands moved, as they fanned with whisks. They were greatly intoxicated, having drunk liquor and the blood from the armies of those who were enemies of *devas*. Their eyes rolled around incessantly, and their faces were always full of laughter. A plough and a pestle assumed the form of excellent weapons and in the form of divinities, resided along the two sides of Kirichakra, king of chariots. Instead of crowns on their respective heads, they held the embodied forms of their respective weapons. The Gods remember and describe them as the destroyers of those who oppose the universe. Using these two weapons, in the battle, Lalitaa Dandanayikaa would slice down the *danava* named Vishanga. In that same layer and in front of Dandanathaa, there was the extremely terrible lion, the sound of whose roar

shattered the firmament. As it gnashed its teeth, the sound deafened the directions. It was known as Chandochanda. It possessed four paws and three eyes. Its form blazed and it held a trident, a sword, a *preta* and a noose. It constantly glanced towards Devi Potrini and served her.'

'In the sixth layer of Kirichakra, king of chariots, there were eight Devis, Vartali and others, who were famous in the eight directions. ⁸⁴⁴ The sound of their terrible roars was like that of eight mountains clashing against each other. Eight serpents functioned as their glittering ornaments. Their strength and energy were inexhaustible. Using their mighty arms, they had offered oblations of crores of *danavas*. Day and night, they served Devi Lalitaa Dandanathaa. Their names are famous. O one who originated from a pot! Listen to their names. They were Vartali, Varahi, Varahamukhi, Andhini, Rodhini, Jrimbhini, Mohini and Stambhini. They were capable of agitating, stupefying and uprooting enemies. On the same layer and to the left, there was always Dandanathaa's mount, a grey buffalo. The distance between the two horns was half a *krosha* and the length of the body was one *krosha*. The body was covered with stiff body hair, resembling swords. The tail caused fear and was covered with hair resembling Kala's staff. Its complexion was that of a mountain made of blue collyrium. It was hideous, lofty and full of rage. The area around the hump was excellent, like a supreme mountain made out of blue antimony. It sighed a lot and that wind spread and made the oceans tremble. As Kala's buffalo grunted, it seemed to laugh loudly. When it flung its hooves around, all the clouds were scattered. The eight guardians of the worlds, Indra and the others, had their wonderful habitations below this layer. They had arrived to inform Lalitaa about the task to be performed. There was Indra, sixty-four crores of *apsaras*, *siddhas*, Agni, Sadhyas, Vishvadevas, Vishvakarma, Maya, extremely strong *matrikas*, Rudras and their attendants, and *pishachas*, the attendants of Rudras. The leaders of *rakshasas* and many *rakshasas* wept at this. There were Mitras; *gandharvas*, always accomplished in singing, famous ones like Vishvavasu being the foremost; large numbers of other *bhutas*; Varuna; Vasava; *vidyadharas*; *kinnaras*; lords among Maruts; Chitraratha and other makers of chariots; Tumburu; Narada; ⁸⁴⁵ Yaksha; Soma, the lord of

yakshas; the divinity Bhagavan Govinda, Kamalaa's consort; Ishana, who devours the wheel of the universe, with his terrible trident; Brahma; the two Ashvins, accomplished in the art of healing; the illustrious Dhanvantari; and other leaders of *ganas*, the *musth* from whose temples gratified the bees. There were lords among *nagas*—Ananta, Vasuki, Taksha, Karkota, Padma, Mahapadma, Shankhapala, Gulika and Subala, surrounded by crores of *nagas*. In this way, there were many divinities there, all attentive. Starting with the east, they created their residences all around. There was a circle of divinities in the north-western direction. These three divinities, Jrimbhini, Stambhini and Mohini, established themselves there. On that same layer of the radiant Kirichakra, Kshetrapala was always resplendent, serving Kitishvari.⁸⁴⁶ His radiant form was huge, and his hair stood up. He held a skull and a club. His complexion was exceedingly dark, like the moss that gathers at the bottom of Patala. He laughed out loudly, like a bolt of thunder, and seemed to shatter the circle of the cosmic egg. The sound of his drum shattered the space between earth and heaven. The noose in his hand was a serpent, possessing three hissing hoods. The maned mount was stationed near him. Astride this, she wished to embark on her task of killing Bhandasura. The attributes of Deveshi's mount, the lion, have already been described. On that layer, and slightly below, there were said to be one thousand divinities, serving Kitishvari. Their complexion was like that of Dandanathaa. All their ornaments were similar to Dandini's.⁸⁴⁷ Their weapons were similar. Their complexion was dark, with faces of boars. Their dark mass of hair was marked with a sign of the moon. They repeatedly whirled around ploughs and pestles in their hands. They filled the skulls they held with flows of blood from those who hated Lalitaa, those who hated Shyamaa, those who hated their mistress. They were ornamented with garlands, made out of the entrails of those who harmed their own devotees. There were radiant garlands on their breasts, made out of the shaven heads of those who acted the ordinances of their respective communities. Blood incessantly flowed from these heads. O one who originated from a pot! Their names were the one thousand names of Dandini. It will be spoken about later and not recounted now. Near these

boar-faced divinities, there was a black antelope, conventionally regarded as Dandini's mount. The distance between its horns was one quarter *krosha* and the length of the face was one-eighth of a *krosha*. The length of each leg was one *krosha* and its tail was always upright. There was a white shadow on its stomach. With its loud grunt, it laughed at the valour of the deer that was Marut's mount.⁸⁴⁸ This excellent mount was in the region of the same layer. Kirichakra was a king among chariots and located on that same layer, there was the ocean of liquor, assuming the form of a divinity. He held a lump of flesh in his hand, as red as a mountain made out of rubies. His eyes rolled around, and his garland was made out of golden lotuses. He was embraced by Mada Shakti, who held a red lotus.'

'Whenever the battle with Bhandā *daitya* would rage, the Shaktis would perspire and become thirsty. At those times, the ocean of liquor would scatter itself in many directions, removing the exhaustion of the divinities and imparting energy to them. There is no doubt that these excellent showers will occur. When I describe this, you will happily hear about this from me. Below that same layer, in the eight directions, there are said to have been ten, who progressively established their residences, starting with Hetuka. These were the best among the excellent Bhairavas, famous for their extensive valour. They were like dazzling suns and their infinite energy ignited the firmament. When the *kalpa* comes to an end, following Dandini's command, they destroy the universe. Their nature was exceedingly fierce. They gnashed their teeth and bit their lips in rage. With the tips of their tridents, they scattered the masses of large clouds. They were Hetuka, Tripurari, Agnibhairava the third, Yamajihva, Ekapada, Kala, Karalaka, Bhimarupa, Hatakesha and the one named Achala. These were the ten famous ones, each followed by ten crores of soldiers. They were there, near the extremities of Kirichakra. Such were the divinities on Dandanathā's Kirichakra. They started with Jrimbhini and ended with Achalendra.⁸⁴⁹ They purify the three worlds and they have been spoken about. Dandanetri's⁸⁵⁰ jewel among chariots, Kirichakra, advanced. In the battle, the large numbers of many divinities would kill *danavas* and drink showers of their blood. There were many groups of divinities on the layers,

armoured in many kinds of ways. Wherever chariot Chakraraja⁸⁵¹ advanced, so did the excellent Geyaratha.⁸⁵² Wherever Geyaratha advanced, so did the excellent Kirichakra. Amidst the army of thousands of Shaktis, the three auspicious chariots advanced,⁸⁵³ resembling the three worlds. It was as if the mountains Meru, Mandara and Vindhya had come together. There were tumultuous sounds in the army of the Shaktis. As a result of the clatter of all those wheels, the earth quaked. Lalitaa's leading chariot had the name of Chakraraja. It possessed six charioteers, skilled in holding the reins and wielding whips. Wherever there was Geyaratha, there was the excellent chariot of Kirichakra. Iradevi was the first charioteer, followed by Tripurabhairavi. The next was Samhara-Bhairava, followed by Raktayogini-Vallabha. The fifth was Sarasa and the next was Chamundaa. These divinities are described as the charioteers of the chariot. The charioteer of Geyachakra, Indra among chariots, was Hasantika. The charioteer of Kirichakra, Indra among chariots, is said to have been Stambhini. Lalitaa's supreme chariot possessed a height of ten *yojanas*. The excellent Gitachakra possessed a height of seven *yojanas*. O sage! Kirichakra possessed a height of six *yojanas*. There was an umbrella made out of large pearls, held aloft Laliteshani's⁸⁵⁴ chariot and nowhere else. It extended for ten *yojanas*. This is described as indicative of the empire of the Shaktis. There were ordinary umbrellas above the other two chariots. Lalitaa Ishani was Maheshvari over all the Shaktis. She was Parameshvari, instated in that position of presiding over a great empire. Desiring to accomplish the destruction of Bhanda *daitya*, she advanced. All the directions echoed with that sound and the earth trembled. As Laliteshi emerged, all beings were agitated. The drums of the *devas* were sounded and flowers were showered down. Vishvavasus and other *gandharvas*, such as Tumburu and Narada, were excellent celestial singers. They were accomplished in singing. They, and Sarasvati herself, recited auspicious chants of victory. Their faces bloomed with joy and their body hair stood up, like ornaments. They repeatedly praised Laliteshvari with the words, "Victory to you." They were filled with great delight and crazy and intoxicated, danced at every step. In the form of *Rig*, *Yajur*, *Sama* and

Atharva Veda hymns, *saptarshis*, Vasishtha and the others, enhanced the glory of her victory. They resembled oblations when offered into the extremely purifying flames of great fires. These excellent ones enhanced the greatness of benedictions. They lauded Lalitaa, radiant astride her excellent chariot. Along with her soldiers, she advanced to vanquish the terrible Bhandasura.'

Chapter 133-2(21) (Bhandasura's insolence)

Hayagriva said, 'Those who resided in Bhandasura's city were greatly agitated when they heard the sounds of Devi Lalitaa marching out on her journey. The wicked Bhandasura's impregnable city was beyond the limits of Mount Mahendra, on the shores of the great ocean. It was famous in the three worlds under the name of Shunyaka. The *daitya* who was Vishanga's elder brother always resided there, in that city, which extended for one hundred *yojanas*. All the asuras were scared and terrified at Shri Devi's arrival. The entire city, full of *asuras*, extended for one hundred *yojanas*. It was repeatedly enveloped in smoke and there were evil portents. The walls of the *daitya*'s habitation were shattered at the wrong time. Giant meteors whirled around and fell down on the ground from the sky. An earthquake is the first among evil portents. This occurred in the habitation of Shunyaka and the entire earth blazed. The *daityas* who resided in the city faced untimely palpitations of the heart. Herons, vultures, cranes and other birds perched on the tops of standards. They repeatedly glanced at the solar disc and called out loudly. There were many predatory creatures that could not be seen with the eyes. Harsh voices were repeatedly heard from the sky. In every direction, the banners were seen to become dirty. The smoke agitated the *daitya* and *rakshasa* populace. At the wrong time, the ornaments and garlands of the *daitya* women were dislodged. They lamented and wept piteously and shed profuse flows of tears. Mirrors, armour, standards, swords, wealth, jewels and garments were repeatedly sullied. The loud and harsh shouts uttered by *bhutas* could be heard in

mansions, chambers on tops of buildings, everywhere in pleasure chambers, houses, cow pens, shops, assembly houses, quadrangles, balconies, turrets, camps of soldiers, *sarvatobhadras*, *nandyavartas*, homes, agitated *vicchandakas*, excellent treasure-houses, svastikas, all the delivery-chambers, arches, doors, roofs, boundaries, windows, rooms and threshing floors. ⁸⁵⁵ All the residents who dwelt within the limits of the city heard these sounds. Everything turned lax, horrible in hue and dreadful. Looking towards the sun, crows called in hideous tones. While they crowed, crores of skulls fell on the ground. Drops of blood mixed with water fell in the centre of sacrificial altars. Bunches of hair fell everywhere, smoky in complexion and grey. All the residents of the city witnessed these evil portents on earth, in the sky and in heaven. Greatly terrified, all of them went to Bhandasura, extensive in fame, and reported to him what they had seen.'

'There were groups of these terrible and evil portents. However, Bhandasura was not dislodged from his fortitude. He went to the place meant for consultations. The Indra among *daityas* sat down on an excellent throne, decorated with many colourful gems so that it resembled part of Meru's body. The mass of jewels scattered rays from the sparkling crown on his head. The lord of *danavas* was radiant and seemed to illuminate the ends of all directions. The arena of that great pavilion extended for one *yojana*. As he was seated on that lofty throne, he was served by his two younger brothers, Vishukra and Vishanga, who were extremely strong and valiant. Their terrifying arms were like staffs, acting as thorns to the three worlds. They never transgressed the commands of their elder brother. They repeatedly enhanced his great fame by obtaining victory in the three worlds. They lowered their heads a bit, before his footstool. Joining their hands in salutation, they prostrated themselves and sat down on the ground. The supreme enemy of the immortals was seated there, in that place. All the vassals of the Indra among *daityas* arrived, so as to see him. It was impossible to count the number of soldiers each possessed. They announced their respective names and prostrated themselves before Bhandasura, the lord.

He looked at all those *asuras* with extremely patient eyes. Honouring them, he remained in that position for a while, looking at them.'

'Vishukra spoke to his elder brother, the lord of *danavas*. His voice was like that of bellows, or like the sound of the great ocean being churned.

"Terrible in your strength and valour, you have destroyed the *devas*. Those worst among Gods are sinners. They are evil-souled and wicked in conduct. They could not find refuge with anyone and were dejected. They faced destruction as if they were descending into a fire full of a circle of flames. A woman has arisen from those *devas*, and she is proud of her strength.

Devas, Vasava and others have themselves created her. Hence, they have again been infused with great strength and enterprise. Through this, many women and their attendants have been created, armed with diverse kinds of weapons. They are full of enthusiasm and valour. This will lead to great hardships for us. Such is the perverse nature of destiny. Though we are strong, if these weak women were to vanquish us, this will be like a stone being shattered with a broken sprout. If anyone speaks of such a possibility, that should be dismissed as jest. Is this not ridiculous? Is this not shameful? Perhaps they have been filled with fright at the leading warriors among our soldiers. Shakra and the other residents of Heaven have been overwhelmed by distress. Because of our strength and weapons, Brahma and the others have lost interest. What need be said about Vishnu? Maheshvara is scared. The guardians of the directions have fled. What need be said about others? Our sharp arrows are seen to have descended on their limbs. Everywhere, the invincible armour of the Gods has been shattered. Such has been the great valour in our arms. Nevertheless, a woman is advancing against us, desiring to defeat us. Though she is a woman, one should never ignore her. Those who wish for victory should not disregard and ignore an enemy, however insignificant. Therefore, to uproot her, servants should be sent. Let that insolent one be seized by her hair and brought here. O lord! Those who traverse a wicked path against you are like those who should be hunted. Within a short period of time, that evil one will be reduced to the status of a female servant. Indeed, everyone in the three worlds who acts in a contrary way, mobile or immobile, is terrified of a single warrior amongst all our

soldiers. O *danava*! However, your mind is a hallmark about what needs to be done.” When he submitted this to Bhanda *daitya*, his anger increased.’

‘Vishanga possessed great spirits. He could reflect and was discriminating. He addressed his elder brother, the great *daitya* who was full of pride, in these words. “O lord! O scorcher of enemies! You know everything about what must be done. When it is a question of following the path of good policy, there is nothing that needs to be said to you. The task must be undertaken after thinking about everything. Reflection is the greatest resort. If an act is undertaken without reflection, it leads to destruction from the roots. One should make efforts to send spies to the adversary’s camp. If a person wishes for success in obtaining victory, he should know the strengths and the weaknesses. A person who is firm in his wisdom should use spies as his eyes. He must always be suspicious, though he should behave as if he is not suspicious. The counsel with his ministers must be kept secret. Before taking every step, he should employ the six methods. ⁸⁵⁶ Such a king obtains victory. However, a rash person is instantly destroyed. If something is started without reflection, it causes destruction. A task undertaken after reflection is specifically one that leads to victory. Kings should not ignore enemies, even if they belong to an inferior species, are women or are insignificant. Power can be generated everywhere. Hiranyakashipu was the lord of all beings. But he was killed by an entity, with a body like a man and inferior species, originating from a pillar. ⁸⁵⁷ Earlier, there was a woman named Chandikaa, who manifested herself from *maya*. In battles, she destroyed Shumbha, Nishumba and Mahisha. ⁸⁵⁸ In that connection, many *daityas* were destroyed by her. Therefore, I say that one should never act to ignore her, even if she happens to be a woman. The power that is the cause of victory and prosperity exists everywhere. We have no reason to fear the foundation of that power, whether it is in a man or a woman. It is the nature of this world that power manifests itself everywhere. Therefore, you should seek to ascertain her wishes and her conduct. Who is she? Where did she originate? What is her conduct? Where does she obtain support? What is her strength? Who are her aides? O lord! These are the things you should think about.”’

‘Addressed thus by Vishanga, he replied, “Why should extremely energetic ones reflect? In our army, there are hundreds of leaders of *akshouhinis* who possess great spirits. They are capable of drinking up fathomless oceans and their fire can burn down heaven. O one who is speaking of wicked things! Why are you scared of women? Using spies, I have already ascertained all this. Someone has risen from Agni and her name is Lalitaa. Her name is appropriate. ⁸⁵⁹ Her form and features are like those of a flower. She possesses no spirit or valour and does not know about battles. She does not think about what she does, but she resorts to *maya*. Since she lacks in spirit, she created all these women from her *atman*. She is exerting herself through them. Or perhaps, as you have properly stated, there is a large army. Even then, who can defeat Bhandas, whose greatness has surpassed the three worlds? Even now, the residents of heaven are almost unable to breathe. They have been rendered senseless by the force and strength of my arms. Some of them have resorted to the depths of Patala. Some have entered the waters of the ocean. Some have sought refuge in the corners of the directions. Some are hidden in groves in the mountains. Extremely scared, they have vanished, abandoning their wives, sons and prosperity. They have been dislodged from their positions and are wandering around, hidden in the garb of animals. This woman did not originate a long time ago and does not know that the valour of my arms is like this. Hence, she is proud. Women do not know. They are foolish and their conceived bravery is futile. Deluded about what should be done and what should not be done, they head towards destruction. Nevertheless, placing her at the forefront, if the residents of heaven, great *uragas*, *siddhas*, *Sadhyas*, unassailable in battle, Brahma, the one with a lotus in the navel, Rudra, the lord of the Gods and other guardians of the directions do come, I am capable of crushing them. The commanders of my soldiers are invincible in battle. They will crush the enemy, treating them like ripe cucumbers. I have extremely strong sons—Kutilaksha, Kuranda, Karanka, Kalavashita, Vajradanta, Vajramukha, Vajraloma, Balahaka, Suchimukha, Phalamukha, Vikata, Vikatanana, Karalaksha, Karkataka, Madana, Dirghajihvaka, Humbaka, Halamulluncha, Karkasha, Kalkivahana, Pulkasa,

Pundraketu, Chandabahu, Kukkura, Jambukaksha, Jrimbhana, Tikshnashringa, Trikantaka, Chaturgupta, Chaturbahu, Chakaraksha, Chatuhshira, Vajraghosha, Urddhakesha, Mahamaya, Mahahanu, Makhashatru, Makhaskandi, Simhaghosha, Shiralaka, Andhaka, Sindhunetra, Kupaka, Kupalochana, Guhaksha, Gandagalla, Chandadharma, Yamantaka, Laduna, Pattasena, Purajit, Purvamaraka, Svargashatru, Svargabala, Durgakhya, Svargakantaka, Atimaya, Brihanmaya, Upamaya, Ulukajit, Purushena, Vishena, Kuntishena, Parushaka, Malaka, Kashura, Mangala, Draghana, Kollata, Kujilashva, Dashera, Babhruvahana, Drishtahasa, Drishtaketu, Parikshepta, Apakanchuka, Mahamoha, Mahadamshttra, Durgati, Svargamejaya, Shatketu, Shadvasu, Shaddanta, Shatpriya, Duhshatha, Durvinita, Chhinnakarna, Mushaka, Attahasi, Mahashi, Mahashirsha, Madotkata, Kumbhotkacha, Kumbhanasa, Kumbhagriva, Ghatodara, Ashvamedhra, Mahanda, Kumbhanda, Putinasika, Putidanta, Putichakshu, Putyasya, Putimehana and other brave ones. They are the equals of Hiranyakashipu and Hiranyaksha. Each of these has given birth to another one hundred brave sons. My soldiers are intoxicated. When they surround and follow my sons, in a battle, they will rout the worst among the immortals. Even if they are enraged in battle, even if they possess thousands of excellent *akshouhinis*, the enemy will be reduced to ashes. What need be said of women? When they come into battle, all of them use *maya*. However, those on my side use greater *maya* and will angrily reduce their forces to ashes. Therefore, let your mind not be depressed on account of unnecessary fears.” Having said this, Bhanda, Indra among *daityas*, arose from the king’s seat. He spoke to Kutilaksha, the immensely strong commander of his soldiers. “Arise! From every direction, summon the forces. Place the forces everywhere, around the gates of Shunyaka. Arm the fortifications and place hundreds of *kshepanakas*.⁸⁶⁰ Ministers and priests should perform evil acts of *abhichara*.⁸⁶¹ Prepare the weapons. A battle has presented itself. Let the commanders now advance, with many hordes of soldiers who are terrible to behold. Because of the spirit of the *devas*, she is foolish and insolent. At the time of battle, descend on her and defeat her. Drag her here, by the hair.” He

spoke in this way to Kutilaksha, the leader of the forces, who led three thousand soldiers and was great in spirits. Thereafter, he left for the inner quarters. The sounds of Shri Devi advancing on her march were heard. The Indras among *daityas* heard this and were filled with anxiety.’

Chapter 134-2(22) (Death of Durmada and Kuranda)

Hayagriva continued, ‘War drums were sounded by Shri Lalitaa’s soldiers. As the Indras among *asuras* sounded their war drums in the battle, the roar became louder. The directions seemed to be crushed. The depths of the ocean were agitated. The worlds were deafened, and the three worlds trembled. All the directions were crushed and mountains and caverns shattered. The sounds created by the *daityas* overwhelmed the sky. The sound created was like the enraged *humkara* of Narahari. ⁸⁶² The drums of the enemies of the Gods were harsh, without any charm. After this, crores of *daityas* started to chatter. Angry, they rushed forward against Parameshvari. Some covered their bodies with colourful armour, studded with jewels. Some resembled a mobile and lofty Mount Rohana. ⁸⁶³ One particular warrior resembled the night of destruction as he whirled around a sword that had been carefully polished by the weapon-maker, drawing it out from its sheath. Another delightedly touched the tip of his spear with his hands. He was astride a horse and displayed many kinds of movements along the route. Some warriors, along the path, were on lofty elephants. They resembled mountains that were tossed around by the wind. They were astride many kinds of mounts as they advanced against Lalitaa—armed with spears, bludgeons, thunderbolts, ⁸⁶⁴ javelins, *druhanas*, ⁸⁶⁵ *bhushundis*, axes, clubs, maces, *shataghnis*, arrows with three tips, iron arrows, arrows with heads like a half-moon, great *chakras*, curved arrows, arrows with faces like serpents, different types of weapons resembling hoods of serpents, bows, bows made of horn, staffs, weapons that were hurled, arrows as firm as the *vajra*, excellent rocks held by the fingers and in the fists, *valalas*, *khandalas*, ⁸⁶⁶ daggers, daggers with points in the middle,

daggers with teeth like fangs, battleaxes, nooses used as weapons, nooses resembling snouts and thousands of weapons that resembled beaks of crows. There were many such fierce weapons, capable of destroying life. Crores of armoured *daityas* held them in their hands. They were astride horses and astride elephants. Others were astride donkeys, camels, wolves and dogs. There were those who were astride crows, vultures and herons. Some were astride tigers. Others were astride lions. Some were mounted on *sharabhas*. Others were mounted on *bherundas*.⁸⁶⁷ Some were astride boars, others were astride predatory beasts. Some were mounted on *pretas*. They advanced astride their own mounts, strong and senseless with rage. There was a *danava* named Durmada. He was the leader of the soldiers and was crooked. With ten *akshouhinis*, he was dispatched towards Lalitaa. With his forces, it was as if he wished to burn down the entire universe. Along with warriors, this commander advanced in Lalitaa's direction. With the loud sound of drums, he shattered the fourteen worlds. As he advanced in her direction, Durmada laughed uproariously.'

'The immensely strong Kutilaksha was commanded by Bhandasura. Accordingly, he told Talajangha that he should stand at the eastern gate of the city of Shunyaka to protect it. There were ten *akshouhinis* with him. To protect the southern gate of the city, the *daitya* named Talabhuja was engaged, with ten *akshouhinis*. To protect the western gate of the city, the *daitya* named Talagriva was engaged, with ten *akshouhinis*. With ten *akshouhinis*, the immensely strong Talaketu was instructed to protect the city's northern gate. In a circle, ten *akshouhinis* were instructed to be stationed all around the city and on tops of walls and houses. In this way, fifty *akshouhinis* were engaged to protect the city. Having done this for the city of Shunyaka, he informed his master about what he had done.

Kutilaksha said, "O lord! Following your command, soldiers have been employed to protect the city. Durmada has already been sent, to advance against the wicked Lalitaa. Our servants are sufficient to destroy the wishes of that woman. Nevertheless, the conduct of a king should be such that he acts to protect the city." Having told Bhandasura, the Indra among *daityas*, this,

the extremely haughty Kutilaksha readied his soldiers and his commanders.’

‘Kutilaksha *danava* had sent a messenger earlier.⁸⁶⁸ With standards, creating a great noise, he surrounded Lalitaa’s soldiers. There were thousands of warriors there, chattering loudly. They whirled their swords and descended on the Shakti soldiers. Those Shaktis were dreadful. They laughed uproariously and shouted. With blazing weapons, they fought against the *danavas*. As the Shaktis and *danavas* clashed against each other in the battle, the sky was covered with dust and the three worlds were agitated. The shafts of the chariots made this dust dense, and the trumpeting of the elephants enhanced it, while the breathing of the horses scattered it, thus making it rise up into the sky. Sampatsarasvati⁸⁶⁹ saw that he was descending, surrounded by ten *akshouhinis*. Full of rage, she rushed forward to do battle. There were other Shaktis who were Sampatkari’s equal. There were horses and intoxicated tuskers. These crushed the *danava* army. A tumultuous battle ensued between the two sides and there were chattering sounds. Dust arose and war drums were sounded. Large rivers of red blood started to flow here and there, as the Shaktis brought down thousands of *danavas*. Struck by arrows whetted on stone,⁸⁷⁰ standards were brought down and scattered. All the other insignia and umbrellas were flung around. Covered with red blood, circles of umbrellas fell down in the field of battle. They resembled the moon, covered with red clouds in the evening. The *daitya* soldiers resembled the garland of flames of the fire that comes at the end of a *kalpa*, shrouding the beautiful ocean. Like that, they surrounded the Shakti army. Shaktis used blazing and sharp weapons to easily sever their heads. In the field of battle, there were piles of heads of *danavas* that had fallen. The lips were bitten and there were frowns on the cruel faces. The eyes were red with rage. Such were the severed heads that fell on the ground in the course of the battle. This was a time that caused terror to the universe. The Shaktis were exceedingly angry and crushed the *daitya* soldiers. They fell here and there, struck senseless by the weapons of the Shaktis. Struck by the forces of Sampaddevi,⁸⁷¹ the *danavas* were destroyed. Durmada, the scorcher of enemies, comforted his army, which

had been routed. He mounted a camel and suddenly rushed against that army. The camel was lofty and had a long neck. Seated on it, he cruelly struck it with his goad. With Durmada on top, the mount, the camel, advanced. They ⁸⁷² followed the wicked one, with a wrathful mind, astride the camel. Wishing to fight against the Shaktis, he assured the scared *danavas*. Like a cloud that showers a forest with rain, he unleashed a shower of arrows with iron and blazing tips towards the circle of Sampatkari's army. They were struck by many arrows that were difficult to withstand and for an instant, Sampatkari's soldiers were stunned in the battle. At this, Sampatambikaa's ⁸⁷³ eyes turned red with rage. She fought astride an elephant named Ranakolahala. In the battle, she drew the bow all the way back up to her ear. The bangles moved and made her hand appear even more beautiful. Because of the dexterity with which she moved, no one could see the bow-string being drawn back, or the arrow being released. When the arrow was fixed, only the circle of the bow could be seen. The arrows released from Sampatkari's bow touched the sun's rays and the reflection made their tips sparkle. The enemy was burnt down. The fight between her and Durmada was extraordinary. As arrows whetted on stone clashed against each other, sparks flew. In the beginning, the arrows shot by Sampatkari and the enemy of the Gods caused darkness that made the sun disappear. After this, as the skillfully released arrows clashed against each other, there were whirling sparks. The one with the beautiful hips was astride the elephant, Ranakolahala. In the encounter, it displayed many different kinds of valour. It killed some *daityas* with its trunk and others by kicking them with its feet. It killed other *danavas* with blows from its tusks, which were like bludgeons. Other enemies were killed by lashes from its tail, which was as firm as a tree trunk. Some were crushed by its body, others were killed by its nails. As it struck with its large head, it crushed some other *daityas*. Sampaddevi's intoxicated elephant showed its skills. His face red with rage, Durmada used a single firm arrow to gouge out a single jewel from Sampatkari's crown. Her eyes turned red with rage. She shot arrows whetted on stone. They pierced him in the chest. Durmada immediately gave up his life and was killed. At this, the excellent Shakti

soldiers roared and chattered. Many excellent *danavas*, supreme soldiers, were killed. Those *daityas* who weren't killed by the arrows of the Shaktis fled. They abandoned the battle and sought refuge in the city of Shunyaka.'

'Hearing what had happened, the lord of *danavas* became angry. Terrible in his power, he seemed to blaze. With fierce eyes, he looked at them and touched his sword, intending to fight. He spoke to Kutilaksha, the commander of soldiers, who was near him. "Durmada was full of strength. How did that wicked woman bring him down in the battle? The course of destiny leads to misery. Gods, *yakshas* and Indras among *uragas* were unable to withstand Durmada's strength. Yet, he has been slain by a woman. That wicked woman must be defeated and forcefully dragged here by the hair. Send the commander named Kuranda, who is invincible in battle." Kuranda was terrible and awful, immense in strength. Kutilaksha sent him, to present himself before the master. Kuranda arrived and prostrated himself before the master. Kutilaksha told him, "Go and ready the soldiers. You are skilled in the use of *maya*. You are accomplished in fighting in wonderful ways. You are accomplished in deceitful fighting. Crush that woman." In front of the master, Kutilaksha instructed him in this way. Kuranda, terrible in valour, swiftly emerged from the city. In every direction, he surrounded himself with twenty *akshouhinis*. The surface of the earth was crushed with elephants, horses and infantry. Kuranda, Durmada's dreadful elder brother, advanced to fight. He was overwhelmed by sorrow and rage. Nevertheless, he steadied his mind and advanced on a swift horse. The dust that he raised enveloped the directions. He seized his bow made of horn and when it was twanged, it made a terrible sound. He unleashed showers of arrows on Sampatkari's large army. "O evil one! You killed my younger brother Durmada, who was invincible in battle. Why do you boast about your valour? Do you possess even a bit of bravery? I will now use this circle of iron arrows and make sure you reach the Destroyer's city. Behold. Blood will flow your body. Blood will flow from the bodies of these women. It will be extremely delightful and tasty, and the soldiers will drink it in the battle. You will now reap the consequences of slaying my younger brother. O wicked one! I will free you today. Behold the strength of my arms." In

this way, he roared in the direction of Sampatkari, who was astride the excellent elephant. He encouraged his soldiers to attach and crush the Shakti soldiers. Chandi got ready to crush the soldiers of the immensely energetic Kuranda. She encouraged her own soldiers. There was a wonderful battle, exciting the curiosity of the entire universe. She arrived astride her horse and addressed Sampatkari in these affectionate words. “O friend! Listen to my words with affection. Grant me this battle, so that I can obtain excellent qualities. Withdraw from the battle for a while and engage me. I am requesting you as a friend. Do not have any hesitation about the matter.” Hearing her words, Sampaddevi, the one with the sweet smiles, withdrew her soldiers from Kuranda’s direction. Shaktis who possessed the complexion of the rising sun were astride horses as fleet as the wind. Like waves in the ocean, these soldiers sallied forth. Their hard hooves repeatedly etched out marks on the ground. In the field of battle, in a single wave, they rushed against Kuranda. Ambikaa’s soldiers, the Shaktis, were astride horses and fought against the *danavas*. They were skilled in different techniques of holding the reins, advancing and retreating, different kinds of movements and the five kinds of movements, striking with the hooves, encouraging the horses with signs from the tips of the hands and the feet and knowing about the hearts of horses in a battle. Kuranda encouraged the invincible *danavas* to fight. A battle between the Shaktis and the enemies of the Gods ensued. She ⁸⁷⁴ was astride a swift horse named Aparajitaa. Mounted on his horse, she rushed towards Kuranda, wicked in conduct. The fortunate one’s braid of hair moved around, dazzling like a digit of the autumn moon. Her beautiful face resembled the red lunar disc at the time of evening. As she picked up a bejewelled bow in the battle, she seemed to smile. With a face like that of a horse, ⁸⁷⁵ she showered arrows in Kuranda’s direction. Astride her horse, she showered arrows and enveloped the directions. Arrows whetted on stone, with golden tufts, covered the ten directions. Kuranda, Durmada’s elder brother, was terrible in prowess and became angry. From his bow made of horn, he showered arrows in the direction of the one who was mounted on a horse. She was astride a horse and that horse also crushed *danavas*. Great in speed, the dreadful blows

from its hooves split those soldiers. Its neighing resembled the roar of the ocean. Even when heard from a distance, there were many among the enemy who lost their senses. Mounted on the horse, she moved around here and there, amidst the circle of *daityas*. She released her divine weapon, a noose that was blazing in form. From that noose, crores of other nooses were generated, as terrible as serpents. All the soldiers were bound in these. Once bound, they lost their senses. Since the soldiers were killed, Kuranda became angry. With a single arrow, he severed the bejewelled string of her bow. When the string was severed, she cast aside that bow. Mounted on the horse, she became extremely angry and brought down the goad on that evil-minded one's chest. That blazing goad drunk up the blood of his life. Like a tree struck by the *vajra*, Kuranda fell on the ground. Horrible demonesses and some warriors emerged from the goad. They devoured the soldiers, drank up the blood flowing from the nooses and then vanished. In this way, Kuranda and twenty *akshouhinis* were destroyed. The remaining *daityas* quickly fled. The Shakti soldiers brought down Kuranda and his younger brother in the battle. Hearing this, the lord of Shunyaka sighed like a serpent.'

Chapter 135-2(23) (Slaying of Karanka and other generals)

Hayagriva continued, 'Kuranda was thus destroyed by the one astride a horse. Wishing to fight, Bhandu *danava* spoke to Kutilaksha again. "The hardship that has arrived is something that we did not see in a dream, something that we have never witnessed earlier and something that our minds would not have suspected. The two brothers, Kuranda and Durmada, were full of spirits. The power and *maya* of the wicked one is clearly greater. After this, send five commanders of soldiers, Karanka and others. Let one hundred *akshouhinis* leave for the field of battle. These are brave ones, invincible in battle. They are ready to give up their lives while fighting. In every possible way, they will defeat that wicked and haughty woman." Hearing Bhandu's words, Kutilaksha hurried. He summoned

Karanka and other commanders of soldiers. As instructed by Kutilaksha, they bowed down before their master. It was as if they were ready to enter the fire. Blind with rage, they emerged from the city. As they advanced, the greatly tumultuous sound they caused was impossible to tolerate. Hearing this, the ears of the *diggajas* were shattered and they were agitated. One hundred *akshouhinis* advanced, with garlands of standards. There were lofty horses and intoxicated elephants. Horses neighed, elephants trumpeted and warriors roared. As the chariots moved, their wheels thundered. As the rims of the wheels struck against the ground, dust arose and shrouded the sun, so that it seemed to be covered in flakes of snow. The entire circle of the universe was covered in dust. There was sound everywhere and harsh sounds in some places. The nets of dust that arose covered the *daitya* soldiers. Therefore, one could not even think of the number of soldiers who were advancing. There were standards of many different types, colourfully marked with fishes and predatory creatures. As they marched through the net of dust, they resembled fish in the great ocean. All the immortals saw them descend towards Lalitaa's soldiers. They were scared, worried that the Shaktis would be routed.'

'There were five generals, Karanka being the foremost. In the battle, they used their great *maya* to create one named Sarpini.⁸⁷⁶ They created the wicked Sarpini, a demoness of battle. She was smoky in complexion. Her lips were smoky in complexion. Her breasts were smoky in complexion. The expanse of the hollow in her belly was as deep as the giant ocean. In the battle, she moved on ahead and caused terror in the minds of the Shaktis. She was like another Kadru.⁸⁷⁷ She was evil, and many snakes constituted her ornaments. Her body was full of *maya*, and she writhed in the place where she had arisen. She rolled around on the ground, in front of those commanders. As she writhed in many kinds of way, she shrieked in a hideous tone. Using such *maya*, those Indras among *asuras* had triumphed earlier. There were five such evil-souled ones, Karanka and others. It was as if they desired to give up their lives.'

'A battle ensued between the Shaktis and the enemies of the immortals. They addressed each other in words used by heroes, causing encouragement

and rage. So great was the tumultuous encounter that they could not distinguish each other. With weapons in their hands, Shaktis and *danavas* struck each other. As the weapons clashed against each other, flames arose. The flow of arrows was such that it covered the intervening spaces between the directions. There were many rivers of blood that bore along intoxicated elephants. The circle of chariots got stuck, submerged in the mire created by the flesh. Dishevelled strands of hair floated around, like moss in streams of blood. It was extremely cruel and destructive, with the horrible roars of lions. There was dust and darkness, causing satisfaction to the *rakshasi*.⁸⁷⁸ Weapons mangled arrays of *daityas* and blood flowed from their throats. There was a terrible battle between the Shaktis and the enemies of the Gods. Sarpini was goaded on by the five generals, who gathered their forces together. She created many kinds of snakes from her body. They were the equals of Takshaka and Karkotaka.⁸⁷⁹ They were as virulent as Vasuki and other foremost serpents. They possessed many kinds of bodies and hues. Their sight was dreadful, in many kinds of ways. There were many kinds of virulent poison, capable of burning down the three worlds. There were many types of poison—*darada*, *vatsanabha*, *kalakuta*, the poison *sourashtra*, the terrible *brahmaputra*, *shouklikeya* and other kinds of poison.⁸⁸⁰ There were serpents that emerged from Sarpini's two eyes. There were others that emerged from Sarpini's body and terrified the Shakti soldiers. These snakes were exceedingly horrible. They were smoky in complexion and possessed two mouths. There were those that emerged from Sarpini's two eyes, blazing in rage. They were yellow in complexion and possessed three hoods. They had fangs and their faces were hideous. Crores of snakes arose from the cavities in Sarpini's ears. They held up their hoods and had mouths in front, as well as at the tails. Hooded serpents emerged from Sarpini's mouth. Their bodies were blue. There were many others, strong and with different complexions. They possessed four mouths and four feet. They emerged from the cavities in her nostrils, emitting fierce flames. There were those with long hanging folds of skin. They emerged from her round and large breasts and from the cavity in her navel. There were many hideous ones, red in complexion. Leaders of *pannagas* arose,

bearing *halahala*. They bit the Shakti soldiers and burnt them down with the fire of their poison. They bound them in serpentine coils and struck them with numerous hoods. They caused distress in Laliteshi's army. They were repeatedly sliced down by the crores of weapons of the Shaktis. But they repeatedly increased. Those lumps led to more snakes. Though many snakes were destroyed, others were born again. At the time when one was destroyed, many others arose. The root cause, wicked Sarpini, was not destroyed. Hence, when snakes created by her were destroyed, other snakes were generated. Thus, the bodies of the Shakti soldiers were scorched by the poisonous flames. Scorched, they were miserable. In that battle, they were overwhelmed. As a result of the serpents, the Shaktis were bewildered and did not know what to do.'

'Meanwhile, the five *danavas* exhibited many kinds of valour. Karanka⁸⁸¹ was astride a chariot yoked to one hundred donkeys. He used a *chakra*, sharp at the edges, to crush the Shakti soldiers. Bhandu *daitya*'s forces had another general, named Vajradanta. In that battle, he rode a camel and struck with arrows that were as forceful as the *vajra*. Vajramukha was astride a vehicle with large wheels. He struck that circle of Shaktis with a sharp spear. There was a second Vajradanta, a powerful general of the forces. He was astride a chariot yoked to two vultures and struck with arrows whetted on stone. In this way, those wicked generals were encouraged in the encounter. Hundreds of *akshouhinis* descended and toyed with the enemy. Sarpini, evil in conduct, used many kinds of *maya*. Every instant, she created crores of hooded serpents. Nakuli⁸⁸² was astride Garuda. On seeing that the soldiers were disabled, she became enraged and descended in that battle. Her complexion was like that of molten gold, and she had originated from Lalitaa's palate. All the different forms of speech were in her and her teeth were as firm as the *vajra*. She released her own soldiers in Sarpini's direction. She was astride Garuda, who possessed lofty shoulders and could sweep aside mountains through a blow of his wings. In the encounter, he resembled a mobile Sumeru. Nakuli saw that terrible snakes had originated through Sarpini's *maya*. Her eyes turned red with rage, and she opened her gaping mouth. From the array of Shri Nakuli

Devi's thirty-two teeth, thirty-two crores of mongooses were born, and they were golden in complexion. Here and there, they cut down the circle of Sarpini's snakes. They crushed them with their own teeth and destroyed their poison. In that dreadful battle, the golden mongooses moved around, destroying the poison. As a result of their great rage, they pricked up their ears and shook their body hair. With gaping mouths, the delighted mongooses bit the serpents. For every snake created through *maya*, a mongoose originated. Using sharp teeth, it brought down and sliced the enemy's body. The blood that emerged from the bodies of the serpents made the corners of their mouths red with blood. The tongues of the mongooses were like sprouts. They licked them and jumped around in the battle. The bodies of the *pannagas* were very slippery. Bitten repeatedly by the mongooses, they writhed their coils and tried to move. However, struck by the mongooses, their bodies, with the raised hoods, were destroyed. In the encounter, the destroyed hoods were strewn around, heavy with jewels. Struck by the force of the mongooses, the circle of hoods that had emerged was destroyed. The hoods were like a blaze created from enmity and it was extinguished. In this way, the circle of mongooses destroyed the net of snakes, created through *maya*.'

'At this, Sarpini was filled with wrath. Nakuleshvari fought a great battle with her. She invoked the cruel Garuda weapon on an arrow whetted on stone. That Garuda weapon blazed in great flames and ignited the directions. It penetrated Sarpini's body and destroyed all the *maya* of snakes. When the strength of *maya* was destroyed, Sarpini dissolved away. When she was destroyed, those five excellent generals were filled with rage. Because of her strength, they had paid scant regard to all the soldiers of the Gods. However, the valour of the mongooses had conveyed Sarpini to her destruction. Since their own soldiers had been destroyed, those generals became extremely angry. United in their efforts, they showered down weapons on Nakuli. The Ishvari of the army was alone, mounted on Tarkshya.⁸⁸³ But she fought with those five. Exhibiting the dexterity of her hands in the battle, she showered down weapons—spears, bludgeons and thousands of javelins. With teeth that were as firm as the *vajra*, she bit them

in their inner organs. The servants of the *daitya* ⁸⁸⁴ uttered terrible sounds of lamentation. The terrible bites of the mongooses caused them great agitation. Some of these leapt up into the sky, screaming in hideous tones. Blazing in their anger, they bit and agitated the soldiers of the enemy. Some were bitten on the ears. Others were bitten on the noses and the tops of the heads. Some were bitten on the backs and rendered incapable of motion. They were incapacitated, their armour destroyed. Terrified and scared, they flung away their weapons. Overwhelmed by the mongooses, they fell, their bodies lifeless. Some mongooses entered the gaping mouths of the enemy. They tugged at the coiled serpents and bit them on their tongues. Other mongooses entered the bodies of the enemies of the Gods through the ears. The mongooses assumed subtle forms and entered through the many openings. Seeing that his own soldiers were dejected, overwhelmed by the mongooses, Karanka became angry. The other immensely strong generals also displayed the dexterity of their hands. Like clouds showering down rain, they showered down arrows on the mongooses. The arrows that issued from the bows of the *daitya* soldiers were whetted on stone. They clashed powerfully against the array of teeth the mongooses possessed. The mongooses were severely struck by the arrows shot by those generals and flames issued from their teeth, which were like the *vajra*. The five generals seemed to toy with them. The arrows, with sparkling tips, crushed the army of mongooses. Here and there, those generals shot crores of arrows. Their bodies shattered; the mongooses surrounded Nakuli. Nakuli, the sole Goddess of language and speech, ⁸⁸⁵ was surrounded by the mongooses and was filled with great rage. She fixed the great weapon named Nakula on her bow made of horn. It did not decay and faced every direction. Its tips were covered with garlands of flames. Mongooses, numbering crores, emerged from it. Their bodies were like the *vajra*. Their body hair was like the *vajra*. Their teeth were like the *vajra*. They were great in speed. Their substance was as firm as the *vajra*. They were as terrible as nets of *vajra*. Their nails had the form of the *vajra*, and they swiftly tore up the surface of the ground. They were ornamented with eyes that were as radiant as bejewelled *vajras*. As they hissed through their noses, it was like a bolt of thunder. Biting with

crores of teeth, they crushed the soldiers of the enemies of the Gods. They exhibited many kinds of valour, without resorting to deceit. Thus, there were many crores of immensely strong mongooses, as terrible as the *vajra*. They mangled and destroyed every limb of the worst among *danavas*. In this way, that force, consisting of one hundred *akshouhinis*, was shattered by that circle of mongooses, which were as firm as the *vajra*. Those excellent generals were the only ones left in the encounter and they were filled with great fear and rage. Drawing their bows back, they fought even more. In many kinds of ways, Nakuleshvari fought against them. She used a spear to sever Karanka's firm head. Astride Garuda, she leapt up and used her sword to sever the heads of the four enemies, Kakavashita⁸⁸⁶ being the foremost. Witnessing the dexterity exhibited by Nakuli, Shymalambikaa⁸⁸⁷ showed a great deal of honour to the immensely spirited one, who had destroyed the wicked *asuras*. Shyamalambikaa bestowed on her the status of a Devi who was part of her own self. Who is not filled with delight when supreme qualities are seen in this world? The ones who were left were scared. Terrified, they sought refuge with Nakuli. Seeing them, she was filled with compassion. She smiled and said, "Do not be scared. Go and make your king understand everything about the battle." Sent by her, they looked at the field of battle and were terrified again. However, happy,⁸⁸⁸ they fled to Shunyaka. Hearing from them what had happened, Bhandas was filled with terrible rage.'

Chapter 136-2(24) (Slaying of seven generals, Balahaka and others)

Hayagriva continued, 'When they were killed, the lord of Shunyaka became blind with rage and sighed. Anxious, but eager to fight, he spoke to Kutilaksha.⁸⁸⁹ "O fortunate one! O commander! We face a misfortune. Karanka and others were generals who showed the valour of their arms. Using Sarpini's *maya*, they shattered the insolence of all the residents of heaven. But that wicked one has used mysterious *maya* and has brought

them down. There are seven generals, Balahaka and others. They are spirited and fierce in their arms. Send them to fight. Along with them, send thirty *akshouhinis*. They are accomplished in the use of *maya* and will crush Lalitaa's soldiers. They are worthy of ensuring victory and returning to my presence. They are terrible in valour and have been born from Kikasa's womb. These are the seven brothers, Balahaka being the foremost. They are always victorious. They will certainly triumph in the field of battle." Thus addressed by Bhandasura, Kutilaksha summoned the seven generals, Balahaka being the foremost. They were powerful and haughty. Balahaka was the first among them and Shuchimukha was the next. The others were Phalamukha, Vikarna, Vikatanana, Karalayu and Karataka. These seven were full of prowess. They were eager to fight and prostrated themselves before Bhandasura. All these brothers were the sons of Kikasa and they protected each other. They were each other's aides. They emerged from the city. Thirty *akshouhinis* of soldiers followed these generals. Their standards etched out marks on the thick clouds in the sky. They were terrible in fighting and the stamping of their feet made the earth suffer. As a result of the net of dust they created, they drank up all the water from the ocean. There were the sounds of many kinds of drums—*bheris*, *nihsanas*, *tampottas*, *panavas* and *anakas*.⁸⁹⁰ At every step, the universe and the sky were filled with the qualities of this sound. Taking those thirty *akshouhinis* with them, Kikasa's sons, insolent and haughty, left, so as to enter the universe.⁸⁹¹ Because of their rage, their faces were red. The solar disc illuminated their armour. Their weapons and ornaments blazed. The hair braided above their heads also blazed. Earlier, these seven had been sent to crush the seven worlds. This was when Bhandasura had desired to embark on his great expedition of conquest. He had witnessed how these immensely strong ones had crushed the seven worlds. Therefore, evil in intelligence and wishing to triumph over Lalitaa's soldiers, he sent them. Waving their weapons in their hands, they descended on the field of battle. Full of rage, they advanced in the direction of the Shakti soldiers. They repeatedly roared and chattered, announcing themselves to the ten directions. They advanced to the spot where Devi's soldiers were.'

‘Lalitaa Devi’s soldiers were armoured, wielding terrible weapons. They furrowed their cruel brows and advanced in the direction of the enemy. O sage! Some held nooses, others held bludgeons. There were others who wielded *chakras*. There were others who held clubs, spears and bows. In Lalitaa’s army, there were many fierce Shaktis. They advanced in thousands, ready to drink up the ocean of *daityas*. The *danavas* roared loudly and chastised the Shaktis. “O evil and wicked ones! O worst among women! Come. Keep your *maya* far away. Using that, you can only confound the dumb. Today, we will convey you to the residence of the lord of *pretas*. We will use terrible arrows that sigh like serpents.” One used a spear and severed the head of an Indra among *daityas*.⁸⁹² The blood that flowed from his throat rushed upwards. Many vultures hung on, forming a circle. They seemed to enhance the beauty of the umbrella held above the lord of *pretas*. In the battle, an enemy of the Gods released a weapon in the direction of a Shakti. But that Shakti countered this with an arrow and that arrow also brought him down. Another Shakti was astride her trained elephant and used her elephant to strike at the chest of an evil-minded one. Another Shakti fought against an enemy warrior who was seated on the head of a tusker. She struck the elephant violently with her sword. Killing it, she sent it to the beloved heaven. Releasing a *chakra* from her hand, another Shakti severed the bow of an enemy of the Gods into two parts. It was as if she was fashioning a pair of eyebrows for herself. Using hundreds of arrows, another Shakti pacified and brought down the adversary. Another pierced the enemy in the line of hair above the lotus of his navel and brought pleasure to her own self. Another used a bludgeon to crush and bring down the adversary. Another used the wheel of a chariot to strike the adversary on the buttocks and brought pleasure to her own self. Using a sword, another severed the terrible shaft on the chariot of a lord among *danavas* and brought pleasure to herself and to the earth. The Shakti soldiers entered inside the army of *daityas*. The *daitya* soldiers also entered inside the army of Shaktis. The mingling of the Shaktis and the enemies of the Gods was like a mix of water and milk. At the time of battle, they got variously engaged with each other. With blows from their swords, the

Shaktis sliced off the trunks of the intoxicated elephants the *daityas* possessed, so that these came to resemble giant boars. Such was the battle, causing fear even amongst heroes. It is impossible for cowards among men to remember it. Even for the terrible, it was dreadful. As a result of the weapons, the field of battle was impossible to traverse.’

‘Balahaka was astride a huge vulture. It possessed a beak and talons that were as fierce as the *vajra*. Its firm shanks resembled Kala’s staff. It was named Samharagupta. Earlier, it had originated from the fire. It was as grey as smoke and the beating of its wings was terrible. Astride this, indomitable in battle, he fought in many kinds of ways. When it stretched its wings, they extended for half a *krosha*. It stood there and screamed in a hideous tone. Its beak was like a pit full of blazing coal. It shattered and devoured the forces. The huge vulture, Samharagupta, possessed cruel eyes. It bore Balahaka, who drew his bow back in the course of the battle. Balahaka was stationed on the back of this vulture. His body resembled a *balahaka* cloud,⁸⁹³ above a large mountain with wings. Shuchimukha, Indra among *daityas*, was astride a crow. The tips of its cruel wings were as sharp as a needle. Astride this, he struck and fought in this tough battle. The crazy crow was as large as the summit of a mountain, and it possessed large wings. Its terrible shanks were like Kala’s staff. Its complexion was dirty, radiant like a *pushkalavarta* cloud.⁸⁹⁴ When it stretched its wings, they extended for one *krosha*. Shuchimukha was astride this crow, which emitted a foul smell. With blows from its large beak, it crushed the Shaktis. Phalamukha picked up a plough as his own weapon. Astride a heron in that battle, he resembled a mountain. The immensely strong Indra among *daityas*, known as Vikarna, was a leader of soldiers. Astride a *bherunda* bird, he fought a terrible battle. In the battle, Vikatananana advanced on an extremely dreadful and fierce cock. His weapon was a shining spear. The cock saw the Shaktis in front and its eyes shone with delight. It roared deeply, from within its throat. As it moved, it used its feet as weapons. The sixth, Karalaksha,⁸⁹⁵ was the most senior and resembled a mountain. His roar was like the clash of thunder, and he advanced on a *preta* as his mount. Earlier, this brave one had obtained success in the use of *mantras* associated with cremation grounds.

That his how he had subjugated the *preta*, who bore him in the field of battle. The *preta* possessed long arms and extended feet. Its face was held downwards. Karalaksha advanced, with this *preta* as his mount. The final one was named Karataka and he was a crest jewel among the *daitya* soldiers. With a *vetala* as his mount, he crushed the Shakti soldiers. The *vetala* was one *yojana* tall and possessed cruel eyes. Using *mantras* associated with cremation grounds, he had been successful in subjugating the *vetala*. As instructed by him, it crushed the army of Shaktis. Mounted on that excellent *vetala*, the *danava* fought with the Shaktis in many kinds of ways. Such were the seven, with crookedness in their *atmans*. They were like seven oceans. Attacked by them there, the Shakti soldiers became anxious.’

‘Earlier, these seven had satisfied Savitar through their austerities. Satisfied by their austerities, the radiant one had granted them a boon. “O Kikasa’s immensely fortunate sons! I have been satisfied by your virtuous austerities. O fortunate ones! Ask for a boon.” Kikasa’s sons, emaciated through austerities, were addressed in this way by the lord of the day. For the sake of the *asuras*, they asked for an intractable boon. “When a battle presents itself, you must be present in the pupils of our eyes. Your terrible energy will burn down anyone who opposes us. O Tapanā! ⁸⁹⁶ O lord! When you are present in our eyes, let all those who come within the range of vision of our eyes be rendered immobile. As a result of your presence, if we glance at anyone with our eyes, let the weapons of the soldiers who oppose us be paralyzed. O lord! When we look at them, their weapons will be immobilized. When they are immobile, we will be able to kill the enemy easily.” Earlier, Kikasa’s sons had obtained this boon from Divakara. With this boon obtained, they got ready to move around in the battle. With Surya present in their eyes, they glanced at the Shaktis and their floods of weapons were rendered immobile and futile. Kikasa’s seven sons were spirited. With their *astras* and *shastras* paralyzed, the Shaktis could not exert themselves. Even when they exerted themselves, their weapons were repeatedly immobilized. Overwhelmed, the Shaktis were quietened and sighed. The *daityas* were instructed by their own respective masters.

Finding the opportunity, they raised many kinds of weapons and crushed the Shakti soldiers. Without any weapons, the Shakti soldiers could not repel them. They were agitated, even though their arrows could penetrate thorny armour as firm as the *vajra*. Pierced by the flood of weapons released by the *daityas*, the bodies of the Shaktis exuded blood. In the battle, they resembled sprouts of the Kankola creeper.⁸⁹⁷ Lamenting loudly, they sought refuge with Laliteshvaree. With all their weapons paralyzed, all the Shaktis shrieked.'

'At this, following Devi's command, Devi Tiraskaranikaa, who was the one who protected Dandanathaa from the side, presented herself in the field of battle. She was astride a *vimana* named Tamolipta, which faced every direction. Astride this, Mahamayaa assured the Shaktis that there was no reason to be afraid. She was as dark as a *tamala* tree and was clad in dark armour. She was astride Tamolipta, which cast a dark shadow and was yoked to dark horses. She picked up a bow named Vasanti Mohana, which thundered loudly. She roared like a lion and showered down arrows that were like snakes. They assumed the form of black serpents, resembling the clubs that can be seen on the solar disc. When the arrows were infused with the weapon that caused delusion, the *daityas* were unable to tolerate it. Here and there, Mahamayaa's arrows, whetted on stone, crushed them. The crooked ones, with Balahaka at the forefront, were filled with great rage. Tiraskarini Ambaa⁸⁹⁸ followed Dandanathaa's instructions. She released the great weapon known as *andha*⁸⁹⁹ in the direction of the large numbers of the enemy. The seven, Balahaka and the others, were insolent because of the boon obtained from the maker of the day. But when they were struck by the *andha* weapon, it was as if their own eyes were covered. Devi Tiraskaranikaa seized the great bow known as Mohana and the arrows known as *andha* pierced their eyes. Blinded, those seven could not see anything. When they could not see, the paralysis of the weapons was destroyed. Raising weapons in their hands, they⁹⁰⁰ roared like lions again. Wishing to take revenge against the *daityas*, they got ready to fight. They placed the immensely strong Tiraskaranikaa in front of them. Using that excellent means, they were extremely content in the field of battle. They

exclaimed, “O immensely fortunate one! O Tiraskaranikaa! O Ambikaa! What you have done is praiseworthy. In this place, you have abused the evil-souled enemy. ⁹⁰¹ You are the medication that chastises the eyes of the wicked. You have thus bound the sight of the circle of *daityas*. O Devi! You have carried out the task of the *devas* properly. It was impossible for those like us to defeat them and you have made them face a hardship. There were seven great *asuras* who were wicked in conduct. Hearing that you have killed them, Lalitaa will be filled with great satisfaction. As a result of what you have done, Dandini will be pleased. The immensely fortunate Mantrini will also be filled with great delight. Therefore, in the field of battle, destroy these seven. We will raise our weapons and destroy all their soldiers.” Eagerly, all those Shaktis urged and sent her. She advanced towards Balahaka’s forces, astride the vehicle Tamolipta. Those seven, worst among *asuras*, saw her advancing. At ease, they again remembered the boon granted by Savitar. Since Tiraskarani’s energy covered their eyes, though Savitar entered them, they were incapable of restraining her. The great *asura*, Balahaka, was immensely strong and valiant, blind as a result of his rage and also because of the weapon conferred by the boon. The weapon and the rage made him blind. The divinity who is inside seized him by the hair and used her sword to slice him down. She used an arrow to sever the head of his mount, the vulture. Tiraskaranikaa then advanced in Suchimukha’s direction. With a blow of her spear, she brought down his stiff head. Gradually, she reduced the other five to the five elements. ⁹⁰² The divinity who is inside then used strands of their hair to fashion a garland for her neck, with the heads of the seven *daityas*, and roared. The Shaktis were senseless with rage and killed all the soldiers. Many rivers flowed from this, the blood constituting the water. What Mahamaya Ambikaa did was extremely wonderful. She covered up the eyes of Balahaka’s soldiers. The ones who remained were filled with great terror. Afflicted and shrieking, they sought refuge with the lord of Shunyaka. Some repeatedly praised Dandini and Mahamayaa. Since she cast her favourable glances towards them, they were satisfied. The Shaktis who were present there shook their

heads and uttered words of praise. At every step, they applauded Devi Tiraskaranikaa.'

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Chapter 137-2(25) (Vishanga's flight)

Hayagriva said, 'They had possessed austerities and strength. Hearing that they had been killed, Bhandasura, the great *asura*, sighed like an Indra of black snakes. In private, he summoned his great brothers for a consultation. Bhandasura was terrible in his valour and desired victory in the battle. Along with his younger brother, Vishanga, the heir apparent ⁹⁰³ was also angry. He arrived at the place meant for consultations and prostrated himself before Bhandasura. He ⁹⁰⁴ was extremely agitated. To devise a means to defeat Lalitaa, he held consultations with his ministers, Kutilaksha being the foremost. Bhandasura said, "Alas! The destruction of the lineage of the enemies of the Gods has arrived. The powerful destiny is now acting negligently towards us. When my servants were merely named, the residents of heaven used to flee. Though we were like that, a calamity faces us. Destiny is impossible to cross. It turns a strong person into a eunuch, robs a rich person of his wealth and takes away life from a person with a long lifespan. Where is our spirit and the strength of our arms? Who is this wicked woman, Lalitaa? Destiny is cruel and destiny has done what should not have happened. Sarpini's fierce *maya* made the valour of the generals impossible to cross. However, in the field of battle, they have been brought down. Who is this woman, full of great insolence and *maya*? She has struck us. Shame on our strength earned through the force of our arms. Since my tongue is speaking about this, my tongue is deceitful. How can a woman, evil in insolence, crush my soldiers? Therefore, we must make efforts to cut down her foundations. Through the mouths of spies, I have ascertained her conduct. She remains behind all the extremely strong soldiers. The soldiers, horses, elephants, chariots and others, advance in front of her. This is the right opportunity for someone to strike her from the sides. Vishanga is clever enough to strike her from the sides. Desiring to fight, let fifteen commanders advance with him, those who are senior, proud and intoxicated, invincible and experienced in many battles. Then again, she

doesn't possess too many attendants at the rear. Since she is protected by a few, she can be seized easily. O Vishanga! Hiding yourself, act so as to seize her from the rear. Insolent and proud, you should make many such arrangements. As a result of your valour, take only a few soldiers with you. Let commanders, who have been victorious over the guardians of the worlds, also prepare themselves and advance. Let fifteen *akshouhinis* of soldiers also advance. However, in hidden garb, you must firmly descend on the wicked one and kill her. She is the great foundation of all the Shaktis. Therefore, if she is destroyed, as the foundation, a large number of Shaktis will also be destroyed. They will be like the petals of lotuses floating around in the water, when the tuber has been severed. There is a radiant chariot that is advancing behind all the others. Its body rises ten *yojanas*. It is adorned with a large umbrella, embellished with large pearls, held above it. There are many whisks that fan it from four directions. There are lofty standards that seem to etch out marks on the cluster of clouds. The evil one and tawny-eyed one can be seen to advance on that chariot. She is marked by those signs. In secret, descend on her. Defeat the one who is evil in conduct. Drag her by the hair and crush her. When that spirited army has advanced in front, that woman will only be protected by women and can swiftly be brought under subjugation. There are leaders of soldiers who will be your aides. Listen to the names of those who will attentively help you in this battle. The first is named Madanaka and Dirghjihva is the second. There are Hubaka, Hulumulu, Kaklasa, Kaklivahana, Thuklasa, Pundraketu, Chandabahu, Kukkura, Jambukaksha, Jambhana, Tikshnashringa, Trikantaka and Chandragupta. These are the fifteen and they have been named. Each of them will possess excellent armies, with one *akshouhini* each. These extremely strong commanders, Damana ⁹⁰⁵ and others, will advance with you. You will be a thorn to the enemy, and they should not know about your movements. Act secretly in this way. Act so as to seize her from the rear. In this task, act in accordance with great wisdom. O Vishanga! ⁹⁰⁶ You will obtain excellent success and victory.” Bhandanava, wicked in counsel, thus held consultations with his ministers. He despatched Vishanga, guarded by the commanders.’

‘The *daitya*, the younger brother of the heir apparent, made efforts to seize Shri Lalitaa Devi from the rear. At that time, the sun approached the mountain behind which it set. The first day of the battle, extremely terrible to the worlds, was over. Darkness set in, as if it wished to seize the day. That darkness was smoky, like the shoulder of a buffalo. It was as radiant as the body of a wild boar. The dense darkness was like the blue on a peacock’s throat, and it spread everywhere. It gathered in clumps in the groves and made the intervening points vanish. It seemed to rise from thousands of cavities within the earth. It incessantly emerged from the caverns inside mountains. In some places, where there was a net of illumination from lamps, all its efforts seemed to suffer. However, resembling blue lotuses in the ears of women, it gathered renewed strength. It assembled, like old *diggajas*, as dark as collyrium. It seemed to have struck a pact of friendship with the verdant grasslands. In love, it seemed to embrace the sparkling swords and staffs. It seemed to have secretly penetrated the dark arrays in forests. Gradually, it increased in strength and became greater. The night was like a beautiful woman and its sheen was like that of her blue bodice. The world was shrouded in darkness, and nothing could be discerned. Night increases the strength of the evil *asuras*. Their practice of *maya* is also enhanced at the time.’

‘The immensely energetic Vishanga made his soldiers advance. The spread of darkness seemed to be enhanced by the shade from polished swords. Damana and the other commanders were clad in dark armour. Their head-dresses were dark. All their equipment was dark in complexion. They seemed to become one with the enhanced darkness. They advanced behind Vishanga, who had prostrated himself before his elder brother. He wished to defeat Maheshvari by resorting to deceitful methods of fighting. On his chest, he wore the armour named Meghadambaraka. His attire and everything else were appropriate for fighting in the night. In that way, all the soldiers were clad in dark jackets and other things. There were no sounds of drums being sounded. There was no sound from *mardala* drums. No sounds were made by *panavas*, *anakas*, *bheris* and other musical instruments. Shrouded in that darkness, they advanced in secret.

Unsheathing their swords, they advanced in the direction of the enemy. Lalitaa and her standards were advancing towards the west. Circling through the north, they arrived in the eastern part. At every step, they took care to restrain their breathing. To seize her from the rear, the *danavas* advanced with great care. Some, soft in valour, returned to the front again and asked Lalitaa's soldiers about where her army was stationed. Covering their bodies with armour, they then returned secretly to the rear. They saw the lofty chariot Chakraraja, resembling Meru and Mandara. It was surrounded by the blazing Shaktis. Right in the centre, there was the umbrella, studded with pearls. She was seated astride that, facing the west. She resembled one thousand suns. She was served by Kameshvari and other Nityaas, who were like her in prosperity. On that excellent chariot, they served her, with delightful conversation and pleasures. With great eagerness, she was glancing towards the large army that was in front, with conduct and preparations appropriate for the battle.'

'Vishanga thought that it would be extremely difficult to attack her. With his soldiers, he attacked those who were behind that Indra among chariots. All around, there were the forces of the Shaktis, Animaas and others. Animaas and the others and hundreds of others created a tumultuous sound. Those Shakti forces were cruelly struck with spears, bludgeons, javelins and *bhushundis* and those blows were as firm as that of the *vajra*. Great in spirit and revered in battles, the *danavas* crushed them. As a result of the suddenness of the attack, their bodies suffered from hardship. Having agitated the circle of Shaktis and made them retreat, they approached the chariot. In the darkness, which made it difficult to see, they used arrows to strike. In this way, they stationed themselves on the ninth layer of Chakraratha, Indra among chariots. Their weapons could not be seen. Their armour could not be seen. Shrouding their forms in the darkness, the *danavas* used arrows whetted on stone. Here and there, the circle of Shaktis suffered a lot. Their armour was shattered, and their inner organs were penetrated. Shrieking, they rushed towards Lalitaa. As had happened earlier, they were filled with great fear. They told her what had transpired. Hearing this, Lalitaa was filled with rage. Bhandas were terrible, learned in wicked

counsel. At this time, he sent the immensely energetic Kutilaksha, along with ten *akshouhinis*, so that he could destroy Lalitaa's soldiers in the battle. Kutilaksha fought such a great battle that, on hearing the tumult at the rear, the army that was in front could not return.⁹⁰⁷ In this way, the battle continued on both fronts, in front and at the rear. There was great tumult amidst the Shakti soldiers. In the night, the Indras among *daityas* were full of spirits and were covered in darkness. The Shaktis lost interest and lost their armour. Vishanga and Damana and other excellent commanders harboured high hopes. Their soldiers struck and brought down crores of the enemy. The chariot Chakraraja was encircled by garlands of *daitya* weapons. It seemed as if a king of mountains was encircled by arrays of cranes. The evil-souled Vishanga attacked the lowest layer. Shooting a single arrow, he pulverized Devi's fan, made out of palm leaves.'

'At this sudden attack, the circle of Shaktis was scared. The Nityaas, Kameshvari being the foremost, were filled with great rage. Shri Devi's lotus face showed a slight trace of furrow on the forehead. On seeing this, the Nityaas became extremely anxious and made greater efforts. Each of the Nityaas had the form of a unit of time and each of them was the presiding divinity of a *tithi*. They saw that their empress was enraged and got ready to do battle. They prostrated themselves before Devi, the extensive and great queen. Eager and filled with enthusiasm for the battle, they spoke these faltering words. The Nityaas, the divinities of the *tithis*, said, "O great Devi! O great queen! Your army has been sent on ahead and it is protected by the great Shaktis, Dandini, Mantranathaa and others. Suffering and crushed there, these evil ones have restricted this excellent chariot from the rear. They are skilled in *maya* and deceit. They wish to fight and seize from the rear. The enemies of the Gods have hidden their bodies in the darkness. We will pacify their insolence in an instant. Behold. There are these two Nityaas, Vahnivasini and Jvalamalini.⁹⁰⁸ So that we are able to see the enemies of the Gods, they will provide illumination in the battle. They wish to seize from the rear, but we will quieten their great insolence. We will return swiftly and serve your beautiful lotus feet. O great queen! Command us, so that we can crush these evil-souled ones." Addressed by the Nityaas

in this way, she signified her assent. Nityaa Kameshvari prostrated herself before Laliteshvari. So that she might instantly kill the evil-doers, accomplished in deceitful fighting, she sent her, with her bow strung. She drew this bow, her face as red as the rising sun in anger. “O sinners! Stay. You are devoted to *maya* and deceit. Having obtained this darkness, you are using your skills of deceitful fighting.” Reprimanding them in this way, she took arrows out of her quiver. Her steps faltering because of her anger, she descended from that layer. Other Nityaas, Bhagamalaa being the foremost, also descended from that layer and advanced, their bows strung. Nityaa Jvalamalini and Nityaa Vahnivasini readied themselves for the battle. They used their own energy to illuminate the field of battle. As a result of the illumination, in the field of battle, the bodies of the wicked *danavas* could be seen and they were filled with great rage. There were fifteen Nityaas, Kameshvari and others. Wielding weapons and roaring like lions, as if toying with them, they crushed the *daityas*. A great and tumultuous sound arose in the field of battle. It was as if, agitated by Mandara,⁹⁰⁹ the waves of the ocean dashed against the shore. The powerful Nityaas waged an extraordinary war, as if they were drawing back bows representing the breath of life, with the bangles on their hands tinkling in the course of the battle. The battle continued for three *yamas*.⁹¹⁰ With sharp arrows, the Nityaas destroyed the *akshouhinis*. At first, Kameshi used arrows to kill the wicked Damana. Bhagamalaa mangled Dirghajihva, the commander. Nityaklinnaa and Bherundaa respectively killed Humbaka and Hulumallaka.⁹¹¹ Using hundreds of arrows, Vahnivasaa⁹¹² slew Kaklasa. Using arrows, Mahavrajeshvari shattered Kekivahana. Shivaduti sent Pulkasa⁹¹³ to Yama’s abode. Using her arms, which were like staffs, Tvaritaa tore apart Pundraketu. Nityaa Kulasundarikaa disposed of Chandabahu and Kukkura. For the sake of victory, Nilapatakaa and Vijayaa rendered Jambukaksha and Jrimbhana as offerings in the battle. Nityaa Sarvamangalikaa sliced down Tikshnashringa. Nityaa Jvalamalini killed the fierce Triakarna.⁹¹⁴ Chitraa shattered Chandragupta,⁹¹⁵ evil and colourful in conduct. All the evil-souled generals were killed.’

‘Vishanga was filled with great rage. The powerful one advanced in front. In the last *yama* of the night, only two hours were left. He continued to fight with the Nityaas. But his hopes were dashed and thinking himself to be incapable, he decided to run away. The sharp arrows shot from Kameshvari’s bow shattered his armour. Vishanga was disturbed and his resolution became firmer. With the remaining warriors, he fled. The wicked *danava* was not killed by them, because he should be killed by Dandanathaa’s arrows, which resembled the staff of destiny. At the time when the wicked Vishanga, Bhandas brother, fled, the night was over, and the directions turned clear and favourable again. “It is not proper to pursue heroes who flee from a battle.” At the time, thinking this, the Nityaas refrained from fighting. The bodies of the Nityaas were full of wounds caused by *daitya* weapons and blood flowed from these. But they were proud of their victory and prostrated themselves before Shri Lalitaa Devi. In this way, there was a terrible and great battle at night. The great queen heard what had happened. With eyes full of compassion, she glanced at the forms of the Nityaas, wounded by weapons. As soon as she looked at them, the wounds were healed. Lalitaa was pleased with the valour of the Nityaas.’

Chapter 138-2(26) (Slaying of Bhandas sons)

Hayagriva said, ‘The valiant Kutilaksha had ten *akshouhinis* with him. But he was routed by Dandanathaa’s sharp arrows and ran away. She destroyed ten *akshouhinis* of soldiers in the night. Hearing this account, Bhandas was filled with agitation. On hearing that the wicked enemies of the Gods had resorted to fighting deceitfully in the night, Mantrini and Dandanathaa were dejected. “On account of the *daityas*, Devi has faced a great hardship. Our intelligence was shallow. Therefore, we advanced in front. The forces could not adequately protect the great Chakraratha, Indra among chariots. Therefore, detecting an opportunity, the evil ones caused this hardship during the night. What happened? What did the leaders do in the battle? Who are the other Shaktis who fought against the great *asuras*?’

Since we deviated from the task, how should we act now? What is in Mahadevi's heart?" They worried in this way. Placing Dandanathaa and Mantrini at the head, they advanced towards Lalitaa. When night was over, the circle of Shaktis and all the respected commanders quickly surrounded the Indra among chariots. Mantrini and Dandanayikaa got down from their own vehicles. Marshalling the soldiers below, they climbed up the chariot. Swiftly, they progressively crossed over those nine layers. Wherever they went, the circle of Shaktis properly announced who they were. Mantrini and Dandanayikaa approached the great queen. With their eight *angas* touching the ground, ⁹¹⁶ they informed Devi. "O Ambikaa! We have heard that a great catastrophe took place. Using secret means of the fight, the deceitful *daityas* have caused damage. That evil-souled one is wicked in conduct. He is scared of fighting openly. By using deceitful means, he wishes to obtain success and victory. It is through good fortune that the arrows and other weapons of the wicked enemies of the immortals have not touched our queen's body. That is the reason he is still alive. ⁹¹⁷ O great queen! By resorting to your feet alone, we obtain our strength. That is how all of us are alive and accomplish our objectives. Hence, it is our task to protect your illustrious body. The Indras among *daityas* use *maya* and we should have consultations. In this time of calamity, Bhanda and the others, worst among *danavas*, must be defeated. They should not be allowed to fight deceitfully and should not be allowed to penetrate this army. Therefore, our task is to create a great camp, extending for many hundreds of *yojanas*, to the south of Mount Mahendra. For the sake of protection, a circular rampart made of fire must be fashioned. Our soldiers must be stationed such that the enemy's insolence can be pacified. Let the centre of the encampment be devised such that it only extends for one hundred *yojanas*. Let the entry to the circular rampart of fire be towards the south. This is because Shunyaka, the city of the enemy, is to the south. Many attendants, with upraised weapons, must be stationed at this gate. They will restrain all those who enter and leave. Those stationed there must always be attentive, those who are not lazy and those who do not fall prey to sleep. Those wicked ones wish to engage in deceitful fighting. If this is done, the enemy will then be

incapable of mounting a firm and deceitful attack from there, at the wrong time, at the time of *sandhya* and at midnight. Even if they resort to many kinds of *maya*, the hopes of the *daityas* will be frustrated. Unless this is done, while we look on, they will strike this large army and plunder everything.” Hearing the words of Mantrini and Dandanathaa, Lalitaa spoke, as if shedding pearls from her beautiful and sparkling teeth. “Your counsel is for the good and represents intelligent reflection. This is the eternal path of good policy, followed by those who are accomplished and intelligent. One must first make firm efforts to protect one’s own circle. Great ones who desire victory must act against the enemy’s circle subsequently.” Lalitaa said this to Mantrini and Dandanathaa. She then summoned Nityaa Jvalamalini and spoke to her. “O child! Your form is that of the fire. Your form is that of a garland of flames. Therefore, the task of protecting this great army vests with you. Go and assume the form of a blaze that rises thirty *yojanas*. To the extent of one hundred *yojanas*, surround the ground. Leave an entry that only extends for one *yojana*. Let your body blaze everywhere else. Assuming the form of fire and flames, protect the entire army.” Laliteshvri said this to Nityaa Jvalamalini. She then prepared to proceed to the region that was to the north of Mahendra. That Nityaa’s body always blazed in the form of flames. The presiding divinity of *chaturdashi tithi* signified her assent and prostrated herself. As instructed by her ⁹¹⁸ earlier, she again formed a coiled circle of flames on the ground that was to the north of Mahendra. Her form assumed that of a garland of flames, stretching out in a circle, up to the sky. The soldiers of Mantrini and Dandanathaa and the entire large army of Shaktis entered inside this circle. They were radiant and lost their exhaustion. Dandini placed Rajachakra, ⁹¹⁹ Indra among chariots, in the centre. She placed her own chariot on the left and Shyamalaa’s chariot on the right. Sampadeshi’s ⁹²⁰ chariot was towards the rear and Hayasanaa’s was in front. In this way, all of them were placed around Chakraraja. She placed the fierce divinity named Stambhini at the entry. A blazing staff was her weapon and there were twenty *akshouhinis* with her. Devi Dandanathaa is famous as Vighnadevi. After having protected the camp in this way, when the sun

arose, Potrini ⁹²¹ got ready to fight again. The large army of Shaktis created a tumultuous sound. Roaring loudly, they emerged through the gate in the rampart of fire.’

‘The terrible Bhanda *danava* heard that Lalitaa’s camp had been properly protected in this way. He was again filled with anxiety. He again consulted his advisers, Kutilaksha being the foremost, Vishanga, Vishukra and his own sons. The immensely strong one wished to attack in a single mass and conduct the battle. He called his sons, Chaturbahu being the foremost. They resembled the four oceans. They were skillful in fighting and the *danava* summoned them. Bhanda, terrible in his blazing rage, sent them to fight. The sons numbered thirty. They were gigantic in size and immensely strong. I will describe their names. O one born from a pot! Listen. They were Chaturbahu, Chakoraksha, Chatuhshira as the third, Vajraghosha, Urddhakesha, Mahakaya, Mahahanu, Makhashatru, Makshaskandi, Simhaghosha, Siralaka, Laduna, Pattasena, Purajit, Purvamaraka, Svargashatru, Svargabala, Durgakhya, Svargakantaka, Atimaya, Brihanmaya and the valiant Upamaya. ⁹²² These sons of Bhanda *daitya* were indomitable and evil in intelligence. Their valour was like that of their father. Their forms were like that of their father. They arrived and faithfully worshipped Bhanda’s feet. On seeing them, the *danava*’s eyes were pleased. The destroyer of the lineage addressed them in these proud words. “O sons! On earth, who is your equal? In truth, it is with your help that I conquered the earth earlier. Angry in the course of the battle, you tugged at the hair of Shakra, Agni, Yama, Nirriti and the one who wields the noose. ⁹²³ You know about all the *astras* and *shastras*. Even when you are alive, the lineage faces hardship. There is a wicked woman named Lalitaa. She uses *maya* and is indomitable in battle. She is with many women who are just like her, and they have harmed us. Hence, in the course of the battle, you must certainly act so as to subjugate her. Use your blazing weapons to seize her alive. When you are blind in rage, you are immeasurable, and it is not appropriate to send you against a single woman. However, such is the progress of destiny. You should tolerate this, though this is against your valour and deeds.” Addressing them in this way, Bhanda, Indra among *daityas*, sent

them to the battle. To help them, two hundred *akshouhinis* were sent. These two hundred *akshouhini* soldiers were like a *tilaka* mark.⁹²⁴ With furrowed eyebrows and weapons in their hands, they emerged from the house. When Bhandā's sons emerged, the earth quaked. There were many kinds of evil portents and the world was scared. Those princes were full of great spirits. As they advanced astride their vehicles, along the road, the aged women of the city showered down parched grain in all directions. *Bandis* and *magadhas* praised the princes. At each door they passed, the women of the city did their *arati*⁹²⁵ and pronounced auspicious benedictions. The earth seemed to be shattered and the firmament seemed to be dragged along. The ocean seemed to be churned and whirled around. Bhandā's sons accepted those two hundred *akshouhinis* of soldiers. With cruel faces, foreheads furrowed in rage, they emerged from the city. They roared. Using words meant for heroes, they boasted to each other. "In the battle, in an instant, we will devour all the Shakti soldiers. We will use sharp arrows to pulverize their circle of weapons. Using force, we will pacify the circle of fire that has formed a rampart. Lalitā is haughty in vain. We will swiftly make her a prisoner." Bhandā's sons approached the rampart that was in the form of a fire. As a result of youth and insolence, they were blind. Their vision was clouded, and they furrowed their cruel eyebrows. They roared even more loudly, like lions. Touched by this terrible roar, the cosmic egg seemed to shatter. The force of that terrible roar was like a storm and created a shower of evil portents. This great uproar was heard in the sky.'

'Such a sound had not been heard before and agitated the minds of the Shaktis. Along with their own soldiers, they too started to chatter. They hurled many kinds of weapons, enhancing the radiance of their *vimanas*. Hearing that the princes, Bhandā daitya's sons, had arrived to fight, Balāa was filled with curiosity. She was Lalitā Devi's daughter and always resided near her. She possessed such valour that she was worthy of being worshipped by the entire circle of Shaktis. Her form was like that of Lalitā and this daughter was filled with anger. She was a reservoir of every kind of learning and her form always seemed to be that of nine years of age. Her body resembled the rising sun. Her hips and body were red, and her form

was like that of a creeper. She was always present near the feet of the great queen. It was as if Lalitaa's breath of life was roaming around outside her. She was like her fourth eye. Balambaa ⁹²⁶ decided, "I will quickly destroy Bhanda's sons, who have come." Accordingly, she informed the great queen. "O mother! The sons of the great *daitya*, Bhanda, have arrived at fight. Though I am a young girl, I am filled with enthusiasm and wish to fight against them. My arm is throbbing, as if it is itching to fight. This is my pastime, and you should not destroy it by restraining me. I am a girl, and I am always addicted to pastimes. By sporting in this encounter for a while, my mind will find pleasure." Thus addressed, Devi replied to Kumarikaa. "O child! You are nine years old, and your limbs are delicate. All your attempts are new. You have recently learnt about fighting. Besides, you are my only daughter. Without you, I will not be able to breathe even for an instant. You are my breath of life. Do not advance into this great battle. Dandini and Mantrini are there and there are crores of other Shaktis. In truth, they can fight. O child! Why should you be rash?" In this way, Shri Lalitaa Devi restrained the young girl. However, full of youth and eagerness, she again requested that she should fight. Shri Lalitaa Ambikaa saw that her resolution was extremely firm. Therefore, embracing her firmly with her arms, she granted her permission. She took off a piece of her armour and gave her that armour. From her weapons, she gave her weapons and released her. From the spine of her bow, the great queen created Karniratha. It was yoked to hundreds of swans and Kumarikaa mounted this.'

'When she set out to do battle, the divinities on all the layers joined their hands in salutation. Holding extended swords, they prostrated themselves. When they prostrated themselves, she descended from the excellent Chakraratha. Having descended, she entered amidst the soldiers who were stationed below. Mantrini and Dandanataa saw Kumarikaa advance, red with rage. They were scared and spoke. "O daughter of our leader! Why have you yourself come out to fight? There was no need for the great queen to send you to battle. When the soldiers are present, this is not appropriate for you. You are Shri Devi's daughter, and you are her life personified. You

should withdraw from this fight. We prostrate ourselves before you.”

Though entreated by them in this way, she did not deviate from her firm resolve. Mantrini and Dandanayikaa were filled with great wonder. They too advanced along both sides, so as to protect her. With them following her and with a large number of soldiers, Kumarikaa emerged through the gate in that circle of fire. She was mounted on Karniratha. The Shakti soldiers and their leaders joined their hands in salutation and prostrated themselves. She showed all of them her favours. The scorcher of enemies advanced against Bhandasura's wicked sons. Kumarikaa did not possess any specific soldiers of her own. All Lalitaa's soldiers became her soldiers.’

‘A battle commenced, with exhibitions of extraordinary valour.

Kumarikaa showered down nets of arrows on the Indras among *daityas*. The battle between Bhandasura's sons and the great queen's daughter was so superb that Gods and *asuras* desired to participate in such a clash. The sons of the *daitya* were extremely surprised at this nine-year-old. They saw her astride Karniratha, showering down nets of arrows in every direction. The attendants of the great queen moved around and every instant, informed the great queen what the girl was doing in that great battle. Though Mantrini and Dandanathaa did not leave her side during the battle, they were mere witnesses and their thirst⁹²⁷ was not quenched. Though Kumarikaa was alone, each of the *daitya*'s sons saw her as a different person, like different reflections of the sun. Arrows with fire at their heads pierced their inner organs. Full of rage, her radiant face resembled a red lotus. As they looked on from the sky, the residents of heaven remarked that this was extraordinary. Mantrini and Dandanathaa applauded her in many kinds of ways. Dextrous in the use of her hands, Kumarikaa was thus worshipped in the battle. Throughout the second day of the battle, Lalitaa's daughter exhibited her own prowess in the battle. She countered their weapons with her weapons and pierced all of them. The great queen's daughter then released the Narayana weapon. In an instant, the two hundred *akshouhinis* of soldiers were reduced to ashes. When the *akshouhinis* were instantly destroyed, they were filled with great anger. Easily drawing their bows back, they rushed against her in unison. There was a tumultuous sound

among the Shaktis and the residents of heaven. Kumarikaa simultaneously shot thirty arrows from her bow. Using the dexterity of her hands, she shot arrows with heads like crescent moons. These thirty arrows severed the heads of Bhandaa's thirty sons. In this way, Bhandaa's sons were conveyed to Yama's abode. Extremely astounded, the Gods showered down flowers from the clouds. Thus, the great queen's daughter destroyed the *asura* soldiers. Full of great joy, Mantrini and Dandanathaa embraced her. As a result of her valour, the Shaktis danced and exclaimed "Victory". They uttered tumultuous sounds of praise and filled up the three worlds. Full of joy, all the Shakti commanders, with Dandanathaa at the forefront, went and informed the great queen about this wonderful account. Hearing what they said about the strength of her daughter's arms, Devi Lalitambikaa was filled with delight. Witnessing her valour, the likes of which had never been seen among *devas* before, all the Shaktis were filled with great wonder.'

Chapter 139-2(27) (Gananatha's valour)

Hayagriva said, 'When the sons were destroyed, the Indra among *daityas* was overwhelmed by a fire of grief. He lamented and thought that the lineage had been destroyed. "Alas! O sons! Alas! O ones extensive in qualities! Alas! O ones who were only devoted to me. Alas! O ones who filled my eyes with nectar! Alas! O ones who extended my lineage! Alas! O ones who were devoted to shattering the insolence of all the best among Gods! Alas! O ones who charmed and agitated the hearts of all the women among Gods! Sit on my lap and address me in eloquent and pleasant speech now. Abandoning your father, what happiness have you gone to now? O sons! Without you, my kingdom is no longer charming. My homes are empty. My assembly hall is also empty. O ones who dash hopes! How is it that all of you were killed? You were the budding sprouts of my lineage. The spirit of your arms could not be assailed. How did that wicked woman, alone, kill all of you in the battle? My sources of happiness have been destroyed. The women of the lineage have been destroyed. After this, the

bravery and happiness of my lineage will decay. I obtained you as a result of the good deeds performed by my ancestors. But you have been destroyed today. Therefore, I have also been destroyed. Alas! I face adversity. O sons! I suffer from misfortune.” In this way, with dishevelled hair, he lamented a lot. Having lost heart, he lost his senses and fell down from the throne.’

‘In that assembly, mentioning the crooked working of insurmountable destiny, Vishukra, Vishanga and Kutilaksha comforted Bhandu. Vishukra said, “O lord! Like an ordinary person, why are you succumbing to grief? Your sons have come about their deaths in a great battle, and you are lamenting about them. That is the eternal path, laid down for heroes who follow *dharma*. Therefore, if they have come about their deaths in the course of a battle, it is not proper to lament them. However, there is something about their destruction that impales the mind with a stake. A woman arrived and suddenly killed these excellent warriors in a battle.” Addressed by the *daitya* in this way, Bhandu cast aside grief on account of his sons. He was filled with rage, like the terrible fire of destruction. He unsheathed his fierce sword, which resembled Yama. The pupils of his eyes were dilated and blazed in great energy. “I will now use this sword to shatter that wicked one into fragments. With my relatives, I will exert in the battle.” The letters faltered because of his wrath. He sighed like a serpent. Like a person who was mad, he stood up, raised his sword, and moved around. Scared, all the bulls among *danavas* restrained him. They spoke blazing words full of great wrath, directed towards Lalitaa. “O master! You should not show this kind of respect towards her. Instead, we, with our own forces, should be eager for this fight. The instant we receive your command, we can violently crush the entire universe. What need be said about that deluded woman? Shall we suck up the seven oceans? Shall we agitate mountains? Will we turn the three worlds upside down? Will we shatter all the Gods and rampage their residences? Will we crush the guardians of the directions? O immensely intelligent one! Please command us.” He heard these words, which were full of great insolence and pride. His eyes turned red with rage, and he replied in these words. “O Vishukra! Go to the enemy’s camp. Use *maya* to render yourself invisible. You must create the

great *yantra* known as *yajyavighna*.”⁹²⁸ Hearing his words, Vishukra was filled with wrath. Using *maya* to render his body invisible, he went towards Lalitaa’s army. When he was ready to leave, the sun was about to set. Its rays spread in all directions and turned them red. Full of love, evening advanced towards the sun’s garland. Eager to engage in sexual intercourse, she followed him, to a grove in the nether regions. The sun’s body descended with great force into the ocean and the splash led to foam rising in every direction. A great darkness that was like darkness set in. It assumed the same complexion as the sword the one with evil intelligence had raised. He shrouded himself in that great darkness and was astride a chariot made out of *maya*. With his movements invisible, the deceitful one went to Lalitaa’s army.”

“Having gone there, the evil-minded one saw the blazing rampart that was made out of fire. It extended for one hundred *yojanas*. It blazed all around and rose up into the sky. He approached the southern gate and thought for a moment. He saw the great-spirited ones there, wielding weapons and attentive. They were near the gate, armoured and astride their vehicles. There were Shaktis, Stambhini being the foremost, with twenty *akshouhinis*. Dandanathaa had instructed them to always protect the gate. He saw them and was amazed. For some time, he thought about the matter. Remaining outside the camp, he fashioned the *yantra*. There was an extremely large slab of stone, one *gavyuti* long and one *gavyuti* wide. He drew the excellent *yantra* on that. He drew eight tridents in the eight directions, with the *akshara* of *samhara*⁹²⁹ on the crest. He drew the *yantra*, along with the eight divinities. They were Alasa, Kripaana, Dina, Nitandra, Pramiliika, Kliba and Nirahamkara.⁹³⁰ These are described as the eight divinities. On top of the eight tridents, he etched these eight divinities. Full of *maya*, having etched them, he used a *mantra* to invoke them. Using a *mantra*, he performed the required worship, using goats and other objects as offerings. Evil in intelligence, he stood outside the circle of the camp. In the course of the battle, the *asura* hurled the *yantra* inside the camp. In the course of the battle, hurled from outside, it fell inside the camp. The Shaktis in the camp were affected by the deviations caused by the *yantra*. Dejected

in their minds, they cast aside their weapons and resorted to renouncement. “What do we have to do with killing *asuras*? Enough of *shastras* and *astras*. What fruits will be obtained by achieving success and victory? Why cause violence to beings? That leads to sin. It is for the sake of the immortals. What will happen to us? The uttering of these tumultuous sounds is futile. No fruits are to be attained from fighting. Who is our mistress? Who is the great queen? Who is Dandanayikaa? Who are Mantrini and Shyamaa? Why have we been reduced to this state of being servants? All of us have been reduced to the state of being servants and a single woman has become our mistress. After this, what fruits can we enjoy? What is the need to use weapons and pierce the inner organs of the enemy? Let this clash be pacified. It only leads to our bodies being severely mangled with weapons. Perhaps we will die in the battle and our lives will be in vain. Perhaps we will die while fighting. Isn’t that delusion? There are no fruits from exerting oneself. It is sleep alone that brings happiness. There is nothing that rests the mind as much as laziness. Even if the queen gets to know that we have become like this, what will she do? It is we who have collectively thought of her as a queen. If she is ignored by us, her strength will be destroyed. If the queen loses her senses, how can she possibly chastise us?” In this way, at the commencement of the battle, the Shaktis cast aside their weapons. They wandered around near the gate as if immersed in sleep. In every task, there was great lassitude. In the camp of the Shaktis, everything became extremely lax. Using the great *yantra* of *jayavighna*, the *danava* accomplished all this. As a result of its powers, the camp was penetrated and crushed.’

‘It was midnight on the second day of the battle. Surrounding himself with thirty *akshouhinis*, the *daitya* Vishukra emerged from the city again and arrived at the enemy’s camp. The sounds of him advancing into battle were heard. Nevertheless, inside the camp, the Shaktis showed no enthusiasm. Because of their great sentiments, Mantrini and Dandanathaa were not affected by *jayavighna yantra*. They were filled with worries. “Alas! What is this great calamity and fear that has descended on us? What is the source of this transformation? The soldiers have lost all enterprise.

They have cast aside their weapons and have lost their pride. They are reeling around as if immersed in sleep. They are not paying heed to our words. They are not worshipping Maheshvari. All these Shaktis are no longer interested and have become indifferent.” Thus, Mantrini and Dandanathaa were immersed in thoughts. They ascended the chariot Chakraraja and spoke to the great queen. Mantrini said, “O Devi! Where has this deviation come from? The Shaktis have lost their enterprise. O great queen! They do not listen to your commands, which are followed by the universe. They have lost attachment towards each other. They have withdrawn from all tasks. They have succumbed to sleep and lassitude and speak evil words. ‘Who is Dandini? Who is Mantrini? Who is the great queen? What is the nature of this battle? Why indulge in it?’ While they say this, the immensely strong enemy has arrived. The space between heaven and earth has been shattered by the sound of the war drums. O great queen! This is the nature of what has happened.” Saying this, Mantrini prostrated herself, along with Dandini. At this, Lalitaa Devi glanced towards Kameshvara’s face. As she laughed, the row of her red teeth could be seen. From the radiance of her smile, a divinity manifested himself. His face was like that of an elephant. *Musth* exuded from his temples. His complexion was like that of a *japa* or *patala* flower. The crescent moon was on his body. In his ten large hands, he held a *bijapuraka*,⁹³¹ a mace, a bow made of sugarcane, a beautiful trident, a lotus, a noose, a blue lotus, a clump of *vrihi* for granting boons, *kusha* grass and a bejeweled pot. His stomach was prominent and the moon was on his crest. The sound he made resembled a gentle trumpeting. Siddhi Lakshmi embraced him and he prostrated himself before Maheshvari. She had achieved her objective. The great Gananatha Gajanana emerged speedily, so as to shatter the great *yantra* of *jayavighna*.⁹³² He roamed around inside that camp of women and somewhere, he saw *jayavighna*, fixed in an isolated location. The divinity struck it with a terrible and intolerable blow from his tusks. In an instant, the giant slab of *jayavighna* was shattered. Along with the wicked divinities who were stationed there, that *yantra* was reduced to fragments and flung up into the

sky. At this, the Shaktis created a chattering sound. They gave up their lassitude. With weapons in their hands, they got ready to fight.’

‘The one with a tusk uttered a great roar from within his throat. He destroyed the *yantra jayavighna*, created in the night. Hearing this account, Bhandas were agitated. The tusked one created many who were elephant-faced like him. *Musth* exuded from their temples and this intoxicating fragrance attracted the best of buzzing bees, who seemed to chant songs praising those great ones. Using their trunks, they scattered around sparkling filaments from pomegranate flowers. It seemed as if they were always ready to drink up the oceans, stores of jewels, in their playfulness. They were served by the Shaktis, Riddhi being the foremost. He created six Vighnanayakas, Amogha being the chief. ⁹³³ They were Amogha, Pramodha, Sumukha, Durmukha, Arighna and Vighnakarta. They were the lords of seven crore Herambas. In the battle, all these great Ganapatis marched in front. Those elephant-faced ones emerged from the wall created by fire. Uttering words of *humkara* and roaring loudly in rage, they attacked the *danavas*. The residents of heaven were again deafened by their loud roars. The army of *ganas* descended on the *daitya* soldiers. Using sharp arrows, Gananatha pierced the *danavas*. The immensely energetic Gananatha fought against Vishukra. As they fought, the sound of *humkara* surpassed the sound of the twanging of bows. Vishukra roamed around in the battle and fought with him, furrowing his cruel eyebrows and biting his extremely red lips. There was the sound of weapons clashing against each other, mixed with roars uttered by the enemies of the Gods. There was a sound created by the hooves of the *daitya* horses, resembling the sound created by a large number of spades wielded simultaneously. Indras among elephants trumpeted and this mixed with shrieks of fear. Arrays of horses neighed. The wheels of chariots clattered. The sound of bows being strung mixed with that of the soldiers shouting. Torrents of arrows made a sound and heroes boasted. Those who resembled the great Indra laughed loudly. There were many roars like lions. As the battle continued, these increased and agitated the directions.’

‘The evil-souled Vishukra possessed thirty *akshouhinis* of soldiers. The Gananathas were *maharathas* and fought with each one of them. They coiled them in their trunks and pierced them with their tusks. They shook their ears, which were like *pushkalavarta* clouds, and angered them. The harsh breaths from their trunks flung the foot-soldiers away. Their chests resembled the slopes of mountains, and they crushed them with these. They crushed them with blows of the feet and smothered them with their large stomachs. They pierced them with tridents and using *chakras*, sliced them down. They terrified the armies with loud blares from conch shells. From the mouths of Gananathas, thousands of other elephant-faced warriors emerged. Displaying great enterprise, they reduced all those soldiers to dust. At this, he ⁹³⁴ was filled with wrath. Standing in front of his own soldiers, he sent a Gajasura ⁹³⁵ to fight against the divinity. Evil in intelligence, Gajadaitya roared horribly, like a lion. He was accompanied by seven *akshouhinis* and Ganeshvara fought against him. Vishukra saw that his ⁹³⁶ valour was increasing, while the strength in Gajasura’s arms was declining. He fled. That Indra among heroes, astride his mount of a mouse, moved around alone. He crushed Gajasura, along with his seven *akshouhinis*. Gajasura was killed and Vishukra ran away. From the field of battle, the great Ganapati went to Lalitaa’s presence. Since it was night, there was disengagement and it was a night of destruction for the *daityas*. Lalitaa was delighted at his valour. Pleased, the great queen bestowed on Ganesha the excellent boon of being worshipped before all the other *devas* are worshipped.’

Chapter 140-2(28) (Slaying of Vishukra and Vishanga)

Hayagriva said, 'Bhanda *daitya* heard that his brother, the great *daitya*, had been routed in the battle and that the soldiers had been slaughtered. He was tormented and worried a lot. Bhanda *daitya* sent both his brothers to fight, along with all the soldiers. Instructed by Bhanda *daitya*, both of them were greatly angered. Vishanga and Vishukra made great efforts. Along with his younger brother, Vishukra, the heir apparent advanced, followed by an army that made the three worlds tremble. He was surrounded by four hundred *akshouhinis* of soldiers and this enhanced the great power of the heir apparent. There were ten nephews, Ulukajit and others, born through the womb of Dhumini, Bhanda's sister. Bhanda, their great maternal uncle, had trained them in the use of weapons. As commanders of soldiers, they were brave and strong. They advanced and the twanging of their bows resounded in the ten directions. These nephews enhanced the joy of the two maternal uncles. Each of them was full of great insolence and was astride a vehicle. They followed Vishukra, drawing back the strings on their bows. Vishukra reached the field of battle astride an elephant. As a mark of the heir apparent's radiance, this was adorned with an umbrella and whisks. He was surrounded by soldiers who created a tumultuous sound. The accomplished Vishukra made a terrible roar, like a lion. This agitated the Shaktis and excited their pride. In fixed arrays, they emerged from the circle of fire that created a rampart. As a result of their own rays, they seemed to mark the sky with flashes of lightning. As they raised up their faces to fight, the sky seemed to be covered with rows of red lotuses. Thus, invincible in fighting, Bhanda's younger brothers arrived.'

'Hearing this, Mantrini and Dandanayikaa came to fight simultaneously. They were mounted on Kirichakra and Jneyachakra, ⁹³⁷ crest jewels among chariots. Circular umbrellas were held above them, and they were fanned with whisks. *Apsaras* danced and sang about their greatness. Following Lalitaa's command, the two of them advanced to fight. One hundred

akshouhinis of soldiers had been employed to protect Shri Chakraratharaja. With the exception of these, all the other armies emerged in the direction of the battle, wielding terrible weapons. Dandanathaa marched ahead of them, astride her chariot. In the finger of one hand, she twirled a plough as a weapon. In the other hand, she repeatedly whirled around a pestle. Her lotus face resembled that of a boar. A liquid digit of the moon sparkled on her crest. She was always full of valour and in a battle, she struck from the front. She ⁹³⁸ followed her, mounted on Geyachakra. The sound of her large bow twanging filled up the universe. Her hair was braided and the moon sparkled like a blossom amidst it. With a *tilaka* made of *sindura*, her third eye dazzled. Her beautiful hands were like lotuses and bejewelled bangles rendered them even more beautiful. She was twirling an arrow whetted on stone, which she had drawn out from her quiver. Divine sages danced and uttered words of benediction that were like *amrita*. These mounting pronouncements of “Victory” increased her great delight. The rims on the wheels of Geyachakra, Indra among chariots, clattered. This shattered the surface of the ground and also the hearts of the *daityas*. Celestial women composed songs that charmed the minds of the world and greatly delighted all the worlds. These songs spoke of her fiery glory. There were eight thousand *akshouhinis*, ready to do battle. They resembled the ocean at the end of a *kalpa*, when it transcends all bounds. In her army of Shaktis, some were as radiant as gold. Some resembled pomegranates. Others were as radiant as clouds. Others were as radiant as *sindura*. Still others possessed the complexion of *patala* flowers. The garments of some were divine. For others, they were delicate and dark. Some resembled diamonds. There were others who resembled emeralds. They wielded hundreds of crores of weapons, mixed with the five arrows. ⁹³⁹ As some of them wielded their weapons, the beauty of their bodies was enhanced. There were innumerable Shaktis in Mantrini’s army. O one born from the pot! They advanced and the preparations of these were like those of Dandanayikaa’s soldiers. The ornaments and garments were similar. The signs and power were similar. The possession of good qualities was similar and were other attributes, like the ability to destroy *daityas*, the trait of being worshipped by everyone. All

Dandini's Shaktis resembled the great queen. But, in particular, there was a special sign on Dandini's hand. She wore a ring on her finger, as an indication of the power granted to her by the great queen. In this way, the soldiers of Mantrini and Dandanathaa advanced. The earth suffered as a result of the burden and swung to and fro, like a swing.'

'A tumultuous battle ensued, and it made the body-hair stand up. Particles of water arose and converted the waters of the seven oceans into a slush. Horses fought against horse-riders, chariots against those who were astride chariots. Those on elephants fought against elephant-riders. Using swords, foot soldiers clashed. In that encounter, Dandanathaa fought against Vishanga. Drawing back her bejewelled bow, Shyamaa fought against Vishukra. In the battle, Ashvarudha fought strongly against Ulukajit. Desiring to fight, Sampadishaa⁹⁴⁰ seized Purushena. Desiring to fight, Devi Nakuli challenged Vishena. Mahamayaa fought against Kuntishena. Unmattabhairavi fought against Malada. In the battle, Laghushyamaa fought strongly against Kushura. In the battle, Svapneshi pierced the Indra among *daityas* named Mangala. In the battle, Vagvadini fought against Drughana. Chandakali fought against the wicked Kolata. Hundreds of *akshouhinis* fought against the *daitya akshouhinis*. Senseless with rage, they struck each other in that great battle. As the battle continued, the wicked *danava*, Vishukra, saw that the strength of the Shakti army was increasing, while that of his own army was diminishing. Full of rage, he drew back his heavy bow and released *trishastra*⁹⁴¹ towards all the Shakti soldiers. This blaze was like a forest conflagration and the radiance crushed the army. This was the third day of the battle and only one *yama* had passed since sunrise. When Vishukra released *trishastra*, the Shaktis were agitated. All their senses were afflicted, in particular, the root of the palate. The cavities in their ears turned dry and their limbs became weak. Terrified by the weapon, their bodies dropped down on the surface of the ground. As a result of the fever created by the great thirst, the Shaktis suffered. All their enterprise was countered, and they no longer strived in the battle. Mantrini and Potrini saw that the Shakti soldiers were suffering and were filled with great worries. Suspecting a great calamity, Mantrini, who was on her

chariot, spoke to Dandanathaa, who was also on her chariot, to decide a means of countering this. “O friend! O Potrini! The evil one has used *trishastra* and it has made our soldiers lax. Alas! Such is the progress of destiny. The roots of the palates have dried up. The energy to fight has been lost. The circle of Shaktis is no longer interested in the battle. Not a single one is fighting, not a single one is wielding weapons. Since the roots of the palates have dried up, they are incapable of speaking too. If Maheshvari hears that we have been reduced to such a plight, what will she say? The *daityas* have caused us harm and we must think of a means to counter it. O Potrini! Among the sixteen thousand *akshouhinis*, there is not a single Shakti soldier who is not suffering from the thirst. Since our soldiers have cast aside their weapons, the *danavas* have detected an opportunity. Using that opportunity, they are striking us with their arrows. To make exertions in the battle, you and I must devise a means. There is a cold and large ocean on one of the layers of your chariot. Instruct him to dispel the thirst of all the Shaktis. This thirst is such that it cannot be destroyed by a little bit of water. That ocean of liquor can alone satisfy the Shaktis. Instruct that great-souled one. He will fill them with enthusiasm for the battle. He pacifies all thirst and enhances great strength.” Thus addressed, Dandanathaa was delighted at this excellent means. In the battle, Chakreshvari ⁹⁴² summoned and instructed the ocean of liquor.’

‘His eyes were red with intoxication and his complexion was golden. He was adorned in garlands. Ready to carry out her command, he prostrated himself before Dandanathaa. He divided himself into many parts. Some were red, like the rising sun. Some were dark, like *tapichha*. ⁹⁴³ Some were white in complexion. Some assumed the form of trunks of elephants. There were crores of flows of liquor. Fanned by the wind, the king of oceans showered down these flows, as if from *pushkalavarta* clouds showering down at the end of a *kalpa*. The ocean descended amidst the Shakti soldiers and sprinkled them. Even if one inhales the fragrance, a dead person becomes well and rises up. A weak person becomes strong. The ocean of liquor showered down these flows. These progressive showers of liquor numbered more than one *parardha*. The Shaktis raised up their thirsty

mouths and drank this, rising. Kadamba-vana-vasini ⁹⁴⁴ performed a great wonder. She displayed the dexterity of her hands and shot thousands of arrows, creating a great wall around the Shakti soldiers, so that the shower of liquor did not descend amidst the *daityas*. Everyone was astounded at her deed. Aided by the wind, in the midst of the battle, all the Shaktis drank copiously from the many kinds of flow of liquor and it increased their strength and enthusiasm. On the third day of the battle, this period lasted till the second *prahara*. ⁹⁴⁵ The ocean of liquor constantly showered down flows of liquor and each received what brought pleasure to her mind, with the desired taste— *goudi*, *paishti*, *madhvi*, excellent *kadambari*, *haitali*, *angaleya*, *talajata* liquor, that obtained from a divine *kalpavriksha* tree, those produced from many countries, tasty and fragrant, with auspicious fragrances that brought happiness, delightful and fragrant with *bakula* flowers, with sparkling froth that made a sound, pungent, astringent, sweet, with the desired bitterness, with many kinds of colours, those that pierced, slippery, slightly sour, others that were a mix of pungent and sour, those that healed wounds from weapons, those that fixed broken joints, those that dispelled confusion from fighting, cold, light, those that healed parched lips, those that dispelled torment, *varuni* and those that ensured victory. ⁹⁴⁶ Without any break, for the space of one *yama*, each *yogini* happily drank a flow of liquor that was as thick as Airavata's trunk. ⁹⁴⁷ The Shaktis raised their mouths, closed their eyes and used their lolling tongues to happily drink the liquor. In this way, the ocean of liquor showered down many flows of liquor. Having satisfied them, he assumed a divine form and arrived. The ocean of liquor went before Dandanathaa again and prostrated himself. He addressed her in words that were gentle and deep. "O Devi! O great queen! O Dandanayikaa! Behold. I have satisfied them and the army of Shaktis has assumed a delighted form. Some are dancing and singing, with their girdles tinkling joyously. Some are clapping their hands in front of those who are dancing. Some are laughing and their thick breasts are bouncing as they speak. Because of their happiness, some are slow in movements and are leaning on each other's limbs for support. As they swagger, the girdles and garments are slipping from the hips of some. Some

have risen, armoured. Though they are wandering around, they are without weapons.” In this way, the ocean of liquor pointed to the Shaktis. Seeing this, Dandini was extremely content and spoke to him. “O ocean of liquor! I am very satisfied at what has been ensured with your help. You have removed the impediment and have accomplished a task for the *devas*. From now on, as a result of my favours, at every sacrifice a person performing a sacrifice undertakes in *dvapara yuga*, you will be worthy of being used at sacrifices, such as in the drinking of *soma*. When you have been purified through *mantras*, all the *devas* will drink you at sacrifices. When you have been purified through *mantras*, all the people will drink you at sacrifices. You will bestow *siddhi*, *riddhi*, ⁹⁴⁸ strength, heaven and emancipation. Great people will follow the norms and drink you—Maheshvari, Mahadeva, Baladeva, Bhargava, ⁹⁴⁹ Dattatreya, Vidhatri and Vishnu. Worshipped at a sacrifice, you will bestow every kind of *siddhi*.” Bestowing this boon, she satisfied the ocean of liquor.’

‘Dandini urged Mantrini to swiftly fight again. The battle between Shaktis and *danavas* commenced again. As if toying with them, the Shaktis descended on the army of *daityas*. They were full of joy and their loud laughter shattered the eight directions, the earth and the mountains. Each of them was intoxicated with liquor and their eyes were red. The prosperity of the Shaktis was evident in the radiance of two things—their eyes were red with liquor and their weapons were red with the blood of *daityas*. There was a tumultuous battle between the Shaktis and the enemies of the Gods. It was as if Death was himself annihilating the terrified subjects. Their eyes were red and as a result of the intoxication, their steps faltered. As they uttered brave words spoken by heroes in the course of a fight, their *aksharas* faltered. All their limbs were seen to express their joy and their eyes were as round as *kadamba* flowers. The Shaktis destroyed the soldiers of the heir apparent. Dandini herself destroyed one hundred *akshouhinis* there, Mantrini destroyed one hundred and fifty *akshouhinis*. The eyes of Ashvarudha and others were red with intoxication. They conveyed one hundred and fifty *akshounis* to Death’s abode. In the course of the battle, Turagarohini ⁹⁵⁰ used her extremely sharp goad to crush and kill Ulukajit,

making him a guest of the other world. There were Sampatkari and other Shaktis, leaders of the army of Shaktis. They restrained and checked others, Purushena being the foremost. By the time the sun set, the entire army was destroyed. Shyamalaa, full of rage, fought against Vishukra. In the course of the encounter, Mantrini fought a great battle, using *astras* and counter *astras* that terrified the residents of heaven. The immensely energetic Vishukra used extremely sharp weapons. But she used arrows whetted on stone to progressively shatter his standard, his charioteer, his bow-string and the spine of his bow. She then used the *brahmashiras* weapon, which blazed like the flames of a fire. Using this, she crushed Vishukra and he fell, his body splintered. Intoxicated, Dandanathaa fought against the great *daitya*, Vishanga. She used a terrible club to fight and struck him with this. However, that wicked *danava* also used a club that resembled Kala's staff. Wielding this in his hand, he fought an extremely terrible battle. As the duel with clubs continued, they joyously struck each other on their limbs. Their horrible laughter was loud, and they circled. As they swiftly circled, they exhibited many kinds of movements. They repeatedly confounded each other by striking each other with their staffs. Both of them were great and they sought out each other's weaknesses and struck each other. As the great clubs and the tips of the staff clashed, the sound agitated the firmament. Dandini and the crest of *daityas* were unassailable and they fought. This battle continued until midnight. Dandanayikaa became angry and got ready to kill Vishanga. She pierced the enemy's head with her club and dragged him. Potrini then dealt him a hard blow with her club. As a result of the blow of the club, the great *asura* gave up his life. His body shattered into one hundred fragments and he fell on the ground. Mantrini and Dandanayikaa accomplished this great deed. They spent the rest of the night near the camp.'

Chapter 141-2(29) (Slaying of Bhandasura)

Agastya said, ‘O one with a horse’s face! O immensely wise one! You have described Mantrini’s strength. In the course of the battle, you have described how Dandanathaa killed Vishanga. I wish to hear about the valour shown by Shri Devi in the course of the battle. On hearing about the calamity that befell his brother, what did Bhandasura do? What was his enthusiasm for the clash? Who did he fight against? When his brothers and sons were killed, who were his aides?’

Hayagriva answered, ‘O immensely wise one! Listen. This destroys all sins. This is Lalitaa’s sacred account, and it bestows *anima* and the other qualities. If this is recited at the time of *vishuva sankranti*, the transition between *ayanas* and at auspicious times like the five *parvas*, it bestows *siddhi* and destroys all sins.’ ⁹⁵¹

‘At the time, Bhandasura heard that his own brothers had been killed in the battle. He was overwhelmed by great grief and lamented. His hair was dishevelled. He lost his senses and fell down on the ground. Afflicted by grief on account of his brothers, he did not find any comfort. He lamented repeatedly. Kutilaksha assured him repeatedly. Though full of grief, he became wrathful. His extremely cruel eyebrows were furrowed, separating the hair on both sides of his head. His eyes were as red as burning coal. He sighed like a black serpent. He addressed Kutilaksha, the commander of all the soldiers, in these words. He repeatedly touched his sword and whirled it around. He roared loudly in rage and his roar resembled the clash of thunder from clouds. “It is evident that she has used the strength of *maya* to fight and kill my brothers, my sons and thousands of commanders. I will use the blood that originates from the throats of those wicked women and use that to quench the great fire of grief, arising on account of my brothers and my sons. O Kutilaksha! Go and prepare the soldiers.” Saying this, between his arms, he wore tough armour capable of withstanding a blow from the *vajra*. He fastened two quivers on his back. He brandished his firm bow and the twanging of its bowstring was as harsh as his breathing. As

angry as the fire of destruction, he emerged from his own city. He placed Talajangha and others at the eastern gate. The four kinds of forces were with them. They were armoured and wielded weapons. There were thirty-five commanders, Kutilaksha being the foremost. Kutilaksha was the leader of all the generals, and he was also angry. There were forty excellent generals who united with Bhandasura.⁹⁵² Their weapons blazed. Their hair blazed. They emerged, their armour blazing. There were two thousand *akshouhinis*, with eighty-five forming the rear guard. Bhandasura marched out, along with all the soldiers. They followed him, to playfully sport with enemies and destroy them. Only women were left in the city of Shunyaka. The excellent chariot of the *maharatha* Indra among *daityas* was named Abhila. One thousand lions were yoked to this and ready to fight, he ascended this. On that excellent chariot, he blazed, resembling the dazzling fire of destruction. His sword was named Ghataka and it resembled a *chandrahasa*.⁹⁵³ As the soldiers marched here and there, dust arose. Unable to bear the burden, it was as if the earth headed to heaven, in search of protection. The earth was insufficient to handle the march of some and they marched, following a path along the sky. Some *maharathas* marched while riding on the shoulders of others. The directions and the earth's globe could not be discerned, nor could the sky. It was as if they marched with great difficulty, unable to bear contact with each other. Given the large number of soldiers, some were crushed under the wheels of chariots. Some were trampled by the feet of elephants and fell on the ground. In this way, all the soldiers marched together. Their roar was like the thundering of clouds or the clash of thunder. A roar arose through Bhandasura's mouth and it seemed to shatter the world. He repeatedly roared in that harsh tone, like a lion. The oceans were dried up and the sun and the moon seemed to run away. The stars fell from the firmament and the earth seemed to rock. The *dignagas*⁹⁵⁴ were terrified and the residents of heaven lost their senses.'

'The armoured Shaktis were scared and agitated. In the midst of the battle, they sustained their lives in some fashion. The Shaktis had cast aside their weapons out of fear. But they picked them up again. The area outside the rampart of fire had been serene but was woken up again. The Indra

among *daityas* roared like a lion. The bows of the generals twanged. The warriors shouted and the world was filled with sound. From that loud sound, Devi Lalitaa decided that Bhandaa *daitya* had emerged and prepared to fight herself. Taking the other Shaktis to be incapable, she decided to participate in the great battle herself. After all, the wicked Bhandaa *daitya* had himself decided to take up the fight. Her great chariot, Chakraraja, advanced. The four *Vedas* were its four wheels. The *purusharthas* were the large horses. The chariot possessed nine layers and bliss was the standard attached to it. There were Devis on the nine layers and they drew back their heavy bows. They were surrounded by a large retinue, numbering more than one *parardha*. At each position on every layer, they protected all the directions. The chariot was ten *yojanas* high and its expanse was four *yojanas*. The great queen's Chakraraja, Indra among chariots, advanced. As it advanced, so did the chariots of Shyamaa and Dandanathaa. Geyachakra advanced at the front of the army and Kirichakra was at the rear. The vehicles of the other Shaktis numbered one *parardha*. They advanced on mounts that were man-lions, camels, donkeys, predatory creatures, deer, birds, horses, elephants, *bherundas*, *sharabhas*, tigers, *vatamrigas*⁹⁵⁵ and similar other inferior species. There were superior and inferior Shaktis, ready to fight against Bhandasura. The length of the gate, from the rampart made out of the wheel of fire, was one *yojana*, but it was not sufficient for all the commanders. Nityaa Jvalamalinikaa extended the dimensions of the gate, to cater to all the soldiers who wished to emerge. The extremely great mother of the universe was the great queen. The powerful one emerged from that circle of fire, through that excellent gate. The drums of the *devas* were sounded and flowers were showered down. The umbrella, decorated with large pearls, was seen to shine in the firmament. Amidst Lalitaa's soldiers, all the portents were pleasing, indicating victory and prosperity. However, amidst the army of the enemy, there were evil portents.'

'A battle commenced between the two groups of soldiers. As arrows were shot, a blinding darkness enveloped and covered them. The heads of the *daityas* were covered in white umbrellas. As elephants were killed inside that darkness, drops of blood flowed and bore away these heads. The

directions could not be seen, nor the sky. The mountains could not be seen, nor the earth. Nothing could be seen. All that could be seen was the dust. It covered everything. As the soldiers fought against each other, rivers of blood flowed. Headless torsos danced, appearing like trees along the banks. The hair from thousands of *daityas* constituted moss and delicate sprouts. The circles of white umbrellas were as radiant as white lotuses. The feet of elephants, severed by *chakras*, resembled a series of tortoises. The throats and cheeks of large *daityas*, killed by Shaktis, were like heaps of rocks. Whisks fell, severed from their handles, and resembled foam. There were masses of sharp swords, resembling dense creepers along the banks. There were arrays of shining eyes, from slain *daitya* heroes, resembling pearls. The large number of *daitya* mounts were like hundreds of fish and crocodiles. In this way, the terrible battle continued, causing terror to Death itself. This was the fourth day of the battle, starting in the morning and the soldiers fought against each other for two *praharas*.’

‘After this, in the course of the battle, Shri Lalitaa Devi attacked Bhanda. The clash, with weapons and counter-weapons, was terrible, causing tumult and agitation. Bow strings slapped against palms. There were extremely terrible roars. There were sounds created by arrows while taken out of quivers, while affixed to excellent bows and while released. In that terrible battle, arrows that took away lives were shot. The great queen shot arrows from her lotus hands. As a result of the force and dexterity of her hands, nothing could be seen. O one born from the pot! Listen. I will tell you everything about the clash. When one arrow was fixed to the bow, it became ten when it was released. It became one hundred in the sky and one thousand by the time it reached the *daitya* soldiers. Whetted on stone, when they touched the limbs of *daityas*, each arrow turned into crores. The great queen used arrows to create a darkness that penetrated the space between heaven and earth. She used great arrows to pierce the vital organs of the terrible ones. The eyes of Bhanda *danava* turned red with great rage. He showered down a great net of arrows towards Laliteshvri. He released the great weapon known as *andha-tamisraka*.⁹⁵⁶ Maheshvri severed it with the arrow of *maha-tarani*.⁹⁵⁷ In the battle, the immensely brave Bhanda

released *pakhandastra*.⁹⁵⁸ The mother of the universe released *gayatri astra* and severed it. Bhandā released *andhastra*,⁹⁵⁹ which could destroy the vision of Shaktis. She pacified it with the great weapon of *chakshushmat*.⁹⁶⁰ In the great battle, Bhandā released the weapon known as *Shakti-nasha*.⁹⁶¹ Using the weapon known as Vishvavasu, she robbed it of its insolence. Enraged, Bhandā *danava* released *antakastra*.⁹⁶² She destroyed its strength with the weapon of *maha-mritunjaya*.⁹⁶³ Bhandā released the weapon known as *sarvastra-smriti-nasha*.⁹⁶⁴ Chakreshi destroyed its strength with the weapon known as *dharana*. Bhandā released *bhayastra*,⁹⁶⁵ which caused fear to the Shaktis. The mother of the universe released *Aindrastra*, which grants freedom from fear. The *danava* released *maharogastra*,⁹⁶⁶ directed against the Shakti soldiers. Thousands of ailments, pulmonary consumption and other ailments, manifested themselves. To obtain success in countering it, Lalitā Parameshvari released a great weapon, consisting of a great *mantra* with the three names.⁹⁶⁷ Achyuta, Ananta and Govinda arose from the arrow. Through their *humkara* alone, they burnt down the diseases and ensured that all was well. They prostrated themselves before Maheshani and she ordained that they would be used in the three worlds to crush all ailments devotees suffer from. Thus engaged, they left for their own abodes. Bhandā *danava* released the weapon of *ayurnasha*.⁹⁶⁸ The queen released the weapon of *kala-samkarshani*.⁹⁶⁹ Bhandā *danava* released the terrible weapon of *mahasurastra*.⁹⁷⁰ Thousands of them were born, giant in form and immense in strength. There were Madhu, Kaitabha, Mahishasura, the *daitya* Dhumralochana, the two *asuras* Chanda and Munda, Chikshubha,⁹⁷¹ Chamara, the *asura* Raktabija, Shumbha, Nishumbha, the extremely strong Kalakeyas and Dhumra and others. All these excellent *danavas* arose from the weapon, with their tough weapons. They roared in hideous tones and crushed the Shakti soldiers. Crushed by the *daityas*, the Shaktis shrieked and lamented. They swiftly sought refuge with Lalitā and pleaded, “Save us. Please save us.” Devi became extremely angry. She laughed loudly in her rage.’

‘At this, an illustrious one named Durgā arose. Her form was devised from the energy of all the *devas*. The universe was her form. The wielder of

the trident ⁹⁷² gave her a trident. The wielder of the *chakra* ⁹⁷³ gave her a *chakra*. Varuna gave her a conch shell and the bearer of oblations ⁹⁷⁴ gave her a javelin. In the great battle, Marut ⁹⁷⁵ gave her a bow and two inexhaustible quivers. The wielder of the *vajra* gave her the *vajra*. Dhanada ⁹⁷⁶ gave her a goblet. Kala gave her a great staff. The wielder of the noose ⁹⁷⁷ gave her a noose. Brahma gave her a water pot, while Airavata gave her a bell. Mrityu ⁹⁷⁸ gave her a sword and a shield. The ocean gave her a necklace. Vishvakarma gave her radiant ornaments. Her limbs dazzled, like thousands of suns with their rays. This made all the weapons shine even more. Others bestowed beautiful equipment on her. Astride her mount, the lion, Narayani advanced to fight. She brought down *danavas*, the one known as Mahisha and others. This was the task earlier undertaken by Chandikaa, as described in *Saptashati*. ⁹⁷⁹ Similarly, in this battle, she destroyed the insolence of Mahisha and the others. Having performed this extremely difficult task, she prostrated herself before Lalitaa.’

‘The wicked *danava* released *mukastra* ⁹⁸⁰ towards the Shakti soldiers. The origin of the universe released the weapon named *maha-vagvadini*. ⁹⁸¹ In the battle, the indomitable Bhandaa *danava* released a weapon that created worst among *asuras*. They stole the *Vedas*, which are the form of learning. Using the nail on the thumb of her right hand, the great queen chastised them. In the battle, the immensely brave Bhandaa *daitya* released *arnavastra*. ⁹⁸² This filled everything up with water and the Shakti soldiers submerged in this. Shri Lalitaa used the nail on the index finger of her right hand. She created the primordial Kurma, extending for one *yojana*. He held them up on the shell on his back, which was like a large skull. The Shaktis were filled with delight and gave up their fear of the weapon that created an ocean. The illustrious one drank up all the water in the ocean. The wicked *danava* released the great weapon, Hiranyaksha. ⁹⁸³ Thousands of Hiranyakshas were generated from this, wielding clubs as weapons. Struck by them, the Shakti soldiers were terrified and agitated. They were scattered here and there and became lax in pursuing the war. Shri Lalitaa used the nail on the middle finger of her right hand. A great Varaha arose from this, and he resembled Kailasa. He used his snout, which was as tough as the

vajra, to rout them. Crores of Hiranyakshas were crushed and conveyed to their destruction. At this, Bhanda furrowed his eyebrows in great rage. Hiranyas, ⁹⁸⁴ numbering crores, were generated from this furrowing. They blazed like dazzling suns and their weapons also blazed. They crushed the Shakti soldiers and also crushed Prahlada. For the Shaktis, this Prahlada was the mark of supreme bliss. Though he was only a small boy, he was oppressed by Hiranya. He sought refuge with Lalitaa and the queen showed him her compassion. She wished to protect Prahlada, who was bliss personified for the Shaktis. Therefore, Maheshvari twirled the tip of the ring finger on her right hand. Janardana arose from this, with the face of a lion and the torso of a man. His three eyes blazed and he shook his thick mane. Talons were his weapons and he laughed out aloud, terribly, assuming the form of Rudra, the destroyer. He followed Lalitaa's command. From Bhanda's furrowed eyebrows, thousands of terrible Hiranyakashipus had originated earlier. Using his talons, which were as firm as the *vajra*, he shattered them in an instant. The great *asura*, Bhanda, then released the extremely terrible Balindra ⁹⁸⁵ weapon towards Lalitaa Devi. This was capable of destroying all *devas*. From the tip of the little finger on the right hand of the immensely energetic great queen, thousands of Vamanas originated, so as to destroy the insolence of that weapon. They were immensely strong and increased in number every instant. They held nooses in their hands. They used these nooses to restrain and bind all the Balindras who had originated from the weapon. Kamesha's beloved created them from the tip of the little finger on the right hand. They were gigantic in size and great in the endeavour. They destroyed that weapon. In the field of battle, Bhanda *daitya* released Haihayastra. Thousands of Arjunas were generated from this and each possessed one thousand arms. ⁹⁸⁶ From the nail on the thumb of Shri Lalitaa's left hand, Bhargava Rama arose. He blazed in rage and roared like a lion. Using his sharp and tough battleaxe, he splintered them. In an instant, the one thousand Arjunas were annihilated. Bhanda *daitya* became angry and roared in his rage. Ravana arose from this roar, holding a *chandrahasa* sword in his hand. He was surrounded by one thousand *akshouhinis* of soldiers. Taking his younger brother,

Kumbhakarna, and son, Meghnada, with him, he crushed the Shakti soldiers and flung them far away. From the nail on the index finger of Shri Lalitaa's hand, Rama originated, wielding his bow. Lakshmana was with him. His crown consisted of matted hair. Creepers were used to bind his quivers on his back. He was dark in complexion, like a blue lotus. He repeatedly twanged his bow. Using divine weapons, he destroyed the *rakshasa* soldiers in an instant. He crushed Poulastya ⁹⁸⁷ and his brother, Kumbhakarna. Lakshmana destroyed the immensely brave Meghanada. Bhandu *danava* released the immensely terrible *Dvividashtra*. ⁹⁸⁸ Many monkeys, possessing tawny eyes, were born from this. Their faces were coppery with rage and each one of them was Hanuman's equal. They uttered cruel roars and destroyed the Shakti soldiers. From the nail on the middle finger of Shri Lalitaa's left hand, Talanka manifested himself. His middle eye was red with rage. The garment on his limbs was blue and he sparkled like Kailasa. He destroyed all the monkeys who had originated from *Dvividashtra*. The immensely strong one released the great weapon known as *rajasura*. Many *danavas* who were kings originated from this weapon. They were Shishupala, Dantavakra, Shalva, the king of Kashi, Poundraka Vasudeva, Rukmi, Dimbhaka, Hamsaka, Shambara, Pralamba, Banasura, Kamsa, the wrestler Chanura, Mushtika, Utpalashekhara, Arishta, Dhenuka, Keshi, Kaliya, Yamalarjuna, Putanaa, Shakata and Trinavarta. There were other *asuras* too. There was the immensely valiant one, known as Naraka. There was the *asura* Mura, who assumed Vishnu's form. Many other soldiers arose, holding weapons in their hands. To destroy all of them, from the nail on the ring finger of Shri Devi's left hand, the eternal Vasudeva arose. He assumed Chaturvyuha, with four forms—Vasudeva, Samkarshana is said to be the second, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. ⁹⁸⁹ All of them raised their weapons. They destroyed all those evil-doers, who increased the burden of the earth. They destroyed all those great *asuras*, who had disguised themselves under the garb of lords of the earth. When they were destroyed, Bhandu *danava* became angry. He released the terrible *kalyastra*, ⁹⁹⁰ which causes transgressions in *dharma*. Kings were born from *kalyastra*—Andhras, Pundras, Kiratas, Shabaras, Hunas and Yavanas. They were

wicked in conduct, causing disturbances in the *Vedas*. They were against *dharma* and caused violence to life. They mixed up *varnas* and *ashramas* and their limbs were filthy. They repeatedly crushed Lalitaa's army of Shaktis. From the nail of the little finger on Shri Lalitaa's left hand, which was like a lotus, Janardana originated, under the name of Kalki. He was astride a horse and blazed in his prosperity. He laughed loudly. The sound of his laughter was like a bolt of thunder. All the Kiratas lost their senses and were destroyed. The Shaktis were delighted. Those ten *avataras* performed an extremely difficult deed. They stood there, joining their hands in salutation, and prostrating themselves before Lalitaa. In every *kalpa*, so as to protect *dharma*, Matsya and the others take birth. Engaged by Lalitaa Ambaa to do this, they left for Vaikuntha.'

'When all these weapons were destroyed, his hopes were also dashed. He released the weapon *mahamoha* ⁹⁹¹ and the Shaktis lost their senses. Ambaa released Shambhavastra ⁹⁹² and destroyed the weapon *mahamoha*. In that great battle, there was a torrent of weapons and counter-weapons. The sun was about to set behind Mount Asta ⁹⁹³ In the course of the battle, Devi Lalitaa Ambikaa used Narayanastra to reduce all the *akshouhinis* to ashes. The great queen then used Pashupatastra, which blazed like the fire of destruction. This crushed the forty commanders. With all his relatives killed, the wicked one was the only one who was left. The great *asura* had caused havoc to the universe. Bhandu possessed great spirits and was terrible in valour. He blazed in rage. Lalitaa Kameshvari used the weapon Mahakameshvara, which possessed the splendour of one thousand suns. Using this, the mother robbed him of his life. The flames from that weapon destroyed the habitation of Shunyak, along with the women and the children, the settlement of cows, the wealth and the grain. Everything was suddenly burnt down and the ground alone remained. When Bhandu was destroyed, the three worlds danced in delight. She was unblemished in deeds and accomplished the task of the Gods in this way. Astride the handsome chariot of Chakraraja, she blazed in her glory. Kameshvari is the mother of the three worlds. Her excellent victory and prosperity made her shine even more. All the soldiers were exhausted as a result of the clash.

They had been tormented and had suffered because of Bhandasura's powerful arrows. When the sun set, famous for her powers, Shri Devi brought them to the camp. O one rich in the wealth of austerities! If a person reads about the slaying of Bhandasura *danava* and the deeds accomplished by Lalitamba Amba, even once, all his hardships are destroyed. He will accomplish the eight *siddhis*. Enjoyment of objects of pleasure and emancipation will be in the palm of his hand. This account of Lalitamba's valour is sacred. It destroys all sins and accomplishes all the *siddhis*. If a man reads this on auspicious days, good fortune and excellent prosperity serve him.'

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Chapter 142-2(30) (Madana's rebirth)

Agastya said, 'O one with a horse's face! O immensely wise one! I have heard this excellent account described by you, especially concerning Lalitaa Devi's valour. O one with a horse's face! I am extremely happy at having heard about Shri Devi's unblemished conduct and the two great Shaktis, Mantrini and Dandanathaa. O one with a horse's face! When the night of the fourth day passed, what did Ambikaa do, after the battle was over?'

Hayagriva answered, 'O one born from the pot! O wise one! Hear about the conduct of the mother of the universe, after the task of killing Bhanda *danava* had been completed. Her eyes flowing with *amrita*, she repeatedly delighted all the Shakti soldiers who had suffered on account of the *daitya* weapons. Through the sidelong glances of Lalitaa Parameshi, which showered *amrita*, the Shaktis got rid of exhaustion caused by the battle and their minds were delighted. At this time, the *devas* were content at Bhanda having been crushed. All of them, with Brahma and Vishnu at the forefront, arrived, so as to serve her. All of them arrived and joyously praised Maheshvari seated on the throne—Brahma, Vishnu, Rudra, Shakra, the residents of heaven, the Adityas, the Vasus, the Rudras,⁹⁹⁴ the Maruts, the Sadhya *devas*, the *siddhas*, *kimpurushas*, *yakshas*, Nirriti and others who roamed around in the night, Prahlada and other great *daityas* and all those who resided in the cosmic egg.'

'Brahma and the others said, "I prostrate myself before you. O single protector of the universe! I bow down. O one who is known by the name of Shri Tripuraa! I prostrate myself before you. I bow down. O destroyer of the great *asura* Bhanda! I prostrate myself before you. O Kameshvari! O Vamakeshi!⁹⁹⁵ I prostrate myself before you. O *chintamani* jewel! O one accomplished in thinking about bliss! O one who cannot be thought of! O one whose garlands are waves of eternal forms! O one with colourful garments! O origin of the wonderful universe! O one known as Chitraa! O eternal one! O bestower of happiness! I prostrate myself before you. O

bestower of *moksha*! O one with the charmed moon on your crest! O one with the charming smile! O one accomplished in dissipating delusion! O Ishvari of *mudras*! O one discussed in texts on royal policy! O one who loves *mudras*! O Devi! I prostrate myself before you. I bow down. O one who destroys the cruel Death! O one with the delicate limbs! O one who assumes the body of Kali in her rage! O one with the face of a boar! O protector of the large number of soldiers! O one who accepts everyone on your lap and dispels fear! I prostrate myself before you. O Devi with the six *Vedangas* as attendants! O Krishnaa! O one who is sought out in the words of the six *Vedangas* and the *shruti* texts! O one established in six *chakras*! ⁹⁹⁶ O one with the six waves! ⁹⁹⁷ O one with the six forms and sentiments! ⁹⁹⁸ O Lalitaa! I prostrate myself before you. O Kamaa! ⁹⁹⁹ O Shivaa! O foremost among everything eternal! O one seated on a beautiful throne! O one with large eyes resembling the petals of a lotus! O bestower of everything desired! O Kamini! O one desired by the desired Shambhu! O lord of all the *kalaas*! I prostrate myself before you. O first among divine herbs! O one with a form as groups of cities! O divine one! O one with the radiance of one thousand suns! O radiant one! O one who is compassionate, along with her lord! O one loved by the lord of all the *devas*! I prostrate myself before you. O one who always deserves to be served by *anima* and the other *siddhis*! O one who is Sadashiva's *atman*! O one who resides on a resplendent couch! O refined one! O one whose feet are always worshipped by the virtuous! O origin of the worlds! I prostrate myself before you. I bow down. O one who is served by large numbers of *matrikas*, Brahmi being the foremost! O one loved by the *brahman*! O one who severs bonds for *brahmanas*! You are the royal swan who swims in the *amrita* flowing from the *brahman*. O Brahmeshvari! O Shri Lalitaa! I prostrate myself before you. O one who is served by all the *mudras*, Samkshobhini being the foremost! ¹⁰⁰⁰ O destroyer of *samsara*! O one who enacts pastimes in *samsara*! O one with eyes like lotuses! O Lalitaa! O one who presides! I always prostrate myself before you. O eternal one! O one who alone represents the sixteen *kalaas*! You attract the lord through your name alone. You deserve to be served by the *pramathas*. O eternal one! O

compassionate one, who ensures that *prapancha* is free from fear! O one with tresses of dark hair! I prostrate myself before you. I bow down. O Devi, who deserves to be served by Ananga's numerous attendants, Anangapushpa being the foremost! O destroyer of the inauspicious! O one with a form in the groups of *aksharas*! O slayer of groups of enemies! O Lalitaa! I prostrate myself before you. O pervasive one, blazing in great resplendence! O one who is surrounded by a garland of fourteen waves, Samkshobhini being the foremost! You are resplendent in your own *atman*. O one with the excellent radiance! O refuge of the auspicious! O one with the auspicious stride! I prostrate myself before you. O one who deserves to be worshipped by the *siddhas*, along with Sharva, and the Shaktis! O one whose lotus feet are known by Sarvajna! ¹⁰⁰¹ O one who surpasses everything! O one who goes everywhere! O bestower of all the *siddhis*! O Shri Lalitaa! I prostrate myself before you. O Devi, the refuge of all those who first originated from Sarvajna! O one who resorts to forests in this circle of the earth! O one who fulfils the wishes of all the immortals! O origin of all the worlds! Protect me. I worship the one who appears in various forms of speech, *vashini* ¹⁰⁰² and the others. O one who enhances the resplendence of Vishnu's *chakra*! O one who brings resplendence! You possess hair that is as dark as the clouds. O ocean of speech! O bestower of boons! O beautiful one! Save the universe. O empress! O possessor of arrows and other divine weapons! O one who burnt down Bhandasura's soldiers, like a forest blaze! O one who is exceedingly fierce in energy! O ocean that blazes! You deserve to be served, all around. I prostrate myself before you. O Kameshi! O Vajreshi! O Bhageshi! O one without a form! O maiden! O *kalaa*! O one accomplished in eliminating Kala! O one who reduced the *daitya* soldiers to a mere account! O one loved by Kamesha! O Kamalaa! I prostrate myself before you. O one established in *bindu*! ¹⁰⁰³ O one who assumes the form of *bindu* and *kalaa*! O one whose *atman* is *bindu*! O one who extends and illuminates consciousness! O one with a necklace swinging over thick breasts, with tips like lotus buds! O one with extensive powers! O Lalitaa! I prostrate myself before you. O one who always dwells on Kameshvara's lap! O one whose *atman* is Kala! O Devi!

Please display your compassion. At the end of the *kalpa*, you rise up in the form of Kali. O bestower of desires! O Kalpalataa! ¹⁰⁰⁴ I prostrate myself before you. You are with Varuni. The nectar of your glance is as cool as the moon's beams. O one with eyes like a fawn! O one with a face like a lotus! O essence of all essences! You alone are like the entire earth. O Vidyeshvari! I show obeisance to you. You originated from the fire of consciousness. You were made manifest by Shri Shambhunatha. It is through your powers that Bhandasura and other terrible ones have been killed. The thorns of the universe have departed. Floods of your nectar of compassion have made everything assume new forms. You have delighted the world and given it new life. You can be obtained by those who are civilized. He is the form of Shri Shambhunatha's second flow of energy. ¹⁰⁰⁵ He is in the state of Sthanu, which you yourself have arranged. Separated from Sati, he is bereft of attachment. He is indifferent towards enjoyment. We sought to unite him with the maiden Umaa, born in the lineage of the mountain. Hence, when he was engaged in extremely terrible austerities, we sent Smara. He became angry at an impediment being caused by his indifference and austerities. The fire that arose from his forehead burnt Madana down. Bhandasura was born from the remaining ashes. He was invincible in battle. However, his wishes were dashed, and he was killed by you. He has become Atanu ¹⁰⁰⁶ for our sake and we should quickly revive Kama. Separated from her husband, this Rati ¹⁰⁰⁷ is depressed. She is suffering greatly from the unfortunate state of being a widow. O Shri Lalitaa! If you bring Kama back to life, she will again be united with her lord. When the one with the moon on his crest ¹⁰⁰⁸ sees you, Manobhava ¹⁰⁰⁹ may be able to charm him, as he had done earlier. Parvati has undertaken austerities for a very long period of time. Perhaps Isha will wish to marry her. Kumara will be born from their union, and he will be the commander of all the armies of the Gods. In a battle, that brave one will kill the king of the enemies of the Gods, named Taraka. He is a friend of Bhanda *daitya*, who harboured impossible hopes. For the three worlds, he is like a meteor. When Shrikantha's son kills him in a battle, we will get our lives back again. O Ambaa! O Tripuraa! The brave and noble Manmatha's pride should be

restored. You should devise a means so that Rati's miserable state of widowhood is countered. The agitation has led to her hair being dishevelled. Without a protector, she has sought refuge with you. As a result of her husband's destruction, her body has become as thin as a stick. O one known as Tripuraa! She is prostrating herself before you. You should display a bit of your compassionate glance towards her.”

Hayagriva continued, ‘In this way, Maheshani was praised by Brahma and the other excellent Gods. She saw the jaded Rati, suffering from grief. Tears flowed from her face. Her hair was dishevelled, and she was grey with dust. Since she was a widow, she had cast aside her ornaments. She prostrated herself before the mother of the universe. On seeing her, Parameshvari was filled with compassion. Manmatha was reborn from her sidelong glances, with his lotus face smiling. He was intoxicated with joy and his body was more beautiful than it had been earlier. He possessed two hands and was adorned in all the excellent ornaments. His arrows were made from flowers. His bow was made from flowers. With a sidelong glance, he delighted Rati, as he had done in his previous birth. The noble Rati was immersed in a great ocean of bliss. On seeing her own husband, she was filled with joy. Their hearts were filled with happiness and their minds were filled with devotion. Knowing this, the great queen had a gentle smile on her lotus face. Glancing towards Rati, whose head was lowered in shame, she addressed Shyamalaa in these words. “O Shyamalaa! Bathe her and let her wear garments and golden ornaments. When she has been ornamented, as used to be the case earlier, quickly bring her here.”

Lowering her head and accepting the command, Shyamalaa did everything that she had been asked to. Vasishtha and the other *brahmarshis* performed the act of marriage. The couple was made to perform the auspicious act of accepting each other's hands. All the *apsaras* danced and sang. On seeing this, the great Indra and the others, and *rishis*, stores of austerities, uttered words of praise. They lauded and eulogized Lalitaa Ambikaa. Delighted in their minds, all of them showered down flowers. Full of great devotion, both of them prostrated themselves before Laliteshvari. They came to her side. Joining their hands in salutation, they stood there. The valiant

Kandarpa prostrated himself before Maheshvari. His mind full of devotion, he requested her in these words. “O Lalitaa Ambikaa! Through Isha’s eye, my body was burnt down. Through the favours of your glance, I have got it back again. I am your son. I am your servant. Engage me in whatever task you wish.” Thus addressed, Parameshani replied to Makaradhvaja. Shri Devi said, “O child! O one born from the mind! You can go. You need have no fear. Through my favours, you will use your unimpeded arrows to confound everyone in the universe. When your arrows descend on him, they will disturb Ishvara’s fortitude too. He will quickly marry Gouri, the mountain’s daughter. Through my favours, one thousand crores of Kamas will be born from you. They will enter everyone’s body and grant them supreme sexual pleasure. Since he is not attached, Ishvara may be enraged. However, because of my favours, he will not be able to burn down your body. Your form will be invisible, and you will confound all living beings. Struck by your arrows, anyone’s mind will suffer at the prospect of he being separated from his own wife and he will be ready to give up half of his body for her. O Kandarpa! From now on, as a result of my favours, you will be great. Anyone who criticizes you, or frustrates your wishes, will certainly be a eunuch, from one life to another life. There are evil-souled sinners, who oppose my devotees. Bring them down and destroy them. Make them have intercourse with women they shouldn’t have intercourse with. There are those who worship me. Their minds are devoted to me. Ensure that they obtain every happiness and desire that is wished for.” Addressed by Shri Lalitaa Devi in these words, Smara pledged that he would act in accordance with her command. He lowered his radiant head. Joining his hands in salutation, he departed. From every pore on Ananga’s body, many Madanas arose. They were beautiful in form and confounded the universe. Through them, Manobhava confounded the entire universe.’

‘Desiring to conquer the one with the moon on his crest, he again went to Sthanu’s hermitage. His friend was Vasanta ¹⁰¹⁰ and the one with the cool beams ¹⁰¹¹ was his general. His companions were attachment and a gentle breeze. Calls of male cuckoos and gentle sounds of musical instruments were with him. He possessed the prowess of *shringara* and Rati embraced

his body. Foremost among brave ones, he brandished his victorious bow. Free from fear, Madana approached and faced his enemy's direction. The one with the moon on his crest was engaged in austerities and he struck him with his arrows. Thus, Chandrashekhara ¹⁰¹² was struck by Kandarpa's arrows. He cast aside his non-attachment and discarded the austerities which were so very difficult to perform. Shiva abandoned all the *niyamas* and gave up his fortitude. Afflicted by Smara, he repeatedly meditated on Parvati. Sharva sighed many times and his cheeks turned pale. Tears flowed from his eyes. He was separated and tormented, and he lost his patience. He repeatedly remembered that he had seen the daughter of the mountain earlier. Scorched by Ananga's arrows, the wielder of the trident was tormented. Struck by the flowery arrows, he constantly became unsteady and the mark of the moon, Ganga, Nandi, Bhringi, Mahakala and the foremost *ganas* were incapable of assuaging the torment his body experienced. Nandi supported him by the hand. He went from one flowery couch to another flowery couch and struggled repeatedly. The flowery beds, *amrita* flowing from the moon's part and the cold water from the ice could not counter the fever his body felt. Wishing to calm the fiery blaze in his body, Shiva repeatedly sought recourse in the snowy slabs of the mountains. He used his nails to etch pictures of the mountain's daughter on the slabs. But when he looked at these, Ananga's affliction did not go away. It only increased. He was embarrassed at what he had etched. He lowered his head and cast sidelong glances at these. He touched his limbs to those pictures on the slabs and his body hair stood up. He had great thoughts of being united with her and this greatly increased his desire for intercourse. He was again tormented by Smara and the one with an uneven number of eyes ¹⁰¹³ was distressed. He saw her everywhere. His mind was only directed towards her. In his madness, he saw only her and wished to converse only with her. She alone was in his heart. His mind was devoted to her. He spent night and day only on the nectar of her words. He was eager to describe her conduct and eager to see her form. Like a maker of garlands, he wove imaginary garlands, thinking of beautiful bouts of enjoyment with her. Shiva was immersed in her alone and suffered from great torment. Dhurjati ¹⁰¹⁴ could

find no medication for the affliction wrought by Manobhava. Deciding that marriage was the only way, he made great efforts towards that end.'

'Obeying Lalitaa's command, Kandarpa confounded the divinity in this way. He then used his arrows to torment the mountain's daughter. She repeatedly suffered from the fiery pangs of separation. She turned pale and sighed deeply. Her lips were like petals, and they dried up. Her cheeks turned pale. While eating, lying down or sleeping, she could not find any peace. Thousands of friends constantly sprinkled her, using devices to cool her down. But she was repeatedly tormented and repeatedly agitated. Manmatha's fire was great, and nothing could pacify the pain. Tormented by separation, Parvati could not sleep. The torment in her body increased the distress of her parents. The Indra among mountains was filled with great sorrow since he could see that his daughter suffered harshly as a result of separation from Shiva and that this could not be countered. Her father urged her, "O fortunate one! Use austerities to satisfy the divinity Maheshvara. You will obtain him as a desired husband." For the sake of obtaining a husband, Parvati performed extremely difficult austerities on the summit of Mount Himalaya, named Gourishekhara. During winter, she resided in the water. During summer, she undertook extremely difficult austerities, standing amidst fires, with her eyes cast on the sun. ¹⁰¹⁵ Satisfied with these austerities, Shiva granted her his proximity. He pledged that he would follow the norms for a marriage and accept her as a wife. He first sent the *saptarshis* and sought her and the lord of the mountains bestowed his lotus-eyed daughter.'

'For a long period of time, Maheshvara pleased himself with her. He resided in his father-in-law's residence in the city of Oshadhiprastha. ¹⁰¹⁶ Along with all the *pramathas*, he then returned to Kailasa again. He brought Parvati there and pleased the lord of mountains. He sported with her in Kailasa, Mandara, Mount Vindhya, Mount Himalaya, Malaya, Pariyatraka and many places. Thus, Maheshvara satisfied his desire. He released his semen inside her, but she was unable to bear it. She cast it on the earth and the earth cast it into the fire. Vahni flung it among the Krittikas, who flung it into the waters of Ganga, who released it in a clump of reeds. The

immensely valiant, Mahasena, with the six faces, originated from this. Conveyed near Ganga, Dhurjati's son grew up. He grew from one day to another day, fierce in his valour. Trained by his father, he obtained all the different kinds of learning. After this, taking his father's permission, he became the commander of all the soldiers of the Gods. He killed Taraka, along with all the *danavas*. Satisfied that Taraka, Indra among *daityas*, had been killed, Shakra bestowed Devasenaa on him and he married her. Shakra's illustrious daughter was named Devasenaa. ¹⁰¹⁷ Having obtained the beloved Skanda, she was filled with great joy. In this way, Manobhava confounded the entire circle of the universe. Having accomplished the task of the *devas*, he went to Shripura ¹⁰¹⁸ again. To ensure the prosperity of the world, Lalitaa Parameshvari resides in the sacred Shrinagara. He went there to serve her.'

Chapter 143-2(31) (Appearance of seven chambers and Matanga's daughters)

Agastya asked, 'Why is this named Shripura? What is its form? Who constructed it earlier? Please tell me all this. What are its dimensions? What is its colour? O lord! Please tell me this. You are the sun who dries up all the mud of doubts.'

Hayagriva answered, 'Lalitaa Parameshvari originated from the fire of a great sacrifice. She obtained Chakraratha, with the qualities that have already been described. Requested by Brahma and the others, she again went through the pastime of marrying. ¹⁰¹⁹ She destroyed the *asura* named Bhanda, the thorn of the worlds. At this, the great Indra and other *devas* were filled with great satisfaction. They wished to construct a beautiful residence for Kameshvara and Lalitaa, which would always be stocked with all the objects of pleasure. Brahma, Vishnu and Maheshvara, Lalitaa Devi's sons, invited Vishvakarma, the architect of the Gods, who was skilled in artisanship. They also invited Maya, the architect of the *asuras*, who was accomplished in the use of *maya*. Following Lalitaa's commands, they

honoured them. The men who possessed the rights ¹⁰²⁰ said, ‘O Vishvakarma! O one who knows about artisanship! O noble Maya! The two of you know about all the sacred texts. You are accomplished in creating. As soon as you think about it, the two of you are accomplished in conceiving and creating great works of artisanship. Lalitaa Devi is an eternal and great ocean of *jnana*. The two of you must construct Shrinagaris, ornamented with every kind of jewel. Their number must be sixteen and they must be in the centre of the Shodashi *kshetras*. ¹⁰²¹ Lalitaa Parameshvari will divide herself into sixteen parts and always reside there, for the sake of saving the universe. Build these. This will please us, and it will please the Maruts too. This will also please all the worlds. Construct them, so that they are worthy of their names.’ Hearing the reason and the words of the *devas*, Vishvakarma and Maya bent down and replied in words of assent. Bowing down, they asked the men who are the causes, ¹⁰²² ‘O great ones! In which *kshetras* should these Shrinagaris be built?’ Thus asked, Brahma and the others spoke to the two architects again. They told them about the conception of the appropriate *kshetras* and divisions.’

‘The Karanapurushas said, “The first will be on the slopes of Meru. The others will be on Mount Nishadha, Hemakuta and Himagiri, ¹⁰²³ with the fifth on Gandhamadana. There will be Nila, Mesha, Shringara and the great mountain of Mahendra. These are known as the nine *kshetras* on earth. There are said to be seven watery areas in all the oceans—salty ocean, ocean of sugarcane juice, ocean of liquor, ocean of *ghee*, ocean of curds, ocean of milk and as the seventh, the ocean of fresh water. The nine Indras among mountains have been spoken about first and the seven oceans thereafter. When they are aggregated, there are sixteen *kshetras* for constructing Ambaa’s Shripuras. The two of you are learned architects, with divine workmanship. For the immensely energetic Lalitaa, build divine abodes there. There is no doubt that these worthy *kshetras* will become famous under the names of the Nityaa Devis who killed the great *asuras*. In her own supreme Nityaa form, she pervades time. Devi controls everything. The entire universe is controlled by her. The great queen is the Nityaas. The Nityaas are her. There is no difference between the two. Therefore, the

cities will be famous under their names—Kameshvari Puri, Bhagamalaa Puri, Nityaklinna Puri and other names. These are famous habitations. Befitting the name and the *varna*,¹⁰²⁴ on an appropriate sacred day, use the great techniques of artisanship to build an auspicious city.” They were told this by Brahma, Vishnu and Maheshvara, the Karanapurushas. Thus addressed, they started to construct Shripuris in those *kshetras*.’

‘I will describe to you the expanse of the Shripuris and the divinities who preside over these cities. O Lopamudra’s husband! Listen and understand. Meru is the support for everything and rises for many *yojanas*. The fourteen worlds are fixed in their own body. It has four peaks—to the east, south-west, north-west, and in the centre. Their height will be described. Each of the three peaks mentioned earlier is one hundred *yojanas* in height. Each extends for one hundred *yojanas*. It is the view that there are three worlds there—Brahma’s world, Vishnu’s world and Shiva’s world. On another occasion, I will describe the way the houses are arranged within these. Hear about the height and expanse of the peak in the centre. It is four hundred *yojanas* high and the expanse is the same. The two architects built Shripura on that great summit. O one born from a pot! It extended for four hundred *yojanas*. The different divisions chosen there will be indicated. It is said that the first wall was constructed out of black iron. Its circumference was one thousand and sixteen *yojanas*. There were four gates in the four directions, and each was four *yojanas* high. O one who drank up the ocean!¹⁰²⁵ The base of the chamber at the bottom was ten thousand *yojanas*. There were two separate windows at the top of the chamber, and each measured half a *gavyuti*. The door to the chamber was one *yojana* high. There were two doors in each gate, each half a *gavyuti* wide. The doors were constructed out of black iron and were one *yojana* tall. The bars for bolting the two doors were half a *krosha* wide. All the four doors are said to have been similar. O one born from the pot! I will describe the placement of the *gopura*.¹⁰²⁶ At the base of the chamber, mentioned earlier, one *yojana* was marked out.¹⁰²⁷ On either side, two *yojanas* each were marked out. This is how it was constructed. Its depth was all the way, until it reached the gate. On either side, there were two *yojanas* each. There was one *yojana* at the

centre of the chamber. O sage! When one adds up, the dimension was five *yojanas*. Along the two sides, two and a half *kroshas* were also added. ¹⁰²⁸ Thus added, the total enumeration comes to five *yojanas*. O sage! The wall and the *gopura* were constructed in this way. Hence, the perimeter at the base of the *gopura* was twenty *yojanas*. ¹⁰²⁹ It is said that as one went progressively up, the perimeter declined. The height of the *gopura* is said to have been twenty-five *yojanas*. After every one *yojana*, there was a gate, with a beautiful door. There were that many floors too and, as one went up, they became smaller. Thus, the top of the *gopura* only extended for one *yojana*. The length was the same as the breadth and it is said that three crowns ¹⁰³⁰ were fixed at the top. O one born from the pot! Each crown measured one *krosha*. O sage! They were two *kroshas* high and were thus smaller than the *gopura*. The space between the crowns is said to have been half a *krosha*. For the *gopura* on the southern gate, the crowns extended from west to east. For the *gopura* on the western gate, the crowns extended from south to north. For the *gopura* on the northern gate, the crowns extended as they did for the southern gate. For the *gopura* on the eastern gate, the crowns were conceived as they were for the western gate. Seven *yojanas* inside the chamber were said to have been made from black iron, there was a chamber made out of bronze. As was the case earlier, there were *gopuras* on this too. The dimensions of the base of this chamber were exactly as has been described earlier. Towards the east and in other directions, this chamber of bronze also had gates. At every gate, there were *gopuras*, with the characteristics of being built-in floors.'

'O one born from the pot! It is said that, in every direction, in the space between the chamber made of black iron and the chamber made of bronze, there was a large garden with many kinds of trees. Every kind that sprouts and germinates exists there. There were thousands of trees, always full of flowers and always full of fruits. They were always full of excellent sprouts. They were always full of fragrances. There were *chuta*, *kankolaka*, *lodhra*, *bakula*, *karnikara*, *shimshapa*, *shirisha*, *devadaru*, *nameru*, *punnaga*, *nagabhadra*, *muchukunda*, *katphala*, *ela*, *lavanga*, *takkola*, *karpura* branches, *pilu*, *kakatunda*, *shalaka*, *asana*, *kanchana*, *ara*, *lakucha*, *panasa*,

hingula, patala, phalini, jatili, jaghanephala, ganika, kuranda, bandhujiva, dadima, ashvakarna, hastikarna, champaka, kanakadruma, yuthika, talaparni, tulasi, sadaphala, tala, tamala, hintala, kharjura, shara, barbura, ikshu, kshirina, shleshmantaka, vibhitaka, haritaka, avakpushpa, ghontali, svargapushpika, bhallataka, khadira, shakhota, chandana trees, kalaguru trees, kalaskandha, chinchā, vata, udumbara, arjuna, ashvattha, shami tree, dhruva trees, ruchaka, kutaja, saptaparna, kritamalaka, kapittha, tintini and other such thousands of trees.¹⁰³¹ To ensure *shringara* for Devi, they belonged to all the seasons. With their excellent branches, the many trees seemed to be engaged in a great festival.'

'Inside the bronze chamber, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there was a square chamber made out of copper. It was seven *yojanas* high. The distance between the two is described as *Kalpavatika*.¹⁰³² There were trees laden with beautiful fruit, fragrant with the smell of camphor. The rinds were golden, and the seeds were made from jewels. The branches were covered with divine yellow bark, made from coral. The sweet juice of *amrita* oozed out from them, and the flowers were like ornaments. In this way, there are said to have been many *kalpavrikshas* there. There was a second chamber,¹⁰³³ known by the name of *kalpvapi*. This was inside the chamber made of copper and was described as *Nagashala*.¹⁰³⁴ Measured diagonally, the distance between these two chambers was seven *yojanas*. *Santanavatika* was there, of the same shape as *Kalpavatika*.¹⁰³⁵ *Harichandanavatika* is said to have been in the space between the two. It had the same shape as *Kalpavatika* and was full of flowers and fruit. As was the case earlier, for all these chambers gates were thought of. As was the case earlier, *gopuras* and crowns were conceived. The dimensions of *gopuras*, gates and doors were as has been indicated before. Inside the chamber made of brass and at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there was a chamber made of *panchaloha*.¹⁰³⁶ Its shape was the same as that of the earlier chambers. It is said that the space between them had a *Mandaravatika*. Inside the chamber made of *panchaloha* and at a distance of seven *yojanas*, it is said that there was a chamber made of silver. It possessed the characteristics mentioned earlier. It is said that the space

between them had a Parijatavatika. It was full of divine fragrances and shining flowers and fruit. Inside the chamber made of silver and at a distance of seven *yojanas*, it is said that there was a chamber made of gold, decorated with gates, as was the case earlier. The space between the two is said to have had a Kadambavatika. There were divine *nipa* trees there, two *yojanas* tall. The trees were radiant and there was a constant and smooth flow of liquor from them. This was named Kadambari, and it provided enjoyment to *yoginis*. In particular, Mantrini always loved this garden full of liquor. The *nipa* trees were full of leaves and sprouts and provided excellent shade. The place was filled with the buzzing sounds of delighted and intoxicated bees. Mantranathaa's extremely beautiful residence was there. Around that excellent grove of *kadamba* trees, the sub-directions seemed to blaze. The original architect conceived of four lofty residences there. Each of these residences extended for five *yojanas*. The width was also of five *yojanas*. Such were the seven ramparts. In every sub-direction, there were *priyaka* trees. ¹⁰³⁷ Shyamaa's city of habitation is said to have been there. In that place, known as Mahapadmavati, there was another city for the soldiers. Had her residence been many *yojanas* away, Mantrini would not have been able to constantly serve Shri Devi. Therefore, for Shri Mantranathaa, Tvashtra ¹⁰³⁸ of the Gods and Maya constructed another residence that was just beyond the residence made from *chintamani*. ¹⁰³⁹ Such was Mantrini Devi's residence in Shripura, possessing many qualities. Even if a person possesses two thousand tongues, he will not be able to describe it completely. Matanga's daughters sing and sport there, to the tune of sweet notes from the *veena*. Kadambari makes their eyes coppery-red.'

Agastya asked, 'Who was the one named Matanga? Though they were intoxicated with sweet liquor, how did they constantly serve Mantranathaa?'

Hayagriva answered, 'The one named Mataga was a store of austerities and accumulated a heap of austerities. He possessed great powers and wished to create a world full of people. The power of austerities gave him great intelligence and his commands were followed everywhere. His son, Matanga, was persevering in intelligence. ¹⁰⁴⁰ He performed terrible

austerities and satisfied Mudrini Mantranayikaa. ¹⁰⁴¹ The sage Matanga's son worshipped her for a very long period of time. Mantrini arrived in his presence and instructed him to ask for a boon. Matanga was a store of austerities and best among all the sages. He spoke to Shyamalambikaa, who had shown herself in front of him. Matanga, the great sage, said, "O Devi! As soon as I remembered you, *anima* and all the other *siddhis* and all the other powers have been realized by me. O mother! There is nothing in the three worlds I do not possess. All the time, I have been favoured by memory of your conduct. Nevertheless, this presence of yours should not be futile. O mother! Hence, I will ask for a boon. Let it be satisfied. Earlier, I was friends with Himalaya and jested with him. Insolent and eloquent because of his pride, he uttered words that should not have been spoken. 'I am Gouri's father.' Saying this, he praised himself. Since his qualities were superior to mine, I did not like his words. When friends are equal in qualities, there is equilibrium. However, if one becomes superior in qualities, the other one also desires that. Though all my wishes have been met, I performed austerities so that I might praise myself as Gouri's father. O Mantranathaa! I will become successful when you become my daughter. In that event, there is no doubt that my name will be famous." Hearing the words of Matanga, the great sage, she replied in words of assent and vanished. The sage was delighted. When *maharshi* Matanga was dreaming happily, as ornaments for his ears, she gave him a bunch of *tapiccha* ¹⁰⁴² flowers. Matanga's wife was named Siddhimati. As a result of the power of that dream, she conceived Laghushyamaa in her womb. Since she was born through her, she is described as Matangi. She was known as Laghushyama because Shyamaa was the root cause of origin. Matanga had crores and crores of daughters—Laghyshyamaa, Mahashyamaa, Matangi and many others. They became subsidiary Shaktis and loved *priyaka* trees. O one born from the pot! This is how Matanga's daughters originated. I have also described the seven chambers and walls, made out of iron and other things.'

Chapter 144-2(32) (Divinities who protected seven chambers of Tripura Shrinagara)

Agastya said, ‘There were guards for the seven chambers, made out of iron and other things. O wise one! Recount their names and dispel my doubts.’

Hayagriva replied, ‘O one born from the pot! There was a great garden, full of many trees. Mahakala, dark in complexion, the devourer of all the worlds, resides there. He wears a dark jacket, and his eyes are red with intoxication. He drinks the essence of the universe from a full tumbler that is Brahmanda. He is seated on a throne, with the *kalaas* at the end of the *kalpa* in his *atman*. He glances at Mahakali, whose complexion is as dark as a cloud. Ananga has made her soft. He meditates on Lalitaa and is eager to worship Lalitaa. Since his devotion to Lalitaa is great, his lifespan becomes even longer. Servants, Kala and Mrityu ¹⁰⁴³ being the foremost, serve him. Mahakala and Mahakali obey Lalitaa’s commands. Controlling the entire universe, they reside in the first enclosure. Matanga’s Kalachakra constitutes his seat. ¹⁰⁴⁴ There are four sheaths and there is a beautiful *bindu* in the centre. There is a triangle and a pentagon. There are lotuses with sixteen petals and eight petals. Mahakala is in the centre. ¹⁰⁴⁵ Mahakalyaa, Mahasandhyaa and Mahanishaa ¹⁰⁴⁶ are at the three vertices. These three Mahadevis are Mahakala’s Shaktis. At the five vertices of the pentagon are the Shaktis of time—Pratyusha, Pitriprasu, Prahna, Aparahana and Madhyahna. ¹⁰⁴⁷ O sage! Hear about the ones who are on the sixteen petals of the lotus. They are Dina, Nisha, Tamisra, Jyotsni, Pakshini, Pradosha, Nishitha, Prahara, Purnima, Raka, Anumati, Amavasya, Sinivali, Kuhu, Bhadra and Uparaga as the sixteenth. ¹⁰⁴⁸ The Shaktis who are on the sixteen petals of the lotus are said to be *kalaa*, *kashtha*, *nimesha*, *kshana*, *lava*, *truti*, *muhurta*, *kutapa*, *hora*, *shukla paksha*, *krishna paksha*, *vishuva* as the thirteenth, *samvatsara*, *parivatsara* and *samvatsara*. ¹⁰⁴⁹ The Shaktis who are on the lotus with eight petals are *idavatsara*, *indu-vatsara*, *vatsara*, *tithi*, *vara*, *nakshatra*, *yoga* and *karana*. Kali, Kalpaa, Kalanaa and Kali—these

four are instated as the gatekeepers of the radiant Kalachakra. These Devis, associated with Mahakala, have smiling faces and are intoxicated. They hold red and shining tumblers that are filled with liquor. All of them are dark in complexion and are Kala's wives. They are devoted to worshipping Lalitaa, performing *dhyana* and *japa* on her, and lauding her. They serve Mahakala, who is astride his seat in Kalachakra. O one born from the pot! Kalpavatika's guard is the immensely energetic Vasanta, Lalitaa's beloved servant. He is seated on a throne made of flowers. He is red, intoxicated with liquor made from flowers. Flowers are his weapon. Flowers are his ornaments. He is adorned with an umbrella made of flowers. His wives are the two Devis, Madhushri and Madhavashri. ¹⁰⁵⁰ They are intoxicated with liquor made from flowers. They desire the one who possesses flowers as his arrows. Santanavatika's guard is the season Grishma, with fierce eyes. He is Lalitaa's servant and always carries out her commands. His two wives are said to be Shukrashri and Shuchishri. ¹⁰⁵¹ O sage! Harichandanavatika is guarded by the season Varsha. Varsha is immensely energetic, and flashes of lightning constitute his tawny eyes. His loud laughter is like a bolt of thunder and his mount is an intoxicated cloud. He is covered with armour made of clouds and he wields a bejeweled bow. He is intent on worshipping Lalitaa, performing *dhyana* and *japa* on her, and lauding her. He is the one who conquered Vindhya and brought delight to the three worlds. Varsha is said to have twelve Shaktis—Nabhas-shri, Nabhasyashri, Svarasvara, Svamalini, Ambaa, Dulaa, Nirali, Abhrayanti, Meghayantrikaa, Varshayanti, Chibunika and Varidharaa. ¹⁰⁵² Their eyes are red with intoxication, and they shower down. Along with these Shaktis, the season of Varsha always performs *japa* on Parameshvari, using clusters of flowers he has gathered up himself. He adorns countries where there are Lalitaa's devotees with prosperity. The ground where her enemies exist is made to suffer on account of lack of rain. Such is the nature of Devi's servants, at the onset of the rains. The season of Sharad always resides in Mandaravatika, protecting that chamber. His beautiful glance always brings pleasure to the mind. The season loves Ishashri and Urjashri like his own life. ¹⁰⁵³ They collect water and he gathers the flowers himself. Using these, they worship the queen

who is Shri Kameshvara's beloved. Hemanta is immensely energetic, and his body is as cool as ice. He is Lalitaa's beloved servant, and his face is always pleasant. Gathering flowers himself, he worships Parameshvari. He protects Parijatavatika and causes oppression to even the fire. His two auspicious wives are Sahas-shri and Sahasyashri. ¹⁰⁵⁴ The form of Shishira guards the garden of Kadambavatika. O best among sages! O one born from the pot! Shishira is in that chamber and everywhere, the ground is rendered cold by him. Hence, Shyamaa, the divinity who resides there, is also cool in form. His two excellent wives are Tapas-shri and Tapasyashri. ¹⁰⁵⁵ Along with them, he worships Ambaa Lalitaa, who purifies the universe.'

Agastya said, 'O one who enhances fragrances! O illustrious one! Among the seven gardens, full of many kinds of trees, I have heard about the first, protected by Mahakala. You have spoken about his circle, consisting of four sheaths. I have also heard about Kalpavatika and the other gardens, protected by the six seasons. However, I have not heard about the divinities in those circles. O illustrious one! You are omniscient and you are great. Therefore, please tell me about Vasanta and the other divinities who are on the sheaths of the circles.'

Hayagriva answered, 'O best among sages! Hear about the divinities who are established in the circles. I have spoken about Kalachakra earlier. I will speak about Vasanta Chakra now. It should be known that there are seven coverings, with a triangle, a pentagon, a lotus with eight petals, a lotus with sixteen petals, a lotus with ten petals, a second lotus with ten petals and a square. The immensely radiant Vasanta is in the *bindu* that is in the centre of the circle. Both Madhushri and Madhavashri are together, seated on his lap. With his hands, he holds their breasts, one breast of each. With one pair of hands, he kneads this. In the other pair of hands, he holds a tumbler full of liquor, made fragrant with flowers, and a piece of meat. O one who crushed Vindhya! *Dhyana* on all the seasons should be performed in this way. When one performs *dhyana* on Varsha, it should be known that the first two Shaktis are seated on his lap. The other Shaktis are near him. After this, I will speak about the Devis who are in Vasanta Chakra. Listen. It should be known that there are thirty such Shaktis. They are Madhushuklaa

of *prathama*, Madhushuklaa of *dvitiya*, Madhushuklaa of *tritiya*, Madhushuklaa of *chaturthi*, Madhushuklaa of *shashthi*, Madhushuklaa of *saptami*, Madhushuklaa of *ashtami*, Madhushuklaa of *navami*, Madhushuklaa of *dashami*, Madhushuklaa of *ekadashi*, Madhushuklaa of *dvadashi*, Madhushuklaa of *trayodashi*, Madhushuklaa of *chaturdashi*, Madhushuklaa of *pournamasi*, Madhukrishnaa of *prathama*, Madhukrishnaa of *dvitiya*, Madhukrishnaa of *tritiya*, Madhukrishnaa of *chaturthi*, Madhukrishnaa of *panchami*, Madhukrishnaa of *shashti*, Madhukrishnaa of *saptami*, Madhukrishnaa of *ashtami*, Madhukrishnaa of *navami*, Madhukrishnaa of *dashami*, Madhukrishnaa of *ekadashi*, Madhukrishnaa of *dvadashi*, Madhukrishnaa of *trayodashi*, Madhukrishnaa of *chaturdashi* and Madhukrishnaa of *amavasya*.¹⁰⁵⁶ In this way, there are another thirty Shaktis for the month known as Madhava. Together, there are said to be sixty Shaktis for Vasanta. Following the norms, each must be worshipped using the respective *mantra*. Their seats are in the seven coverings of Vasanta Chakra. These sixty divinities are established in their sixty seats. *Sadhakas* must worship them separately, using the respective *mantra*. Such is Vasanta Chakra, and it is the same for the other seasons. There are said to be sixty great Shaktis in Grishma Chakra. These supreme divinities are different, depending on whether it is Shukra or Shuchi. In this way, for Varsha Chakra, there are differences between Nabhas and Nabhasya. In each of these Chakras, sixty Shaktis are established. I am scared that the book will become too long. Hence, I will not start to enumerate them. These Shaktis for the seasons are affectionate towards Lalitaa's devotees. They are devoted to worshipping Lalitaa, performing *dhyana* and *japa* on her, and lauding her. Intoxicated, they wander around in Kalpavatika and the other circles. They satisfy Maheshvari with the honey produced from their own respective flowers. Taken together, the number is three hundred and sixty. In this way, there are the divinities who protect the seven chambers. Since you asked, I have described their names. I will now describe what exists in the other chambers. Understand. In detail, I will describe the Shaktis who are there.'

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Chapter 145-2(33) (Chambers, starting with a wall of topaz, ending with a wall of pearls)

Hayagriva said, ‘I have described the characteristics of the seven chambers created by the architects. I will now describe the bejewelled chambers. Listen. The distance between the chamber of gold and the chamber of topaz is said to be only seven *yojanas*. Intoxicated with liquor, male and female *siddhas* sport there. They savour tasty juices, apply collyrium on their feet and hold swords. Full of devotion towards Lalitaa, they satisfy great people. They reside there and drink many kinds of tasty liquor. For the chambers made of topaz and other materials, the doors were devised, as was the case earlier. For the chamber made of topaz, it should be known that the gates, doors and *gopuras* are made out of topaz. They are lofty and shine like the sun and the moon. There is ground between the chamber made of gold and the chamber made of topaz. It is said that this is also made out of topaz. All the rooms in these great chambers will be described. The hues of the birds are similar. The complexions of the ponds are similar. The colour of the water in the rivers is similar. The complexions of the bejewelled trees are similar. There are those who worshipped Devi in many kinds of ways earlier. When they gave up their bodies, they were born as *siddhas*. The male and female *siddhas* are there. In the due order, they are devoted to Lalitaa. They use *mantras* to perform *japa* on Lalitaa. All of them chant Lalitaa Devi’s names. Inside the great chamber made from topaz and at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is a chamber made out of rubies. In every direction, it is in the shape of a square. The ground is covered with excellent rubies and the *gopuras* and other things are also made from this. There were those who resided in the land of the *charanas* ¹⁰⁵⁷ earlier. When their former bodies were destroyed, they obtained *siddhi*. They serve at the great queen’s lotus feet. The *charana* women possess beautiful limbs and wish to get intoxicated. They roam around with their husbands and drink sweet liquor. Inside the great chamber made of rubies, at a distance of seven

yojanas, there is a great chamber made of hessonite, just like the earlier chamber in shape. In its centre, there is an extremely lofty chamber made of diamonds, covered with diamonds. O one born from the pot! Groups of excellent *gandharvas* and *apsaras* reside there, those who had worshipped Devi in their earlier births. To the notes of lutes, they sing of the numerous qualities of the great queen. They are interested in enjoying the objects of desire and their bodies are like that of Kama. Their nature is gentle, and they are full of devotion towards Shri Devi. The chamber of hessonite has the same shape as that of the earlier chamber. There are crores of Yoginis and Bhairavas inside it. They devoutly serve Ambaa, who causes afflictions to Kala himself. Inside the great chamber made of hessonite, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there are the residences of the courtesans of *devas* ¹⁰⁵⁸ and others like them—Urvashi, Menakaa, Rambhaa, Alambushaa, Manjughoshaa, Sukeshi, Purvachitti, Ghritachi, Kritasthalaa, Vishvachi, Punjikasthalaa and Tilottama. Along with the *gandharvas*, they drink from fresh *kalpavrikshas*. They repeatedly perform *dhyana* on Lalitaa Devi. To enhance their good fortune, they chant about her qualities. All the *apsaras*, with fourteen kinds of origins, are there. ¹⁰⁵⁹ They reside there happily and worship Devi.’

Agastya said, ‘O lord! O immensely wise one! O great ocean full of every kind of learning! Please describe the fourteen kinds of birth the *apsaras* had.’

Hayagriva answered, ‘The learned say that the causes behind their origin are Brahma’s heart, Kama, Mrityu, Urvi, ¹⁰⁶⁰ the wind-God, the sun’s rays, the moon’s beams, the *Vedas*, the fire, lightning, nectar, Daksha’s daughter and water. ¹⁰⁶¹ They are reckoned as celestial women, with sparkling good fortune and prosperity. Along with the *gandharvas*, they worship Chakrini. O sage! There are *kimpurusha* men and women. Along with their women, the *kimpurushas* resort to the region full of diamonds and are intoxicated with liquor. Performing *japa* with the great queen’s *mantra*, they cleanse themselves of all sins. O one born from the pot! They dance and sing. O sage! The river named Vajraa flows in a place that is full of diamonds. ¹⁰⁶² Dense trees that have the form of diamonds float in it. The sand is made out

of diamonds. The water seems to be made out of liquid diamonds. The purifying river always flows everywhere around that region. There are excellent humans who are devoted to Lalitaa Parameshani. They drink that water, and their bodies assume the form of the *vajra*. O one born from the pot! They possess long lifespans and do not suffer from disease. When Shatakratu hurled the *vajra*, Bhandasura caused it to melt. Therefore, devoted to Vajreshi, he ¹⁰⁶³ tormented himself through austerities along its banks. At this, Devi arose from the water and gave the *vajra* to Bala's enemy. Thereafter, she vanished. Having accomplished his objective, he returned to heaven. Inside the chamber made from diamonds, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is a lofty chamber made out of lapis lazuli and like earlier, it has *gopuras*. The ground is radiant and is made from lapis lazuli. There are *sadhakas* who resided in Patala and worshipped Shri Devi. They assume the forms of *siddhas* and reside there, full of happiness—Shesha, Karkotaka, Mahapadma, Vasuki, Shankha, Takshaka, Shankhachuda, Mahadanta and Mahaphana. There are many other *nagas* too, male and female. Bali is the foremost among Indras among the *daityas* and he is devoted to *dharma*. He resides there, along with a large number of *nagas* and his own women. They have initiated themselves into Lalitaa's sacred texts and perform *japa* with Lalitaa's *mantras*. The *asuras* and serpents dwell there, and constantly worshipped Lalitaa. In the chamber made from lapis lazuli, the rivers possess cold water. The lakes have sparkling water and are adorned with cranes. The mansions are divine and are studded with lapis lazuli. *Nagas* and *asuras* sport there, along with their women. Inside the great chamber made from lapis lazuli, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is a circular chamber made out of sapphire. O sage! In the centre of the chamber, the ground is covered with blue sapphire. The rivers there are sweet, and the lakes are cool. There are many kinds of succulent objects of pleasure. There were mortals on earth who used Lalitaa's *mantras* to become *sadhakas*. When they give up their bodies, they obtain a residence in that chamber made of sapphire. Along with their women and friends, they enjoy divine objects of pleasure there. Full of devotion, they drink sweet liquor and dance. O one born from the pot! They sport in ponds,

banks of rivers, residences made of creepers and large and beautiful mansions. They constantly recite about Shri Devi's qualities and perform *japa* on her. Surrounded by the women, those immensely fortunate ones reside there. When their *karma* is exhausted, they again go to earth and assume human bodies. They are again filled with desire and worship Chakrini again. They again go to Shrinagara, that great region that is full of sapphire. As a result of association with that region, attachment and hatred originate. O sage! Humans are always attached to sapphires. However, there are also mortals who possess *jnana*. They conquer their senses and are devoid of the opposite pairs of sentiments. O sage! Full of amazement, they enter Maheshvari. Inside the chamber made from sapphire, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is a chamber made of pearls. As was the case earlier, it possesses *gopuras*. O sage! The ground between them is extremely clear and radiant. Everything is constructed with pearls and is very beautiful and cool. Tamraparni, Mahaparni and other great rivers always flow in that great region. Their waters yield pearls. All those along their banks were residents of the world of the *devas*. In their former births, they used Shri Devi's *mantras* to become *sadhakas*.'

'Starting with the east, all around the chamber made out of pearls, in the eight directions, there are the worlds of Shakra and the others. Their gates face the chamber made of pearls. In between the chamber made of pearls and the chamber made of sapphire, in the eastern direction, there is Shakra's world. At its corner, there is Vahni's world. ¹⁰⁶⁴ To the south is Yama's city and the lord who wields the staff resides there. His nature is fierce, and he performs *japa* with Lalitaa's *mantra* everywhere. Yama's servants follow his commands, Chitragupta being the foremost. Along with him, Guha ensures that Shri Devi's *niyamas* and ordinances are enforced. O one born from a pot! Those cursed by Guha; those evil in conduct; those who hate Lalitaa; those who show fraudulent devotion; fools; those who are senseless; those who are excessively insolent; stealers of *mantras*; those who use wicked *mantras*; those who use evil forms of learning; those who resort to sins; non-believers; those wicked in conduct; those who cause violence to life in vain; those who hate women; those hated by the worlds;

and those who protect heretics suffer hardships in Kalasutra, Rourava, Kumbhipaka, Asipatravana, the terrible Krimibhaksha, Pratapana, Lalakshepa, Suchivedha, Angarapatana and other such hells. ¹⁰⁶⁵ Following Shridevi's commands, the immensely energetic one ¹⁰⁶⁶ hurls them down there. To its west, ¹⁰⁶⁷ is Nirrit, who wields a sword. Residing in this world of *rakshasas*, he worships Lalitaa. To its north, in between the two gates, is Varuna's world and Varuna is always present there. Having savoured the tasty *varuni*, he is intoxicated. His limbs are fair and his mount is a fish. ¹⁰⁶⁸ He always performs *japa* with Shri Devi's *mantra*. He is a *sadhaka* who follows Shridevi's procedures. Using his noose, he binds down those who hate Shridevi's *darshana*. ¹⁰⁶⁹ Binding them, he conveys them along a path that heads downwards. However, for those who are devotees, he frees bonds. To its northern corner, is the world of the immensely radiant Vayu. Great ones, whose bodies are in the form of the wind, reside there, always full of bliss. There are *siddhas*, divine *rishis* and others who practice the retention of air. These are *yogis*, devoted to *yoga*, Goraksha being the foremost. ¹⁰⁷⁰ Along with all these great-spirited ones, the lord of all the winds resides there. O one born from a pot! He always has different kinds of forms. Marutanatha ¹⁰⁷¹ always desires sweet liquor and these three Shaktis are Ida, Pingala and Sushumna. ¹⁰⁷² He holds a standard in his hand, and he is astride his great and excellent mount of an antelope. He is devoted to worshipping Lalitaa in the due order, performing sacrifices and *japa*. He is surrounded by other Shaktis, whose limbs are filled with bliss. The illustrious Maruteshvara always performs *japa* on Chakrini. Using his power, at the end of a *kalpa*, he instantly conveys the three worlds, and their mobile and immobile entities, to the supreme and is delighted. To accomplish success in attaining power, he faithfully worships Laliteshvari. He is adorned with all the ornaments. To its north, is the immensely radiant world of the *yakshas*, in between the two gates. The illustrious Indra of the *yakshas* resides there. He possesses nine *nidhis* and his Shaktis are Riddhi and Vridhhi. Along with them, he fills Lalitaa's devotees with wealth and prosperity. He is surrounded by pleasant *yakshis* ¹⁰⁷³ who are favourably inclined. Along with them, with many kinds of liquor, he worships

Chakrini. There are commanders of *yakshas* too—Manibhadra, Purnabhadra, Maniman, Manikadhara and others. To its east, is the world of the extremely great Rudra. Rudra is the presiding divinity there and he is ornamented with many kinds of expensive jewels. He always blazes in rage. Large quivers are always fastened on him. Along with him, there are other great-spirited Rudras who are his equals. They are accomplished in maintaining the worlds. They are accomplished in stringing their bows and are established in sixteen sheaths. Covering their faces, they always perform *japa* on Shridevi. They perform *dhyana* on Shridevi and are eager to worship Shridevi. The sides are ornamented by many crores of Rudranis. All their limbs are resplendent and all of them are proud of their blooming youth. They are devoted to performing *dhyana* on Lalitaa. They are always eager to be intoxicated on *asava* liquor. Along with them, there is the illustrious Maharudra, who wields his trident. He is served by many other Rudras, Hiranyabahu being the chief. With the tip of his trident, he pierces those who have deviated from visiting Lalitaa and those who have been reprimanded by their *gurus*. He burns them down with the fierce fire that emanates from his eyes. He also destroys their wives, servants and offspring. The immensely valiant one is obedient and carries out Lalitaa's commands. O one born from a pot! He resides in Rudra's extremely beautiful world. O *rishi*! Maharudra's attendants are the *pramathas*. There are innumerable Rudras. Who is capable of enumerating them? There are thousands and thousands of Rudras on earth. There are thousands and thousands in heaven. Arrows constitute their food. Arrows are their breath of life. Blazing and tawny-eyed, they shower down arrows. Those immensely energetic ones exist in the ocean and in the firmament. They have matted hair and imbibe liquor. They are red in complexion, with blue throats. They are above the world of beings. They possess arrows and matted hair. Using many kinds of vessels used for food, they drink up people. There are Rudras who are charioteers along the path and those who reside in *tirthas*. There are thousands of others, with arrows and quivers. The Rudras exist in different directions, carrying out Lalitaa's commands. All of them are extremely great-souled. They can destroy the three worlds

in an instant. They are devoted to performing *dhyana* on Shridevi. Using Shridevi's *mantras*, they perform *japa*. Full of compassion, they protect those who are Shridevi's devotees. Inside the wall made out of pearls, they are established in sixteen sheaths. All of these Rudras seek refuge with the extremely great Maharudra. They, Hiranyabahu being the chief, blaze and worship him.'

Chapter 146-2(34) (Shiva's world)

Agastya asked, 'With Rudra as the presiding divinity, what is the circle with sixteen sheaths? Who are the Rudras who are established there? What names are they famous under? O ocean of compassion! Under what names do they reside in those original coverings? What are their *yougica* and *roudhika* names?' ¹⁰⁷⁴

Hayagriva answered, 'Rudra's world is said to have been fashioned with nets of pearls. It is decorated. It is five *yojanas* long and five *yojanas* wide. It possesses sixteen sheaths and there is a beautiful pedestal in the centre. Maharudra blazes on the pedestal in the centre. His three eyes blaze in rage. O sage! He always holds a strung bow in his hand. O one born from a pot! It is said that there are three Rudras in the triangle that constitute the first sheath. They are Hiranyabahu, Senani and Dishampati. There is a second sheath in the form of a hexagon and the Rudras there are Vriksha, Harikesha, Pashupati, Shashpinjara, Tvishiman and Pathinampati. ¹⁰⁷⁵ In the third sheath, in the form of an octagon, there are Babhrushsha, Vivyadhi, Annapati, Harikesha, Upavitin, Pushtanampati, Bhava and Heti. In the fourth sheath, in the form a decagon, there are Jagatamapati, Rudra, Atatavin, Kshetrapati, Suta, Ahamtvanya, Vanapati, Rohita, Sthapati and Vrikshanampati. Their bows are ready. O one born from a pot! In the fifth sheath, in the form of a duodecagon, there are Mantri, Vanija, Kakshapati, Bhavanti as the fourth, Variva as the fifth, Oshadhinampati as the sixth, Ucchairghosha, Akrandayana, Pathanampati, Kritansavita, Dhava, and Sattvanampati. They are on the twelve petals of the fifth sheath. The

divinities in the sixth sheath, in the form of a heptagon, should be known as Sahamana, Nirvyadhi, Avyadhinampati, Kakubha, Nishangi, Stenampati and Nicheru. O one born from a pot! O sage! Below, the sixteen who reside on the sixteen petals of the seventh sheath are Aranyapati who roams around, Srikavisha, Jighamsanta, Mushnatampati, Asimanta, Suprajna, Naktachara, Prakritinampati, Ushnishi, Gireshchara, Kuluchanampati, Dhanvavida with the arrows, Atanvana, Pratipurva, Dadhanaka and Ayachhata. O one born from a pot! O one who crushed Vindhya! O one who drank up the ocean! There are eighteen divinities in the eighth sheath—Visrijanta, Asyanta, Vidhyanta, Asina, Shayana, Yanta, Jagrata, Tishtanta, Dhavanta, Sabhya, Samadhipa, Ashva, Ashvapati, Avyadhinya, Vividhyanta, Ganadhyaksha, Brihanta and Gritsa. The Rudras who are presiding divinities in the ninth sheath are Gritsadhpati, Vrata, Vratadhipa, Gana, Ganapa, Vishvarupa, Virupaka, Mahanta, Kshullaka, Rathin, Aratha, Ratha, Rathapati, Sena, Senani, Kshattara, Sangrahitara, Takshana, Rathakaraka and Kulala. O one born from the pot! The Rudras who are said to occupy the tenth sheath are Karmara, Punjishta, Nishada, Ishukridgana, Dhanvakara, Mrigayu, Shvani, Shvana, Ashva, Ashvapati, Bhava, Rudra, Sharva, Pashupati, Nilagriva, Shitikantha, Kapardi, Vyuptakesha, Sahasraksha, Shatadhanva, Girisha, Shipivishta and Midhushtama. O one born from the pot! There are said to be twenty-four immensely strong Rudras in the eleventh sheath, in the form of a wheel—Ishuman, Hrasva, Vamana, Brihan, Varshyan, Vriddha, Samriddhi, Agrya, Prathama, Ashu, Ajira, Shighra, Shibhyaka, Urmyavasus, Anyarudra, Srotasya, Divya, Jyeshtha, Kanishtha, Purvaja, Avaraja, Madhyama, Avagamy and Jaghanya. O one born from a pot! O store of austerities! There are said to be twenty-six in the twelfth sheath — Budhnya, Soumyarudra, Pratisarpaka, Yamyaka, Kshemya, Uvochava, Khali, Shlokya, Avasanyaka, Vanya, Kakshya, Shrava, Pratishrava, Ashushena, Ashuratha, Shura, Avabhinda, Varmi, Varuthi, Bilmina, Kavachi, Shruta, Sena, Dundubhya, Ahananya and Dhrishnu. They have gigantic bodies and are immensely strong. O sage! Hear about the Rudras who are in the thirteenth sheath. O one born from a pot! O one who crushed Vindhya! They are Prabhrisha, Duta, Prahita,

Nishangi, Ishudhiman, Takshneshu, Yudhi, Svayudha, Sudhanva, Stutya, Pathya, Kapya, Natya, Sudha, Sarasya, Nadhamana, Veshanta, Kupya, Avadhavarshya, Avarshya, Medhya, Vidyuta, Ighrya, Atapya, Vatya, Reshmya, Vastavya, Vastupa and Soma. They are immensely strong. O sage! The divinities who are Rudras in the fourteenth sheath are said to be Rudra, Tamraruna, Shanga, Pashupati, Ugra, Bhima, Agrevadha, Durevadha, Hanta, Haniyan, Vrisha, Harikeshaka, Tara, Shambhu, Mayobhu, Shankara, Mayaskara, Shiva, Shivatara, Tirthya, Kulya, Parya, Aparya, Pratarana, Uttarana, Atarya, Labhya, Shashtha and Phenya. O wise one! There are thirty-two Rudra divinities who are constantly stationed in the fifteenth sheath, along with their weapons. O store of austerities! O sage! They are Sikatya, Pravahya, Irinya, Prapathya, Kimshila, Kshayana, Kapardi, Pulastya, Goshtya, Grihya, Talpya, Gehya, Katya, Gahvareshta, Urudipaka, Niveshtya, Pantavya, Rathanya, Shukya, Haritya, Alotha, Lopya, Urya, Surmya, Payeya, Parnasha, Vaguramanaka, Abhighna, Anashidu, Prakhidan, Kirika and Devanamhridaya. As was the case earlier, the sixteenth sheath has gates and those who are there are Vikshinatka, Vichinvatka, Nirhatanamaka. Abhivakta and Nishtapta. There are thousands of Rudras who are established in the sixteen sheaths, and they worship Maharudra. They serve Maharudra, who carries out Lalitaa's commands. The lord of the north-east resides in that chamber made of pearls and ensures the prosperity of the worlds. These immensely strong Rudras are enumerated in the Shatarudriya *mantra*. Day and night, they protect those who are devoted to Lalitaa. For those who are not devoted to Lalitaa Devi, they create great obstacles along the path. Thus, Shakra and the other guardians of the worlds resort to the chamber made out of pearls. They constantly serve Lalitaa Parameshvari.'

'Inside the chamber made of pearls, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, is a chamber made of emeralds, four *yojanas* in height. As was the case earlier, it possesses *gopuras*. In the four directions, beginning with the south-east, there are four residences for Shri Dandanathaa, as large as Mantrini's residences. In the great battle with Bhandasura, there were Devis who were on the layers of Gitichakra, Indra among chariots. They reside here, always

awake. Everywhere, the ground there is auspicious and is studded with emeralds. There are excellent golden palms, and the place is stocked with every kind of object. All the Devis there are as prosperous as Dandanathaa. They roam around, whirling their ploughs and whirling their pestles. There are innumerable palm trees there, as colourful as fresh gold. Each of their trunks is one *yojana* tall. The leaves are dense and thick, and the barks are golden. They are laden with fruit and their shade is gentle. From the top to the root, pots of liquor hang from them. The artisans crafted these for Dandanathaa's pleasure. Jrimbhini and other Devis of that circle, Hetuka and other Bhairavas and the seven Devis who restrain ¹⁰⁷⁶ drink from the pots full of palm juice and become intoxicated. Intoxicated and maddened, they dance, in whichever of the four directions Dandini happens to cast her glance. As was the case earlier, all these possess Devi's radiance.

Unmattabhairavi, Svapneshi and others are in all directions. This residence of Dandanathaa's is only for the sake of showing her honour. To serve, ¹⁰⁷⁷ she has another residence, in the region of Mahapadmatavi. Since her other residence was very far, this residence was constructed for serving. In the chamber made of emerald, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is a wall, made out of coral as red as the rising sun. The entire ground there is made from coral. Brahma, whose complexion is like that of coral, is seated there, on a lotus. Along with all the sages and lords, he always comes there from Brahma's world, so that he can attentively serve Shri Lalitaa Devi. O one who drank up the ocean! He remains there, along with Marichi and the other Prajapatis. For the prosperity of the worlds and following Lalitaa Devi's command, the fourteen kinds of learning, thousands of types of subsidiary learning and the sixty-four arts assume great and embodied forms and serve Brahma there, inside the wall made of coral. ¹⁰⁷⁸ Inside the chamber made of coral, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is the world of Vishnu, who is eager to serve Lalitaa. All around, in every direction, there are pavilions made of rubies. Vishnu, the eternal one, is himself present in Vishnu's world there. Madhava is always present there, assuming different kinds of forms, numbering, ten or twelve. In the course of the battle with Bhandasura, there were ten *avatars* who emerged from Shri Devi's nails.

They also reside in the pavilion made of rubies. The only special difference between this chamber and the earlier chambers is that this one is seen to be covered only with rubies. The divinity is within the chamber, holding a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace. ¹⁰⁷⁹ Starting with the east, he assumes twelve forms and protects the directions. Keshava, with a complexion of molten gold, holds a *chakra* and protects the east. Narayana's complexion is like that of a dark cloud. He holds a conch shell and protects the west. As dark as a blue lotus, Madhava protects the liquor. The great Govinda's complexion is like that of the moon. He holds a bow and protects the southern flank. To the north, Vishnu's complexion is like that of the filament of a lotus. Wielding a plough, he protects. To the south-east, Madhusudana, whose complexion is like that of a lotus, wields a pestle and protects. Trivikrama is in the south-western direction. He holds a sword in his hand and blazes in radiance. Vamana is as radiant as the rising sun. He wields a *vajra* and is in the north-western direction. Shridhara is in the north-eastern direction. His complexion is like that of a lotus and his weapon is a spear. Hrishikesha's complexion is like that of lightning. He holds a bludgeon and protects from below. Padmanabha, with the Sharnga bow in his hand, possesses the radiance of one thousand suns. Following the natural order, he surrounds the pavilion made of rubies. He possesses all the weapons and all the powers. He is omniscient and faces every direction. His complexion is like that of an *indragopa* insect. He has a noose in his hand and is undefeated. Damodara is in all *atmans* and is dependent on devotion towards Lalitaa. Following the natural order, he surrounds the pavilion made of rubies. Thus, the lotus-eyed Bhagavan has twelve bodies. He is radiant in Vishnu's world, within the pavilion made of rubies. Inside the chamber made of many jewels, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is an extremely beautiful pavilion, named Sahasrastambhaka. ¹⁰⁸⁰ It is studded with many kinds of gems and ornamented with many kinds of jewels. There is a lofty chamber there, constructed with many kinds of jewels. In a single row, there are one thousand pillars that stretch in a diagonal direction. Like that, there are many rows in the four directions. As was the case earlier, the coverings are made of gems and wood. Shiva's great world is there. He

sparkles in radiance and is always awake. In embodied form, the twenty-eight Shiva *agama* texts are said to be present there. ¹⁰⁸¹ The excellent ones are present there, Nandi, Bhiringi and Mahakala being the foremost. There are divinities of the twenty-six *tattvas*. There are thousands who are elephant-headed. There are in Shiva's excellent world, in the pavilion of Sahasrastambhaka. Ishana Chandrashekhara is the lord of every kind of learning. He carries out Lalitaa's commands and ensures that Lalitaa's instructions are carried out. His mind is full of eternal bliss, and he performs *japa* with Lalitaa's *mantra*. Shiva casts his favourable glance towards his own devotees, so that they obtain success through Lalitaa's *mantra*. She is accomplished in destroying the mass of darkness that is inside and outside. She is the form of great illumination. She illuminates the power of the intellect. Mahadeva is omniscient and is the universal doer. Dependent on devotion towards Shridevi, he is present in the pavilion of Sahasrastambhaka. O one born from the pot! He remains in those chambers.'

Chapter 147-2(35) (*Arghya* in Mahapadmatavi)

Hayagriva said, ‘After this, I will describe the *vapitrayas* that are within the different chambers. ¹⁰⁸² Inside the chamber known as Sahasrastambhaka, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is a great chamber named Manah. ¹⁰⁸³ It is adorned with every kind of jewel. As was the case earlier, it possesses *gopuras*, gates and doors. The entire region inside that chamber is covered by a well of *amrita* that extends everywhere. Drinking this, *yogis* become *siddhas*, like the *vajra* in form and immensely strong. These are men who are wise in *rasayana*. ¹⁰⁸⁴ Using this, the water in the well becomes *amrita*. As soon as one inhales its fragrance, one becomes lord of all the *siddhis*, in the form of desired women. O one who crushed Vindhya! Even if a man touches it, his sins are destroyed. On both sides of the two chambers, along the banks of the well of nectar, there are many other wells. These are in the form of squares, with half a *kroshta* along each side. Inside the water, the depth is four *yojanas*. The rows of steps that lead down are decorated with many kinds of jewels. The swans and cranes possess the complexion of gold and the complexion of jewels. The waves inside ripple and dash against the banks. The birds drink that water and because of *rasayana*, become like new. O destroyer of Vindhya! They become immortal and do not suffer from old age. The *karandava* birds call all the time. Using *mantras*, they seem to be performing *japa* on Lalitaa Devi’s greatness. All around, the place is surrounded by many wells. Unless one uses a boat as a vehicle, there is no means of following a path inside. Without the command of Mantrini and Dandanathaa, one cannot reach there. There is a great Shakti named Taraa there. She is in charge of all the gates. Taraa has many attendants, as dark as blue lotuses. They sport in the waters of the lake, in thousands of bejewelled boats. They go to the other bank and return again to this bank. They repeatedly play on *veenas*, flutes and drums. There are crores of Taraas there, in the bloom of new youth. They function as sailors. They repeatedly sing and dance about Devi’s sacred fame. Some have oars

in their hands. Some have horns filled with water in their hands. They drink the water that is nectar and cross in hundreds of boats. These Shaktis are dark and row the boats. Their chief is Tarambaa. Without the commands of Mantrini and Dandanathaa, no one is capable of crossing that torrent of water. She does not even grant permission to the three-eyed one to cross the well of water. The Taraas who enable the crossing over in boats are extremely beautiful. These Shaktis sing and row the boats, rendered beautiful with jewels. At every step, they cite instances of the great queen's greatness and nobility. In large tumblers made out of rubies, they drink a lot of liquor. In every boat, there is a beautiful house made out of gems and they dwell in these. O sage! Some boats are superb because of gold, others are fashioned out of jewels. Some are in the shape of *makaras*. Some boats possess faces, like deer. Some have the faces of lions, others possess the faces of elephants. In this way, the place is surrounded with many kinds of wonderful boats. In their midst, Tarambaa is radiant in her own great boat. She travels in the water of the well, in an *anuloma* and *pratiloma* direction.

¹⁰⁸⁵ Taraa constantly protects this chamber.'

'Inside the chamber of Manah, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is the chamber of Buddhi. ¹⁰⁸⁶ This is four *yojanas* high. The area inside this chamber is covered everywhere by a well of *ananda*. This is full of great and divine liquor, rendered fragrant by *bakula* flowers. That shade, like molten gold, extends over the water. The depth of the well of *ananda* is the same as what has been described before. There are steps and birds, as was the case earlier. There are Shaktis along the banks. They drink the water and liquor there. They sport, maddened and intoxicated and become red because of their intoxication. Devi Varuni is herself in charge of all the boats there. She is also known as Sudhamalini and Amriteshvari. She is surrounded by Shakti soldiers, stationed in bejewelled boats. Through her mere glance, she provides intoxication to the three worlds. Her complexion is like that of the rising sun and her cheeks are red with intoxication. The braids of her hair are decorated with garlands made of *parijata* flowers. She rows amidst those lotus flowers, bearing a tumbler filled with liquor. In another bejewelled vessel, she holds a cooked piece of meat. Varuni, the leader of

those rows of boats, is radiant there. Without the permission of Mantrini and Dandanathaa, she does not allow anyone to cross the well, not even the three-eyed one.’

‘Inside that great chamber of Buddhi, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is a great chamber of Ahamkara. ¹⁰⁸⁷ As was the case earlier, it is equipped with *gopuras*. O sage! The entire ground between the two chambers is covered with a well-named *vimarsha*. This represents the *amrita* of *sushumna*. There is a wind inside the minds of great *yogis*. This rises in the cavity in the *sushumna* channel and fills it up with supreme *amrita*. O store of austerities! This is what constitutes the water in that well. As was the case earlier, it is said that there are steps, birds and boats. The Devi who oversees the boats there is known as Kurukulaa. She is as dark as a *tamala* tree and wears a dark bodice. She is surrounded by others who are in charge of boats, and they are just like her own self. There is a bejewelled oar in her hand, and she is constantly in a state of delight and inebriation. O sage! On her bejewelled boat, she roams around everywhere. The depth of the water in this lake is exactly the same as what has been described before.’

‘Inside this chamber of Ahamakara, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is the great chamber of Suryabimba. ¹⁰⁸⁸ This is four *yojanas* tall. Earlier, the rising sun was greater than the sun itself. The area between the two chambers is decorated with *kuruvindas*. ¹⁰⁸⁹ Lalitaa Parameshvari resides there, in the place where the rays of the rising sun spread. The sun performed extremely fierce austerities and obtained its resplendence. All the large number of planets, *rashis*, *nakshatras* and stars also tormented themselves through austerities there and obtained the capacity to illuminate the worlds. O sage! Martanda Bhairava is present there, in his twelve different forms. ¹⁰⁹⁰ He is with crores of Shaktis, full of energy. His form is that of great illumination and his eyes are red with intoxication. He is constantly eager to sport among the clumps of *kankola* trees. O one who suppressed Vindhya’s insolence! He is constantly immersed in this. His great Shakti is named Mahaprakashaa. Chakshumati is another Shakti and Chhayaa is said to be another. He is surrounded by these three desired

Shaktis. Using the learning, he constantly performs *japa* on Lalitaa Maheshani in his heart. He uses his radiance to illuminate those who are her devotees. Thus, he destroys the mass of darkness, inside and outside, from the roots. Martanda Bhairava shines in the region where the rays of the rising sun spread.’

‘Inside the great chamber of Suryabimba, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, is the chamber of Chandrabimba. ¹⁰⁹¹ This is four *yojanas* in height and has *gopuras*, gates and doors, as was the case earlier. The entire region within this is described as the gate to moonlight. Chandrama was born from Atri’s eye. ¹⁰⁹² In this region, the gate to moonlight, he tormented himself through extremely terrible austerities and obtained his beauty. The one known as Shri Somanatha resides there and his form is sparkling. This divinity destroys the darkness in the three worlds and ensures that *samsara* functions. Using a full and sparkling tumbler, he drinks the *amrita* of the moonlight. He is surrounded by twenty-seven *nakshatras*, as Shaktis. His form is always full, without any blemishes. The illustrious Shashi resides in the region known as the gate to moonlight. He worships Lalitaa hundreds of times, through *japa*, *dhyana* and *stotrams*. Chandrama spends his time there, along with Ashvini ¹⁰⁹³ and the others. There are thousands of other Shaktis too, known by the name of stars. They are present near him and fill up that chamber.’

‘Inside Chandra’s chamber, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, there is a chamber named Shringara and it is four *yojanas* in height. The halls of *shringara*, within it, are made out of *koustubha* jewels. The entire ground inside is covered by a moat known as Maha Shringara. That circular moat is filled with *shringara rasa*. There are Shringara Shaktis, radiant in many kinds of ornaments. Intoxicated, they travel in thousands of boats there. They always serve the one with flowers as his weapon, ¹⁰⁹⁴ who is constantly intoxicated and is on a boat. Using *sammohana* and the others, he confounds the universe. Following Lalitaa’s command, he pierces all the worlds with his arrows. Those who are stupefied by his powers go to the region known as Mahapadmatavi. They were pure garments and full of devotion, and worship Lalitaa. With an attentive mind, they proceed

towards the region of Padmatavi. However, Gods, divine *siddhas* and men do not possess the capacity to go there. Brahma, Vishnu and Mahesha are naturally pure in their minds. Following her supreme command, they can proceed to the region known as Mahapadmatavi. Those in *samsara* are blind with attachment. They conceive of many kinds of resolutions. Such men are greatly agitated and are so filthy that they do not possess the alternative *jnana*. They are deluded and submerged deep in a lot of attachment. Hence, they do not possess wisdom. They are not discriminating enough to cross the moat of Maha Shringara. The person who has the rights over the moat of Maha Shringara is Smara. His charm cannot be overcome, and he confounds the three worlds. Even the great are subject to delusion and cannot cross. Therefore, no one is capable of going to Mahapadmatavi.’

‘Inside the chamber of Shringara, at a distance of seven *yojanas*, is a residence named Chintamani. This is the great residence of Chakraraja. In its centre, the entire region is studded with jewels. This is Mahapadmatavi and it bestows every kind of good fortune. O sage! Starting with Shringara and ending with Mahakala, there are *gopuras*. In the four directions, the *gopuras* are arranged in the following way. O sage! In all the directions, it is said that there are one hundred *gopuras*. There are said to be twenty-five auspicious halls. At their base, all these halls extend for one *yojana* and are connected to the region of Padmatavi. I will describe it. Listen attentively. The distance between them is six *yojanas* and this area is completely covered with jewels. There are *sthalapadmas* ¹⁰⁹⁵ in every direction, with huge stalks. The stalks are one *yojana* long and are covered with soft thorns. Each of the leaves is as long as ten palm trees. The filaments of these lotuses are as long as five palm trees. Each pericarp is said to be as long as ten palm trees. They are extremely delicate and bloom all the time. Their large petals spread out and the fresh fragrance is pleasing. There are many crores and crores of such lotuses. O one born from a pot! On the eastern side of the chamber known as Mahapadmatavi, there is the great vessel for offering *arghya*. It is one *krosha* in height and possesses the form of a circular fire. Its diameter is half a *yojana* and it is divided into ten parts.

There are Shaktis all around the base and their bodies blaze. The fire possesses ten radiant parts, Dhumraa, Archi and others. They blaze in their youth and prosperity and are adorned with many kinds of ornaments. The illustrious and prosperous fire-god is like the base and eager for love, they seem to embrace him from every direction. The ten parts, which assume the form of the base of the fire, are said to be Dhumraa, Archi, Ushnaa, Jvalini, Vishphulingini, Sushri, Surupaa, Kapilaa, Havyavahaa and Kavyavahaa. ¹⁰⁹⁶ The divinity is established there at the base, in the form of a vessel. Surya is famous as the one who destroys the darkness of the three worlds. Surya's *atman* is in that vessel, which is one and a half *yojanas* in height. The diameter is of one *yojana* and it is filled with great radiance and illumination. All around that vessel, embracing its body, there are twelve extremely radiant rays, which are like daughters. They are Tapini, Taapini, Dhumraa, Marichi, Jvalini, Ruchi, Sushumnaa, Bhogadaa, Vishvaa, Bodhini, Dharini and Kshamaa. This vessel is the cause of supreme bliss. It is supreme *amrita*. It is full of excellent tastes and has all the herbs. It is full of a pleasant fragrance. It is constantly made fragrant by blue lotuses and waterlilies that do not fade. It is always desirable, delightful, cool and pure. There are hundreds of gentle ripples, making it worthy of being used for worshipping Lalitaa. Used for worship, it is radiant, and the ripples make a sound. It is said that this *arghya* of *amrita* is made from the digits of the moon. Within it, there are minute boats, studded with jewels. The digits of the moon, fresh with the bloom of youth, are in these boats and sport. They are Amritaa, Manadaa, Pushnaa, Tushti, Pushti, Rati, Dhriti, Shashini, Chandrikaa, Kanti, Jyotsnaa, Shrih, Priti, Angadaa, Purnaa and Purnamritaa. ¹⁰⁹⁷ These are the digits, with nectar in their rays. They possess the bloom of fresh youth, and their faces are always smiling. Brahma's digits also sport there and are said to be—Pushti, Riddhi, Sthiti, Medhaa, Kanti, Lakshmi, Dyuti, Dhriti, Jaraa and Siddhi. Hari's digits are Sthiti, Palini, Shanti, Ishvari, Tati, Kamikaa, Varadaa, Hladini, Priti and Dirghaa. Rudra's digits who are present are Tikshnaa, Roudri, Bhayaa, Nidraa, Tandraa, Kshut, Krodhini, Trapaa, Utkari and Mrityu. Ishvara's digits are said to be four in number, Pitaa, Shvetaa, Arunaa and Sitaa. ¹⁰⁹⁸ O Vindhya's enemy!

Shankara's digits are spoken of as sixteen—Nivritti, Pratishthaa, Vidya, Shanti, Indiraa, Dipikaa, Rechikaa, Mochikaa, Paraa, Sukshmaa, Sukshamritaa, Sukshmakalaa, Jnanamritaa, Vyadhini, Vyapini and Vyomarupikaa. These Shaktis sport there. In the form of Shaktis, thousands of different kinds of learning are present there. They move around and sport, astride Rudra's boat. For the sake of purifying the *arghya*, Parameshthi conceived them. Drinking that *arghya* of *amrita*, the Shaktis are always intoxicated. They reside in that great wheel of Mahapadmatavi. The *arghya* becomes fresh all the time and is repeatedly filled with fragrances. There are thousands of bejewelled pots and golden pitchers. They are constantly filled with that great *arghya* of *amrita*. For those who reside in the homes in Chintamani, Shaktis are attendants. Intoxicated, they offer the *arghya* to *anima* and other Shaktis. Towards the east of the chamber of Mahapadmatavi, the *arghya* has been thought of in this fashion and I have described it. I will speak about other things later.'

Chapter 148-2(36) (Inside the residence of Chintamani)

Hayagriva said, 'To the south-east of the residence of Chintamani, there is the mansion Kundamanaka. It is one *yojana* long and wide. Along with *chataka* birds, it rises one *yojana*. The fire of *chit* ¹⁰⁹⁹ blazes there and is worshipped by hundreds of flows of nectar. Following Lalitaa's command, it purifies and gives rise to great prosperity. The great blaze has no kindling but is fuelled by the nectar. The flames blaze in a place where there is the shade of tender *kankola* trees. Mahadevi is the *hotree* there and Kameshvara is the *hotri*. ¹¹⁰⁰ Both of them are the eternal *hotris* and protect the universe. Lalitaa functions. She has no superior and is not subordinate to anyone. Urged by Lalitaa and Shankara, Kama functions. To the south-west of the excellent mansion of Chintamani, there is a lotus grove. Chakraratha, the best among chariots, is there. It is lofty. It possesses nine layers and is studded with jewels everywhere. It extends for four *yojanas* and the height is ten *yojanas*. As one goes up, the expanse becomes shorter. The pole is

thick and radiant. The four *Vedas* are the large wheels. The *purusharthas* are the large horses. The *tattvas* assume the form of beautiful whisks and serve it. It possesses the characteristics that have been mentioned earlier and is adorned with an umbrella made of pearls. In the great battle against Bhandasura, it displayed great deeds of bravery. In the midst of the chariot, is the pedestal with Shri Devi's seat. To the north-west of the excellent residence of Chintamani, there is a grove of lotuses. Mantrini's Geyachakra, Indra among chariots, can be found at this end. To the north-east of the excellent residence of Chintamani, is another grove of lotuses.

Dandanathaa's beloved chariot, the great chariot of Geyachakra, is there. As the three divinities are equally established in the limbs, it should be known that these three chariots are established in the arrays of *kshetras* that constitute Shripura. There is a fire that constantly blazes in a pit towards the south-east. Performing austerities there is the same as performing austerities with *gayatri mantra*, bestowing freedom from fear. O ascetic! Behind that, there is Surya in the form of Ghrini,¹¹⁰¹ with the temple of Oumkara,¹¹⁰² and Devi Turiyagayatri¹¹⁰³ and Chakshusmati. Parishadrudra, king of *gandharvas*, and Bhagavati Tarambikaa are established behind. Bhagavan Hari, whose three names are spoken about in the great *mantra*,¹¹⁰⁴ resorts to the south-western part of Chintamani, Indra among residences. The great Ganapati makes his residence towards the north. Shiva is further north, spoken about in the *panchakshari mantra*.¹¹⁰⁵ Or, the lord who conquered death can be spoken about in three *aksharas* alone.¹¹⁰⁶ Sarasvati, who assumes the form of *dharana*, is also said to reside in the north. O destroyer of enemies! Matrikaa's body starts with the *akshara* and ends with .¹¹⁰⁷ O suppressor of Vindhya! Her mansion is to the north of Sarasvati's.

Sampadeshi and Kala-samkarshani are to the north and so is Shri Maha Shambhunathaa, the cause of Devi's manifestation. There are divinities whose residences have been created to the north of this—Shri, Parambaa, Vishadajyotsna and Nirmalavighrahaa. There are four who have abodes further north—Balaa, Annapurnaa, Hayarudhaa and Shripadukaa. On the ground that is to the north-west of the excellent residence of Chintamani, there are divinities whose abodes have been built in Mahapadmatavi. There

are Unmattabhairavi, Svapnavarahikaa, Tiraskarani Ambaa, a fourth and a fifth. As was the case earlier, these great Devis have their abodes there. Mahadevi Shripurti and Shri Mahapadukaa, these two excellent divinities, have their abodes there, as was the case earlier. ¹¹⁰⁸ All this knowledge, pertaining to the region of Mahapadmatavi has been expounded by Shankra in *Shadamnayagasara*. ¹¹⁰⁹ In this way, there are great and illustrious mansions, with garlands of rays and covered with jewels. O store of austerities! Flags flutter above and the lofty chambers have flights of stairs. O one who drank up the ocean! At the eastern gate of Chintamani, the excellent residence, on the side to the right, there is Mantranathaa's great residence. On the left side is Dandanathaa's residence, constructed with jewels. This is to the east of the place meant for *arghya*, where Brahma, Vishnu and Mahesha reside. The residence, and all the directions, blaze because of rays from jewels. All the divinities present there are full of devotion towards Lalitaa. They worship Shri Devi and perform *japa* with Lalitaa's *mantra*. For the southern gate, the place for offering *arghya* and the means of making *arghya* have been described earlier. It is said to be the same for all the gates.'

'O great sage! After this, I will describe the residence of Chintamani. Listen. It is located at the centre of Shri's pedestal and is said to extend for two *yojanas*. The base, constructed out of *chintamani*, extends for one *krosha*. The coverings that spread out above are also made out of *chintamani* rocks. Here and there, these are lofty and rise in the form of peaks. The walls of the residence are four *yojanas* in height. The floors that rise up above are said to extend for twenty *yojanas*. As one rises, it tapers and there are three blazing crowns at the top. O *rishi*! These crowns are the forms of *iccha*, *kriya* and *jnana*. ¹¹¹⁰ Constructed out of *chintamani*, they blaze all the time. Everything in the mansion of Chintamani is said to be made out of *chintamani*. Each of the four gates is half a *krosha* in width. O sage! The depth of the doors is said to be one-quarter of a *krosha*. This is true of all the doors that are inside the residence of Chintamani too. Lalitaa Devi's form is like an ocean that is red but is hidden. Her form is as radiant as one thousand rising suns, but as cool as the moon. O great sage! The

form repeatedly assumes the nature of a flow. The gate to the east is said to consist of Purvanamnyaya and the gate to the south has the attributes of Dakshinamnyaya. The gate to the west has the signs of Paschimamnyaya and the gate to the north has the attributes of Uttaranamnyaya. Inside that king among houses, decorated handles are stuck to the walls. Bejewelled and radiant lamps are fixed to these and their resplendence is like that of one crore suns. In every direction, these illuminate the interior of the mansion. In the great centre of the residence of Chintamani, there is an extremely lofty altar, with the even greater Binduchakra. After leaving out one *krosha*, because of the walls, the space between the lofty residence of Chintamani and Binduchakra is said to be three *kroshas*. This region of three *kroshas* is occupied by the rays of *anima* and the others. The entire region of three *kroshas* can also be enumerated in *hastas*. It is said to amount to twenty-four thousand *hastas*.’

‘Bindu up to Peethesha, there are fourteen divisions. ¹¹¹¹ Using *hastas*, I will enumerate these divisions. O sage! The inside of the abode of Chintamani is twenty *hastas* above the region of Padmavati and *anima* and the others reside there. ¹¹¹² Inside, the abodes of *anima* and the others extend for four *nalvas*. A *kishku* consists of four hundred *nalvas* and *kishku* and *hasta* have the same meaning. Inside, starting with the east, there are abodes for *anima* and the others. These are *anima*, *mahima*, *laghima*, *garima*, *ishitvam*, *vashitvam*, *prakamya*, *mukti*, *iccha*, *prapti* and *sarvakama*. These are the excellent *siddhis*. Many *siddhis* are spoken about and revered by yogis. There are the eight *siddhis*—*rasa-siddhi*, *moksha-siddhi*, *bala-siddhi*, *khadga-siddhi*, *paduka-siddhi* or *anjana-siddhi*, *vaksiddhi*, *loka-siddhi* and *deha-siddhi*. ¹¹¹³ Inside, all of them surround Parameshvari and serve her. O sage! Other than *anima* and the others, there are crores of other *siddhis* inside too. They possess the fresh bloom of youth, and their lotus faces smile. Their hands shine, like *chintamani*. They are always sixteen years old. Their nature is extremely generous and intoxicated and eager, they sport.’

‘Inside, and above *anima* and the others, there is an extremely beautiful residence. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four

nalvas. In the four directions, there are exceedingly beautiful flights of stairs. Starting with Brahmi and ending with the one who arose from the ocean, hear about the Devis who are stationed there. They are Brahmi, Maheshvari, Koumari, Vaishnavi, Varahi, Mahendri, Chamundaa as the seventh and Mahalakshmi as the eighth. Their residences have been constructed there. They possess many excellent weapons and many Shaktis are their attendants. Starting with the east, these abodes have been designed in a clockwise direction.’

‘O one born from a pot! Inside, and above Brahmi and the others, there is the abode named Mudrantara. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. Ten *mudras* have their residences there— Samkshobha, Dravana, Akarsha, Vashya, Unmada, Mahankusha, Khechari, Bija, Yoni and the one known as Trikhanda as the tenth. ¹¹¹⁴ Starting with the east, the *mudras* are established here. They are extremely charming in form. With the fresh bloom of youth, they are restless. With their beauty and charm, they fill up the inside of the residence. O tiger among sages! They serve Lalitaa Parameshvari. Inside, these three floors delude the three worlds. These are the Shaktis who manifest themselves and their names have been spoken about. Tripuraa is established there, as the leader of this *chakra*. The mudra known as Samkshobhanaa is the one who protects this circle.’

‘Inside, and above the *mudras*, it is said that the Nityakalaas exist. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. It is said that flights of stairs rise, one above the other. The Nityakalaas, with Kamakarshanikaa as the foremost, are inside. They have made their abodes all around, and their *atmans* consist of the sixteen digits of the moon. With exceedingly cool nectar, they satisfy the directions in that circle. O one born from the pot! Hear about their names from me. They are Kamakarshanikaa, Nityaa Buddhyakarshanikaa, Rasakarshanikaa, Nityaa Gandhakarshanikaa, Chittakarshanikaa, Nityaa Dhairyakarshanikaa, Smrityakarshanikaa, Nityaa Namakarshanikaa, Bijakarshanikaa, Nityaa Arthakarshanikaa, Amritakarshanikaa and Sharirakarshanikaa. ¹¹¹⁵ These are secret *yoginis* and the Chakrini is Tripureshi. She is also known as Sarvashapurikaa ¹¹¹⁶ and

she is the divinity who is established in this *chakra*. The *mudra* who protects this *chakra* is named Dravinikaa.’

‘Above the Nityakalaas, there is an exceedingly beautiful residence. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. As before, it has flights of stairs and it is known as Sarvasamkshobhana. There are eight Shaktis there and their eyes are red with intoxication. Proud because of their fresh youth, they serve Parameshvari. These eight Shaktis are Kusumaa, Mekhalaa, Madanaa, Madanaturaa, Rekhaa, Vegini, Ankushaa and Malini. With Anangapurvikaa as the foremost, they have crores of Shaktis as attendants. This *chakra* is known as Sarvasamkshobhana. The presiding divinity there is Sundari, also known under the name of Guptataraa. The *mudra* who protects the place is described as Karshanikaa.’

‘O one born from the pot! Above Ananga Shakti, ¹¹¹⁷ inside, there is a residence that is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. This is Samkshobhini and it bestows every kind of good fortune. Fourteen Shaktis, Sarvasamkshobhini being the foremost, dwell there. Listen to their names. They are Sarvasamkshobhini, the Shakti Sarvavidravini, Sarvakarshanikaa, the Shakti Sarvahladanikaa, Sarvasammohini, the Shakti Sarvastambhanikaa, Sarvajrimbhinikaa, the Shakti Sarvavashamkari, the Shakti Sarvaranjani, the Shakti Sarvonmadanikaa, Sarvarthasadhikaa, the Shakti Sarvasampattipurini, Sarvamantramayi and the Shakti Sarvadvandakshayamkari. These reside in the city of Chakrini and are known as Sampradayaa. It is held that the *mudras* known as Sarvavashyaas protect this *chakra*. There are crores of Shaktis who are their servants.’

‘O one born from a pot! Inside and above Samkshobhini, twenty *hastas* above the floor below, there is a residence that extends for four *nalvas*. This is the excellent mansion of Sarvasiddhipradaa and others. These Devis, representing the parts, are Sarvasiddhipradaa, Sarvasampatpradaa, Sarvapriyamkari, Devi Sarvamangalakarini, Sarvakamapradaa, Devi Sarvaduhamochini, Sarvamrityuprashamani, Sarvavighnanivarini, Sarvangasundari and Devi Sarvasoubhagyadayini. They are also known

under the name of *yoginis*. This *chakra* accomplishes every objective and the Chakrini is known as Shri. The protector of this *chakra* is the *mudra* Sarvonmadana.’

‘O one born from the pot! Inside and above Sarvasiddhipradaa and others, twenty *hastas* above the floor below, there is a residence that extends for four *nalvas*. This belongs to Sarvajnaa and others and has the name of Sarvarakshara. This *chakra* of Sarvajnaa and others is said to be large and divine. These leading *yoginis* are Sarvajnaa, Sarvashakti, Sarvaisharyapradayini, Sarvajnanamayai, Devi Sarvavyadhivinashini, Sarvadharaśvarupa, Sarvapapahari, Sarvanandamayai, Sarvarakshasvarupini and Sarvepsitapradaa. Malini is described as the Chakrini and the *mudra* is Sarvamahankushaa. These are the *chakras* inside Chintamani, up to Sarvajnaa and others. O sage! There are said to be other *chakras*. Hear about them.’

Chapter 149-2(37) (Inside the residence of Chintamani, continued)

Hayagriva continued, ‘O one born from a pot! Inside and above that of Sarvajnaa and others, it should be known that there is the residence of Vashini and others. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor and extends for four *nalvas*. As before, it has flights of stairs and mansions. This *chakra* is famous under the name of Sarvarogahara. Starting in the east, in the due order, there are Vashini and other Devis. Along with all the vowels, the first one there is Vashini. Next, there is Kameshvari, the Goddess of speech, along with all the letters in the series. ¹¹¹⁸ The third is said to be Modini, the Goddess of speech, along with all the letters in the series. Vimalaa, the Goddess of speech, is next, ornamented with all the letters in the series. The fifth is Pradharanaa, the Goddess of speech, with the letters of the series. The sixth is held to be Jayini, infused with the letters of the series. Sarvaisharyaa, the Goddess of speech, is next, in a square with the four letters , , and . Koulini is held to be the eighth, with the six *aksharas* ,

, , , *anusvara* and *visarga*. Adorned with ornaments made of pearls, all these Devis are engaged in *japa*. It is said that they are constantly nurtured by flows of prose and poetry. O one born from a pot! They are present there, amusing Shri Devi with sweet poetry and plays that are pleasant to the ears. O one who scorched Vatapi! ¹¹¹⁹ They are famous under their secret names. The leader of this *chakra* is said to be the one named Siddha. It is said that the protector of this *chakra* is Khechhari.'

'O one who crushed Vindhya! Inside and above Vashini and the others, there is the *chakra* known as Astra. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. It should be known that the divinities there are Banaa and others. These five Devis are known as Baneshvaris and they are Kameshvara's five arrows. ¹¹²⁰ The two goads of the original man and original woman blaze. O Vindhya's enemy! There are two bows two. These are thought of as nine lotuses. ¹¹²¹ O one born from the pot! With two blazing nooses, there are four excellent weapons. There are four for Kameshvari and four for Shri Mahesha. Thus, taken together, there are eight weapons that shine and blaze. In the great battle against Bhandasura, these divine weapons drank the blood of wicked *danavas* and became content. They are awake. These weapons have other weapons as attendants. The number of weapons inside runs into crores. There are the Shaktis of *vajra*, *shataghni*, *bhushundi*, *musala*, *kripana*, *pattisha*, *mudgara* and *bhindipala*. ¹¹²² There are thousands and thousands of such weapons. Intoxicated and eager, they serve the great Shaktis of the eight weapons.'

'O scorcher of Vatapi! Inside and above the weapons, there is the excellent abode of the three Samayeshis. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. There are three Devis, Kameshi and others. There is also a fourth one. They constantly serve Lalitaa, the mother of the universe. Listen to the names of the three. Kameshi is described as the first. The others are Vajreshi and Bhagamalaa and thousands serve them. These different kinds of Devis are said to represent all the *darshanas*. All of them there serve those great ones, Kameshi and others. In this connection, it is Shri Devi who completes and fills the *atmans* of the Nityaas, Chakrinis and *yoginis*. Lalitaa Ambikaa lies down on

Kameshvara's lap and is said to be the fourth, along with Kameshi and the others. She is held to be one among the sixteen Nityaas. She is described as the ninth among *yoginis* and Chakrinis.'

'O slayer of Ilvala! ¹¹²³ Inside and above the Samayeshis, there is the residence known as Nathantara. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. As before, it is adorned with flights of stairs. The Nathaa Mahadevis are there, those who have propounded the texts of *yoga*. All of them are *gurus* who have bestowed *mantras*. All of them are great oceans of every kind of learning. For the protection of the worlds, there are four Yoganathaas. The divinity Kamesha created them. Hear their names. O one born from the pot! There are known as Mitri, Shoudisha and Charya. ¹¹²⁴ For the protection of the worlds, they created many *padukas*. ¹¹²⁵ Possessing divine learning, there were humans, groups of *siddhas* and Gods who followed austerities. They obtained the *siddhis* of *salokya*, *sarupya* and *sayujya*. They were great *gurus*, and many served these *gurus*.'

'Inside and above the residence of Nathaas, there is an excellent residence. This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. This is known as Nityantara and there are fifteen Nityaas there. These are Nityaa Kameshvari, Nityaa Bhagamalini, Nityaa Klinnaa, Bherundaa, Vahnivasini, Mahavajreshvari, Duti, Tvaritaa, Kulasundari, Nityaa Nilapatakaa, Vijayaa, Sarvamangalaa, Jvalamalinikaa and Chitraa. ¹¹²⁶ These are said to be the fifteen and they are Devi's own forms. They are extremely strong and valiant. Starting with the first *tithi* of *prathama*, they pervade the three worlds. Their forms are those of the three periods of time. ¹¹²⁷ They are accomplished enough to devour time too. They are established, following Devi's command. They remain for a long period of time. Starting with Brahma and encompassing everything else, they represent lifespans of one hundred years. They are always eager and never suffer from any fear. They have originated from Shri's supreme limbs. For the prosperity of the worlds, they serve Lalitaa, whose form is that of consciousness. Their blazing residences are considered to be fifteen Ishvaras. Shodashi's abode is the Binduchakra of creation.'

‘O one born from the pot! Inside and above the residence of the Nityaas, is said to be the abode of the Angadevis. ¹¹²⁸ This is twenty *hastas* above the floor below and extends for four *nalvas*. As before, it possesses flights of stairs and mansions. O sage! Hridaya Devi and the other Shaktis exist there. The six are said to be Hridaya Devi, Shirodevi, Shikha Devi, Varma Devi, Drishti Devi and Shastra Devi. ¹¹²⁹ They are extremely close to Shri Kameshvara, who possesses excellent eyebrows. Their limbs are full of the fresh bloom of youth, and they carefully hold up their weapons. Proud in their forms, they wander around the *peetha* of Bindu. They implement Lalitaa’s commands. These controlled ones ensure that the *peetha* functions properly.’

‘Inside and above the Angadevis, there is the great *peetha* of Bindunada and it is in the form of a *mandala*. This is ten *hastas* above the floor below and extends for eight *nalvas*. It resembles the rising sun. Bindu *peetha* is also known as Shree *peetha*, Maha *peetha*, Vidya *peetha* and Ananda *peetha*. It has the forms of fifty different *peethas*. The great Shri Lalitaa Devi has the five *brahmanas* inside her. ¹¹³⁰ Her jewel among couches is there and it is the root cause of *prapancha*. That couch is said to have four legs. Each of these is ten *hastas* tall and three *hastas* wide. Brahma, Vishnu, Mahesha and Ishvara have assumed these forms. Since they constantly perform *dhyana* on Shri, they have been infused with the powers of the Shaktis. One of the five legs has the complexion of a *japa* flower. It should be known that its *atman* is Brahma. It is in the south-eastern direction. The fourth leg of the couch has the complexion of a *karnikara* flower. It should be known that its *atman* is Ishvara and it is in the north-eastern direction. ¹¹³¹ All of them possess weapons and are bedecked in every kind of ornament. Above and below, they have the forms of pillars. In the centre, they have the forms of beings. As they perform *dhyana* on Shri, their eyes are closed. Since they are immersed in *dhyana* on Shri, their limbs do not move. Above them, the plank of the couch is Sadashiva. Its complexion is like that of a pomegranate flower. It is six *nalvas* long and four *nalvas* broad. Its form is always radiant. O ascetic! From the residence of the Angadevis and up to the plank of this couch, there are radiant stairs. These

are made out of *chintamani* and these are the forms of the *tattvas*. Thirty-six of them reside there. I will describe these stairs, in ascending order. They are earth, water, fire, wind, space, smell, taste, form, touch, sound, genital organ, anus, feet, hands, organ of speech, nose, tongue, skin, eyes, ears, *ahamkara*, *buddhi*, *manah*, Prakriti, Purusha, destiny, time, attachment, *kalaa*, learning, *maya*, pure Vidyeshvara, Sadashiva, Shakti and Shiva. Thus, the flights of thirty-six stairs which are in the nature of the *tattvas* have been described. These shining flights of stairs are to the east of the couch. On top of that excellent couch, there is a bed made out of the feathers of a swan. It extends for four *nalvas*, but its height is only one *hasta*. There are two resplendent pillows, one for the head and the other for the feet. It is adorned with sixty-four pink and golden vases. The top of the couch is covered with a spread that is crimson in colour. It is pure and soft, with a hue resembling that of rubies. Bhagavan Kameshvara Shiva, the primordial divinity, is seated on this, facing the eastern direction. He is full of compassion. He is always sixteen years old, and his beautiful garments are always ready for *shringara*. He dazzles like the disc of the rising sun and possesses four hands and three eyes. He is ornamented with necklaces, bracelets, diadems, bangles and other things. His pleasant smile resembles moonlight, spreading everywhere on his cheeks. He is constantly awake.’

‘She is seated on his lap, red like the rising sun. She is proud of the fresh bloom of youth and is always sixteen years old. She has the complexion of a ruby that has not been polished. Her nails possess the tinge of sandalwood and lotus. Even without red lac being applied, the soles of Shri Lalitaa Devi feet are red. The sound of the anklets and bangles is charming. Her hips quell the pride of Ananga’s excellent quiver. Her beautiful thighs are like the trunks of elephants and resemble the beauty of the trunks of plantain trees. Her excellent buttocks can be clearly seen through a red and thin piece of cloth. Her shining loins are radiant. A shining girdle is set with gems and its knot extends up to the middle of her thighs. Her depressed navel is like a large eddy and the three lines above it shine, like waves in a river. She wears hundreds of necklaces made of pearls and they swing over her breasts. Because of the burden of her very thick breasts, her thin waist

seems to break. Her hands are as soft as *shirisha* flowers. Her four hands are adorned with rows of armlets, bracelets and bangles. There are rings on her fingers. Her beautiful neck is like a conch shell and touches her husband. Her face is round like a mirror and surrounds her cheeks. Her lips are red. Her row of sparkling teeth shine, as if they are forms of learning. They are as radiant as the buds of jasmine and these teeth seem to radiate moonlight. As a result of the many ornaments made from large pearls, she is dazzling. Her long eyes are like the inner petals of a *ketaki* flower. Her forehead is decorated by the half-moon, with her neatly arranged hair appearing like shade. The tips of her ears are adorned with earrings made from rubies. Her preparations of betel are always perfumed with fresh camphor and musk. Her sweet face resembles the disc of the autumn moon. Her diadem is studded with the essence of *chintamani*. The third eye in her forehead shines, its complexion like that of a sparkling *tilaka*. Her mass of hair is thick, resembling dense darkness. There is a radiant mark of *sindura* in the parting of her hair. The dazzling crescent moon is like a diadem and her eyes dart around. She wears excellent garments, exemplifying *shringara*. She is adorned in every kind of ornament. She is the mother of all the worlds. She enhances eternal bliss. She is the origin of Brahma, Vishnu, Girisha, Isha and Sadashiva. With sidelong glances, she satisfies everyone with streams of compassion. Bhagavati Lalitaa Ambikaa, the destroyer of sins, is resplendent. It is known that the fruits obtained from worshipping other *devas* are fruits obtained from worshipping her. The fruits of her worship are said to be the worship itself.'

'How can I describe that Lalitaa Devi? Even if one tries for thousands of crores of years, it will be impossible to describe even one portion. Since her form cannot be described, what purpose will words serve? Words cannot reach her. She cannot be reached through thoughts. What is the need to speak a lot? Listen to the truth. I am not saying this out of partiality, affection or delusion. O store of austerities! Let the branches of a *kalpataru* ¹¹³² be pens. Let all the seven large oceans be pots for storing ink. Let the earth, extending for fifty crores of *yojanas*, be the paper to write. Let the time given for writing be a *parardha* number of years. Let everyone write

and let each of them possess one crore hands. O one born from a pot! Even if everyone is as eloquent as Brihaspati, it will be impossible to describe one-thousandth portion of the radiance on one of Shri Devi's toenails on her lotus feet. All activities are futile when one seeks to praise her superior qualities. There is a curtain on four sides of Bindu *peetha*. This is a long curtain of great *maya*, and it is dark in hue. Forty *hastas* above the ground, there is a canopy that is held aloft Devi. This is a canopy made of *indragopa* insects and it is extremely rare in the three worlds. The nets of ornaments that are there are also extremely rare in the three worlds. If I seek to describe these, my words choke in shame. She alone knows about all the qualities. Her good fortune is beyond the reach of the mind. Who can describe it? Thus, for the sake of killing Bhandas *daitya*, Lalitaa Ambikaa manifested herself from the fire of consciousness and burnt down all the *danavas*. Divine architects constructed sixteen *kshetras* for her residence. Presiding over them, she lives in Shrinagara and always protects the universe. In this way, there are other Shripuras too. There is no difference between these cities. The difference is only in name. Those who speak, in the due order, about this account of Shripura, with its many trees and large and beautiful gardens, go to the supreme destination. If men hear it, ask about it, or seek it, or even if they hold this book, they proceed to the supreme destination. All those who use artisans to create a replica of Shripura, with its walls and different divisions within it, or those who construct large temples for Shri Devi, are devotees who proceed to the supreme destination.'

Chapter 150-2(38) (*Sadhana* with the king of *mantras*)

Agastya said, ‘I have heard the great account about the great manifestation, about the slaying of Bhandasura and Devi’s residence in Shrinagara. I now wish to hear about the *mantra* used to perform her *sadhana*. Please tell me everything about the attributes of those *mantras*.’

Hayagriva answered, ‘Among the meanings of all *padas*, the object that is the greatest is the sound. ¹¹³³ O great sage! Among all sounds, the collections in the *Vedas* are the greatest. Among everything in the *Vedas*, the *Veda mantras* are the greatest. Among all the *Veda mantras*, Vishnu’s *mantras* are the greatest. O bull among sages! But Durgaa’s *mantras* are greater than those too. O sage! However, in vigour, Ganapati’s *mantras* are greater than those. Arka’s ¹¹³⁴ *mantras* are greater than those and in turn, Shiva’s *mantras* are greater. Lakshmi’s *mantras* are greater than those and Sarasvati’s *mantras* are superior to those. Girijaa’s *mantras* are greater than those. The different kinds of *amnaya mantras* are superior to any of these. ¹¹³⁵ Among all the *amnaya mantras*, Varaha *mantras* are the greatest. ¹¹³⁶ O destroyer of Ilvala! The *mantras* to Shyamaa are superior to those. Lalitaa’s *mantras* are superior to those and are divided into ten types. O crusher of Vindhya! Among those, two kings of *mantras* are supreme. These are known under the names of Lopamudra and Kamaraja. The one that starts with “*ha*” is known as Lopamudraa and the one that starts with “*ka*” is known as Kamaraja. ¹¹³⁷ Kamaraja Maheshvara is worshipped under Hamsa and other names. Devi Shri Lalitaa Ambikaa is worshipped under Smara and other names. Three letters cause the difference between the *mantra* that begins with “*ha*” and the *mantra* that begins with “*ka*”. ¹¹³⁸ Among these, Kamaraja bestows *siddhi* on those who are filled with devotion. The first set of five letters is identified with Shiva, Shakti, Kama, Kshiti and *maya*. ¹¹³⁹ The second set consists of Hamsa, Bhrigu, Kama, the one with the moon on the crescent and Shakra. The third set consists of Bhuvanasha, Chandra, Smara, *kshiti* and the line in the heart. This is said to be the king among

mantras, concerning Hamsa and the others. Smara is the origin of the king among *mantras*, concerning Kama and others, and emanating from Shri's mouth. This is great knowledge, where Lalitaa Ambaa is spoken about in three sets of five. Those who use this to worship her are extremely fortunate and achieve every kind of *siddhi*. This consecrated *mantra*, consisting of three sets of five, must be received from a virtuous *guru*. After this, the learned person must perform *sadhana* in the proper way. I will describe the method. I will speak about it in the due order. O sage! Listen attentively.'

'He must get up in the morning and think of a dazzling lotus within his head. It is brilliant, with one thousand petals and has excellent filaments and a pericarp. He must next meditate on his illustrious *guru*, who is pleasant and full of compassion, within the lotus. Going out, he must complete his ablution rites. When he returns, he must smear himself with scented oil. Thereafter, he must bathe properly in pure and hot water. Water is naturally pure. What need be said when it is heated in fire? Hence, he should bathe in hot water. If that is not available, any water will do. He must next wear two clean pieces of cloth, orange or red in colour. After completing *achamana*, the learned person will then perform *dhyana* on supreme Ambikaa in his heart. As is appropriate for him, he must then make a mark on his forehead with *urddhapundra*, *tripundra*, *pattavardhana* or *agastyapatra*.¹¹⁴⁰ Pure in his *atman*, in a secluded place, he must then perform the *sandhya* worship. In a vessel that is in the form of an *ashvattha* leaf, he must offer an *arghya* to Martanda, consisting of *kusha*, *akshata*, flowers and sandalwood. Devi Lalitaa is also worthy of *arghyas* and three *arghyas* must be offered to her. According to his capacity, he must use the root *mantra* to satisfy Laliteshvari. Following the norms, he must then satisfy *devas*, *rishis* and groups of ancestors. He must worship the sun and Devi, present in the solar disc. Silent and pure in his heart, he must then enter the chamber where the sacrifice is to be performed. He must smear himself with beautiful camphor, musk, sandalwood paste and other unguents. He must adorn his limbs with ornaments. His garments must be beautiful, befitting of *shringara*. He must adorn his hair with beautiful garlands made of flowers. His ornaments will depend on his wealth.

Alternatively, he can merely think of these ornaments. In the section on worship, the rites of *nyasa* have been described. ¹¹⁴¹ This must be performed in the due order. He must then be seated on a soft seat, performing *dhyana* on the great Shrinagara, starting with great gardens with many kinds of trees, and ending with Lalitaa. Pure inside and outside, he will meditate on the divine Shringara. A discriminating person will follow the methods spoken about in the section on worship and perform worship. He will pick up a string of *aksha* ¹¹⁴² beads, made fragrant with camphor and musk. He will face the north or the east and perform *japa* on Ishvari, seated on her throne. If this *japa* is performed three million and six hundred thousand times, Vidyaa ¹¹⁴³ is pleased. The number of times oblations is offered must be one-tenth the number of times *japa* is performed. The number of times *tarpana* is performed must be one-tenth the number of times oblations is offered. It is said that the number of *brahmanas* who are fed must be one-tenth the number of times *tarpana* is performed.’

‘Once a person has obtained *siddhi* with this *mantra*, he can again perform *japa* as he wishes. By merely performing *japa* one hundred thousand times, he can bring men under his subjugation. If he performs *japa* two hundred thousand times, he can bring all women under his subjugation. If he performs *japa* three hundred thousand times, he can bring all the kings under his control. If he performs *japa* four hundred thousand times, all the daughters of serpents become agitated. ¹¹⁴⁴ If he performs *japa* five hundred thousand times, this happens for all the women who reside in Patala. If he performs *japa* six hundred thousand times, all the beautiful women in Bhuloka come under his control. If he performs *japa* seven hundred thousand times, this happens for all the doe-eyed women in Svarloka. If he performs *japa* eight hundred thousand times, this happens for all those who are born in the *deva* species. If he performs *japa* nine hundred thousand times, all the Gods come under his control. If he performs *japa* one million and one hundred thousand times, this happens for Brahma, Vishnu and Maheshvara. If he performs *japa* one million and two hundred thousand times, the eight *siddhis* come under his control. Earlier, using this *mantra*, Indra obtained his status of Indra, Vishnu

obtained his status as Vishnu, Shiva obtained his status as Shiva, Indu ¹¹⁴⁵ his status as Chandra and Bhanu ¹¹⁴⁶ obtained his status as Bhaskara. All the *devas* blaze because of this *siddhi*. All this has happened through this king among *mantras*. Understand this.'

'A person who performs *japa* with this *mantra* is devoid of sin. He becomes the most beautiful in the three worlds, confounding even Manmatha. He possesses all the *siddhis*. He is omniscient and is worshipped by everyone. Merely through seeing him, the hearts of others are filled. In words, he becomes like Vachaspati. ¹¹⁴⁷ In prosperity, he comes to resemble Shri's consort. He is like the Maruts in strength and like the Himalaya in stability. He is Meru's equal in loftiness. In depth, he is like the great ocean. In an instant, his form can agitate villages, small rural settlements and cities. Through the slightest furrowing of his eyebrows, he can cause *stambhana*, *jrimbhana*, *ucchatana*, *mohana* and *marana* for those who are evil in their minds. ¹¹⁴⁸ When he is enraged, the deceitful seek to placate him. His sight causes delight. There is nothing from the eighteen kinds of learning that is not known to him. His speech is as sweet as the flow of Mandakini. ¹¹⁴⁹ O one born from the pot! There is nothing in all the sacred texts that is unknown to him. He is accomplished enough to rebut all the different kinds of *darshana*. He knows the truth about everything and attains a state of being omniscient. His heart is always compassionate towards all beings. The three worlds are unable to tolerate the fire of his rage.'

'As soon as they see him, the minds of women, possessing beautiful eyebrows, are agitated. At their waists, the knots of their garments become loose. Their girdles slip down and their earrings are dislodged. As a result of drops of sweat, their bodies seem to be adorned with strings of pearls. As a result of great desire, their eyes dart around. The rows of bangles slip off their hands, which are like lotuses. Their thighs become stiff, and they lower their heads in shame. The vaginas ¹¹⁵⁰ become moist. Their body hair stands up and resembles ornaments. As a result of what Kama does, they seem to assume different forms. Like blazing *kadamba* flowers, their great desire makes them blaze. They glance around as if afflicted by showers of

Ananga's fiery arrows. They suffer from anxiety and their bodies are hot with fever. The perspiration of exhaustion sprinkles this and they dry it up in shame. Regardless of family, birth, good conduct and shame because of the family, they cast aside fear of both the worlds, fear of relatives and fear of the other world. Seeking him in their hearts, they become like deer. Wherever he may be, in the forest, in a habitation, in the temple of *devas* or in a monastery, those doe-eyed ones rush towards him. When the leaf of a lotus is struck, a drop of water on it moves around. On seeing him, their minds become like that.'

'He is humble, and the great fruit is that he drives away those who are not modest. In rows, all the different kinds of learning serve him. In the form of a woman, the three worlds become attached to him, as soon as she sees him. She is beautiful, with two breasts that are like the solar and the lunar disc. O store of austerities! That being the case, what need be said about women who are inferior? His sacred fame is always announced in habitations, streets, squares and forests. He is like a divine tree. As soon as sinners see him, their nets of sins are destroyed. Everywhere, excellent poets recite his qualities. There are those who meditate on Mahadevi, using different sheaths and weapons, different mounts and ornaments. Regardless, the *siddhis* serve them. The first part of the *mantra* possesses the white radiance of a jasmine flower or the moon. Flaming, that blaze should be thought of in the *chakra* that is at the root of the heart. ¹¹⁵¹ The second part of the *mantra* resembles an *indragopa* insect. Like a blazing flame, it should be thought of in the *chakra* of the heart, extending all the way up to the tips of hair on the head. The third part is inside a two-petalled lotus on the forehead. This is the part that conveys one beyond all sins. If one desires emancipation, one should meditate on Ambikaa. She is white in complexion and resembles moonlight. If one is interested in controlling others, one should meditate on her, with a complexion like that of the red rays of *sandhya*. If one desires to gain every kind of prosperity, one should think of her as dark in her limbs. Blue is the colour if one wishes to render others dumb and yellow is the colour when one seeks to paralyze others. To obtain the powers of being a poet, her form will be like that of sparkling crystal,

with clear cheeks. To obtain riches, one must think of Lalitambikaa's form, golden in complexion. There are those who meditate on her as a blazing mass of energy, resembling a lamp made of rubies, beginning with *muladhara chakra* and ending with *brahmarandhra*.¹¹⁵² They obtain all the *siddhis*. O one born from a pot! Thus, there are many differences in methods of performing *dhyana* on Shridevi. Those who do this, obtain great prosperity. She can only be reached by virtuous people, never by those who are not. Only those who have tormented themselves through fierce austerities are capable of performing this *dhyana* in their *atmans*. They do not have any birth thereafter. Unless a person is like Shankara himself, he is incapable of obtaining this knowledge about Lalitaa Parameshvari. If this *mantra* exists in any lineage, everyone in that lineage will be satisfied and obtain liberation. There is no doubt about this. All the sacred texts have determined that this is secret and is the greatest of secrets. The *Vedas* and all the sacred texts praise Laliteshvari. She is the *paramatman* and she is the supreme destination. She is the greatest of *tirthas*. She is the greatest of fruits. The sages sing about her. Sanaka and the others meditate on her. The best among Gods, Brahma and the others, meditate on her. She is the one who bestows the five *siddhis*.¹¹⁵³ She cannot be obtained by those who are evil in character, despicable, those who resort to crookedness, those inimical to *devas*, those who argue in vain, those with confused intelligence, those who have lost their good conduct, those who eat left-overs, those cast off from their families, those who are cruel, those who hate *darshanas*, those who are evil in behaviour, those who criticize good conduct, those who are insolent, those who are vain in speech and those who are excessively proud. Such mortals and *devas* find it impossible to reach her. O one born from a pot! It has been said that she is worthy of being worshipped by the *devas*. For the sake of killing Bhandasura, she manifested herself from the fire of consciousness. This beautiful form of Tripurasundari radiates energy. Vidhatri praised Laliteshvari as Kamakshi. With great devotion, Sadashiva meditated on the supreme Lalitambikaa. Since his mind coaxed her, she is known as Lalitaa.¹¹⁵⁴ I have exactly reported all that she did and everything about the forms of worship and the

methods, as stated in the sacred texts. In a different section, I will speak about her extremely wonderful pastimes.'

Chapter 151-2(39) (Kamakshi's glory)

Agastya said, 'She is without a beginning and without an end. She is unmanifest. She is the original cause behind all that is manifest. She is the taste of bliss and understanding. I worship the great one, the one who is greater than the greatest. O one with the head of a horse! O immensely wise one! O one who knows the *Vedas* and *Vedanta*! I have heard this excellent, great and sacred account about Lalitaa. You have said that Tripuraa is the supreme divinity and should be worshipped by everyone. Her four arms hold a polished noose, goad, a bow and arrows. You have spoken about her *mantra*, Shri's *chakra* and the ornaments of the *chakra*. Ishani has nine sheaths. She is the presiding divinity of Shripura. The city of Kanchi is sacred and is like an ornament on the great surface of the earth. Who is the fortunate and famous Kamakshi who is radiant in that place? She possesses two arms. Her body is like that of a creeper, radiant and graceful in many kinds of ways. The likes of her beauty have never been seen before. She is supreme, filled with supreme refulgence.'

Suta continued, 'Addressed by Agastya in this way, the great-minded Hayagriva was filled with supreme delight. He closed his eyes and meditated on that great energy. Having meditated on her and having prostrated himself before her, he replied to Agastya in these words.'

Hayagriva replied, 'O Lopamudra's husband! I will speak to you about a secret. Listen. The primordial one is smaller than an *anu*.¹¹⁵⁵ She is *chit*.¹¹⁵⁶ She is supreme. She is the original cause. She is also spoken of as the destroyer. Those who have thought about the *tattvas* say that all this is her own form. A second one manifested herself, Suddhaparaa, possessing two arms. Her right hand was in the *mudra* of *yoga*. There was a book in her left hand. She was radiant, with a dazzle resembling that of snow, a jasmine flower or a pearl. The third one is Paraparaa, resembling ten thousand rising

suns. She is adorned with all the ornaments and holds a lotus in her right hand. Her other hand rests on her left thigh. She is adorned with the half-moon, like a crown. The supreme Tripurarunaa manifested herself after this, possessing four arms. She holds a noose, a goad, a stalk of sugarcane and four arrows in her hands. She is Lalitaa. She manifested herself as Kamakshi in Kanchi. Sarasvati, Ramaa, Gouri and others worship her. The two cities of Kashi and Kanchi are Mahesha's two eyes. It ¹¹⁵⁷ is a famous *kshetra* associated with Vishnu, leading to Shiva being present there.'

'Earlier, in the *kshetra* of Kanchi, Dhatri, the grandfather of all the worlds, tormented himself through extremely difficult austerities, so that he might see Shridevi. O sage! He was engaged in that vow, performing *dhyana* on her in his *atman*. Lakshmi, greater than the greatest, manifested herself before him, holding a lotus in her hand. Along with Jishnu ¹¹⁵⁸ Vishnu, she was seated on a lotus. She was adorned in all the garb of *shringara*. She was bedecked in all the ornaments. She is the one who protects all the worlds and is known as Simhasaneshvari. Her beauty was extraordinary. She was supreme, infused with a great radiance. She is known as Adilakshmi and is present in everyone's heart. She is known as Tripuraa, the mother of Brahma, Vishnu and Isha. She is known as Kamakshi. On seeing her, full of devotion, he praised her. Brahma said, "O Devi! Victory to you. O mother of the universe. O Tripurasundari! Victory to you. O one who is Shrinatha's brother! ¹¹⁵⁹ O Shri! O Sarvamangalaa! Victory to you. O Shri, mass of compassion! Victory to you. O leader of *shringara*! Victory to you. O Ishvari of many *siddhis*! Victory to you. O one worshipped by Indras among *yogis*! Victory to you. O mother of the universe! Victory to you. O one with an eternal form! Victory to you. O bestower of happiness on all those who bow down before you! Victory to you. O one praised by Mount Himalaya! Victory to you. O one desired by Shankara! Victory to you. O one with the beautiful eyes! Victory to you. O Devi! O one who uses her own resolutions to repeatedly carry out birth, preservation, destruction, withdrawal and blessings to the worlds! I prostrate myself before you. I bow down. There are wicked ones who cause a mixing up of the *varnas* and *ashramas*. O Devi! You use exceedingly

sharp weapons to slay them. *Yogis* cannot know you through *agama* texts, *Vedas* and other sacred texts. You can only be known by your own self. I prostrate myself before that *Devi*. I bow down. There are lords among sages who know your *tattvas* through secret *amnaya* texts and *Vedanta*. You are known as the supreme *brahman*. I bow down before you. You are in the hearts of everyone but cannot be seen by anyone. Your form is that of subtle *vijnana*. *Brahma*, *Vishnu*, *Rudra*, *Ishvara* and *Sadashiva* are constantly intent on performing *dhyana* on you. I bow down before you. *Indra* and the others are devotees before your radiant feet and carry out your commands. You are the *Ishvari* of royal prosperity. I bow down before you. The *Vedas* are your breath. The five elements are your glance. Everything mobile and immobile in the universe is your smile. I bow down before you. At your command, the *Indra* among serpents holds up the earth on his one thousand hoods. He supports the foundation of all the people. I bow down before you. Following your command, the fire blazes, the sun scorches and the wind blows. Your form is *jnana* and *Shakti*. I bow down before you. You are the twenty-five *tattvas* and the five coverings of *maya*. The sages have said that you permeate these. I bow down before you. It is said that *Shiva*, *Shakti*, *Ishvara*, pure understanding and *Sadashiva* are different ways you manifest yourself. I bow down before you. You are radiant in the *guru*, the *mantra*, *devas* and the five forms of *prana*. Your form is that of *chit*. I bow down before you. You are present in everyone's inner *atman*. Your form is that of supreme bliss. You are described as *Shrividya*. I bow down before you. The learned know that all the different *darshanas* are your limbs. You are all the *niyamas*. O *Devi*! I prostrate myself before you. I bow down. You are radiant in all the worlds, with jewels, *mantras* and herbs in your *atman*. All the instructions about *tattvas* are your form. I bow down before you. Your form is radiant in all objects, in all time, space and materials. I bow down before you. Your forms are manifest in everything. ¹¹⁶⁰ You possess all the auspicious qualities. You are known as *Vishvottirnaa*. ¹¹⁶¹ I bow down before you." Mahadevi was thus eulogized by Dhatri, the grandfather of the worlds. He repeatedly prostrated himself and immediately sought refuge with her.'

‘At this, Devi was pleased and glanced at Brahma, who was prostrate before her. She is the one who bestows boons on all the worlds. She instructed him to ask for a boon. Brahma said, “As a result of my devotion, I have been able to see you. There is no doubt that I have accomplished my objective. Even then, to show a favour to the worlds, I am going to ask for something. This world is *karmabhumi*.¹¹⁶² Nevertheless, people are generally foolish. To show them favours, please remain present here, always.” Agreeing to this, she satisfied the creator’s wishes. At this, Dhatri again conceived of a residence for Devi. He prostrated himself before Pundarikaksha Achyuta, Shridevi’s brother. He earnestly requested that he should also constantly reside in Kanchi. Janardana promised him that he would act accordingly. Thus satisfied, the creator of the universe spoke to Maheshvari again. “As a result of affection towards you, let Shiva also be present here, near you.” Ishana is the Ishvara of every kind of learning and is present in all bodies. He is the supreme Kameshvara. At this, he appeared on Shri Tripuraa’s right. Mahadeva is himself the leader of every kind of *shringara* and manifested himself. At a glance from the eye in Shri Kamakshi’s forehead, a young maiden manifested herself. She was extremely fair and extremely radiant. She was attired in the excellent garb of every kind of *shringara*. She was an ocean of every kind of charm. Along with Shri Pundarikaksha, Brahma lovingly performed the auspicious marriage rites of the primordial man and woman. Akhandala¹¹⁶³ and the other *devas* were there, as were the Vasus, the Rudras and other divinities. Markandeya and other sages and Vasishtha and others, lords among sages, were present. There were Sanaka and others, Indras among *yogis*, and Narada and other celestial *rishis*. There were Vamadeva and other *jivanmuktas*,¹¹⁶⁴ Shuka and others. There were *yakshas*, *kinnaras*, *gandharvas*, *siddhas*, *vidyadharas* and *uragas*. There were Mahashastra and other supreme *ganas*. There were Durgaa and other *matrikas*. There were others known as *devas*, seated on excellent seats and *vimanas*. All of them joined their hands in salutation and bowed down before Parameshvari. Using the powers of his mind, Dhatri constructed a wonderful city. In its centre, he created an enchanting and sparkling residence for Parameshani,

her brother, the illustrious Vasudeva, and Maheshvara. In the presence of the auspicious fire, Bhagavan Bhava married Gouri. The drums of the *devas* were sounded, and flowers were showered down. This was the auspicious act of accepting the hand in marriage of a couple, who are the masters of the universe. Even if one possesses one thousand tongues, who is capable of describing it?’

‘Mahesha’s residence is to the north-west of the residence of the primordial Shri. It is extensive and is the best among abodes. It was conceived by Parameshthi. To the south-east of Shri’s residence, is Vishnu’s colourful abode. These three divinities are always present there. After performing *pradakshina* of the supreme couple, Vidhatri and Janardana reached the chamber designed as an assembly hall. Following the norms, all the members arrived at the assembly hall. Using *mantras* from the *Vedas*, they happily performed the *samskara* rites. Adilakshmi Shri Parameshvari was in front of all of them. She glanced at Virinchi with her right eye and at Hari with her left eye. Vani’s name is Kaa and Kamalaa’s name is Maa. ¹¹⁶⁵ At the time, both of them manifested themselves as masses of energy, as if stationed inside cages. Both of them joined their hands in salutation, above their heads, and bowed down before Shridevi. They said, “O Kamakshi! Victory to Kamakshi” and prostrated themselves. Ganga and Yamuna assumed forms and arrived there, to serve her. There are three and a half crores of divinities who preside over *tirthas*. All of them arrived there, to serve Tripurambaa. Bharati and Shri held whisks in their hands. As is appropriate, they presented themselves before Shridevi and fanned her. Bharati and Shri were both born from the eyes of the primordial Shri. Their hands were like creepers and tinkled with bangles. Their beautiful nails were like rare jewels. As they fanned her, all the people were very surprised. Since then, Kalyani ¹¹⁶⁶ came to be known as Kamakshi. As soon as that name is uttered, Shridevi bestows welfare. The three *aksharas* in Kamakshi ¹¹⁶⁷ are the cause of everything that is auspicious. Ishani of the universe is accomplished in the *Vedas* and *Vedangas*. She instructed Sarasvati, “Always reside in Vidhatri.” At this, while all the *devas* looked on, the Goddess of speech handed over the whisk in her hand to Ganga and

entered Vidhatri's mouth. Indiraa Mahalakshmi was also similarly instructed. To satisfy her, she happily took up her rightful residence on Vishnu's chest. Ramaa and Vishnu devoutly accepted this command. The couple bowed down before the great Tripurasundari and prayed that they might become the divinities of a sheath. Agreeing, Tripurasundari granted them that boon. Padmaa and Achyuta obtained the status of being divinities of a sheath.'

'Mahagouri's reflection assumed an agreeable and divine form. She went there, establishing them ¹¹⁶⁸ to the north of her own pedestal, while she herself remained to the south. She told Mahagouri, "Assume another form." This form was just like that of Mahagouri. It was as radiant as the rising sun and the two feet were beautiful. The anklets tinkled on the bejewelled pedestal. The bejewelled and charming girdle resembled a flash of lightning and tinkled. The two hands dazzled with bangles and armlets studded with jewels. The fastening at the waist glittered with pearls, lapis lazuli and rubies. It was resplendent at the waist, with the three lines that marked the stomach. The ornamented navel was as beautiful as a whirlpool in river Jahnavi. The breasts were decorated with a paste made from sandalwood, camphor and *kumkuma*. There was a dazzling bodice over the breasts and ornaments made of pearls hung over it. As if to amuse, an excellent chain hung from the region of the waist. As ornaments, she wore rings on her fingers, set with bits of rubies. There was a shining, gentle and enchanting lotus in her right hand. A diving garland made from *kalpavriksha* and *kadamba* flowers, hung all the way up to the feet. The mass of rays from the dazzling jewels and ornaments illuminated the directions. She was adorned with a necklace around her throat, made of molten gold and studded with gems. The bejewelled and auspicious *mangalasutra* ¹¹⁶⁹ seemed to make her neck red. The tips of the ears were adorned with earrings made from rubies. The grace of the charming lips was like that of coral or a *japa* flower. Her shining array of teeth were like the seeds of a pomegranate fruit. She smiled gently and this seemed to be reflected on her delicate cheeks. The bejewelled nose-ring was beautiful and was without any parallel. The peaked nose shone, resembling the beauty of a sesamum flower. The lovely

eyes were slightly open and resembled blue lotuses. The graceful and enchanting eyebrows were like a bow made out of fresh flowers. ¹¹⁷⁰ The forehead was like the half-moon and the face was like the full moon. There was a dazzling *tilaka* mark on the forehead, made fragrant with excellent musk. The face, covered with excellent locks, was like a lotus, with buzzing bees circling around it. The braided hair had garlands of *parijata* flowers. There was a crown on the head, studded with excellent jewels. She possessed every kind of charm and was the radiant abode of prosperity.’

‘Shiva, Vishnu and the other great ones grasped that this was Devi’s reflection, no different from herself. While all the *devas*, who looked to her for support, looked on, in front of them, Maheshani, who acted according to her own will, entered this reflection. She created a reflection from her own *atman* and having entered this reflection, remained established there. On seeing this, Vidhatri prostrated himself again and entreated her. “O great Tripurasundari! O great Shakti! O one who is full of the *brahman*! O one who is known by the name of Shri Kamakshi! Every day, I prostrate myself before you. I wish to submit something before you today. Please listen and show me your compassion. O Shridevi! O one who is eternally auspicious! Let the marriage between Mahagouri and Mahesha be celebrated here, every year. You should do this for the prosperity of the universe, so that the residents of heaven get a chance to serve you. O Mahadevi! There are foolish people in Bhuloka. On witnessing this, they will bow down in devotion and proceed to the supreme destination.” At this, an invisible voice was heard from the sky in reply, agreeing to this. After this, she released all of them and allowed them to return to their own abodes. They repeatedly remembered her wonderful conduct. Remembering this, all of them prostrated themselves repeatedly and returned to wherever they had come from. The grandfather was delighted in his mind. Along with Mukunda and Shiva, he used *mantras* to happily instate her in Shri’s residence. ¹¹⁷¹ He used laudatory hymns from the *Vedas* to worship her and did *sashtanga pranama*. In a voice from the sky, Devi addressed Brahma in these words. “Control yourself and with an attentive mind, instate Vishnu and Shiva in their respective places. With a steady mind, serve them there, every year.

Shrisha, Mitra, Isha ¹¹⁷² and Ambaa have respectively manifested themselves here. So has this pedestal of Shri Kamagiri, which has manifested itself in the centre of Shripura. Lakshmi, who serves Vishnu elsewhere, is to his left. This is in the form of consciousness and bliss and is the presiding divinity of all sacred spots. The foundation of everything is not manifest and its form is invisible. But, since there has been this appearance, for the prosperity of all the worlds, perform worship in this excellent temple. Choose a prosperous and agreeable *nakshatra* and use petals and diamonds. O Vidhatri! You should now happily follow the norms and perform that worship. Create a *mandala* and protect all your own worlds.” Thus addressed, Bhagavan Brahma did what he had been asked to do. He placed Devi in his heart and returned to his own world.’

‘I have thus told you the truth about the wonderful conduct of Kamakshi. O one born from the pot! Know that she is Mahalakshmi herself. If a person constantly hears this, or controls himself and reads it, objects of pleasure and emancipation are in the palm of his hand. There is no doubt about this. He becomes Brihaspati’s equal in intelligence and becomes a master of every kind of learning. The primordial and illustrious Bhagavan Narayana is affectionate towards his devotees. Earlier, through austerities performed over a long period of time, I satisfied him. Out of compassion, the lord granted me, his son, emancipation in the form of *sarupya*. He also instructed me about the greatness of Tripurasundari. Therefore, I know a bit about this. I would not have spoken about it otherwise. I will describe a secret *mantra* to you. Listen attentively. Brahma, Vishnu and Rudra do not know this. These three are deluded by her *maya*. The fourth, Ishvara Sadashiva, does not know it either. If Sadashiva does not know it, how can ordinary *devas* know it? Sadashiva is in all *atmans*. His form is that of *sacchidananda*. ¹¹⁷³ Maheshvara always thinks, “I am that alone.” But deluded by her *maya*, he is incapacitated and is reduced to the state of a *shava*. ¹¹⁷⁴ She is the reason behind their origin and dissolution. But there is one special portion of hers that is worth mentioning. Listen. There are the three, Brahma and the others. There is the fourth, the lord Ishvara. However, the one who creates all these four is Sadashiva. I have spoken

about this secret and about her wonderful conduct. I will tell you more.
Listen attentively.'

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Chapter 152-2(40) (Kamakshi's greatness)

Agastya asked, 'The great Devi Tripurasundari is known as Shri Kamakshi and is established in the great *peetha* of Shri Kamakoshtha. What are the pastimes the great Tripurasundari, known as Kamakshi, engages in? Instated on the earth's globe, what does Devi Maheshvari do? O supreme among eloquent ones! Please tell me about her divine conduct.'

Hayagriva replied, 'O one born from the pot! Though she is established here, she is also in everyone's heart. For embodied entities, she bestows fruits, in accordance with their *karma*. Everything that occurs in the world is the consequence of her actions. Someone may think of something, but it is she who disposes of it. Her *avatars* are the Shaktis, Taraa and others. She is Mahalakshmi, who created three eggs earlier. These were abodes for the three divinities, as well as for the three Shaktis. Ambikaa and Purushottama originated from one egg. Shri and Virinchi were born from another egg. Giraa ¹¹⁷⁵ and Shiva were born from the other egg. Maheshvari united Indiraa with Mukunda. ¹¹⁷⁶ She united Parvati with Paramesha and Sarasvati with her grandfather. She engaged Brahma in the creation of all the worlds, Vasudeva in saving and the three-eyed one in destruction. They respectively reside in Brahma's world, Vaikuntha and Kailasa. All of them perform *dhyana* on Mahalakshmi, who always bestows welfare.'

'On one occasion, the auspicious Devi Parvati was on the summit of Kailasa. She was sporting with Mahesha and covered his two eyes, which are the sun and the moon. Because of this, there was no energy anywhere and the three worlds were covered with darkness. All the worlds abandoned rites meant for *devas* and ancestors. The *prajas* were confused and did not know what they should do. On seeing this, Bhagavan Rudra addressed Parvati in these words. "O Devi! By covering my eyes, you have committed a sin. The *rishis* have abandoned their austerities. The *sandhya* rites of the *Vedas* have been destroyed. O Ambikaa! You have destroyed all the rites of the *Vedas*. Therefore, to pacify the sin, you should perform extremely

difficult austerities. Go to Kashi and spend some time there, doing that. After that, go to the city of Kanchi and see Kamakshi there. Constantly worship Shiva there. She is the one who destroys all sins. Placing a *tulasi* plant in front of you, perform austerities on the banks of Kampa.” ¹¹⁷⁷ Having instructed her in this way, Mahadeva vanished from the spot.’

‘Ishani acted in accordance with her husband’s instructions. She performed austerities for a long period of time, with her heart on Shiva alone. Kamakshi appeared in front of her and addressed her in these words. “O child! O one excellent in austerities! Enough. I am pleased with your fierce austerities.” At this, Parvati opened her eyes and saw her standing in front of her. She resembled ten thousand rising suns and was adorned in every kind of ornament. She was ornamented with a diadem, necklaces, armlets, bangles and other things. A noose, a goad, a stalk of sugarcane, a bow and five arrows dazzled in her hands. On top of her crown, there was the dazzling ornament of the moon’s mark. She was the one who had bestowed their positions on Vidhatri, Hari, Rudra, Isha and Sadashiva. She is spoken of as the *saguna brahman* ¹¹⁷⁸ and as the supreme destination. She is the one who created the two *prapanchas*. ¹¹⁷⁹ She is the supreme Ambikaa. On seeing that great queen, she was overwhelmed with great bliss. On all her limbs, the body hair stood up. Her eyes dilated in joy. Along with her own friends, Chandikaa, Mangalaa and the others, she instantly prostrated herself in *sashtanga pranama* and performed *pradakshina*. Joining her hands in salutation, she again prostrated herself before the one who was nothing but her own form. Full of compassion, the great Tripurasundari glanced towards her. Embracing her with her arms, she lovingly addressed her in these words. “O child! You will obtain the desire in your mind and get Rudra as a husband. To protect the world, act in accordance with my instruction. There is no doubt that there is no difference between you and me. O fortunate one! How can you commit a sin? You are the one who destroys sins. Indras among *yogis* think that you are the form of the *brahman*. O child! This is nothing but your supreme pastime, to confuse the world.” The great queen addressed Sarvamangalaa Ambikaa in these words. Full of devotion, she prostrated herself. She

looked on, full of great delight. As Parvati praised her, another divinity manifested herself. O great sage! This other divinity entered her heart and caused her delight. Full of amazement, she repeatedly wondered, “Was this a dream I witnessed? Have I been deluded?” Thinking in this way, she cast her eyes all around her. Thereafter, she saw her friends, Jayaa and Vijayaa, with smiles on their faces, and her face showed signs of pleasure. When they bowed down before her, she spoke to them. “O loved ones! Where have you been, all this while? I saw Kamakshi. Did the two of you see her also?” Hearing her words, the eyes of the two friends dilated in joy. They placed the flowers meant for worship in front of her and replied. “It is true that you have now seen the supreme one and so have the two of us. It is not a dream. Nor is it delusion. She directly entered your heart.” Saying this, they sat down at her sides, full of humility.’

‘Meanwhile, separated from Bhavani, Bhagavan suffered. At the root of Ekamra, ¹¹⁸⁰ so that he might obtain Gouri, he controlled his senses and meditated on Kamakshi. Shri Vidyaa, the supreme divinity, was also there, near him. Shiva was immobile, performing *dhyana*. She ¹¹⁸¹ was satisfied. Full of compassion, she spoke. “O one who destroyed Kandarpa’s pride! Enough of *dhyana*! Follow my instructions and give Kandarpa his body back. He will also abide by my commands. This is my *peetha*, known as Ekamra. Always reside here. O one excellent in vows! So as to please me, arrive in my presence. Show your favours to Gouri, who is residing near the waters of Kampa. Quickly abandon the two kinds of torment, from *yoga* and separation.” ¹¹⁸² Saying this, the supreme Ramaa vanished from within his heart. Shiva immediately got up, delighted in his mind and patient. The one who is served by all the *devas* had obtained her favours. In his heart, he performed *dhyana* on the great Tripurasundari. The origin and dissolution of the universe, with its mobile and immobile entities, is the consequence of her pastimes. Her *atman* exists in the two *prapanchas*. Shiva is adorned with compassion. ¹¹⁸³ Her mind is wet with compassion. Having made the pledge, he followed the norms and married Gouri. Taking her with him, he mounted the bull and went to the summit of Kailasa.’

‘O immensely wise one! O one born from a pot! Hear about something else. O unblemished one! I will speak to you about the power of the primordial Lakshmi. The three divinites had gone to Brahma’s assembly hall. All the Gods and the guardians of the worlds were there and so were Sanaka and other *yogis*. Narada and other *devarshis* were there and so were Vasishtha and other ascetics. All of them were there together. Both Brahma and Kapardin possessed five faces and they were unable to distinguish between the two. They asked each other, “Which one is Brahma? Which one is Shankara?” In the midst of their conversation, Shiva quickly vanished. Thereafter, a debate ensued between the five-faced Brahma and Narayana, dark in complexion. “O Brahma! O ignorant one! You have originated from the lotus in my navel. Therefore, you are my son.” Brahma responded, “I am the creator, and my *dharma* is evident in my name. Since I created both of you, you and Rudra are my sons.” In this way, both of them were deluded by *maya* at the time. To demonstrate his own greatness and display that he was the *brahman*, Maheshvara manifested himself between them, in the form of a great column of fire. Realizing that this was Mahesha, Vishnu stood there, silent. However, the five-faced Brahma, who was also present there, showed him great disregard. In front of them, above Brahma’s head, a circle of energy manifested itself. The divinity ¹¹⁸⁴ manifested himself in its centre, along with Umaa. Brahma looked up and again uttered words full of disrespect. Hearing this, the destroyer of Tripura was filled with great rage. As a result of the transformation caused by anger, he also looked towards Vishnu. Bhairava arose from the two of them, ¹¹⁸⁵ full of rage. Using his nails, he severed one of Vidhatri’s heads. Everyone uttered words of lamentation. Shrieking, they fled. Brahma’s skull stuck to Bhairava’s nail. Though he shook it repeatedly, it would not be released. To free himself from the sin of *brahmahatya*, ¹¹⁸⁶ he roamed around the entire surface of the earth. He went to all the sacred *kshetras*, Ganga and the other great rivers. But Kapali ¹¹⁸⁷ could not free himself from *brahmahatya*. He was dejected and his face showed signs of distress. He appeared as if he had lost his signs of prosperity. After a long period of time, he reached Kanchi, where Brahma had dwelt earlier. There, as a mendicant who sought alms, he

constantly served the supreme Shri. Every day, he bathed in the five *tirthas* there, which possess the attributes of being *tirthas* on earth. The one who loves a *bilva* tree lived there for some time, confused. He resided in the *kshetra* of Kanchi and gradually controlled himself. His mind was immersed in Shridevi, and he cleansed himself of all his fears. She is served by Lakshmi on the north and Vasudeva to the south. He arrived in Shri Kamakoshtha and stood in front of it. He controlled himself and performed *dhyana* on the feet of the primordial Lakshmi. He was like a lamp when there is no wind, like an ocean with no waves. In that way, controlling the breath of life within him, Achalesvhara ¹¹⁸⁸ did not move. The one loved by the mountain's daughter constantly performed *dhyana* on Shri. Like a vessel from which a constant stream of oil flows, Bhairava's meditation was not disturbed. Brahma, Vishnu, the *siddha* Kapila, Sanaka and the other sages, Shuka and others would never have been able to replicate this faith and *samadhi*. As a result of his sentiments and *yoga* on Shri, Shiva obtained a state of being identified with Shri. Shridevi was pleased. At midnight, she manifested herself in front of him, surrounded by a circle of radiance. The one who is the form of speech addressed him in these words. "O Shrikantha! O one who destroys all sins! How can there be sin in you? Your body is my form. Why are you causing this confusion in the worlds? Tomorrow, you will be instantly freed from the sin of *brahmahatya*." Having said this, Ishvari, who is seated on the great throne, vanished from the spot. Bhairava's mind rejoiced. At having seen Shri, he thought that he had accomplished his objective. He spent the rest of the night, immersed in *dhyana* on Shri alone. In the morning, he bathed in the five great *tirthas* and performed the *sandhya* rites. He repeatedly shook the skull that was stuck to his hand. Though he did this, it didn't get dislodged and he was filled with great dejection. "Was it a dream? Was it *maya*? Was my mind deluded?" He repeatedly thought in this way and his mind was overwhelmed by grief. So as to control his grief, Shiva, foremost among those with fortitude, bowed down before the circle of *tulasi* and standing in front of it, worshipped it. He controlled the aggregate of his senses and again immersed himself in *samadhi*. A period of only one *yama* passed and Devi appeared in his

presence again. “O Shambhu! Enough of *samadhi*. Immerse yourself in the pond here.” Instructing him in this way, she vanished again. He was filled with thoughts. “Is this *maya*? Is this a dream? What should I do now? The supreme Shridevi had earlier told me that when it was tomorrow, I would instantly be freed from *brahmahatya*. But one *yama* of the day has passed. Was all of this false?” In this way, Bhagavan was filled with great thoughts. At this time, an invisible voice roared from the sky, “Submerge yourself.” Hearing this, Shankara cast aside his doubts and decided that this was the truth. He immersed himself in the pond but arose in Ganga. Seeing that this was now Kashi, he wondered, “What is this?” For a *muhurta*, he stood there, silent, with the skull still stuck to his nail. He saw the sun had risen, scorching everyone’s forehead. Controlling himself, to seek alms, Shiva entered the city. Wandering around in the streets, Bhava went to some houses. Then, right in front of him, he saw a woman with the form of Shridevi of Kanchi. She gave him alms in the form of a resplendent mass of energy and instantly vanished. Immediately, Brahma’s skull was dislodged from the tip of his nails. Ishana witnessed this excellent and wonderful conduct, on the part of Kamakshi. His lotus face was pleased, and he repeatedly showed her a great deal of respect. He thought that the city in front of him was the city of Kanchi and the river in front of him was the sacred river of Kampa. He thought that the divinity present in this city ¹¹⁸⁹ was none other than Kamakshi. In this way, as a result of Devi’s powers, Hara was freed from the difficulty. Hale again, he returned to his own place, praising supreme Shri.’

‘O one born from a pot! I will tell you about her pastimes again. Listen. One should always hear about Shri Mahadevi’s powers. It bestows all that one wishes for. The lord of Ayodhya was an illustrious king, named Dasharatha. For a long period of time, he did not have sons and was overwhelmed by grief. In private, the intelligent one summoned Vasishtha, his own priest. He spoke to the one who was pure in conduct and was accomplished in the meanings of all the sacred texts. “O illustrious one! O lord! A long period of time has passed, but I have not got a son. I am constantly tormented, and it is constantly increasing. Please tell me what I

should do to get a son.” Vasishtha answered, “I will tell you about a secret that concerns my lineage. ¹¹⁹⁰ Ayodhya, Mathura, Maya, Kashi, Kanchi and Avantika are described as excellent cities and the most sacred. ¹¹⁹¹ The great Tripurasundari is the great divinity and the men of Ayodhya worship her mere presence. There is no divinity who is her equal. Nor is there anyone greater than her. O king! All the others, Brahma, Vishnu, Mahesha and others, along with their wives, always worship Shridevi. They use coconut, jackfruit and bananas and heaps of honey, ¹¹⁹² *ghee*, sugar, *payasam* ¹¹⁹³ and other offerings. In particular, cooked objects must be used to worship Tripurambaa. Within a short period of time, she will grant us all that we wish for.” Thus addressed, he honoured his *guru*, who had instructed him about the method for obtaining a son. The lord of the earth gave him gifts and released him.’

‘As instructed by his *guru*, full of great devotion, the Indra among kings worshipped Lalitaa Parameshvari. In this way, happy in his mind, he followed the norms and did this. He slept in Devi’s abode in Ayodhya. Midnight had passed and the light of the lamps was weak. As a result of sleep, there was a lack of alertness in him. Tripurambikaa appeared in front. Her four arms held a noose, a goad, a bow and polished arrows. She was attired in all the excellent garb of *shringara* and was adorned in all the ornaments. Standing there, she addressed Indumati’s son in these words. ¹¹⁹⁴ “O Panktiratha! ¹¹⁹⁵ O illustrious one! O unblemished one! You possess the good fortune of having sons. However, earlier, you committed acts of treachery. To pacify the likes of that *karma*, go to the excellent city of Kanchi. After bathing in river Kampa there, you will see me, the purifying one. In the centre of the city of Kanchi, you will see Kamakoshtha, like an abyss in the centre of the sky. It destroys sin and has seven gates that are like pits. It signifies empire and grants men the three kinds of success. ¹¹⁹⁶ I, Ishvari, am astride that great throne, facing the east. Its my form as Mahalakshmi, with two hands and holding a lotus. I am Chakreshvari, the great queen, who is invisible to those with gross vision. Mahagouri, who originated from my eyes, is on my right. She is the essence of every kind of beauty and is adorned in every kind of ornament. She has two hands and

holds a lotus. I have devised an abode for her. She is stationed there, in the form of Mahalakshmi, or in the form of Kritiyaa. She has been born as my portion, from the head to the pedestal. If a person sees her, his great sins are instantly destroyed. What need be said of minor sins? Wicked desires, wicked intelligence, the aggregation of wicked arguments, wicked bodies, wicked natures and atheism—all these are dissolved. Using rice, honey, ¹¹⁹⁷ *ghee*, *payasam* and different kinds of food objects with the six kinds of taste, undertake my great worship there. When I am greatly pleased, I will grant you your boon.” In that divine form, the queen instructed him and vanished. The king suddenly woke up. “What is this?” he wondered. He woke up Kousalya, the queen, who had also noticed auspicious portents. He lovingly told her what had occurred during the night. Hearing this, the queen was also content.’

‘In the morning, full of joy, along with his beloved, army, advisers and attendants, the king arrived in the city of Kanchi. He bathed in the waves of Kampa and saw the purifying Devi. Along with his queen, Kousalya, the king bathed in the five *tirthas*. Along with his wife, he pleased those who resided in the *tirthas* and *kshetras* with donations of cows, land, garments, gold and other objects. They honoured his devotion. Full of great devotion, the excellent king entered her residence. Full of humility, he performed *pradakshina* thrice. Along with his queen, Kousalya, he then approached. The great Tripurasundari’s residence is Shri Kamakoshtha. He saw Ambaa, the mother of the three divinities, who is present there in the form of Shri *chakra*. Along with his wife, the faithful one performed *sashtanga pranama*. In his own city, there was Tripuraa’s residence, built formerly by Ikshvaku. ¹¹⁹⁸ Along with his disciples, Durvasa had earlier identified this for worship. It possessed everything—male and female servants, standards that rose up above and housing. As instructed by his *guru*, he had himself completed half of the worship there. However, as he dreamt in the night, he had seen that great form in his own city. As the excellent king approached, the form that he saw now was the same as the form he had seen in the night. The great king performed *dhyana* for a long time. He donated many

excellent garments, divine residences and other objects. He then recited a *stotram*.’

‘O one who is beautiful because of the excellent ornaments hanging down to the tips of the feet! O one whose radiant lotus feet are rendered beautiful because of the bejewelled anklets! O one whose soft golden girdle sparkles above yellow garments! O one whose arms are like creepers and have polished armlets and bracelets on them! O one whose soft left hand holds a shining bow made out of *pundrekshu*! ¹¹⁹⁹ O one whose right hand is decorated with flowery arrows set in gems! The area around your breasts dazzles because of the white garlands. O one whose hands are rendered radiant by a noose, a goad and armlets! The radiance of your face has conquered the disc of the autumn moon. The rays from the bejewelled earrings on your ears make your cheeks shine. Your left hand holds a lotus with an excellent stalk. O Maheshi! Your sidelong glances are full of compassion. Your neck is like a conch shell and is made radiant by strings of rubies and gems. Your locks shine, illuminated by the part of the moon that is on your forehead. Your gentle smile sparkles. You possess an excellent nose. The beauty of your eyes has conquered the petals of a blue lotus. You possess excellent eyebrows. You possess an excellent face. You possess an excellent and wonderful forehead. You are a swan who resides in Lake Manasa in the hearts of Indras among *yogis*! Your large golden crown is studded with jewels. You are beautiful in all your limbs. You are worshipped by all the Indras among Gods. You are the one who bestows boons, in accordance with what is desired. Your mind is wet with compassion. You are proud of the prosperity of your empire. O Chakranathaa! Your lotus feet are served by Indra and the other *devas*. O Ishvari on the throne! Show your supreme presence to me.’

Hayagriva continued, ‘In this way, the lord of the earth lauded her devoutly, inside and outside. ¹²⁰⁰ He then went and saw Mahagouri, stationed on her right. He prostrated himself like a rod on the ground and praised her too. He gave her many kinds of great and expensive garments and great, expensive and priceless ornaments. Having performed *pradakshina* with his wife, he emerged. Following the rites instructed by his

guru, he then performed great worship. Thinking of her alone, he stayed there for seven nights. On the eighth day, he looked at Devi and devoutly bowed down before her. In his mind, he prayed, “O Ambaa! Please grant me what I wish for.” Kamakshi was greatly pleased. She spoke to him, in the form of an invisible voice from the sky. “O king! Four sons will be born to you, and they will be my portions.” When he heard this, his face bloomed in joy. He performed *sashtanga pranama* before Shri and sought refuge with the supreme one. With his wife and his ministers, he mentally took his leave from Ambaa. Indumati’s son reached the city of Ayodhya. Such are the powers of Kamakshi, who desires welfare for all the worlds. She completely fulfils the wishes of all devotees. In this way, there are many people who have followed the norms and have worshipped Kamakshi, the supreme divinity, faithfully. They have obtained everything that they desired. O sage! Even now, devotees obtain the fruits. In the future, there will be many who will benefit from Kamakshi’s compassionate glance. Who is capable of describing the greatness of Shridevi? I, Shambhu, Brahma and Vishnu are incapable. What need be said of others? I have thus told you a little bit about Kamakshi’s dazzling conduct. If one hears it or reads it, it is said that all sins are destroyed.’

Chapter 153-2(41) (Worship of Kamakshi)

Agastya asked, ‘What is the nature of her *yantra*? What is the nature of the best *mantra*? What is the nature of the instructor? What is said to be the nature of the *shishya*? O Hayagriva! You are omniscient. You are yourself the supreme being. O lord! Cast your glance of compassion towards me and tell me everything.’

Hayagriva answered, ‘Tripurambikaa’s *mantra* is Shrichakra.¹²⁰¹ She is Mahalakshmi. Earlier, this sparkling *chakra* was seen to emerge from the *atman*. It sparkled and was full of a radiance that increased. The greatness of this *chakra* is impossible to fathom. In truth, Shrichakra is Mahalakshmi herself. It is through worshipping it that the great Vishnu deluded all the

worlds. The lotus-eyed one obtained the radiant and desired form of Mohini. It is through worshipping it that Ishana became the lord of every kind of learning. Specifically, Brahma worshipped it and created Brahmanda. By worshipping it, Smara managed to delude even the sages. The *chakra* should be made out of gold or silver and placed in front of Shridevi. Using knowledge about the *mantra* with sixteen *aksharas*, this should be worshipped with fragrances. Every day, sacred and auspicious *tulasi* leaves must be used. Chanting the root *mantra* one thousand times, one should perform *dhyana* on Shridevi. She must be worshipped with honey, ¹²⁰² *ghee*, sugar, *payasam* and auspicious objects. The *naivedya* must be agreeable and unmatched, with *masha* and *apupa*. ¹²⁰³ An intelligent person will worship Mahalakshmi in three *mandalas*. Done this way, Parameshvari will suddenly appear before him. When she is pleased, she will fulfil every wish that exists in his mind. As has been mentioned before, if a person uses white flowers to worship the *chakra*, Bharati constantly dances on the tip of his tongue. Following the path indicated earlier, if a person uses red flowers to worship the *chakra*, he becomes a universal emperor over all kings, who serve him like mere servants. As in the earlier case, if a person uses auspicious yellow flowers to worship the *chakra*, there is no doubt that Shri herself constantly resides on his chest. Even if they possess excellent colours, one should not use flowers that have a bad smell or lack in fragrance. One must worship Shivaa with fragrant flowers and blossoms. Kamakshi is Mahalakshmi and her *chakra* is Shrichakra.'

'Shrividya ¹²⁰⁴ is supreme learning. It is the best of *gurus*. O store of austerities! For her, Shrividya is the king of *mantras*. At the end of the Kamaraja *mantra*, Shri's *bija mantra* has to be added. This knowledge about the *mantra* with sixteen *aksharas* is described as Shrividya. I have spoken about a secret, and one must make efforts to keep it a secret. This knowledge is said to be about the three different forms of Shakti. This knowledge takes the form of the breath of life for all *mantras*. If one acquires this knowledge through *parampara*, ¹²⁰⁵ it frees from bonds. It is said to destroy all sins. It destroys old age and death. When worshipped, it destroys misery, misfortune, disease and poverty. When praised, it pacifies

waves of impediments. When one performs *dhyana* on it, it bestows success in every objective. If a person possesses special knowledge about the truth of the *mudras*, if he has destroyed his sins by taking *diksha* and if he uses this to worship Parameshvari, he will obtain his desires as fruits. She is attired in white garments and is in the centre of a white residence. A man must observe *brahmacharya* and worship her with white flowers. The *naivedya* must be white, consisting of curds, milk and rice. He must worship Parameshvari with a resolution that is white. ¹²⁰⁶ Pure in his mind, he must use knowledge about the *mantra* with sixteen *aksharas* to worship her. At the end, in the due order, Shri Balaa's *bija mantra*, with the three *aksharas*, must be added. ¹²⁰⁷ Using the *aksharas* of the *mantra*, *japa* must be performed in the usual order and also in the reverse order. ¹²⁰⁸ One must think of Shridevi in the form of a lamp, in front of all the *devas*. O ascetic! The *japa* must be done in the *upamshu* tone, or loudly. Shridevi's image must be created, along with *nyasa* done of Shridevi. If one performs the *japa* one hundred thousand times, one is freed from major sins. O *devarshi*! If one performs the *japa* two hundred thousand times, the *sadhaka* attains a supreme state and sins committed across seven births are destroyed. O sage! If he performs the *japa* three hundred thousand times, there is no doubt that he is freed from sins committed across one thousand births. He becomes eternally pure. In the due order, if he performs the *japa* one million and six hundred thousand times, he reaches Devi's presence.'

'It is said that the worship must be performed thrice a day, with the offering of oblations, feeding of *brahmanas* and *purashcharana*. ¹²⁰⁹ "Svaha" must be uttered after offering oblations and *tarpana*. After *nyasa* and worship, the word "namah" must be uttered. As is appropriate, at the time of *japa*, at the end of the *mantra*, Devi must be worshipped. The number of times oblations are offered must be one-tenth the number of times *japa* is performed. The number of times *tarpana* is performed must be one-tenth the number of times oblations are offered. O one who crushed Vindhya! The number of *brahmanas* who are fed must be one-tenth the number of times *tarpana* is performed. On grounds of hardships of time and space, if any of the subsidiary rites is left incomplete, it is recommended

that *japa* must be performed double the number of times before *purashcharana* is undertaken. Thereafter, to accomplish any desired objective, *japa* must again be performed three hundred thousand times. Indifferent towards everything else, he must perform the vow. Thrice a day, he must be intent on performing the worship. After this, if he performs *vashya* ¹²¹⁰ and other rites, he will be successful. The person uttering the *mantra* must always think of himself in the centre of the *chakra* and undertake the worship. His own form will be completely red and the object to be achieved will also be thought of as red. O Vindhya's enemy! He will then become handsome, with every kind of good fortune. He will be loved by all the worlds and will be able to control them. There is no doubt about this.'

'He will mix equal parts of *gorochana*, ¹²¹¹ *kumkuma* and sandalwood paste. A learned person will perform *japa* 108 times and make a *tilaka* with this. After that, if he looks at any person, speaks to him, touches him or thinks of him, half of that person's body comes under his control, like a servant. O store of austerities! In that way, after performing *japa* 108 times, if a flower, fruit, fragrance, drink or garment is sent to a woman, her heart becomes deluded, and she is instantly attracted to him. Using *gorochana*, in a secluded place, one must draw a picture of the woman on the ground. She must be beautiful in form, in the garb of *shringara* and adorned with ornaments. On the forehead, neck, heart, navel and knees, ¹²¹² one should write her birth, her name and "great *vidya*", ending with a goad. The *aksharas* of Madana's names must be written on all the joints in the limbs. Placing that image inside a triangle, he must face its direction. ¹²¹³ With the hands bound in *kshobhini mudra*, he must use the learning to perform *japa* one hundred and eight times. ¹²¹⁴ In the chamber where the sacrificial fire is kept, with a radiance like that of the sun or the moon, he must then perform *yoga*. She will be agitated, and her limbs will be scorched. Her mind will suffer from Ananga's arrows. Her glances will display the fire of desire. The region of her loins will throb. The dazzling rays of Shakti's *chakra* will incapacitate her and make her succumb. With large eyes that are like the petals of lotuses, she will cast aside her good conduct. Her eyes will be

attracted. She will lose her patience and her shame. She will be bound in the firm bonds of *mantra*, *yantra*, herbs and the great *mudra*. The lotus in her heart will tremble because of the attachment of this new love. As one uses this great *mantra* to perform *japa* in one's mind, an even greater number of times, her silken garment will be removed. It is as if she is deluded. It is as if she is agitated. It is as if she is being scorched. It is as if she is a picture. It is as if she is devoid of her senses. It is as if she has been crushed. It is as if she has been dissolved. It is as if she cannot make any effort. It is as if she cannot go anywhere. Whirled around by the wind of the *mantra*, she is like the leaf of a bamboo. If he thinks of the woman, she is whirled around, even if she is one hundred *yojanas* away.'

'In the centre of the *chakra*, he must think of the earth, with its mountains, groves and forests, extending up to the four oceans and blazing. If he practices this for six months, he will become as handsome as Madana. When he looks, the worlds will be attracted. When he looks, they will come under his control. When he looks, a woman will be agitated. When he looks, poison will be countered. When he looks, he makes someone a lord of speech. When he looks, he can delude everyone. When he looks, *chaturthika* and other fevers are instantly destroyed. ¹²¹⁵ He must draw the *chakra* with some yellow material and secretly wear it on his body. There is no doubt that he will quickly paralyze the words of those who are eloquent. Using a dark blue dye, he must write down the name of the enemy. Facing the south, he must burn this in a fire. The enemy will be killed. The name of the enemy can be written with cow's urine and the excrement of buffaloes and horses. When this is placed inside a *chakra* made of *aranala*, ¹²¹⁶ the enemy will be hated. Using *gorochana*, the name can be drawn in the centre, in the shape of a crow's wing. The enemy will then be hung downwards. This is a supreme form of *ucchatana*. If he wears a *chakra* that has been drawn with a mixture of milk, lac, *gorochana* and a dark blue dye, he will bring the four *varnas* under his control. Following these norms, if the *chakra* is placed inside water and that water is used to drink or bathe, there is no doubt that he obtains unmatched good fortune. O sage! If he constantly thinks of the blazing form of a country, city or beautiful woman

inside the *chakra*, within seven days, he will cause them agitation. If a person faces the east and does this with a *chakra* that has been drawn with yellow colour, there is no doubt that he can paralyze all debaters. If a person faces the north and does this with a *chakra* that is like *sindura* in hue, there is no doubt that the worlds come under his control. It cannot but be otherwise. If a person faces the west and worships a *chakra* that has been drawn in *gairika*, ¹²¹⁷ there is no doubt that all women are attracted and agitated and come under his subjugation. O one who dispelled Vindhya's pride! A person must wander around a mountain and, using *mantras*, worship the *chakra* in secret. There is no doubt that he will not suffer from old age and death. O great sage! I have described a secret to you, and it must be kept a secret. If it is kept secret, all *siddhis* are obtained. If it is disclosed, a person is dislodged. O sage! If a person does not follow the norms and performs the rite of *purashcharana*, he is cursed by *devas* and does not obtain *siddhi*. To pacify taints in application, a learned person will again perform *japa* one hundred thousand times. If a person performs the worship in the proper way, he becomes worthy again. If a person constantly worships *devas*, without any desire, if he is only dependent on devotion, and thinking about her, according to his capacity, if he performs *japa* with this *mantra*, he is capable of bearing all the burdens in this world. This ensures liberation for him. She is constantly present near him. She tells him everything. Just as a mother cow follows its calf lovingly, she follows him. In that way, Devi follows her devotee, one who has sought refuge with her.'

Agastya asked, 'What is the meaning of the word *sharanagata*? ¹²¹⁸ O one with the face of a horse! Please tell me. Who is the one whom Gouri follows, like a mother cow following a calf?'

Hayagriva answered, 'If a man places the entire burden of this world and the next on Shridevi, if his mind is always full of devotion towards her, if he is always favourable towards everyone everywhere, if he does not oppose anyone, if he does not seek refuge with anyone else, if he is firm in praying that Gouri should protect him, if he believes that she will protect him, if he serves her without any objective in mind and if he is only devoted towards her, such a person is a *sharanagata*. Whether he is praised or

criticized, his own nature and intelligence are such that he thinks, “Let people criticize me. Let people praise me.” He does not suffer from dejection or joy. There are six attributes of a *sharanagata*—favourable thoughts, avoidance of unfavourable thoughts, trust that she will protect, seeking refuge with her for the sake of protection, surrendering oneself and compassion. ¹²¹⁹ After taking this pledge of surrendering oneself, one should surrender the five organs of action. In bestowing objects of pleasure and emancipation, there is no *sadhana* that is its equal. Lack of pride, lack of wickedness, non-violence, fortitude, uprightness, service of the preceptor, purity, patience, self-control, non-attachment towards objects of the senses, lack of *ahamkara*; reflection on the taints associated with birth, death, old age, ailments and sorrow; lack of attachment towards and association with sons, wives and homes; constant impartiality towards the good, the bad and hardships; single-minded and non-deviating devotion towards Devi along with a preference for deserted places, lack of attachment towards assemblies of people, constant pursuit of *jnana* about *adhyatma* ¹²²⁰ and insight about the true meaning of *jnana*—these are means of pursuing *jnana* and they must always be practised. A person who only undertakes tasks for her, a person who is supremely devoted, a person who avoids attachment and a person who does not harbour enmity towards any being—such a person obtains the supreme Shri. O scorcher of Vatapi! Like me, the *guru* must be intelligent and famous. The instructor of the *amnaya* texts has said that the *shishya* must be a person like you.’

Chapter 154-2(42) (*Mudras*)

Agastya said, ‘O one with the face of a horse! Please tell me about the different types of *mudras* that can be formed, through the formation of which, Shridevi is pleased.’

Hayagriva replied, ‘The great *mudra* of *avahani* is said to consist of three parts. ¹²²¹ The hands are turned, with the palms facing the front and the thumbs together. The two index fingers are bent below the two ring fingers.

O store of austerities! The two little fingers are in their respective places. I will now tell you about the *mudra* known as *samkshobhini*.¹²²² Listen. The two middle fingers are in the centre and so are the two little fingers and thumbs. Above the middle finger, the index finger is extended, like a rod. O one who robbed Vindhya of his insolence! In this *mudra*, if the middle fingers are kept straight, that *mudra* is known as *vidravini*.¹²²³ O one born from a pot! The two middle fingers and index fingers are together. The two little fingers and ring fingers are also together, so that the shape of a goad is formed in the centre. This is known as *akarshini mudra*,¹²²⁴ capable of attracting the three worlds. The two hands are in the form of cups. The index fingers are in the shape of goads. The middle fingers are turned over and kept under these. O *devarshi*! After this, following the order, the two little fingers at the centre of the two middle fingers. The two ring fingers are straight and the two index fingers are outside. In the form of rods, the two thumbs are near the region at the bases of the two middle fingers. O scorcher of Vatapi! This *mudra* is famous under the name of *unmadini*.¹²²⁵ The two ring fingers are in the form of goads and are tucked below. After this, in the due order, this is also done with the two index fingers. This is known as *mahankusha mudra*.¹²²⁶ It accomplishes success in every objective. O *devarshi*! The arms are crossed, so that the left hand is to the right and the right hand is to the left. The palms are turned over. O ascetic! In the due order, the little fingers and the ring fingers are joined. The two index fingers are placed on top of this, and the two middle fingers are above all these. O Lopamudra's husband! The thumbs are straight. This *mudra* is named *khechari*¹²²⁷ and it is the best among them all. If one possesses the *vijnana* of this alone, one is loved by *yoginis*. The palms are turned over and made to touch. The two index fingers and thumbs are simultaneously joined, so that they assume the form of a half-moon. The two middle fingers are joined and the two little fingers point downwards. When they are bent and joined in this way, the two ring fingers are below all the others. This is known as *bija mudra*. Within a short period of time, this ensures the flow of every kind of *siddhi*. The tips of the two middle fingers are bent and are placed above the two index fingers. The two little fingers are placed in the

centre of the two ring fingers. All of this is brought together and pressed by the two thumbs. This is the first among the *mudras*, known as *yonī mudra*. O *devarshi*! These are the *mudras* used to please Shridevi. In the right order, they must be used at the time of worship.'

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Chapter 155-2(43) (*Diksha* and a *mantra*)

Agastya said, ‘O one with the face of a horse! O immensely wise one! O ocean of the *amrita* of compassion! According to Shridevi’s *darshana*, what is the nature of *diksha*? Please tell me.’

Hayagriva replied, ‘I will speak about *diksha*. Through this, men obtain identity with the divinity and cleanse their mire of sins. The *guru* performs *dhyana* on Shiva’s city in the hand. He touches the *shishya*’s body and performs *japa* with Angamalini’s root *mantra*. This is known as *diksha* by touch. He closes his eyes and performs *dhyana* on Shri Kamakshi. When the *guru* looks at the *shishya* properly, this is known as *diksha* by sight. As soon as the *guru* looks, speaks or touches, *jnana* is instantly generated. This is known as Shambhavi *diksha*.¹²²⁸ As has been said, the *guru*’s body is like Devi’s body. Through his favours, the *shishya* is radiant, in a form similar to his. The leading instructor is satisfied when there has been a long period of proper service to him. When he is silent and does *diksha* for the *shishya* through resolution, this is held to be one done mentally. Among all the kinds of *diksha*, this is held to be the best. Initially, the rites required for *diksha* must be performed. I will describe their nature. It is recommended that one should choose an auspicious day in *shukla paksha*. Pure in his mind, the disciple must clean his tongue and face and perform his ablutions. He must then follow the norms and bathe. He must complete the *sandhya* rites and be seated in a secluded spot, remembering his *guru*’s excellent and illustrious body. He must be silent and restrained in diet. Behaving in that way, the *guru* will enter the abode where the worship is to be performed. Using the knowledge of Devi *suktam*, he will perform *nyasa* of the *matrikas*.¹²²⁹ After reciting Purusha *suktam*, he will then please Tripurambikaa with what are known as the sixteen kinds of *upachara*—*avahana*, *asana*, *padya*, *arghya*, *achamana*, *snana*, *vastra*, *bhushana*, *gandha*, *pushpa*, *dhupa*, *dipa*, *naivedya*, *tambula*, *pradakshina* and

pranama.¹²³⁰ Using knowledge of the *mantra* with one thousand *aksharas*, he will then offer flowers.’¹²³¹

‘OUM! *Aim, hrim, shrim, aim, klim, souh*. OUM! *Namah*. (1) O Tripurasundari! (2) O Hridayadevi!¹²³² (3) O Shirodevi!¹²³³ (4) O Shikhadevi!¹²³⁴ (5) O Kavachadevi!¹²³⁵ (6) O Netradevi!¹²³⁶ (7) O Asyadevi!¹²³⁷ (8) O Kameshvari! (9) O Bhagamalini!¹²³⁸ (10) O Nityaklinna!¹²³⁹ (11) O Bherundaa!¹²⁴⁰ (12) O Vahnivasini!¹²⁴¹ (13) O Mahavajreshvari!¹²⁴² (14) O Vidyeshvari!¹²⁴³ (15) O Parashivaduti!¹²⁴⁴ (16) O Tvaritaa!¹²⁴⁵ (17) O Kulasundari!¹²⁴⁶ (18) O Nityaa!¹²⁴⁷ (19) O Nilapatakaa!¹²⁴⁸ (20) O Vijayaa!¹²⁴⁹ (21) O Sarvamangalaa!¹²⁵⁰ (22) O Jvalamalini!¹²⁵¹ (23) O Chitraa!¹²⁵² (24) O Mahanityaa!¹²⁵³ (25) O Parameshvari! (26) O Mantreshamayi!¹²⁵⁴ (27) O Shashthishamayi!¹²⁵⁵ (28) O Udyanamayi!¹²⁵⁶ (29) O Lopamudramayi!¹²⁵⁷ (30) O Agastyamayi!¹²⁵⁸ (31) O Kalatapanamayi!¹²⁵⁹ (32) O Dharmacharamayi!¹²⁶⁰ (33) O Muktakeshishvaramayi!¹²⁶¹ (34) O Dipakalanathamayi!¹²⁶² (35) O Vishnudevamayi!¹²⁶³ (36) O Prabhakaradevamayi!¹²⁶⁴ (37) O Tejodevamayi!¹²⁶⁵ (38) O Manojadevamayi!¹²⁶⁶ (39) O Animasiddhaa!¹²⁶⁷ (40) O Mahimasiddhaa!¹²⁶⁸ (41) O Garimasiddhaa!¹²⁶⁹ (42) O Laghimasiddhaa!¹²⁷⁰ (43) O Ishitvasiddhaa!¹²⁷¹ (44) O Vashitvasiddhaa!¹²⁷² (45) O Praptisiddhaa!¹²⁷³ (46) O Prakamyasiddhaa!¹²⁷⁴ (47) O Rasasiddhaa!¹²⁷⁵ (48) O Mokshasiddhaa!¹²⁷⁶ (49) O Brahmi! (50) O Maheshvari! (51) O Koumari! (52) O Vaishnavi! (53) O Varahi! (54) O Indrani! (55) O Chamundaa! (56) O Mahalakshmi! (57) O Sarvasamkshobhini!¹²⁷⁷ (58) O Sarvavidravini!¹²⁷⁸ (59) O Sarvakarshini!¹²⁷⁹ (60) O Sarvavashamkari!¹²⁸⁰ (61) O Sarvonmadini!¹²⁸¹ (62) O Sarvamahankusha!¹²⁸² (63) O Sarvakhechhari!¹²⁸³ (64) O Sarvabijaa!¹²⁸⁴ (65) O Sarvayoni!¹²⁸⁵ (66) O Sarvastrakhandini!¹²⁸⁶ (67) O Trailokyamohini!¹²⁸⁷ (68) O Chakrasvamini!¹²⁸⁸ (69) O Prakatayogini!¹²⁸⁹ (70) O Bouddhadarshanangi!¹²⁹⁰ (71) O Kamakarshini!¹²⁹¹ (72) O Buddhyakarshini!¹²⁹² (73) O Ahamkarakarshini!¹²⁹³ (74) O Shabdakarshini!¹²⁹⁴ (75) O Sparshakarshini!¹²⁹⁵ (76) O Rupakarshini!¹²⁹⁶ (77) O Rasakarshini!¹²⁹⁷ (78) O Gandhakarshini!¹²⁹⁸ (79) O Chittakarshini!¹²⁹⁹ (80) O Dhairyakarshini!¹³⁰⁰ (81) O Smrityakarshini!¹³⁰¹ (82) O Namakarshini!¹³⁰² (83) O Bijakarshini!¹³⁰³ (84) O Atmakarshini!

¹³⁰⁴ (85) O Amritakarshini! ¹³⁰⁵ (86) O Sharirakarshini! ¹³⁰⁶ (87) O
Guptayogini! ¹³⁰⁷ (88) O Sarvasha-paripuraka-chakra-svamini! ¹³⁰⁸ (89) O
Anangakusumaa! ¹³⁰⁹ (90) O Anangamekhalaa! ¹³¹⁰ (91) O Anangamadini!
¹³¹¹ (92) O Anangamadanaturaa! ¹³¹² (93) O Anangarekhaa! ¹³¹³ (94) O
Anangavegini! ¹³¹⁴ (95) O Anangankushaa! ¹³¹⁵ (96) O Anangamalini! ¹³¹⁶
(97) O Guptatarayogini! ¹³¹⁷ (98) O Vaidikadarshanangi! ¹³¹⁸ (99) O Sarva-
samkshobha-karaka-chakra-svamini! ¹³¹⁹ (100) O Purvamnayadhidevataa!
¹³²⁰ (101) O Srishtirupaa! ¹³²¹ (102) O Sarvasamkshobhini! (103) O
Sarvavidravini! (104) O Sarvakarshini! (105) O Sarvahladini! ¹³²² (106) O
Sarvasammohini! ¹³²³ (107) O Sarvastambhini! ¹³²⁴ (108) O Sarvajrimbhini!
¹³²⁵ (109) O Sarvavashamkari! (110) O Sarvaranjini! ¹³²⁶ (111) O
Sarvonmadini! (112) O Sarvarthasadhikaa! ¹³²⁷ (113) O Sarva-
sapatprapurini! ¹³²⁸ (114) O Sarvamantramayi! ¹³²⁹ (115) O Sarva-dvanda-
kshayakari! ¹³³⁰ (116) O Sampradaya-yogini! ¹³³¹ (117) O Souradarshanangi!
¹³³² (118) O Sarva-soubhagya-dayaka-chakraa! ¹³³³ (119) O
Sarvasiddhipradaa! ¹³³⁴ (120) O Sarvasapatpradaa! ¹³³⁵ (121) O
Sarvapriyankari! ¹³³⁶ (122) O Sarvamangalakarini! ¹³³⁷ (123) O
Sarvakamapradaa! ¹³³⁸ (124) O Sarva-duhkha-vimochini! ¹³³⁹ (125) O Sarva-
mrityu-prashamini! ¹³⁴⁰ (126) O Sarva-vighna-nivarini! ¹³⁴¹ (127) O
Sarvangasundari! ¹³⁴² (128) O Sarva-soubhagya-dayini! ¹³⁴³ (129) O
Kulottirna-yogini! ¹³⁴⁴ (130) O Sarvartha-sadhaka-chakreshi! ¹³⁴⁵ (131) O
Sarvajnaa! ¹³⁴⁶ (132) O Sarvashakti! ¹³⁴⁷ (133) O Sarvaishvarya-
phalapradaa! ¹³⁴⁸ (134) O Sarvajnanamayini! ¹³⁴⁹ (135) O Sarvavyadhi-
nivarini! ¹³⁵⁰ (136) O Sarvadhara-svarupaa! ¹³⁵¹ (137) O Sarvapapaharaa!!
¹³⁵² (138) O Sarvanandamayini! ¹³⁵³ (139) O Sarvaraksha-svarupini! ¹³⁵⁴ (140)
O Sarvepsita-phalapradaa! ¹³⁵⁵ (141) O Niyogini! ¹³⁵⁶ (142) O
Vaishnavadarshangi! ¹³⁵⁷ (143) O Sarva-raksha-kara-chakreshthaa! ¹³⁵⁸ (144)
O Dakshinamnayeshi! ¹³⁵⁹ (145) O Sthitirupaa! ¹³⁶⁰ (146) O Vashini! ¹³⁶¹
(147) O Kameshi! (148) O Modini! ¹³⁶² (149) O Vimalaa! ¹³⁶³ (150) O
Arunaa! ¹³⁶⁴ (151) O Jayini! ¹³⁶⁵ (152) O Sarveshvari! ¹³⁶⁶ (153) O Koulini!
¹³⁶⁷ (154) O Rahasyayogini! ¹³⁶⁸ (155) O Rahasyabhogini! ¹³⁶⁹ (156) O
Rahasyagopini! ¹³⁷⁰ (157) O Shaktadarshanangi! ¹³⁷¹ (158) O Sarvaroga-
hara-chakreshi! ¹³⁷² (159) O Pashchimamnayaa! ¹³⁷³ (160) O Dhanurbana-

pashankusha-devataa! ¹³⁷⁴ (161) O Kameshi! (162) O Vajreshi! ¹³⁷⁵ (163) O
 Bhagamalini! ¹³⁷⁶ (164) O Atirahasyayogini! ¹³⁷⁷ (165) O
 Shaivadarshanangi! ¹³⁷⁸ (166) O Sarvasiddhi-prada-chakraa! ¹³⁷⁹ (167) O
 Uttaramnayeshi! ¹³⁸⁰ (168) O Samhararupaa! ¹³⁸¹ (169) O Shuddhaparaa! ¹³⁸²
 (170) O Bindupeethagataa! ¹³⁸³ (171) O Maharatri! ¹³⁸⁴ (172) O
 Tripurasundari! (173) O Paraparati! ¹³⁸⁵ (174) O Rahasyayogini! (175) O
 Shambhava-darshanangi! ¹³⁸⁶ (176) O Sarvananda-maya-chakreshi! ¹³⁸⁷
 (177) O Tripurasundari! (178) O Tripuravasini! ¹³⁸⁸ (179) O Tripurashri! ¹³⁸⁹
 (180) Tripuramalini! ¹³⁹⁰ (181) O Tripurasiddhaa! ¹³⁹¹ (182) O Tripurambaa!
¹³⁹² (183) O Sarvachakresthaa! ¹³⁹³ (184) O Anuttaramnayakhya-svarupaa!
¹³⁹⁴ (185) O Mahatripurabhairavi! ¹³⁹⁵ (186) O Chaturvidhagunarupaa! ¹³⁹⁶
 (187) O Kulaa! ¹³⁹⁷ (188) O Akulaa! ¹³⁹⁸ (189) O Kulakulaa! ¹³⁹⁹ (190) O
 Mahakoulini! ¹⁴⁰⁰ (191) O Sarvottaraa! ¹⁴⁰¹ (192) O Sarvadarshanangi! ¹⁴⁰²
 (193) O Navasanasthita! ¹⁴⁰³ (194) O Navakshari! ¹⁴⁰⁴ (195) O
 Navamithunakriti! ¹⁴⁰⁵ (196) O Mahesha-Madhava-Vidhatri-Manmatha-
 Skanda-Nandindra-Manu-Chandra-Kuberagastya-Durvasahkrodha-
 Bhattarakavidyatmikaa! ¹⁴⁰⁶ (197) O Kalyana-tattva-trayarupaa! ¹⁴⁰⁷ (198)
 O Shivashivatmikaa! ¹⁴⁰⁸ (199) O Purnabrahmashakti! ¹⁴⁰⁹ (200) Maha
 Parameshvari! (201) Maha Tripurasundari! I worship your illustrious
 sandals. *Namah, ka, em, ila, hrim, hasa, kahala, hrim, sakala, hrim, aim,*
klim, souh, souh, klim, aim, shrin.

Hayagriva continued, ‘Using knowledge about the *mantra* with one
 thousand *aksharas*, an offering of flowers must be given to Devi. Those
 who know about the *Vedas* say that, otherwise, the worship will be futile.
 After this, the ground must be smeared with cow-dung and a *drona* ¹⁴¹⁰ of
shali rice must be kept there, along with another *drona* of pure rice that
 possesses praiseworthy colours. There must also be a new pot, filled with
 one *drona* of water. Five new gems must be placed in it. The water must be
 rendered fragrant by flinging bark and sprouts from *nyagrodha*, *ashvattha*,
makanda, *jambu* and *udumbara* into it. ¹⁴¹¹ On top of the pot, one should
 place a ripe and auspicious fruit of a coconut. After worshipping with
 fragrances, flowers and other things, incense and lamps must be shown. In
 his heart, he must perform *japa* with the Shri Chintamani *mantra* and the

mantras for the *matrikas*. This must be done while touching the pot, which is conceived as the form of Shri Kamakshi's body. After performing *japa* one hundred and eight times, the lamp must be shown again. He will then summon the *shishya* in private and bind his eyes with a piece of cloth. The *guru* will make him perform *shashtanga pranama* three times. Placing flowers in his hand, he will make him tender an offering of flowers, while reciting, "O Shrinathaa! O mass of compassion! O Ishvari who is full of supreme radiance! I am placing this offering of flowers at your lotus feet. You are the supreme refuge. You are the supreme *brahman*. You are my supreme divinity. From today, protect me and my sons. I have sought refuge with you." Saying this, the *shishya* will place his head on the lotus feet of his *guru*. When the *guru* places his sandals on his head, this is because of the good deeds performed in an earlier birth, obtained by serving the one seated on a lotus, the chastiser of Mura and the chastiser of Tripura. ¹⁴¹² Having said this, full of devotion, he will get up. He will calmly stand to the left of the *guru*, full of humility and without pride. The bond over his eyes will be loosened and he will be shown the rest of the worship. It is instructed that the *naivedya* for Maha Tripurasundari will consist of white sugar, honey, ¹⁴¹³ *ghee*, bananas and *payasam*. These will be sprinkled with water from the pot, kept to the left. Softly, the *mantra* with the sixteen *aksharas* will be whispered into the *shishya*'s left ear. Emerging outside, he will be made to sit on a pure wooden seat. With a piece of cloth spread over it, he will be seated, facing the east. Uttering *mantras*, he will sprinkle the *shishya* with water from the sacred pot. Bathing in pure water again, he ¹⁴¹⁴ will then wear two pieces of garment. After performing *japa* with the *mantra* one hundred and eight times, he will go to sleep. If an auspicious dream is seen, those sacred and excellent merits will accrue to him. If a nightmare is seen, *japa* must be performed one thousand and eight times. Tripurambaa's worship must be carried out in accordance with this stated path. If no dream is seen, *siddhi* will only occur after a long period of time. With great devotion, the disciple must himself accept whatever is left of the offerings to Devi. When the *shishya* does this, he instantly becomes a person who sanctifies a *pankti*.'

‘The disciple is instructed to offer his body, his wealth and his breath of life to the illustrious *guru*. He must always remain subservient to him and must never violate his words. Even if he is pleased for half a *kshana*, he bestows *moksha* and prosperity. It should be known that a *guru* who enables a person to cross over *samsara* is extremely rare. The *akshara* “*gu*” means darkness and the *akshara* “*ru*” signifies a person who prevents this. Since he prevents darkness, he is spoken of as a *guru*. When one has obtained a *guru*, who is the form of understanding, it is instructed that one should not look for another *guru*. Even when harsh words are spoken by a *guru*, he should think of it as a blessing. He must first worship him and then obtain *jnana* about the world, about the *Vedas* and about *adhyatma* from him. After these three forms of *diksha* have been carried out, he can then be instructed about understanding. Devotion towards the *guru* constitutes good conduct. Opposing him is a great sin. Remembering his feet constitutes emancipation. This is the course of action as long as the body lasts. If one speaks false words before a *guru*, one commits a sin. Even if one kills a cow or a *brahmana*, the sin is not as great. “From Brahma to a blade of grass, everyone is my *guru*. All of them should be worshipped by me. On the surface of the world, who should not be worshipped by me?” In this way, a person who is favourable towards everyone is described as a true *shishya*. A *shishya* is described as someone who possesses sparkling good qualities, possesses many qualities and follows the *guru*’s commands. If one becomes exhausted by performing *japa*, one should practice *dhyana*. If one becomes exhausted by performing *dhyana*, one should again practice *japa*. If one is proficient in *japa* and *dhyana*, one quickly obtains success in *mantras*. Through *dhyana*, even a worm is capable of becoming a bee. Like that, through *samadhi*, a man is capable of becoming identified with the *brahman*. At the time of dissolution, *prapancha* cannot be seen. Nor can it be seen when the eyes are closed. This is the characteristic of *dhyana*. The supreme truth has not transformation. Even if one knows it, it cannot be described. When one knows it, the *mantras* become his servants and he becomes a lord of *mantras*. When one is immersed in the unity of the *atman*, this is *darshana*. A *mantra* is equal to *yoga* and austerities. Hence,

his glance is like wealth. ¹⁴¹⁵ When pride about the body dissolves away, the *paramatman* is realized. One can then achieve *samadhi*, regardless of where the mind chooses to travel. When a person perceives the non-dual, omniscient, serene and blissful *atman*, there is nothing left for him to obtain. There is nothing left for him to know.'

'One crore of *pujas* are equal to one *stotram*. One crore of *stotrams* are equal to one *japa*. One crore of *japas* are equal to one *dhyana*. One crore of *dhyana* is equal to dissolution. The body is spoken of as an abode of the *devas* and Maheshvara is the *jivatman*. Abandoning the garland of ignorance, one should perform *yoga* with the sentiment, "I am he." A grain of paddy is covered in husk. When the husk does not exist, it becomes a grain of rice. An entity bound in the noose is described as a living being. Freed from the noose, the entity is Maheshvara. The movement of birds in the sky cannot be seen. Nor can that of aquatic creatures in the water. In that way, the great conduct of great-souled ones cannot be discerned. The *nitya* worship must be performed during the day, the *naimittika* worship must be performed at night. ¹⁴¹⁶ It is the determination of the sacred texts that *kamya karma* can be performed at both times. Remembering the illustrious sandals is greater than crores and crores of great gifts, crores and crores of great vows and crores and crores of great sacrifices. Whether one possesses knowledge about the *karma* required for emancipation, or whether one does not, as long as the body exists, one must follow the tasks for *varnas* and *ashramas*. Everything that emerges from a *guru*'s mouth is described as a sacred text. Even if it happens to be something forbidden, one must carry out a *guru*'s command and not transgress it. Even if a person is of noble birth, is learned and possesses excellent wealth, as soon as he sees the *guru* from a distance, he must happily prostrate himself on the ground like a rod and perform *pradakshina* thrice. Taking this to be a *guru*, one must bow down before everything, a *deva* or a blade of grass. Taking it to be a divinity, one must bow down before an image made of iron or clay. Those who shout at *gurus*, insult *brahmanas* in disrespectful words, defeat *brahmanas* in arguments or divulge secret sacred texts, become *brahma-rakshasas*. One must always harbour sentiments of non-duality and never

possess sentiments of duality vis-à-vis the *guru*. One must not criticize ordinances of the *Vedas* and sacred texts like the *agamas*.’

‘If a *shishya* stays in the same village as the *guru*, he must prostrate himself before the *guru* at the time of the three *sandhyas*. If he stays within a distance of one *krosha*, he must devoutly prostrate himself before the *guru* every day. If the *shishya* resides within a distance of half a *yojana*, he must prostrate himself at the time of the five *parvas*. Starting with a distance of one *yojana* and ending with a distance of twelve *yojanas*, he must prostrate himself before the *guru* for as many months as there are *yojanas*. If the *shishya* dwells very far away, he can go to him whenever he wishes. One must not visit a king, a *deva* or a *guru* with an empty hand. According to capacity, one must offer fruits, flowers and garments. A *guru* is like supreme Shiva himself, bound in human skin. He roams around the earth in secret, in order to show favours to a virtuous *shishya*. Shiva is without form. However, he assumes a form so as to protect virtuous devotees. The ocean of compassion acts in this way in *samsara*. An illustrious *guru* is described as Shiva himself, without the three eyes; as Achyuta himself, without the four arms and as Brahma himself, without the four faces. The blind cannot see the sun. Like that, those without good fortune cannot see the illustrious *guru*, who is described as the supreme truth, even if he is right in front of their eyes. Excellent thoughts are those that are about the truth. Medium thoughts are those that are about *japa*. Inferior thoughts are those that are about the sacred texts. Worldly thoughts are the worst among the worst. There is no truth superior to the *guru*. There is no happiness superior to *jnana*. There is no *puja* superior to devotion. There is no fruit superior to *moksha*. The words of all the *Vedas* and all the sacred texts state that Shri Kamakshi is greater than the greatest, superior to Brahma, Vishnu, Shiva and the others. There are many dualities that are seen and heard — Shachi and Indra, Rohini and Chandra, Svaha and Agni, Prabha and Ravi, Lakshmi and Narayana, Vani and Dhatri, Girija and Shiva, Agni and Soma, *bindu* and *nada*, Prakriti and Purusha, the one who is the support and the one supported, objects of pleasure and *moksha*, *prana* and *apana*, a word and its meaning, what is to be done and what is prohibited, happiness and

misery. However, there is no doubt that everything in the world is the supreme *brahman*. Beyond this, there is the supreme refulgence, known under the name of Kamakshi. Brahma, Vishnu, Shiva and the others constantly perform *dhyana* on her. In this world, if a man follows this path of Shakti, he obtains the favours of Shridevi and enjoys objects of pleasure and emancipation. Those who worship Kamakshi with a *mantra* or without a *mantra*, even if they are women, *vaishyas* or *shudras*, go to the supreme destination. What need be said of *kshatriyas* and *brahmanas*, who first use *mantras* to worship her? Even if they follow *samsara*, there is no doubt that they are liberated. At the time of the five *parvas*, *naivedya* must always be offered, in the form of sugar, honey, ¹⁴¹⁷ *ghee*, bananas and *payasam*. A person who does not worship Shakti is cursed by Devi. If a person is incapable, he must always mentally think of objects and worship Ambikaa. A householder must worship Mahadevi, with auspicious rites. In this worship of Mahalakshmi, the women of his family and his friends will follow him. O one born from a pot! The *guru* will mention the norms of good conduct thrice. If the *shishya* does not grasp this, the sin is the *shishya*'s, not the *guru*'s. In his mind, he must think of the illustrious *guru* and the *guru*'s wife as Lakshmi and Narayana, Vani and Vidhatri, Girijaa and Shiva and as his father and his mother. O one born from the pot! I have thus told you everything briefly. By carefully retaining this, an intelligent person will become omniscient.'

Chapter 156-2(44) (*Dhyana on Devi*)

Hayagriva said, 'He ¹⁴¹⁸ must take his seat with him and enter the place meant for *japa*. Using *mantras* stated by the *guru*, he must sprinkle water in the proper way. There, he must think of himself as Devi's form, with no difference between the two, and perform *dhyana*. Facing the east, he will sit firmly in *padmasana*, with his mind on nothing else. Having done *trikhandas*, ¹⁴¹⁹ he must worship *gurus* and others. Reciting Balaa's *bija mantra* twice, in the due order, he must start with the middle fingers and

perform *nyasa* on his palm. Having purified his hand first, a person who knows the *mantras* will use the *astra mantra* to create a wall of fire around him. ¹⁴²⁰ Starting with , the extensive *nyasa* must be done in the right order. Then starting with , it must be done in the reverse order. ¹⁴²¹ He will commence this extensive *nyasa* with the pervasive *vagbhava mantra*. ¹⁴²² He will then think of three bodies being manifest—causal, subtle and gross. Using Balaa’s *bija mantra*, he will perform their *nyasa* in the navel, the heart and the middle of the eyebrows. In the due order, he must perform *nyasa* of the *matrikas* at the contracted root of the navel and other places. Using Balaa’s *bija mantra* and others he must perform their *nyasa* twice. He must place them on the fingers, starting with the middle fingers, and on the palms, and not anywhere else. The *nyasa* must then be done in the navel, on the two feet, the knees, the thighs, the buttocks, the genital organs, the root of the navel, the heart and the head, in the due order. *Nyasa* of nine seats must be done in the heart and displayed accordingly—Brahma, Vishnu, Rudra, Ishvara, Sadashiva, Pushan, Tulika, Prakashaka and Vidyasana. ¹⁴²³ He must then display the *mudra* known as *padma-trikhanda-yoni*. Filling himself up with wind, through half-closed lips, he must utter “*hum hum hum*”, thus waking up *kundalini*. ¹⁴²⁴ After using the power of the *mantra* twelve times, he must think of his identity with Shiva and again place him ¹⁴²⁵ in his rightful place. Using *vagbhava* and other *bija mantras*, *nyasa* must be performed at the roots of the heart and the arms. In the due order, the hands, with the roots, middle and tips of the fingers, must be placed over the entire head. Starting with the thumbs and ending with the palms, *nyasa* must be done in all these parts. Starting with the heart, he must perform *kumkuma nyasa*. ¹⁴²⁶ Using the third *bija mantra*, he must perform a pure *nyasa* of the contracted *matrikas* again. *Nyasa* must first be done with the two other *bija mantras* and *nyasa* with this *bija mantra* performed at the end. Thereafter, *nyasa* must be undertaken on the surface of the ground, but not too extensively. *Nyasa* of the eight groups of letters must be done at the root of the navel, the heart and the throat. He must first start with , and and perform their *nyasa* at the root of the heart and on the head. They must also be placed at the armpits, waist, right shoulder, left

shoulder, loins and heart. For the six lower organs, the *nyasa* must be performed with the group of letters that being with . ¹⁴²⁷ The *rishi* for this is Shabda-Brahma and the *chhanda* is held to be *bhutralipi*. ¹⁴²⁸ Shrimula-Prakriti is described as the divinity of this *mantra*. He must perform *dhyana* on her in the following form. She holds a string of *aksha* beads and a book in her upper hands and a bow and arrows made out of flowers. Her hands are in *abhaya* and *varada mudras*. This is her unmatched form. There is a necklace of *aksha* beads around her throat, signifying protection. She is adorned with necklaces, armlets and bangles and ornaments worn by heroes. She is adorned with bejeweled earrings and divine unguents. She resides in this form on a lotus, below the letters, which are like a *kalpadruma*. ¹⁴²⁹ She is the letters herself. He must perform *dhyana* on Bhairavi, who is affectionate towards her devotees. On every side, she is ornamented by many crores of female messengers. Having meditated on her in this way, in the due order, he must again perform *nyasa* of the *aksharas* on the surface of the ground. Starting with *muladhara chakra* and ending with *ajna chakra*, *nyasa* must be done of the eight groups of letters. *Nyasa* of , and will be done on the head and *nyasa* of the vowels performed within this. *Nyasa* of , , , and will be done above, in the five parts of the face, the roots, middle and tips of the fingers, the roots of the wrists, the arms, the feet, the stomach, the right and the left sides, the navel and the back. , and must be placed at the root of the heart or the head. *Nyasa* of and the other letters can also be done there. The order of the letters in *bhutralipi* is said to be the following. First, there are the five short vowels. ¹⁴³⁰ Next, there are the four conjunct *aksharas*. ¹⁴³¹ After this, there are , , , and . Thus, starting with , , , and so on, all the remaining groups follow in the due order. With , and , there are said to be forty-two *aksharas*. The first group of five *aksharas* consists of the five short vowels. The second group consists of the four conjunct *aksharas*. Thereafter, there are six groups consisting of five *aksharas* each. ¹⁴³² Finally, it is held that the ninth group consists of three letters. In the due order, the nine respective divinities are Brahma, Vishnu, Rudra, Dhanesha, ¹⁴³³ Indra, Yama, Varuna, Soma and the three Shaktis. ¹⁴³⁴ These are described as the divinities of the

letters and this is the order of *bhūtalipi*. This is read as the order of creation. The order of withdrawal is the reverse. These are the positions in which *nyasa* of the letters must be performed, with *visarga* and *bindu* coming at the end.'

‘A wise person will thereafter perform *nyasa* of, and *dhyana* on, Rati and the others. Their forms have the complexion of *japa* flowers, and they are as red as *kumkuma*. One should meditate on them as seated on Kama’s left lap, who holds a bow and arrows. Kama loves sexual intercourse and desires beautiful women. He is beautiful and Mohini is with him. His limbs are charming, but he loves a woman who is fond of quarrels. Willful in conduct, Kama is with Vilasini. ¹⁴³⁵ Kama, who is full of desire, is with Kalpalataa, ¹⁴³⁶ who is dark in complexion. Kama has a sweet smile and is the one who binds. He is with Vismritaa. ¹⁴³⁷ The one who indulges in dalliances is with Vismitakshi. ¹⁴³⁸ The handsome one is with Lelihaanaa. ¹⁴³⁹ Rati’s lord is loved by women and has the same directions as his excellent garments. He loves sexual intercourse. Rati’s lord is with the beautiful Kubjaa. ¹⁴⁴⁰ Rati’s lord is with Dharaa. ¹⁴⁴¹ Ramaa’s beloved is worthy of being worshipped by Ramaa. ¹⁴⁴² Pleasuring himself, he roams around in the night. Mohini’s lord is auspicious. He causes delight and is with Uttamaa. ¹⁴⁴³ The one who causes joy is with excellent Gods. He is the one who causes delight and is also the one who is delighted. He possesses excellent beauty. The lord of treasures is in the form of a boy and has five arrows. He is with a woman who loves quarrels. He is also Rati’s friend. He holds a bow made out of flowers and is with Ekakshi. ¹⁴⁴⁴ The lord possesses an excellent face and wields a large bow. He is dark, with matted hair. He gradually roams around and is Palini’s ¹⁴⁴⁵ husband. Shivaa’s beloved roams around. He wanders around with Mugdhaa. ¹⁴⁴⁶ Ramaa obtains the one who wanders around. The one who causes the wandering around is spoken of as a bee. His confused conduct is caused by Lochanaa, ¹⁴⁴⁷ who also possesses a long tongue. She follows the one who roams around. The one who charms loves sexual intercourse. The one who confounds is with Palashakshi. ¹⁴⁴⁸ Housewives desire the confusion he creates. Vikataa’s ¹⁴⁴⁹ lord is the one who causes delusion. As he increases in size, he is with Dharaa. Madana is

without parallel. Manmatha is accompanied by the breeze. ¹⁴⁵⁰ The one who maddens is with Hladini. ¹⁴⁵¹ He is desired and faces all the directions. He is the leader and black bees are in front of him. He is a singer and is with Nandini. ¹⁴⁵² He is known as the one who calculates and is with Anamaa. ¹⁴⁵³ He is a dancer, desired by Kali. When he is with the excellent Kalakarni, ¹⁴⁵⁴ he is the one who jests. When he is maddened, he is known as Kandarpa. He is a dancer and is loved by Shyamalaa. He sports, with a fish as his mount. When he approaches Unmattaa, ¹⁴⁵⁵ he sports and increases desire.'

‘After this, meditating first, he will perform *nyasa* of Srikantha and the others. He will meditate on Ardhanarishvara, ¹⁴⁵⁶ the two halves of whose body have the complexion of *sindura* and gold. The daughter of the mountain forms half of Hara’s body, whose hands have two nooses, a string of *aksha* beads and signs of granting whatever is wished for. After remembering him, *nyasa* must be done of the letters and their meanings. These excellent forms will be those of Shrikantha, Ananta, Sukshma, Trimurti, Amareshvara, Urvisha, Bharabhuti, Atithisha, Sthanuka, Hara, Chandisha, Bhoutika, Sadyojata, Anugrahashvara, Akrura and Mahasena. There are also Krodhisha, Chandisha, ¹⁴⁵⁷ Panchantaka, Shivottama, Ekarudra, Ekakurma, Ekanetra, Chaturanana, Ajesha, Sharva, Somesha, Hara, Langali, Daruka, Ardhanarishvara, Umakanta, Chapadhya, Dandin, Atri, Mina, Mesha, Lohita, Shikhin, Khadgadanda, Sumahakala, Vyalin, Bhujangesha, Pinakin, Khadgesha, Baka, Shveta, Abhra, Lakulin, Shiva and Samvartaka.’

‘The Shaktis of the vowels are Purnodari, Virajaa, Shalmali as the third, Lolakshi, Vartulakshi, Dirghaghona, Sudirghamukhi, Gomukhi, Dirghajihvikaa as the ninth, Kunjari, Urddhakeshaa, Dvimukhi, Vikritananaa, Satyalilaa and Kalavidyaa. These are Shaktis of the vowels. The Shaktis of the consonants are Mahakali and Sarasvati, who possess the power to bestow all *siddhis*, and Gouri, Trailokyavidyaa, Mantratmashaktikaa, Lambodari, Bhutamataa, Dravini, Nagari, Khechari, Manjari, Rupini, Virini, Kotara, Putanaa, Bhadraa, Kali, Yogini, Shankhini, Garjini, Kalaratri, Kurdini, Kapardini, Vajraa, Jayaa, Sumukheshvari, Revati, Madhavi, Varuni, Vayavi, Rakshavadharini, Sahajaa, Lakshmi,

Vyapini and Mayaa. ¹⁴⁵⁸ These are enumerated as Shaktis for consonants. The platform must only be created with the colours of Balaa, mentioned twice before. To obtain identity with the divinity, *nyasa* must be performed six times.’

‘Meditating, *nyasa* of Vighnesha ¹⁴⁵⁹ and the others must be undertaken first. They resemble the rising sun, possess three eyes and have the heads of elephants. Their heads hold a noose and a goad and are in *abhaya* and *varada mudras*. They possess all the powers. In the due order, the names of Ganeshas for the fifty-one letters are Vighnesha, Vighnaraja, Vinayaka, Shivottama, Vighnakrit, Vighnahanta, Vighnarat, Gananayaka, Ekadanta, Dvidanta, Gajavaktra, Niranjana, Kapardavan, Dirghamukha, Shankukarna, Vrishadhvaja, Gananatha, Gajendrasya, Shurpakarna, Trilochana, Lambodara, Mahanada, Chaturmurti, Sadashiva, Amoda, Durmada, Sumukha, Pramodaka, Ekapada, Dvipada, Shura, Vira, Shanmukha, the divinity named Varada, Vakratunda, Dvidantaka, Senani, Gramani, Matta, Mattamushaka-vahana, Jati, Mundin, Khadgin, Varenya, Vrishaketana, Bhakshyapriya, Ganesha, Meghanada and Ganeshvara. ¹⁴⁶⁰ The associated Shaktis are Shri, Hri, Pushti, Shanti, Tushti, Sarasvati, Rati, Medhaa, Kanti, Kamini, Mohini, Tivraa, Jvalini, Nandaa, Suyashaa, Kamarupini, Ugraa, Tejovati, Satyaa, Vighneshani, Svarupini, Kamartaa, Madajihvaa, Vikataa, Ghurnitananaa, Bhuti, Bhumi, Dviramya, Amarupaa, Makaradhvajaa, Vikarna-bhrukuti, Lajjaa, Dirghaghonaa, Dhanurdhari, Yamini, Ratri, Chandrakantaa, Shashiprabhaa, Lolakshi, Chapalaa, Rijvi, Durbhagaa, Subhagaa, Shivaa, Durgaa, Guhapriyaa, Kali and Kalajihva.’

‘Therefore, initially performing *dhyana*, he must control himself and undertake *nyasa* of the planets. He will remember their excellent forms, with their hands in *abhaya* and *varada mudras*. Their Shaktis embrace them. They resemble *kumkuma*, milk, blood, jasmine, gold, a conch shell, a cloud, smoke and darkness. ¹⁴⁶¹ Starting with Surya, he will remember them in these forms. The *nyasa* of Ravi will be done below the heart, Soma on the head, Kuja on the eyes, Shukra in the heart, Budha in the centre of the heart, Brihaspati on the throat, Shanaishchara in the navel, Rahu in the mouth and Ketu on the two feet. He must next meditate on the stars,

adorned with all the ornaments, and perform their *nyasa*. They resemble the blazing fire of destruction and their hands are in *varada* and *abhaya mudras*. They will be placed on the forehead, the two eyes, the two nostrils, the throat, the two shoulders, the two elbows, the two wrists, the two breasts, the navel, the hips, the thighs, the knees, the calves and the two feet.’

‘Pure and controlling himself, in the due order, he must next perform *nyasa* of the *yoginis* in the heart, in the navel, in *svadhishtana*, in *muladhara*, between the two eyebrows and the head. The Shaktis of the letters must be placed on the petals of the lotus and the pericarp. All of them must be placed on the tips of the petals of the lotus that is in the head. The sixteen Shaktis associated with the vowels are Amritaa, Anandini, Indrani, Ishani, Umaa, Urddhvakeshi, Ridvidushi, Lrikarikaa, Ekapadatmikaa, Aishvaryakarini, Oushadhatmikaa, Ambikaa and Rakshatmikaa.¹⁴⁶² In the due order, there are twelve Shaktis that should be known—Kalikaa, Khechhari, Gayatri, Ghantadharini, Nadatmikaa, Chamundaa, Chhatrikaa, Jayaa, Jhankarini, Samjnaa, Tankahastaa and Thankarini.¹⁴⁶³ In the due order, ten Shaktis are known—Dankari, Dhankarini, Namini, Tamasi, Thankarini, Dayaa, Dhatri, Nadini, Parvati and Phatkarini.¹⁴⁶⁴ In the due order, there are six Shaktis — Bardhini, Bhadraa, Majjaa, Yashasvini, Ramaa and Labhini.¹⁴⁶⁵ Thereafter, there are four Shaktis—Varadaa, Shri, Shandhaa and Sarasvati.¹⁴⁶⁶ Finally, there are the Shaktis Hakini and Kshamaa.¹⁴⁶⁷ After this, starting with the right foot and ending with the left foot, *nyasa* of Mesha¹⁴⁶⁸ and the other *rashis* must be done, in the feet, the genital organs, the two sides, the heart, the head and the stomach.’

‘After this, in his mind, he must perform *nyasa* of the fifty one *peethas*: (1) Varanasi; (2) Kamarupa; (3) Nepala; (4) Poundravardhana; (5) Varasthira; (6) Kanyakubja; (7) Purnashaila; (8) Arbuda; (9) Amratakeshvara; (10) Ekamra; (11) Trisrota; (12) Kamakoshthaka; (13) Kailasa; (14) Bhrigunagara; (15) Kedara; (16) Chandrapushkara; (17) Shripeetha; (18) Ekavira; (19) Jalandhra; (20) Malava; (21) Kulanna; (22) Devikota; (23) Gokarna; (24) Maruteshvara; (25) Attahasa; (26) Viraja; (27) Rajaveshma; (28) Mahapatha; (29) Kolapura; (30) Kailapura; (31)

Kaleshvara; (32) Jayantika; (33) Ujjayini; (34) Chitra; (35) Kshiraka; (36) Hastinapura; (37) Udira; (38) Prayaga; (39) Shashtimayapura; (40) Gourisha; (41) Salaya; (42) Shrishaila; (43) Maru; (44) Girivara; (45) Mahendra; (46) Vamanagiri; (47) Hiranyapura; (48) Mahalakshmipura; (49) Purodyana; and (50) Chhayakshetra. These are the names spoken about by the learned. ¹⁴⁶⁹ These follow the order of the letters and their *nyasa* must be performed in the places meant for the letters. When this *nyasa* is performed, in the due order, they are united with the letters. I have thus described the six kinds of *nyasa* spoken about by Ishvara himself. ¹⁴⁷⁰ When he performs this *nyasa* in different parts of the body, his body becomes like that of the divinity.’

‘Having first performed these six kinds of *nyasa*, he will perform *nyasa* of Shrichakra. He will start with *mantras* for the different parts and end with the form that represents infinite bliss, thus completing the extensive *nyasa*. Using *mantras* to dedicate the *chakra* to Chakreshvari, he will perform her *nyasa* in the heart. *Nyasa* of Ganapati and the others will be performed in the other places that have been stated. The right thigh is equal to the left thigh. In the due order, *nyasa* will be undertaken for all of them — Ganesha, Kshetrapala, Yogini and Batuka. Initially, *nyasa* of Indra and the others will be done on the tips of the big toes, the knees, the sides, the top of the face, the thighs, the head and *muladhara*. *Nyasa* of the ten *siddhis*, *anima* and the others, will be done, in the due order, on the shoulders, the hands, the back, the toes, the buttocks, the back, the head and the feet. The *siddhis* are described as *anima*, *laghima*, *mahima* as the third, *ishitvam*, *vashitvam*, *prakamya*, *prapti*, *iccha-siddhi*, *rasa-siddhi* and *moksha-siddhi*. O *brahmana*! After this, in due order, an intelligent person will perform *nyasa* of the eight *matrikas* on the two big toes, the right side, the left side of the head, the left knee, the right knee, the right shoulder and the left shoulder. The learned should know that the right order of the *matrikas* is Brahmi, Maheshvari, Koumari, Vaishnavi, Varahi, Indrani, Chamunda as the seventh and Mahalakshmi. The Devis of the *mudras* must be placed in these eight positions. Two more are placed on the head and the foot. The *mudras* are Sarva-samkshobhini, Sarva-vidravini, Sarvartha-

karshani, Sarva-vashakarini, Sarva-priyakarini, Sarva-mahankushi, Sarva-khechari, Trikhanda, Sarva-bijaa, Sarva-prapurikaa and *yonimudra*. These should be known as the *mudras*. Thereafter, the *chakra* that confounds the three worlds must be offered to Chakreshvari and *nyasa* of her pervasive form performed on the body. Next, in the due order, there will be *nyasa* of the digits and the sixteen Nityaas. They are said to be Kamakarshana-rupaa, Shabdakarshana-rupini, Ahamkara-karshini, Buddhyakarshana-rupini, Sparshakarshana-rupaa, Rupakarshana-rupini, Rasakarshana-rupaa, Gandhakarshana-rupini, Chittakarshana-rupaa, Dhairyakarshana-rupini, Smrityakarshana-rupaa, Hridakarshana-rupini, Shraddhakarshana-rupaa, Atmakarshana-rupini, Amritakarshini and Sharirakarshini. Their places are the right ear, the back, the shoulder, the elbow, the back of the palm of the right hand, the right buttock, the right knee, the right calf and the right foot. Starting with the left foot, this must then be done in the reverse order. In this way, the *chakra* must be offered to Chakreshi and the *nyasa* of her pervasive form performed on the body. Thereafter, starting with Anangakusumaa, the *nyasa* of these eight divinities must be done on the right side of the forehead, the right clavicle, the right thigh and the right calf. On the left side, this must be done in the reverse order. They are Anangakusumaa, Anangamekhalaa as the second, Anangamadanaa, Anangamadanaturaa, Anangarekhaa, Anangavegaa, Anangakushaa and Anangadhara-malini. The *chakra* must be offered to Chakreshi and the *nyasa* of her pervasive form performed on the body. Starting with Sarva-samkshobhini, the Shakti Devis must next be placed on the forehead, the cheek, the base of the foot, the knee, the top part of the calf and the bottom part of the calf. On the left, this must be done in the reverse order. The Shaktis are Sarva-samkshobhini, Sarva-vidravini, Sarva-karshani, Sarva-prahladini, Sarva-sammohini, Sarva-stambhini, Sarva-jrimbhini, Sarvavasha-karini, Sarva-ranjini, Sarvonmadini, Sarvartha-sadhini, Sarvasha-purini, Sarva-mantramayi and Sarvadvanda-kshayankaraa. The *chakra* must be offered to Chakreshi and the *nyasa* of her pervasive form performed on the body. *Nyasa* must then be done of the ten divinities, Sarva-siddhipradaa and the others, in the right nostril, the root of the teeth,

the right breast, the right elbow and the right wrist. For *nyasa* on the left side, the reverse order must be followed. The divinities are Sarva-siddhipradaa, Sarva-sampatpradaa, Sarva-priyankaraa, Sarva-mangalakarini, Sarvagha-mochini, Sarva-dukkhavimochini, Sarva-mrityuprashamni, Sarva-vighnavinashini, Sarvanga-sundari and Sarva-soubhagyadayini. The *chakra* must be offered to Chakreshi and the *nyasa* of her pervasive form performed on the body. Sarvajnaa and the others must then be placed on the breast and the teeth. They are known as Sarvajnaa, Sarvashakti, Sarvajnanapradaa, Sarvajnanamayi, Sarva-vyadhi-vinashini, Sarvadhara-svarupaa, Sarva-papaharaa, Sarvananda-mayi, Sarva-raksha-svarupini and Sarvepsita-phalapradaa as the tenth. The *chakra* must be offered to Chakreshi and the *nyasa* of her pervasive form performed on the body. Starting with Vamaa and others, an intelligent person will then perform *nyasa* on the right cheek, the neck, the breast, the navel and the sides. The learned say that their names are held to be Vamaa, Vinodini, Vidyaa, Vashitaa, Kamiki, Kameshvari, Mohini, Vimalaa, Arunaa, Jayini, Sarveshvari and Koulini.'

'The *chakra* must be offered to Chakreshi and the *nyasa* of her pervasive form performed on the body, placing her in the heart. Starting in the eastern direction, on the outside, an intelligent person must then perform *nyasa* of the four weapons. Starting with the south-east corner, the four *peethas* will be placed in the centre. A circle will be drawn in the centre and *nyasa* of the sixteen Nityaas undertaken there. They are described as Kameshvari, Bhagamalini, Klinnaa, Bherundini, Vahnivasinika, Mahavajreshvari, Shivaduti, Tvaritaa, Kulasundarikaa, Kulyaa, Nilapatakaa, Vijayaa, Mangalaa, Prabhamalini and Chitraa. Their *nyasa* must be done inside a triangle in the heart, with the point of the triangle facing downwards. The Nityaas Pramodini and Tripurasundari are on either side. *Nyasa* of Devi Akhanda Jagadatmikaa is done in the centre. When *nyasa* of Chakreshvari has been done in the heart, the entire *chakra* is raised. Exhibiting *yonimudra*, he must perform *japa* with the *mantra* that bestows every kind of bliss. Chakreshvari's *chakra* will then become one's own.'

Lalita's account ends abruptly in this way, without anything else being said in the conclusion.

This concludes *Brahmanda Purana*.

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Notes

Introduction

¹ For example, *shlokas* 2.4.10, 4.1.2 and 4.5.11 of the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad use the two expressions together.

² Chandogya Upanishad, 7.1.2.

³ *Ancient Indian Historical Tradition*, F.E. Pargiter, Oxford University Press, London, 1922.

⁴ *Sutas* were bards, minstrels, raconteurs.

⁵ The Critical Edition of the Valmiki Ramayana was brought out by the Baroda Oriental Institute, now part of the Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda. The Critical Edition of the Mahabharata was brought out by the Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, Pune. For a few Puranas, work on Critical Editions has started.

⁶ The Bhagavat Gita translation was published in 2006 and reprinted in 2019, the translation of the Critical Edition of the Mahabharata in 10 volumes between 2010 and 2014 (with a box set in 2015) and the translation of the Critical Edition of the Valmiki Ramayana in 2017. The translations are by Bibek Debroy, and in each case, the publisher is Penguin.

⁷ *Brahmanda Purana*, Krishnadas Academy, Varanasi, 1983.

⁸ *The Brahmanda Purana*, translated and annotated by G.V. Tagare, five volumes, Motilal Banarsidass Publishers, Delhi, 1983 to 1984.

⁹ Asiatic Society went through several name changes, but it can simply be called Asiatic Society.

¹⁰ *The Vishnu Purana, A System of Hindu Mythology and Tradition*, Horace Hayman Wilson, Trubner & Company, London, 1864–1870.

¹¹ *Studies in the Puranic Records on Hindu Rites and Customs*, R.C. Hazra, University of Dacca, 1940. This has since been reprinted several times, by different publishers.

¹² *Op.cit.*

¹³ *The Bhagavata Purana*, Volumes 1–3, Penguin Books, 2018; the *Markandeya Purana*, Penguin Books, 2019; *The Brahma Purana*, Volumes 1–2, Penguin Books 2021; the *Vishnu Purana*, Penguin Books, 2022; the *Shiva Purana*, Volumes 1–3, Penguin Books, 2023.

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The Brahmanda Purana Continued

¹ Parashurama, who was descended from Bhrigu's lineage.

² This is a reference to Vishnu's *vamana* (dwarf) incarnation. Vamana covered everything in three of his strides.

³ *Siddhi* is success in attaining the objective. *Siddhis* mean powers. Specifically, *yoga* leads to eight major *siddhis* or powers. These are *anima* (becoming as small as one desires), *mahima* (as large as one desires), *laghima* (as light as one wants), *garima* (as heavy as one wants), *prapti* (obtaining what one wants), *prakamyā* (travelling where one wants), *vashitvam* (powers to control creatures) and *ishitvam* (obtaining divine powers).

⁴ *Kavacha* is armour. This is in the form of the *mantra*.

⁵ Vasishtha is speaking to King Sagara.

⁶ *Vraja* is a place where cows reside. This is the region where Krishna resided, during his childhood. *Stotram* is a hymn of praise.

⁷ Vishnu.

⁸ Krishna has four manifestations (*vyuhas*) as Vaasudeva, Samkarshana, Pradyumna and Aniruddha.

⁹ Isha and Ishana are Shiva's names.

¹⁰ Indira is one of Lakshmi's names. *Gopa* is a cowherd, *gopi* being the feminine. *Gopis* committed the transgression of being attracted to Krishna, even though they were married.

¹¹ Semi-divine species, also known as *kimpurusha*.

¹² The three *gunas* of *sattva* (purity), *rajas* (passion) and *tamas* (ignorance).

¹³ Krishna.

¹⁴ Incarnation.

¹⁵ *Dvija* means twice-born. It is often used for *brahmanas*, but can also be used for any of the first three *varnas*, who have a second birth when they are invested with the sacred thread. When the text uses *dvija*, as opposed to some other word for *brahmana*, we will retain *dvija*.

¹⁶ In addition, this is an allusion to Rama, Lakshmana, Bharata and Shatrughna.

¹⁷ That is, Vishvamitra's.

¹⁸ Daughter of the king of Videha, Sita.

¹⁹ Kartavirya Arjuna's capital, identified with Maheshvara in Madhya Pradesh. Kartavirya Arjuna conquered Mahishmati from Karkotaka *naga*.

²⁰ Shiva destroyed Tripura, which actually consisted of three separate cities.

²¹ That is, Dattatreya's.

²² Chariots, elephants, horses and infantry.

²³ An *akshouhini* is an army and consists of 21,870 chariots, 21,870 elephants, 65,610 horses and 1,09,350 infantry men.

²⁴ *Astra* and *shastra* are both weapons and the words are often used synonymously. However, an *astra* is a weapon that is hurled or released, while a *shastra* is held in the hand.

²⁵ Though the singular is used, it is perhaps better to take this in the plural. Some women were attired in black clothes, others were naked.

²⁶ A *pulkasa* (equivalently *pukkasa*) is the son of a *nishada* father and a *shudra* mother. A *nishada* is a hunter, typically dwelling in the mountains.

²⁷ Battleaxe.

²⁸ Mangala is the king of Matsya. The word *astra* is also used for a divine weapon and these are respectively named after Vayu (the wind-God), a mountain (*parvata*) and Narayana.

²⁹ A *maharatha* is a great warrior, someone who can fight against 10,000 warriors at the same time.

³⁰ Towards Kartavirya.

³¹ Water is touched before any auspicious act.

³² The moon has sixteen digits (*kalas*) and is the lord of *kalas*. Kali wears the crescent moon on her forehead.

³³ *Ganas* are Shiva's companions and attendants and Ganeshvaras are their leaders.

³⁴ That is, Brahma.

³⁵ The three kinds of hardship relate to *adhidaivika* (destiny), *adhibhoutika* (nature) and *adhyatmika* (one's own nature).

³⁶ This a reference to Devi's various names. Jagaddhita, more commonly Jagaddhatri, means mother of the universe. Though Shiva destroyed Tripura, Devi has several names associated with Tripura (Puratraya has the same meaning).

³⁷ A reference to Devi's form as Bagalamukhi, one of the ten Mahavidyas, common in *tantra*.

³⁸ A *mudra* is a symbolic and mystical positioning of the fingers and the thumb. *Abhaya mudra* indicates freedom from fear and *varada mudra* indicates the granting of boons.

³⁹ A lion.

⁴⁰ *Pranayama* is control over breath (*prana*) and *achamana* is rinsing of the mouth, or ablutions in general.

⁴¹ A *nalva* is a measure of distance, equal to 400 *hastas* or cubits.

⁴² *Vyuha* is a battle-formation. There were many types of these.

⁴³ As a substitute for touching water.

⁴⁴ Krishna's name, the one in whom the universe resides.

⁴⁵ Ravana.

⁴⁶ The knowledge of bringing the dead (*mrita*) back to life (*sanjivani*).

⁴⁷ Silent chanting.

⁴⁸ Vasishtha is speaking to King Sagara, the son of Subahu/Bahu.

⁴⁹ A *muhurta* is forty-eight minutes but is often used in the sense of an instant.

⁵⁰ *Vimana* has many meanings. In this context, it means a celestial vehicle. The text uses the word 'Druhina'. We have loosely translated it as God. But specifically, the word is used for Brahma, Vishnu and Maheshvara.

⁵¹ Nandana is a celestial pleasure garden, specifically, that belonging to Indra.

⁵² *Touryatrika*, a word used to mean the triple symphony of singing, dancing and instrumental music.

⁵³ Meaning Kartavirya.

⁵⁴ One with a bull on the banner, Shiva's name.

⁵⁵ Alaka/Alakapuri is adjacent to Kailasa and is the capital of Kubera, the lord of *yakshas*.

⁵⁶ A *yojana* is a measure of distance, between eight and nine miles.

⁵⁷ *Vidyadharas* are semi-divine species. *Sarpas* are snakes. It is derived from the word for creeping along. The word *sarpa* is often used as a synonym for *naga/uraga/pannaga*. Throughout this translation, we will use the word 'snake' for *sarpa* and the word 'serpent' for *naga/uraga*. *Nagas* are a semi-divine species, with powers to assume any form they will. As the antithesis of *suras*, there are the demons, *asuras*. *Daityas* and *danavas* are used as synonyms for *asuras*. *Daityas* are the offspring of Diti and *danavas* are the offspring of Danu, both married to the sage Kashyapa. A *preta* is a

ghost, the spirit of a dead person, or simply something evil. A *bhuta* has the same meaning. Strictly speaking, there are differences between *preta*, *bhuta* and *pishacha* (one who lives on flesh). A *preta* is the spirit (not necessarily evil) of a dead person before the funeral rites have been performed. A *bhuta* (not necessarily evil again) is the spirit of a dead person who has had a violent death and for whom, proper funeral rites have not been performed, and may not even be performed. A *pishacha* (necessarily evil) is often created deliberately through evil powers. A *kushmanda* is an evil spirit, sometimes described as Shiva's companion. A *brahma-rakshasa* is a *brahmana* who is born as a *rakshasa*. A *vetala* is ghost or goblin. A *kinnara* or *kimpurusha* belongs to a semi-divine species, companions of Kubera. *Dakinis* and *yoginis* are semi-divine female deities.

⁵⁸ Kshetrapalas.

⁵⁹ The word used is *tata*. It means son, but is used for anyone who is junior. It also means father but is used for anyone who is senior. Vinayaka would probably regard Parashurama as junior, rather than senior.

⁶⁰ Ganesha.

⁶¹ Ganesha.

⁶² The earth consists of seven *dvipas* (continents).

⁶³ Ganesha.

⁶⁴ On the successful completion of studies, the fee paid by a *shishya* to a *guru*. The word is also used for the sacrificial fee paid to the priest who performs a sacrifice.

⁶⁵ Shiva.

⁶⁶ *Makara* is a mythical aquatic creature but can loosely be translated as crocodile or shark.

⁶⁷ Krishna's friend.

⁶⁸ That is, Radha.

⁶⁹ Those who strike, Shiva's followers. *Pramathas* and *ganas* are often used synonymously.

⁷⁰ *Brahmanda* is a cosmic egg, that is, the universe. *Lambodara* means pot-bellied, with a large stomach.

⁷¹ With the head of an elephant.

⁷² *Chaturthi* is the fourth lunar day (*tithi*). A sage named Darbhin is mentioned in the Mahabharata. But we know nothing about his cursing the moon (Chandra). *Bhalachandra* means with Chandra on the forehead.

⁷³ Jataveda is Agni. He was cursed by the *saptarshis* because he seduced their wives. *Shurpa* is a winnowing basket or fan. *Shurpakarnaka* (*Shurpakarna*) is one with ears like a winnowing basket or winnowing fan. The word means elephant and is also Ganesha's names. The allusion is to Ganesha fanning Agni back to life.

⁷⁴ One who destroys impediments.

⁷⁵ With a single tusk.

⁷⁶ With a curved trunk.

⁷⁷ Past, present and future.

⁷⁸ *Kalpa* is one of Brahma's days, the period during which creation lasts, before dissolution. The present *kalpa* is *Varaha kalpa*. There is a list of *kalpas* in the *Matsya Purana*. According to that list, *Varaha kalpa* is the twenty-sixth. The tenth was *Ishana* and the thirteenth was *Udana*. *Samskara* means cleansing, specifically done at certain periods of life. There are thirteen *samskaras* or sacraments. The list varies a bit. But one list is *vivaha* (marriage), *garbhalambhana* (conception), *pumshavana* (engendering a male child), *simantonnayana* (parting the hair, performed in the fourth month of pregnancy), *jatakarma* (birth rites), *namakarana* (naming), *chudakarma* (tonsure), *annaprashana* (first solid food), *keshanta* (first shaving of the head), *upanayana* (sacred thread), *vidyarambha* (commencement of studies), *samavartana* (graduation) and *antyeshti* (funeral rites).

⁷⁹ This is a prayer to Kartikeya. These prayers are such that one verse flows into the other and there are also several typos in the text.

⁸⁰ This is a prayer to Krishna.

⁸¹ This is a prayer to Radha.

⁸² Krishna's dance with *gopis*.

⁸³ In this description of creation, the word 'Virat' is used in multiple senses. It is the aggregation of principles that emerged from the cosmic egg.

⁸⁴ Brahma.

⁸⁵ Alternatively, milk.

⁸⁶ Described in Volume 1 of the *Brahmanda Purana*.

⁸⁷ The two Krishnas are Krishna and Krishnaa (Radha). The two Bhavas are Bhava and Bhavani.

⁸⁸ *Pradakshina* is more specific than a mere act of circumambulating. This circling or circumambulation has to be done in a specific way, so that the right side (*dakshina*) always faces what is being circled.

⁸⁹ *Samhita* means collection, of *mantras* (hymns).

⁹⁰ *Dandavat*, like a staff (*danda*). This means lying completely prostrate on the ground and is also known as *sashtanga pranama*, *ashta* meaning eight and *anga* meaning limb. Eight of one's limbs must touch the ground. Though the number eight is sometimes interpreted metaphorically, literally, it means two feet, two knees, two hands, the chest and the forehead. These must touch the ground.

⁹¹ *Sadhya* is the attainable objective, *sadhana* is the means. *Sadhaka* is the person who is using the means to attain the objective. *Siddhi* is success in attaining the objective.

⁹² Ganesha.

⁹³ A rite of atonement.

⁹⁴ *Vratas* are vows, *niyamas* are rules of restraint and self-control.

⁹⁵ Five of Kartavirya's sons ran away to the Himalayas and saved themselves. They were Shura, Vrishasya, Vrisha, Shurasena and Jayadvaja.

⁹⁶ Jamadagni.

⁹⁷ Rite that brings satisfaction to the dead.

⁹⁸ Shiva's attendant, who had promised to arrive when needed. This incident has been described in Volume 1.

⁹⁹ *Sarvamsaha*, the same as *Sarvasaha* or *Sahasaha*, means someone who can endure everything. From what follows, *Sarvasaha* was sent as a chariot-driver.

¹⁰⁰ *Vitihotra* was the son of *Talajangha* and *Talajangha* was the son of *Jayadhvaja*.

¹⁰¹ This should probably read twenty-four years, twelve years for each year of extermination.

¹⁰² Described in Volume 1.

¹⁰³ That is, using water, he anointed them as kings.

¹⁰⁴ Both *tirthas* and *kshetras* are sacred places of pilgrimage. However, *tirthas* are associated with water, while *kshetras* are not. The etymology of the word *tirtha* is based on descent or descending. A *tirtha* is a place where one descends into the water. Here, the word probably means flights of stairs, leading down to the water.

¹⁰⁵ Funeral rites.

¹⁰⁶ The same as *Samantapanchaka*.

¹⁰⁷ A *pinda* is a funeral cake, offered as oblation.

¹⁰⁸ A guest is offered *padya* (water to wash the feet), *achamaniya* (water to rinse the mouth), *asana* (a seat) and *arghya* (a gift).

¹⁰⁹ This is unusual. Usually, kings performed horse sacrifices.

¹¹⁰ *Ritvijas* are officiating priests. Though the classification varied over time, there were four types of *ritivijas*. The *adhvaryu* chanted hymns from the *Yajur Veda*, the *hotri* chanted hymns from the *Rig Veda*, the *udgatri* chanted hymns from the *Sama Veda* and the *brahmana* chanted hymns from the *Atharva Veda*.

¹¹¹ Assistant priest.

¹¹² As *dakshina* to the *guru*. Mount Mahendra was excluded.

¹¹³ The *guru*.

¹¹⁴ *Avabhritha* is the most important final component of a sacrifice, characterized by the taking of a bath.

¹¹⁵ Kashyapa was Marichi's son.

¹¹⁶ Establishment/showing of lamps.

¹¹⁷ Talajangha.

¹¹⁸ Sagara's father was Bahuka, also known as Asita. But this name is not consistently given, across texts.

¹¹⁹ *Chakravarti* is a universal emperor, literally, a king whose wheel (*chakra*) travels everywhere on earth.

¹²⁰ *Dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*.

¹²¹ In addition to chariots, horses, elephants and infantry, there were divisions for provisions/food and entertainment.

¹²² That is, Shiva.

¹²³ Kosala was the kingdom. At various points in time, Kosala has had different capitals—Ayodhya, Saket and Shravasti. In King Sagara's time, the capital was Ayodhya.

¹²⁴ Predatory beasts.

¹²⁵ *Mleccha* can loosely be translated as barbarian, but means someone who does not speak Sanskrit.

¹²⁶ This Shurasena cannot be Kartavirya's son, Shurasena.

¹²⁷ That is, Mathura.

¹²⁸ Camp doesn't convey the sense completely. The word used is *skandhavana*. It means all the various divisions that accompany a king.

¹²⁹ The *sutas* were charioteers, as well as raconteurs of tales. *Magadhas* were minstrels and bards. So were *bandis*. But *magadhas* seem to have also composed, while *bandis* sang the compositions of others.

¹³⁰ Indra.

¹³¹ *Dharma*, *artha* and *kama*.

¹³² He became a universal emperor. The word *Vrishā* means Vishnu. But it is possible that the word *Vrishā* is used in the text in a completely different sense. The word means bull, as well as Shiva and Indra. There was also an asura *named* *Vrishā*, who ruled over the entire earth.

¹³³ Vasishtha's name.

¹³⁴ The word *rajan* means king. But *rajan* is a king who delights the subjects (this is the etymology) and is not a word used for an ordinary king.

¹³⁵ *Shali* is a fine rice.

¹³⁶ The father's side and the mother's side.

¹³⁷ They thought that clouds and the monsoon had arrived.

¹³⁸ There are many words for trees. *Vanaspati* is a large tree that grows in the forest. Specifically, it is a tree with fruit, but no visible flowers. *Vrikshas* have both flowers and fruit. The text uses both words.

¹³⁹ The word *saranga* has different meanings. Here, it means the *chataka* bird.

¹⁴⁰ *Hamsa* is a swan, *sarasa* is the *sarus* crane, *chakravaka* is the Brahminy duck, *karandava* is a goose, and *shuka* is a parrot.

¹⁴¹ *Ambuja* is any aquatic flower (specifically, a lotus), *kahlara* is a white lotus or water-lily, *kumuda* is a lotus that blooms during the night and *utpala* is a blue lotus (or water lily).

¹⁴² The wives.

¹⁴³ Mythical eight-legged creature that feeds on lions. However, the word also means a young elephant or a camel.

¹⁴⁴ *Gavaya* is a wild ox.

¹⁴⁵ The moon.

¹⁴⁶ A crystal or gem that gives rise to fire when touched by the rays of the sun.

¹⁴⁷ We have simplified the name to Asamanja.

¹⁴⁸ Ayodhya was on the banks of Sarayu.

¹⁴⁹ *Vashatkara* is the exclamation '*vashat*' made at the time of offering an oblation.

¹⁵⁰ *Yoga* has eight elements—*yama* (restraint), *niyama* (rituals), *asana* (posture), *pranayama* (breathing), *pratyahara* (withdrawal), *dharana* (retention), *dhyana* (meditation) and *samadhi* (liberation/deep meditation).

¹⁵¹ *Havya* is oblations offered to *devas*, *kavya* is oblations offered to ancestors.

¹⁵² Virinchi is Brahma's name. Sharva is Shiva and it is unusual that Shiva should go with the *devas*. This is undoubtedly a typo for Shakra (Indra).

¹⁵³ That is, Kapila.

¹⁵⁴ *Adhidaivika* (destiny), *adhibhoutika* (nature) and *adhyatmika* (one's own nature) as causes.

¹⁵⁵ Dhatri is the one who nurtures, and Vidhatri is the one who ordains.

¹⁵⁶ *Diksha* is the process of initiation/consecration.

¹⁵⁷ The seven nether regions are Atala, Vitala, Sutala, Rasatala, Talatala, Mahatala and Patala.

¹⁵⁸ The antithesis of *dharma*.

¹⁵⁹ Cross-legged, in the lotus posture.

¹⁶⁰ The fire of destruction.

¹⁶¹ This is the subterranean fire, in the shape of a mare's head (*vadavamukha*), also known as the Ourva fire.

¹⁶² Literally, *brahmadanda* means a *brahmana*'s staff or curse. But it is also a metaphor for the punishment.

¹⁶³ The cycle of material worldly existence, with death and rebirth.

¹⁶⁴ Because he didn't want to lose Amshuman, who was only a child.

¹⁶⁵ That is uncles, fathers by extrapolation.

¹⁶⁶ As a descendant of Sagara.

¹⁶⁷ Person on whose behalf the sacrifice is being performed, in this case, Sagara.

¹⁶⁸ For possible transgressions in the course of the sacrifice.

¹⁶⁹ Earlier, Sagara's wife has been mentioned in the singular. Here, it is mentioned in the dual.

¹⁷⁰ Meaning Amshuman.

¹⁷¹ The moon.

¹⁷² Meaning Sagara now.

¹⁷³ It is difficult to infer what this means, probably submerged in the ocean.

¹⁷⁴ Saagara means the ocean.

¹⁷⁵ Literally, Brahma's foot.

¹⁷⁶ The state of emancipation, when everything is extinguished. There is no rebirth thereafter.

¹⁷⁷ The famous Mahabaleshwara temple to Shiva is in Gokarna in Karnataka.

¹⁷⁸ The text uses the word *anupa*. This means a region near water. Specifically, it also means a marshy region.

¹⁷⁹ Brahma.

¹⁸⁰ The word *nakra*, used in the text, means both crocodile and alligator. The word *graha*, means something that seizes. So *graha* could also have been translated as shark.

¹⁸¹ Jahnu was the *rajarshi*'s name, explaining the name Jahnavi. Jahnu used to be a king, which is the reason he is referred to as a *rajarshi*. However, when the incident occurred, he had retired to the forest and had become a sage.

¹⁸² Sita is identified as the river Tarim, Suchakshu (Chakshu) as Oxus and Bhadravati as Syr Darya.

¹⁸³ A specific *asana* (posture).

¹⁸⁴ That is, the ocean.

¹⁸⁵ When the word mountain is used, it should be understood in the sense of a range, rather than a specific mountain in that range. From Mahendra (Eastern Ghats), Parashurama came to Sahya (Western Ghats) and descended to the shores of the ocean.

¹⁸⁶ Prachetas is one of Varuna's names.

¹⁸⁷ Narasimha/Nrisimha is Vishnu's half-man half-lion *avatara*, assumed to kill Hiranyakashipu.

¹⁸⁸ *Timingila* is a fish that devours whales (*timi*).

¹⁸⁹ The word *shurpa* means winnowing basket. The word for sacrificial ladle, used in the text, is *shruva*. Both *shruk* and *shruva* are sacrificial ladles, *shruk* is like a bowl with a handle, *shruva* resembles a spoon. Shurparaka is identified as Nallasopara or Nala Sopara, near Mumbai.

¹⁹⁰ This *shloka* is not at all clear and we have taken liberties. Hence, the adjective eastern also remains unclear. A subsequent *shloka* suggests that land was created in the form of an island in the ocean.

¹⁹¹ Since the expanse of the land was four hundred *yojanas*, what is presumably meant is that Rama redid the watery part, so that it measured six hundred *yojanas* and not one thousand *yojanas*.

¹⁹² Vedavyasa.

¹⁹³ Usually, she is referred to as Varunani. Stutaa means the one who is praised.

¹⁹⁴ This Suraa seems to mean Varuna's daughter Varuni. The words *suraa* and *varuni* mean liquor. Sometimes, Varuni is described as Varuna's daughter. Sometimes, Varuni is equated with Varuna's wife, Varunani. Thus, there was a Kali who was Varuna's son and there was a Kali who was Suraa or Varuni's son.

¹⁹⁵ *Sandhya* is dawn and dusk when night meets day and day meets night. There are thus two *sandhyas*. Sometimes, mid-day is added as a third *sandhya*. It is implied that these *rakshasas* were the sons of Shakuni and Ayomukhi.

¹⁹⁶ *Brahmachari* is someone who follows *brahmacharya*. *Brahmacharini* is the feminine.

¹⁹⁷ The text is not correct in places and is difficult to correct. Tvashta is being equated with Vishvakarma. Tvashta/Vishvakarma was the son of Varastri, Brihaspati's sister. Brihaspati and Dharma were Brahma's sons, though Brihaspati is sometimes described as the son of Angiras. If Brihaspati is regarded as Brahma's son, by extrapolation, Tvashta/Vishvakarma was Dharma's grandson.

¹⁹⁸ Another name for Trishira.

¹⁹⁹ Maya was the architect (hence known as Vishvakarma) for *asuras*. Since Surenu/Samjna is described as Tvashta's daughter later, Maya must also have been Tvashta's son. That is, the Vishvakarma in the text here means Tvashta.

²⁰⁰ Savitar is the sun-God, Surya. Vivasvat is another of Surya's names, as is Martanda.

²⁰¹ Martanda was the son of Kashyapa and Aditi, in the form of an egg. When nothing resulted from the egg, Aditi threw it away and Tvashta broke it.

²⁰² Martanda is derived from *mrita* (dead) *anda* (egg).

²⁰³ That is, Aditi.

²⁰⁴ This bit does not belong here and breaks the continuity. We have been told earlier that Tvashta said this. Other Puranas do say that it was Kashyapa who said this.

²⁰⁵ Surya.

²⁰⁶ Since *chhaya* means shadow, this lady is also known as Chhaya. Savarnaa means that she had the same complexion (form) as Samjna.

²⁰⁷ Surya.

²⁰⁸ The current Manu is Vaivasvata. The names of the future Manus are often given as Savarni, Daksha-Savarni, Brahma-Savarni, Dharma-Savarni, Rudra-Savarni, Rouchya and Bhoutya. Shanaishchara, the slow-moving one, is the planet Saturn.

²⁰⁹ As the son of Vivasvat, Yama is also Vaivasvata. At this time, Yama did not of course know that this wasn't the real Samjna. When he censured her back, he raised his foot to kick her, though he stopped short of actually kicking her.

²¹⁰ Before agreeing to Samjna, Chhaya had stipulated a condition. She would not reveal the truth, that she was not the real Samjna, but only as long as she was not cursed, or seized by the hair. When this happened, she would tell the truth. According to some accounts, Vivasvat also seized Chhaya by the hair.

²¹¹ Surya.

²¹² Surya.

²¹³ As a horse, Vivasvat approached her from the rear. Taking him to be someone else's husband, she turned her back away and the mare's mouth faced the horse.

²¹⁴ For each month, Aditya has a different form.

²¹⁵ Vaivasvata Manu, Yama, Yami, Shanaishchara, Savarni Manu, Tapati, Nasatya and Dasra.

²¹⁶ Surya.

²¹⁷ This seems to be the place where Surya's quote ends, although it is not clear.

²¹⁸ Vishnu's Sudarshana *chakra* was created with the pared off energy.

²¹⁹ For each *manvantara*, *devas* and *rishis* are different.

²²⁰ Manava means son of Manu. The text incorrectly says nine. We have corrected the number.

²²¹ As we will be told later, King Sudyumna entered a grove where Shiva and Parvati were sporting. Any male who entered would become female. That is how Sudyumna became Ilaa. He would have remained Ilaa for life. But, on Parvati's intercession, this was reduced to a period of one year.

²²² Soma is the moon and Budha was the son of Soma and Tara.

²²³ Usually, but not invariably, identified as Paithan in Maharashtra.

²²⁴ Sanaka, Sananda, Sanatana and Sanatkumara, sons born to Brahma through the powers of his mind. They were *brahmacharis*, perpetually in the form of children.

²²⁵ Parvati.

²²⁶ Different from the Nabhaga who was Vaivasvata Manu's son.

²²⁷ Brihaspati and Samvarta were the sons of Angiras and in general, Samvarta always opposed his elder brother, Brihaspati.

²²⁸ Identified as Vaishali.

²²⁹ Vaivasvata Manu's son.

²³⁰ Dvaraka or Dvaravati (city with gates).

²³¹ Krishna's father.

²³² Balarama.

²³³ The seven *svaras* (notes) are *shadaja*, *rishabha*, *gandhara*, *madhyama*, *panchama*, *dhaivata* and *nishada*, usually known as *sa*, *re*, *ga*, *ma*, *pa*, *dha* and *ni*. *Grama* means a musical scale and there were originally three scales, *shadaja*, *madhyama* and *gandharva*, with combinations of *svaras* and *shrutis* (quarter tones). *Murchhana* is moving up or down the scale and seven times three is twenty-one. *Tala* is the beat of time in music, but the word used in the text is *tana*. *Tana* is a grouping of *svaras* and is derived from *murchhana*, by dropping specific notes. There are forty-nine hexatonic sub-divisions.

²³⁴ In these sections, there are several typos in the text, making them difficult to understand. This also explains why the numbering is not consistent and why the translation seems so obscure.

²³⁵ These two are repeated.

²³⁶ *Pakshi* means bird.

²³⁷ In this context, *alamkara* means the embellishment for a song.

²³⁸ That is, whether the pitch is ascending, descending, or steady.

²³⁹ Segment of a sentence, combination of *aksharas*, line of a verse.

²⁴⁰ As with the previous chapter, there are several typos in the text. We have tried to make sense of the text as best as we can. In the process, several liberties have been taken.

²⁴¹ That is, the chest.

²⁴² The first *varna* is *sthayin*, not the *srishtha* mentioned in the text. *Sthayin* means steady or stable. Using *sa*, *re*, *ga*, *ma*, *pa*, *dha* and *ni*, if the same note is uttered over and over again, that is *sthayin*. The natural course of ascendance is *arohana*. When the utterance is in descending order, it is *avarohana*. *Prasanchari* or *sanchari* is when there is a blend of these three.

²⁴³ The list of *alamkaras* goes on and there are more than four. The text does not explain what they are. It merely lists them. *Natya Shastra* texts

give several names of *alamkaras*, but those names don't match the ones given here.

²⁴⁴ As in measurement of time.

²⁴⁵ Literally, the one that cuts a fly.

²⁴⁶ *Matra* indicates the time taken to articulate an *akshara*.

²⁴⁷ *Hrasva* or short vowels are pronounced over one *matra* (a prosodial or syllabic instant), *dirgha* or long vowels over two *matras* and *pluta* or elongated vowels over three *matras*. The *pluta* pronunciation now exists only in the utterance of OUM.

²⁴⁸ *Pana* is a specific type of *tana*.

²⁴⁹ *Pada* also means quarter. The division of *padas* refers to *ektala* (a single *dirgha* sound repeated four times), *dvitala* (a double *dirgha* sound repeated four times), *tritala* (a triple *dirgha* sound repeated four times) and *chatushtala* (a quadruple *dirgha* sound repeated four times). Uttara is north and Dakshina is south. There were clearly regional differences in music.

²⁵⁰ Brahma's world.

²⁵¹ *Saptajana* is a synonym. These were seven sages who were originally *rakshasas*. Therefore, their descendants are equated with *rakshasas*.

²⁵² Vaivasvata Manu's son. Sharyatas were the sons of Sharyati.

²⁵³ *Kshut* means to sneeze. Hence the name.

²⁵⁴ Vikukshi.

²⁵⁵ Literally, the northern road. The northern part of Jambudvipa. The southern region/road was Dakshinapatha.

²⁵⁶ *Ashtaka* is the eighth lunar day, but during *krishna paksha*, the dark lunar fortnight. A *shraddha* is often performed on the day of *ashtaka*.

²⁵⁷ We have deliberately left this as *mriga*. *Mriga* is any animal that is hunted, a wild animal. But specifically, it means a deer.

²⁵⁸ Sprinkle with water, as consecration. Vasishtha was the preceptor of the Ikshvakus. Since a part had been eaten, the meat had become a left-over and could not be offered.

²⁵⁹ One who has eaten a hare (*shasha*).

²⁶⁰ In hell.

²⁶¹ *Mamsa* is meat. This explanation is based on *mam* (me) and *sa* (he). He will eat me.

²⁶² The Adibaka battle was a battle between Vasishtha and Vishvamitra, where the two sages respectively assumed the forms of two aquatic birds of

the crane type. *Devas* and *asuras* also respectively took sides. Kakustha means hump and Kakutstha fought while seated on the hump of the bull.

²⁶³ Shravasti is in UP, near Ayodhya, the capital of the Kosala kingdom.

²⁶⁴ To the effect that Dhundhu would be killed.

²⁶⁵ This seems to mean Krishashva's.

²⁶⁶ We don't know the reason for this curse.

²⁶⁷ Divoukasa means resident of heaven. But here, it seems to be a proper name for the king of Vidarbha.

²⁶⁸ The same as Trayyaruni.

²⁶⁹ *Shvapakas* are sometimes equated with *chandalas*. *Shva* means dog and *paka* means to cook. Thus, *shvapaka* means someone who cooks dogs (eats dogs) or cooks for dogs (lives with dogs).

²⁷⁰ Because there was no king in the kingdom. Indra killed a demon named Paka and chastiser of Paka means Indra.

²⁷¹ Vishvamitra was descended from Kusha and is therefore Koushika. *Gala* means throat or neck and Galava's name is derived from that.

²⁷² *Vrata* is a vow. Chanting (*japa*) of a *mantra* takes place in the course of observing a vow. This *japa* can be of three types—*vachika* (loud chanting), *manasika* (silent chanting mentally) or *upamshu* (when only the person performing the *japa* can hear the chanting, which is in a low voice).

²⁷³ One can deduce what this means. The maiden who had been abducted by Satyavrata was being married to someone else. However, the seven steps hadn't been completed.

²⁷⁴ *Shanku* means stake/dart and *tri* is three.

²⁷⁵ Trishanku's son.

²⁷⁶ *Vijaya* means victory.

²⁷⁷ Haihayas and Talajanghas being counted together.

²⁷⁸ *Sa* (with) + *gara* (poison).

²⁷⁹ Sagara's son and Sagara would dwell in heaven for eternity.

²⁸⁰ The king was Sagara and the ocean became Saagara. These boons were granted to Sagara.

²⁸¹ Literally, he knew the heart of the dice.

²⁸² That is, through his wife.

²⁸³ Parashurama.

²⁸⁴ Not to be confused with the Dilipa who was Bhagiratha's father.

²⁸⁵ Meaning Shrutakirti, Shatrughna's wife, Kushadhvaja's daughter.

²⁸⁶ By killing the *rakshasas*.

²⁸⁷ Ravana.

²⁸⁸ Though not clearly stated, the chant seems to end here.

²⁸⁹ This is the school descended from Jaimini. *Vishnu Purana* tells us that Hiranyanabha from Kosala and Poushpinji were co-disciples of Sukarma. There is no obvious eastern school of the *Sama Veda*, and the expression probably refers to the Kauthuma recension.

²⁹⁰ *Salokya* is the ability to reside with the Lord, *samipya* is proximity to the Lord, *sarupya* is to be like the Lord in form and *sayujya* is identification with the Lord. These are different grades of emancipation.

²⁹¹ Vasishtha was the officiating priest at Nimi's sacrifice but had to perform Indra's sacrifice first. Having gone to Indra's sacrifice, Vasishtha did not return for a long time and Nimi started the sacrifice without him. On return, Vasishtha cursed Nimi that he would be without a body (*videha*). *Arani* means the two churning sticks used to kindle a fire, by rubbing them against each other. In this case, three *parvas* should probably be interpreted as three auspicious days during which the sacrifice was undertaken. *Bhagavata Purana* tells us that Janaka was born when Nimi's dead body was churned. The word *janana* means birth and Janaka is derived from that.

²⁹² He was performing austerities.

²⁹³ *Saptarshis*. The *saptarshis* are the seven great sages. The list varies, but the standard one is Marichi, Atri, Angira, Pulastya, Pulaha, Kratu and Vasishtha. The *saptarshis* change from one *manvantara* to another. In the sky, the *saptarshis* are identified with the constellation of Ursa Major (Great Bear).

²⁹⁴ *Prajas* are beings who were created. The four types are those born from wombs, those born from eggs, those born from seeds and those born from sweat/moisture (worms and insects).

²⁹⁵ A *nakshatra* is not a star. It can also be a constellation. There are twenty-seven (alternatively twenty-eight) *nakshatras*.

²⁹⁶ Of gold coins. A *rajasuya* sacrifice is a royal sacrifice, performed by an emperor.

²⁹⁷ Sinivali/Sini is the deity (and the day) for the day preceding the night of the new moon, while Kuhu is the deity (and the day) for the night of the new moon.

²⁹⁸ That is, Brihaspati.

²⁹⁹ Ushanas is Shukracharya. Brihaspati's father was Angiras and Rudra was Angiras' *shishya*. Ajagava is the name of Shiva's bow. *Brahmanda*

Purana mixes things up, as compared to something like *Brahma Purana*. *Devas* took Brihaspati's side while *asuras* fought on Chandra's side. *Brahma Purana* says Rudra fought on Chandra's side, contradicting what is stated in *Brahmanda Purana*.

³⁰⁰ Over Tara.

³⁰¹ A mark of love and affection.

³⁰² From Brihaspati (Jupiter). Budha is Mercury.

³⁰³ Ilaa.

³⁰⁴ Pururava.

³⁰⁵ Soma. Soma was partial towards one of his wives, Rohini, and was cursed by his father-in-law, Daksha.

³⁰⁶ Urvashi was a celestial *apsara* and Pururava was a mere man.

³⁰⁷ Kubera's capital.

³⁰⁸ Another name for Badarikashrama.

³⁰⁹ These are respective durations of time—ten years in Chaitraratha, eight years along the Mandakini, seven years in Alaka and so on.

³¹⁰ In some accounts, Urvashi was cursed by Mitra and Varuna. The curse was that she would have to reside in the world of mortals for a limited period of time. Urvashi imposed conditions on Pururava before agreeing to be his wife.

³¹¹ The word *mesha* can also be translated as sheep.

³¹² The story is not told in detail. The rams were being stolen in the middle of the night. Realizing that this was happening, Urvashi called out and Pururava got up from the bed, to save the rams. There was a flash of lightning, engineered by the *gandharvas*, and Urvashi saw Pururava naked. The contract was broken and she had to return.

³¹³ *Ahavanīya*, *garhapatya* and *dakshinagni* fires.

³¹⁴ Near Prayaga, so this is identified as Jhunsi or Jhusi.

³¹⁵ Kanchana is the same as Kanchanaprabha.

³¹⁶ There are various versions of this curse. In some versions of the story, Ganga was jealous of Kaveri and cursed her that she would become a river.

³¹⁷ The performer of one hundred sacrifices, Indra's name. Purandara is also Indra's name.

³¹⁸ Richika's father was Ourva. Ourva's father was Chyavana. Chyavana's father was Bhrigu.

³¹⁹ *Charu* is an oblation of rice, barley and pulses, cooked in butter and milk.

³²⁰ Satyavati was married to Richika, a sage. So her son should be an excellent *brahmana*. Her mother was married to Gadhi, a king. So her mother's son should be an excellent *kshatriya*. The exchange of *charus* ensured the opposite.

³²¹ Respectively, the serene and terrible ones.

³²² The root *jam* means to eat. The Vaishnava *charu* had been prepared on a serene fire.

³²³ The art of fighting.

³²⁴ Parashurama.

³²⁵ This sentence hangs loose. Thus stated, they seem to have been Satyavati and Richika's sons, that is, Jamadagni's brothers. More commonly, they are described as Ajigarta's sons. Later, Shunahshepha was adopted by Vishvamitra as a son.

³²⁶ *Pashu* means animal, but specifically, it means a sacrificial animal. Therefore, the word is also used for a wild animal, as opposed to a domesticated animal.

³²⁷ Literally, presented by *devas*.

³²⁸ *Gotra* is the lineage one has been born into, with marriage within the same *gotra* prohibited.

³²⁹ This statement is repeated.

³³⁰ *Abja* means born from water.

³³¹ *Arvaka srota*, a downward creation, a creation inferior to that of *devas*.

³³² The art of medicine and treatment of ailments. Literally, the technique of ensuring a long lifespan.

³³³ *Ayurveda* covers eight topics—general medicine, pediatrics, extraction of foreign objects, ENT (ear, nose, throat) ailments, pacification of spirits, toxicology, rejuvenation and aphrodisiacs.

³³⁴ One of Shiva's attendants. There are various versions of this curse, all involving Divodasa.

³³⁵ In the context of Shiva's marriage to Parvati.

³³⁶ Parvati's mother, Himalaya's wife.

³³⁷ *Avimukta* is a name for Kashi/Varanasi. The word *mukti* means salvation/liberation, release. The usual explanation for the name *Avimukta* is that one obtains liberation there. Here, the explanation is based on Shiva not leaving that residence of his.

³³⁸ All that we know is that Bhadrasena, also known as Bhadrashenya, used to be the king of Varanasi earlier.

- ³³⁹ That is, Durdama wrested Varanasi from Pratardana.
- ³⁴⁰ Agastya's wife.
- ³⁴¹ Alarka.
- ³⁴² Shachi is Indra's wife.
- ³⁴³ Fruit of the jujube tree.
- ³⁴⁴ Indra's.
- ³⁴⁵ Raji's sons.
- ³⁴⁶ Indra.
- ³⁴⁷ The text says Marut. It should be Marutta and we have changed it to Marutta, to avoid confusion with the Maruts, the wind-Gods.
- ³⁴⁸ A *soma* sacrifice dedicated to the Maruts.
- ³⁴⁹ Liberation from the worldly cycle (*samsara*) of death and rebirth.
- ³⁵⁰ Another Jaya.
- ³⁵¹ Vrishaparva was the king of *asuras*, while Ushanas (Shukracharya) was the preceptor of *asuras*.
- ³⁵² Yayati.
- ³⁵³ He was known as Lohagandhi, someone who smelt of iron (probably meaning weapons). Janamejaya killed Gargya's son.
- ³⁵⁴ Uparichara Vasu was Indra's friend.
- ³⁵⁵ Brihadratha's son. Brihadratha was the son of Uparichara Vasu.
- ³⁵⁶ Kavya/Ushanas is Shukracharya, Devayani's father. As a result of the quarrel between Devayani and Sharmishtha, Shukracharya cursed Yayati, but allowed him to transfer the curse to someone else. The story is recounted in the Mahabharata.
- ³⁵⁷ Where the wife has a *varna* higher than that of the husband.
- ³⁵⁸ An *apsara*. Nandana and Vaibhaja are celestial pleasure-gardens.
- ³⁵⁹ *Kalaas* and *kashthas* are units for measuring time.
- ³⁶⁰ Fire.
- ³⁶¹ Paddy.
- ³⁶² This is the standard account, not that Kartavirya Arjuna was born with one thousand arms.
- ³⁶³ Otherwise, he possessed two hands.
- ³⁶⁴ Other than the famous sage, there was also a *gandharva* named Narada.
- ³⁶⁵ An image for the waves.
- ³⁶⁶ Ravana.
- ³⁶⁷ Agni.

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³⁶⁸ Though a son born to Brahma through his mental powers, Vasishtha was also born through a sacrifice offered to Varuna. Apava is one of Vasishtha's names.

³⁶⁹ When he burnt down Khandava forest, Kounteya Arjuna surpassed the deed performed by Kartavirya Arjuna.

³⁷⁰ The maker of the day, Surya.

³⁷¹ Presumably, those who regularly performed sacrifices with oblations offered into the fire.

³⁷² Akshara and Antara must be the same individual. Either the same individual had two names, or one is a typo.

³⁷³ The brothers drove Jyamagha out. The *brahmana* didn't quite oppose him. The *brahmana* advised him to go to Narmada. At least, that's what other Puranas say.

³⁷⁴ The text says Chidi. We have corrected it to Chedi.

³⁷⁵ Another Madhu.

³⁷⁶ Probably meaning Bhajamana, Mahabhoja, Vrishni and Devavidha.

³⁷⁷ That is, Upabahyaka. These bits are written in a very convoluted way. One shouldn't confuse the husband, Bahyaka, with the wives, Bahyaka and Upabahyaka.

³⁷⁸ Also known as Varnasha.

³⁷⁹ This probably means that they killed them in battle.

³⁸⁰ The text says Dhrishti. But there was no son named Dhrishti. Accordingly, we have corrected this to Vrishni.

³⁸¹ Satrajit.

³⁸² Without the blazing disc.

³⁸³ That is, you don't really need it.

³⁸⁴ Krishna decided that he was more suitable to possess it.

³⁸⁵ Krishna.

³⁸⁶ Krishna.

³⁸⁷ The third daughter was Prasvapini. Bhangakara married Satyabhama to Krishna.

³⁸⁸ There is an obvious inconsistency in the Brahmanda Purana. Satyabhama was Satrajit's daughter, not Bhangakara's daughter.

³⁸⁹ This concerns an incident from the Mahabharata. Duryodhana plotted to burn down the Pandavas in a house of lac in Varanavata. The Pandavas were presumed dead and Krishna went to Varanavata for the funeral rites.

³⁹⁰ Such as funeral rites.

³⁹¹ Balarama.

³⁹² Krishna.

³⁹³ Shatadhanva.

³⁹⁴ Shatadhanva's.

³⁹⁵ The person is Akrura. The idea is that the possession of Syamanataka enabled him to collect these materials.

³⁹⁶ Akrura's mother was Gandini. His father was Shvaphalka, descended from Babhru.

³⁹⁷ Balarama.

³⁹⁸ Because Akrura had left Dvaraka, with his fortunate Syamantaka.

³⁹⁹ Akrura's name. Literally, the lord of donations. Akrura was liberal in donating.

⁴⁰⁰ Indra.

⁴⁰¹ Meaning Kaccha, a marshy area, Kutch in Gujarat.

⁴⁰² He could wear it openly and no longer needed to conceal it.

⁴⁰³ The sun.

⁴⁰⁴ There is a sudden break. From the other Puranas, we know Yadu had a son named Kroshta. Kroshta had two wives, Gandhari and Madri. Gandhari's son was Anamitra.

⁴⁰⁵ Meaning, giver of a cow.

⁴⁰⁶ The names of Akrura's brothers.

⁴⁰⁷ That is, Koushalya. The text says Satyaka, which is an error. We have corrected it to Satvata. Seven names were given earlier. Here, it is four. It is impossible to sort out the inconsistency, unless one presumes it should be Satyaka. Even then, there is an inconsistency. However, this might be neither Satyaka nor Satvata, but Andhaka. However, that contradicts what is stated later.

⁴⁰⁸ Tumburu was a famous *gandharva*.

⁴⁰⁹ Abhijit.

⁴¹⁰ In the kingdom where Ahuka was the king.

⁴¹¹ The text says Ardraka's son. But this must mean Ahuka's son and we have corrected it.

⁴¹² In the list of Bhajamana's sons, this name has not been mentioned earlier.

⁴¹³ *Dundubhi* is a large drum, *anaka* is a kettledrum. Delighted, *devas* sounded these in the firmament, and he came to have the name of Anakadundubhi, though he is usually known as Vasudeva.

⁴¹⁴ Kuntibhoja was his friend and had no offspring. Adopted by Kuntibhoja, Prithaa was given the name of Kunti.

⁴¹⁵ *Atiratha* is a supreme warrior, surpassing a *maharatha*.

⁴¹⁶ He married Rajadhidevi.

⁴¹⁷ Ravana. The sage Vishrava was the son of the sage Pulastya. All of Visharva's sons are Vaishnavas. Vishrava's sons were Kubera, Ravana and Kumbhakarna. Here, Vaishnavana means Kubera.

⁴¹⁸ Not on an equal footing with the wives. If one adds these two minor wives, one has fourteen names. If one doesn't add them, one has twelve names.

⁴¹⁹ That is, Rohini.

⁴²⁰ Balarama.

⁴²¹ As stated, the text mixes up Balarama's offspring with those of Sarana. These should really be Sarana's sons.

⁴²² The text says Durdama. We have corrected it to Durdama.

⁴²³ Bhadraa has not been named earlier, though we had Bhadravaishakhi. Other Puranas do mention a wife known as Bhadraa. There is also a missing name. Therefore, Bhadravaishakhi is probably meant to be two different names, Bhadraa and Vaishakhi/Vaishali. Shouri means Shura's son, or more generally, anyone who is Shura's descendant. Here, Shouri means Vasudeva.

⁴²⁴ Here, Hari means Krishna.

⁴²⁵ As Aditi's son.

⁴²⁶ One of Vishnu's names.

⁴²⁷ Vishnu/Krishna bears the *srivatsa* mark (or curl) on his chest. This is the place where Shri/Lakshmi resides.

⁴²⁸ Kamsa had ousted his father, Ugrasena, as king. The *gopas* had come to Mathura to pay taxes to Kamsa.

⁴²⁹ Kamsa was only interested in killing the sons.

⁴³⁰ *Ekadashi* (the eleventh lunar day) is sacred to Vishnu and here, Ekadashaa is being used as one of Yogamaya's names.

⁴³¹ Implying Prakriti.

⁴³² Prithivi is the earth.

⁴³³ In a former life, Nanda used to be a Vasu named Drona and his wife was named Dharaa.

⁴³⁴ Since Krishna's wives are being listed, Rohini is an error. The names of Krishna's wives varies. But this should probably be Lakshmana.

⁴³⁵ Depending on the text, the number, and names, of *apsaras* varies.

⁴³⁶ Vishnu.

⁴³⁷ We haven't been told who Tumba was.

⁴³⁸ This isn't the Pandava Yudhishtira. Krishna had a son named Yudhishtira.

⁴³⁹ By deduction, this is a list of those who took birth as humans.

⁴⁴⁰ The word used is *tata*. While it means father, it is used to address anyone who is senior.

⁴⁴¹ Brahma.

⁴⁴² A reference to Vishnu's *vamana* (dwarf) *avatara* and his Trivikrama form.

⁴⁴³ A reference to Vishnu's Narasimha/Nrisimha (half-man, half-lion) *avatara*.

⁴⁴⁴ The subterranean fire of destruction, which is in the form of a mare's head (*vadavamukha*).

⁴⁴⁵ Brahma emerged from a lotus. A lotus has many names. The one used here is *pankaja*, born from mud. This explains the play on words.

⁴⁴⁶ Kalanemi was an *asura*, killed by Vishnu in the Tarakamaya battle. He was reborn as a *rakshasa* and was killed by Hanuman. He was reborn again as Kamsa.

⁴⁴⁷ Both Indra and Vishnu were born as Aditi's sons, Vishnu being younger to Indra. Scared, the *daitya* women miscarried.

⁴⁴⁸ Indra.

⁴⁴⁹ *Garhapatya* and *ahavaniya* are references to two of the fires. *Anvaharya* is a monthly *shraddha*, based on the *anvaharya* fire.

⁴⁵⁰ Water and vessel used for sprinkling.

⁴⁵¹ *Pavitra* is a ring of *kusha* grass that is worn, *paridhi* means *palasha* twigs that are laid around, *ashvamedha* is a horse sacrifice, *rajasuya* is a royal sacrifice. A *yajna* and a *kratu* are both sacrifices. However, the former is performed with a sacrificial post and the latter without one. More specifically, the former is performed with sacrificial animals and the latter without sacrificing animals.

⁴⁵² *Kshana* is a measurement of time, with differing interpretations. A second or an instant is accurate enough. *Muhurta* is forty-eight minutes. *Nimesha* is the twinkling of an eye, a minute. *Kalaa* is a small measure of time, but that measure is not consistently defined. A *kashtha* is 1/30th of a *kalaa*. The three periods of time mean the past, the present and the future.

Tithi is a lunar day, *masa* is a month, *dina* is a day, *samvatsara* is a year and *ritu* is a season

⁴⁵³ The three means the three *Vedas*. The text uses the word *pramana*. *Pramana* means proof and four kinds of proof are easy to identify—*pratyaksha* (perception), *anumana* (inference), *upamana* (comparison) and *shabda* (testimony). Of these four, three are being singled out.

⁴⁵⁴ Given the others, field (*kshetra*) probably means the physical body.

⁴⁵⁵ There is a listing of eighteen kinds of knowledge (*vidya*). The ones being singled out are probably *anvikshiki* (inquiry), *trayi* (the three *Vedas*), *varta* (Arthashastra) and *dandaniti* (policy for punishment).

⁴⁵⁶ This expression can be interpreted in different ways, cool, moist, pleasant. The word *soumya* also means blood, before it has turned red.

⁴⁵⁷ The word *ashma*, used in the text, means stone and refers to the foetus getting solidified.

⁴⁵⁸ *Vata*, *pitta* and *kapha* can be loosely translated as wind, bile and phlegm. In *Ayurveda*, these are the three *doshas* or humours in the body and they are always striving against each other.

⁴⁵⁹ As in the digestive fire.

⁴⁶⁰ The word used is *karkandhu*. This means the fruit of a jujube tree, but the word is also used for a foetus that is ten days old.

⁴⁶¹ *Prana* is the breath of life or the life-force. *Prana* draws breath into the body, *apana* exhales it. *Vyana* distributes it through the body and *samana* assimilates it. *Udana* gives rise to sound.

⁴⁶² At the time of Vishnu's *vamana* (dwarf) *avatara*.

⁴⁶³ Shanda and Marka were two demons.

⁴⁶⁴ Vishnu's *varaha* (boar) incarnation.

⁴⁶⁵ The three-eyed one, Shiva.

⁴⁶⁶ That is, they were killed.

⁴⁶⁷ *Dhvaja* means standard.

⁴⁶⁸ Indra.

⁴⁶⁹ Shukracharya cursed Bali because Bali did not listen to him.

⁴⁷⁰ The one who is blue in the throat, Shiva.

⁴⁷¹ Bhrigu's.

⁴⁷² Literally, the one in charge of the pit.

⁴⁷³ Bhrigu's wife, Kavyamataa.

⁴⁷⁴ Indra.

⁴⁷⁵ One with a dark throat. This also means, one with a white throat.

⁴⁷⁶ One who licks, such as when he destroys the worlds.

⁴⁷⁷ One who should be licked, as in *amrita*.

⁴⁷⁸ Presiding divinity of the year.

⁴⁷⁹ One with matted hair.

⁴⁸⁰ Haryaksha is one of Kubera's names. This can also be split up into two different names. Haryaksha, the tawny-eyed one, is one of Shiva's names. Varada, the one who bestows boons, is also one of Shiva's names. The name, as given in the text, is Haryakshavarada, which can be translated in either way.

⁴⁸¹ Violent one.

⁴⁸² The generous one.

⁴⁸³ The fire.

⁴⁸⁴ Both and are Shiva's names and one doesn't always pay attention to the difference in spelling. The former means one who lies down on a mountain. The latter, the one used in the text, means the lord of mountains.

⁴⁸⁵ Here, this means the radiant one.

⁴⁸⁶ The origin.

⁴⁸⁷ With the universe as form.

⁴⁸⁸ The fair one.

⁴⁸⁹ The auspicious one.

⁴⁹⁰ One who is everything.

⁴⁹¹ The most excellent one.

⁴⁹² Pinaka is the name of Shiva's bow. But his trident and staff are also called Pinaka.

⁴⁹³ One with a single foot, one of Shiva's forms/names.

⁴⁹⁴ One who assumed the form of a hunter of deer (at the time of Daksha's sacrifice).

⁴⁹⁵ The immobile one.

⁴⁹⁶ The tawny one.

⁴⁹⁷ The foremost hero.

⁴⁹⁸ One with three eyes.

⁴⁹⁹ Lord of habitations.

⁵⁰⁰ One who wields Pinaka.

⁵⁰¹ One who bestows the auspicious.

⁵⁰² One who has just been born, one of Shiva's names.

⁵⁰³ The benevolent one.

504 Vamadeva and Ishana are Shiva's forms.
505 The great precept.
506 Meaning the shining one.
507 One who wears a hide as a garment, specifically, an elephant's hide.
508 At the time of Daksha's sacrifice.
509 The subtle elements.
510 Shukracharya.
511 That Shukracharya hadn't returned.
512 Those for whom a sacrifice is performed.
513 This one is Brihaspati.
514 Brihaspati.
515 Referring to Shanda and Marka.
516 The *asuras*.
517 The listing, names and chronology of Vishnu's *avatars* varies from text to text. The reference to Chakshusha *manvantara* suggests Matsya (fish) *avatara*. Hence, Dharma's son should not be taken literally.
518 Prithu.
519 With Matsya accounted for, this means either Varaha or Kurma (tortoise), probably the former. The text means that the four *yugas* were over and Varaha emerged in that single mass of water, following the dissolution. Varaha *avatara* also killed Hiranayksha.
520 The second means the second of the brothers. Hiranyaksha and Hiranyakashipu were twins. Texts disagree on who was the elder of the two. Narasimha *avatara* killed Hiranyakashipu and protected his son, Prahlada.
521 Upendra is Vishnu's name, when he was born as Aditi's son and as Indra's younger brother.
522 Probably meaning Matsya, Varaha and Narasimha.
523 This probably means that Dattatreya's story is told in the Markandeya Purana.
524 Utathya taught Mandhata.
525 Jatukarna/Jatukarnya was the Vedavyasa of the twenty-seventh *dvapara yuga*.
526 Gargya was Krishna's teacher and Aditi and Kashyapa were born as Devaki and Vasudeva.
527 Sandipani taught Krishna and Balarama.
528 Killed by Balarama.
529 Chanura.

⁵³⁰ Jarasandha.

⁵³¹ Kalayavana.

⁵³² Yajnavalkya will be Kalki's preceptor. *Sandhya* is the intervening period between two *yugas*. Kalki will be born as a *brahmana*. *Sandhya* is the intervening period before a *yuga* and *sandhyamsha* the intervening period at the end of a *yuga*.

⁵³³ As King Pramiti or Pramati, descended in Bhrigu's lineage. This is described in *Matysa Purana*.

⁵³⁴ The one preceding the present *kalpa* of Varaha *kalpa*, Aghora *kalpa*.

⁵³⁵ While this means *shudra*, it also means outcast.

⁵³⁶ That is, he was not their biological father. They were the sons of a sage and Bali's wife.

⁵³⁷ Jiva is Brihaspati's name.

⁵³⁸ A long period (*dirgha*) of darkness (*tamas*). Dirghatamas was born blind.

⁵³⁹ Ushija's.

⁵⁴⁰ Surabhi is the divine cow and the mother of cattle.

⁵⁴¹ Ushija is being referred to as the uncle.

⁵⁴² *Darsha* means the day of the new moon.

⁵⁴³ Sharadvan, Utathya's son. Sharadvan was the son of Dirghatamas' brother, not the son of Dirghatamas.

⁵⁴⁴ That is, wife.

⁵⁴⁵ Based on *go* (cow) + *tamas* (darkness).

⁵⁴⁶ Bali will be Indra in the next *manvantara*.

⁵⁴⁷ Meaning, without an anus.

⁵⁴⁸ Jarasandha was Brihadratha's son and Sahadeva was Jarasandha's son.

⁵⁴⁹ Kusumpura, identified as Patna.

⁵⁵⁰ Inferior *kshatriyas*.

⁵⁵¹ The umbrella a sign of sovereignty.

⁵⁵² What is stated here does not of course correspond exactly with history. Bhadrasara means Bindusara. The succession from Bindusara to Ashoka wasn't clean. That's the reason the text says Ashoka and others, meaning, Ashoka and his brothers.

⁵⁵³ Kushala, or Kulala, means Kunala, who never actually became king.

⁵⁵⁴ Meaning Pushyamitra.

⁵⁵⁵ This sentence doesn't make any logical sense.

⁵⁵⁶ Clearly meaning Nandiyasha's lineage.

⁵⁵⁷ Implying an excess of women.

⁵⁵⁸ *Rashi* is a sign of the Zodiac. Tishya *nakshatra* is the same as Pushya.

⁵⁵⁹ Magha *nakshatra*.

⁵⁶⁰ 2700 years. Some of these *shlokas* are very difficult to understand and we have taken liberties.

⁵⁶¹ These two stars are Kratu and Pulaha, that is, Dubhe and Merak, the pointer stars. Since the *saptarshi* constellation straddles a wide space, how do we decide that it has reached a particular *nakshatra* and is in conjunction with it? That point is defined as the mid-point of Kratu and Pulaha.

⁵⁶² Presumably meaning Maru.

⁵⁶³ What's probably implied is the following. *Brahmanas* lead to the destruction of *kshatriyas*, and it is through *brahmanas* that a fresh round of *kshatriyas* starts.

⁵⁶⁴ That is, coins.

⁵⁶⁵ When this is being stated, it is actually *kali yuga* of the twenty-eighth. 71-28=43.

⁵⁶⁶ This completes the *third pada*, *upodghata pada*.

⁵⁶⁷ Towards the start of *Brahmanda Purana*, in the first volume, we were told of four *padas* or sections—*prakriya*, *anushanga*, *upodghata* and *upasamhara*. Three sections have been completed and we are now on the fourth. *Upasamhara* means conclusion. But here, the fourth *pada* is referred to as *samhara*, meaning destruction.

⁵⁶⁸ Manu, *saptarshis*, Gods and Indra vary from *manvantara* to *manvantara*.

⁵⁶⁹ Everything now being described concerns Savarni *manvantara*.

⁵⁷⁰ To refresh the memory, the future seven Manus are Savarni, Daksha-Savarni, Brahma-Savarni, Dharma-Savarni, Rudra-Savarni, Rouchya and Bhoutya. But these names are not consistently given and sometimes, Meru-Savarni figures in the list. As will become clear, the four with divine visions are Brahma-Savarni, Daksha-Savarni, Rudra-Savarni and Dharma-Savarni.

⁵⁷¹ Surya.

⁵⁷² Daksha's wife.

⁵⁷³ That is, Savarni *manvantara*.

⁵⁷⁴ In the list of future seven *manvantaras*, only Savarni *manvantara* has been described. Accordingly, this should be the ninth, not the tenth. Brahma-Savarni has been missed and this is a description of Dharma-Savarni.

⁵⁷⁵ That is, Kamagas.

⁵⁷⁶ These sections are not very clear, and liberties have been taken. Sudharmans are obviously the ones who are the best among *grahas* (planets). There are eleven *devas* in each category, aggregating to thirty-three.

⁵⁷⁷ This seems to be a meaningless sentence. Prajapati Ruchi was born through Brahma's mental powers, as was Pulaha.

⁵⁷⁸ *Shadaja, rishabha, gandhara, madhyama, panchama, dhaivata* and *nishada*.

⁵⁷⁹ *Gayatri, ushnih, anushtubh, brihati, pankti, trishtubh* and *jagati*, the seven metres used in the *Vedas*.

⁵⁸⁰ *Sthanins* are those who occupy fixed and permanent positions.

⁵⁸¹ The beginning of creation, meaning *ahamkara*. The four worlds, Bhuloka, Bhuhvarloka, Svarloka and Maharloka are destroyed.

⁵⁸² *Naimittika* dissolution (*pralaya*) occurs at the end of Brahma's day, *prakritika* at the end of Brahma's day (when everything dissolves into Prakriti) and *atyantika* when the *jivatman* merges into the *paramatman*. In addition, *nitya pralaya* is the daily destruction of beings.

⁵⁸³ A period of three hours.

⁵⁸⁴ The sun sucks up water, the vapour forms clouds and clouds shower down rain.

⁵⁸⁵ *Varsha* is a sub-division of a *dvipa*.

⁵⁸⁶ A reddish insect, sometimes identified with a firefly, also known as *shakragopa*.

⁵⁸⁷ From the root word *abhati*, meaning splendour/light. There are several etymological plays on words, such as *bhasma* (ashes) explaining the meaning of the word *ambhas*. We are skipping the details of these explanations.

⁵⁸⁸ Born from wombs, born from eggs, born from seeds and born from moisture.

⁵⁸⁹ As in, Time.

⁵⁹⁰ The primordial one.

⁵⁹¹ There are typos in the text that have been corrected. There is inconsistency in the repetition, probably because the text is referring to two different kinds of measurement.

⁵⁹² Since there are 900, saying more than 600 is odd.

⁵⁹³ We have expanded the translation to make the meaning clear. *Angula* is the length of a finger. *Masha* is just short of one gram.

⁵⁹⁴ *Savana* is a solar month with thirty days.

⁵⁹⁵ This should actually be 1,20,00,000 years.

⁵⁹⁶ This is usually stated as 4,32,00,00,000 years.

⁵⁹⁷ A *parardha* is half of Brahma's life. Brahma's lifespan is 100 years and fifty years amount to one *parardha*.

⁵⁹⁸ Without birth, Brahma's name.

⁵⁹⁹ Vayu's name.

⁶⁰⁰ Kritis can be understood in the sense of perfect worlds, these are the seven upper worlds. Akritis can be understood in the sense of imperfect worlds, these are the seven nether regions.

⁶⁰¹ They proceed to the three higher worlds.

⁶⁰² *Vyahriti* means the words *bhuh*, *bhuvah* and *svah*, uttered after OUM. An expanded *vyahriti* mentions all the seven worlds.

⁶⁰³ Lord of *bhutas* (anything that has come into existence).

⁶⁰⁴ From *janan*, meaning birth. Svayambhuva means Svayambhuva Manu.

⁶⁰⁵ *Tapas* means austerities, though the word has the nuance of scorching/heating, signifying purification, not captured by the word austerities.

⁶⁰⁶ The Pole Star.

⁶⁰⁷ This suggests that *devas* exist for ten *kalpas*.

⁶⁰⁸ The *akshara* OUM.

⁶⁰⁹ Past, present and future.

⁶¹⁰ Respectively, *eka*, *dasha*, *shata* and *sahasra*. As the powers of ten increase, the standard names are *eka*, *dasha*, *shata*, *sahasra*, *ayuta*, *laksha*, *niyuta*, *koti*, *arbuda*, *vrinda*, *kharva*, *nikharva*, *shankha*, *padma*, *sagara*, *antya*, *madhya* and *parardha*. There are differences between this listing and what has been stated in the text. Elsewhere, we have referred to *koti* as the more common crore.

⁶¹¹ *Parardha* is 10^{17} and *para* is 10^{18} .

⁶¹² *Krosha* is one-fourth of a *yojana*, the distance from which a shout can be heard.

⁶¹³ Literally, the tip of a hair.

⁶¹⁴ *Yuka* is a louse and *liksha* is a nit, the egg of a louse.

⁶¹⁵ A grain of barley.

⁶¹⁶ Shukra is Venus, while Lohita is the red one, Mars. Budha is Mercury. Brihaspati is Jupiter, while Shanaishchara (the slow moving one) is Saturn.

⁶¹⁷ Bhuloka, Bhuvvarloka and Svarloka.

⁶¹⁸ All these names mean something. We will give the relevant translations below, for the hells mentioned specifically. The names and numbering of hells varies across texts.

⁶¹⁹ Where sinners shriek in pain.

⁶²⁰ Where a sinner is seized by cruel entities.

⁶²¹ Where a sinner is eaten by pigs.

⁶²² A hell full of palm trees.

⁶²³ Full of pots of heated oil.

⁶²⁴ The great blaze.

⁶²⁵ Speckled, spotted.

⁶²⁶ Delusion.

⁶²⁷ Where there are worms like iron.

⁶²⁸ Where the sinner is devoured by worms.

⁶²⁹ Where sinners subsist on saliva.

⁶³⁰ Where sinners are incessantly reprimanded.

⁶³¹ Where sinners hang, heads facing downwards. Earning a living through *nakshatras* means the person is an astrologer.

⁶³² Where the sinner is borne along with pus/putrid matter.

⁶³³ Where a sinner becomes blind because of the blood.

⁶³⁴ Where sinners eat excrement. A *pankti* is a row. When guests sit down to eat, those belonging to the same category are seated in the same *pankti*.

⁶³⁵ Full of urine.

⁶³⁶ A terrible river that flows in the nether regions.

⁶³⁷ The dark hell.

⁶³⁸ With a forest, where the trees have leaves that are like swords.

⁶³⁹ Blazing fire. Shyama and Shabala are the names of Yama's dogs.

⁶⁴⁰ Where sinners are stung and bitten. *Ishta* is a sacrifice, *purti* is civic works and *vrata* is a vow.

⁶⁴¹ Where sinners are eaten by dogs.

⁶⁴² Blinding darkness.

⁶⁴³ One that is very cold.

⁶⁴⁴ The noose of time/destiny.

⁶⁴⁵ Where one lacks establishment.

⁶⁴⁶ Full of waves.

⁶⁴⁷ Iron.

⁶⁴⁸ Full of adversity.

⁶⁴⁹ Lokaloka can be interpreted in various ways, places where is light versus places where there is darkness, populated places versus uninhabited regions, and so on.

⁶⁵⁰ We can take Bhuta, Bhavya and Bhava as the past, the future and the present, or as Bhuloka, Bhuvarloka and Svarloka.

⁶⁵¹ 60,000 sages who were the sizes of thumbs. They preceded the sun's chariot.

⁶⁵² The one who knows the *kshetra* (field or physical body), used both for the *paramatman* and the *jivatman*.

⁶⁵³ The supreme lord.

⁶⁵⁴ Probably meaning the eight *siddhis*.

⁶⁵⁵ The five elements, *bhutadi* and Mahat.

⁶⁵⁶ Mahat is the primordial principle, while Vishesha is the specific and the individual. Throughout this chapter, some *shlokas* are terse and cryptic. We have taken liberties in the translation.

⁶⁵⁷ Principles.

⁶⁵⁸ The visible universe.

⁶⁵⁹ Respectively, *sarga* and *pratisarga*.

⁶⁶⁰ We have translated *avidya* as lack of knowledge or ignorance. *Avidya* leads to the three bonds. Bondage based on lack of skills means that which is based on lack of discrimination.

⁶⁶¹ Probably meaning animals, birds, reptiles, plants, *bhutas* and *pishachas*. As stated, the three causes seem to be *ajnana*, attachment and thirst.

⁶⁶² The subtle body.

⁶⁶³ Probably meaning the five sense, the mind, intelligence and *ahamkara*.

⁶⁶⁴ Presumably meaning *devas*, *danavas*, ancestors, *rakshasas*, *yakshas*, *sarpas*, *bhutas* and *gandharvas*.

⁶⁶⁵ Born as different kinds of species, superior, middling and inferior.

⁶⁶⁶ Respectively, living being, breath of life, subtle body and the one who acts.

⁶⁶⁷ A living being has four states—waking, dreaming, sleeping and *turiya*. *Turiya* is the fourth state, when one perceives union between the *jivatman* and the *paramatman*.

⁶⁶⁸ The word *kshetra* is being derived from *kshara* (perishable) and from *trayate* (to save).

⁶⁶⁹ The *jivatman*.

⁶⁷⁰ Derived from *pura* (city), standing for the body.

⁶⁷¹ Purusha and Prakriti.

⁶⁷² Pradhana is the principal cause behind creation, it can be interpreted as the cause, while Prakriti is the effect. Pradhana can also be understood as intelligence.

⁶⁷³ Souti means Suta's son. Suta was himself the son of a *suta*, so there is no contradiction.

⁶⁷⁴ The tone of this chapter suggests that this was the end of the *Brahmanda Purana*, with anything that follows being added subsequently.

⁶⁷⁵ The word used in the text is *abhimana*, pride. But it seems to us that this is intended in the sense of *ahamkara*.

⁶⁷⁶ Five senses of perception, five organs of action, five gross elements, five subtle elements, intelligence, mind, *ahamkara* and Prakriti account for twenty-four, according to the principles of *samkhya*. As with the previous chapter, some *shlokas* in this chapter are obscure and we have taken liberties.

⁶⁷⁷ It is not clear who is saying this. Perhaps Suta continued to speak.

⁶⁷⁸ Shakti was Parashara's father.

⁶⁷⁹ As has been mentioned earlier, the core of the *Brahmanda Purana* is over. These sections don't quite belong and have clearly been added later.

⁶⁸⁰ Lalitaa's account.

⁶⁸¹ Interpreted as the third of the *purusharthas*, *kama*.

⁶⁸² This is the Ekambareswarar temple in Kanchipuram. The Kamakshi temple, also known as the Lalitaa or Tripurasundari temple, is also in Kanchipuram.

⁶⁸³ Hayagriva means with the face of a horse. This is one of Vishnu's *avatars* and there is a Hayagriva temple in Kanchipuram.

⁶⁸⁴ Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva.

⁶⁸⁵ Lord who is half male and half female.

⁶⁸⁶ The name of Vishnu's bow, made of horn.

⁶⁸⁷ Agastya was born from a pot.

⁶⁸⁸ This form was that of Mohini.

⁶⁸⁹ Manmatha/Kama is the God of love, who was burned down by Shiva.

⁶⁹⁰ Other than the wife.

⁶⁹¹ The sentence sounds incomplete. This is the progressive severity, in diminishing order, of sin from killing these.

⁶⁹² There are problems with the text, rendering meanings unclear.

⁶⁹³ The fourteen types of creatures are *siddhas*, *guhyakas*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *rakshasas*, *pannagas*, *vidyadharas*, *pishachas*, humans, reptiles, monkeys, wild animals, domestic animals and birds.

⁶⁹⁴ *Antyaja* can loosely be translated as outcaste. Literally, it means someone who is born in the extremities (of the main habitation).

⁶⁹⁵ A hunter.

⁶⁹⁶ Mountain-dwellers.

⁶⁹⁷ The east.

⁶⁹⁸ This should probably be Devavratapura.

⁶⁹⁹ Literally, *Shatarudriya* means one hundred Rudras and is a *mantra* to Rudra, from the *Yajur Veda*.

⁷⁰⁰ A specific *mantra* for worshipping Rudra. Often specifically used for the *mantra* from *Vajasaneyi Samhita*.

⁷⁰¹ *Asava* is liquor, specifically, that which is distilled.

⁷⁰² Respectively made from rice, palm, coconut, *madhuka* flowers and molasses.

⁷⁰³ Suggesting that *paishtika* and *talaja* are prohibited for them.

⁷⁰⁴ Since *dvija* refers to the first three *varnas*, there should have been only three numbers.

⁷⁰⁵ *Chandrayana* is a kind of fasting that follows the progress (*ayana*) of the moon (*chandra*). On the full moon night, one only eats fifteen mouthfuls of food. For the fifteen lunar days following the full moon, this is decreased by one mouthful per day. For the fifteen lunar days following the new moon, this is increased by one mouthful per day.

⁷⁰⁶ Mother Goddesses. Bhairava is not a Shakti. So Bhairava should probably read Vaishnavi and Mahashastri should probably read Maheshvari.

⁷⁰⁷ The number of days when he has drunk liquor.

⁷⁰⁸ Obviously other than the wife.

⁷⁰⁹ An unchaste woman.

⁷¹⁰ *Chakri* is a potter, *kaivarta* is a fisherman and *karmakara* is an artisan.

⁷¹¹ A *dasi* is a servant-maid. In this context, *devadasi* is *dasi* to a *deva*, while *brahmadasi* is *dasi* to a *brahmana*. *Svatantra* is one who is independent (serving whoever she wills), while *shudradasi* is a *dasi* who is a *shudra*.

⁷¹² A rite of atonement. Eating only once in the morning for three days, eating only once in the night for three succeeding days, subsisting on alms for three more days and finally, fasting for three days.

⁷¹³ From the other man.

⁷¹⁴ The God of love, Kama.

⁷¹⁵ *Pravritti* is attachment to action and consequent fruits. *Nivritti* is detachment from fruits and renunciation of action.

⁷¹⁶ The five senses, the five objects of the senses, the five organs of action, the five elements, mind, intelligence, ego and consciousness. These are twenty-four *tattvas* (principles) of *Samkhya*, with Prakriti as the twenty-fifth. When consciousness is not separately listed, Prakriti is the twenty-fourth and Purusha is the twenty-fifth.

⁷¹⁷ The *panchadasi mantra*, consisting of fifteen *aksharas*, each of which is a *bija*. *Bija* means seed and is a mystic *akshara* (syllable). There are various versions of the *panchadasi mantra*, one of which is

⁷¹⁸ This has several meanings, but probably refers to a medicinal seed, *Echites antidysenterica*.

⁷¹⁹ A kind of gourd.

⁷²⁰ Red gourd.

⁷²¹ A kind of mushroom.

⁷²² A kind of perfume.

⁷²³ Impossible to identify this.

⁷²⁴ *Gavya* is a product prepared from a cow's milk. The five sacred products from a cow (*panchagavya*) are milk, curds, *ghee*, cow-dung and cow's urine. Since *gavya* is used for food here, one means cow's milk, *ghee*, curds and buttermilk.

⁷²⁵ Feminine of *brahmana*.

⁷²⁶ A *bruva* is a person who proclaims himself to be a *brahmana*, without actually being so.

⁷²⁷ This is the *mantra* in *Atharva Veda* 6.115.2-3, a prayer for forgiving sins. 'Let the water sanctified by this *mantra* cleanse me from sins' and so on.

⁷²⁸ The '*idam Vishnu*' *mantra* is from *Rig Veda* 1.22.17. 'With his three strides, Vishnu crossed over the worlds' and so on. '*Tryambaka mantra*' is from *Rig Veda* 7.59.12. 'We worship Tryambaka, who brings prosperity' and so on.

⁷²⁹ This is the famous *mantra* from *Brihadaranyaka Upanishad* 1.3.28.

It is so familiar that it requires no translation. Loosely, ‘Lead me from falsehood to the truth, from darkness to illumination and from death to immortality.’

⁷³⁰ ‘*Anna suktam*’ is *Rig Veda* 1.187.1-11. It is a praise of food.

‘Bhrigurvai Varuni’ is from *Taittiriya Upanishad* 3.1.1. Bhrigu, Varuna’s son, approaches his father and asks him to teach him about the *brahman*.

⁷³¹ *Bhagavat Gita* 4.24, stating that offerings, oblations, the ladle, the sacrificial fire and the act of offering are all the *brahman*.

⁷³² This is inconsistent with other accounts, where Diti and Danu were Daksha’s daughters and became Kashyapa’s wives.

⁷³³ Shukracharya.

⁷³⁴ Indra’s assembly-hall, the assembly-hall of *devas*.

⁷³⁵ Land where *karma* is undertaken, a word used for Bharatavarsha.

⁷³⁶ Vishvarupa had three heads and was known as Trishira.

⁷³⁷ Both Vishnu and Brahma are being referred to as sages.

⁷³⁸ This is probably a reference to Indra asking Kama to disturb Shiva.

⁷³⁹ The fire.

⁷⁴⁰ Indra's name. Indra has tawny horses.

⁷⁴¹ Vishnu.

⁷⁴² Vishnu.

⁷⁴³ Vasuki.

⁷⁴⁴ In one form, Vishnu was the base, in his *kurma* (tortoise) *avatara*. In another form, Vishnu (Madhava) was amidst the Gods. In yet another form, he was amidst the *daityas*.

⁷⁴⁵ As Narayana.

⁷⁴⁶ Goddess of the liquor named *varuni*, the embodied form of that liquor.

⁷⁴⁷ Those who did not accept *sura* (liquor). Gods became *suras*.

⁷⁴⁸ The etymology of the word *apsara* means that they arose from the water.

⁷⁴⁹ The moon.

⁷⁵⁰ Water-pot.

⁷⁵¹ Lakshmi, Goddess of wealth and prosperity, also known as Ramaa (the one who causes delight).

⁷⁵² The hymn of praise from the appendices (*khila* part) of the *Rig Veda*.

⁷⁵³ There are four/eight elephants that dwell in the four/eight directions. These are known as *diggajas*, the elephant (*gaja*) for a direction (*dik*). The number mentioned depends on whether one is listing four or eight directions.

⁷⁵⁴ Shri.

⁷⁵⁵ *Rasa* means taste. But in this context, it means the emotional flavor, or state of mind. Eight (or nine) *rasas* are described—*shringara* (romance), *hasya* (laughter), *raudra* (fury), *karuna* (compassion), *bibhatsa* (disgusting), *bhayanaka* (terrible), *vira* (heroic), *adbhuta* (extraordinary) and *shanta* (peace). *Nayikaa* is difficult to translate, leader/heroine is the closest.

⁷⁵⁶ Saimhikeya, that is, Rahu. The body-less head is believed to be Rahu and the head-less torso is believed to be Ketu.

⁷⁵⁷ *Champaka* is a tree with yellow and fragrant flowers.

⁷⁵⁸ *Saraca Indica*.

⁷⁵⁹ The trumpet flower.

⁷⁶⁰ *Tamala* is a tree with a dark bark, *tala* is palm and *hintala* is a specific variety of palm.

⁷⁶¹ *Santana* is a celestial tree that grows in Indra's garden. Since *santana* also means offspring, there is a play on words.

⁷⁶² The three folds above the navel, a mark of beauty.

⁷⁶³ *Acacia sirissa*.

⁷⁶⁴ *Ketaki* is the fragrant crepe myrtle or caldera.

⁷⁶⁵ *Tilaka* is the mark made on the forehead, *kasturi* is musk.

⁷⁶⁶ Vermilion.

⁷⁶⁷ Meaning Agastya, who made Mount Vindhya lower his head.

Agastya's wife was Lopamudra.

⁷⁶⁸ Kailasa.

⁷⁶⁹ Class of *devas*.

⁷⁷⁰ Vishnu.

⁷⁷¹ Probably meaning that the first two were Shri and Mohini.

⁷⁷² Daksha's daughter, Sati.

⁷⁷³ So that Parvati could serve Shiva while he was practicing austerities.

⁷⁷⁴ Brahma is now speaking to Kama, though sometimes, he seems to be quoting what Vishnu told Kama. Manmatha is one of Kama's names, as is Smara.

⁷⁷⁵ Brahma.

⁷⁷⁶ The mountain's daughter, Parvati.

⁷⁷⁷ The one with a *makara* on his banner, Kama.

⁷⁷⁸ *Bhanda* means happy and prosperous. Brahma blessed him that he would be this.

⁷⁷⁹ Shiva disappeared.

⁷⁸⁰ That is, Shukracharya.

⁷⁸¹ Geographically identified with different places.

⁷⁸² Either Hiranyaksha or Hiranyakashipu.

⁷⁸³ Implying they would have to wait until his time was over.

⁷⁸⁴ *Mimamsa darshana* is the philosophical school on critical investigation.

⁷⁸⁵ Vishnu, Kamalaa is Lakshmi.

⁷⁸⁶ Literally, Indra's plain. Clearly, this couldn't have been in today's Delhi.

⁷⁸⁷ Narada.

⁷⁸⁸ Their fear might have led them to abandon their rites. But since the word freed is used, it probably means there was no longer any need for them to practice rites.

⁷⁸⁹ *Mahamasa* is a kind of bean, *Dolichos catjang*. This is the word used in text. From what follows, it is clear that this should be *mahamamsa* and we have corrected the typo. *Mahamamsa* means expensive flesh, specifically, human flesh. *Devas* offered flesh from their own bodies as oblations.

⁷⁹⁰ The China rose.

⁷⁹¹ Among the many hymns listing Devi's names, one of the most famous is *Lalita Sahasranama*, the one thousand names of Lalitaa. Contrary to popular impression, this is a later text and is not part of *Brahmanda Purana*. This praise, from the *Brahmanda Purana*, doesn't have one thousand names. It has more like two hundred, though we have translated some into English and sometimes, it is difficult to distinguish adjectives from proper names. If one regards this entire prayer as a *mantra*, there are roughly one thousand *aksharas* in the *mantra*.

⁷⁹² Shrikantha is the one with the beautiful throat, that is, Shiva.

⁷⁹³ Flowers in the hair.

⁷⁹⁴ The Goddess of speech.

⁷⁹⁵ A *yantra* is a mystical geometric diagram, used extensively in *tantra*. A *mandala* is also a mystical diagram, with a *yantra* typically smaller than a *mandala*.

⁷⁹⁶ Shambhavi has several meanings. Naturally, Shambhu (Shiva) and Shambhavi go together. But Shambhavi also means possibility and is the hole in the crown of the head, through which, emancipation is achieved. Thus, Shambhavi represents the possibility of liberation from this world. Shambhavi also means *sushumna nadi*.

⁷⁹⁷ Garuda.

⁷⁹⁸ Divinities who protected *kshetras*, Shiva's attendants.

⁷⁹⁹ Semi-divine species, *ganas*, Shiva's companions, sometimes evil spirits.

⁸⁰⁰ Nine (*nava*) jewels (*ratna*) usually listed as ruby, pearl, red coral, emerald, yellow sapphire, diamond, blue sapphire, hessonite and cat's eye. But this list is not uniform.

⁸⁰¹ A gem that bestows everything desired.

⁸⁰² Kandarpa is Kama, the God of love.

⁸⁰³ Kama/Smara was reduced to ashes by Shiva.

⁸⁰⁴ In general, there are eight kinds of marriage—*brahma*, *daiva*, *arsha*, *prajapatya*, *gandharva*, *asura*, *rakshasa* and *paishacha*. The taxonomy given here is different, though *svayamyuta* corresponds to *gandharva* and *pitridatta* corresponds to *brahma*. *Kalakrita* is when a bride is bought for a fixed period of time. *Krayakrita* is when the bride is bought as a servant. *Yukta* means someone who has been united. *Bharya* means wife and has the connotation of someone who is supported and cherished.

⁸⁰⁵ Reservoir of jewels, the ocean.

⁸⁰⁶ This can mean grain of any kind. But it is specifically used for threshed and winnowed rice that has not been dehusked.

⁸⁰⁷ Waving of lights, the same as *niranjana*.

⁸⁰⁸ Both derived from *kama* (desire).

⁸⁰⁹ *Kalpavriksha* is a tree that grants everything desired, *kamadhenu* is a cow that grants everything desired and Kamalaa means Lakshmi.

⁸¹⁰ A war-drum.

⁸¹¹ *Atuku* and *lingana* might be typos.

⁸¹² Some of these are unknown names and the possibility of typos always exists.

⁸¹³ The same as Sampatkari.

⁸¹⁴ Trot, canter, gallop, move swiftly and leap.

⁸¹⁵ We have translated the Sanskrit terms literally. Texts described auspicious traits of horses (*ashva lakshana*).

⁸¹⁶ *Humkara* means to utter the sound ‘*hum*’, a sound believed to possess special powers.

⁸¹⁷ The leader of the forces. She was also known as Potrini or Potrimukhi. While *potri* means boar, it also means snout and an officiating priest. Thus, translation of Potrimukhi as boar-faced isn’t obvious. It might mean someone whose mouth was like a snout. However, there is a mention of boar-faced later.

⁸¹⁸ With a roar like thunder.

⁸¹⁹ Vishnu in his *kurma* (tortoise) *avatara*.

⁸²⁰ The same as Dandanathaa.

⁸²¹ The lord of *mantras*, also known as Mantrini. Mantranayikaa is the same as Mantranathaa.

⁸²² *Kadamba* is *stephegyne parvifolia*.

⁸²³ The personified form of *dhanurveda*.

⁸²⁴ The same as Shyamaa, literally, as dark as a cloud.

⁸²⁵ Sangitayogini.

⁸²⁶ Indra.

⁸²⁷ The numbering doesn't exist in the text. We have added it.

⁸²⁸ The chariot, referred to as Shrichakra earlier.

⁸²⁹ Other than in the forms just described.

⁸³⁰ The word *gupta* means secret/concealed. The seats of these sixteen Gupta Shaktis are hidden and secret. They are also known as Nitya Shaktis, the word *nitya* meaning eternal. These sixteen correspond to the sixteen digits (*kalaas*) of the moon.

⁸³¹ The same as Chakraraja and Shrichakra.

⁸³² Citron.

⁸³³ Corresponding to the fifteen *tithis* (lunar days).

⁸³⁴ The same as Mantranathaa's.

⁸³⁵ The same as Gitichakra.

⁸³⁶ *Butea frondosa*.

⁸³⁷ *Bhushundis* are catapults. *Shatagnis* are weapons that can kill one hundred at one blow.

⁸³⁸ *Nidhis* are divinities of treasures. Kubera possesses nine *nidhis*—Padma, Mahapadma, Makara, Kacchapa, Kumuda, Shankha, Nila, Nandana and Kharva.

⁸³⁹ The text says *vajra*. But since *vajra* has already been mentioned, we have changed this to *chakra*.

⁸⁴⁰ The chariot (*ratha*) named Kirichakra, Dandanathaa's chariot.

⁸⁴¹ The number, names and order of *matrikas* varies. In the intended list here, not stated, there are eight *matrikas*, with Varahi as the fifth and Chandikaa (Mahalakshmi) as the eighth. They are not on this layer, since they are elsewhere. The other six are probably Brahmi, Maheshvari, Koumari, Vaishnavi, Aindri and Chamundaa.

⁸⁴² The word used is *chakra*, translated as circle. But since these sections are influenced by *tantra*, the word *chakra* may be an allusion to *chakra*, understood as a centre of energy within the body.

⁸⁴³ The seven constituents of the body. They drank these up from the bodies of the enemy.

⁸⁴⁴ From Hayagriva's opening statement in this chapter, one might form the impression that Kirichakra possessed five layers. It actually possessed

seven layers and initially, the first five layers were described. However, nothing is said about the fifth layer, nor about the seventh layer.

⁸⁴⁵ The *gandharva*.

⁸⁴⁶ Lalitaa.

⁸⁴⁷ Dandanathaa's.

⁸⁴⁸ Vayu's mount is a gazelle and the gazelle's exploits are relatively inferior to those of the black antelope.

⁸⁴⁹ Achala.

⁸⁵⁰ Dandanathaa's.

⁸⁵¹ Kirichakra.

⁸⁵² Geyachakra.

⁸⁵³ Chakraraja, Kirichakra and Geyachakra.

⁸⁵⁴ Lalitaa's.

⁸⁵⁵ *Sarvatobhadra* is a building that is auspicious on every side, usually in the form of a circle or a square, or with one enclosed within the other. *Nandyavarta* is a building in the form of a quadrangle, without a gate on the west. *Vicchandaka* has multiple storeys. *Svastika* means a temple or mansion with a terrace.

⁸⁵⁶ The six methods used by a king are alliances, war, marching, halting, strategies and seeking aid from friendly kings.

⁸⁵⁷ Vishnu's Narasimha/Nrisimha (half-man, half-lion) *avatara*.

⁸⁵⁸ Mahishasura. These incidents are described in various places, including the *Markandeya Purana*.

⁸⁵⁹ *Lalita* means gentle and soft, beautiful and charming.

⁸⁶⁰ Implements that could discharge missiles and weapons, like slings and catapults.

⁸⁶¹ Magical *mantras* used for malevolent purposes.

⁸⁶² Vishnu as Narasimha.

⁸⁶³ Identified as Adam's Peak in Sri Lanka.

⁸⁶⁴ *Bhiduras*.

⁸⁶⁵ A weapon difficult to identify, something used to strike.

⁸⁶⁶ *Valalas* and *khandalas* are unidentified weapons.

⁸⁶⁷ *Bherunda* is an awful bird.

⁸⁶⁸ Meaning Durmada.

⁸⁶⁹ That is, Sampatkari. She saw that Durmada was advancing.

⁸⁷⁰ Throughout, we have translated a *shilimukha* arrow as an arrow whetted on stone. It can also mean an arrow with a head made from stone.

⁸⁷¹ Sampatkari.

⁸⁷² The *daityas*.

⁸⁷³ Sampatkari.

⁸⁷⁴ Chandi. *Aparajita* means the unvanquished one.

⁸⁷⁵ Turanganaa.

⁸⁷⁶ Literally, one who writhes and slithers ahead. This was a demoness.

⁸⁷⁷ Daksha's daughter and Kashyapa's wife, the mother of serpents.

⁸⁷⁸ Feminine of *rakshasa*.

⁸⁷⁹ Famous *nagas*.

⁸⁸⁰ Names of different kinds of poisons. *Darada* is one that causes terror and resembles quicksilver; *vatsanabha* is derived from aconite; *kalakuta* is the terrible poison that arose from the churning of the ocean, though this is also known as *halahala*; *sourashtra* was probably made through a chemical process; *brahmaputra* is a vegetable poison; and *shouklikeya* (*shoulkikeya*) was a poison produced in the region of Shulkika (or something produced from fish and meat).

⁸⁸¹ The text says Karindra. We have amended it.

⁸⁸² Nakuli means female mongoose, in this case, a form of Devi. Also known as Nakuleshvari.

⁸⁸³ Garuda.

⁸⁸⁴ Meaning Bhandasura.

⁸⁸⁵ Therefore, identified with Sarasvati.

⁸⁸⁶ One of the five generals, not named earlier.

⁸⁸⁷ Shyamalaa. Also, Shyamambikaa.

⁸⁸⁸ At having escaped with their lives.

⁸⁸⁹ The text says Kujalasha. We have changed it.

⁸⁹⁰ Of these, *nihsanas* and *tampottas* may not have been drums. They may have been other musical instruments. *Bheri* is a large drum, while *anaka* is a smaller one. *Bheri* sometimes means a trumpet, but here, it seems to mean a drum.

⁸⁹¹ Entering the universe is probably meant to signify that they were about to die.

⁸⁹² The text in these sections seems corrupt and we have taken some liberties.

⁸⁹³ At the time of destruction, seven terrible clouds appear. One of these is named *balahaka*.

⁸⁹⁴ *Pushkala* and *avarta* are two different types of clouds.

895 Referred to as Karalayu earlier.
896 The one who scorches. Surya's name.
897 A plant, *Piper cubeba*.
898 Tiraskaranikaa. Ambaa means mother.
899 The one that blinds.
900 The Shaktis.
901 *Tiraskara* means to abuse and reproach.
902 That is, killed them.
903 That is, Vishukra.
904 Bhandasura.
905 This should read Madana/Madanaka. Kaklivahana should probably be Kalkivahana and Kaklasa should probably be Kalkasa or Karkasha.
906 The text says Nishanga. We have corrected it.
907 To support the forces at the rear. Kutilaksha attacked from the front.
908 Literally, residing in fire and garlanded in flames.
909 At the time of the churning of the ocean.
910 A *yama* is a period of three hours. A night consists of three *yamas* and is known as *yamini*.
911 Referred to as Halamulluncha earlier.
912 The same as Vahnivasini.
913 The text says Puklasa.
914 Referred to as Trikantaka earlier.
915 Referred to as Chaturgupta earlier.
916 In *sashtanga pranama*.
917 Otherwise, we would have killed him.
918 Lalitaa.
919 Chakraraja.
920 Sampadishvari.
921 The text says Yotrini. We have changed it.
922 Twenty-two names are mentioned. The other eight, as mentioned earlier, were Andhaka, Sindhunetra, Kupaka, Kupalochana, Guhaksha, Gandagalla, Chandadharma and Yamantaka.
923 Varuna.
924 That is, they were the best.
925 Waving lights as a mark of worship.
926 Mother Balaa. Balaa is also known as Kumarikaa.
927 For fighting.

⁹²⁸ A *yantra* is a mysitical diagram. This will be inscribed in the enemy's camp, so that there are impediments (*vighna*) when the enemy seeks victory (*jaya*).

⁹²⁹ Death/destruction.

⁹³⁰ Literally, Lazy, Niggardly, Dejected, Inattentive, Sleepy, Eunuch and Lacking in Pride. Only seven have been named.

⁹³¹ Citrus fruit.

⁹³² Ganesha is Vighnesha, the one who destroys impediments. He is the leader of *ganas* and Gananatha and Ganapati mean that. Gajanana means one with the face of an elephant.

⁹³³ Ganesha created them. Vighnanayaka means leader of those who create impediments. Heramba is also one of Ganesha's names.

⁹³⁴ Vishukra.

⁹³⁵ An *asura* in the form of an elephant (*gaja*). Gajadaitya is another name for Gajasura.

⁹³⁶ Gananatha's.

⁹³⁷ The same as Geyachakra.

⁹³⁸ Mantrini.

⁹³⁹ Meaning Kama's five arrows.

⁹⁴⁰ Sampadishvari. The names of Ulukajit's brothers are mentioned here, but the total adds up to nine, not ten.

⁹⁴¹ A weapon that leads to thirst.

⁹⁴² Dandanathaa.

⁹⁴³ Another name for the *tamala* tree.

⁹⁴⁴ The one who resides in a *kadamba* forest.

⁹⁴⁵ While all this was going on, there was a break in the battle.

⁹⁴⁶ Different kinds of liquor are described. *Goudi* is distilled from molasses, *paishti* is fermented and made from ground flour, *madhvi* is sweet and is distilled from grape juice, *kadambari* is made from *kadamba* flowers, *haitali* (it should read *haintali*) is made from *hintala*, *langaleya* is made from *langala* (a kind of palm), *talajata* is made from palm, *bakula* is *Mimusops elengi*.

⁹⁴⁷ Airavata is Indra's elephant.

⁹⁴⁸ Prosperity.

⁹⁴⁹ Probably meaning Parashurama.

⁹⁵⁰ The one mounted on a horse. Since Ashvarudha means the same thing, Turagarohini must mean Ashvarudha.

⁹⁵¹ *Sankranti* is the movement of the sun from one sign of the zodiac (*rashi*) to another. Thus, there are twelve of these. The entry of Surya into Capricorn, with the movement from *dakshinayana* to *uttarayana*, is known as *makara sankranti*, while its entry into Cancer, with the movement from *uttarayana* to *dakshinayana*, is known as *karka sankranti*. The entry into Aries and Libra is known as *vishuva sankranti*. *Parva* is an auspicious day and the five are *purnima* (night of the full moon), *amavasya* (night of the new moon), *sankranti*, *ashtami* (eighth lunar *tithi*) and *chaturdashi* (fourteenth lunar *tithi*).

⁹⁵² The discrepancy in numbers is probably because five remained at the eastern gate.

⁹⁵³ *Chandrasahsa* (literally, the moon smiling) is a glittering sword, shaped like a crescent at the tip. Scimitar is a bad translation. Ghataka is one who kills.

⁹⁵⁴ Same as *diggajas*.

⁹⁵⁵ Antelopes as swift as the wind.

⁹⁵⁶ Blinding darkness.

⁹⁵⁷ The great ship, the sun.

⁹⁵⁸ Weapon of heresy.

⁹⁵⁹ Weapon of blindness.

⁹⁶⁰ Weapon that bestows sight.

⁹⁶¹ Destructive of Shaktis.

⁹⁶² Weapon that destroys.

⁹⁶³ The great weapon that conquers death.

⁹⁶⁴ Weapon that destroys memory of all weapons.

⁹⁶⁵ Weapon that causes fear.

⁹⁶⁶ Weapon that causes great diseases.

⁹⁶⁷ Achyuta, Ananta and Govinda, Vishnu's three names.

⁹⁶⁸ Destructive of a long life.

⁹⁶⁹ Weapon that drags away death.

⁹⁷⁰ Weapon that creates giant *asuras*.

⁹⁷¹ This should be Chikshura.

⁹⁷² Shiva.

⁹⁷³ Vishnu.

⁹⁷⁴ Agni.

⁹⁷⁵ Vayu.

⁹⁷⁶ Kubera.

⁹⁷⁷ Varuna.

⁹⁷⁸ Death.

⁹⁷⁹ *Durgaa Saptashati* or the *Devi Mahatmya* section of the *Markandeya Purana*.

⁹⁸⁰ Weapon that leads to dumbness.

⁹⁸¹ Great and eloquent speech.

⁹⁸² Weapon in the form of the ocean.

⁹⁸³ As should be obvious, this narration mirrors Vishnu's *avatars*.

⁹⁸⁴ That is, Hiranyakashipu.

⁹⁸⁵ Bali, the Indra.

⁹⁸⁶ This means Kartavirya Arjuna, the Haihaya king, who was killed by Parashurama.

⁹⁸⁷ Pulastya's descendant, Ravana.

⁹⁸⁸ Dvidida was an *asura* killed by Balarama.

⁹⁸⁹ Vishnu has four manifestations (*vyuha*) as Vasudeva, Samkarshana, Pradyumna and Aniruddha.

⁹⁹⁰ Weapon that leads to the effects of *kali yuga*.

⁹⁹¹ The great delusion.

⁹⁹² Shambhu's (Shiva's) weapon.

⁹⁹³ Asta is the mountain behind which, the sun sets. The sun rises from Mount Udaya.

⁹⁹⁴ The singular Rudra means Shiva, while the plural means the other Rudras.

⁹⁹⁵ One with beautiful hair.

⁹⁹⁶ As in centres of energy in the body.

⁹⁹⁷ When associated with the body, these six are interpreted as grief, delusion, old age, death, hunger and thirst.

⁹⁹⁸ Interpreted as the four types of living beings, ignorance and the *paramatman*.

⁹⁹⁹ The desired one. Kamini has the same meaning.

¹⁰⁰⁰ Devi is worshipped in sheaths (*avaranas*). There are fourteen *mudras* (Shaktis) in the fourth *avarana*, Sarva-Samkshobhini being the first.

¹⁰⁰¹ The omniscient one, meaning Shiva.

¹⁰⁰² *Vashini* is the capacity to subjugate others.

¹⁰⁰³ *Bindu* is the dot in a mystical diagram. An expression like OUM, in addition to the three *aksharas* that are pronounced, has *nada* (sound) and *bindu* (the nasal sound that cannot be pronounced).

- 1004 Creeper that bestows everything desired.
- 1005 A reference to Shiva.
- 1006 Without a body. Meaning Kama.
- 1007 Kama's wife.
- 1008 Shiva.
- 1009 The one born from the mind, Madana's name.
- 1010 Personified form of spring.
- 1011 The moon.
- 1012 With the moon on the crest, Shiva's name.
- 1013 Shiva has three eyes.
- 1014 Shiva.
- 1015 Four fires on four sides and the sun overhead.
- 1016 Or Oushadhiprastha. A mountain near Kailasa, where many kinds of herbs and medicinal plants were found. The capital of Himalaya's kingdom.
- 1017 She is sometimes described as Daksha's daughter. In some accounts, Skanda never married.
- 1018 The same as Shrinagara.
- 1019 Marrying Kameshvara.
- 1020 As Brahma, Vishnu and Maheshvara.
- 1021 *Shodashi* means sixteen. These are sixteen sacred spots, nine in mountains (on earth) and seven in oceans.
- 1022 Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva are first described as Adhikaripurushas, those who possess the rights. They are now described as Karanapurushas, those who are the causes.
- 1023 Himalaya.
- 1024 This seems to mean the first *varna* (letter) of the name.
- 1025 Agastya drank up the ocean.
- 1026 Tower placed above the main gate.
- 1027 These *shlokas* on the dimensions are not very clear and liberties have been taken.
- 1028 Perhaps as additional structures.
- 1029 It was in the form of a square, with five *yojanas* along each side.
- 1030 *Mukutas*. These were like domes at the top.
- 1031 *Chuta* is mango, *kankolaka* (*kankola*) is *Piper Cubeba*, *lodhra* is the lotus bark tree, *bakula* is a flowering tree, *karnikara* is *Cassia Fistula*, *shimshapa* is similar to *ashoka*, *shirisha* is a variety of acacia or mimosa, *devadaru* is a kind of pine (cedar), *nameru* is *Elaeocarpus*, *punnaga* is

nutmeg, *nagabhadra* is probably the same as *nagakeshara*, a flowering tree, *muchukunda* is a kind of *karnikara*, *katphala* is the bayberry tree, *ela* is cardamom, *lavanga* is clove, *takkola* is a kind of pepper, *karpura* is camphor, *pilu* is *Salvadora persica*, *kakatunda* is dark *Agallochum*, *shalaka* (*shala*) is a tall tree, *Shorea robusta*, *asana* is *Terminalia tomentosa*, *kanchana* is the orchid tree, *ara* is the name of an unidentified tree, *lakucha* is the breadfruit tree, *panasa* is jackfruit, *hingula* is a medicinal plant, *patala* is the trumpet flower, *phalini* is the same as the *priyangu* creeper, *jatili* is probably *Ceropegia juncea*, *jaghanephala* is *Ficus hispida*, *ganika* is a kind of jasmine, *kuranda* is the name of a plant, *bandhujiva* is *Pentapetes Phænicea*, *dadima* is pomegranate, *ashvakarana* is either *Shorea robusta* or a medicinal plant, *hastikarna* is the castor oil plant, *champaka* is a tree with yellow and fragrant flowers, *kanakadruma* is thorn apple, *yuthika* is jasmine, *talaparni* is *Anethum graveolens*, *tulasi* is holy basil, *sadaphala* is *bilva*, fig or coconut, *tala* is a palm tree, *tamala* is a tree with dark bark, *hintala* is a variety of palm, *kharjura* is date, *shara* is white reed, *barbura/barbara* is a kind of ocimum, *ikshu* is sugarcane, *kshirina/kshirini* is a medicinal plant, *shleshmantaka* (*shleshmataka*) is *Cordia dichotoma*, *vibhitaka* and *haritaka* are kinds of myrobalan, *avakpushpa* is *Anethum sowa*, *ghontali* is jujube, *svargapushpika* is a tree from heaven, *bhallataka* is the marking nut, *khadira* is acacia, *shakhota* is *Trophis aspera*, *chandana* is sandalwood, *kalaguru* is black aloe, *kalaskandha* is ebony, *chinha* is tamarind, *vata* is banyan, *udumbara* is fig, *arjuna* is a tall tree, *ashvattha* is the holy fig tree, *shami* is *Prosopis cineraria*, *dhruva* is the Indian fig tree, *ruchaka* is citron, *kutaja* is a kind of coral tree, *saptaparna* (*saptaparni*) is *Alstonia scholaris*, *kritamalaka* is *Cassia fistula*, *kapittha* is wood apple and *tintini* (*tintrini*) is a kind of tamarind.

¹⁰³² Garden filled with *kalpavriksha* trees.

¹⁰³³ Second after the bronze, not counting from the beginning.

¹⁰³⁴ Since *naga* means lead, this was made from lead.

¹⁰³⁵ The five trees in heaven are Mandara, Parijata, Santana, Kalpa and Harichandana. Accordingly, this garden (*vatika*) has Santana trees, just as the earlier one had Kalpa trees. There was a garden for each of these trees. In addition, there was Kadambavatika. *Nipa* is the same as *kadamba*.

¹⁰³⁶ The word used is *arakuta*, which means brass. But this is clearly the same as the chamber made of lead. *Panchaloha* is an alloy made of gold,

silver, copper, zinc and iron.

¹⁰³⁷ The same as *nipa*.

¹⁰³⁸ Vishvakarma.

¹⁰³⁹ That is, Lalitaa Devi's residence.

¹⁰⁴⁰ The father was Matanga and the son was Maatanga. But since there is no danger of confusion, we have written the son as Matanga.

¹⁰⁴¹ *Mudra* means a seal or sign. Since Mantranayikaa had Lalitaa Devi's signet ring, she was known as Mudrini.

¹⁰⁴² The same as *tamala*.

¹⁰⁴³ Respectively, Time/Destiny and Death.

¹⁰⁴⁴ Kalachakra is the wheel of time. The reference to Matanga is not obvious. There are *agama* (such as *tantra*) texts attributed to Matanga. Alternatively, Devi's sacred seats are known as *peethas* and one of these is named Matanga.

¹⁰⁴⁵ This is a *yantra*, with Mahakala and Mahakali in the centre.

¹⁰⁴⁶ Literally, great dawn, great dusk and great night.

¹⁰⁴⁷ Respectively, break of day, onset of night, forenoon, afternoon and mid-day.

¹⁰⁴⁸ Respectively, day, night, dark night, night with moonlight, night with two *tithis*, evening, midnight, period of three hours, night with full moon, day of full moon, night before full moon, night of new moon, divinity of full moon, day of new moon, the second *tithi* and an eclipse.

¹⁰⁴⁹ *Truti* is one-fourth of a *kshana*, *kutapa* is the eighth *muhurta* of the day, while *hora* is hour. *Samvatsara* is the solar year, *anuvatsara* is the lunar year, *parivatsara* seems to have been calculated on the basis of Jupiter's orbit and *vatsara* was calculated on the basis of the *nakshatras*. Since *idavatsara* occurred once every five years, it probably had an intercalary month. *Indu-vatsara* means *anuvatsara*. *Vara* means a solar day, while *yoga* is a conjunction. *Karana* is half a *tithi*.

¹⁰⁵⁰ Vasanta (spring) has the two months of Madhu (Chaitra) and Madhava (Vaishakha). These are the personified forms of the beauty of these two months.

¹⁰⁵¹ Grishma (summer) has the two months Shukra (Jyeshtha) and Shuchi (Ashadha).

¹⁰⁵² Varsha (monsoon) has the two months Nabhas (Shravana) and Nabhasya (Bhadrapada). The other ten are attributes of the monsoon. For instance, Varidharaa means water pouring down.

¹⁰⁵³ They are his wives. Sharad (autumn) consists of the months Isha (Ashvina) and Urja (Kartika).

¹⁰⁵⁴ Hemanta is pre-winter or late fall and consists of the two months Sahas (Margashirsha) and Sahasya (Pousha).

¹⁰⁵⁵ Shishira is winter and consists of the two months Tapas (Magha) and Tapasya (Phalguna).

¹⁰⁵⁶ *Shukla paksha* has fifteen *tithis*, starting with *prathama* and ending with *purnima*. There are also fifteen for *krishna paksha*, aggregating to thirty. Accordingly, for the month of Madhu, we have thirty Shaktis. Vasanta's second month of Madhava gives us another thirty Shaktis. With six seasons, the total is $60 \times 6 = 360$.

¹⁰⁵⁷ Singers, typically celestial.

¹⁰⁵⁸ That is, *apsaras*.

¹⁰⁵⁹ There are fourteen classes of *apsaras* — Shobhayantyas, Vegavatyas, Uryas, Ayuvatyas, Shubhancharas, Kuravas, Shubhas, Vahnayas, Amritas, Mudas, Bhavas, Ruchas, Bhairavas and Shoshayantyas.

¹⁰⁶⁰ The earth.

¹⁰⁶¹ Thirteen sources are mentioned. The fourteenth is the churning of the ocean of milk.

¹⁰⁶² The word *vajra* also means diamond.

¹⁰⁶³ Indra. Indra killed a demon named Bala.

¹⁰⁶⁴ Indra's direction is the east and Agni's direction is the south-east. Yama's direction is the south and Nirriti's is south-west. Varuna's direction is the west and Vayu's is the north-east. Kubera's (the lord of *yakshas*) direction is the north and Rudra's direction is the north-east.

¹⁰⁶⁵ These are the names of different hells, where a sinner faces different kinds of hardships. For example, Kalasutra is the thread of destiny, Rourava is one where the sinner screams in pain, Kumbhipaka is one where he is cooked in a pot full of boiling oil, Asipatravana is a place where the leaves of trees and bushes are like swords, Krimibhaksha is one where he is devoured by worms, he is struck in Pratapana, made to survive on saliva in Lalakshepa, pierced with needles in Suchivedha and burning coal is hurled down on him in Angarapatana.

¹⁰⁶⁶ This seems to mean Guha, rather than Yama.

¹⁰⁶⁷ To the west of Yama's world.

¹⁰⁶⁸ Fish means *makara*.

¹⁰⁶⁹ As in school of philosophy.

¹⁰⁷⁰ Goraksha means Gorakhnath. Without getting into issues of dating Goraknath, this indicates when these portions of *Brahmanda Purana* were composed.

¹⁰⁷¹ Meaning Vayu. He is also known as Maruteshvara, the lord of winds.

¹⁰⁷² These are the channels of energy, on the left, the right and the centre.

¹⁰⁷³ Feminine of *yaksha*.

¹⁰⁷⁴ *Yougika* is the original name, used in *yoga*. *Roudhika* is a derived and conventional name.

¹⁰⁷⁵ The text doesn't clearly state that these are the sheaths. We have expanded, so that the meaning is clear. In some instances, we have stated the name as singular, but the text has the plural, indicating that the same name has several Rudras.

¹⁰⁷⁶ Known as Nigraha Devis. Usually, six names are given — Dakini, Rakini, Lakini, Kakini, Shakini and Hakini. But since Unmattabhairavi and Svapeshi have been mentioned, given the description of the battle earlier, the seven seem to be Ashvarudha, Sampadishaa, Nakuli, Mahamayaa, Laghushyamaa, Vagvadini and Chandakali.

¹⁰⁷⁷ Serve Lalitaa.

¹⁰⁷⁸ The fourteen kinds of learning (*vidya*) are the four *Vedas*, the six *Vedangas*, *Dhanurveda*, *Ayurveda*, *Gandharvaveda* and *Arthashastra*. It is unnecessary to list the sixty-four arts (*kalaas*). They are listed, for example, in Vatsyayana.

¹⁰⁷⁹ The fourth hand holds a lotus.

¹⁰⁸⁰ Meaning, with one thousand pillars.

¹⁰⁸¹ These are divided into four schools of Kapala, Kalamukha, Pashupata and Shaiva.

¹⁰⁸² *Vapi* means well or pond. *Vapitraya* means three wells, subsequently described as those of *amrita* (nectar), *ananda* (bliss) and *vimarsha* (reflection). Much of what is in these sections is an allegory and is not meant to be a physical description. This becomes even clearer in this chapter. One uses the waters from these wells, goes through a process of *yoga* and attains Lalitaa Devi. The offering of *arghya* is the act of worship.

¹⁰⁸³ The mind.

¹⁰⁸⁴ *Rasayana* is impossible to translate. Literally, it is the path of pursuing *rasa*. Loosely, it means alchemy or chemistry. *Rasayana* is the path of rejuvenation and finding an elixir.

¹⁰⁸⁵ *Anuloma* means the normal direction, *pratiloma* means the contrary direction. Here, the words respectively mean anti-clockwise and clockwise.

¹⁰⁸⁶ Intelligence, intellect.

¹⁰⁸⁷ Ego.

¹⁰⁸⁸ The solar disc.

¹⁰⁸⁹ In this context, *kuruvinda* means rubies.

¹⁰⁹⁰ One for each month.

¹⁰⁹¹ The lunar disc.

¹⁰⁹² In some accounts, Chandra/Chandrama (the moon), also known as Soma, was the son of the sage Atri and Anasuya. Somanatha means Soma's lord. Shashi is another of Chandra's names.

¹⁰⁹³ One of the *nakshatras*, the first in the present list of twenty-seven.

¹⁰⁹⁴ That is, Kama. Kama's five flowery arrows are made out of lotus, *ashoka*, mango, jasmine and blue lotus. They are also known as *unmatta* (causing madness), *rodana* (causing crying), *shoshana* (causing drying up), *sammohana* (causing delusion) and *stambhana* (causing stupefaction), because of the effects they lead to. Kama is also known as Smara.

¹⁰⁹⁵ The land lotus, a kind of hibiscus.

¹⁰⁹⁶ These are the ten Shaktis.

¹⁰⁹⁷ Sixteen in number. There are ten digits for Brahma, Vishnu and Rudra.

¹⁰⁹⁸ Respectively, yellow, white, red and black.

¹⁰⁹⁹ Consciousness.

¹¹⁰⁰ Written in this way, to distinguish the masculine and the feminine in *hotri*.

¹¹⁰¹ With the rays, shining.

¹¹⁰² Oumkara is utterance of the word OUM.

¹¹⁰³ The fourth (*turiya*) line of *gayatri mantra*.

¹¹⁰⁴ Probably meaning the names Hari, Krishna and Rama.

¹¹⁰⁵ *Mantra* with five *aksharas*, *Shivaaya namah* = *Shi+vaa+ya+na+mah*.

¹¹⁰⁶ Tryambaka = *tryam+ba+ka*.

¹¹⁰⁷ The word *aksha* means the senses.

¹¹⁰⁸ These are the names of the fourth and the fifth.

¹¹⁰⁹ Literally, the ocean consisting of the six sacred texts. It is a reference to a text on *tantra*. More accurately, it is a reference to six separate texts (*Shadammaya*), emerging from six of Shiva's mouths. *Purvamnaya* emerged from the face that is towards the east, *Dakshinamnaya* from the face that is towards the south, *Paschimamnaya* from the face that is towards the west, *Uttaramnaya* from the face that is towards the north, *Urddhvamnaya* from the face that is upwards and *Adhanamnaya* from the face that is downwards. These texts are also identified with parts of Devi's body.

¹¹¹⁰ Respectively, resolve, action and knowledge.

¹¹¹¹ *Peetha* is Devi's sacred seat and *Peethesha* means lord of *peetha*.

¹¹¹² The description ascends upwards, vertically. In each layer, there is a *chakra* (circle or focal point of energy), a Chakrini (leader of the *chakra*) and divinities who exist at that level. There are also *mudras* who protect the *chakra*.

¹¹¹³ The meanings of most these *siddhis* are obvious and need no explanation. *Khadga-siddhi* is success in weapons, *paduka-siddhi* is an ability to go anywhere, *vaksiddhi* is success in speech and *deha-siddhi* pertains to the body.

¹¹¹⁴ The names are sometimes given as masculine and sometimes as feminine.

¹¹¹⁵ Only twelve names have been given, not sixteen. They respectively attract, or drag away, desire, intelligence, taste, smell, consciousness, fortitude, memory, names, seeds, *artha*, *amrita* and the body.

¹¹¹⁶ One who fulfils all wishes.

¹¹¹⁷ That is, Anangapurvikaa.

¹¹¹⁸ The letters in *ka-varga* and so on.

¹¹¹⁹ Agastya swallowed and digested a demon named Vatapi.

¹¹²⁰ The word *bana* means arrow.

¹¹²¹ Five arrows, two goads and two bows. To get four, one counts arrow, bow, goad and noose.

¹¹²² *Musala* and *mudgara* are clubs/bludgeons, *kripaṇa* is a sword, *pattisha* is an axe or spear and *bhindipala* is a catapult.

¹¹²³ Agastya killed Ilvala, Vatapi's brother.

¹¹²⁴ Only three names are given.

¹¹²⁵ *Paduka* means sandal. The nuance is that they followed in the footsteps of their *gurus*.

¹¹²⁶ There are only fourteen names, unless one treats one of the Nityaas as a proper name, not as a qualifier.

¹¹²⁷ The past, present and future.

¹¹²⁸ Devis of different limbs (*anga*) of the body.

¹¹²⁹ Respectively corresponding to heart, head, tuft of hair, armour, sight and weapon.

¹¹³⁰ Brahma, Vishnu, Mahesha, Ishvara and the paramatman.

¹¹³¹ *Shlokas* for two of the four legs are clearly missing.

¹¹³² *Kalpavriksha* tree.

¹¹³³ Here, the word *pada* is to be understood in the sense of an inflected word. When a word is uttered, the most important part is the sound.

¹¹³⁴ Surya's.

¹¹³⁵ *Amṇaya* means traditional texts, passed down by transmission. But as mentioned earlier, these specifically mean a class of *tantra* texts.

¹¹³⁶ This probably means a *mantra* to Varahi.

¹¹³⁷ These are *bija mantras*, with deep esoteric and mystical significance. At the core is a mantra with fifteen *aksharas* (*panchadashi*). These are taken in three groups—*ka, e, i, la, hrim*; *ha, sa, ka, ha, la, hrim*; and *sa, ka, la, hrim, ka*. These *aksharas* are interpreted in different ways and a sixteenth *akshara* is added for Lalitaa. The second group seems to have six letters, not five.

¹¹³⁸ Probably meaning *e, i* and *sa*.

¹¹³⁹ *Kshiti* is the earth. Given the secret and mystical nature of these *mantras*, we may not have got the sense exactly right.

¹¹⁴⁰ *Urddhapundra* consists of vertical lines, in the shape of U. *Tripundra* has three horizontal lines. *Pattavardhana* is in the shape of a leaf. *Agastyapatra* is in the shape of a leaf of the Agastya (*Agasti Grandiflorum*) flower.

¹¹⁴¹ *Anga-nyasa* is the mental appropriation (*nyasa*) of different limbs of the body (*anga*) to different divinities. *Kara-nyasa* is similarly done to different parts of the hand (*kara*).

- ¹¹⁴² *Rudraksha*.
- ¹¹⁴³ The personified form of learning.
- ¹¹⁴⁴ Desiring him.
- ¹¹⁴⁵ Another name for Chandra.
- ¹¹⁴⁶ Surya.
- ¹¹⁴⁷ Lord of speech, Brihaspati's name.
- ¹¹⁴⁸ Respectively, stupefy them, cause them to yawn, drive them away, delude them and kill them.
- ¹¹⁴⁹ Ganga.
- ¹¹⁵⁰ The text says, homes of Kandarpa.
- ¹¹⁵¹ We have amended a slight typo in the text.
- ¹¹⁵² A *chakra* is the focal point in a body, used for meditation. The usual list has twelve *chakras*—*muladhara*, *svadhishtana*, *manipura*, *anahata*, *vishuddha*, *ajna* and *sahasrara*. In the twelve-chakra system, there are six within the body and six that are outside the body, higher and universal. The six within the body are *muladhara*, *svadhishtana*, *manipura*, *anahata*, *vishuddha* and *ajna*. The higher six are *sahasrara*, *narayanana*, *brahmanana*, *trikuthi*, *svaminana* and *muktanana*. *Brahmarandhra* is the centre of the brain and *sahasrara* is located inside *brahmarandhra*.
- ¹¹⁵³ Eight *siddhis* have been mentioned earlier. Five *siddhis* usually refer to knowing the past, present and future, an ability to handle opposite pairs of sentiments, knowing the minds of others, an ability to remain unconquered and an ability to counter the forces of nature.
- ¹¹⁵⁴ The word *lalana* means to fondle and caress. Lalitaa is derived from that.
- ¹¹⁵⁵ Molecule.
- ¹¹⁵⁶ Consciousness.
- ¹¹⁵⁷ Kanchi.
- ¹¹⁵⁸ Jishnu is Vishnu's name, meaning the victorious one.
- ¹¹⁵⁹ Since both of them originated from Lalitaa.
- ¹¹⁶⁰ We have corrected a certain typo in the text, which has the expression *pratibhata*. This cannot be translated as anything meaningful.
- ¹¹⁶¹ One who transcends the universe.
- ¹¹⁶² Where *karma* is performed.
- ¹¹⁶³ Indra.
- ¹¹⁶⁴ A *jivanmukta* is a person who is emancipated, while still alive in his physical body.

¹¹⁶⁵ Vani is Sarasvati, the Goddess of speech, and Kamalaa is Lakshmi, the Goddess of wealth. Sarasvati is known as Bharati, while Lakshmi is known as Shri.

¹¹⁶⁶ The auspicious one, Tripurasundari.

¹¹⁶⁷ *Ka+ma+kshi*.

¹¹⁶⁸ Vishnu and Lakshmi.

¹¹⁶⁹ Auspicious thread worn by a married woman around the neck.

¹¹⁷⁰ With an obvious allusion to Kama's bow.

¹¹⁷¹ The reflection was instated.

¹¹⁷² Respectively, Vishnu, Surya and Shiva.

¹¹⁷³ Truth, consciousness and bliss.

¹¹⁷⁴ *Shava* means dead body, corpse. Without Shakti, Shiva becomes inert.

¹¹⁷⁵ The Goddess of speech, Sarasvati.

¹¹⁷⁶ Mukunda is Purushottama Vishnu and Indiraa is Shri or Lakshmi.

Ambikaa is Parvati and Shiva is Paramesha.

¹¹⁷⁷ River Kampa in Kanchi.

¹¹⁷⁸ *Saguna* means with *gunas*. *Nirguna* is devoid of *gunas*.

¹¹⁷⁹ *Prapancha* is the visible universe. Hence, the use of the word two probably means the gross and the subtle.

¹¹⁸⁰ Literally, the single mango tree. The tirtha in Kanchi.

¹¹⁸¹ Shri Vidyaa.

¹¹⁸² Because of austerities and because of separation from Gouri.

¹¹⁸³ *Kampa* means trembling. The river is called Kampa. Since *anukampa* means compassion, there is a play on words.

¹¹⁸⁴ Shiva.

¹¹⁸⁵ From the anger directed at Brahma and Vishnu.

¹¹⁸⁶ The sin of killing a *brahmana*.

¹¹⁸⁷ The one with the skull. Shiva's/Bhairava's name.

¹¹⁸⁸ Shiva.

¹¹⁸⁹ Of Kashi.

¹¹⁹⁰ Although Vasishtha mentions the story, he doesn't exactly recount it. Kalmashapada Soudasa was Dasharatha's ancestor and was cursed that he couldn't have a son. Through a system of *niyoga*, where another man impregnates the wife, Madayanti, Soudasa's wife, had a son through Vasishtha. In that sense, one could say Vasishtha's lineage and Dasharatha's lineage are the same.

¹¹⁹¹ Maya is Haridvara and Avantika is Ujjain. Usually, seven sacred cities are mentioned. The one missing in this list is Dvaravati/Dvaraka.

¹¹⁹² *Madhu*, alternatively, liquor.

¹¹⁹³ *Payasam* is a dish made out of sweetened milk and rice.

¹¹⁹⁴ Dasharatha was Indumati's son.

¹¹⁹⁵ Since *pankti* means ten, this is an unusual, but correct way of addressing Dasharatha.

¹¹⁹⁶ *Dharma, artha, kama*.

¹¹⁹⁷ Alternatively, liquor.

¹¹⁹⁸ Ikshvaku was Dasharatha's ancestor, the first king of the lineage.

¹¹⁹⁹ *Pundrekshu* is a specific type of sugarcane.

¹²⁰⁰ With external worship and inside his mind.

¹²⁰¹ Shrichakra or Shriyantra is a mystical diagram, difficult to comprehend from the text alone. In its two-dimensional form, *bindu* is in the centre. There are nine interlocking triangles around it. The four that face upwards represent Shiva. The four that face downwards represent Shakti. Outside this, there are lotuses with eight petals and sixteen petals. There are three *mandalas* around this.

¹²⁰² Alternatively, liquor.

¹²⁰³ *Naivedya* is an offering of food, *masha* is *urad dal* and *apupa* is a sweet cake.

¹²⁰⁴ Knowledge/learning about Shridevi.

¹²⁰⁵ The traditional transmission of knowledge from *guru* to *shishya*.

¹²⁰⁶ That is, pure.

¹²⁰⁷ *Bija mantras* are sacred and therefore, not usually stated. This might be

¹²⁰⁸ *Anuloma* means to use the *aksharas* in the usual order, from the front. *Pratiloma* means to start with the *aksharas* at the end and do it in the reverse order.

¹²⁰⁹ A term particularly used in *tantra*. This means to accomplish a task, with a specific objective in mind, within a stipulated period of time.

¹²¹⁰ Rites undertaken to control others.

¹²¹¹ Bright yellow pigment obtained from a cow.

¹²¹² Of the image.

¹²¹³ This sentence is such that it is impossible to understand its meaning. Taking the word *triputa* to mean triangle, we have taken liberties.

¹²¹⁴ *Kshobhini mudra* is the *mudra* that agitates. The index and middle fingers of both hands are together and are used to point. The other fingers are close together.

¹²¹⁵ There is a taxonomy of different kinds of fever (*jvara*). *Chaturthika* is the fever that is heightened on the fourth day.

¹²¹⁶ A gruel made from fermented rice.

¹²¹⁷ Red ochre.

¹²¹⁸ One who has sought refuge.

¹²¹⁹ The text says *karpanya*, niggardliness. We have changed it to *karunya*, compassion.

¹²²⁰ Transcendental knowledge about the *paramatman*.

¹²²¹ Used for invocation.

¹²²² *Mudra* that causes agitation.

¹²²³ One that drives away.

¹²²⁴ One that attracts.

¹²²⁵ That which maddens.

¹²²⁶ The great goad.

¹²²⁷ Literally, travelling in the sky.

¹²²⁸ Based on the word Shambhu, which can be interpreted in various ways, for example, conducive to welfare.

¹²²⁹ While there are several *suktams* that go by the name of *Devi suktam*, this should mean *Rig Veda* 10.125. This is also known as *Ambhrini suktam*. *Purusha suktam* is *Rig Veda* 10.90.

¹²³⁰ It is recommended that sixteen objects (*shodasha upachara*) should be used for worship. The list varies, but will typically include some combination of five *amritas* (ghee, milk, curds, molasses honey), five objects from a cow, five jewels, five kinds of leaves, seven kinds of clay, seven kinds of grain, seven types of minerals, eight types of gifts (*padya*, *achamana*, seat, garments, flowers and so on), five *upacharas* (fragrances, flowers, incense, lamp, *naivedya*) and so on. In some specific instances, sixty-four kinds of *upachara* are mentioned. The list given here is different. *Avahana* is invocation, *asana* is a seat, *padya* is water for washing the feet, *arghya* is a gift, *achamana* is water for rinsing the mouth, *snana* is a bath, *vastra* is a garment, *bhushana* is an ornament, *gandha* is fragrance, *pushpa* is a flower, *dhupa* is incense, *dipa* is a lamp, *naivedya* is food, *tambula* is betel leaf, *pradakshina* is circumambulation and *pranama* is obeisance.

¹²³¹ In an independent and later text, *Lalita Sahasranama*, Lalitaa's one thousand names are mentioned. This *mantra* does not have one thousand names, it has one thousand *aksharas* and some of those *aksharas* aren't names. Some of those are *bija mantras*. The text counts the entire *mantra* with one thousand *aksharas* as a single *shloka*, thereby under-counting the number of *shlokas* in this chapter. Naturally, the numbering of the names does not exist in the text. We have added them for convenience. Some names are repeated. With that double counting, there are 201 names. As a caveat, the meanings of some names can be translated in more than one way.

- ¹²³² Devi in the heart.
- ¹²³³ Devi in the head.
- ¹²³⁴ Devi in the tuft of hair.
- ¹²³⁵ Devi in the *kavacha*.
- ¹²³⁶ Devi in the eyes.
- ¹²³⁷ Devi in the face.
- ¹²³⁸ With a garland of suns.
- ¹²³⁹ One who is always moist.
- ¹²⁴⁰ The terrible one.
- ¹²⁴¹ One who resides in fire.
- ¹²⁴² Ishvari who is like a great *vajra*.
- ¹²⁴³ Ishvari of learning.
- ¹²⁴⁴ Messenger of the supreme Shiva.
- ¹²⁴⁵ Swift one.
- ¹²⁴⁶ Beautiful one of the lineage.
- ¹²⁴⁷ Eternal one.
- ¹²⁴⁸ One with a blue banner.
- ¹²⁴⁹ The victorious one.
- ¹²⁵⁰ One who is everything auspicious.
- ¹²⁵¹ One with a garland of flames.
- ¹²⁵² The colourful one.
- ¹²⁵³ The great and eternal one.
- ¹²⁵⁴ Ishvari of all *mantras*.
- ¹²⁵⁵ Lord of the *tithi* of *shashthi*.
- ¹²⁵⁶ Full of gardens.
- ¹²⁵⁷ One who fills Lopamudra.
- ¹²⁵⁸ One who fills Agastya.

- 1259 Identical with the one who scorched Kala (Shiva).
1260 Identical with the good conduct of *dharma*.
1261 Identical with Ishvara, who has loose hair.
1262 One who fills up the lamp and the moon.
1263 Identical with the divinity Vishnu.
1264 Identical with the divinity, the sun.
1265 Identical with the divinity of energy.
1266 Identical with the divinity, Kama.
1267 Possessing the *siddhi* of *anima*.
1268 Possessing the *siddhi* of *mahima*.
1269 Possessing the *siddhi* of *garima*.
1270 Possessing the *siddhi* of *laghima*.
1271 Possessing the *siddhi* of *ishvitva*.
1272 Possessing the *siddhi* of *vashitva*.
1273 Possessing the *siddhi* of *prapti*.
1274 Possessing the *siddhi* of *prakamya*.
1275 Possessing the *siddhi* of *rasa*, the word *rasa* can be interpreted in different ways.
1276 Possessing the *siddhi* of *moksha*.
1277 One who agitates everyone/everything.
1278 One who drives away everyone/everything.
1279 One who attracts everyone/everything.
1280 One who subjugates everyone/everything.
1281 One who maddens everyone.
1282 Great goad for everyone.
1283 One who travels everywhere in the sky.
1284 Seed of everything.
1285 Womb of everything.
1286 One who shatters every kind of weapon.
1287 One who deludes the three worlds.
1288 Owner of the *chakra*.
1289 Manifest as a *yogini*.
1290 One whose limbs are Bouddha *darshana*.
1291 One who attracts desire.
1292 One who attracts intelligence.
1293 One who attracts *ahamkara*.
1294 One who attracts sound.

- 1295 One who attracts touch.
1296 One who attracts form.
1297 One who attracts taste.
1298 One who attracts smell.
1299 One who attracts the mind.
1300 One who attracts patience.
1301 One who attracts memory.
1302 One who attracts names.
1303 One who attracts seeds.
1304 One who attracts *atmans*.
1305 One who attracts *amrita*.
1306 One who attracts bodies.
1307 The secret *yogini*.
1308 Owner of the *chakra* that fulfils all wishes.
1309 Identical with Ananga's flowers.
1310 Identical with Ananga's girdle.
1311 One who maddens Ananga.
1312 Afflicted by Ananga's desire.
1313 Marked with Ananga's lines.
1314 Possessing Ananga's speed.
1315 Identical with Ananga's goad.
1316 One who wears Ananga's garland.
1317 The most secret *yogini*.
1318 One whose limbs are the *darshana* of the *Vedas*.
1319 Owner of the *chakra* that causes agitation to everyone.
1320 Presiding divinity of the eastern *amnaya*.
1321 One whose form is creation.
1322 One who delights everyone.
1323 One who deludes everyone.
1324 One who stupefies everyone.
1325 One who makes everyone yawn.
1326 One who delights everyone.
1327 One who accomplishes every objective.
1328 One who fills up with every kind of prosperity.
1329 One who is full of every kind of *mantra*.
1330 One who destroys every kind of duality.
1331 *Yogini* who follows the tradition.

- 1332 One whose limbs are Surya's *darshana*.
- 1333 The *chakra* that bestows every kind of good fortune.
- 1334 One who bestows every kind of *siddhi*.
- 1335 One who bestows every kind of prosperity.
- 1336 One who does what is agreeable to everyone.
- 1337 One who does everything that is auspicious.
- 1338 One who bestows everything desired.
- 1339 One who frees from every kind of misery.
- 1340 One who pacifies death for everyone.
- 1341 One who counters every kind of impediment.
- 1342 Beautiful in every limb.
- 1343 One who bestows every kind of good fortune.
- 1344 *Yogini* who has gone beyond the *kula*. *Kula* means lineage or family

and rituals and practices have been progressively passed down from one generation to another, especially in *tantra*. In general, this is called *kulachara* (the practice of the *kula*) or *kulamarga* (the path of the *kula*). Within these strands, there are further divisions.

- 1345 Ishvari of the *chakra* that accomplishes all objectives.
- 1346 The omniscient one.
- 1347 Possessing every kind of Shakti.
- 1348 One who bestows every kind of prosperity as fruits.
- 1349 Possessing every kind of *jnana*.
- 1350 One who counters every kind of ailment.
- 1351 One whose form is every kind of support.
- 1352 One who dispels every kind of sin.
- 1353 Full of every kind of bliss.
- 1354 One whose form protects everyone.
- 1355 One who bestows every desired fruit.
- 1356 One who engages.
- 1357 One whose limbs are Vaishnava *darshana*.
- 1358 One who is established in the *chakra* that protects everyone.
- 1359 Ishvari of the southern *amnaya*.
- 1360 One whose form is preservation.
- 1361 One who controls.
- 1362 One who delights.
- 1363 The sparkling one.
- 1364 The red one.

- 1365 The victorious one.
- 1366 Ishvari of everyone/everything.
- 1367 One who follows the *kula* rituals.
- 1368 Mysterious *yogini*.
- 1369 One whose enjoyment is mysterious.
- 1370 One who protects secrets.
- 1371 One whose limbs are Shakta *darshana*.
- 1372 Owner of a *chakra* that dispels all ailments.
- 1373 Western *amnaya*.
- 1374 Devi with a bow and arrow, noose and goad.
- 1375 Vajra's Ishvari.
- 1376 With a garland of good fortune.
- 1377 Extremely mysterious *yogini*.
- 1378 One whose limbs are Shaiva *darshana*.
- 1379 *Chakra* that bestows every kind of *siddhi*.
- 1380 Ishvari of the northern *amnaya*.
- 1381 One whose form is destruction.
- 1382 The pure and the supreme.
- 1383 One established in *bindu* and *peetha*.
- 1384 The great night.
- 1385 One known as greater than the greatest.
- 1386 One whose limbs are Shambhava *darshana*.
- 1387 Owner of the *chakra* that possesses every kind of bliss.
- 1388 One who resides in Tripura.
- 1389 The prosperity of Tripura.
- 1390 With Tripura as a garland.
- 1391 One with *siddhi* in Tripura.
- 1392 The mother in Tripura.
- 1393 Present in every *chakra*.
- 1394 One whose own form is known as the absolute *amnaya*.
- 1395 Bhairavi of the great Tripura.
- 1396 One whose form is the four kinds of *gunas*. Because of the number four, this probably means *sattva*, *rajas*, *tamas* and *nirguna*.
- 1397 With a *kula*.
- 1398 Without a *kula*.
- 1399 With a *kula* and without a *kula*.
- 1400 With a great *kula*.

- 1401 Beyond everything.
- 1402 One whose limbs are every kind of *darshana*.
- 1403 Seated on nine seats.
- 1404 With nine *aksharas*.
- 1405 In the form of a new couple.
- 1406 One whose *atman* has the form of Mahesha, Madhava, Vidhatri, Manmatha, Skanda, Nandi, Indra, Manu, Chandra, Kubera, Agastya and Durvasa's rage and venerable learning.
- 1407 One whose form consists of the three beneficial *tattvas*.
- 1408 One whose *atman* is Shiva and Shiva.
- 1409 The Shakti of the complete *brahman*.
- 1410 A wooden vessel, also a measure of capacity.
- 1411 *Nyagrodha* is the holy fig tree, while *jambu* is rose apple. *Makanda* has several meanings, such as mango, myrobalan or yellow sandalwood.
- 1412 Respectively, Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva.
- 1413 Alternatively, liquor.
- 1414 The disciple.
- 1415 The *guru*'s, since the *guru* bestows the *mantra*.
- 1416 Rites can be *nitya karma* (daily rites), *naimittika karma* (occasional rites) and *kamya karma* (rites performed for a specific objective).
- 1417 Alternatively, liquor.
- 1418 The disciple. There are several parts of this chapter that are not very clear, since they describe a ritualistic practice.
- 1419 *Trikhanda* may refer to display of *trikhanda mudra*, a variant of *yonimudra*. It may also mean fashioning a *trikhanda*, that is, a *mandala* consisting of three parts.
- 1420 For his protection, created through the power of the *mantra*. An *astra mantra* creates this *kavacha* (amour) for him.
- 1421 A *nyasa* is being performed of the *aksharas* on the limbs. The explanation of this extensive *nyasa* is not clear enough. Clearly, one means five consonants that start with , five that start with , five that start with , five that start with and five that start with . In the right order, one starts with and ends with . Then, for *nyasa* in the reverse order, one starts with and ends with . The meaning seems to be something of this kind.
- 1422 This has different meanings, but probably means the *bija mantra*, *aim*.
- 1423 These nine seats are in *anahata chakra*.

¹⁴²⁴ Shakti's energy at the root of the spine, in *muladhara chakra*.

¹⁴²⁵ Shiva.

¹⁴²⁶ Probably meaning *nyasa* of Devi in the form of Kubjikaa, who possesses the colour of *kumkuma*.

¹⁴²⁷ The six lower organs are the two feet, the two knees and the two thighs. Since there is no group of letters that begins with , this is probably a typo and should read , thus meaning the letters , , , and .

¹⁴²⁸ Each *mantra* has a *rishi* as composer and a *chhanda* (metre) in which it is composed and a divinity associated with it. Eight groups of letters were mentioned earlier. In *bhupalipi*, these are (1) the vowels; (2) those beginning with ; (3) those beginning with ; (4) those beginning with ; (5) those beginning with ; (6) those beginning with ; (7) , , , and ; and (8) , and .

¹⁴²⁹ *Kalpavriksha*.

¹⁴³⁰ , , , and . The long forms of these are subsumed in the short forms.

¹⁴³¹ , , and .

¹⁴³² As mentioned earlier, those beginning with ; those beginning with ; those beginning with ; those beginning with ; those beginning with ; and , , , and . The last group has , and . Hence, in this listing, there are nine groups of letters, not eight.

¹⁴³³ Lord of riches, Kubera.

¹⁴³⁴ Counted as one.

¹⁴³⁵ A charming and playful woman.

¹⁴³⁶ A creeper that grants all desires.

¹⁴³⁷ One who causes loss of memory.

¹⁴³⁸ One whose eyes are full of wonder.

¹⁴³⁹ One who licks.

¹⁴⁴⁰ A hump-backed woman or a female servant.

¹⁴⁴¹ One who holds up. Specifically, the earth.

¹⁴⁴² Ramaa is Lakshmi and Ramaa's beloved is Vishnu.

¹⁴⁴³ The excellent one.

¹⁴⁴⁴ One with a single eye, or with an excellent eye. But Ekakshi is also the name of one of the *matrikas*.

¹⁴⁴⁵ One who protects.

¹⁴⁴⁶ One who is charmed, or causes infatuation.

¹⁴⁴⁷ One with beautiful eyes.

- ¹⁴⁴⁸ One with eyes like *palasha* flowers.
- ¹⁴⁴⁹ Horrible or hideous one.
- ¹⁴⁵⁰ The text uses the word *Malaya*, which means a breeze from the south.
- ¹⁴⁵¹ One who causes delight.
- ¹⁴⁵² One who causes joy.
- ¹⁴⁵³ One without a name.
- ¹⁴⁵⁴ The divinity of misfortune.
- ¹⁴⁵⁵ One who is mad.
- ¹⁴⁵⁶ Lord who is half-man and half-woman. Shiva's name.
- ¹⁴⁵⁷ Repeated. There are fifty-one names, one for each letter.
- ¹⁴⁵⁸ There are fifteen Shaktis for vowels and thirty-five for consonants, with a total of fifty, falling one short of fifty. Perhaps *Trailokyavidyaa* is to be read as *Trailokyaa* and *Vidyaa*.
- ¹⁴⁵⁹ Ganesha.
- ¹⁴⁶⁰ However, only forty-nine names are given, with forty-eight names for the Shaktis.
- ¹⁴⁶¹ Respective complexions of Surya/Ravi, Chandra/Soma, Mangala/Kuja (Mars), Shukra (Venus), Budha (Mercury), Brihaspati (Jupiter), Shanaishchara (Saturn), Rahu and Ketu.
- ¹⁴⁶² Only thirteen Shaktis are named. *Amrita* starts with , *Anandini* starts with , *Indrani* starts with , *Ishani* starts with , *Umaa* starts with , *Urddhvakeshi* starts with , *Ridhvidushi* starts with , *Lrikarika* starts with , *Ekapadatmikaa* starts with , *Aishvaryakarini* starts with and *Oushadhatmikaa* starts with . The logic is clear, but is missing and *Ambikaa* and *Rakshatmikaa* do not fit the pattern.
- ¹⁴⁶³ Respectively associated with , , , , , , , , , , and .
- ¹⁴⁶⁴ Respectively associated with , , , , , , , , and . This *Thankarini* is . The earlier *Thankarini* was .
- ¹⁴⁶⁵ Respectively associated with , , , , and .
- ¹⁴⁶⁶ Respectively associated with , , and .
- ¹⁴⁶⁷ Associated with and .
- ¹⁴⁶⁸ Aries. *Nyasa* of six *rashis* on the right side and six on the left.
- ¹⁴⁶⁹ The notion of Shakti *peethas* evolved over time, with a story about Sati giving up her body at the time of Daksha's sacrifice. The dead body was sliced up by Vishnu and fell in different parts, each becoming a Shakti *peetha*. Lists of Shakti *peethas* are given in *Devi Bhagavata Purana* and *Padma Purana* and in *tantra* texts. The numbering is 4, 18, 50/51 and 108,

depending on the text. A geographical identification is often tentative and subjective. The text doesn't have a numbering here. We have added it for convenience.

¹⁴⁷⁰ *Nyasa* of *matrikas*, letters, Shaktis, planets, *rashis* and *peethas*.

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Acknowledgements

The corpus of the Puranas is huge—in scope and size. The Mahabharata is believed to contain 100,000 *shlokas*. The Critical Edition of the Mahabharata, edited and published by the Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, Pune, doesn't quite contain that many *shlokas*. But this still gives us some idea of the size of the epic. To comprehend what 1,00,000 shlokas mean in a standard word count, the ten-volume unabridged translation I did of the Mahabharata (published by Penguin) amounts to a staggering 2.5 million words. After composing the Mahabharata, Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa composed the eighteen *mahapuranas*, or major Puranas. Or so it is believed. (There are *upapuranas*, or minor Puranas too.) Collectively, these eighteen Puranas amount to 4,00,000 *shlokas*, meaning a disconcerting and daunting number of ten million words.

After translating the Bhagavat Gita, the Mahabharata, the *Harivamsha* (1,60,000 words) and the Valmiki Ramayana (5,00,000 words), it was but natural to turn one's attention towards translating the Puranas, that is, the major Puranas. This is the daunting Purana Project, so to speak. (All these translations have been, and will be, published by Penguin Random House India.) As the most popular and most read Purana, the *Bhagavata Purana* was the first to be translated (three volumes, 5,00,000 words). The *Markandeya Purana*, another popular Purana (one volume, 1,75,000 words), came next. This was followed by the *Brahma Purana* (two volumes, 3,90,000 words), the *Vishnu Purana* (1 volume, 1,75,000 words) and the *Shiva Purana* (three volumes, 6,75,000 words). The *Brahmanda Purana* (2 volumes, 3,76,000 words) is the sixth in the series. With eighteen Puranas, the number six is a threshold, in the sense that one-third of the Purana Project has been completed. But this is in terms of number of

Puranas, not in terms of number of *shlokas*, since the *Padma Purana* and the *Skanda Purana* are huge. That these translations were well-received was encouragement along the intimidating journey of translating the remaining Puranas and I am indebted to the reviewers of these various translations. Two obvious points that are sometimes missed. First, the quality of the texts, on the basis of which these translations are being done, varies from one Purana to another. If a Purana has been read a lot, such as the *Bhagavata Purana*, *Markandeya Purana* or *Vishnu Purana*, the text tends to be clean, not characterized by typos. Clearly, the *Brahmanda Purana* isn't one of these and there are typos in the text. Second, the structure of the text varies, depending on the subject. The *Shiva Purana* was a difficult Purana to translate and, as the reader will discover, so is the *Brahmanda Purana*.

As I have traversed the route of the Purana Project, my wife, Suparna Banerjee Debroy, has been a constant source of support and encouragement, providing the conducive environment for the translation work to continue unimpeded. The journey of translating hasn't been an intimidating one only for me. Penguin Random House India must also have thought about it several times, before going ahead with the Purana translations. Most people have some idea about the Ramayana and the Mahabharata, but the Puranas are typically rendered in such dumbed down versions that the readership for unabridged translations had to be created. However, Penguin Random House India also believed in the Purana Project, which still stretches into some interminable horizon in the future, more than one and a half decades down the line. For both author and publisher, this is a long-term commitment. But six have been completed and *Kurma Purana* (one volume) is next in the line. I am indebted to Penguin Random House India, in particular, Meru Gokhale, Moutushi Mukherjee and Yash Daiv. The exceptional editing has ensured that the final product is superior to what I delivered. These Purana translations have been brought alive by the wonderful illustrations by Shamanthi Rajasingham and *Brahmanda Purana* is no different. I also thank the cover designers.

Murli Manohar Joshi is much more than a politician and a former member of Parliament and union minister. Though his subject was physics,

his interest in Sanskrit and the Sanskrit legacy runs deep. Ever since the days of the Mahabharata translation, he has taken a keen and avuncular interest in the progress of the translations. With the threshold of six crossed, I can think of no better person to dedicate the *Brahmanda Purana* to.

12 December 2023

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